Sir Aurel Stein, Colleagues and Collections

Edited by Helen Wang

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Introduction

Helen Wang

Department of Coins and Medals
The British Museum

Twenty years ago, at a time of momentous political change (the opening-up of China, the collapse of the Soviet Union, the tearing down of the Berlin Wall) the Silk Road offered a positive, and conveniently indefinable, ground where the fractured world could come together and establish new relationships. People reading about the Silk Road sooner or later came across the name of Sir Aurel Stein, and many turned to Peter Hopkirk's *Foreign Devils on the Silk Road: The Search for the Lost Treasures of Chinese Chinese Asia* (1980 and subsequent reprints) for the broader picture. With Hopkirk's provocative title and the vilification of Stein in Chinese publications, it was hardly surprising that questions were asked. In the 1990s when Stein's biographer Annabel Walker asked me whether Stein was a competent archaeologist, the best answer I could give her was that, as far as I knew, no one who travelled with Stein wrote their own version of those expeditions, and that the only people who were visiting the remote sites in northwest China were Chinese archaeological teams and international expeditions (such as the 1995 Sino-British Taklamakan Expedition led by Charles Blackmore and Barney White-Spunner). It was an honest, but ignorant, reply. Today, we are in a much better position to answer her question. Sir Aurel Stein was not just a competent archaeologist, he was one of the best archaeologists of his time, with an academic reputation that circled the world. Even the most famous Chinese archaeologist Xia Nai wrote in his diary on 15 January 1936 that he had read On *Ancient Central Asian Tracks* (Stein's summary of his first three expeditions to Central Asia), and that from an academic point of view he found Stein remarkable, his achievements surpassing those of J.G. Andersson (generally considered to be the first archaeologist working in China).[1]

I would like to highlight some of the work that has been done over the last two decades to document the collections of Sir Aurel Stein with the intention that they may be consulted more effectively now and in the future. In the UK, the Stein Collections are housed in various museums, libraries and archives, and in the early 1990s a small group of curators, librarians and archivists agreed to meet annually to share information and expertise about these collections. In 1999 we produced the *Handbook to the Stein Collections in the UK*, and in the bibliography I included all the references I could find to Aurel Stein in *The Times* newspaper. This was not a small undertaking (before the existence of the Times Online website, it involved going to the Guildhall Library in person, queuing in line to use the manually operated microfilm machines, scrolling through the pages, printing out the relevant parts and then typing them up), but it was a worthwhile exercise, as the resulting publication *Sir Aurel Stein in The Times* (2002) allowed us to follow him in that newspaper over a period of some forty years.

An unexpected and very welcome result of the *Handbook* came in the form of a proposal raised by Éva Apor, at the Library of the Hungarian Academy of Sciences, to form an international team to catalogue the Stein Collection in the LHAS. Lilla Russell-Smith was instrumental in helping to get this off the ground and she, John Falconer and myself (on the UK side) and Éva Apor, Ágnes Kelecsényi and Ágnes Kárteszi (on the Hungarian side) produced two volumes: the *Catalogue of the Collections of Sir Aurel Stein in the Library of the*

Hungarian Academy of Sciences (2002), and the *Supplement to the Collections of Sir Aurel Stein in the Library of the Hungarian Academy of Sciences* (2007). After Éva retired, Ágnes Kelecsényi took over as Head of the Oriental Library. It is unfortunate that neither Ágnes nor Lilla were able to contribute a paper to this volume as they have both played very significant roles in the documenting of the Stein collections and deserve a special mention. Ágnes is, without doubt, the expert on Stein in Hungary. Having sorted the Stein Collections at the Library, having played a key role in the cataloguing, and having completed her doctorate on Stein, there are few people who can match her knowledge and experience. Lilla has also played a key role, from her student days at SOAS, and the Circle of Inner Asian Art, through her work on the digitisation of the Stein Collections at the British Museum, and on the UK-Hungarian project. We are delighted that she is now Curator for Central Asian Art, at the Museum für Asiatische Kunst in Berlin.

The *Hungarian Catalogue* and *Stein in The Times* were launched at the Aurel Stein Study Day, held at the British Museum in 2002. The proceedings of the study day, together with a full listing of the Stein papers in the British Museum Central Archives, were published in 2004.

As specialist work continues on the documents, paintings, small finds and textiles that Stein collected, we have also been documenting and digitising the Stein Collections. The British Library's International Dunhuang Project (IDP) web-pages, and in particular the news pages, record all the relevant projects, personnel, publications and conferences. In 2004, Susan Whitfield, Head of IDP, curated 'The Silk Road: Travel, Trade, War and Faith' exhibition at the British Library, with its own exhibition catalogue, and wrote a small, richly illustrated book about Stein.

In 2007 Frances Wood (British Library), Angela Pusey (British Academy) and I organised an international conference in London commemorating the centenary of Stein's first visit to Dunhuang. Frances and I presented a very brief history of the Stein Collections and the key people involved. It was also an opportunity to remind delegates that recent achievements could not have taken place without the hard work and friendship of earlier international collaborations.

This volume, published to mark the 150th anniversary of Stein's birth, presents papers about Stein, his colleagues and his collections. I would like to thank the contributors for their whole-hearted commitment to this volume and for their prompt responses to my many demands. I would also like to thank my colleagues at the British Museum, in particular Andrew Burnett, Joe Cribb and Philip Attwood, successive Keepers of the Department of Coins and Medals, for supporting my own work on Stein, and Josephine Turquet and Eleanor Belson for transforming the texts and images into a digital Research Publication. Very special thanks are due to Josephine, who, as series editor of the British Museum's Research Publications, has worked with me on no fewer than four Stein volumes since 1998: the *Stein Handbook* (1999), the *Stein Study Day Proceedings* (2004), the revised *Stein Handbook* (2008) and now this one.

All quotes from the Sir Aurel Stein Collection housed in the Bodleian Library are reproduced with the kind permission of the British Academy.

Note

1 Xia Nai, Xia Nai riji, vol. 2, Huadong shifan daxue chubanshe, Shanghai, 2011.《夏鼐日记》卷2，华东师范大学出版社，上海， 2011. Xia Nai was critical of Stein's work from a moral point of view.

Editorial note: The papers in this book represent the views of the individual authors, and do not necessarily represent the views of the British Museum.

Aurel Stein's Work in the North-West Frontier Province, Pakistan

Wannaporn Rienjang

Reaserch Assistant, Masson Project, British Museum

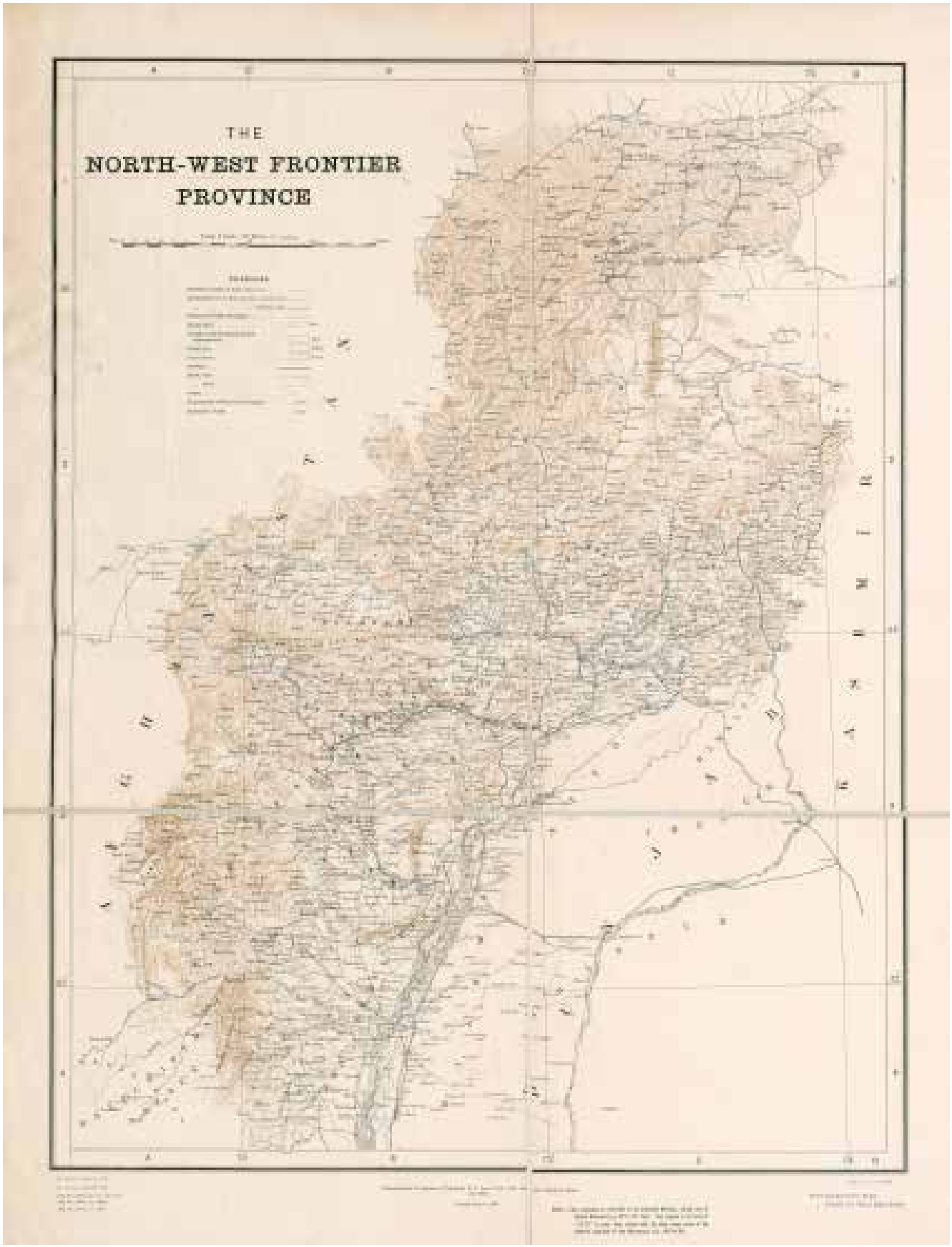
Introduction

Aurel Stein's work in the North-West Frontier Province (NWFP) (Map 1), Pakistan, includes archaeological tours, survey work and excavations carried out during his service in India from 1898 to 1928. Much of his work received support from Colonel Sir Harold Arthur Deane, the first Political Agent of the Malakand and the first Chief Commissioner of the NWFP, who shared an interest in the antiquity of the region with Stein. Many of the sites visited by Stein had never been explored by Europeans before. Most of them yielded Buddhist remains, though his main interest in this region was to follow Alexander the Great's route to the Indus. Throughout his work, Stein made attempts to identify sites with references to Classical and Buddhist sources. Although not all identifications were correct, some proved to be valid and have paved the way for later archaeologists. Stein's work in the NWFP began in 1898, when he was in his mid-30s occupying the position of Principal of the Oriental College, in Lahore. His subsequent position as Superintendent of Archaeology in NWFP from 1904 to 1917 allowed him to conduct further survey work and excavations in this province. Stein retired from service in India in 1917 but obtained an extension of service on 'special duty' to work on publications, the collections from his third Central Asian expedition and other projects until 1928.[1] It was during this time that he returned to conduct another archaeological tour in Upper Swat, a place he had long wanted to visit, in search of Aornos, the site of Alexander's last siege before advancing to the Indus.

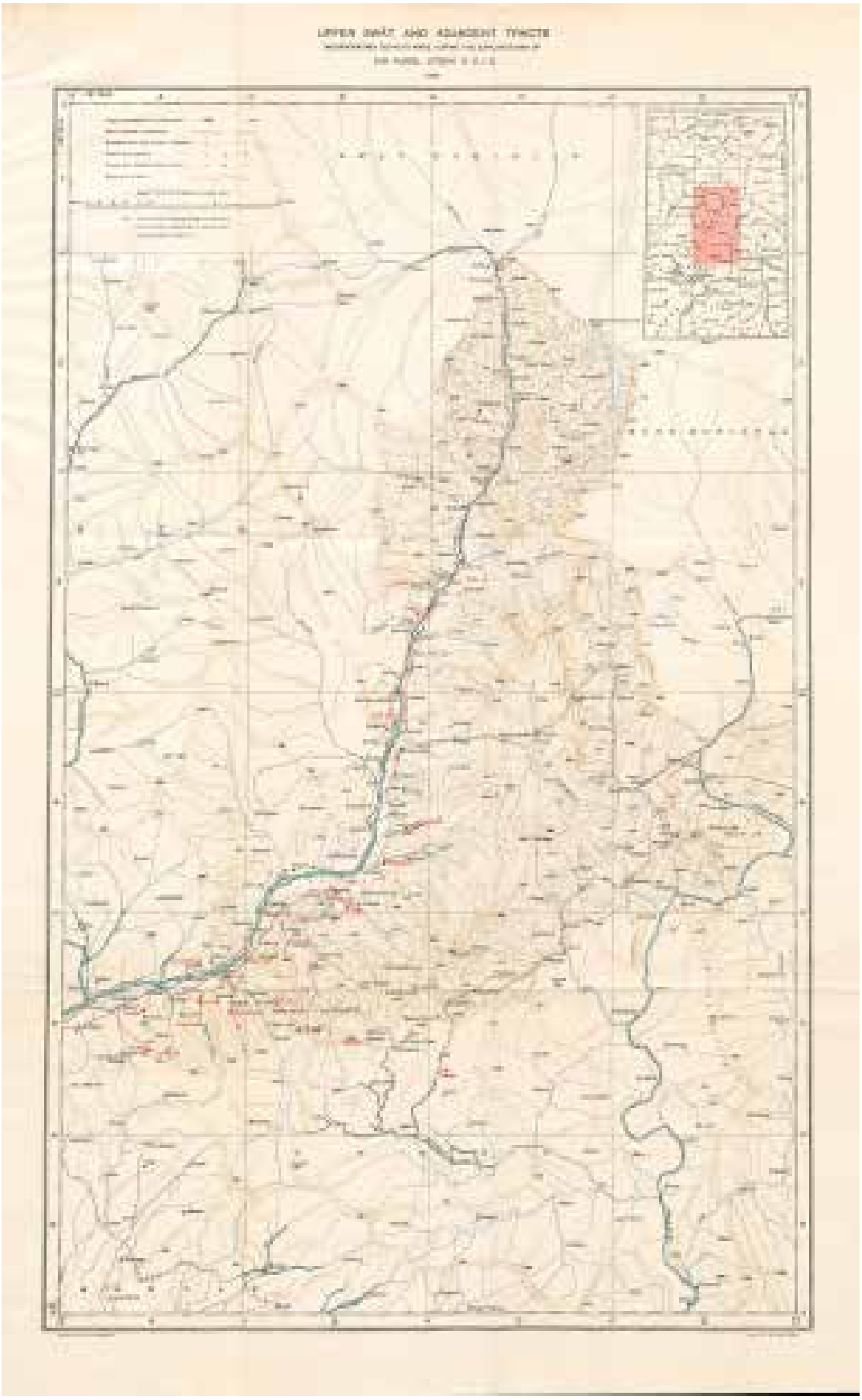
A start in Udyana

The fertile valleys along the Swat River and parts of Buner have long been recognised as forming an ancient place called Udyana (Map 2).[2] Udyana, or 'garden' in Sanskrit, was visited by Chinese – and later Tibetan – Buddhist pilgrims from the 5th century onwards, who recorded numerous Buddhist sites. The place is also renowned for being the birthplace of Padmasambhava, the sage said to have brought Buddhism to Tibet. Stein's first visits to Udyana were made during his Christmas holidays in 1896 and 1897, just one year after the British Chitral Campaign of 1895. There he visited the Buddhist sites and other ancient remains in the lower part of the Swat River. A year later he made another visit to Udyana. This time he conducted a one-month archaeological tour, with the support of Colonel Deane, who arranged for his expedition to be carried out with the Buner Field Force. During this month Stein made a survey of many ancient sites in several villages in Buner as well as parts of the Mardan and Malakand districts. His record of the survey was published the following year.[3] He covered a lot of ground in one month, but the speed of his tour did not allow him much time to make thorough examinations of the sites. Nevertheless, Stein did manage to carry out a brief excavation at Gumbatai (see below).[4]

On visiting several villages in Buner, Stein noted the defensive character of many ruined structures. These structures are situated on a series of rocky ridges, some with traces of ancient fortifications. He did not give any date to them but remarked that they should belong to the pre-Islamic period on the basis of masonry type and coin finds. During



Map 1 Map of NWFP in 1903–1910 ©The British Library Board (Maps I.S)



Map 2 Map of Upper Swat and adjacent hill tracts made by Torabaz Khan under Stein's supervision (Stein, *Memoirs of the Archaeological Survey of India* 42, Calcutta (1930), pp. 1–104, Map 1)

his tour around Tursak, the main village of Buner, Stein visited three main Buddhist sites: Girarai, Gumbatai and Pinjkotai.[5] He identified them with three Buddhist sacred sites recorded by the Chinese pilgrims on the basis of their characters and positions: the Stupa of Dove-ransoming, the *Mo-su* monastery and the *Mahavana* monastery. As recorded by the Chinese pilgrims, these three sites, as well as many other sites in Udyana, are associated with stories of the former lives of the Buddha.[6] In identifying them, Stein made reference to *Mung-kie-li* which he believed located at Manglawar, a town in Upper Swat. *Mung-kie-li* was said to have been the town of residence of the kings of Swat and was taken by the Chinese pilgrims as the starting point of their visits to the sacred sites in Udyana.[7] For this reason, Stein started his identification with the *Mahavana* monastery which the Chinese pilgrim Xuan Zang recorded as being situated by the side of a great hill 200 *li* (approx. 100km) south of *Mung-kie-li*.[8] On visiting the ruins of Pinjkotai, situated on a slope of a spur of a hill approximately 192 *li* (approx. 96km) from Manglawar, Stein identified it with the *Mahavana* monastery. The ruins comprise a large structure and two small circular mounds which Stein ascribed to monastery and stupas, respectively. He disproved Cunningham's identification of the ruins on Mount Mahaban as the *Mahavana* monastery by pointing out that the the ruins on Mount Mahaban were situated south east of Manglawar and not to the south as recorded by the Chinese pilgrims.[9]

The remaining two identifications were made with reference to the location of the *Mahavana* monastery/ Pinjkotai. Xuan Zang recorded that 30–40 *li* (approx. 15 to 20km) north-west of the *Mahavana* monastery lies the *Mo-su* monastery and 60-70 *li* (approx. 30 to 35km) west of the latter lies the Stupa of Dove-ransoming.[10] Taking Pinjkotai to be the *Mahavana* monastery, Stein identified the ruins of Gumbatai, 36 *li* (approx. 18km) north-west of Pinjkotai, and the ruined mounds near Girarai, exactly 60 *li* (approx. 30km) west of Gumbatai, as the *Mo-su* monastery and the Stupa of Dove-ransoming, respectively. Stein visited these three sites and carried out a brief excavation at Gumbatai. He attempted to find the original ground level of the monastery but, owing to a lack of time, he was only able to excavate to a depth of 3 feet and did not reach the original level. The identification of *Mung-kie-li,* the town of residence of the kings of Swat was first proposed by V. De Saint-Martin,[11] and was accepted by Cunningham,[12] Deane[13] and Stein. However, this identification was disproved by later archaeologists who placed *Mung-kie-li* further south and identified it with the modern town of Mingora.[14]

Although most of the sites Stein visited during this brief tour suggested Buddhist connections, Stein made an attempt to visit Mahaban, the mountain claimed as Aornos, the location of Alexander the Great's famous last battle. However, the submission of the Chamla clans in that year did not permit any advance into the Chamla valley south east of Buner where Mahaban is located. Despite this political restriction, Stein was able to visit the north foot of Mahaban with the help of General Jeffreys of the Buner Field Force, who arranged for him to make a rapid excursion to the Chamla valley and who provided him with an escort from the Xth Regiment Bengal Lancers. Five years later, when Stein eventually made it to the top of Mahaban, he determined that its identification as Aornos was invalid.[15]

Survey work in the NWFP and the first attempt to search for Aornos

In July 1903 Stein was appointed to the new combined post of Inspector-General of Education and Archaeological Surveyor for the NWFP and Baluchistan. He began his survey of the regions in January the following year. The survey encompassed districts of the NWFP and Baluchistan, many of which had not yet been explored by Europeans.[16] Stein carried out the survey, taking 60 photographs and recovering more than 200 pieces of Gandharan sculpture. It was during this survey that Stein visited Mahaban, the first European to do so, accompanied by Rai Lal Singh of the Survey of India, who made a survey map under his supervision.

The trip to Mahaban required careful planning. 'Tribal arrangements' needed to be made and some unforeseen (political) complications arose before the start of the trip. However, with help from Colonel Deane, then Chief Commissioner of the NWFP, P.J.G. Pipon, Assistant Commissioner in charge of the Yusufzai District (i.e. the Peshawar valley, then the borderlands between British and independent territories), and some Khans, the tour was eventually made possible. Stein had long wanted to visit Mahaban for a long time. It was 50 years since General Abbott had first identified it as Aornos, observing the mountain from the distant Hazara hills.[17] Colonel Deane had heard from local people that there was an ancient fort on its summit, and this had further stimulated Stein's interest in the mountain.[18] Stein made detailed notes of the ancient remains found on the steep ascent, and on reaching the top of the mountain, he did indeed find an ancient fort. However, careful examination showed that the fort had no connection with Alexander, and that it was probably was of a much later date. Stein concluded that the identification of Mahaban as the Aornos of Alexander's time was invalid:[19] Mahaban had none of the natural features of Aornos as recorded in the classical sources,[20] and no local traditions of any kind were attached to the mountain and the fort. Stein spent one night on the summit, where he experienced heavy rain followed by fierce snow at day break. The view from the top of Mahaban was magnificent, he wrote, though it could not compensate for his disappointment in the search for Aornos.

However, the trip to Mahaban was not wasted, for Stein discovered on Banj mountain, south of Mahaban, some ruins that suggested a monastery and stupas: a sacred Buddhist site. Stein identified this site as the 'Buddha's Body-offering'.[21] According to the Chinese pilgrims, it was where the Buddha, in his former life, was believed to have offered his body to feed a tigress.[22] Cunningham had proposed Manikyala, near Rawalpindi, as the location for the Buddha's Body-offering,[23] but this was rejected by Chavannes, who argued that Cunningham had misinterpreted the texts of the Chinese pilgrims, Song Yun and Xuan Zang, and proposed that the site of the Buddha's Body-offering should be located somewhere towards the Mahaban region.[24] Stein agreed with Chavannes. Although Stein did not have Xuan Zang's book with him when he discovered the ruins, he recognised the

features described by the Chinese pilgrim, including the red soil said to represent the Buddha's blood. Later, when he checked Xuan Zang's description, he was delighted to find that the positions of most of the ruined structures matched with the pilgrim's description.

Further to the south in the NWFP, Stein made surveys in Kohat, Kurram valley, Bannu and the northern part of Dera Ismail Khan.[25] He wondered if the Upper Kurram valley, a strategic location, might have been part of Lo-I [Luoyi], a place described by Fa Xian in the 5th century as having many Buddhist establishments and approximately three thousand monks.[26] Stein did not find any ancient structures in the Upper Kurram valley nor was he informed of any. However, he noted the importance of the Kurram route that links Kabul with the central part of the Indus valley, and learnt from the local people that the Sikaram peak of the Safed Koh, a mountain range on the Afghanistan-Pakistan border, was still a place of regular annual pilgrimage for Hindus from the Indus to Kabul. In Bannu, he took measurements of the main mound of Akra, and determined that the remains of Akra belonged to the main town of ancient Bannu. He examined the banks of soil laid bare by the previous diggings of villagers, and noted the colours of these soils, the finds in them and their possible indications of an ancient 'culture-stratum'.[27] Coins shown to him by the villagers as obtained from Akra ranged from Azes I (*c.* 46–1 BC) to the 'Little Kushans', the Kidarites, (4th–5thcentury AD).[28]

Stein also made a survey of the remains of a mountain stronghold, known locally as Kafirkot, on the Khasor range south-east of the Kurram valley. It comprised ruins of fortifications, temples and shrines of Hindu character. Cunningham had visited this site before and made a brief description of it.[29] Stein made a more detailed description and also discovered one shrine which seemed to have escaped Cunningham's notice. Described as the most ornate shrine, Kanjari-Kothi was overgrown with vegetation at the time of discovery (Stein had the trees cut down before taking its photograph). The site seems to have captured Stein's attention as he camped there for a few days and examined the position, character and extent of each ruin in detail. He noted the remarkable extent of the debris of ancient dwellings and the great quantity of potsherds inside the walls of Kafirkot, and the absence of both outside the walls. No coins or inscriptions were found. Stein assigned this site to the Islamic period on architectural grounds. The total absence of any Islamic remains and the strong Hindu character of the ruins led Stein to suggest that the site was abandoned before or about the time of the final Muslim conquest of this region.[30]

At the end of his survey of the NWFP, Stein had 'put into safe custody' 253 pieces of Gandharan sculpture.[31] These sculptures were handed over to British officials in the NWFP by village headmen and locals who claimed to have found them during 'accidental excavations'.[32] The sculptures ranged from small fragments to statues of almost life-size proportions. The majority of them were given to P.J.G. Pipon, Assistant Commissioner at Mardan from 1902 to 1904. At Stein's suggestion, Pipon arranged for the sculptures to be transferred to the new Peshawar Museum (which opened in 1907). Stein praised Pipon for having kept a careful record of all the alleged find-places. Stein had the sculptures carefully packed and transported to his office, where every piece was subsequently marked with the name of the collector and its alleged find-spot was recorded, before being transported to the new museum.

Excavations at Sahri Bahlol

The site of Sahri Bahlol is renowned for its wealth of Gandharan sculptures. It is situated in the middle of the fertile Peshawar valley, the heartland of Gandhara. The ancient walled urban site lies buried beneath a modern village (settled from the mid-19th century onwards), which prevents its excavation. The settlement is encircled by numerous mounds, fifteen of which have provided sculptural and/or excavation evidence of being Buddhist (**Fig. 1**).[33] One of these sites was excavated in the 1860s by H.W. Bellew,[34] a further three were explored by Alexander Cunningham,[35] and D.B. Spooner conducted the Archaeological Survey excavations of Mounds A and B,[36] and produced the first comprehensive plans and photographs of these two Sahri Bahlol sites and finds. Stein, while Superintendent of Archaeology of the NWFP, conducted excavations at Sahri Bahlol from 21 February to the first week of April in 1912.[37] His excavations were regarded as the best at the time.[38] Stein employed 300 labourers to dig for nine to ten hours every day. Within ten weeks, six mounds had been excavated, 249 photographs had been taken, and sculptures had been selected, carefully packed and transported to the Museum.

The six mounds excavated by Stein (mounds C to H) all proved to be Buddhist in origin, and shared the common feature of being monastic quarters adjoining the shrines. The absence of any superstructures led Stein to suggest that the walls were built of materials of a rapidly decaying nature, such as clay, sun-dried bricks and timber. A particularly interesting feature noted by Stein were the piles of mostly broken sculptures and reliefs found *in situ* on and beside platforms which, he believed, were originally built as bases of stupas or shrines, but later re-used as bases for images (**Figs. 2-3**). These sculptures vary in style and execution, and Stein described them as being in two categories: the 'superior' type of the earlier period when the Buddhist art of Gandhara was flourishing and the 'decadent' type of the later period. The two categories were found mixed together, with many of the 'superior' type broken, while those of the 'decadent' type were in a better condition. Two mounds (C and D), situated at some distance from the ancient urban area, contained many sculptures of the 'superior' type. Sculptures of the 'decadent' type were found in all mounds, with the smallest quantity at mound D. This led Stein to suggest that mound D ceased to be a place of worship before the others. He noted some sculptures of Hindu character (including a marble lingam), and two copper Hindu Shahi coins (with the titles of Spalapatideva and Vakkadeva, *c.* AD 750–950)[39] in mound E, the mound closest to the ancient urban area, and suggested that the occupation of this mound continued to the 10th century AD. Stein also found coins at other mounds: coins of Azes I (*c.* 46–1 BC), Vasudeva I (*c.* AD 191–227) and 'Later Indo-Scythian rulers' (i.e. Late Kushan and imitations, *c.* AD250–400) from mound C (providing an occupation date of *c.* 1st century BC to early 5th century AD); and three copper

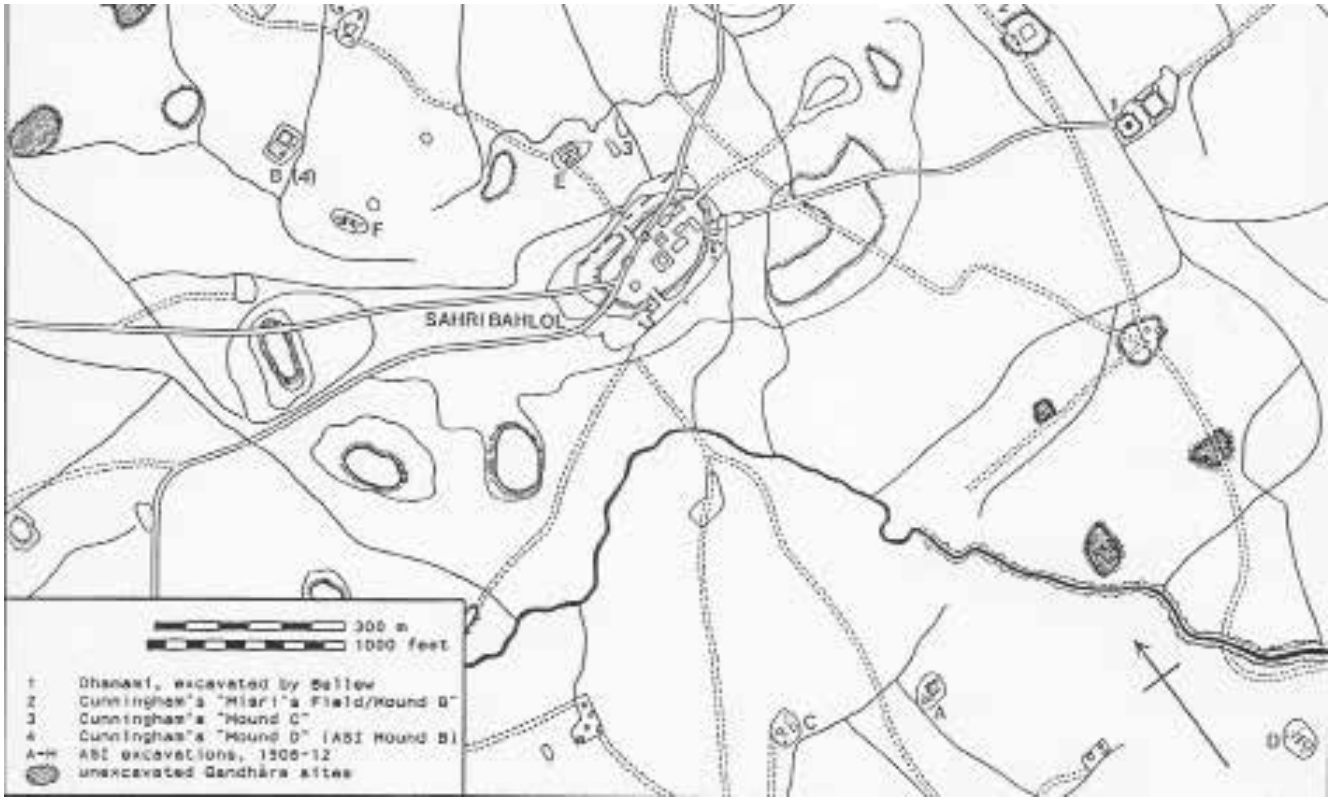


Figure 1 The site of Sahri-Bahlol (Courtesy of E. Errington, 'In search of Palusha', *Bulletin of the Asia Institute: Iranian Studies in Honor of A.D.H. Bivar*, vol. 7 (1993), fig. 3)



Figure 2 Stupa bases at Mound D, Sahri-Bahlol, with re-used sculptures in situ (From M.A. Stein, 'Excavations at Sahri-Bahlol', *Archaeological Survey of India Frontier Circle 1911–12*, Peshawar, 1912, part 2, section 5; also M.A. Stein, *'*Excavations at Sahri Bahlol*', Archaeological Survey of India 1911–12*, Calcutta, 1915, A. No. 371, S. No. 1199)



Figure 3 Detail of a stupa base at Mound D, Sahri-Bahlol, with re-used sculptures *in situ* (From M.A. Stein, 'Excavations at Sahri Bahlol', 1912, Negative No. I.O. 1213)

coins all of the 'Later Kushans' (i.e. Kanishka II to Kipunada, *c.* mid 3rd–4th century AD) and their successors (i.e. Kidarites, 4th–5th century AD) from mound F.[40]

Stein recorded six small cinerary urns found in the shrine areas of two mounds (D and E). The first was found on the northern end of a platform in mound D. It contained small fragments of burnt bones and a coin too corroded to permit identification. The second urn was found at the back of a large platform also in mound D. The remaining four urns were found deposited near the earliest section of the main platform in mound E. Stein did not record the content of the last five urns but noted the similarity of these funerary deposits with those found at the foot of several Buddhist shrines and stupas in Xinjiang during his First Central Asian Expedition.

The sculptural finds resulting from these excavations amounted to over 1200 pieces, ranging from small fragments to large statues. Stein recorded that of all the colossal statues, whether in stone or stucco, only the heads had survived. He noted that the seated images were in better condition than the standing ones. Among the images, those of the Buddha and Bodhisattvas were the most popular, with the latter being most numerous. After the excavation, he spent over two weeks selecting, packing and transporting these sculptures to the Peshawar Museum.

The return to Udyana and the identification of Pir-Sar as Aornos

Thirty years after his first visit to Udyana in 1896, Stein returned to this familiar place again in the spring of 1926. He was now in his sixties, retired, but on an extension of 'special duty' service to work on books and other projects. Following his first attempt in 1905 to search for Alexander's Aornos on Mahaban and the invalidation of such a claim for the mountain, Stein had hoped to search for the true site of the famous rock stronghold which he thought was located somewhere higher up on the right bank of the Indus.[41] The unsettled tribal politics in Upper Swat and the surrounding areas at the time had precluded him from realising this pursuit. Almost two decades later, when the situation was calmer, Stein had a chance to resume his search in 1921, making a rapid tour along the left bank of the Indus, where he tried to find information on the possible site of Aornos.[42] The situation became more favourable a few years later when Upper Swat (including the areas between the Swat watershed and the Indus) was consolidated under Miangul Gul-shahzada. This new ruler of Swat had close and friendly relations with the British administration of the NWFP, and Stein's old friend, Colonel E.H.S. James, was at that time Political Agent for Dir, Swat and Chitral. At last, Stein might realise his long-cherished plan. In 1925, he re-submitted a proposal to visit the possible site of Aornos. The new ruler of Swat not only granted him permission to visit the proposed area, but also allowed him survey most areas of his territory. He also mentioned in his letter to Stein that the site he wished to visit was locally known as Pir-Sar. Stein received 2000 rupees from the Archaeological Department for expenses during this expedition. He was also provided with a fully trained surveyor from the Survey of India Department, Torabaz Khan, who made a map of Upper Swat and the surrounding areas.

The extent of the expedition includes areas along the Swat River and parts of the area on the right bank of the Indus above Buner (Map 2). The expedition started from Lower Swat, then reached further up to Central and Upper Swat, before cutting east to Pir-Sar and south to Mount Ilam.[43] Most of these areas had never been visited by Europeans before. The expedition took place in the spring of 1926 and lasted for two and a half months. Stein spent his time identifying sites associated with Alexander's operations

in Swat and the Buddhist sacred sites mentioned by the Chinese pilgrims, though paid more attention to the former. He identified Birkot with Bazira, and Udegram with Ora, the two towns captured by Alexander. These identifications were soon widely accepted, and when Birkot was excavated by later archaeologists it revealed an urban settlement dating from the Indo-Greek period.[44] However, Stein's identification of Pir-Sar with Aornos was rejected by later archaeologists.[45]

On his map, Stein had the Buddhist sites and mounds suggestive of Buddhist sites found during this survey marked in red (in the form of a stupa) (Map 2). Most of these sites and mounds were found clustered along the central and lower Swat River. Among them, Stein noted various mounds at Butkara, south of Mingora, and took measurements of the mound he thought might have been a stupa (marked as a red stupa without a name on his map).[46] The site of Butkara I was subsequently excavated by Italian archaeologists and proved, according to numismatic evidence, to be one of the first Buddhist establishments in NWFP.[47] Modern excavations have further revealed Buddhist structures along the central and lower Swat River, especially near Mingora, in particular, the sites of Butkara III, Panr I, and Saidu Sharif I.[48] As mentioned above, Stein believed that Manglawar was *Mung-kie-li*, the town of residence of the kings of Swat, and based most of his identifications of the Buddhist sacred sites on their distances from it. This may explain why many of the sites around Mingora, believed to be *Mung-kie-li* by later archaeologists,[49] escaped Stein's attention when it came to identifying the places mentioned by the Chinese pilgrims.

However, the true purpose of Stein's tour was not to identify the Buddhist sacred sites or to follow the routes of the Chinese pilgrims, but to trace the locations of Alexander's operations in Swat. Stein declared his motivation in the form of a confession to his 'Chinese patron saint', Xuan Zang, at the beginning of *On Alexander's Tract to the Indus*, his published account of this expedition.[50] The idea of Pir-Sar as the possible rock stronghold of Aornos first came to Stein from Colonel R.A. Wauhope of the Survey of India.[51] According to Arrian, the three towns in Swat captured by Alexander before his advance towards the Indus are Massaga, Ora and Bazira, and when they heard of the fall of Ora, the people of Bazira and other towns in Swat fled to a rock called Aornos.[52] Stein did not identify Massaga but believed that its location should be somewhere south of Bazira (Birkot). This belief also led him to think that the most logical direction to look for Aornos was towards the east, for the other directions would have already been barred by the Macedonians. The Macedonians came from the west, and they had already captured the north (Ora/Udegram) and south (Massaga and Charsadda). Stein supported his identification by noting that several passes provided routes for fugitives from Bazira eastwards to Pir-Sar, noting as well as the great height, the steep incline and the flat expanse at the top of Pir-sar (**Fig. 4**).[53] Stein climbed to the top of Pir-Sar and described the mountain in detail. He also supervised Torabaz Khan, the surveyor, in the making of a map of Pir-sar and its environs.[54] To support his identification, Stein sought information that might link Pir-Sar with Alexander from the Gujars, the local people of this area. They were not able to tell him of any such local traditions.

Stein's expedition in Udyana ended with his ascent of Mount Ilam, or Ilam-Sar. Situated to the south east of Birkot, this mountain has the reputation of being a sacred place for both Hindus and Buddhists (**Fig. 5**). For this reason, it had

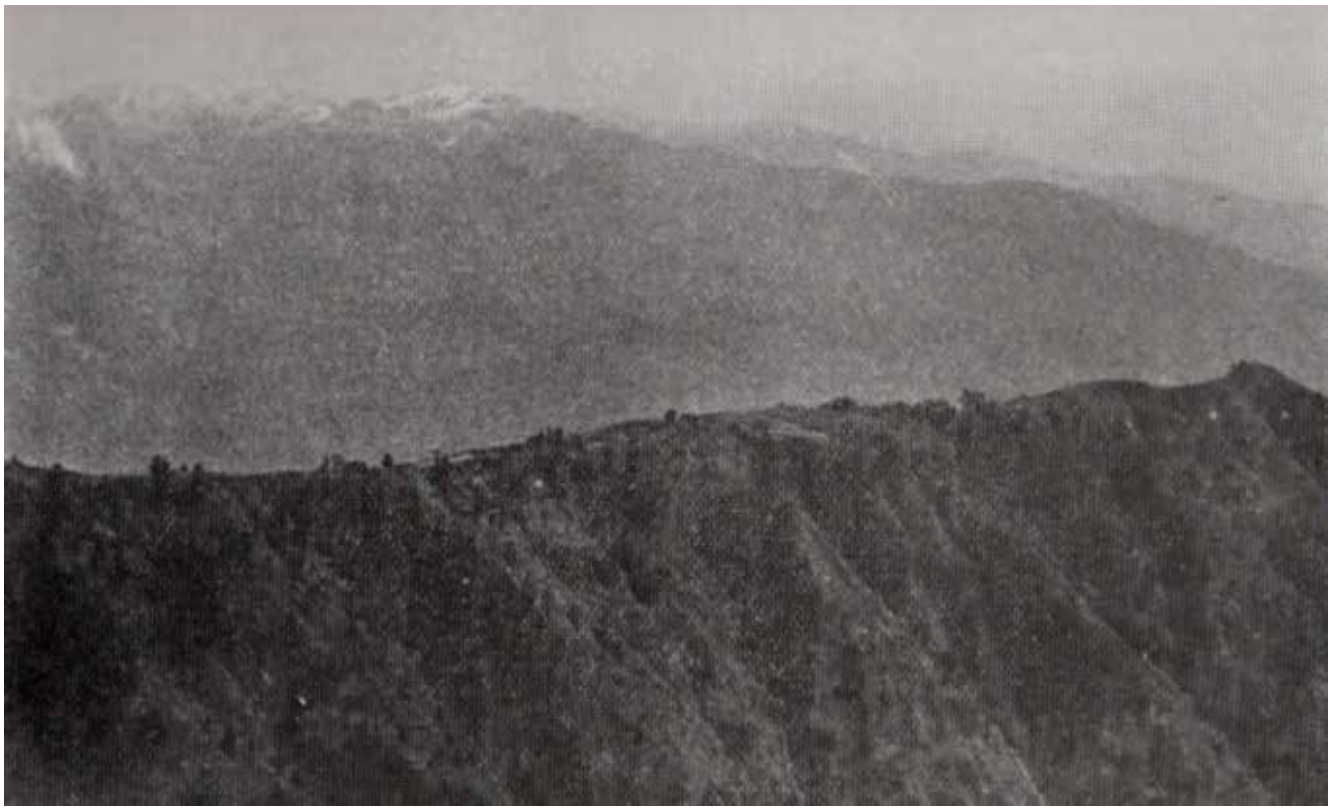


Figure 4 Pir-Sar ridge (From M.A. Stein, 'An archaeological tour in Upper Swat and adjacent hill tracts', *Memoirs of the Archaeological Survey of India* **42, Calcutta, 1930, fig. 38)**



Figure 5 Iliam-Sar with sacred pool and Xuan Zang's 'stone couches' (From M.A. Stein, 'An archaeological tour in Upper Swat and adjacent hill tracts' 1930, fig. 66)

long been of interest to Stein, and he was determined to reach its summit. Less than two weeks after his ascent of Pir-sar, Stein reached the summit of Mount Ilam. He saw what he expected to see: the oblong stone heap believed by Hindus to be the seat of Rama and the couch-like rocks recorded by Xuan Zang as the place where the Buddha in his former life renounced the world.[55] While surveying Pir-Sar, Stein had noted that the distance from Birkot (the town from where people fled to Aornos) to Ilam was closer than the distance from Birkot to Pir-Sar. Therefore, he suggested, in terms of distance, it would be more logical for the people of Birkot to flee to Ilam.[56] However, because Stein believed that Massaga, the first town seized by Alexander, was situated to the south of Birkot, he thought it would not make sense to flee southwards (where Ilam was) as this would not offer safe refuge, given that the area was occupied by the Macedonians. For this reason, when Stein visited Ilam, he did not make the link with Alexander, and thus occupied himself with the sacred sites of Hindus and Buddhists instead.

On this expedition, Stein set out in search of Aornos. He thought he had found it in Pir-sar. It would take another 50 years before the last mountain he climbed – Ilam – would be identified as the true Aornos.[57] His search for Aornos may have been proved unsuccessful, but his work in the NWFP has left us a wealth of knowledge about a place which is almost as inaccessible today as it was in his time.

Notes

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53 Stein, 'Alexander's Campaign (contd.)', p. 526.

54 Stein, 'An archaeological tour in Upper Swat', map 2.

55 Beal, *op. cit.*

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57 Tucci, 'On Swat, the Dards and Connected Problems'. See pp. 52–5 for Tucci's discussion on his inclination towards Ilam as Aornos.

Aurel Stein's Methods and Aims in Archaeology on the Silk Road

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> The old saying that a man finds what he looks for in a subject, is too true; or if he has not enough insight to ensure finding what he looks for, it is at least sadly true that he does not find anything that he does not look for.[1]

As early as the publication of *Sand Buried Ruins of Khotan* (1904), Aurel Stein had developed clear notions about the geographical and historical patterns that regulated life on the Silk Road. Among the forces of change that he considered to be the most definitive were the availability of water, the transmission of Buddhism, and constant shifts in political authority. His speculations over where these patterns originated, how they moved across the massive territorial extensions of Asia, and how they expressed themselves in the daily lives of its oases steered the direction of his expeditions, regulated where he stopped to search, and dictated which finds he considered important and worth preserving. What, then, were Stein's major scientific goals? How did his interpretations and methods of inquiry change throughout his thirty years of work in northwest China?

In *On Ancient Central Asian Tracks* (1933), the succinct account of his first three Central Asian explorations,[2] Stein condensed his findings of over thirty years of archaeological, antiquarian and geographical research in Central Asia.[3] Chinese Turkestan, he wrote, despite the arduousness of its geography, 'served as the principle scene for that important historical process, the early interpenetration of Far Eastern, Indian and Western civilizations.'[4] During the reign of emperor Wu-ti [Wudi] (115 BC) the Chinese had begun to expand westwards, establishing military colonies along the northern part of the Nan-shan in order to protect the corridors that made trade possible. They would control these 'great natural highways, provided by the string of oases in the Tarim basin'[5] for more than a century until the downfall of the Han in the early 3rd century C. Stein clarified, however, that before the Chinese discovered the possibilities of Central Asian trade, different groups of cultivators had inhabited the oases of the Tarim Basin. These peoples spoke a variety of Indo-European languages and their remains bore undisputable marks of western classical influence.[6] The hope that first led him to Khotan, to find proof of this 'bygone culture, which rested mainly on Indian foundations',[7] remained his primary objective throughout the course of his long archaeological career. It is perhaps worth pointing out that not only was Stein's main academic training in oriental (essentially Indian) philology, he was for most of his life employed by the [British] government in India, and thus it would have been appropriate for him to stress the Indian angle. Even in the choice of titles for his publications, he chose to emphasize the diverse cultures of this region – *Desert Cathay* (1912), *Serindia* (1921), *Chinese Turkestan* (1923), *Innermost Asia* (1928), *Ancient Central Asia* (1933) – when the political name for the most northwesterly region of China was Xinjiang Province between 1884 and 1955.[8]

None of the major historiographical traditions of the area recorded the full details of the existence of the ancient settlements in the region. Stein continually expressed this idea and tied it into his notion of archaeological responsibility. In the preface to *Ancient Khotan* he asserted:

> Neither the occasional references of the Chinese Annals nor the brief notices of Chinese Buddhist pilgrims could help us far to reconstruct, in its main aspects, that bygone phase of civilization of which all indigenous records and remains seemed to have banished.[9]

Thus, it was necessary for Stein to attempt to find the records of the daily lives of these people in their own languages and script, and to recover from beneath the layers of Chinese influence their development, their relationship to the West and the ways in which they had come to settle in the lands of Central Asia.[10]

Stein's main aim, though refined and further clarified, remained the same from the publication of *Sand Buried Ruins of Khotan* in 1904, until he delivered the Lowell Lectures at Harvard (December 1929), which were published in the volume *On Ancient Central Asian Tracks* (1933). An unfailing archaeological interest in the sites of Niya and Miran – and his very different approach to investigating the remains at Dunhuang – demonstrate Stein's intent to solve the puzzle of the original inhabitants of the Silk Road and how they were connected to the West. Finally, the contents of his writings, both personal and academic, and their relationship to the broader world of archaeology, particularly to the works of the Egyptologist Sir Flinders Petrie (1853–1942), also suggest that, for Stein, the execution of a systematic archaeological method was inextricably linked to his scholarly identity and project. The first sentence in Petrie's seminal guide *Methods and Aims in Archaeology* reads 'Archaeology is the latest born of the sciences';[11] and in the same spirit, Stein referred to his own detailed scholarly publications as scientific reports.

To understand Stein's approach it is helpful to revisit the contents of Petrie's *Methods and Aims in Archaeology*. This 208-page book consists of 14 chapters which cover, in order,

> (1) **the excavator** (character, experience, organization, acquirements, demands of the work);
>
> (2) **discrimination** (temples, towns, cemeteries, indications, productions, pottery, style, visual memory);
>
> (3) **the labourers** (quality, education, control, substitution, overseers, direct system, day pay, piecework, day and piece work, rewards, accounts, native ways;
>
> (4) **arrangement of work** (turning over, raising earth, tracing walls);
>
> (5) **recording in the field** (need of record, value of record, resulting view, marking, nature of notes, planning, plotting);
>
> (6) **copying** (paper squeezes, dry squeezes, casting, drawing, restored forms, copying inscriptions);
>
> (7) **photographing** (the camera, preparing objects, lighting, arrangement of objects, stereographs, developing);
>
> (8) **preservation of objects** (stone, pottery, textiles, wood, ivory, papyri, beadwork, stucco, gold, silver, copper, bronze, lead, iron, sorting);
>
> (9) **packing** (blocks, long objects, heavy stones, pottery, softening, cases, unpacking);
>
> (10) **publication** (arrangement, plates, processes, editions, text, publishing);
>
> (11) **systematic archaeology** (systems of work, need of a *corpus*, example of *corpus*, utility, successive ages, sequences, sequence dates, conservation, buildings, lighting, grouping, national repository);
>
> (12) **archaeological evidence** (nature of proof, legal evidence, witnesses, material facts, exhaustion, probabilities, legal proof, Egypt and Europe, in XXVIth dynasty, XVIIIth dynasty paintings, burnt groups, rubbish mounds, houses, scarabs, tombs in Egypt, tombs in Greece, variation with date, style, recapitulation, XIIth dynasty Kahun, XIIth dynasty in Crete, pan-graves, VIth to IIIrd dynasties, Ist dynasty Aegean, Ist dynasty Cretan, prehistoric;
>
> (13) **ethics of archaeology** (individual rights, destruction, restoration, sacrifices, responsibility, rights of the future, rights of the past, duties, future of museums, publications, state claims, state rights, excavating laws; and
>
> (14) **the fascination of history**.

In her biography of Stein, Jeannette Mirsky reconstructs the circumstances that prompted him to organize the First Central Asian Expedition. Stein had carefully studied the inscriptions discovered by Major Deane,[12] explored ruined Buddhist establishments in Swat and Buner with Alfred Foucher,[13] and read extensively about the Chinese pilgrims who traversed Central Asia in search of Indian lands and their Buddhist knowledge. The appearance of Bower's manuscript from Kucha and of numerous coins and sculptures, convinced him 'beyond all doubt' that the old sites in the territory of Khotan, 'systematically explored, promise[d] to yield finds of great importance for Indian antiquarian research'.[14] The transmission of Buddhism somehow demonstrated to Stein that all of these settlements had once been connected by common religious concerns and practices. For Stein, understanding these interconnections required more than the hoarding of precious materials purchased in bazaars or obtained far beyond their places of origin. Systematic research entailed recording an object's precise surroundings and speculating on its everyday uses, allowing the researcher to reconstruct the daily life of a vanished community.[15]

In the opening pages of *Ancient Khotan* (1907), the detailed report of his First Central Asian Expedition (1900–01), Stein clarified his stance on method. He emphasized that he sought not only to recover great objects in Chinese Turkestan but also to establish a precedent in Central Asian studies, a new way of understanding the region through archaeology.[16]

Extensive recordkeeping, the search for the objects of daily life, and packaging finds appropriately were central to his approach. His standard was 'an archaeological explorer of unequalled experience', Professor Flinders Petrie, and his manual *Methods and Aims in Archaeology* (1904). As Stein explained:

> No part of Chinese Turkestan had then been explored from an archaeological point of view, and it struck me that, however much attention these and other future discoveries might receive from competent Orientalists in Europe, their full historical antiquarian value could never be realized without systematic research on the spot.[17]

Methods and Aims contains Petrie's reflections of what proper archaeology ought to be. Surviving correspondence demonstrates that Stein was also well informed of Petrie's activities on the ground: Petrie visited Stein's collections of the first expedition in London in 1901–2, and both scholars exchanged works and letters between 1907 and 1938.[18] Stein also became the second recipient of the Petrie medal, after Petrie himself, in 1928.[19] The archaeological techniques pioneered by Petrie in Egypt such as grouping materials to determine their relationships, his insistence on everyday objects such as pottery fragments, plain tools and weapons

and his use of a typological sequence dating to determine the chronology of a society, addressed the kinds of historical questions that Stein wished to resolve about the ancient inhabitants of the Silk Road.[20] Given the limited amounts of writings about archaeological practice at the time, the precedent set by the Egyptologist's work also allowed Stein to contextualize his Central Asian project in a language more intelligible to fellow scholars:

> It is impossible to overlook the fact that archaeological research in great fields like India and Central Asia, which lie beyond the stimulating influence of Biblical associations, has not as yet succeeded in gaining its due share of sympathy and interest from the wider public.[21]

The First Central Asian Expedition began in May 1900 north of Kashmir. On the morning of 18 January 1901, a 38 year-old Stein reached Niya.[22] Stein's camel-man soon found two wooden tablets with Kharoshthi script.[23] Stein was surprised to find that these tablets had writing in an Indian script and language. During a brief survey of the site, Stein and his assistants discovered 85 more tablets; he described each tablet carefully, mentioning characteristics like the degree of preservation of the ink and the manner in which he had unearthed them. He went so far as to point out in which cases he used a brush to remove the sand and how he kept the objects in the order in which he had unearthed them to preserve the chronology. He believed the tablets to have originated in 'the first three centuries of our era',[24] but was still unsure about the significance of the discovery. He worried that the tablets might contain exact replicas of prayers or extracts from sacred Buddhist texts and offer no information on the daily affairs of the community. The way in which the inhabitants of Niya had sealed the tablets, however, seemed point to more practical writings, perhaps contracts or official documents of some kind.[25] When he examined them more closely, he realized that he could read parts of them because 'the language was an early Indian Prakrit.'[26] The texts also seemed to vary greatly from tablet to tablet. His excitement increased when he found Kharoshthi tablets with seal impressions of classical deities including depictions of Athena, Eros, and Heracles. He knew that classical art had existed in Bactria and on the northwest frontier of India, 'but there was little to prepare' him 'for such tangible proofs of the fact that it had penetrated so much further to the east, half-way between Europe and Peking.'[27] The seal of Athena which he found at Niya appeared on the title page of every one of Stein's publications about Central Asia, and became a symbol of how profoundly Niya shaped his scientific inquiries on the Silk Road.[28] This is further attested in *Ruins of Desert Cathay* where Stein also dedicated a substantial part of the Niya chapters to describing the intaglios of classical workmanship representing Pallas Promachos, Heracles with a club and lion-skin, Zeus, and helmeted busts.

From Niya's residences Stein retrieved objects as diverse as an ancient wooden chair, household implements, and parts of musical instruments. The designs on these objects made Stein wonder whether they were meant to resemble the Kimnaras of Indian mythology or the Centaurs of Greece.[29] He began to question why the inhabitants of Niya crafted their objects in this manner, and how their artistic techniques related to the classical legacy of the West or to India. *Ancient Khotan* (1907), the scholarly report of the expedition, presented more detailed descriptions of each of the items that Stein extracted from the site. Petrie's manual warned the explorer that 'recording is the absolute dividing line between plundering and scientific work, between the dealer and the scholar',[30] and Stein took this extremely seriously. In Section VIII, at the end of the chapter entitled 'The Ancient Site beyond the Niya River', Stein classified the antiques he found at Niya according to material and by the section, or the dwelling, in which he found them. He then numbered, measured, and described the quality of the writing on each of the documents. These classifications were part of Stein's preliminary interpretations.[31]

Stein recorded the progression of his Second Expedition (1906–08) in two major works, a personal narrative entitled *Ruins of Desert Cathay* (1912) and the four-volume scientific report, *Serindia* (1921).[32] During the expedition, he traveled north via Chitral and the Wakhan corridor of Afghanistan, revisited old sites, including Niya, and excavated at new ones such as Miran, Lou-lan, the Chinese *Limes,* and Ming-oi.[33] Stein claimed in the introductory chapter of *Ruins of Desert Cathay* that 'the very novelty [of the discoveries] and the remoteness of their region laid it upon' him 'to become their interpreter.'[34] Stein's writing in *Ruins of Desert Cathay* is much more poetic and self-analytical than in *Sand-buried Ruins of Khotan*. This 'personal narrative' is representative of a genre of travel writing common among explorers of the end of the nineteenth and the beginning of the 20th century that was aimed towards a larger audience more interested in the journey and its perils, and in gaining a broader understanding of the world, than in the minutiae of the archaeological finds.[35] Hence, the book was not simply a description of the excavations, the logistics, the crew and the possible historical interpretations of the documents. It also recorded Stein's impressions and feelings about the landscape. Niya was the object of many of these poetically tinted reflections, and Stein came to think of this site as 'my own little Pompeii'.[36]

Stein rushed his October 1906 excavation of the Domoko oasis in order to reach Niya once more. To do so, Stein reported to his friend Percy Stafford Allen in a letter dated 10 October, meant nearly exhausting local financial reserves. The decision to hurry towards Niya, excavate there as quickly as possible and then march to Charchan, was in part related to the fact that a French excavation party led by the French sinologist Paul Pelliot had already reached Kashgar,[37] and that he had competition. Stein's main motivation, though, was the appearance of new ruins. From these Stein expected to retrieve more evidence with which to reconstruct the lives of the original inhabitants of Niya.

The excavations at Niya on this Second Expedition, like those on the First, yielded proof that the Kharoshthi script and Prakrit language had been in use as far east as the Lop Nor region, as some of the documents had originated in the Lop Nor sites. In *Serindia* he continued to pursue the linguistic question that he had first established in both *Sand Buried Ruins of Khotan* and *Ancient Khotan*.[38] He was able to confirm the contents of the documents and to begin to ascertain the

nature of the relationship between Niya's local administration and the Chinese political authority. The abundance of documents in the Kharoshthi script and Prakrit language showed that beneath the Chinese supra-structure there had been a semi-autonomous community which continued to thrive and to produce documents in their own language. The nature of this population, however, remained enigmatic. Stein wished to know the specific reasons why the settlement had been abandoned and, perhaps more importantly, where the ancestors of these people came from and why they expressed themselves using classical motifs. To answer these questions, he revisited Niya in his Third (1913–16) and Fourth Expeditions (1930–31).

If Stein interpreted Niya's textual remains as the earliest examples of the daily affairs of a classically influenced Indo-European population that predated the arrival of the Chinese, the site of Miran allowed him to witness how these peoples might have looked. On the walls of a circular passage, enclosing a small stupa, Stein discovered 'frescoes of unexpected beauty'.[39] He was able to date the site almost immediately on account of remains of silk prayer flags with Kharoshthi inscriptions. It seemed likely that the shrine was already deserted by the 3rd or 4th century, giving him what he had 'always longed for, specimens of pictorial work of the same period as the Niya ruins'.[40] As he cleared the stupa, Stein found paintings of winged angels and 'felt completely taken by surprise' to see in 'the desolate shores of Lop-nor, in the very heart of innermost Asia ... such classical representations of Cherubium'.[41] These were the clearest depictions of classical design and colour in any ancient pictorial art that he had unearthed so far.[42] In *Ruins of Desert Cathay,* using the same rose-tinted narrative tone reserved for describing Niya, he described having felt as if he were '... among the ruins of some villa in Syria or some other Eastern province of the Roman empire', and not in 'a Buddhist sanctuary on the very confines of China'.[43] Stein expressed in this personal narrative his desire to recover, like the explorers of Pompeii, vignettes of everyday life in Central Asia and to identify the possible interconnectedness of these scenes with the classical world, much as Petrie had done in Egypt.

Although his scientific interpretations of the possible origins of these frescoes are limited, even in his 1933 book *On Central Asian Tracks*, he dedicates a significant number of his descriptions to their iconography and even ventures to produce a hypothesis about one of the painters of the murals. He saw in their faces Greek features mingled with Circassian types.[44] After the French scholar Abbé Boyer determined that one of the Kharoshthi votive offerings recorded the name *Tita* for the painter, Stein conjectured that since Tita could not be accounted for etymologically in any Indian or Iranian language it must have been a rendering of the Roman name Titus in Sanskrit and Prakrit. This was a common name in the Roman Orient, and perhaps this painter had been travelling eastwards on his way to China. Stein recalled as evidence a passage on Marinus of Tyre, preserved in Ptolemy's *Geography,* which showed that Roman Eurasians 'as it were, were accustomed to visit the land of Seres i.e. China proper, in connection with [the] silk trade' since 'long before the probable date of the Miran shrines'. [45] Given the paintings' paramount importance in deciphering the puzzle of the original inhabitants, Stein decided that it was necessary to remove the frescoes to a location where they could be better studied. Since he knew of no established method to do so, he improvised the procedure and recorded each step in detail.[46] He first photographed the frescoes and then attempted their removal. The process was long and hard and in the end only partially successful. In 1908, while still on the Second Expedition, Stein sent his assistant to retrieve the remaining paintings. Naik Ram Singh, however, had severe glaucoma and lost his sight before he could remove them. Having failed to obtain the paintings a second time, Stein made a point of returning to Miran on his Third Expedition (1913–16). He recorded the final removal in *Innermost Asia* (1928), the scientific report of the Third Expedition. All in all, Miran had demanded from him great persistence and the need to display significant archaeological inventiveness.

Stein's approach to working at Miran and Niya contrasted starkly with his approach to Dunhuang. The different approaches speak volumes about the methodological and scholarly aspirations that were central to Stein's Silk Road project. Although Stein understood the magnitude and importance of China (and, in the case of Miran, of other powers like Tibet) in shaping the inner rhythms of the Silk Road, he remained resolutely interested in the peoples that populated the central Asian oases before the arrival of these empires. A comparison between his understanding of Niya and Dunhuang demonstrates this. Niya epitomized what Stein considered a proper archaeological excavation should be. Not only in terms of method did Niya fulfill Stein's expectations, its documents presented tangible examples of a 3rd century society that possessed clear expressions, both linguistic and material, of 'strong Hellenistic influence as transmitted from Eastern Iran and the North-Western borders of India'.[47]

Dunhuang, on the other hand, was the site that brought him international acclaim and scholarly freedom; its massive finds eased the process of obtaining funds for future investigations.[48] For instance, after his return from Dunhuang, The Times carefully followed Stein's Central Asian expeditions and reported on his findings, taking the information directly from his letters or quoting the public discussions in the Geographical Journal. The newspaper articles highlight the importance of the discoveries in lands where 'nothing but desert and sands prevail',[49] and the audacity and brilliance of the explorer.[50] The New York Times also reported on Stein's expeditions in similarly heroic terms.[51]

Yet for all the fame it brought him, the discovery of the library cave in 1907, the negotiations with Wang Yuanlu, the keeper of the manuscripts,[52] and the removal of the finds, hardly constituted by Stein's standards an archaeological excavation. Dunhuang was in his eyes an important opportunity to salvage hundreds of documents from a commendable, but ignorant keeper. Although Stein knew Dunhuang to be fundamental in achieving a greater understanding of the relationships that might have existed between the original settlements of the Silk Road and the Chinese supra-structure of military and administrative control, he did not regard the site as having the same bearing as Niya or Miran in the resolution of his main historical

concerns. His interest in the manuscripts was especially aroused when he heard that some of them were not Chinese: 'the assertion that some of these manuscripts were not Chinese had naturally made me still keener to ascertain exact details.'[53] Moreover, his justification for removing the manuscripts, even though Dunhuang was still an active place of worship, hinged on the hope that the finds would eventually prove useful to Indian and Western research:

> In the first rapid examination Chiang [Stein's learned Chinese assistant] failed to discover colophons giving exact dates of the writing in any of the Chinese rolls, and owing to their length a complete unfolding would have required much time. So I had reason to feel doubly elated when, on the reverse of a Chinese roll, I first lighted upon a text written in that cursive form of Indian Brahmi script with which the finds of ancient Buddhist texts at sites of the Khotan region had rendered me familiar. Here was indisputable proof that the bulk of the manuscripts deposited went back to the time when Indian writing and some knowledge of Sanskrit still prevailed in Central Asian Buddhism. With such evidence clearly showing the connection which once existed between these religious establishments and Buddhist learning as transplanted to the Tarim Basin, my hopes rose greatly for finds of direct importance to Indian and western research.[54]

Dunhuang was after all a meeting point, and the hidden library was an archive where remains from diverse communities along the road might have been preserved. Stein believed that

> apart from all philological interest, these texts in Indian script, whatever their language, possess historical value as tangible proofs that the monastic communities established at Tun-huang among a population mainly Chinese were, until a relatively late period, maintaining direct connection with their co-religionists in the Tarim Basin, from which Buddhism first reached China.[55]

Retrieving the relationships between the strings of Buddhist communities and their chronologies might illuminate unaccounted aspects of the history of some of the Tarim Basin settlements. Stein's reconnaissance work on the *Limes* and subsequent excavations at other sites such as Endere and Lop-nor, were, like Dunhuang, supplementary pieces for solving the question of the original population.

Stein's methods and aims remained relatively unchanged throughout his expeditions to Central Asia. However, Stein's report of his Third Expedition, *Innermost Asia*, also describes the changing situation with regards to foreign excavations in China. It was one that Stein found difficult to accept. The Chinese revolution in 1911 altered the character of the Third Expedition significantly, bringing to the fore the rise in Chinese nationalism and opposition to foreign explorers and archaeologists. Stein was aware of these changes, but displayed a rather bullish attitude to the situation. For example, in the introduction to *Innermost Asia*, Stein relates that, while removing the last of the Miran frescoes, he received a letter from Sir George Macartney, informing him that the 'head-quarters of the provincial Government at Urumchi' had issued an edict 'ordering all district authorities to prevent us from carrying out any surveying work, and in case of any attempt to continue our explorations to arrest us and send under escort to Kashgar "for punishment under treaty".'[56] Yet, Stein wrote about 'obstructions' and of finding ways to surmount them. It seems that he did not appreciate the seriousness of the Chinese intent, and that he did not fully connect the rise of Chinese nationalism with his own excavations. Despite his rigorous approach to archaeological 'scientific' methods, it appears that he did not pay enough attention to Petrie's idea of autonomous governments regulating over their patrimonies.[57]

Proper archaeological ethics for Stein in 1933 meant the same practices as in 1898.[58] His notions about the behaviour of the archaeologist were grounded on the concept of the scholar who defends and rescues history from oblivion, without regard for external social or political conditions. Petrie's manual devotes an entire chapter to ethics, but also states that for the serious archaeologist 'conservation must be his first duty'. Although Petrie writes in his *Methods and Aims* that it is the right of governments to determine how the archaeological remains of their territories should be treated, he also acknowledges how troubling this can be for the archaeologist who finds himself 'debarred from using the material when an ignorant peasant may destroy and dig as he pleases.'[59] Stein, too, it appears, was set on upholding the preservation of archaeological remains above all other considerations.

Stein's excavations irretrievably transformed the ways in which the Silk Road could be studied.[60] He made documents, artefacts and data available to scholars of all disciplines and gave rise to numerous investigations that continue just as vigorously today. His scholarly archaeological project, though constant and unchanging, provided a framework of selection and emphasis that, when combined with the antiquarian methods of description, yielded extensive and useful records, as well as hypotheses about the history of Central Asia. Stein's commitment to applying systematic archaeological methods has allowed modern scholars to transcend Stein's own aims as an investigator and to search in other directions beyond his own interests. The fact that his vast records allow us the possibility to do this is an immense contribution to our understanding of ancient Central Asia and the Silk Road.

Notes

1 I would like to thank Valerie Hansen for reading multiple drafts of this paper and for inviting me to participate in the Stein conference that took place in Budapest in 2007; and Helen Wang for her comments and suggestions. The quote is from Sir Flinders Petrie, *Methods and Aims in Archaeology*, Macmillan and Company, London, 1904, p. 1.

2 Stein, *On Ancient Central Asian Tracks: Brief Narrative of Three Expeditions in Innermost Asia and North-western China*, Macmillan, London, 1933 (repr. Pantheon Books, New York), p. 1.

3 For a discussion of the antiquarian approach, see Arnaldo Momigliano, 'Ancient History and the Antiquarian', *Journal of the Warburg and Courtauld Institutes* vol. 13, no. 3/4 (1950): pp. 285–315, including on p. 313: 'The antiquary rescued history from the skeptics, even though he did not write it. His preference for the original documents, his ingenuity in discovering forgeries, his skill in collecting and classifying the evidence and, above all, his unbounded love for learning are the antiquary's contributions to the "ethics" of the historian.'

4 Stein, *On Central Asian Tracks*, p. 17.

5 *Ibid*., pp. 20–23.

6 *Ibid*., p. 27.

7 M.A. Stein, *Sand-Buried Ruins of Khotan; Personal Narrative of a Journey of Archaeological & Geographical Exploration in Chinese Turkestan*, T.F. Unwin, London, 1903, p. xvi.

8 The political name for this region between 1884 and 1955 was Xinjiang Province. M.A. Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay: Personal Narrative of Explorations in Central Asia and Westernmost China*, Macmillan & Co. Ltd,

London, 1912; *Serindia: Detailed Report of Explorations in Central Asia and Westernmost China*, Clarendon Press, Oxford, 1921; *Memoir on Maps of Chinese Turkestan and Kansu from the Surveys made during Sir Aurel Stein's Explorations,1900–1, 1906–8, 1913–15*, Trigonometrical Survey Office, Dehra Dun, 1923; *Innermost Asia: Detailed Report of Explorations in Central Asia, Kansu and Eastern Iran*, Clarendon Press, Oxford, 1925; *On Ancient Central Asian Tracks, op. cit.*

9 Stein, *Ancient Khotan*, p. ix.

10 Stein, *Sand-Buried Ruins of Khotan*, p. xiv.

11 Petrie, *op. cit.*, p. vii.

12 Harold Deane (1854–1908), Political Resident, Kashmir, Chief Commissioner, North-West Frontier from 1901.

13 Alfred Charles Auguste Foucher (1865–1952), Indologist, professor at the Sorbonne. On Foucher's work with Stein, see A. Fenet, 'Les archives Alfred Foucher (1865–1952) de la Société asiatique, (Paris)', *Anabases* 7 (2008), pp. 163–92.

14 Letter submitted to the Lieutenant Governor for its subsequent transmission to the government of India; see Jeanette Mirksy, *Aurel Stein: Archeological Explorer*, University of Chicago Press, Chicago, 1977, p. 79.

15 A concern with the everyday life of ancient societies is present in Stein's writings from the beginning of his scholarly career. See Sir Aurel Stein, *Kalhana's Rajatarangini: A Chronicle of the Kings of Kasmir*, A. Constable, London, 1900, p. ix.

16 Stein, *Sand-Buried Ruins of Khotan* , p. xii.

17 Stein, *ibid.*, p. xii.

18 Mirksy, *op. cit.*, p. 201; see also the correspondence from Stein to Petrie, now in the Petrie Museum, University College London.

19 P.J. Ucko and S. Quirke, 'The Petrie Medal', *Public Archaeology*, vol. 5 (2006), pp. 15–25; see also the paper by Strong and Wang in this volume.

20 See J. Malina and Z. Vasicek, *Archaeology Yesterday and Today: The Development of Archaeology in the Sciences and Humanities*, Cambridge University Press, Cambridge (UK) and New York, 1990, pp. 49–50; V.M. Fargo, 'BA Portrait Sir Flinders Petrie', *The Biblical Archaeologist*, vol. 47, no. 4 (Dec 1984), pp. 220–23; Sidney Smith, 'William Matthew Flinders Petrie, 1853–1942', *Obituary Notices of Fellows of the Royal Society*, vol. 5, no. 14 (Nov 1945), pp. 3–16; and Margaret Drower, *Flinders Petrie: A Life in Archaeology*, University of Wisconsin Press, Madison, 1995.

21 Stein, *Sand-Buried Ruins of Khotan*, pp. xii–xiii:

22 Stein, *ibid.*, p. 339.

23 *Ibid.*,p. 343.

24 *Ibid.*,p. 360.

25 *Ibid.*, p. 359

26 *Ibid.*, p. 399.

27 Stein, p. 397.

28 'Mr. Fred. H. Andrews ... his wide knowledge of ancient Indian art, especially of the Greco- Buddhist styles, his familiarity with the products of many old Eastern industries ... exceptionally qualified him to assist me in the arrangement, description and illustration of my collection of antiques ... Besides the sketches and diagrams reproduced among the illustrations, I owe to Mr. Andrews' artistic skill the black and white drawing which has furnished the vignette for the title page. My volumes could scarcely issue under a more felicitous emblem than this faithfully restored enlargement of the figure of Pallas Promachos as seen in several of the ancient seal impressions in clay excavated by me', in Stein, *Ancient Khotan*, p. ix.

29 Stein, *Sand Buried Ruins of Khotan*, p. 379.

30 Petrie, *op. cit.*, p. 48.

31 After the end of the expedition Stein began to collaborate almost immediately with other scholars to interpret the documents. E.J Rapson, with the assistance of E. Senart and Abbé Boyer, undertook the decipherment and publications of the Kharoshthi documents on wood and leather recovered from the Niya site. E. Chavannes translated the documents in Chinese. See Stein, *Ancient Khotan*, p. 364.

32 Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, vol. 1, p. 1.

33 A. Walker, *Aurel Stein: Pioneer of the Silk Road*, John Murray, London, 1995, p. 46.

34 Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, vol. 1, p. 1.

35 For representative examples of this genre see C. Heaney, *Cradle of Gold: The Story of Hiram Bingham, a Real-Life Indiana Jones, and the Search for Machu Picchu*, Palgrave McMillan, New York, 2010; B.G. Trigger, *A History of Archaeological Thought*, Cambridge University Press, Cambridge, 1989; B. Kuklick, *Puritans in Babylon: The Ancient Near East and American Intellectual Life, 1880–1930*, Princeton University Press, 1996; W.H. Stiebing, Jr., *Uncovering the Past: A History of Archaeology*, Prometheus Books, Buffalo, 1993, pp. 29–49; S. Hedin, *My Life as An Explorer*, Kodansha International, New York , 1996 (reprint).

36 'Niya is always wrapped in an elegiac tone' is Mirsky's description of Stein's personal correspondence regarding Niya; see Mirsky, *op. cit.*, p. 243. 'My own little Pompeii' is in a letter from Stein to P.S. Allen, from Niya, dated 8 December 1912, quoted in Mirsky, p. 363. In his article 'Into Chinese Turkestan', in *The Times* (16 July 1931, 13f), Stein refers to Niya as 'a sand-buried modest Pompeii abandoned in the 3rd century AD'.

37 Mirsky, *op. cit.*, p. 242.

38 See J. Brough, 'Some comments on third-century Shan-shan and the history of Buddhism', *Bulletin of the School of Oriental and African Studies*, vol. 28, part 3 (1965), pp. 582–612, 590: 'Even with the lapse of years it would be presumptuous to claim that definite answers can now be given...and it does now seem possible to say that Stein's insight here was remarkable, and that his interpretation appears to be in essentials correct.'

39 Mirsky, *op. cit.*, p. 249.

40 Mirsky, *op. cit.*, p. 249; see also Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, pp. 459.

41 Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, vol. 1, p. 457.

42 *Ibid.*, p. 458.

43 *Ibid.*, p. 484.

44 Stein, *On Ancient Central-Asian Tracks*, p. 109.

45 *Ibid.*, pp. 110–11.

46 Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, p. 460.

47 Stein, *On Central Asian Tracks*, p. 26.

48 The acquisition of manuscripts at the library cave at Dunhuang brought Stein immediate recognition: a knighthood in 1912, and praise from scholars in a variety of disciplines; for example, 'A Third Journey of Exploration in Central Asia, 1913–16: Discussion' by A. Chamberlain, H. Read, F. Younghusband, H. Trotter, C.E. Yate and Dr Barnett, *The Geographical Journal*, vol. 48, no. 3 (Sept 1916), pp. 225–29; also 'Explorations in Central Asia, 1906–8: Discussion' by Mr Macartney, M.A. Stein, L.D. Barnett, Lord Curzon, H. Trotter, T.H. Holdich and S. Hedin, *The Geographical Journal*, vol. 34, no. 3 (Sept 1909), pp. 264–71.

49 'Explorations in Central Asia, 1906-1908 Discussion', p. 269.

50 See *The Times:* 'Dr. Stein's travels in Central Asia', 8 Dec 1906; p. 4a; 'Central Asia', 29 Jan 1907, p. 6e; 'Dr. Stein's travels in Central Asia', 25 May 1907, p. 8a; 'Dr. Stein's travels in Central Asia', 15 Oct 1907, p. 11a; 'Dr. Stein's travels in Central Asia', 9 Mar 1909, p. 10a; 'Dr. Stein's travel's in Central Asia', 31 Mar 1909, p. 9d; 'Dr. Stein and the Campbell Memorial', 8 Apr 1909, p. 3f; 'Sir Aurel Stein's expedition: Exploring Central Asia', 26 Jun 1914, p. 7f; '"New" China and Sir Aurel Stein. Demand for expulsion', 29 Dec 1930, p. 10b; 'China and Sir Aurel Stein. The explusion demand', 30 Dec 1930, p. 10c; 'Sir Aurel Stein in China', 3 Jan 1931, p. 11e. These are reproduced in H. Wang, *Sir Aurel Stein in The Times*, Saffron Books, London, 2002.

51 See *The New York Times*: 'Bids China expel British explorer; Association for Preservation of Relics holds Sir Aurel Stein insulted nation', 28 Dec 1930, p. 13; 'Defends archeologist: British Legation at Peking', 30 Dec 1930, p. 6; 'Sir Aurel Stein, 80, an archeologist: explorer of Central Asia wrote many works on subject – dies in Kabul, Afghanistan, 23 Oct 1943, p. 19.

52 Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, chapters 64–66.

53 *Ibid.*, vol. 2, p. 28.

54 *Ibid.*, vol. 2, p. 176.

55 *Ibid.*, 184.

56 Stein, *Innermost Asia*, p. 175.

57 In a letter addressed to John Burrow [one of the main scholars working on the Niya documents at this time], dated 6 December 1937, Stein wrote: 'As you are probably aware, Chinese Nationalist obstruction made any systematic excavation impossible on that occasion. However, I succeeded in recovering a dozen or so of tablets. I was obliged to leave them at the Kashgar Consulate in accordance with a promise I had given of removing any antiquities collected on that journey only with the permission of the Chinese authorities. The efforts made by Captain Sheriff … proved in vain … they have probably been lost during the subsequent revolutionary troubles', see Wang Jiqing, 'Photographs in the British Library of Documents and Manuscripts from Sir Aurel Stein's Fourth Central Asian Expedition', *British Library Journal*, vol. 24, no. 1 (Spring 1998) pp. 23–74, 22.

58 The conclusion of the Miran chapter in *On Ancient Central Asian Tracks* (p. 112) further illustrates this point. Stein reflects on the difficulties of

preservation and on the risks of allowing untrained amateurs to perform excavations. When he revisited the site in January 1914, he found that a young Japanese traveler, who 'lacked preparation, technical skill and experience', was attempting to remove the frescoes. His sloppy efforts resulted in the paintings' destruction. Stein's photographs, being the only original records of the damaged frescoes, became important for future researchers and symbolic of what Stein conceived to be proper archaeological ethics, i.e. keeping meticulous records of an excavation and ensuring that the artifacts were removed safely and conserved to the best of the archaeologist's ability.

59 Petrie, *op. cit.*, p. 187.

60 See P. Hopkirk, *Foreign Devils on the Silk Road*, University of Massachusetts Press, Amherst, 1980, p. 161.

Aurel Stein's Dealings with Wang Yuanlu and Chinese Officials in Dunhuang in 1907

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Aurel Stein had become experienced at dealing with Chinese officials during his First Central Asian Expedition (1900–1) in Xinjiang Province. In his formal application to the Government of India for his Second Central Asian Expedition, Stein wrote:

> Previous experience has shown me the importance of securing the willing co-operation of the Chinese District authorities. Effective means for this purpose are, besides official recommendations from Kashgar, suitably selected presents for the chief local Magistrates. … Consequently I feel obliged to suggest for 'Tosha Khana' purpose a sum of 1,500 (Rs.).[1]

Stein also suggested that:

> In the event of my proposals being approved by the Government of India, I requested that timely steps may be taken to secure for me the necessary passport from the Chinese Government, enabling me to travel in the territory of Chinese Turkestan as well as in the province of Kan-suh [Gansu] and if necessary further east. A specific mention of my official position would be distinctly useful, and I hope, therefore, it will be possible to draw the attention of His Majesty's Embassy at Peking to this point.[2]

Sir Ernest Satow, H.M. Minister at Peking did indeed pay attention to this point.[3] Stein's Chinese passport was issued by the Wai-wu-pu ([Waiwubu 外务部] Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Chinese Foreign Office) on 10 September 1905, in which he was given the status of *Da Ying zongli jiaoyu dachen* 大英国总理教育大臣. This is a strange appellation and can be translated literally as 'Prime Minister of Education of Great Britain'.[4] The effect of this would be felt in different ways. Stein would later grumble about

> those formal visits which seemed to have grown more exacting since the style of my new Chinese passport from the Wai-wu-pu had promoted me to the rank of a Ta-jên [*dachen* 大臣] or 'Excellency'.[5]

But to the Chinese officials and ordinary people of Xinjiang and Gansu, those formalities reflected the very high status of such an important guest (whose official position was also expressed 'Prime Minister of India', 'Viceroy of the British India', 'Prime Minister of Great Britain').[6] How could they refuse him anything?

Stein entered Chinese territory on 29 May 1906 and arrived at Kashgar on 8 June 1906. With the assistance of George Macartney, British Political Agent at Kashgar, Stein engaged Jiang Xiaowan 蒋孝琬 (Chiang Ssŭ-yeh [Jiang shiye] 蒋师爷) from Yarkand as his Chinese secretary. An educated man, Jiang Xiaowan had been private secretary (Ssŭ-yeh) to several officials in Gansu and Xinjiang since 1883 but felt rather disappointed with his career. He thought Fortune was smiling on him when he was engaged by Stein. In the course of the next two years, Jiang Xiaowan helped Stein with all his heart and all his might. When one speaks of Stein's dealings with Wang Yuanlu and Chinese officials, it would be more accurate to call them Jiang Xiaowan's dealings with Wang Yuanlu and Chinese officials on behalf of Stein.[7]

Stein and Jiang Xiaowan travelled from Xinjiang to Gansu, and arrived in Dunhuang in March 1907 at a critical moment. Local peasants were on the point of revolting against sustained misgovernment by the authorities. Since

1726, the provincial government had relocated thousands of poor peasant farmers from all quarters of Gansu to the sparsely populated Dunhuang oasis to open up wasteland. It was stipulated that every household (defined as having 50 *mu* of land) should pay a regular land tax (*tunliang* 屯粮) to the government, namely 2.34 dan (hectolitres) of grain per year. From 1730 on, in addition to the regular land tax, every household was required to sell a further 4 *dan* of grain to the government each year as a contribution to the expenses of the local military or administrative offices. This quota was known as the *caimailiang* 采买粮. In time, the monetary payment from the government for the 4 *dan* quota disappeared and the *caimailiang* simply became an extra tax. In the late Qing dynasty, the peasant farmers of Dunhuang made frequent petitions to different levels of local government asking for the abolition of the *caimailiang* system. But their demands were refused and any resistance was suppressed.[8]

In April 1902, Wang Zonghan 汪宗翰 (b.1845) held the post of Magistrate of Dunhuang. During his term of office (1902–6), the *caimailiang* crisis became increasingly serious. In 1904, the provincial government announced measures to limit people's income. Irritated by this sign of reform, a dozen rich and influential farmers of Dunhuang, under the leadership of Zhang Huming and his brother Zhang Jianming, signed a petition which they submitted to Wang Zonghan requesting an exemption from the *caimailiang* tax. Wang Zonghan not only refused the petition, but also threw some of the petitioners into prison. The enraged leaders of the peasant farmers vowed to bring down the *caimailiang* system and, from autumn 1905, the peasant farmers all refused to pay the caimailiang tax. They also made constant complaints about Wang Zonghan's misgovernment to the Magistrate of Anxi, the Daotai of Suzhou, and even the Viceroy of Shaanxi and Gansu, who was resident in Lanzhou. In March 1906, Wang Zonghan was transferred from Dunhuang to Lanzhou, and Huang Wanchun 黄万春 succeeded him as Magistrate of Dunhuang.[9]

Huang Wanchun's first priority was to deal with the caimailiang crisis. He employed hard and soft tactics, and on one occasion in September 1906 invited several dozen of the more compliant peasant farmers to a banquet at which he asked them to play a leading role in enforcing the *caimailiang* tax. The effect was to split the peasant farmers into two factions. Realising that the radicals were harassing the moderates, and that the majority of peasant farmers were still refusing to pay the *caimailiang* tax, Huang Wanchun had no choice but to order the arrest of the chief radicals.[10]

The *caimailiang* tax had been indispensable for covering administrative and military expenditures at Dunhuang. So it is understandable that the provincial government felt anxious about the crisis. By the end of 1906, Sheng Yun 升允, Viceroy of Shaanxi and Gansu (Shaan-Gan zongdu 陕甘总督), dispatched Wang Jiayan 王家彦 (d.1913) to Dunhuang to investigate the situation on the ground. Wang Jiayan had been magistrate of various districts of Gansu since at least 1902 and was renowned for his competence and effectiveness. After his investigations at Dunhuang, Wang Jiayan submitted a report to Viceroy Sheng Yun to the effect that both government and peasants should make concessions to each other and that the *caimailiang* tax should be reduced by half, from 4 *dan* to 2 *dan*. In the spring of 1907, Wang Jiayan was appointed Magistrate of Dunhuang with a special mission to resolve the *caimailiang* problem once and for all. On the evening of 11 March 1907, the official seal was passed from Huang Wanchun to Wang Jiayan. It was the very same day that Stein and Jiang Xiaowan and their entourage entered the Dunhuang oasis, and in the morning of 12 March 1907, Stein and his party prepared to make their entry into the town of Dunhuang.

They did not arrive unannounced. On his arrival in Gansu province, Stein had sent a telegraphic salutation to Viceroy Sheng Yun in Lanzhou. Four months earlier, in December 1906, Pan Zhen 潘震, Daotai of Aksu – who had been an official in both Gansu and Xinjiang for 40 years and an old friend of Stein's since 1900 – had written a series of letters of recommendation to officials in the main districts of western Gansu, including Huang Wanchun, Magistrate of Dunhuang.[11] But Wang Jiayan was new to his post, and had not yet acquainted himself with any official documents or letters concerning Stein's visit, and consequently neglected this unexpected visitor. When Stein paid his first visit to Wang Jiayan at the Magistrate's Office on 13 March, he

> had just managed to dig out from his predecessor's office records the elegantly worded epistle by which my Tao-t'ai patron had recommended me to the magistrate's attention. He was evidently impressed by its contents; and I instinctively felt that a kindly official providence had brought to Tun-huang just the right man to help me in my first work on these ancient Marches.[12]

Yet, for the newly arrived Wang Jiayan, whose foremost concern was to deal with the pressing caimailiang problem, it must have come as a great shock to have such a distinguished foreign guest as the 'Prime Minister of Education of Great Britain' turn up at his office on his second day, requesting his assistance.

Stein then paid a visit to Lin Taiqing, Commander of the Shazhou Battalion (the military forces of Dunhuang), who was in charge of local public security. Lin Taiqing had risen from the ranks and had been attached to the escort of Emperor Guangxu and the Empress Dowager on their flight to Xi'an in 1900–1. Lin Taiqing was rewarded for his meritorious behaviour and appointed Commander of the Shazhou Battalion in 1902. He had been in Dunhuang ever since. Before their first meeting on 13 March 1907, Lin Taiqing had dispatched some soldiers to act as Stein's camp guard. Stein soon realized that it was Lin Taiqing who controlled Dunhuang, writing that:

> our prolonged visit to the district was evidently welcomed by him as a pleasant diversion, and the help of his myrmidons which he pressed upon us as a safeguard against the obstructive indolence and occasional turbulence of the Tun-huang people in general, soon proved useful in more than one way. That Lin Ta-jên enjoyed more authority in his own sphere than Wang, the newly arrived civilian, did in his, was quite clear… Luckily the two dignitaries were on excellent terms, and the magistrate was only too anxious to let me benefit by the predominant local influence of his military colleague.[13]

Stein had some notion of the serious situation created by local *caimailiang* crisis and the contradictions between officials

and peasants, though found it difficult to get straight answers beyond 'that impenetrable "Pu chih-tao" [*bu zhidao*], "I do not know"'.[14] He faced 'the deep-rooted secretiveness of the local Chinese population'[15] and was aware that 'the suspicious reticence of the people proved a terrible barrier throughout'.[16] And he did not realise that officials in Dunhuang were feigning ignorance of ancient remains:

> Of the ruins I was anxious to trace and explore in the desert nothing was known to our friends the magistrate and military commander, or to the other educated Chinese officials of Tun-huang, though they seemed interested in my work and ready to help.[17]

Neither the officials nor the common people of Dunhuang wanted to encourage Stein to prolong his stay there. Finally, Stein turned to the Turkī traders in Dunhuang for help. It was through Zahīd Bēg from Urumchi that Stein first heard about the discovery of a library cave, now known as Cave 17, at the Mogao Grottoes.

Cave 17 had been discovered, by accident, by Wang Yuanlu 王圓禄 (Wang Tao-shih [Wang daoshi] 王道士, 1850?–1931) about seven years previously, on 22 June 1900. Since its discovery, and particularly after Wang Zonghan's appointment as Magistrate of Dunhuang in 1902, its contents had been in the process of dispersion. Through Wang Yuanlu and Wang Zonghan, ancient manuscripts and paintings found their way into the hands of many officials in Gansu. Some specimens had also been sent to the provincial headquarters in Lanzhou, but transportation of the entire library – estimated at seven cart-loads – had been delayed. In May 1904, the provincial government ordered Wang Zonghan to restore the whole of the find to its original place of deposit. Consequently Wang Zonghan and all the civil and military officials of Dunhuang had come to the Mogao Grottoes to look over all manuscripts in Cave 17, and Wang Zonghan had ordered Wang Yuanlu to take good care of them in their original place. Wang Yuanlu attached a rough wooden door to the opening of Cave 17 and installed a lock on it. The key to the lock was kept by Wang Yuanlu himself.

On 16 March 1907, Stein and Jiang Xiaowan, accompanied by an official attendant, made their first visit to the Mogao Grottoes in order to gain a better understanding of the library cave. Wang Yuanlu happened to be away at the time; he was a monk and was on an alms round in the Dunhuang oasis. A young Buddhist monk helped Stein to locate Cave 17. From 23 March to 15 May, Stein worked in the desert north of the Dunhuang oasis. At the end of March, in response to Stein's telegraphic salutation some weeks earlier, Viceroy Sheng Yun sent a telegraphic circular to several Daotais and to all Magistrates, strongly recommending Stein to official notice.

Having finished his fieldwork north of Dunhuang, Stein returned to town on 15 May, eager to start his work at the Mogao Grottoes. But he had to wait until after the local festival on 19 May (the 8th day of the 4th month according to the lunar calendar, Śākyamuni's birthday), and the annual pilgrimage to the site. As Stein waited, Jiang Xiaowan secretly made contact with Wang Yuanlu in town, and arranged for Wang Yuanlu to await Stein's arrival at the Mogao Grottoes.

At 4 p.m. on 21 May, Stein and his party reached the Mogao Grottoes. Wang Jiayan and Lin Taiqing had provided an officer and some soldiers of the Dunhuang army to accompany Stein's group to the grottoes in order to watch and guard them. On the morning of 22 May, Stein was welcomed by Wang Yuanlu, whom he described as 'a very curious figure, extremely shy and nervous, with a face bearing an occasional furtive expression of cunning which was far from encouraging'.[18] With ulterior motives, Stein pretended not to be interested in Cave 17, but set to work on what ostensibly was the main object of his stay: surveying and photographing. As Stein worked in the morning, Jiang Xiaowan was sent to sound out Wang Yuanlu in a confidential fashion. The promise of a liberal donation persuaded Wang Yuanlu to agree that Stein might see some specimens from the collection. On the afternoon of 22 May, Stein, accompanied by Jiang Xiaowan, paid a formal visit to Wang Yuanlu. Before evening, Jiang Xiaowan had seen Cave 17 and had brought away a first packet of sūtra rolls 'for inspection'.

At noon the next day, 23 May, Stein saw the contents of Cave 17 for the first time:

> The day was cloudless and hot, and the "soldiers" who had followed me about during the morning with my cameras, were now taking their siesta in sound sleep soothed by a good smoke of opium. So accompanied only by Chiang I went to the temple.'

Wang Yuanlu opened the door of Cave 17 to them. From that afternoon and for the next six days (until 28 May), Stein selected manuscripts and paintings from various bundles in the antechapel with its side room and passage, the hidden 'reading room' within Cave 16. The selection was done in secret, and was not noticed by any soldiers or worshippers.

At the end of the afternoon of 23 May, with Jiang Xiaowan's persuasion and 103 miskals (equivalent to 10.3 *liang*/ taels) of silver as 'compensation for MSS.', Wang Yuanlu agreed that Stein's selected documents might be moved away:

> The Tao-shih had summoned up courage to fall in with my wishes, on the solemn condition that nobody besides us three was to get the slightest inkling of what was being transacted, and that as long as I kept Chinese soil the origin of these "finds" was not to be revealed to any living being.[19]

So, Jiang Xiaowan took it upon himself to be the sole carrier between 23 and 30 May: 'For seven nights more he thus came to my tent, when everybody had gone to sleep, with the same precautions'.[20]

On the morning of 27 May, Wang Yuanlu raised the question of a donation for the temple. Stein took up the theme in order to suggest a possible purchase, but made it clear that no definite offer could be made until he had seen the full extent of the collection. Lured by Stein's offer of money, Wang Yuanlu, with the help of his assistant and Jiang Xiaowan, spent the afternoon moving all the bundles of manuscripts from Cave 17. Stein came to the 'conclusion that purchase in part would mean possible havoc & that an effort must be made to save the whole'.[21]

On the morning of 28 May, Stein realized that 'the removal of so many cart-loads of manuscripts would

inevitably give publicity to the whole transaction, and the religious resentment this was likely to arouse in Tun-huang, even if it did not lead to more serious immediate consequences, would certainly compromise my chance of further work in Kan-su'.[22] But he 'was prepared to face these risks rather than forgo the endeavour to rescue the whole hoard'.[23] In terms of the price he was prepared to pay, Stein hinted at 40 horse-shoes of silver (= 2000 *liang*/taels) and was ready to give twice as much. But Wang Yuanlu refused his offer to buy all the manuscripts. Stein recorded in his diary of 28 May:

> Lengthy negotiations on plain trade basis. Asked at first 2 Yambus for 20 bundles, but finally accepted offer of 3 Yambus (M. 1500, incl. M. 340 already paid) for all selections previously made + 50 bundles of texts.[24]

On the morning of 29 May, Stein and Jiang Xiaowan went to collect their selected items. The transaction was settled by 11.30 a.m. to mutual satisfaction. In order to avoid the eyes of the supervisory soldiers, Stein dispatched Tila Bai and Ibrāhim Bēg, his two trusted followers, to assist Jiang Xiaowan in transporting the selected items on the last two nights. They moved furtively between Cave 16 and Stein's camp screened by the shadow of the steep river bank. The huge sackfuls of documents were safely transferred to Stein's store-room without any one, not even Stein's own men, having any suspicion of what was happening.

On the morning of 31 May, a military officer of Dunhuang was sent by Lin Taiqing to visit the Mogao Grottoes, apparently for the purpose of investigating Stein's activities. Uneasy, and probably with a guilty conscience, Wang Yuanlu went into town that day to resume his seasonal alms round.[25]

While Stein busied himself with his work at the Mogao Grottoes, Wang Jiayan devoted himself to settling the *caimailiang* issue. In April/May 1907 he had announced that the *caimailiang* tax would be halved, from 4 *dan* to 2 *dan*, but insisted that the taxes that the peasants had refused to pay in 1905–6 were still owed, and must be paid. He agreed that they could pay in instalments. Most peasants were willing to make a concession, but their leaders, Zhang Huming and his brother Zhang Jianming, refused to pay the tax on principle, and could not accept Wang Jiayan's conditions. Wang Jiayan asked Lin Taiqing and other local officials to talk to the Zhang brothers, but when this did not produce results, a furious Wang Jiayan decided to resolve the matter by force. However, Stein was still in the area, and fearful of causing a rebellion and thus of putting such a distinguished foreign guest in any danger, Wang Jiayan reluctantly postponed any military action.

Stein's long stay at Dunhuang during such an eventful period had already given alarm. Chai Hongshan, Commander-in-chief of the Suzhou Garrison responsible for peace in western Gansu, wrote a report to Viceroy Sheng Yun in April 1907, apparently based on Wang Jiayan and Lin Taiqing's report, Chai wrote that he believed that Stein's archaeological activities would necessarily turn towards tombs, that this would arouse popular prejudice and thus not only expose Stein to personal risk, but also expose the provincial government to serious inconvenience. Viceroy Sheng Yun promptly gave instructions enjoining Wang Jiayan to dissuade Stein – with all diplomatic politeness – from any attempt at excavation.[26]

On the afternoon of 1 June, Wang Jiayan, on his tour to Anxi, made a detour to the Mogao Grottoes to see Stein and convey Viceroy Sheng Yun's orders. Wang Jiayan came too late to affect Stein's transaction with Wang Yuanlu. He had no knowledge of the transaction at all and made no reference to the manuscripts when he saw Stein. Stein was glad about this, but could not help feeling uneasy when he learned confidentially, through Jiang Xiaowan, of Wang Jiayan's purpose in coming. On the morning of 2 June, Stein sent Jiang Xiaowan to town for a couple of days in order to persuade Wang Jiayan to write plain reports to the Daotai of Suzhou and Viceroy Sheng Yun explaining that most of Stein's work lay in the desert and that it was harmless.

During the night of 5 June, Jiang Xianwan returned from town with the assurance that Wang Jiayan had sent a report by wire to Suzhou explaining the innocent nature of Stein's 'hobby'.[25] Wang Yuanlu also returned from town at this time. Reassured that no one in town knew about his secret transaction with Stein, he felt encouraged to make a second transaction on 6 June. To avoid attracting the attention of the accompanying Chinese soldiers the whole collection was brought to Stein's camp as late as 11 p.m.

Having settled up for the second transaction, Stein was ready to pack up the antiquities from 7 June. Local upheavals combined with fears of diphtheria were forcing Stein to leave the Mogao Grottoes as soon as possible. In the course of the packing work, Lin Taiqing came to visit Stein at the Mogao Grottoes on the morning of 9 June. Lin Taiqing's visit, shortly after Wang Jiayan's, aimed to investigate Stein's activities and persuade him to leave this troubled place at the earliest opportunity. Lin Taiqing confided that both he and Wang Jiayan had deemed it prudent to delay any military action until Stein was safely out of the district. Stein appreciated their consideration, for he had come down with a fever and suffered severe swelling of the face since 7 June. Lin Taiqing talked up the prevalence of the diphtheria epidemic in Dunhuang, apparently for the purpose of frightening Stein away as soon as possible.

Dunhuang had been riddled with diphtheria during the late Qing dynasty, with the most virulent attacks occurring in 1870, 1871, 1895 and 1900:

> If one person contracted diphtheria, the whole family could not escape death. If one family contracted diphtheria, the whole street could not escape unscathed. Only one in every ten sufferers survived. Sometimes an entire family died out. Sometimes blood relatives or brothers have to be deserted without care.[26]

In 1907, Dunhuang was rife with diphtheria. When Stein visited the Mogao Grottoes for the first time on 16 March, he saw *en route* 'a shrine with some modest annexes for the priests. The dwellers were absent, probably assisting in the celebrations which were reported [as] being held in the town in order to drive off an epidemic attack described like influenza'.[27] Stein recorded Lin Taiqing's words of 9 June:

> Nan-Darin [Lin Daren = Lin Taiqing] estimates present population of Tun-huang at 80,000 souls. More than this number died in Kang-hsi [rect. Kuang-hsu = Guangxu]21 (1895)

> by an epidemic similar to the one now causing many deaths in city, appar. a kind of diphtheria. Young soldier boy who used to watch my camp, succumbed a few days ago.

The young soldier boy had died of diphtheria in early June, and Stein made 'compensation for services of soldier (dead)' on 12 June with 50 Miskals (5 *liang*/taels) of silver.

Lin Taiqing's visit quickened Stein's leaving. Stein continued his packing on 9 June in spite of being 'weary with fever'.[28] On 10 June, Stein felt 'very tired with low fever',[29] but he still 'approached Tao-shi with suggestions of subsequent cession of *kings*, but met by former apprehension, etc'.[30] On 11 June, Stein paid 110 Miskals (11 *liang*/taels) of silver as a 'reward to Military Daloi & Escort'[31] who had turned a blind eye to Stein's activities over a three-week period at the Mogao Grottoes.

Stein left the Mogao Grottoes on 12 June. Before leaving, Jiang Xiaowan scratched an inscription with a knife on the wall of a cave describing when and how he accompanied Stein the British Prime Minister in visiting the grottoes. Stein recorded his last impression of Wang Yuanlu:

> When I finally said good-bye to the 'Thousand Buddhas', his jovial sharp-cut face had resumed once more its look of shy but self-contented serenity. We parted in fullest amity.[32]

Stein arrived back at the town of Dunhuang, and went to bid everyone farewell: 'see first Nan-Darin [Lin Taiqing] & then Wang-Daloi [Wang Jiayan]. Another pleasant talk with refined scholar. He has smoothed my ways at An-shi [Anxi] & reassured Su-chou Tao-tai about my designs. His grey-haired mother, a dignified matron, sat for family group. Reassembled at Nan-Darin's for quiet meal.' Stein left the town of Dunhuang that evening. He

> found Ambans & all their *kuans* [*guan*] assembled to bid me farewell at temple outside NE gate. Crowd of officials in red-tasselled hats, a picture well framed by polychrome temple portico. In shadow of high temple a scene of the old East, my last impression of Tun-huang.

This was also the last time he would see Lin Taiqing.

Stein arrived at Anxi on 17 June 1907. He visited En Guang, Magistrate of Anxi, and deposited all his collections from Dunhuang at the Magistrate's Office. Stein left Anxi on 24 June for further explorations and arrived at Suzhou [Jiuquan] on 22 July.

Since Stein's departure from Dunhuang, Wang Jiayan had been preoccupied with the tax problem. The day after Stein's arrival in Suzhou (23 July), in the dead of night, Wang Jiayan dispatched He Lin, his close attendant, and 20 soldiers with guns to arrest Zhang Huming in the suburban Zhang's Village. In the course of the fighting, Zhang Huming was shot dead and the Zhang family was humiliated and aggrieved. Aware that Zhang Huming's death would inevitably result in a rebellion among the Dunhuang people, Wang Jiayan consulted with Lin Taiqing and together they issued orders that all the city gates and the gates of the Magistrate's Office be closed immediately and that all soldiers, totalling over 200 men, mount the top of city gate with guns to guard against a peasant rebellion. Their predictions were accurate. As expected, news spread quickly among the peasant farmers of the oasis. Enraged that Zhang Huming had been killed by Wang Jiayan's troops, about 3,000 peasant farmers launched an attack under heavy fire from the guards. They broke through the city gate of Dunhuang, then besieged the Magistrate's Office. In order to protect Wang Jiayan and his family, Lin Taiqing tried to transfer them from the Magistrate's Office to his Commander's Office. The rebels searched in vain for Wang Jiayan, finding only the body of Zhang Huming. Venting their anger, the rebels destroyed and burnt everything in the Magistrate's Office, and then dispersed. In the course of this uprising, 14 soldiers were killed.

Wang Jiayan's reports about the rebellion were submitted through En Guang to officials in Suzhou and eventually to Viceroy Sheng Yun in Lanzhou. The Viceroy immediately ordered that Wang Jiayan be discharged from his post and that this ex-magistrate and a dozen chief rebels be sent to Suzhou for judicial interrogation. Zhang Naicheng, a petty official from Suzhou, was appointed Magistrate of Dunhuang. Stein heard about the rebellion at Dunhuang while he was in Suzhou. Knowing that no Chinese officials of Dunhuang or elsewhere would pose a threat to his archaeological collections, Stein left them at the Magistrate's Office in Anxi, and set out on his expedition to the mountains on 28 July. On his return to Suzhou on 13 September, Stein saw Wang Jiayan awaiting a formal court of enquiry. Stein left Suzhou on 16 September and returned to Anxi on about 25 September.

Stein stayed at Anxi for 12 days. During this period, he retrieved the 17 cases of antiquities he had deposited at the Magistrate's Office in June. He also dispatched Jiang Xiaowan to travel secretly to the Mogao Grottoes of Dunhuang to negotiate with Wang Yuanlu about buying more manuscripts. Stein mentioned this event in his letter to P.S. Allen:

> A proposal for further purchases sent through a trusty messenger met with a promising response, but in order to avoid all suspicions, I had to remain away from the scene & entrust the execution to my ever-zealous secretary. He started off under cover of suitably imagined pretences, while four camels were marched off by the desert route to rendezvous in secret near the caves. A week later, in the dead of night, they turned up again near my temple, … The 230 bundles of MSS. which the good Tao-shih had been induced to part with, contain approx. close on 3000 text rolls, most Chinese sutras & Tibetan Buddhist works.. But no real examination has been possible so far; Central Asian translations are apt to turn up in this big haul. For the present the new acquisitions travel in huge bags, disguised as well as we could manage it. … For the present we must keep this *entre nous* … all which the 'Thousand Buddhas' yielded has cost the Govt. only some £130. The single Sanskrit Ms. on palm leaf with a few other 'old things' are worth this.[33]

The 230 compact bundles containing close on 3000 text rolls were significantly more than Stein had acquired in May and June and undoubtedly represented a much bigger haul of Dunhuang manuscripts.

Knowing that a long delay would mean many hitches, Stein left Anxi on 8 October 1907 and headed for Hami, in Xinjiang Province. He arrived in Hami on 19 October, and wrote a letter to Viceroy Sheng Yun, an official whom he never met:

> In my farewell letter to the Viceroy sent later on from Hami, Chiang made me put in a good word for Wang (Jiayan). I do not know what attention, if any, was paid to it; but before I left Turkestan Chiang heard the cheerful news that Wang had been finally exonerated and given a fresh magisterial charge elsewhere.[34]

Of the chief rebels of Dunhuang who were tried at Suzhou, four were sentenced to death and four were sentenced to life imprisonment. But the *caimailiang* tax was canceled forever.

Lin Taiqing, who always proclaimed himself a loyal official, committed suicide with poison at Dunhuang when he heard an Imperial Edict announcing Emperor Xuantong's abdication on 12 February 1912. Wang Jiayan transferred from Gansu to Xinjiang after the Xinhai Revolution of 1911 as Director of the Civil Bureau of the Provincial Government, and died of an illness at Urumchi on 1 November 1913. Wang Yuanlu lived a miserable life, apparently haunted by his transactions with Stein, and died at the Mogao Grottoes on 3 June 1931.

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Notes

1 The application is dated 14 September 1904; see MS. Stein 294, fol. 85v (Bodleian Library).
2 MS. Stein 294, fol. 86 (Bodleian Library).
3 Satow was the uncle of Stein's close friend Percy Stafford Allen.
4 MS. Stein 283 fol. 6 (Bodleian Library). See Wang Jiqing, 'Sitanyin di er ci Zhongguo kaocha suo chi Zhongguo huzhao jianxi', *Zhongguo bianjiang shidi yanjiu* 1998.4, pp. 69–76. 王冀青:《斯坦因第二次中亚考察所持中国护照简析,《中国边疆史地研究》1998年第4期,第69–76页。
5 M.A. Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay: Personal Narrative of Explorations in Central Asia and Westernmost China*, London: Macmillan and Co, Limited, 1912, vol. 1, p. 141.
6 On Stein's Chinese titles, see Wang Jiqing, '; and, 'Sitanyin di san ci Zhongya kaocha suo chi Zhongguo huzhao jianxi', *Xiyu yanjiu* 1988.4, pp. 21–30. 王冀青:《斯坦因第三次中亚考察所持中国护照简析》,《西域研究》1998 年第4期,第 21–30 页。
7 On the life and career of Jiang Xiaowan (1858–1922), see Wang Jiqing, 'Bu neng bei wangqie de Jiang shiye', *Huasheng guandian* 2002.10 (no. 90), pp. 46–49. 王冀青:《不能被忘却的蒋师爷》,《华声视点》2002 年第10 期(总第 90 期),第 46–49 页。
8 On *caimailiang*, see Lü Zhong (Lü Shaoqing), *Chongxiu Dunhuang xian zhi*, Gansu renmin chubanshe, Lanzhou, 2002. The pages nos given in this article are to the 2002 edition. 吕钟(吕少卿):《重修敦煌县志》,依据吕钟修纂、敦煌市人民政府文献领导小组整理《重修敦煌县志》,兰州:甘肃人民出版社,2002年.
9 Lü Zhong, p. 646.
10 Lü Zhong, pp. 646–647.
11 Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, vol. 2, pp. 68–69.
12 Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, vol. 2, p. 14.
13 Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, vol. 2, p. 18.
14 Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, vol. 2, p. 41.
15 Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, vol. 2, p. 33.
16 Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, vol. 2, p. 41.
17 Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, vol. 2, pp. 32–33.
18 Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, vol. 2, p. 165; and Stein, Serindia: Detailed Report of Explorations in Central Asia and Westernmost China (Oxford, 1921), vol. 2, p. 803.1
19 Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, vol. 2, p. 181.
20 *Ibid*.
21 Stein's diary entry for 27 May 1907 (Bodleian Library, MS.204, p. 315–16).
22 Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, vol. 2, p. 191.
23 *Ibid*.
24 Stein's diary entry for 28 May 1907 (Bodleian Library, MS.204, p. 318).
25 Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, vol. 2, p. 193; *Serindia*, vol. 2, p. 825.
26 Stein's diary entry for 2 June 1907 (Bodleian Library MS.204, p. 327; Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, vol. 2, pp. 232–33.
27 Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, vol. 2, pp. 232–33.
28 Stein's diary entry for 5 June 1907 (Bodleian Library, MS.204, p. 335).
29 Stein's diary entry for 5 June 1907 (Bodleian Library, MS.204, pp. 338–39).
30 Stein's diary entries for 7–9 June 1907 (Bodleian Library, MS.204, pp. 340–44).
31 Lü Zhong Chongxiu', p. 599.
32 Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, vol. 2, p. 21
33 Stein's diary entry for 9 June 1907 (Bodleian Library, MS.204, p. 344).
34 Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, vol. 2, pp. 336–337. Stein's accounts for 12 June 1907 (Bodleian Library, MS.364, p. 78).
35 Stein's diary entries for 9–10 June 1907 (Bodleian Library, MS.204, p. 345).
36 Stein's accounts for 11 June 1907 (Bodleian Library, MS.364, p. 78; and diary for 12 June (Bodleian Library, MS.204, p. 351).
37 Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, vol. 2, p. 194.
38 Wang Jiqing, 'On the photograph of "Magistrate Wang and his family"', *IDP News*, no. 10 (Spring 1998), p. 6. Stein's diary entry for 12 June 1907 (Bodleian Library, MS.204, p. 351).
39 Stein's diary entry for 12June 1907 (Bodleian Library, MS.204, p. 352).
40 Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, vol. 2, p. 236.
41 Lü Zhong, Chongxiu', p. 647.
42 Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, vol. 2, p. 336.
43 Letter from Stein to P.S. Allen, 14 October 1907, quoted in J. Mirsky, Sir Aurel Stein. Archaeological Explorer (Chicago, 1977), p. 280.
44 Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, vol. 2, pp. 336–37.
45 Lü Zhong, Chongxiu', p. 214.
46 Yang Zengxin, 'Dian chengqing jiang xu shou fu Hami panchan zai shi chuli renyuan wen (1913 nian 11 yue 19 ri)', *Buguo zhai wendu*, yi ji yi, Kan dingbian yi (Beijing: Xinjiang zhu Jing gongyu chuban, 1921), p. 21. 杨增新:《电呈请奖恤收抚哈密叛缠在事出力人员文》(1913年11月19日),《补过斋文牍》,乙集一。戡 定编一,北京:新疆驻京公寓初版,1921年,第21页。
47 Wei Juxian, 'Dunhuang shishi'', fulu jiu, *Shuowen yuekan*, 3.10 (May 1943), p. 36. 卫聚贤:《敦煌石室》,附录九,《说文月刊》第3卷第10期。1943年5月。第36页。

Sir Aurel Stein's Visit to Japan in 1930: His Diary and Notebook

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Introduction[1]

In April 1930, amidst preparations for his Fourth Expedition to Central Asia, Sir Aurel Stein (1862–1943) visited Japan and spent 12 days there. He was coming from a North-American lecture tour and was heading for Nanking where he was going to apply for a visa and a permit from the Kuomintang government for his upcoming expedition. The stopover in Japan was essentially a sightseeing visit to famous tourist attractions, during which he also met with a number of scholars, and this is the aspect of his trip that is most interesting to us today. Stein was already 68 at the time and a celebrity in academic circles. Scholars in the newly emerging field of Dunhuang studies had been working for over a decade on the material he had discovered on his previous expeditions, and he was keen to meet them.

Stein arrived in Yokohama on 10 April 1930 and departed from Nagasaki on 21 April. During the week and a half in between, he travelled along the main island from Tōkyō to the Kansai region, visited historical sites and met with a number of people. The Stein Collection at the Library of the Hungarian Academy of Sciences (LHAS) has a small amount of memorabilia related to this visit, including hotel brochures, guidebooks and postcards acquired along the way. There are also are two cuttings from English language newspapers reporting his arrival. The first is from the front page of *The Japan Times*, and has a photo of the aging explorer and the heading 'Noted Archaeologist Arrives on Empress':

> Sir Aurel Stein, K.C.I.E., Ph.D., D.Sc., Superintendent of the Indian Archaeological Survey for over thirty years and a noted explorer and scholar on Buddhism, arrived at Yokohama Thursday morning on the C.P.R. Liner Empress of Asia from Vancouver, enroute to his home in Kashmir, India.
>
> Dr. Stein is proceeding to Nara, where he plans to stay about five days for archeological study and in particular he wishes to study the architecture of the world famous Horiuji Temple in Nara. Also while in Japan he will see Dr. Takakusu and Dr. Takei, Japanese archaeologists.
>
> Sir Aurel in 1900 and 1901 explored Turkestan archaeologically and as a result he published a book called Ancient Khotan. He studied Oriental languages and antiquities at Vienna and at Tübingen University and in England. He is the author of numerous books, among which are Chronicle of Kings of Kashmir, Sand-buried Ruins of Khotan, Ancient Khotan, and Ruins of Desert Cathay.[2]

The second appeared the following day, on the front page of *The Japan Advertiser*, with much the same information. Japanese language papers also ran the story and in all reports he is consistently portrayed in a highly complimentary manner, as an eminent archaeologist.[3] These news reports show that he was a person of considerable reputation and that his visit was of interest to the general public in Japan.

Initially, Stein planned to spend only six days in Japan, taking advantage of the stopover option of the Canadian Pacific Line, as he described it to his good friend P.S. Allen (1869–1933) in a letter written aboard the Empress Maru the day before his arrival in Yokohama.[4] He wanted to see Japan and perhaps meet a few scholars, unless Sir Frederick Whyte (1883–1970), Stein's main ally in his negotiations with the Chinese authorities, suggested that he should proceed

immediately to Shanghai. But Whyte's letter, which he received soon after landing, 'gave encouraging account' about his prospects and thus permitted him to stay for a few days.

Stein landed in Yokohama and the very same day did a tour of Kamakura. He then travelled up to Tōkyō where he spent three days visiting tourist sites and meeting academics. His diary shows that he headed first to the Maison franco-japonaise to meet Henri Maspero (1882–1945), the French sinologist whom he had entrusted with working on the Chinese manuscripts from his Third Expedition. Although Maspero's initial notes on the material were very encouraging, and Stein had used them in *Innermost Asia* (1928), there had been no progress since then and Stein had been unsuccessful in getting a clear answer from him. During a visit to Paris a year earlier Stein learned from the Indologist Sylvain Lévi (1863–1935) that Maspero was working in Tōkyō. Lévi also suggested that perhaps Paul Demiéville (1894–1979), a Swiss Sinologist and resident at the Maison franco-japonaise, could work on the material if Maspero was too busy.[5] Stein arrived to find that Maspero had already left. Demiéville, however, was there, and Stein met him and his family several times.

While in Tōkyō, besides the sightseeing, Stein also had a chance to meet members of the Japanese academic community, most of whom he had met personally or corresponded with before. Among them were Yabuki Keiki 矢吹慶輝 (1879–1939), a historian of religion, whom he had known primarily because of Kabuki's interest in the Dunhuang manuscripts. He had spent the first half of 1923 in London, working on the Stein Collection at the British Museum.[6] Stein also met the art historians Taki Seiichi 瀧精一 (1873–1945) and Dan Inō 團伊能 (1892–1973), and the historian of China Katō Shigeshi 加藤繁 (1880–1946), who were all professors at Tōkyō Imperial University. He appears to have met the archaeologist Harada Yoshito 原田淑人 (1885–1974) as well, but did not mention him in his diary.[7]

Stein was also introduced to Prince Ōyama Kashiwa 大山柏 (1889–1969), a great archaeology enthusiast and collector of neolithic artefacts, who had studied in Berlin and was fluent in both English and German.[8] The prince was the son of Marshal Ōyama Iwao大山巌 (1842–1916), one of Japan's war heroes, commander-in-chief of the Japanese armies in Manchuria during the Russo-Japanese War of 1904–5 and it was his victory there that earned him his princely title. Their scholarly interests and military experience (Stein had military training too) clearly made for stimulating company, hence the 'hearty farewell from soldier scholar' note in Stein's diary. Finally, on his last night in Tōkyō Stein visited the Imperial Academy and was taken out for dinner by Sakurai Jōji 櫻井錠二 (1858–1939), President of the Imperial Academy, and other scholars including Anesaki Masaharu 姉崎正治 (1873–1949), a leading Japanese intellectual, and scholar of religion, and Shiratori Kurakichi 白鳥庫吉 (1865–1942), renowned professor of history at Tōkyō Imperial University.

After Tōkyō, on 13 April, Stein travelled west to the Kansai region. His first stop was Nara where he spent a couple of days looking at local museums and temples. He also met his old friend Sir Charles Eliot (1862–1931), former British Ambassador to Japan, who accompanied him for the next few days. Then Stein took a train to Kyōto where, again, he visited the usual attractions and met with a number of leading Japanese historians and archaeologists, mostly professors from Kyōto Imperial University. Among them was Haneda Tōru 羽田亨 (1882–1955), historian of Central Asia and a leading researcher in the field of Dunhuang studies;[9] the archaeologist Umehara Sueji 梅原末治 (1893–1983), and the Sinologist Kano Naoki 狩野直喜 (1868–1947). He saw briefly Naitō Konan 内藤湖南 (1866–1943), one of the most influential Sinologists in Japan and a leading historian of the 20th century, whom he described as 'a fine old China scholar.' The Stein Collection at the LHAS includes a framed photograph of Naitō with a dedication 'To Dr. Aurel Stein' which must have been received at this meeting (**Fig. 1**).[10] The



Figure 1 Naitō Konan's photograph presented to Stein (Courtesy of LHAS)



Figure 2 Kano Naoki's photograph presented to Stein (Courtesy of LHAS)

LHAS also has a photograph of the Sinologist Kano Naoki 狩野直喜 (1868–1947), which has a dedication on the cover: 'To Sir Aurel Stein with the best compliment of Naoki Kano, Kyoto, Japan' (**Fig. 2**).'[11]

Following his meetings in Kyōto, Stein made another short visit to Nara, and from there he travelled to Kōbe, where he met with Inouye Shūten 井上秀天 (1880–1945), a Zen Buddhist scholar who was working at the British Consulate-General (Kōbe), and Harry J. Griffith (1882–1944), an English expatriate who had lived in Kōbe since 1907 and was at that time a publisher of books on Japan. Finally, on 20 April, Stein boarded the Nagasaki Maru and, after a brief stop the following day in Nagasaki, sailed for Shanghai.

During his trip to Japan Stein was trying to secure a chance for his long-time friend, the art historian Zoltán Felvinczi Takács (1880–1964), to study there. Felvinczi Takács was the Director of the Ferenc Hopp Museum of East Asian Art in Budapest,[12] and the two men enjoyed an ongoing correspondence. In 1930, Felvinczi Takács was trying to organize a Hungarian art exhibition in Japan. Stein was eager to support his younger friend,[13] and mentioned it to Hungary's former prime minister Sándor Simonyi-Semadam (1864–1946), when he ran into him in a hotel in Kyōto.[14] The ex-statesman was visiting Japan in connection with the Hungarian Nippon Society, of which he was the co-president.[15] As Stein's diary shows, the two of them ran into each other several times in hotels in Kyōto and Nara. Stein wrote about his visit to Japan and chance meeting with Simonyi-Semadam to Fervinczi Takács a few weeks later, at the time of his departure from China:[16]

> I spent unforgettable days in scenic Japan; I especially enjoyed the Buddhist art of Nara and its surroundings. The archaeologists and scholars, etc. of the universities and academies in Tokyo and Kyoto received me with great attention. I saw wonderful Chinese artefacts in private collections, and the results of Korean excavations in archaeological institutes.
>
> I was truly happy to run into Dr Simonyi-Semadam in my hotel in Kyoto, and to learn from him that he will bring up semi-officially the issue of the Hungarian picture exhibition at the Japanese Ministry of Education. Naturally, I emphasized the academic benefits of you having the opportunity to stay in Japan for an extended period of time and study the Japanese and Korean collections. I really hope that this plan of yours will come true.[17]

A few months later, already in Kashgar on his Fourth Expedition, Stein wrote to Fervinczi Takács again and told him how happy he was to learn about Simonyi-Semadam's apparent success in Tōkyō. Stein also expressed his opinion that Felvinczy Takács would be able to learn more in 'beautiful Nippon' about Chinese art than in 'poor chaos-stricken China' which was so busy on its way to modernization that it was destroying much of its own heritage.[18]

Almost a year later, having returned to India after the failure of his Fourth Expedition, Stein revisited the same issues in another letter:

> I was especially glad to learn about the useful assistance of Simonyi-Semadam. I sincerely hope that the Japanese-Hungarian exhibition can be carried out and you, my Dear Friend, will soon have the opportunity to become acquainted with the artistic treasure house that is so carefully preserved in that beautiful country. At the time I felt sorry that I could converse with Simonyi-Semadam only briefly in Kyoto and Nara. During those few days I was kept fully occupied by my Japanese contacts and my old beneficiary, the late Sir Charles Eliot, former British Minister and famous scientist, who was, as I had realized at the time, nearing the end of his industrious life.[19]

In the end, the exhibition did not materialize, at least not under the auspices of Felvinczi Takács. Yet Stein continued to support his friend and wrote letters to people he thought would be able to help. For example, the Stein Collection at the LHAS includes two long draft letters written in 1932 to Haneda Tōru and Harada Yoshito with the request to help this 'very deserving Hungarian scholar' to come to Japan. In the absence of other correspondence, we do not know whether either of these professors provided assistance, but four years later Felvinczy Takács was able to spend a year in Japan in 1936.[20]

Although Stein's visit to Japan was mostly sightseeing in nature, it cannot be discounted as a tourist trip of a retired academic to an exotic land. Far from it — he was in the middle of organizing his Fourth Expedition and there was tension in the air. In a few days he would go to Nanking and begin lobbying for a visa and permit to enable him to conduct archaeological work in Xinjiang and Mongolia. He was aware of the new wave of nationalism and its impact on large-scale foreign expeditions, including those of Sven Hedin (1865–1952) and Roy Chapman Andrews (1884–1960).[21] He understood that obtaining the permit in the current political atmosphere was not going to be an easy task, and this was precisely the reason why he travelled to Nanking in person. His time in Japan could be counted as a few days of peace among scholars. His three weeks in Shanghai and Nanking would be devoted to getting the appropriate permissions, and there would be little time for sightseeing.[22] We know that he achieved his aims in Nanking and came away with his visa and digging permit. But the tension continued, and the Expedition ended prematurely. Under pressure from a group of Chinese activist intellectuals, the government revoked Stein's visa and he was forced to exit the country, leaving behind everything he had collected at sites on the way.

Stein's connection with the field of Dunhuang studies in Japan has been the subject of a thoroughly-researched monograph by the Chinese scholar Wang Jiqing.[23] As a supplement to his book, Wang also published a translation of the relevant portion of Stein's diary and notebook, with copious annotation. Although this material was originally written in English, it has not been published previously in English, only in Wang Jiqing's Chinese translation. In this article, my aim is to make the original English text available for further research, and to provide supplementary information to Wang Jiqing's book.

The diary and notebook presented below were written during the 12 days Stein spent in Japan. They are currently in the collection of the Bodleian Library, University of Oxford, catalogued under pressmarks MS.Stein 250, fols 68–73, and MS.Stein 224, fols 99–102, respectively. Stein kept both a diary and a notebook. The notebook was written primarily for Stein's friends and because of this it is written in a neat,

even handwriting, with few abbreviations or ligatures.[24] In contrast with this, the diary was intended as a personal record; it is thus more difficult to read and at times requires a great deal of effort to decipher. From the point of view of their content, because the notebook is primarily an enumeration of tourist sites and museum exhibits, its guidebook-like descriptions are less interesting today to us than the diary which details Stein's meetings and lists the people with whom he interacted. In addition, the notebook is incomplete and does not cover all of the days Stein spent in Japan. The diary and notebook were conceived and written as two separate documents, and for this reason I have not combined them, but present them separately: first the diary, then the notebook. I have annotated the text where it was appropriate to do so. I tried to identify places and people, but in general have tried to focus on academic connections rather than tourist attractions.

A few words about the transcription: ligatures and abbreviations in the text are written out in full, with their omitted portion placed in brackets (e.g. inspn > insp[ectio]n; acct > acc[oun]t; Ch. > Ch[inese]). In general, brackets indicate my interventions. The & sign is kept throughout the text. Although Japanese names and words, especially diacritical marks, are often misspelled or written in a different orthography, they are presented as Stein wrote them – I provide the correct forms, whenever identifiable, at their first appearance in my notes. For the sake of convenience, I also included in the notes the Chinese characters for Japanese names, even when they appear already in the Introduction above.

The diary

10 April 1930. Thursday.

Woke up at 4 P.M.[25] & was ready for medical insp[ectio]n (quarantine) by 6 A.M. Long wait for police insp[ectio]n; interested official in visit to Nara. Letter from Whyte reached me by 7 A.M. & gave encouraging acc[oun]t. My 'stopover' suits, so by 8 A.M. reached New Grand Hotel facing park & harbour.[26] At 9 started in motor bus for Kamakura. Once emerged from Yokohama suburbs along bluff delightful succession of greens & wooded hills. Hotel night porter on his way home explains [*sic*] groups of holiday makers. Arrived near Kamakura St[atio]n & walked up avenue leading under Torii to Hachiman Shrine.[27] Gay stream of pilgrims ripples along broad road lined by cherry trees still in blossom. Left modern shrine girt by pine trees & walked up steep road to Kokenji temple.[28] Noble gateway in Chin[ese] style & high roofed shrine. All breathes China plus European resort. Up between booths in picturesque glen with remains of Japan landscape gardening. Party of tipsy pilgrims with yellow scarves settles down at table. Return along same road missed Ennoji temple.[29] Secured rikshaw with old coolie of humour & passing along bread shop, lined roads, asphalted, visited Dai butsu.[30] Fine bronze image once enclosed in temple, varies in expression as one stands close in front. Concentr[atio]n of down cast eyes missed when photoed from distance. Booth built on to [...].[31]

On to Kwannon shrine on picturesque hillside.[32] First & only beggar seen. Wooden statue in dark interior. Sightseeing fee & cards. On by gay street, soldiers, to Kaihin Hotel.[33] Comfortable modern hostelry. Polite attendants. By 2.30 in crowded train to Katāse along sea shore. Continuous row of shops to Enoshima Island, another scenery.[34] By steep stairs to hilltop. Dancers on platform. A tipsy monk. Down by 3.40 & in tram with school children back to Kamakura. Caught 4.23 train which brought me to Yokohama by 4.49, rather tired. Make my way to Canadian Pacific & extract inform[atio]n about trains to Nikko, etc. Cable to Ψ [Allen], MS. to Lüders,[35] letter to Whyte, Ψ [Allen] & H[arriet][36] by dinner time. Talk with Rosenfield. A.D.C. performance. To rest 11 P.M.

11 April 1930. Friday.

Up by 6 A.M. Letters to Whyte & Sachs.[37] Left New Grand Hotel by 9.30 A.M. for Sagurichо St[atio]n.[38] Past endless suburbs to Tokyo Central St[atio]n. Drive to Maison Franco-Japonaise. Instead of Maspero received by Demiéville who has relieved him. Invited to stay for lunch after visits from Prof. Ino Dan sent by Taki.[39] Young French geographer & Kahn travelling fellow. Yabuki comes by 3 P.M. when I decided to stay over 12th & abandon Nikko visit. Telephone talk with Mr. Samson who tells of Sir Ch[arle]s Eliot staying at Nara.

Driven with French hosts by Yabuki to Shiba Park past Imperial Palace walls. Visit to Zojoji Mausoleums of Shōguns.[40] Received by monks, fat & jovial. Past fine groves & a forest of Samurai lanterns to 6th Shōgun's mausoleum. Overladen gilded shrine showing slavish development of Chin[ese] models. Up prehistoric mound to 12th Shōgun, octagonal hall encloses Stūpa covering remains & votive deposit of jewels. Sombre beauty of grove, with camellias in bloom & bronze roofs in metallic green. Close warm evening.

Driven past villas & old time houses to Baron Okura's Museum.[41] Above it burnt out Europe structure. Shown miscellaneous collection of Tang sculptures, including large Buddha relievo. Few Han carvings, inferior paintings. Whole housed with ostentatious lavishness.

Back at Maison for tea. Dinner with M. & Mad[ame] Demiéville & the two pensionaries. Talk of Chavannes' & their daughter, of Turkestan travels.[42] Feel tired & hoarse, comfortable Japan[ese] upper floor receives me. To rest by 11 P.M.

12 April 1930. Saturday.

Up by 6.30 after fair rest. Wrote up diary & by 8.30 joined by Demiéville from his Japan[ese] house. Show I[nnermost] A[sia] photos, etc. By 9.30 Ino Dan comes to take us to University. Reveived by Taki & Kato[43] who in 1912 had visited B[ritish] M[useum] collection. Shown splendid coll[ectio]n of lacquered bowls & boxes from Dojō tomb, Corea (Rakuro).[44] Inscript[ion] of A.D. 69. Ornaments correspond exactly to lacquer box of L.M.[45] Little of silk fabrics. Tortoise shell. Beautiful little figures on back of lacquer bowl (see Kokka).[46] Next to Marquis Hosukawa's house, magnificent set of Han bronzes;[47] golden inlaid bowl, turquoise buckle; stick handle; see Rozdovt[seff]'s book on Loo collection.[48] Next shown over fine coll[ectio]n of Tang terracottas (house models of Han?; Khara-Khoto pottery); refer to Serindia for T.XXII fabric motifs. Khotan carpets. Fine library comprises Cordier's,[49] sets of Cairo Mus[eum] vol[ume]s, books on India, etc. Whole reflects scholarly care of grandee. Set of stone panels from a Hsingan temple,[50] brought to Japan 30 years ago & set up in garden.

Back in light rain to Maison where Mad[ame] D[emiéville] presides at table. Talk of Maspero's writing & reluctance to answer. By 2.40 past telegram office (inform Sir Ch[arles] Eliot of coming tomorrow). To Duke Ohyama's house.[51] Fine soldier, who has taken to prehistorie [*sic*]; son of Marshal Ohyama.[52] Shown over carefully arranged cases of stone implements & neolithic pottery. Mat-marked jars plentiful, also Sh.T. painted goblets. Told of saucer. No perforated pieces. All finds from kitchen middens around former sea shore about Tokyo. Library full of Japan[ese] & foreign works. Presented with abundance of pamphlets (with account of marathon for Jap[anese] soldiers). Offer of fine publication on pottery all for Arch[aeological] Survey Library. German dedication reveals Prince's military training. Hearty farewell from soldier scholar. Visit to Mad[ame] Demiéville's pretty Jap[anese] house.

Then to Imp[erial] Academy by 6.30 P.M. Dinner after general meeting. Meet Anesaki,[53] Taki, Kato & Shiratori.[54] By side of President Ino Sayukai,[55] welcomed by him. Reply about Jap[anese] historical sense. Return by 8.30. Visit of Peshawari K.K. Sa[?].[56]

13 April 1930. Sunday.

Up by 6 A.M. Receive Fukui's scroll & start by 9 with D[emiéville] in search of code & map. Grand Department Store of Maruyama, Great holiday throngs at Tokyo St[ation]. Left at 10 A.M. in comfortable 1st class comp[artmen]t.

Cloudy weather hides Fuji, but allows green hills & well-cultivated plain to be enjoyed. Dining car full of Japanese travellers. Along shore & succession of ranges to Nagoya, the great industrial centre. Numerous estuaries around. Arr[ive] at Kyōtō at 8.3 & by 8.30 start in overcrowded tram for Nara. Tired but polite holiday folk. Luckily find Nara St[atio]n & am driven in Hotel car to Nara Hotel, a fine hostelry. Received by Sir Ch[arle]s Eliot who has arranged for my being guided by assistant of Prefect.

Felt troubled all day by sore throat & in the evening asthma, too. V[ery] tired, to rest by 11 P.M.

14 April 1930. Monday.

Good rest till 6.30. Delightful vista from Hotel window across pond tow[ards] Nara Park. By 9.30 fetched by Mr. Miyamito with Archaeol[ogical] Sup[erintenden]t Inamad.[57] Driven in Prefect's car thr[ough] thriving Nara & large villages. Horyūji temple reached by 10.30.[58] Excellently kept court & approach. Spent 1 ½ hours within Kondō, main temple.[59] Splendid frescoes completely agree with oldest Ch'ien[-fo-tung] paintings, esp[ecially] embroidery.[60] Frescoes much effaced, but protected. Supposed to be later than found[atio]n of temple. Statuary closely resembles that of China. Its display in narrow square reduces effect. Baldachin corresponds to sq[uare] upper ceilings of Chi'en[-fo-tung]. So do also fig[ure]s of Lokāpalas & Vajrapānis.

Treasury crammed with smaller images of merit. Fine fragments of figured silks incl[uding] what looks like warp rib. Plentiful fine bronzes. Strips of printed Sutras. Paintings look later.

In Stūpa-tower grottos in clay below Mt. Meru represent stories from B[uddha]'s life. Fine group of lamenting followers as at Bezeklik.

Drove back by 1.20 & had lunch with Sir Ch[arles] Eliot. Then in rikshaw first to Kofokuji temple ground.[61] Pilgrims give coins & take off hats. Thr[ough] spa-like road & Nan dai-mon gate to Tōdaiji monastery's Big Buddha, poor work but imposing hall.[62] In fine wood to Sangatsu temple with crowd of T'ang images in dark inner shrine.[63] Good fig[ure]s of Sun & Moon (?). Finally visit plain Shinto shrine & along avenue of 3000 stone lanterns down. Deer called to night's rest. Talk over tea of China & Boxer Indem[nit]y.[64]

15 April 1930. Tuesday.

After a poor night up by 7 A.M. Wrote to Demiéville & in steady rain drove to Nara Museum. Its 13 excellently arranged rooms contain a magnificent collection of statues in wood & plaster from temples of Nara & district. Bronze objects in profusion, paintings on silk, the famous Sasanian silk mounted as kakemono swords[65] from base of Daibutsu, etc. (see Notebook).[66] Arrang[emen]t & labelling v[ery] systematic. Lighting & cases all that c[oul]d be wished. Mr. Kabuto in charge with 10 staff.[67] Well stocked shop for Buddhist articles holds spare plates reproducing textiles of different sources. Restricted purchases.

Mr. Miashito returns with me to lunch. Arrange for berth in N.Y.K.[68] steamer of 20th since 'Asama Maru' start advanced. Ditto for Hotels.

Drive in rain to Shōsōin, court specially opened.[69] Splendid setting of trees & lawn to sacred deposit of Shōmo's Empress. Wonderful massiveness of structure. Elaborate precautions. Legend of deposit saved from fire by lighting. Photos taken in rain. Visit to Koda-in. Fine Lokapālas in corners. Wrote to Sir Fr[ederick] Whyte & Shanghai Hotel. Walk up to Shinto shrines along avenue of 3000 lanterns. Glorious colours of trees & lawns. Back by 7 P.M.

16 April 1930. Wednesday.

Morning misty but clearing during journey to Kyoto, reached at 10.3 A.M. Viewed wooded hill Momoyama where Emperor Meiji buried[70] (state visits to the mound by Ministers & Ambassadors) & the careful tea plants of Uji. Along wide clean roads to Miyako Hotel at N.E. corner, under pretty hill.[71] Awaited by Prof. Haneda,[72] S. Umehara.[73] Talk of Serindia & Uighur studies in room on 6th floor. Then found by Marquess Hosokawa, Pres[iden]t of Archaeological Assoc[iatio]n. Fine aristocratic face of true Japan[ese] style. Taken to lunch by him with H[aneda] & Um[ehara]. A happy party. Hosok[awa] knows England & may visit India. Ask him to come to my camp!

By 1.30 P.M. with Um[ehara] to Chion-in.[74] Hearty reception by abbot, dignitary of Jōdō sect. Dr. A. Wakai, pupil of Leumann, joins.[75] Presents of rosary, handle & books. Next past Howanji temples (late abbot Count Otani, now at Mukden)[76] to Kōryūji temple in NW. suburb, founded under Shotoku, newly built frescoes with door in bronze (Italian style!), numerous wooden statues & kakemonos of Fujiwara.[77] Lokapala banners with S[an]sk[rit] initials. Walls decorated with poor frescoes of floating musical instruments.

Visit to Kyoto Museum where old armour & swords. Textile fragments obviously pilfered from Shosoin. More in priv[ate] possession. Stucco top of relievo arch from Kuchā. Archer between two birdlike fig[ure]s. Chin[ese] apsara of Persian design in faience. Concertina MS. of Tempyo proves to be origin[ally] a roll.

Return to Hotel by 5.45 & met Haneda at his study in Univ[ersity]. Shown Ch[inese] MSS. incl[uding] Nestorian roll. Dinner under Dr. Shinzo Shinzo, President of Imp[eria]l Univ[ersity].[78] Gathering of professors of literature, history, etc. Met Kano,[79] Naito (a fine old China scholar),[80] Dr. Sakaki (S[an]sk[rit]),[81] Hamada (Arch[aeology]),[82] Ogawa (Geogr[aphy]).[83] Dinner with speech read by Pres[iden]t which I replied to. Compared wonder of present transform[atio]n with that of 6th cent[ury]. After tea à la ch[inoise] left by 9 P.M. Met Sir Charles Eliot in his room (642) next to mine. At 12 noon Dr. Simonyi-Semadan greeted me at Hotel.[84]

17 April 1930. Thursday.

Poor rest. Up by 6.30 & by 9 A.M. after talk with Simonyi-Semadan & change of dress taken by Umehara to Imperial Palace. Stands in fine park now open to public, no walls enclose it. Through side gate enter extensive complex of simple halls, all in wood with papered partitions. Fine matting & polished woodwork. Conducted past audience chambers to great reception hall where coronation took place. Two elaborate thrones. Dandy decoration of screens, dating from 1868 when old palace was burnt down. Plan exactly reproduced. Whole impresses by its simplicity & archaic discomfort. Sir Ch[arles] Eliot believes style points to Polynesian origin of Jap[anese] race.

Next to Nijo Palace once residence of Shōguns. It is larger & shows much good lacquerwork on screens & ceilings. Fine reception rooms where feudal lords entered presence.

Called on Haneda & with him & Hamada visited Archaeol[ogical] Institute. Shown pottery & bronzes from Corean excav[ation]s carried on by H[aneda] & Umehara, shown Vol. I. of Archaeologia Orientalis (Pi-tzu-wo site).[85] Spectrums of barbed arrows (pre-Han?). Purchased Chin[ese] ceramics & bronzes. Altogether an ex[cellen]t working collection.

Left at 2 P.M. & drove with Umehara to cable st[atio]n below Mt. Hiei.[86] Lunch in restaurant recalling those in similar situat[io]n in Switzerland. Ascent to top past ski-ing ground, wide panoramic view over Kyoto & L[ake] Biwa. Ran down in 8 m[inutes] & caught 3.40 train. By 4.15 at Hotel, changed & was at st[atio]n for 5.41 train.

Travelled with Ch[arles] Eliot to Nara, pleasant scenery.

18 April 1930. Friday.

Restful night & gloriously clear morning. After hasty meeting with Simonyi-Semadan started by 9.15 for Yakushiji temple by road to Horyuji.[87] Charming quiet surroundings. In main temples are far[?][88] fine images of Tempyo period. Bhaisajyabuddha with sun & moon by his side, all bronze with fine black patina. Pedestal of central image exactly reproduces the pedestals of D[andan] Oilik. Below three stepped bases, above them high oblong member surmounted by two projections. The top one of these ornamented with beautiful vine scroll, quite Hellenistic. The three bases ornamented with lozenges, each holding a jewel within oblong pearl border. Sasanian influence. The middle high shaft shows scenes with coarsely modelled fig[ure]s which recall Indian dancers. The haloes, gilt of all three fig[ure]s, are good Momoyama work, gilt floral ornament, all three fig[ure]s show Gandhāra drapery & jewelry. In Tōyin-do temple Kudara-Kwannon in non-Chinese drapery; fine lacquered shrine.[89] Beautiful wooden halo, broken, from Bhaisajyabuddha; vine leaf motif.

A small shrine holds large stone with Buddha footprints, size like those of Tirath Chakra in middle.[90]
Near bye [*sic*] Tōshōdai-ji temple, founded by Chinese teacher whom Shomo had invited.[91] 1000 armed Kwan-non. Lōkapāla holding pen & roll (Komoku-ten).[92] Chōshu-den hall, from Nara palace.[93] Simple double brackets over massive pillars. Ceiling formed by beams placed crossways. Brackets rest in plain sockets. Ret[urne]d by 12 noon. Lacquer shop. Photos from Hotel. Wrote to Teichman,[94] etc.; after 2 P.M. walk to Museum. Leather book cover decorated with acanthus in resist process. May be non-Japanese. Chinese harp of 124 A.D. from Hōryūji.[95] Relics found below Dai-Butsu incl[uding] beautiful small bowl said to have held a tooth of Emp[eror] Shōmu. Yamamoto explains how early in Meiji specimens of Shōsōin silks were sent by Agricultural Dep[artmen]t to silk factories for imitation. Exhib[itio]n held of Shōsōin objects held in Dai-Butsu. Small silk fr[agment]s given away then.
Walk along W. edge of Deer Park; picnic parties had left their traces by side of receptacles. Back in dusk descended into gayly lit road lined with shops & restaurants.

Talk with Ch[arles] E[liot] over India & its predicament.[96] His Siberian recollections; hopeless ways of white Russians explain breakdown.

19 April 1930. Saturday.

Started by 8.30 for Kasuga temple.[97] Photos taken (8) of lantern-lined avenues, Shinto shrines, Sangatsu-den & Dai Butsu. Home by 11.30. Packed & after lunch with E[liot] & brief talk with Simonyi started with E[liot]'s servant for Momoyama by 2.27 in express train. Hot walk thr[ough] street to entrance of great park which holds burial mound of Emp[ero]r Meiji. Thick mixed forest covers hill around & behind it. Splendid broad gravelled road leads up to it. View allowed only from distance, bareheaded. Descended to another imp[eria]l tomb, smaller & of similar type.[98] Then below high imposing staircase leading to M[eiji]'s, drove to temple dedicated (?) to Marshall Nōgi, his modest dwelling before Port Arthur.[99] Two bronze horses. By train to Kyōtō wherein by 4.55 train to Kōbe. Continuous string of factories & villages. At Oriental Hotel visit of Mr. Inouye[100] from Consulate & Mr. Griffith, an old resident.[101] Felt tired & throat sore.

20 April 1930. Sunday.

Got up by 5.45 & after breakfast served by boys whom the night's dance had kept awake till 4 A.M. wrote cards to H[arriet], Ψ [Allen], Andrews, Takács,[102] also Yabuki & Haneda. At 9.30 A.M. with Mr. Inouye to Nippon Yusen Kaisha Office where received with much attention by staff. Boarded Nagasaki Maru by 10.20 & found a beautiful gift of flowers from Marquis Hosokawa awaiting me, brought by Private Secretary of Mayor. Photogr[aphe]d for Nippon Y[usen] K[aisha]. Ship left at 11 exactly. Crowd at pier keeps to paper cords held by parting friends. Much gay shouting. After lunch enjoyed delightful passage through Inland Sea with its maze of bold islands, all decked with fields & woods. Tow[ards] 6 P.M. passed thr[ough] Kagoshima Channel, with big currents & reefs, a dangerous bit to navigate.

Talk with English merchant who knows Japan well, of industrial future. Wages rising & Chinese competition foreseen. Copper & coal on islands.

After dinner shared with Mrs. _____ from California[103] & Miss Hiller of Connecticut. Typical cinema treat.
21 April 1930. Monday.

Arrived at Nagasaki before 9 A.M. Landed with Mrs Sampson(?) & Miss Hiller to visit curio shops. Town bears a look of decadence owing to trade having shifted to Moji. Saw lacquer & porcelain in an old shop but found nothing to attract. For one small lacquered plain box ¥12 were asked.

Sailed from this old gate of Japan off which lay the island of Deshima, opened to Dutch since 17th cent. by 1 P.M. During afternoon read China Guide about Shanghai & Peking & wrote up diary.

After dinner a typical American cinema Newsreel provided doubtful enjoyment.

Japanese order & neatness characterizes everything on board. Walk on boat deck. Open sea with distant sight of two rocky islands.

The notebook

14 April 1930.

Visit from Nara to Hōryū-ji through thriving country along Ōsaka road. Impressive orderliness of temple court. Within main shrine splendid display of images crowds square platform. Amitābha's and Bhaisajyaguru's triads flank Buddha. Struck by absence of space for all the statues now removed to Nara Museum. Three baldachins hanging over chief groups have the truncated cone shapes & striped decoration of Ch'ien-fo-tung ceilings.

Past Prince Shōtok's[104] shrine to treasure-house of temple, full of bronzes, smaller images & utensils for worships. 'Million' of miniature Stūpas, each containing strip of paper with printed Dhāraṇi; date AD 770.

The five-storied tower, representing Stūpa, contains on lowest floor four stucco grottos with representation of four scenes of life-story. That of Nirvāna with fine figures of lamenting disciples. Close resemblance to Bezeklik fresco.

During afternoon visited with Sir Charles Eliot the various temples of Kufuko-ji in lower portion of Nara Park & then those of Tōdai-ji, set amidst glorious foliage on hill slope. Statue of Dai-butsu has inferior head, a later restoration. High stone platform from which votive deposits were recovered during repairs of 1913. At Sangwatsu-do fine Kwan-yin image.

15 April 1930.

Visited Imperial Nara Museum at 10 A.M. Received by Mr. Kabuto & his aids [sic]. Impressive display of 'treasures' collected from temples of Nara & district.

Main hall contains some wonderful wooden images of Avalokiteśvara besides great array of other Bodhisattvas, Lokapālas, Vajrapāṇis etc. Here and in adjoining rooms arrangement by periods. All statues show close resemblance in pose, drapery, etc. to Ch'ien[-fo-tung] sculptures. Special notes recorded on following.
No. 502. Lifesize Jizō, head shaved, bariolated dress of which edge lifted up with r[ight] hand.

No. 21. Lokapāla's armour on breast shows laced unbrication

such as always found on Vaisravaṇa in paintings.
No. 11. Vaisravaṇa (Temon-ten[105]) points with l. hand to ground; head uplifted in dignified pose.

No. 456, a fine lifesize Jizō of Kamakura period. Underdress shows dark stripes as in paintings.

No. 23, a splendid pair of lantern-carrying demons.

No. 133. Within wooden image of a Hōki-bosatsu[106] there was found a multitude of small narrow figures appar[ently] representing Bodhisattvas.

No. 77. From Hōryū-ji some exquisitely modelled small figures in clay of a boy in devotion, seated saint.
Swords in richly bejewelled sheaths recovered in damaged state from below base of Dai-butsu; d[itt]o quantity of stone beads, etc.

No. 66. A complete book cover, with bamboo matting & strips of tapestry corresponds exactly to the one recovered from Ch'ien[-fo-tung]. Corners fitted with golden butterflies. Between bamboo matting & inner lining an asbestos layer said to be inserted.

No. 76. A number of wooden labels for attachment to rolls recall in size & shape the labels for kitbags, etc., from T[un-huang] Limes.

No. 149. Specimens of small votive Stūpas in wood, presented by Empress Shotoku in a 'million', contained each a small paper roll, with printed Dhāraṇī. Date A.D. 770.

No. 24. Magnificent saddlery meant for use by a 'divinity'. Leather flaps below saddle reproduced in bronze; enormous shoe stirrups; d[itt]o pompons for surcingle & behind; four narrow leather straps bear bells.

Misc[ellaneous] 'ching' rolls with T'ang script include some written in gold over blue or black.
In anteroom a series of three colour plates illustrate fabrics from banner heads; book covers & all varieties of Ch[inese] silk fr[agment]s represented. 'Sasanian' patterns incl[ude] hunting scene; cockatrices facing. Originals said to be in Shōsōin.

16–17 April 1930.

For notes on sculptures, etc. in Kūryi-ji temple, Kyōtō Museum, etc., see Diary notebook.

18 April 1930.

For renewed visit to Nara Museum see notebook.[107]

Notes

1 I would like to express my gratitude to Richard Ovenden and Colin Harris of the Bodleian Library, University of Oxford, for granting permission to publish the parts of Aurel Stein's diaries relating to his visit to Japan. I am also grateful to Ágnes Kelecsényi of the Library of the Hungarian Academy of Sciences (LHAS) for her help in locating items connected with this trip. For items in the LHAS, see J. Falconer et al., *Catalogue of the Collections of the Library of the Hungarian Academy of Sciences*, LHAS/BM, Budapest, 2002; and J. Falconer et al., *Supplement to the Catalogue of the Collections of the Library of the Hungarian Academy of Sciences*, LHAS, Budapest, 2007.

2 *The Japan Times*, 10 April 1930.

3 *The Tōkyō Asahi Shimbun* 東京朝日新聞, 11 April 1930, for example, reported his arrival in Japan with a short notice and photograph.

4 Stein MS.21, fols 80–81, The Bodleian Library, University of Oxford.

5 Letter from Stein to Maspero, 18 June 1929, *LHAS Catalogue*, p. 76, 7/fols 126–9.

6 Their correspondence for the years of 1919–27 is kept at the Bodleian Library. For Stein's connection with Yabuki, see Wang Jiqing王冀青, *Sitanyin yu Riben Dunhuangxue* 斯坦因與日本敦煌學 [Stein and Dunhuang Studies in Japan], Lanzhou, 2004, pp. 196–204.

7 In a letter to Harada a year later, Stein specifically refers to 'the kind welcome you gave me in 1930 on my visit to Tokyo' (Letter from Stein to Harada Yoshito, 12 Sept 1932, *LHAS Catalogue*, p. 59, 5/fol.65).

8 The LHAS collection includes Ōyama's book on the European Palaeolithic (*Ōshū Kyūsekki Jidai* 歐州舊石器時代, Tōkyō, 1929) with a dedication to Stein.

9 The LHAS collection includes Haneda's book, co-edited with Paul Pelliot, on the Dunhuang manuscripts (Tonkō isho 燉煌遺書 / *Manuscrits de Touen-Houang conservés à la Bibliothèque Nationale de Paris*, Kyōto, 1926) with a dedication to Stein. This book was probably presented to Stein while he was in Japan.

10 Although catalogued simply as 'portrait of an unidentified Japanese man', his original name Naitō Torajirō 内藤虎次郎 (Konan was his penname) is written in Japanese on the photograph. See *LHAS Supplement*, p. 164, Stein Photo 44/1/19.

11 *LHAS Supplement*, p. 164, Stein Photo 44/1/18.

12 On Stein's relations with Felvinczy Takács, see Á. Kelecsényi Huszágné, *Stein Aurél (1862–1943) és a Magyar Tudomány: Kapcsolatok a Magyar Tudományos Akadémiával – Stein Gyűjtemények a Magyar Tudományos Akadémia Könyvtárában*, Budapest (ELTE, Ph.D. dissertation), 2004, pp. 161–5.

13 What is left of their correspondence is today kept at the Ferenc Hopp Museum, Budapest, where Felvinczi Takács worked.

14 Simonyi-Semadam was in office for only four months during the year of 1920. He is best known for signing the Treaty of Trianon in 1920, which is considered one of the most painful events in Hungarian history. He was a wealthy banker who acted as the Co-President of the Hungarian Nippon Society, established in 1924.

15 During this visit Kadooka (Sumioka) Tomoyoshi 角岡知良, a Pan-Asian nationalist and President of the Japanese-Hungarian Friendship Society, presented a Japanese sword to Miklós Horthy, regent of Hungary. Simonyi-Semadam was the one who carried this gift back home; see Y. Umemura, *A Japán-Tengertől a Duna-Partig: Imaoka Dzsúicsiró Életpályája a Magyar-Japán Kapcsolatok Tükrében* [From the Sea of Japan to the Banks of the Danube: The Life of Imaoka Jūichirō in Light of the Hungarian-Japanese Relations], Budapest, 2006, p. 43. The *Tōkyō Asahi Shimbun*, 28 April 1930, p. 11, describes the reception held to welcome Simonyi-Semadam on 27 April at the Matsumoto-rō 松本楼 restaurant at Hibiya 日比谷.

16 Stein's letters to Felvinczi Takács were all written in Hungarian (any English translations are mine).

17 Letter from Stein to Felvinczi Takács, from Hakone Maru, near Hong Kong, 16 May 1930, Ferenc Hopp Museum, A 1994/1–2. For a translation of the part of this letter where Stein conveys the good news of successful preparations for his upcoming expedition, see I. Galambos, 'Another Hungarian looting China's treasures? Sir Aurel Stein, Lajos Ligeti and a case of mistaken identity', *Tonkō Shahon Kenkyū Nenpō* 敦煌写本研究年報 4 (2010), pp. 195–207, esp. pp. 197–8. I am grateful to Dr. Györgyi Fajcsák and Tatjána Kardos from the Ferenc Hopp Museum for facilitating access to the archives.

18 Letter from Stein to Felvinczi Takács, from Mohand Marg, 14 October 1930, Ferenc Hopp Museum, A 1995/2.

19 Letter from Stein to Felvinczi Takács, from Mohand Marg, 24 July 1931, Ferenc Hopp Museum, A 1996/2a.

20 He acknowledges his debt to Stein in his book about his journey. He claims that he was invited by the International Cultural Relations Society (Kokusai Bunka Shinkōkai 国際文化振興会) and that he was financed by the Mitsui Foundation established in Budapest following the visit of Baron Mitsui Takaharu 三井高陽 (1900–83). See Z. Felvinczy Takács, *Buddha Útján a Távol-Keleten* [On Buddha's Way in the Far East], vols I-II, Budapest, 1938, p. 2.

21 For a short description of the problems these expeditions were having with Society for the Preservation of Cultural Objects, see Galambos, *op. cit.*, pp. 196–7.

22 On the background of the preparation for Stein's Fourth Expedition, see S. Brysac, 'Sir Aurel Stein's fourth, "American" expedition', in H. Wang (ed.) *Sir Aurel Stein, Proceedings of the British Museum Study Day, 23 March 2002* (British Museum Occasional Paper 142), London, 2004, pp. 17–22.

23 Wang Jiqing, op. cit.

24 After the trip, Stein used these notes to create a continuous account of his time in Japan, in the form of a 'personal narrative'. Stein MS.264, fols 1–12, Bodleian Library. However, since the 'personal narrative' uses the diary and notebook as its primary source of information, I only present these two.

25 4 P.M. in the diary is obviously an error for 4 A.M.

26 The New Grand Hotel in Yokohama was built in 1927 in place of the old one which had been entirely destroyed by the Kantō earthquake of 1923. The new hotel was designed by the architect Watanabe Hitoshi 渡 辺仁, and it was the place where General McArthur stayed before establishing his headquarters at the Dai-ichi Insurance Building. See Hiroshi Watanabe, *The Architecture of Tōkyō: an Architectural History in 571 Individual Presentations*, Edition Axel Menges, Stuttgart, 2001, p. 95.
27 The Tsurugaoka Hachimangū 鶴岡八幡宮 in Kamakura.
28 Kokenji is a mistake for Kenchōji 建長寺, a Zen temple that is one of the main attractions in Kamakura. Stein spells it in his Notebook for this day as Kenjoji. A torii 鳥居 is a traditional Japanese gate in front of Shintō shrines.
29 There is no temple by this name, but it might be referring to Engakuji 円覚寺.
30 The Dai Butsu 大仏 is the giant bronze statue of Buddha, Kamakura's most iconic attraction.
31 The last word here cannot be seen properly.
32 The Kannon Hall 観音堂 in the Hasedera Temple 長谷寺.
33 The Kai-hin 海浜 Hotel was one of the top hotels at the time in Kamakura, it is often seen on contemporary postcards.
34 A collection of 14 'Famous-place' postcards of the views at Enoshima and Kamakura, *LHAS Supplement*, p. 167, Stein Photo 44/4/14.
35 Heinrich Lüders (1869–1943), German Indologist, who also worked on Sanskrit and Turkish texts from Central Asia.
36 Harriet Stein (Henriette Rosalie Hein) (1854–1934), Stein's sister-in-law and long-time correspondent.
37 Paul Joseph Sachs (1878–1965), Associate Director of the Fogg Art Museum at Harvard University, who, together with Langdon Warner (1881–1955), persuaded Stein to make a Fourth Expedition to Xinjiang; see Brysac, op. cit.
38 Sagurichō is obviously the Sakuragichō Station 桜木町駅 in Yokohama.
39 Taki Seiichi 瀧精一.
40 Zōjōji 増上寺 is a Buddhist temple where several of the Tokugawa shōguns are buried. The Stein Collection at the LHAS has two different a set of eight colour postcards of the Shōgun's Mausoleum 東京芝増上寺. *LHAS Supplement*, p. 167, Stein Photo 44/4/14.
41 The Okura Shūkokan Museum 大倉集古館 founded by Okura Kihachirō 大倉喜八郎.
42 Demiéville's daughter was only a year old at this time. Today she is Mme Jeanne-Marie Allier, Librarian at the Société Asiatique. In the summer of 2011 I had a chance to talk to her in person about this small memento of her early childhood in Stein's diary and she was pleasantly surprised to learn about it.
43 Katō Shigeshi 加藤繁.
44 These are the Han dynasty earth mounds (dojō 土城) at Rakrang 楽浪 (pronounced Rakurō in Japanese) in central P'yŏngyang. The Stein Collection at the LHAS includes an envelope with 9 postcards which must have been received during this visit. An inscription on the envelope, in Stein's writing, says, 'With compliments: Rakurō, Heijō Library (near Rakuro), Corea.' The postcards, however, show photos of Chinese bronzes, not lacquerware. *LHAS Supplement*, p. 167, Stein Photo 44/4/15.
45 L.M. is Stein's designation of a site near Loulan where he discovered old lacquerware.
46 *Kokka* 國華 was the leading Japanese journal of art history.
47 Marquis Hosokawa Moritatsu 細川護立 (1883–1970), whose family collection in 1950 became part of the Eisei Bunko Museum 永青文庫.
48 This is Michael I. Rostovtzeff's book *Inlaid Bronzes of the Han Dynasty in the Collection of C. T. Loo* (Paris/Brussels, 1927). At this time the author was a Professor of Ancient History at Yale University and Stein visited his home before coming to Japan. The Stein collection at the LHAS has a letter from Rostovtzeff to Stein, 16 Feb 1930 (*LHAS Catalogue*, p. 87, 8/fol. 270) in which he talks about his support for the excavations at Dura-Europos, which Stein had also visited in December 1929.
49 This is probably a reference to Henri Cordier's monumental work on the history of China: *Histoire générale de la Chine et de ses relations avec les pays étrangers, depuis les temps les plus anciens jusqu'à la chute de la dynastie Mandchoue*, Paris, 1920).
50 Hsingan is Xi'an 西安, commonly spelled in contemporary Western literature as Hsi-ngan.
51 Prince Ōyama Kashiwa 大山柏.
52 Marshal Ōyama Iwao 大山巌.
53 Anesaki Masaharu 姉崎正治.
54 Shiratori Kurakichi 白鳥庫吉.
55 This is most likely a misspelling of Sakurai Jōji, who was indeed the President of the Imperial Academy at the time of Stein's visit.
56 Unfortunately, the name of the person here is illegible.
57 The name Miyamito is obviously misspelled, it appears in the diary for the next day as Miyashito, neither of which are identifiable. Similarly, Inamad is also a misspelling, possibly of Inamura.
58 The Hōryūji Temple 法隆寺 is one of the major attractions in Nara. The LHAS has 8 Hōryūji postcards, showing the gates and courts of the temple compound. Included is one of Kondō. *LHAS Supplement*, p. 167, Stein Photo 44/4/14. There are also 8 postcards from the Asuka (Suiko) (552–644) period, with Buddhist sculptures, all of which are national treasures (uncatalogued memorabilia).
59 Kondō 金堂, as Stein correctly notes, is the main hall at Hōryūji.
60 Ch'ien-fo-tung, today spelled Qianfodong 千佛洞, refers to the Buddhist temple complex at the Mogao Caves 莫高窟 near the city of Dunhuang.
61 Kōfukuji 興福寺, a Buddhist temple and one of Nara's main sights.
62 Tōdaiji 東大寺, another Buddhist temple and important sight in Nara. Nandaimon 南大門 is its southern gate.
63 The Sangatsudō 三月堂, the oldest structure in the Tōdaiji complex.
64 Boxer Indemnity here refers to the scholarship program established for Chinese nationals to study in the United States using part of the indemnity demanded by the foreign powers following the defeat of the Boxer Rebellion 義和團 in 1901.
65 Probably an error for 'scrolls.'
66 Stein's notebook gives a list and short description of artefacts he saw at the museum. The Stein collection at the LHAS also has a small pamphlet titled Catalogue of Sculptures in the Nara Imperial Museum (published by the Museum, 1926) with Stein's pencil notes in it (uncatalogued memorabilia).
67 Mr. Kabuto is clearly Kubota Kanae 久保田鼎 (1855–1949), Director of the Nara Museum, who spoke excellent English and enjoyed personally guiding Western visitors through the museum.
68 Nippon Yūsen Kaisha 日本郵船会社, i.e. Japan Mail Shipping Line, one of the world's largest shipping companies. It operated passenger services from Japanese ports to a multitude of destinations, including Shanghai and Hong Kong. The Stein Collection at the LHAS includes a group of 5 postcards with Stein's pen writing on top: 'Nara, Nippon Y. K.' He may have bought these at this office. *LHAS Supplement*, p. 167, Stein Photo 44/4/14.
69 The Shōsōin 正倉院 is the treasure house at the Tōdaiji, housing artefacts related to Empreror Shōmu 聖武 (701–56) and his consort Empress Kōmyō 光明 (701–60).
70 The Fushimi-Momoyama Castle 伏見桃山陵 in southern Kyōto, where the Meiji Emperor is buried.
71 The Miyako Hotel 都ホテル is one of the top hotels in Kyōto in the Higashiyama district of the city. Today it is the Westin Miyako Hotel and still a common residence of visiting dignitaries (e.g. Queen Elizabeth II, Prince Charles and Princess Diana).
72 Haneda Tōru 羽田亨.
73 Umehara Sueji 梅原末治.
74 The Chion-in 知恩院 in Eastern Kyōto, the head temple of the Jōdo sect 淨土 of Buddhism. The LHAS includes a small brochure of the Chion-in, which must have been given to Stein on this occasion (uncatalogued memorabilia).
75 Enrst Leumann (1859–1931), Swiss Indologist who taught in Germany. His student is probably Wakai Shingen 若井信玄 who had indeed studied with Leumann in Freiburg.
76 Stein is talking about the Higashi Honganji 東本願寺 and Nishi Honganji 西本願寺 temples located not far from Kyōto Station. The former Abbot of the Nishi Honganji was Count Ōtani Kōzui 大谷光瑞 (1876–1948) who had organized and financed three ambitious expeditions to Central Asia during 1902–14. Stein probably met Ōtani when the Count visited London in 1900–1 and 1910, and after this the two of them corresponded sporadically (see I. Galambos, 'Otani Kozui's 1910 visit to London', *Heisei 19 nendo kotenseki dejitaru ākaibu kenkyū sentā kenkyū seika hōkokusho*

平成19年度古典籍デジタルアーカイブ研究センター研究成果報告書, Ryūkoku University, Kyōto, January 2008. (Available online at http://shahon.org/wp-content/uploads/2010/02/Otani-Kozuis-1910-visit-to-London.pdf.). By this time Ōtani had resigned from his position and was living in voluntary exile in Manchuria.

77 The Kōryūji Temple 広隆寺, supposed to have been founded by Emperor Shōtoku 聖徳太子 in the early 7th century.

78 Shinjō Shinzō 新城新蔵 (1873–1938), physicist and President of Kyōto Imperial University.

79 Kano Naoki 狩野直喜.

80 Naitō Konan 内藤湖南.

81 Sakaki Ryōzaburō 榊亮三郎 (1872–1946), Sanskritologist and Buddhist scholar.

82 Hamada Sōsaku 濱田耕作 (1881–1938), Japanese archaeologist, Professor at Kyōto Imperial University.

83 Ogawa Takuji 小川琢治 (1870–1941), geographer, Professor at Kyōto Imperial University.

84 Sándor Simonyi-Semadam.

85 This is the Piziwo 貔子窩 site in Dalian. The LHAS has photographs.

86 The LHAS has 24 postcards of Hieizan.

87 Yakushiji Temple 薬師寺, one of the most famous temples in Kyōto. The Stein Collection at the LHAS includes a small envelope with 9 photographs from Yakushiji and 2 from Tōshōdaiji. The photos are larger than usual postcards and have the temple's seal on the back. *LHAS Supplement*, p. 167, Stein Photo 44/4/14.

88 There is a four or five letter word here that I cannot decipher.

89 Tōindō 東院堂 is the eastern hall at the Yakushiji temple.

90 The Charkra Tirth Temple in Lucknow.

91 Tōshōdaiji 唐招提寺, a Buddhist temple in Nara, established by a Chinese monk recruited by Emperor Shōmu.

92 Kōmokuten 広目天 (Virupaksa), the Guardian of the West.

93 Chōshūden 朝集殿, waiting hall for officials in the imperial palace.

94 Sir Eric Teichman (1884–1944), Secretary at the British Legation, one of the people in China who helped Stein obtain the permit for his upcoming expedition.

95 This is the from the famous Kaiyuan harp 開元琴 in the Hōryūji collection, dating to 724. Thus Stein is mistaken about the date.

96 This may be a reference to the events connected with Gandhi's activities in the first months of 1930.

97 Kasuga jinja 春日神社, a Shinto shrine in Nara. Since 1946 it has been known as the Kasuga taisha 春日大社.

98 The Mausoleum of Emperor Kanmu 桓武天皇.

99 Nogi Maresuke 乃木希典 (1849–1912), a Japanese army general during the Russo-Japanese war of 1904–5. He was in charge of the successful, yet extremely costly in human life, attack on Port Arthur, which also made him famous in Europe.

100 Inouye Shūten 井上秀天.

101 Harry J. Griffith.

102 Zoltán Felvinczi Takács.

103 The name is missing here. She is presumably the person named 'Mrs. Sampson' (followed by a question mark) in the diary for the next day.

104 Prince Shōtoku.

105 Tamonten 多聞天.

106 Hōki bosatsu 法起菩薩.

107 I.e. the diary.

Rudolf Hoernle and Sir Aurel Stein

Ursula Sims-Williams

Curator, Iranian Collections, British Library

Much has been written about the Central Asian explorer and archaeologist Sir Aurel Stein, but his early collaborator Rudolf Hoernle is comparatively less well-known despite his key role in deciphering newly discovered Central Asian languages and managing the cataloguing and editing of all Stein's Brahmi script material until his death in 1918. In this paper I shall attempt to expand on the somewhat complex relationship between them, summarising Hoernle's work and drawing on some relatively unknown sources.[1]

Augustus Frederic Rudolf Hoernle[2] was born on 14 November 1841 in Secundra, India, the second of nine surviving children of the Reverend Christian Theophilus Hoernle. He came from a long line of missionaries which included both linguists and revolutionaries: his father translated the gospels into Kurdish and Urdu; his uncle Theodor Mögling had been a leading force in the 1848 Baden revolution in Germany. In the next generation, his son, Alfred (1880–1943), became a distinguished philosopher, while his nephew Edwin (1883–1952) had a successful political career in the German Democratic Republic as Minister for Agriculture and Forestry. At the age of seven Hoernle was sent home to his grandparents in Germany for his education. After completing theological studies in Schönthal and the University of Basle, he went to theological college in London in 1860, and, from 1864 to 1865, he studied Sanskrit at University College London with Theodor Goldstücker.[3]

Hoernle was ordained in 1864 and returned to India in 1865, where he was posted by the Church Missionary Society to Mirat. In 1869, he was transferred, at his own request, from active missionary service to work as Professor of Sanskrit and Philosophy at Jay Narayan College, Benares. It was there that he several times met and talked to Dayananda Sarasvati,[4] founder of the Arya Samaj movement, and his first publication was a report of Dayananda's public disputation in Benares in 1869.[5] From 1878 to 1881, Hoernle was Principal of the Cathedral Mission College, Calcutta, and, in 1881, he joined the Indian Educational Service as Principal of the Calcutta Madrasah. During these years he was engaged by the Government to inspect coins and archaeological finds in general, and was latterly put on Special Duty to report on the finds from Central Asia which subsequently became known as the British Collection of Central Asian Antiquities. In 1899 he retired to England at the age of 58 and settled in Oxford where he lived until his death after a short attack of influenza on 12 November 1918.

The formation of the British Collection of Central Asian Manuscripts, 1895–1900

Having been in India for several decades already, Hoernle had witnessed the growth of interest in Central Asia. The search for written antiquities began with the discovery of the so-called 'Bower' manuscript,[6] a 5th–century medical birch-bark manuscript in Sanskrit, found by treasure-seekers in 1889, in a stupa at Ming-oi, near Kucha. Its discovery was first announced to the scholarly world in 1891[7] and it was quickly recognised as by far the oldest Indian written book that was known to exist.[8] As a result the Russian Archaeological Society, in November 1891, sent a request to the Russian Consul General in Kashgar, N.F. Petrovsky,[9] to try to collect similar manuscript treasures. Encouraged by the

success of the Russians, in 1893 the Government of India, at Hoernle's suggestion, instructed its Political Agents in different parts of Central Asia to make enquiries and obtain whatever examples they could.[10]

Between 1859 and 1900, 23 consignments of antiquities were forwarded to Hoernle in Calcutta[11] by the British representatives in Kashgar and Kashmir: George Macartney,[12] Stuart Godfrey[13] and Adelbert Talbot.[14] The resulting 'British Collection' included manuscripts in Sanskrit (seven substantial Buddhist manuscripts), Khotanese (parts of six Buddhist manuscripts and 69 documents, Tocharian (17 leaves of a Tocharian medical manuscript), Uigur (24 documents), Persian (four documents) and Chinese (12 documents), in addition to what proved to be forged manuscripts and blockprints (45) in unrecognisable scripts.[15] It also included some 530 coins, 77 seals, terracottas and pottery. However, while the collection continued to grow, the circumstances of its acquisition by treasure-seekers remained obscure with very little information forthcoming on the exact location of archaeological sites.

Hoernle's earliest publications in 1891, on the Bower manuscript, and in 1893, on a collection of manuscripts which he had received from the Rev. F. Weber, Moravian missionary in Leh in Ladakh,[16] were limited to descriptions with photographs and preliminary transcriptions. The Weber collection included besides Sanskrit manuscripts, a manuscript in a previously unknown language (Tocharian). Hoernle could not identify the language, thinking at first it might be Mongolian, and later Turki in Brahmi script, but he was able to recognise the numerous Sanskrit medical terms it contained. In 1897 he provided transcriptions of manuscripts in another unknown language, which was later identified as Khotanese. This he also thought might be Turki, but he noticed however that several documents began with the Iranian word *sali* 'year,' and suggested that it might be a date.[17] Parallel to his work on unknown languages in known scripts, Hoernle devoted an immense amount of time trying to decipher material in unknown scripts. Although these were eventually proved to be forgeries, in 1899 Hoernle believed that the manuscripts, at least, were genuine and that while some of the blockprints might be modern, it was only in so far as they were copied from authentic originals.[18]

Stein and Hoernle 1887–1901

It was in October 1886, the year before Stein went to India, that, according to a letter to his brother Ernst, he first met Dr and Mrs Hoernle in Vienna at the 7th International Congress of Orientalists.[19] Stein read a paper on the Hindu Kush and the Pamir in early Iranian geography, while Hoernle exhibited and spoke on a mathematical birch-bark manuscript discovered at Bakhshali near Peshawar.[20] By 1890 Stein was working on an edition of the 12th-century chronicle of the kings of Kashmir, the *Rājatarañginī* by Kalhaṇa, and was in touch with Hoernle about the possibility of publication.[21] He commented on Hoernle's work on the Bower manuscript[22] and must have remained in contact with him during the next few years though his letters from this period have not survived.

While on a visit to Europe in 1897, Stein heard from his old teacher Georg Bühler[23] of the discovery in a cave near Khotan by Dutreuil de Rhins[24] of the Kharoṣṭhī *Dhammapada*, a birch-bark manuscript dating from the 1st century AD. Émile Senart's[25] paper on it at the 11th International Congress of Orientalists in Paris caused much discussion,[26] after which the Russian scholar Sergei Oldenburg[27] circulated a further fragment apparently from the same manuscript which had arrived at St. Petersburg through Petrovsky. The importance of this discovery, together with the recent acquisitions from Khotan, were, as Stein subsequently wrote, what determined him on his own expedition to Khotan. While in Europe Stein also discussed his idea with other scholars: G.Bühler, Prof. Armin Vámbéry[28] of Budapest, and Prof. L. Schroeder[29] of Vienna.

In May 1898, while in Kashmir, Stein consulted Captain S.H. Godfrey, Assistant Resident in Kashmir, on possible routes, transport arrangements, and expenses, &c. A few weeks later on 25th June he wrote asking for help and advice to Hoernle, who had been placed on special duty for reporting on Central Asian Antiquities. Hoernle was overjoyed at the idea. Ever since the first discoveries he had been trying to get accurate information about the find places and circumstances in which the manuscripts and artefacts had been found. All reports were unreliable second or third-hand accounts from treasure-seekers. 'I wish I could join you in the project,' he replied, but 'I fear I am now too old to meet the fatigues of such a journey'.[30] Hoernle recommended that Stein prepare a draft proposal and suggested the subsidies he should ask for from the Governments of Punjab and India. Stein replied on 17 July, enclosing a draft[31] and then heard from Hoernle one month later:[32]

> I have seen the Lt. Gov. of the Punjab. I showed and explained to him the antiquities from Khotan, and how desirable it was to explore the place by a European expert. I also told him that I supported that you should be deputed. He seemed to me very well disposed towards our project, and told me to make an application.

Stein submitted his proposal to the Lieutenant-Governor of the Punjab, Sir Mackworth Young,[33] requesting leave, and, on receiving a favourable reply,[34] he sent in a revised version for onward transmission to the Government of India on September 10th.[35]

At this point Hoernle intervened and wrote directly to T.W. Holderness,[36] Secretary to the Government of India, Revenue & Agriculture Dept., strongly backing Stein's application. Hoernle wrote of the close literary and artistic links between Khotan and India. He also mentioned his work on the bilingual Sino-Kharoṣṭhī coins issued by the Chinese administration of Khotan dating from the 1st century AD. An expedition, he felt, was needed to corroborate this and to fill in details. 'In the second place,' he wrote, 'there are a number of objects, mostly block-prints, the bonafides of which is not above suspicion. The truth of this matter can only be satisfactorily cleared up by an European explorer on the spot.' Most importantly, he concluded, Chinese Turkestan had become the focus of exploration, particularly by the Russians. A Russian commission was going to Turfan and Sven Hedin[37] was contemplating a second visit to Khotan. Since Khotan belonged to the British 'sphere of influence'

the Government of India should send an expedition there and get the credit for it.[38]

Whether it was due to Hoernle's influence or not, the application was approved far sooner than either Stein or Hoernle had anticipated. Hoernle received a favourable reply from Holderness on 30 December[39] Stein received official confirmation later in January.[40]

Throughout this period Stein and Hoernle were in constant communication. Hoernle had arranged for Stein to succeed him as Principal of the Calcutta Madrasah and there were many details to arrange, but he also helped Stein with contacts in the Survey Department, introductions to technical advisors in Calcutta, and offered to get extra subsidies from other societies – offers which Stein discouraged because he was reluctant to let his plans be generally known until they were well advanced! Hoernle also advised the Government of India, in response to an informal request, on the disposal of the finds of the projected expedition. He strongly recommended, and here he was in complete agreement with Stein, that the antiquities should be forwarded to him for examination as they were at present, to be ultimately deposited in the British Museum. Hoernle, however, went too far in his anxiety to be the first to examine the finds, writing 'I beg to submit that as I am the "intellectual father" of the project of the Khotanese expedition, I have a fair claim to be entrusted with the honour of first examining and reporting on its archaeological proceeds'.[41] By claiming to be the expedition's 'intellectual father', Hoernle caused a temporary rift with Stein who objected strongly,[42] although Hoernle excused himself explaining that the idea of an expedition to Khotan

> …had been present in my mind, before I had any communication from you at all. So, when I heard from you that you were contemplating the same idea, I was delighted, because it was just what I wanted to enable me to put my plan into execution. I could not go myself, and till I heard from you, I did not know, who could undertake it, except Mr. Macartney himself; but there were difficulties in his case.[43]

Hoernle's letters to Stein reveal an eager enthusiasm, especially in descriptions of his latest ideas. Stein spent Christmas with the Hoernles in Simla and had the opportunity to examine Hoernle's material firsthand. It was then that he rashly identified some forged manuscripts as containing Pahlavi words, as Hoernle recounted several months later after he had returned to England:

> I have been working at the Khotan manuscripts (not blockprints). Those two mss which you recognised as Pahlavi, I have submitted to Dr. E.W. West,[44] who is now examining them. He is disposed to agree with you. On July 18th (before having seen the mss) he wrote to me: "Dr. Aurel Stein's opinion I think you may rely upon, so far as it goes." On July 31st he wrote: "I have paid most attention to those mss already [i.e. by yourself] supposed to contain Pahlavi words [I had sent him the other mss also] in which no doubt several letters can be identified with the Sasanian Pahlavi characters on coins and gems…or half the Sassanian alphabet, and others less certain. …" To me it appears that this result is quite sufficient to prove that the script, and probably the language is Sassanian Pahlavi; though of course it is quite insufficient to identify the nature of the work or book. Don't you think so? What is your opinion? Dr. West has still got the two mss, and is continuing his examination and reading. By the way, if I remember rightly shāh was one of the words you identified; this adds one to Dr. West's list.[45]

Unfortunately Stein's reply has not been preserved but he was usually very reluctant to express his opinions on such matters, continually urging caution.

Several recently discovered letters from Heornle's private papers describe Stein's progress in Khotan during his First Expedition to Central Asia, in particular his exposure of the forged manuscripts and blockprints.[46] Stein first wrote to Hoernle from Yarkand on 22 and 24 September 1900. His letters do not survive, but according to Hoernle's register of Central Asian Correspondence,[47] they described a 'well-preserved stūpa in Kashgar.' After leaving Yarkand, Stein stopped on the way to Khotan at Guma, on 5 October, with a view to investigating the sites at which Islam Akhun and others had found the numerous manuscripts and blockprints that Hoernle had described in his articles of 1897 and 1899. Stein wrote again from Khotan on 12 November – another letter which does not survive – presumably reporting to Hoernle his lack of success. Hoernle, however, did not receive this letter until early in 1901, by which time he had already sent to press the second part of his Report, which included a section on the manuscripts in unidentified scripts.[48] Hoernle's reply of 25 February is unfortunately lost.

Stein wrote again from Dandan Uiliq on 3 January 1901 (letter missing) and on 11 March from Camp Bilangan, Keriya Darya. Here he went into some detail about his discoveries at Niya, in temperatures as low as -12°F, of 'hundreds of wooden tablets, together with the parchment documents, that turned up from among the ruined houses'. Beyond Endere River, he discovered an ancient fort:

> On excavating this I made a number of interesting MS. finds. Among these are several well-preserved Tibetan texts and a Buddhist Sanskrit MS. in Brāhmī char. of about the 3rd or 4th century and nearly complete. In addition documents in the non-Indian language, written with cursive "Central-Asian" characters and represented already in the Dandan Uiliq collection, have turned up there, as well as Chinese papers and sgraffitti. The sculptural work shows close resemblance to that discovered at D.U. and the fact that only paper MSS. were found is another point in common. After what I wrote to you in my last letter, you will not be surprised to hear that I failed to discover the slightest trace of any books or MSS "in unknown characters." Brāhmī, Kharoshṭhī, "Central Asian Brāhmī" texts on parchment, wood and paper have come to light in greater number than I could reasonably hope for. Tibetan and Chinese records also duly present themselves. Only the "unknown scripts" with which Kashgar and Ladakh were so liberally supplied for some years, seem now to have vanished. When returning to Khotan I shall endeavour to find out what has become of them, – and those who manufactured them.[49]

Hoernle's anxious reply of 15 May, the day after he received Stein's letter (as recorded in his Central Asian Register), is unfortunately lost.

Stein's final letter to Hoernle from his First Expedition was written at Kashgar on 25 May 1901. Thanking him for his letters of 19 December, 25 February and 27 March, which he had only just received, he wrote about his plans for the future, and his discovery of a large *vihāra*, reliefs, and

sculptures at Rawak, before recounting his eventual interview with Islam Akhun in Khotan on 25 April.[50]

> I cannot enter in detail into your remarks about the forged MSS. and prints with which Islam Akhun's factory supplied Kashgar, Ladakh and Kashmir since 1895. It would be too great a task to enumerate all the evidence which has accumulated as to these forgeries. I have the fullest data to show that whatever you and others got in the way of mss. etc from Khotan since 1895 came either through Turdi, an honest old fellow who "exploited" Dandan Uiliq, or through Islam Akhun. Turdi's finds, mostly scraps in Brahmi and Chinese, are genuine; whatever Islam Akhun supplied, is manufactured. The sites which he mentioned to Macartney and others as his findplaces, are either fictive localities or mere "Tatis," i.e. completely eroded sites of villages where the loess is covered by potsherds and similar hard débris but where the survival of paper is a physical impossibility.
>
> Practically everybody in Khotan knew of the manufacture carried on by Islam Akhun & Co., but as the Sahibs appreciated the products it was neither Badruddin Khan's nor anybody else's business to represent the facts. Islam Akhun who had suffered for forging on two occasions documents pretending to have been written by Capt. Deasy[51] and Macartney, kept out of my way in the autumn. But after my return I managed with the Amban's help to get hold of him. His examination proved a most useful and amusing affair. I shall be able to tell you soon details from his depositories. He made at last a clear breast of it, acknowledged (what everybody else among his friends knew) that he had never been beyond Aksipil, and told in detail how he commenced first to write and then to print his "old books". I have, of course, kept a full record of his statements as to his associates, the process and place of manufacture, etc. and obtained in natura such pièces corroboratives as have survived after the breaking up of the establishment. It had tried its hands also in making carved objects in wood and pottery "Būts". Macartney got and kept a most funny product of the latter class.
>
> Islam Akhun is a very clever rascal, with a good deal of humour and brains quite above the level of his compatriots. His memory as to the articles he supplied was surprising. When he was once on the road to a full confession, it was easy to see how well his avowals agreed with the stories he had told M. and which your Report reproduces. I appreciate brains even in a scoundrel, and I wonder whether I.A. is not too dangerous a fellow to let loose on an innocent Khotan.[52]

Hoernle replied on June 27th to Stein, care of H.S. King & Co, Pall Mall. It was possibly this letter that Stein referred to when he wrote to his brother Ernst on July 4th that Hoernle had accepted the undeniable and wanted to have his Report destroyed.[53] Several days later Stein wrote again to his brother from Hoernle's garden that Hoernle was understandably very disappointed but had got over it.[54] Hoernle had by now received the proofs of the second part of his Report and gave them to Stein on July 17th, together with a revised manuscript introduction. Stein's reply of July 22nd shows his desire for caution:

> As my own report is not yet written and as in my preliminary account it will scarcely be possible to deal in detail with what I may well call the negative results of my tour, it is doubly necessary that the statements as to forged and genuine pieces of the "British Collection" as far as they are made on my authority, should be precise and carefully considered. I am anxious mainly that nothing should be stated that I might subsequently on giving my own detailed account be obliged to modify or criticize.[55]

Stein and Hoernle 1901–18

The original Central Asian Collection was, by previous agreement, purchased by the British Museum for £125 and transferred there on 17 June 1902,[56] with a few items which the Museum did not require being presented to the University of Oxford, in the name of the Government of India.[57] From the end of the year, the Government of India again started to send consignments to Hoernle to report on. Between 1902 and 1918, 12 further collections were sent. These consignments, known collectively as the Hoernle Collection, were transferred to the India Office Library in 1918 and now form part of the British Library collections. They include over 4000 Sanskrit, 1298 Tocharian and 200 Khotanese manuscripts (many fragmentary). Additionally Hoernle was sent the manuscripts in Brahmi script from Stein's first and second expeditions, which he was responsible for cataloguing and dividing between the British Museum and the Government of India (as represented by the India Office Library, London, and the National Museum, Delhi).[58]

From 1903, the volume of material increased to the extent that Hoernle could no longer edit it all himself. As early as 1905, he arranged to bring out a series of volumes of facsimiles and transcriptions to be published by the Clarendon Press, the first of which, *Manuscript remains*,[59] was not published until 1916. To achieve this, Hoernle relied on a team of scholars who included F.W. Thomas,[60] L.D. Barnett,[61] H. Lüders,[62] S. Konow,[63] E. Leumann,[64] K. Watanabe,[65] and S. Lévi.[66] Hoernle did an initial sorting and listing of the fragments himself and then sent them to his collaborators for further study.

Hoernle's later correspondence with Stein, preserved in the Bodleian Library Oxford (1903–5) and the Library of the Hungarian Academy of Sciences in Budapest (1909–13), was largely concerned with the cataloguing and division between the British Museum and the India Office of the first and second expedition Brahmi manuscripts. Nevertheless Hoernle kept Stein uptodate on his own research, particularly his progress with the decipherment of Khotanese, besides including domestic details such as his son's holiday in the Isle of Skye or his daily reading aloud of Stein's newly published *Ruins of Desert Cathay* to his wife for an hour or two after tea 'while she does some domestic work'.[67]

Stein's debt to Hoernle

There is no doubt that Stein would eventually have got permission for his first expedition to Khotan in 1900, however Hoernle certainly made it much easier and quicker for him. As Stein wrote to his brother Ernst, when he wrote of his plan in February 1899, it was through Hoernle's intercession in Simla that the 'high-ups of the Indian Mt. Olympus', as he referred to them, first became interested in the project.[68]

The Government of India's approval of the finds being taken to England, was also probably due to Hoernle's intervention. Hoernle had become the official examiner of Central Asian antiquities and moreover was given permission to continue his work on the 'British Collection' after retirement in 1899 and report on it from England before transferring it to the British Museum.[69] The procedure once established, it was intended, Stein wrote, 'to deposit the

archaeological proceeds which my tour may furnish, in the British Museum, after arranging with Dr. Hoernle and, if necessary, with other experts for their detailed examination'.[70] The eventual disposal of the finds from Stein's subsequent expeditions was the cause of much dispute, but the precedent of the material coming first to England and being assigned to different scholars for evaluation was by then firmly established.

At a personal level Stein probably found Hoernle extremely irritating and frequently tried to dampen his enthusiam, nevertheless Stein valued his friendship and scholarship, regarding him as an indispensible collaborator. As he wrote to George Grierson[71] concerning the decipherment of Khotanese:

> You may have seen from the last number of the R.A.S. J. that Hoernle had the satisfaction of identifying complete versions of two known Sutra texts which will clear the way for a systematic decipherment. …With the key supplied by Hoernle's discovery, the task will not be so puzzling.[72]

On hearing of Hoernle's death in 1918 Stein wrote to Barnett:

> The news of poor Hoernle's death, reported by Reuter, has, as you need scarcely be told, touched me deeply. He had always been a most devoted and painstaking collaborator, and I had owed him much gratitude for his kind help even before I first started for Turkestan. How great his services to Indology were in different and extensive fields you know best. He will be very hard to replace with his indefatigable zeal and thoroughness. It is sad to think how much pain the last four years must have brought him. But at least he lived through it to see the hope of better times. He had richly earned final rest and peace.[73]

Notes

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1 This paper is based on a presentation given at 'A Hundred Years of Dunhuang, 1907–2007', 17–19 May 2007, organised jointly by the British Academy with the British Museum and British Library.
2 See U. Sims-Williams, 'Augustus Frederic Rudolf Hoernle', *Encyclopaedia Iranica* 12, New York, 2004, pp. 418–20.
3 Theodor H. Goldstücker, (1821–72), Indologist and Professor of Sanskrit at University College, London from 1852.
4 Dayananda Sarasvati (1824–83), Hindu religious scholar, reformer.
5 A.F.R. Hoernle, 'A Hindoo reformer', *The Christian intelligencer*, Calcutta (March 1870) p. 79: a report of Dayananda Sarasvati's public disputation in Benares in 1869.
6 Named after Lieutenant, later Major General Sir Hamilton Bower (1858–1940), who purchased it early in 1890. It is now in the Bodleian [MS. Sansk.c.17].
7 J. Waterhouse, 'Birch bark MS. from Kashgaria', *Proceedings of the Asiatic Society of Bengal* (November 1890 [1891]), pp. 221–3, with plate.
8 Hoernle, 'Remarks on birch bark ms', *Proceedings of the Asiatic Society of Bengal* (April 1891 [1892]), p. 64.
9 Nikolai Fedorovich Petrovskii (1837–1908), Russian Consul in Kashgar from 1882 until 1903.
10 Hoernle, 'A report on the British Collection of Antiquities from Central Asia, part I,' *Journal of the Asiatic Society of Bengal* 68/1 extra no. (1899), p. ii.
11 These were: unnumbered collection (sent Apr. 1895); G1 (Nov. 1895); M1 (Dec. 1896); M2 (Aug. 1897); G2 (1897); G3 (Oct. 1897); M3 (Nov. 1897); G4 (Nov. 1897); M4 (Nov. 1897): T1 (Dec. 1897); M5 (Dec. 1897); G5 (Jan. 1898); G6 (Jan. 1898): G7 (Feb. 1898): M6–8 (June 1898); G8 (July 1898); G9 (Aug. 1898); M9 (Oct. 1898); G10 (Nov. 1898); M10 (Nov. 1899); M11 (June 1900).
12 Sir George Macartney (1867–1945), Agent in Kashgar from 1890 to 1918, originally without any official standing, but subsequently Consul (1908) and then Consul-General (1910–18).
13 Lieutenant-Colonel Stuart Hill Godfrey (1861-1941), British Joint-Commissioner in Ladakh in 1895, and Assistant to the Resident in Kashmir between 1897 and 1899.
14 Lieutenant-Colonel Sir Adelbert Cecil Talbot (1885–1920), Resident in Kashmir 1896–1900.
15 See Sims-Williams, 'Forgeries from Chinese Turkestan in the British Library's Hoernle and Stein Collections', *Bulletin of the Asia Institute* 14 (2000 [2003]), pp. 111–29.
16 Hoernle, 'The Weber mss: another collection of ancient manuscripts from Central Asia', *Journal of the Asiatic Society of Bengal* 62/1 (1893), pp. 1–40.
17 Hoernle, 'Three further collections of ancient manuscripts from Central Asia,' *Journal of the Asiatic Society of Bengal* 66/1 (1897), pp. 213–60, p. 48.
18 Hoernle, 'A report on the British Collection of Antiquities from Central Asia, part I,' *Journal of the Asiatic Society of Bengal* 68/1 extra no. (1899), p. 63.
19 Aurel Stein to Ernst Stein, 21 December 1898 [British Academy Archive].
20 Hoernle, 'On the Bakhshālī manuscript', in *Verhandlungen des VII. Internationalen Oreintalisten–Congresses gehalten in Wien im Jahre 1886. Arische Section*, Wien, 1888, pp. 127–47, 3 plates. This manuscript is now in the Bodleian (MS. Sansk. d. 14).
21 Stein to Ernst, 8 April 1891 [British Academy Archive].
22 Stein, 'Kleine Mittheilungen', *Vienna Oriental Journal 5* (1891), pp. 343–5.
23 Johann Georg Bühler (1837–98), German Sanskritist and epigraphist, Professor at the Elphinstone College, Bombay and the University of Vienna.
24 Jules Léon Dutreuil de Rhins (1846–94), French geographer and explorer.
25 Émile Charles Marie Senart (1847–1928), French Indologist and epigraphist.
26 E. Senart, 'Le manuscrit Dutreuil de Rhins', in *Actes du Onzième Congrès International des Orientalistes. Paris, 1897. Première section: langues et archéologie des pays ariens*, Paris, 1899, pp. 1–7.
27 Sergei Fedorovitch Oldenburg (1863–1934), Russian Indologist, Professor at University of St. Petersburg and Director of the Asiatic Museum from 1916.
28 Ármin Vámbéry (1832–1913), Hungarian turkologist and explorer.
29 Leopold von Schroeder (1851–1920), Indologist and Professor at Universities of Innsbruck and Vienna.
30 Hoernle to Stein from Hotel Metropol Simla, 2 July 1898 [Bodleian: Ms Stein 85, ff. 86–87].
31 Stein's list of letters [Bodleian: Ms Stein 129]; also his draft proposal for an expedition to Khotan, 15 July 1898 [Bodleian: Ms Stein 289, ff. 1–14].
32 Hoernle to Stein, 17 August 1898 from Hotel Metropol Simla [Bodleian: Ms Stein 278, ff. 2–5].
33 Sir William Mackworth Young (1849–1924), administrator, Lieutenant-Governor of the Punjab, 1897–1902.
34 Secretary to Lieutenant Governor of the Punjab to Stein, 7 September 1898 [Bodleian: Ms 289, f. 35].
35 Stein to the Chief Secretary for the Government of the Punjab, 10 September 1898 [Bodleian: Ms Stein 289, ff. 15–34].
36 Sir Thomas William Holderness (1849–1924), administrator, Secretary to the Government of India, Revenue and Agricultural Department, 1898–1901.
37 Sven Anders Hedin (1865–1952), geographer and explorer who led four expeditions to Central Asia: 1893–7, 1899–1902, 1905–8 and 1927–35.
38 Hoernle to T.W. Holderness, 13 October 1878 from Farnham Lodge Simla (copy) [Bodleian: Ms Stein 289, ff. 36–40].
39 Sophie Hoernle to Stein, Saturday [December 31] 1898 [Bodleian: Ms Stein 278, ff. 56–7].
40 Stein to Hoernle, 22 Jan 1899 [Bodleian: Ms Stein 289, ff. 114–7].
41 Hoernle to Holderness, postmarked Lahore 26 March 1899 (copy) [Bodleian: Ms Stein 289, ff. 89–94].
42 Stein to Hoernle, 12 April 1899 from Lahore (draft) [Bodleian: Ms Stein 278, ff. 118–25]; also Stein to Holderness, 25 May 1900 from Srinagar [Bodleian: Ms Stein 289, ff. 146–52].

43 Hoernle to Stein, 17 May 1899 from 2 Montague St. London [Bodleian: Ms Stein 278, ff. 126–9].
44 Edward William West (1824–1905), Iranist and translator of Zoroastrian texts.
45 Hoernle to Stein, 3 August 1899 from 40 St. Giles, Oxford [Bodleian: Ms Stein 278, ff. 131–5].
46 British Library: IOR MSS Eur/F302/51. Thanks to Vic Swift of the International Dunhuang Database Project images of these letters can now be viewed with transcriptions (http://idp.bl.uk).
47 Stein's Register of Central Asian Correspondence [British Library: IOR MSS Eur/F302/13].
48 Hoernle, 'A report on the British Collection of Antiquities from Central Asia, part II,' *Journal of the Asiatic Society of Bengal* 70/1 extra no. 1 (1901 [1902]).
49 Stein to Hoernle, 11 March 1901 from Camp Bilangan, Keriya Darya [British Library: Mss Eur/F302/51, ff. 9–12].
50 Stein's interview with Islam Akhun is described in detail in his *Ancient Khotan: Detailed Report of Archaeological Explorations in Chinese Turkestan*, 2 vols, Oxford, 1907, pp. 507–14; also in his *Preliminary Report on a Journey of Archaeological and Topographical Exploration in Chinese Turkestan*, London, 1901, pp. 64–8.
51 Major Henry Hugh Peter Deasy (1866–1947), geographer, explorer and founder of the Deasy Motor Car Manufacturing Company. Deasy travelled in Central Asia and Tibet in 1888 and 1889.
52 Stein to Hoernle, 25 May 1901 from Kashgar [British Library: Mss Eur/F302/51, ff.13–18].
53 Stein to Ernst, 4 July 1901 from St. Ermin's Hotel London [British Academy Archive].
54 Stein to Ernst, 9 July 1901 from Oxford: 'Hier in Oxford fand ich freundlichen Empfang bei den Hoernles und natürlich besonderes Interesse an den mitgebrachten Specimens, etc. H. empfindet begreiflicherweise tief die durch Islam Akhun's Fälschungen bereitete Enttäuschung, hat sich aber zu meiner Befriedigung capacitiren lassen, und eine peinliche Discussion bleibt mir erspart' [British Academy Archive].
55 Stein to Hoernle, 22 July 1901 from Rose Cottage Chislehurst [British Library: Mss Eur/F302/51, ff.28–30]
56 List of Oriental Manuscripts, 1902–10 and Register of Oriental Manuscripts, 1887–1921 [British Library Archive].
57 Proceedings for September 1902 (R&A: Archaeology & Epigraphy) [British Library: IOR/P/6368].
58 Sims-Williams, 'The British Library Hoernle Collection, part 1', *British Library Sanskrit Fragments*, vol 2, Tokyo, 2009, pp. 1–24, pl.1–3. The collections were: two unnumbered (sent October 1902 and 1914?); H [Hoernle].142 (June or July 1903); H.143 (February 1904); H.144 (June 1904); H.147 (December 1905); H.148 (April 1906); H.149 (June 1907); H.150 (June 1907); H.151 (February 1908); H.152 (August 1908); and H.156 (June 1911).
59 Hoernle, *Manuscript Remains of Buddhist Literature found in Eastern Turkestan*, Oxford, 1916.
60 Frederick William Thomas (1867–1956), Indologist, Assistant Librarian, India Office Library 1898, Librarian 1903–27 and Boden Professor of Sanskrit in the University of Oxford, 1927–37.
61 Lionel David Barnett (1871–1960), Indologist, Assistant Keeper and Keeper of the Department of Oriental Printed Books and Manuscripts, British Museum 1899–1936, Professor of Sanskrit at University College, London, 1906–17, and Lecturer in Sanskrit at the School of Oriental Studies, London, 1917–48.
62 Heinrich Lüders (1869–1943), German Indologist at the Universities of Rostock, Kiel and Berlin.
63 Sten Konow (1867–1948), Norwegian Indologist, Government Epigraphist for the Archaeological Survey in India 1906-8, Professor at the Universities of Oslo and Hamburg.
64 Ernst Leumann (1859–1931), German Indologist and Iranist, Professor of Sanskrit in Strassbourg and Freiburg.
65 Kaikyoku Watanabe (1872–1933), Japanese Indologist and Buddhist scholar.
66 Sylvain Lévi (1863–1935), French Indologist, Lecturer at l'École des Hautes Études, Faculté des Lettres of the Sorbonne and Professor at Collège de France, Paris.
67 Hoernle to Stein, 27 March and 27 September 1912 from 8 Northmooor Rd. Oxford [Hungarian Academy of Sciences: Stein Correspondance Box 5, ff. 173–4 and ff.176–7].
68 Stein to Ernst, 2 Feb 1899 from Shah Bahlawal Lahore: 'Herren vom indischen Olymp' [British Academy Archive].
69 Proceedings for April 1899 (R&A: Archaeology & Epigraphy), nos. 3&4: Employment of Dr Hoernle in England in editing archaeological reports [British Library: IOR/P/5670].
70 Stein to Government of Bengal, 8 Aug 1900, printed in Proceedings for January 1901 (R&A: Archaeology & Epigraphy) [British Library: IOR/P/6138].
71 Sir George Abraham Grierson (1851–1941), administrator and philologist, superintendent and compiler of the Linguistic Survey of India.
72 Stein to George Grierson, 31 July 1910 from Merton College Oxford [British Library: Grierson collection IOR MSS Eur/E233/323, ff. 43–44].
73 Stein to L.D. Barnett, 11 December 1918 from Srinagar [British Library: Or.13144, ff.107–15].

Sir Aurel Stein's Calcutta Connection

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This paper seeks to revisit holistically Sir Aurel Stein's brief but important sojourn in Calcutta from 1899 to 1900. Though bits and pieces of information regarding his stay and activities in and around Calcutta are recorded in some of the works related to Stein and his life, there is no comprehensive account of his Calcutta connection as yet, hence this modest attempt.

It was Stein's grounding in Indian languages and palaeography under Georg Buhler that kindled his interest in India. When Stein came to India in 1887 he was appointed to the twin posts of Principal, Oriental College Lahore and Registrar of the Punjab University. During his tenure he undertook archaeological tours and made a thorough study of the topography of Kashmir. As far as the post in Lahore was concerned, Stein's second five-year term was supposed to end in February 1898. He had communicated to his brother Ernst as early as Oct 1895 that he would like to return to Europe in 1898, but this never happened, probably owing to the lack of an appropriate academic position. In 1899 he moved instead to Calcutta, where he was appointed the Principal of the Madrasa College.

The Madrasa College was established in 1781 by Warren Hastings, Governor General of India, to cater to future generations of Muslim gentry who could serve the British government in the departments of revenue administration and the judiciary. The focus at the College, however, remained on the study of the Arabic and Persian languages and Muslim Law. Those who followed the regular curriculum and attained certificates from the college were posted in the Fauzdari Courts as and when vacancies appeared. However, by the time Stein joined the college, many new subjects had been added to the curriculum, such as arithmetic, algebra, geometry, astronomy, Islamic theology, oriental studies, natural philosophy, geological studies, law, logic, rhetoric, grammar and oratory. A medical class, introduced in 1826, continued here till the establishment of Calcutta Medical College in 1836, after which the students of the Madrasa were allowed to study medicine at Calcutta Medical College. This speaks for the high standard of education at the Madrasa in those days and explains why Stein had accepted this appointment.

On 27 December 1898 Stein wrote from Simla,

> I received a letter written by the Lt. Governor of Bengal to Dr. Hoernle offering me a job at Calcutta. Its conditions are as follows: I will be taken into the Indian Educational Service as the principal of the Calcutta Madresa with a salary of 800 rupees per month… Further advancement up to 1500 per month will depend on vacancies in the department. In addition I will have free quarters in the Principal's house- this represents an additional 250 rupees; also a part of the servants, garden and lighting are free. The main fact is that the job has a pension and is a more satisfactory type of work – no teaching, only administration. Dr. H[oernle] has been on 'deputation' several times for scholarly work and thus has established precedents for me. Also it has almost a four-month vacation as against two and half at Lahore… The best thing for me is to accept the job. Dr. H thinks I can get along on half my salary.[1]

It appears from Stein's attitude that he preferred administration to teaching. The prospect of being close to the Hoernles was an added attraction, as is reflected in one of

Stein's letters where he mentions that:

> He [Hoernle] would like me as his successor at the Madrasa in Calcutta. Mrs. Hoernle reminded me that we had met at the 1886 Vienna Oriental Congress and she had not forgotten me…[2]

It has been noted that Stein's appointment to this post in Calcutta was, 'in some respects uncongenial'.[3] Stein himself, in one of his letters to his brother Ernst, regretted his decision of coming to Calcutta, 'I must blame myself for having pushed the Calcutta position without first having acquainted myself with the climate and living conditions'.[4] Stein arrived in Calcutta to assume the principalship of the Calcutta Madrasa on 6 May 1899. Unfortunately, this was not an ideal time for a European to arrive in Calcutta for the first time. The grueling Calcutta summer immediately took a toll upon him and he wrote on 9 May 1899:

> This is the worst season in Calcutta and this year especially bad: such conditions have not been experienced here for a long time – 104 degrees in the shade. Thus I am only too glad to escape this steam bath tomorrow night.

In summer the Governor and the government moved to Darjeeling, a hill station in Bengal. On 14 May 1899, eight days after his arrival, Stein also headed for Darjeeling. From there he wrote a letter to his brother Ernst updating him about his whereabouts. One of his letters indicates that apart from escaping the heat of Calcutta he also intended to acquaint himself with the higher government officials of Bengal to achieve his final goal of securing a one year deputation to Khotan. To satisfy this ambition had been a motivating factor in moving to Calcutta.

Stein's letters to his brother Ernest and his sister-in-law Harriette (also known as Hetty and Jetty), and these letters help us to understand his persona better. The family correspondence is now preserved in the British Academy, having been initially collected together by Aurel Stein's niece, Dr Therese Stein, who handed them to the British Academy in November 1966. From a total of four boxes of correspondence,[5] there are several that Stein during his time in Calcutta: to his brother Ernst (from Calcutta, 1899 and 1900; and Darjeeling, 1899), and to his sister-in-law Harriette (addressed at Hetty, 1900; and as Harriet, 1909).

Stein's letter to Ernst, sent from Darjeeling on 22 May 1899 reveals that he was elated to receive a warm welcome from John Woodburn who had also shown great interest in his Khotan trip and had the previous day (21 May) approved Stein's deputation for one year from the end of summer vacation in 1900. It had taken Stein only 16 days since arriving in Calcutta to get this approval – no wonder the elation! Stein immediately set about planning his vacation which he intended to spend in Kashmir preparing for his expedition to Khotan. It was all the more heartening for Stein that the Central Government, along with the Governments of Punjab and Bengal, would liberally fund the expenses of the expedition which amounted to a huge sum of 14000/- rupees. This sum was equivalent to Stein's salary and expenses for over thirteen months (which Stein would also continue to receive while on deputation).

Six days later, on 28 May, Stein travelled from Darjeeling to Sikkim, where he stayed in the Sandakphu Bungalow, and came back to Calcutta on 13 July 1899. After returning he received the sad news from Lahore that his best Indian friend Pandit Govind Kaul, who had been his co-worker since 1888, was no more. This news came as a major set back to Stein who on many occasions would mention the loss by the early demise of this pandit for whose scholarship he had great respect.

During his stay in Calcutta Stein engaged himself in publications and archaeological tours. Not only was Calcutta the administrative base of the British government, his appointment in the Madrasa College was in one of the oldest centres of higher learning and culture. Many eminent scholars were associated with the Madrasa, and Stein would have recognized it as the prestigious institution it was. Furthermore, Calcutta in those days was a hub of Oriental studies, centred around the Asiatic Society of Bengal, founded by William Jones in 1784.[6] Stein's predecessor at the Calcutta Madrasa was A.F.R. Hoernle, with whom he had exchanged views on Central Asian manuscripts. Hoernle was at the heart of Central Asian antiquities, and in one of his presentations at the Asiatic Society he had pleaded for scientific archaeological expeditions in Central Asia which would independently investigate the sand buried sites near Khotan. Stein had corresponded with Hoernle about such an expedition as early as June 1898 and in May 1900, he was ready to set out for Khotan.

However keen Stein was to make his archaeological expedition to Khotan, the affairs at the Calcutta Madrasa never slipped from his mind. He wanted to justify his appointment to the post of Principal, and this is reflected in one of his letters, 'last but no the least, to get the Madrasa straightened out and thus prove my usefulness to the Gentlemen'.

Stein was also busy working on his unfinished work on the *Rajatarangini* and on making his travel preparations. While in Calcutta, Stein looked for opportunities to do archaeological reconnaissance in and around West Bengal. His attention was drawn towards South Bihar and Hazaribagh which abounded in rich archaeological sites.[7] The fact that these sites were mentioned in detail by the Chinese pilgrims also attracted him. He took a four day break and set out on this tour on 20 July 1899. Archaeologically, the tour was more than satisfactory and in addition to this he received a warm welcome from an officer of the revenue department, Mr. Oldham, in his bungalow.

It is interesting that Stein wanted to utilize his vacations as a 'tour on duty'. This provided with a per diem allowance and an opportunity to stay away from Calcutta to stay physically fit and to devote himself to archaeology. Thus, in September, 1899, he received permission from the then Government of Bengal to embark on a short archaeological tour through portions of the Patna, Gaya and Hazaribagh districts. His main object was to acquaint himself with the important sites of 'old Magadha' and in his own words, 'to test by their examination the materials available for the study of its ancient topography'.

Since these areas had already been surveyed by Cunningham and Beglar, the Government initiative to support this tour financially probably came on the grounds that Stein would survey certain remains in Hazaribagh which

had not been surveyed earlier and would prepare a detailed report for the government. Stein's proposal for this tour was approved by the Lieutenant Governor of Bengal, Sir John Woodburn, who also made arrangements in such a way that the local government would bear the travelling expenses and provide him with a sub-Overseer from the Public Works Department. Stein must have made quite an impression on Woodburn, for he had already approved Stein's deputation to Khotan in May. In his tours Stein aimed at focusing only on those factors that had a direct connection with ancient topography and on those objects which were left unnoticed by Cunningham and others.

Stein commenced his tour on 9 October 1899, setting out from Nawadah. It was a convenient starting point for visiting the localities along and between the Rajgir chain of hills, and remains to this day an interesting archaeological site. From Stein's descriptions of the tour it appears that he was sometimes skeptical of General Cunningham's identification of certain sites. There was some confusion regarding the alleged site of the Sattapanna Cave and Stein seems to question Beglar's view too, writing,

> His [Beglar's] words leave us in some doubt as to the value which he would still have us attach to his own discovery of the 'Seven leaved' cave.

Stein seems to have relied much more on the writings by the Chinese pilgrims, whom he fondly calls 'our Chinese guides'. In retrospect, it would seem that Stein was probably keen to test the accuracy and effectiveness of the Chinese pilgrims' records, in preparation for his expedition to Khotan.

Reading the notes that Stein made during this tour one gets an impression that he was often not agreeable to Cunningham's identification, for example, arguing that Xuan Zang's Kukkutapadagiri was not Kurkihar, but Shobhnath Hill. It appears from Stein's notes that he also kept a keen eye on the sacred sites of the region. Thus he could make good use of his personal inspection of the sites in and around Rajgir, clarify his misgivings regarding identifications with the keen eye of a topographer and venture forth in writing the ancient topography of Magadha. After returning from the sites, he duly wrote a report, which was published in the *Indian Antiquary* in 1901.

While writing about his Gaya trip Stein mentioned that he liked the ambience at the bungalow of Mr. Oldham: 'in his hospitable bungalow I found the Indian atmosphere and way of life which I love. I am surrounded by the quiet and space of a compound'. This contrasts sharply with his dissatisfaction with life in Calcutta, which he found too imposing and too European to his taste. Stein was an admirer of the Indian way of life and found life in Calcutta in the areas where the Europeans worked and lived, was 'less Indian' or 'too European'.

Eventually the vacations were approaching. Stein had planned his Khotan tour in such a way that it immediately followed the vacations. This gave him an extra two months which he spent in Kashmir before leaving for Central Asia. He was relieved to leave Calcutta and a letter to Ernst shows how elated he was about the Central Asian Expedition:

> It is now clear to me how grateful that the Khotan expedition gives me a chance to escape Calcutta and everything connected with it reasonably soon with an advantage. By the fall of 1901 my prospects will probably have clarified themselves.

Stein's publications in Calcutta

Although Stein did not care for life in Calcutta and was keen to leave, his time there was productive, as the following publications – all from Calcutta – demonstrate. In the 1890s, he published a number of articles in the *Journal of the Asiatic Society of Bengal*: 'Notes on the ancient topography of the Pir Pantsal Route' (1895); 'Notes on new inscriptions discovered by Major Deane' (1898) and 'Memoir on maps illustrating the ancient geography of Kashmir' (1899).[8] These early articles show a commitment to historical geography and to the prompt publication of his findings. In his later life Stein continued to publish in the *JASB*, for example, 'Notes on the life and labours of Captain Anthony Troyer' (1940, 1941).[9] As an administrative and educational centre, Calcutta was also a publishing city and the location of the Government of India Central Publication Branch. This organization published several works by Stein in its series entitled Memoirs of the Archaeological Survey of India, for example: 'An archaeological tour in Upper Swat and Adjacent hill tracts' (1930); and 'An archaeological tour in Gedrosia' (1931).[10]

During his brief stay in Calcutta Stein engaged continuously with the Asiatic Society of Bengal, giving papers, sharing his knowledge and publishing his work with the Society. A few examples of such engagements are discussed below. In 1899, at a meeting of the Asiatic Society, Stein presented a paper on his maps illustrating the Ancient Geography of Kashmir, together with printed copies of his *Memoir* on these maps. The *Memoir* was published as an extra number of Part I of the Society's *Journal* for 1899. Owing to its length (223 pages) Stein restricted himself to reading extracts from several chapters of this *Memoir*. In these extracts he described the methods according to which the maps had been prepared at the Survey of India offices. Stein was passionate about maps and did not leave any stone unturned to arrange finances for making these maps with precision. He used his personal charm and contacts and usually succeeded in convincing the authorities of the benefits of doing as he suggested. For example, in 1935 the Secretary of the Royal Geographical Society remarked on a meeting, at which a request by Stein had been approved and the Society had ended up paying for some cartography, 'As usual I found that in spite of my best efforts I had been defeated by Stein. It is also a measure of his charisma that during this process he made no enemies and although some spoke of him in weary despair, there is astonishingly little criticism'.[11] He then indicated the character and critical value of the materials for the study of the ancient topography of Kashmir which were available in foreign records (Chinese itineraries; Alberuni) and still more abundantly in Kalhana's *Rajatarangini* (Chronicle of the Kings of Kashmir); the later Sanskrit chronicles of Kashmir; the Mahatmyas of Kashmirian Tirthas and other indigenous texts. The accuracy and richness of the data furnished by Kalhana's *Rajatarangini* was specially characterized. Stein, in conclusion, had illustrated the results he had derived from the study of these historical

materials and his topographical researches in Kashmir, giving an account of the ancient localities identified along the Pir Pantsal route and of the local traditions associated with them. On this occasion he especially recorded his gratitude to the Asiatic Society whose liberal help had enabled him to bring out maps which besides serving the purpose of the present *Memoir* would be particularly useful as illustrations for his annotated translation of Kalhana's *Chronicle* which was at press, with Messrs Constable & Co., London.

Stein's *Memoir on maps illustrating the ancient geography of Kashmir*, which was accompanied by 2 maps issued in separate covers, was published by the Asiatic Society, and printed, like the Society's *Journal*, by the Baptist Mission Press in Calcutta.[12] Stein's communications in this regard are quite illuminating. The letters that Stein exchanged with the Baptist Mission Press provide a detailed account of the finances involved in the printing of the text and map covers. These letters are preserved in the Bodleian Library, Oxford, and a summary of them is given below (Appendix A).

On another occasion Stein exhibited an old manuscript of certain Parvans of the *Mahabharata*, written in Sarada characters, which he had purchased in Kashmir. He drew attention to the special interest attaching to the codex owing to the additional entries made in it by an old glossator; already known from the codex archetypes of Kalhana's *Rajatarangini* and designated as A2 in Stein's edition of the latter text. A curious Sanskrit deed of sale referring to this Mahabharata MS and recorded on one of its fly leaves by the hand of A2, makes it now possible to ascertain exactly the time and person of this learned glossator whose notes and readings are of great value for the critical study of the Kashmir *Chronicle*.

Stein collections in the Indian Museum, Calcutta

Stein left Calcutta in 1900 but his connection with the city is kept alive with objects from his three Central Asian Expeditions, which are now in the Indian Museum, Calcutta.[13] The process in which the decision regarding these objects being sent to the Indian Museum was taken is also quite interesting. It distributed among the British Museum. the Calcutta Museum and the Lahore Museum.[14] The plan was for the Kharoshthi and Chinese documents to stay in London for study, decipherment and publication, and then be sent to India. The Government of India recommended A.F.R. Hoernle as its representative in determining, in consultation with the BM, the distribution of other objects.[15]

All archaeological materials from the Stein's first three Central Asian expeditions were first sent to London for distribution within the British Museum (including what is now the British Library) with some portion to be made over to the Government of India. The later materials were divided among the National Museum, in (New) Delhi; the India Office Library; the Lahore Museum and the Calcutta (Indian) Museum. The National Museum artefacts included three dimensional materials, wall paintings and some graphic works. The India Office Library was to receive the textual materials mainly in Sanskrit and Tibetan. A smaller part of the collection was to be distributed between the Lahore Art Museum and Indian Museum in Calcutta. The objects that came to the Indian Museum collection, Calcutta, are listed below (Appendix B).

Acknowledgements

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Notes

1 Letter from Stein to a family member, dated 27th December 1898, quoted in Jeannette Mirsky, *Sir Aurel Stein. Archaeological Explorer*, University of Chicago Press, Chicago and London, 1998, pp. 84–85 (first edition, 1977).

2 Letter from Stein to a family member, December 1897, quoted in Mirsky, *op. cit.*, p.84

3 Obituary by C.E.A.W. Oldham, in *Proceedings of the British Academy*, reproduced in Wang and Perkins: *Handbook to the Collections of Sir Aurel Stein in the UK*, British Museum Research Publication 129, 2008, p. 41, http://www.britishmuseum.org/research/research_publications_online/handbook_stein_collection.aspx

4 Letter from Stein to his brother, Ernst, quoted in Mirsky, *op. cit.*, p. 96.

5 Helen Wang and John Perkins, *Handbook*, pp. 54-97.

6 For details of the Society see http://asiaticsocietycal.

7 M.A. Stein, 'Notes on an Archaeological Tour in South Bihar and Hazaribagh', *Indian Antiquary*, 1901.

8 M.A. Stein, 'Notes on the ancient topography of the Pir Pantsal Route', *Journal of the Asiatic Society of Bengal*, vol. 64, Part 1 (1895), pp. 376–86 [Read February 1896]; 'Notes on new inscriptions discovered by Major Deane', *Journal of the Asiatic Society of Bengal*, vol. 67, Part I (1898), pp. 1–19, 7 plates; 'Memoir on maps illustrating the ancient geography of Kashmir', *Journal of the Asiatic Society of Bengal*, vol. 68, Part I, Extra Number 2 (1899), pp. 1–232, 2 maps issued in separate covers.

9 M.A. Stein, 'Notes on the life and labours of Captain Anthony Troyer', *Journal of the Royal Asiatic Society of Bengal*, letters, vol. 6 (1940), 45-59; 'Notes on the life and labours of Captain Anthony Troyer', *Year Book, Royal Asiatic Society of Bengal* (for 1940) Vol. 7 (1941), pp. 184–85.

10 'An archaeological tour in Upper Swat and Adjacent hill tracts', Memoirs of the Archaeological Survey of India no. 42, Calcutta; Government of India Central Publication Branch, 1930; and 'An archaeological tour in Gedrosia', Memoirs of the Archaeological Survey of India No. 43, Calcutta, Government of India Central Publication Branch, 1931.

11 Ref needed.

12 The Baptist Mission Press, Calcutta, was founded in 1818. For further details and photographs see http://www.wmcarey.edu/carey/baptmisspress/bmp.htm .

13 Anusua Sengupta (Das), 'A Note on the Stein Collection of Central Asian Objects in the Indian Museum' in S.S. Biswas et al. (eds), *Essence of Art and Culture (in memory of Professor Kalyan Kumar Ganguli)*, Delhi, 2002, pp. 283-84.Anusua Sengupta (Das), 'Central Asian Objects in the Collection of Indian Museum', *Indian Museum Bulletin*, vol. 39 (2004), pp. 145-200 (edited by S.K. Basu).

14 Helen Wang, 'Catalogue of the Sir Aurel Stein Papers in the British Museum Central Archives', *Sir Aurel Stein. Proceedings of the British Museum Study Day, 23 March, 2002*, 2004, p. 37-62. Wang, 2002, 39. See letter from Secretary of State for India in Council.

15 (CE32/23/5 A.Godley (India Office) to E.M. Thompson (Director, BM), 24 July 1907).

Appendix A

Stein's communication with Baptist Mission Press, Calcutta

From the Stein archives housed at the Bodleian Library, Oxford. The correspondence is between Aurel Stein, who writes from the Museum of Central Asian Antiquities, Raisina, Delhi, and staff at the Baptist Mission Press, 41 Lower Circular Road, Calcutta. The Baptist Mission Press staff named in the letters are: Rev. J.W. Thomas, Superintendent, BMP (letters dated 1899), J.W. Turner, BMP (letters dated 1900) and Percy Knight, Superintendent, BMP (letters dated 1926). The letters are summarised below in archive number order.

MS Stein 64/221-2
From A. Stein, Delhi, to The Manager, The Baptist Mission Press, Calcutta, 22 Jan 1926 – Carbon copy of letter requesting an approximate cost of printing a Sanskrit text of special interest for the history of Kashmir.

MS Stein 64/223
Letter from Percy Knight, The Baptist Mission Press, Calcutta, to A. Stein, Museum of Central Asian Antiquities, Raisini, Delhi, 25 Jan 1926 – requesting more information.

MS Stein 64/224
Letter from Sir Aurel Stein, KCIE, FBA, PhD, DSc, DLitt, Indian Archaeological Survey on special duty, Museum of Central Asian Antiquities, Raisina, Delhi, to The Superintendent, The Baptist Mission Press, Calcutta, 28 Jan 1926 – Carbon copy of letter, enclosing eight pages of the text and commentary so far.

MS Stein 64/225
Letter from Percy Knight, The Baptist Mission Press, Calcutta, to Sir Aurel Stein, KCIE, FBA, PhD, DSc, Dlitt, Museum of Central Asian Antiquities, Delhi, prob. 4 Feb 1926 – encloses estimate for printing, specimens of paper and specimens of type. Can only give a per page rate as he cannot predict the full number of pages without seeing the MS.

MS Stein 64/226
Estimate sent from Baptist Mission Press, Calcutta, to Sir Aurel Stein, KCIE, FBA, PhD, DSc, Dlitt, Museum of Central Asian Antiquities, Delhi, 4 Feb 1926 – estimate for printing 500 copies of 'History of Kashmir' in Sanskrit.

MS Stein 64/227
Piece of paper with handwriting in ink: "Photographic plates came from collection on 14-1-26".
Reckoning of prices handwritten in pencil.andwriting in pencil.

MS Stein 64/228
Handwriting in pencil: jottings working out prices and numbers

MS Stein 64/229-234
Sample pages of printed Sanskrit, with stamp of Baptist Mission Press, Calcutta.

MS Stein 394/34-35
From J.W. Thomas, Baptist Mission Press, Calcutta, to Dr M.A. Stein, 31 May 1899 – mostly concerning the covers for maps.

MS Stein 394/36
Letter from J.W. Thomas, Baptist Mission Press, Calcutta, to Dr M.A. Stein, 2 June 1899 – about the covers for maps.

MS Stein 423/16
From Rev. J.W. Thomas, Superintendent, Baptist Mission Press, Calcutta, to Dr M.A. Stein, 18 Oct 1900.

MS Stein 423/17
Printed invoice from the Baptist Mission Press, Calcutta, 18 Oct 1900 – for 6 copies of Stein's "Memoir on Maps illustrating the Ancient Geography of Kashmir", 84 copies of complimentary slips, postage and packing (incl. of 36 copies sent on 11 Oct 1900).

MS Stein 423/18
Printed invoice from the Baptist Mission Press, Calcutta , 6 Nov 1900 = for postage & packing of a copy of his Memoirs on Ancient Kashmir with maps paper bound sent to Dr Hoernle, England under a registered order.

MS Stein 423/19
Headed paper as per MS Stein 423/16, addressed to Dr. M.A. Stein, Kashgar, 6 Nov 1900 – checking that Stein received letter of 20 Oct. (faded, barely legible)

MS Stein 423/20
Headed paper as per MS Stein 423/16, from J.W. Turner, to Dr. M.A. Stein, Kashgar, 13 Mar 1901. (faded, barely legible)

MS Stein 423/21
Headed paper as per MS Stein 423/16, from J.W. Turner, to Dr. M.A. Stein, Kashgar, 10t Jan 1900.

MS Stein 423/22
Invoice from F.W. Thomas, the Baptist Mission Press, Calcutta, 9 May 1901 – for 1 specially bound copy of Memoir on Maps illustrating the ancient geography of Kashmir, postage and packing for copy sent to Dr Hillebrants, postage and packing of 4 copies sent to addresses in Stein's letter dated 28 Feb 1901.

MS Stein 423/26-27
These are both similar to the previous invoices.

Appendix B

List of objects in the Stein Collection at the Indian Museum, Calcutta

Acquisitions in the Stein Collection at the Indian Museum were collected by Stein during his three expeditions in Central Asia. They arrived in three phases: in 1912, in 1916 and in 1919. The Indian Museum received the 1912 collection from the Government of Bengal. The 1916 and the 1919 collections came from the Director General of Archaeology and these objects were on permanent loan. The following list has been compiled to show the objects in the collection. Arranged by site (in alphabetical order according to site), it gives the Museum no. for each object, a brief description, its material and its dimensions. At the end of the list are added a few objects whose provenance is not known but whose features resemble the Central Asian style, hence we have added these to this list. A similar list was published in the Indian Museum Bulletin by one of the authors (Anusua Sengupta: 2004: 145–200).

SL. no.	Acc. No.	Object	Site	Material	Measurements
1	N.S. 1674/A 14056	Relief fragment: fore-arm of a Buddha	Ak-sipil	Stucco	4.5 x 4cm
2	N.S. 1675/A 13885	Relief fragment: drapery of a human figure	Ak-sipil	Stucco	6.5 x 3.5cm
3	N.S. 1801/A 13804	Grotesque monkey	Ak-sipil	Terracotta	4.5cm in ht.
4	N.S. 1832/A 13828	Grotesque human head	Ak-sipil	Terracotta	4 x 3.5cm
5	N.S. 1833/A 13807	Grotesque human head	Ak-sipil	Terracotta	5 x 4.5cm
6	N.S. 1939/A 19417	Fragments of finger ring broken into four pieces	Ak Taz	Bronze	1.78cm long (largest)
7	N.S. 2510/A 13596	Lump of terracotta	Central Asia	Baked clay	11 x 8cm
8	N.S. 3626/A 18163	Relief fragment: seated Buddha (broken)	Central Asia	Baked clay	10.15 x 11.9cm
9	N.S. 3632/A 18164	Sculpted fragment: palm of a Buddha figure	Central Asia	Baked clay	8.63 x 3.79cm
10	N.S. 3632/A 18165	Relief fragment: head of a Buddha figure	Central Asia	Baked clay	6.32 x 5.26cm
11	N.S. 3632/A 18166	Sculpted fragment: right hand of human figure	Central Asia	Baked clay	7.45 x 6.88cm
12	N.S. 3632/A 18167	Relief fragment: upper part of a Buddha	Central Asia	Baked clay	5.05 x 3.96cm
13	N.S. 3632/A 18168	Face of a camel	Central Asia	Baked clay	3.07 x 2.72cm
14	N.S. 3632/A 18169	Head of a crocodile	Central Asia	Baked clay	3.18 x 1.88cm
15	N.S. 3632/A 18170	Head of a crocodile (?)	Central Asia	Baked clay	3.87cm long
16	N.S. 3641/A 18125	Relief fragment: head of Buddha	Central Asia	Baked clay	7.04 x 4.78cm
17	N.S. 3641/A 18126	Relief fragment: head of Buddha	Central Asia	Baked clay	3.3 x 2.84cm
18	N.S. 3641/A 18127	Relief fragment: head of Buddha	Central Asia	Baked clay	5.85 x 4.21cm
19	N.S. 3641/A 18124	Relief fragment: head of Buddha	Central Asia	Baked clay (?)	5 x 4.32cm
20	N.S. 2421/A 19190	Flying disc	Central Asia	Bone	3.3cm in
21	N.S. 2399/A 19187	Seal	Central Asia	Copper	3.74 x 3.77cm
22	N.S. 2421/A 19189	Elongated seal	Central Asia	Copper	3.38cm long
23	N.S. 3616/A 19375	Seal: upper part designed as a tree	Central Asia	Copper	1.98cm long
24	N.S. 3653/A 19559	Leg of a tripod	Central Asia	Copper	1.2cm long
25	N.S. 3669/A 19182	Bead	Central Asia	Copper	2.25cm diam.
26	N.S. 3669/A 19183	Ball	Central Asia	Copper	2.24cm diam.
27	N.S. 3678/A 19091	Seal	Central Asia	Copper	2.4 x 2.17cm
28	N.S. 1881/A 19131	Glass bead	Central Asia	Glass	0.65cm in diam.eter
29	N.S. 3665/A 19382	Fragment of a lid	Central Asia	Glass	2.23cm in ht.
30	N.S. 3665/A 19383	Fragment of a rod	Central Asia	Glass	2.75cm long
31	N.S. 3665/A 19384	Fragment of a rod	Central Asia	Glass	1.48cm long
32	N.S. 3665/A 19385	Bead	Central Asia	Glass	1cm long
33	N.S. 3665/A 19386	Fragment of a carved object	Central Asia	Glass	2.7 x 1.98cm
34	N.S. 3665/A 19387	Fragment of a ring (?)	Central Asia	Glass	2.07cm long
35	N.S. 3665/A 19388	Spheroid bead	Central Asia	Glass	1.32cm in diam.
36	N.S. 3665/A 19389	Small piece of glass	Central Asia	Glass	1.42 x 1.34cm
37	N.S. 3665/A 19390	Fragment of a bead	Central Asia	Glass	0.97cm in diam.
38	N.S. 3665/A 19391	Fragment of a bead	Central Asia	Glass	0.97cm in diam.
39	N.S. 3678/A 19005	Curved piece	Central Asia	Glass	1.76cm (arm to arm)
40	N.S. 3678/A 19006	Curved thin piece	Central Asia	Glass	1.5cm (arm to arm)
41	N.S. 3678/A 19007	Carved piece (almost flat)	Central Asia	Glass	1.4cm (arm to arm)
42	N.S. 1881/A 19128	Metal fragment	Central Asia	Iron	1.21cm long
43	N.S. 3678/A 19009	Piece of iron	Central Asia	Iron	1.7cm long
44	N.S. 3619/A 19256	Small comb	Central Asia	Ivory	2.5 x 1.94cm
45	N.S. 3620/A 19458	Small ball	Central Asia	Metal	1.17cm in diam.
46	N.S. 3661/A 19379	Miniature camel	Central Asia	Metal	2cm long
47	N.S. 3662/A 18140	Ram (miniature)	Central Asia	Metal	1.7cm long
48	N.S. 3668/A 19123	Metal object	Central Asia	Metal	2cm in ht.
49	N.S. 3669/A 19181	Metal object	Central Asia	Metal	4.3 x 3.7cm

SL. no.	Acc. No.	Object	Site	Material	Measurements
50	N.S. 3669/A 19184	Buckle	Central Asia	Metal	1.8 x 2.3cm
51	N.S. 3669/A 19185	Metal piece	Central Asia	Metal	2.2 x 2.2cm
52	N.S. 3669/A 19485	Circular piece with a bold depression in the centre	Central Asia	Metal	3.95 x 3.5cm
53	N.S. 3669/A 19486	Square piece with bird motifs	Central Asia	Metal	3.08 x 2.93cm
54	N.S. 3672/A 19457	Metal fragment	Central Asia	Metal	-
55	N.S. 3678/A 19008	Curved nail	Central Asia	Metal	Irregular
56	N.S. 3678/A 19092	Figure of Buddha	Central Asia	Metal	2.24cm in ht.
57	N.S. 3678/A 19093	Copper ring	Central Asia	Metal	2.36cm in
58	N.S. 3625/A 13775	Relief fragment: part of a Buddha	Central Asia	Not recorded	Not recorded
59	N.S. 3678/A 19074	Conch shell fragment	Central Asia	Shell	0.74cm long
60	N.S. 3678/A 19078	Cowrie	Central Asia	Shell	1.3cm long
61	N.S. 3678/A 19010	Cowrie-shaped object	Central Asia	Shell (?)	1.5cm long
62	N.S. 2343/A 13643	Miniature human figure, defaced	Central Asia	Steatite	2cm long
63	N.S. 1881/A 19129	Fragment of bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.8 x 0.7cm
64	N.S. 1881/A 19130	Stone bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.56cm in diam.
65	N.S. 2398/A 19112	Ring stone (inscribed)	Central Asia	Stone	1.22 x 0.85cm
66	N.S. 2507/A 13594	Piece of red stone	Central Asia	Stone	2.5 x 1.5cm
67	N.S. 3648/A 13921	Miniature human head	Central Asia	Stone	1.5cm high
68	N.S. 3655/A 14103	Intaglio gem	Central Asia	Stone	1.1cm in
69	N.S. 3655/A 14104	Intaglio gem	Central Asia	Stone	1.1cm in
70	N.S. 3655/A 14105	Intaglio gem	Central Asia	Stone	1cm in
71	N.S. 3655/A 14106	Intaglio gem	Central Asia	Stone	0.06.cm in
72	N.S. 3655/A 14107	Intaglio gem	Central Asia	Stone	0.04cm in
73	N.S. 3657/A 19259	Bust of Buddha (defaced)	Central Asia	Stone	5.24cm in ht.
74	N.S. 3659/A 19484	Stone figure	Central Asia	Stone	1.41 x 1.09cm
75	N.S. 3660/A 19459	Disc-like piece (banded)	Central Asia	Stone	0.63cm in diam.
76	N.S. 3665/A 19381	Handle of a vessel	Central Asia	Stone	4.32cm long
77	N.S. 3666/A 19186	Stone object	Central Asia	Stone	2.77cm long
78	N.S. 3666/ A 19461–82	22 beads, fragments, etc.	Central Asia	Stone	Different shapes and sizes
79	N.S. 3668/A 19121	Fragment of an object	Central Asia	Stone	2.7cm long
80	N.S. 3668/A 19122	Stone object	Central Asia	Stone	1.5cm long
81	N.S. 3668/A 19124	Piece of stone	Central Asia	Stone	1.2 x 1cm
82	N.S. 3668/A 19125	Fragment of an object	Central Asia	Stone	1.38cm long
83	N.S. 3670/A 19079	Spheroid flesh rubber	Central Asia	Stone	3.7cm in
84	N.S. 3670/A 19080	Piece of stone	Central Asia	Stone	3.8 x 4.75cm
85	N.S. 3670/A 19081	Piece of stone	Central Asia	Stone	2.95 x 2.08cm
86	N.S. 3670/A 19082	Piece of stone	Central Asia	Stone	1.7cm long
87	N.S. 3670/A 19083	Fragment of a stone object	Central Asia	Stone	1.76 x 1.53cm
88	N.S. 3670/A 19084	Oval shaped object	Central Asia	Stone	1.47cm diam.
89	N.S. 3670/A 19085	Piece of stone	Central Asia	Stone	1.63cm long
90	N.S. 3670/A 19086	Piece of stone	Central Asia	Stone	2cm long
91	N.S. 3670/A 19087	Piece of stone	Central Asia	Stone	1.8cm long
92	N.S. 3670/A 19088	Piece of stone	Central Asia	Stone	1.24cm long
93	N.S. 3670/A 19089	Four-pronged object	Central Asia	Stone	0.09 x .08cm
94	N.S. 3670/A 19090	Piece of stone	Central Asia	Stone	1.6 x 1.4cm
95	N.S. 3670/A 19090	Piece of stone	Central Asia	Stone	1.6 x 1.4cm
96	N.S. 3678/A 18981	Bead-like object	Central Asia	Stone	1 x 1.1cm
97	N.S. 3678/A 18982	Bead	Central Asia	Stone	1.15cm in diam.
98	N.S. 3678/A 18983	Bead	Central Asia	Stone	1 x 1.3cm
99	N.S. 3678/A 18984	Stone ball	Central Asia	Stone	1.2cm in diam.
100	N.S. 3678/A 18985	Thick disk bead	Central Asia	Stone	1.1cm in diam.
101	N.S. 3678/A 18986	Fragment of a bead	Central Asia	Stone	1.2cm in diam.
102	N.S. 3678/A 18987	Fragment of a bead	Central Asia	Stone	1.1cm in diam.
103	N.S. 3678/A 18988	Fragment of a bead	Central Asia	Stone	1.46cm in diam.
104	N.S. 3678/A 18989	Fragment of a bead	Central Asia	Stone	1.4cm in diam.
105	N.S. 3678/A 18990	Eloated stone object (vase?)	Central Asia	Stone	1.3cm long
106	N.S. 3678/A 18991	Stone object	Central Asia	Stone	1.5cm long
107	N.S. 3678/A 18992	Bead-like object	Central Asia	Stone	0.82cm in diam.
108	N.S. 3678/A 18993	Carved piece	Central Asia	Stone	1.9cm long
109	N.S. 3678/A 18994	Carved piece	Central Asia	Stone	1.94cm long

SL. no.	Acc. No.	Object	Site	Material	Measurements
110	N.S. 3678/A 18995	Carved piece	Central Asia	Stone	1.34cm long
111	N.S. 3678/A 18996	Carved piece	Central Asia	Stone	1.6cm long
112	N.S. 3678/A 18997	Carved piece of stone	Central Asia	Stone	1.64cm long
113	N.S. 3678/A 18998	Piece of stone ring	Central Asia	Stone	1.33cm in diam.
114	N.S. 3678/A 18999	Carved piece	Central Asia	Stone	1.6cm long
115	N.S. 3678/A 19000	Carved piece	Central Asia	Stone	1.9cm long
116	N.S. 3678/A 19001	Carved piece	Central Asia	Stone	1.9cm (arm to arm)
117	N.S. 3678/A 19002	Carved piece	Central Asia	Stone	1.5cm long.
118	N.S. 3678/A 19003	Carved piece	Central Asia	Stone	1.4cm (arm to arm)
119	N.S. 3678/A 19004	Fragment of disc bead	Central Asia	Stone	1.4cm in diam.
120	N.S. 3678/A 19011	Piece of stone	Central Asia	Stone	1.5cm long
121	N.S. 3678/A 19012	Fragment of stone	Central Asia	Stone	1.27 x 1.2cm
122	N.S. 3678/A 19014	Piece of stone	Central Asia	Stone	1.3 x 1.2cm
123	N.S. 3678/A 19015	Piece of stone	Central Asia	Stone	1.2 x 1.1cm
124	N.S. 3678/A 19016	Piece of stone	Central Asia	Stone	1.3cm long
125	N.S. 3678/A 19017	Thin disc (?)	Central Asia	Stone	1.25cm in diam.
126	N.S. 3678/A 19018	Fragment of stone	Central Asia	Stone	1 x 0.09cm
127	N.S. 3678/A 19019	Piece of stone	Central Asia	Stone	1.12 x 0.09cm
128	N.S. 3678/A 19020	Piece of crystal	Central Asia	Stone	1.2cm long
129	N.S. 3678/A 19021	Stone object	Central Asia	Stone	1cm long
130	N.S. 3678/A 19022	Thin disk like object	Central Asia	Stone	0.09cm in diam.
131	N.S. 3678/A 19023	Spheroid bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.09cm in diam.
132	N.S. 3678/A 19024	Oval shaped bead	Central Asia	Stone	9cm in diam.
133	N.S. 3678/A 19025	Thin disc like object	Central Asia	Stone	0.85cm in diam.
134	N.S. 3678/A 19026	Fragment of a spheroid bead	Central Asia	Stone	1.13 x 1.06cm
135	N.S. 3678/A 19027	Fragment of a stone object	Central Asia	Stone	1.2cm long
136	N.S. 3678/A 19028	Thick disc bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.92cm in diam.
137	N.S. 3678/A 19029	Irregular bead	Central Asia	Stone	-
138	N.S. 3678/A 19030	Disc like object	Central Asia	Stone	0.84cm in
139	N.S. 3678/A 19031	Bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.65 x 0.75cm
140	N.S. 3678/A 19032	Bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.72cm in diam.
141	N.S. 3678/A 19033	Bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.72cm in diam.
142	N.S. 3678/A 19034	Piece of stone	Central Asia	Stone	0.76 x 0.09cm
143	N.S. 3678/A 19035	Bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.08cm in diam.
144	N.S. 3678/A 19036	Bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.76cm in diam.
145	N.S. 3678/A 19037	Bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.75cm in diam.
146	N.S. 3678/A 19038	Bead	Central Asia	Stone	7.2cm in diam.
147	N.S. 3678/A 19039	Bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.71cm in diam.
148	N.S. 3678/A 19040	Fragment of stone	Central Asia	Stone	0.84cm long
149	N.S. 3678/A 19041	Bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.65cm long
150	N.S. 3678/A 19042	Bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.74cm in diam.
151	N.S. 3678/A 19043	Bead	Central Asia	Stone	1cm in diam.
152	N.S. 3678/A 19044	Bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.67cm in
153	N.S. 3678/A 19045	Bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.08cm in
154	N.S. 3678/A 19046	Bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.62cm in
155	N.S. 3678/A 19047	Bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.72cm in
156	N.S. 3678/A 19048	Bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.67cm in
157	N.S. 3678/A 19049	Multifaceted bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.55 x 0.57cm
158	N.S. 3678/A 19050	Fragment of a bead	Central Asia	Stone	Irregular
159	N.S. 3678/A 19051	Piece of stone	Central Asia	Stone	1cm long
160	N.S. 3678/A 19052	Bead	Central Asia	Stone	1.16cm long
161	N.S. 3678/A 19053	Fragment of a bead	Central Asia	Stone	1.1cm long
162	N.S. 3678/A 19054	Bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.43 x 0.56cm
163	N.S. 3678/A 19055	Bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.7cm long
164	N.S. 3678/A 19056	Bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.48cm long
165	N.S. 3678/A 19058	Multifaceted of stone	Central Asia	Stone	0.64cm long
166	N.S. 3678/A 19059	Bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.63cm in diam.
167	N.S. 3678/A 19060	Piece of stone	Central Asia	Stone	9cm long
168	N.S. 3678/A 19061	Bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.5cm in diam.
169	N.S. 3678/A 19062	Bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.05 in diam.

SL. no.	Acc. No.	Object	Site	Material	Measurements
170	N.S. 3678/A 19063	Multifaceted of stone	Central Asia	Stone	0.52cm long
171	N.S. 3678/A 19064	Piece of stone	Central Asia	Stone	0.06cm in diam.
172	N.S. 3678/A 19065	Multifaceted piece of stone	Central Asia	Stone	Irregular
173	N.S. 3678/A 19066	Bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.04cm long
174	N.S. 3678/A 19067	Bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.04cm diam.
175	N.S. 3678/A 19068	Bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.04cm long
176	N.S. 3678/A 19069	Bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.04cm long
177	N.S. 3678/A 19070	Elongated piece of stone	Central Asia	Stone	0.8cm long
178	N.S. 3678/A 19072	Elongated piece of stone	Central Asia	Stone	0.8cm long
179	N.S. 3678/A 19073	Fragment of an object	Central Asia	Stone	1.5cm long
180	N.S. 3678/A 19075	Piece of stone	Central Asia	Stone	0.09cm long
181	N.S. 3678/A 19076	Piece of stone	Central Asia	Stone	0.85cm long
182	N.S. 3678/A 19077	Piece of stone	Central Asia	Stone	0.9cm long
183	N.S. 3678/A 19080	Piece of stone	Central Asia	Stone	0.72 x 0.64cm
184	N.S. 3678/A 19090	Piece of stone	Central Asia	Stone	0.62 x 0.7cm
185	N.S. 3678/A 19270	Bead or whorl (?)	Central Asia	Stone	2.89 x 2.19cm
186	N.S. 3679/A 19013	Piece of stone	Central Asia	Stone	1.2cm diam.
187	N.S. 4471/ A 15671–701	Beads	Central Asia	Stone	Different shapes and size
188	N.S. 4472/ A 15618–70 (e x cept 68)	Beads	Central Asia	Stone	Different shapes and size
189	N.S. 4473/ A 15569–617	Beads	Central Asia	Stone	Different shapes and size
190	N.S. 4474/A 16074–146	Beads	Central Asia	Stone	Different shapes and size
191	N.S. 4475/A 15467	Spherical bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.8cm in
192	N.S. 4475/A 15468	Spherical bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.83cm in
193	N.S. 4475/A 15469	Spherical bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.81cm in
194	N.S. 4475/A 15470	Spherical bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.81cm in
195	N.S. 4475/A 15471	Spherical bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.87cm in
196	N.S. 4475/A 15472	Bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.88cm in
197	N.S. 4475/A 15473	Spherical bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.84cm in
198	N.S. 4475/A 15474	Spherical bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.95cm in
199	N.S. 4475/A 15475	Fragment of a multifaceted bead	Central Asia	Stone	2.2cm in
201	N.S. 4475/A 15476	Elliptical bead	Central Asia	Stone	1.18cm in
202	N.S. 4475/A 15477	Barrel-shaped bead	Central Asia	Stone	1.05cm in
203	N.S. 4475/A 15478	Multifacetted bead	Central Asia	Stone	1.57cm in
204	N.S. 4475/A 15479	Spherical bead	Central Asia	Stone	1.05cm in
205	N.S. 4475/A 15480	Spherical bead	Central Asia	Stone	1.29cm in
206	N.S. 4475/A 15481	Spherical bead with tapering ends	Central Asia	Stone	0.91cm in
207	N.S. 4475/A 15482	Unfinished bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.84cm in
208	N.S. 4475/A 15483	Spherical bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.72cm in
209	N.S. 4475/A 15484	Spherical bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.87cm in
210	N.S. 4475/A 15485	Bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.89cm in
211	N.S. 4475/A 15486	Spherical bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.83cm in
212	N.S. 4475/A 15487	Spherical bead	Central Asia	Stone	0.92cm in
213	N.S.3647/A 13712	Fragment of a bangle	Central Asia	Stone	3cmlong
214	N.S.3651/A 18237	Fragment of a miniature camel	Central Asia	Stone	6.53cm in ht.
215	N.S. 4475/ A 15488–15568	Bead etc.	Central Asia	Stone& Glass	Different shapes and size
216	N.S. 1831/A 13827	Relief fragment: Lower part of a kneeling figure	Central Asia	Stucco	6 x 4.5cm
217	N.S. 3621/A 18128	Relief fragment: human finger	Central Asia	Stucco	5.92 x 53.95cm
218	N.S. 3621/A 18129	Relief fragment: part of a human finger	Central Asia	Stucco	5.5cm long
219	N.S. 3621/A 18130	Fragment of a carved relief	Central Asia	Stucco	6.33 x 6.92cm
220	N.S. 3621/A 18132	Relief fragment: male torso	Central Asia	Stucco	4.44 x 6.62cm
221	N.S. 3621/A 18133	Relief fragment: human head	Central Asia	Stucco	4.71 x 3.69cm
222	N.S. 3621/A 18141	Relief fragment: human head	Central Asia	Stucco	3.53 x 2.26cm
223	N.S. 3621/A 18142	Relief fragment: human head	Central Asia	Stucco	2.64 x 3.2cm
224	N.S. 3623/A 18156	Embracing monkeys (damaged)	Central Asia	Stucco	2.68cm in ht
225	N.S. 3623/A 18161	Relief fragment: torso of Buddha	Central Asia	Stucco	7.4 x 5.66cm

SL. no.	Acc. No.	Object	Site	Material	Measurements
226	N.S. 3624/A 13773	Relief fragment: Buddha standing on lotus	Central Asia	Stucco	17.6 x 7.5cm
227	N.S. 3624/A 13774	Relief fragment: standing Buddha	Central Asia	Stucco	16.5 x 7.5cm
228	N.S. 3625/A 13776	Relief fragment: standing Buddha	Central Asia	Stucco	14.9 x 5.4cm
229	N.S. 3625/A 13777	Relief fragment: part of a bodhisattva	Central Asia	Stucco	8.7 x 9.5cm
230	N.S. 3625/A 13778	Relief fragment: standing Buddha (painted)	Central Asia	Stucco	15.5 x 6.1cm
231	N.S. 3625/A 13779	Relief fragment: standing Buddha	Central Asia	Stucco	14.6 x 6cm
232	N.S. 3625/A 18162	Relief fragment: human arm	Central Asia	Stucco	3.67cm long
233	N.S. 3627/A 20873	Relief fragment: standing Buddha	Central Asia	Stucco	18.4 x 5.4cm
234	N.S. 3629/A 13781	Relief fragment: headless figure	Central Asia	Stucco	14.5 x 10cm
235	N.S. 3630/A 18119	Relief fragment: human head	Central Asia	Stucco	4.3 x 3.67cm
236	N.S. 3630/A 18120	Relief fragment: head of Buddha	Central Asia	Stucco	4.19 x 2.71cm
237	N.S. 3630/A 13782	Relief fragment: upper part of a Buddha figure	Central Asia	Stucco	9.1 x 5.8cm
238	N.S. 3630/A 13783	Relief fragment: upper part of a human figure	Central Asia	Stucco	8.9 x 10cm
239	N.S. 3630/A 13784	Relief fragment: upper part of a human figure	Central Asia	Stucco	9 x 7.6cm
240	N.S. 3630/A 18121	Relief fragment: head of Buddha	Central Asia	Stucco	4.79 x 3.42cm
241	N.S. 3630/A 18122	Relief fragment: head of Buddha	Central Asia	Stucco	5.27 x 3.91cm
242	N.S. 3630/A 18123	Relief fragment: head of Buddha	Central Asia	Stucco	3.61 x 3.33cm
243	N.S. 3631/A 13732	Relief fragment: part of a garland bearer	Central Asia	Stucco	8.3 x 13.5.cm
244	N.S. 3631/A 13785	Relief fragment: part of a human figure	Central Asia	Stucco	9.4 x 7.9cm
245	N.S. 3631/A 13786	Relief fragment: part of a human figure	Central Asia	Stucco	8.6 x 12.4cm
246	N.S. 3631/A 13788	Relief fragment: standing Buddha	Central Asia	Stucco	15 x 6.7cm
247	N.S. 3632/A 13782	Relief fragment: part of a garland bearer	Central Asia	Stucco	8.3 x 13.5cm
248	N.S. 3633/A 13794	Relief fragment: standing Buddha	Central Asia	Stucco	15 x 6.5cm
249	N.S. 3633/A 13795	Relief fragment: standing Buddha	Central Asia	Stucco	13.8 x 6.2cm
250	N.S. 3634/A 13796	Relief fragment: upper part of a Buddha figure	Central Asia	Stucco	7 x 7.3cm
251	N.S. 3634/A 18111	Relief fragment: head of Buddha	Central Asia	Stucco	9.19 x 3.58cm
252	N.S. 3634/A 18112	Fragment of a carved relief	Central Asia	Stucco	9.32 x 3.52cm
253	N.S. 3634/A 18113	Relief fragment: head of Buddha	Central Asia	Stucco	8.52 x 3.72cm
254	N.S. 3634/A 18114	Relief fragment: head of Buddha	Central Asia	Stucco	4.07 x 3.55cm
255	N.S. 3635/A 13798	Relief fragment: seated human figure	Central Asia	Stucco	
256	N.S. 3636/A 13800	Relief fragment: part of a Buddha figure	Central Asia	Stucco	
257	N.S. 3636/A 13801	Relief fragment: part of a Buddha figure	Central Asia	Stucco	
258	N.S. 3636/A 13802	Relief fragment: part of a Buddha figure	Central Asia	Stucco	
259	N.S. 3638/A 13691	Relief fragment: Buddha head	Central Asia	Stucco	5.5 x 3.5cm
260	N.S. 3638/A 13692	Relief fragment: standing Buddha damaged	Central Asia	Stucco	8.3 x 3.5cm
261	N.S. 3639/A 18187	Relief fragment: Buddha (?)	Central Asia	Stucco	6.09 x 4.97cm
262	N.S. 3639/A 18188	Relief fragment: Buddha head	Central Asia	Stucco	6.09 x 4.63cm
263	N.S. 3639/A 18189	Relief fragment: defaced head of Buddha (?)	Central Asia	Stucco	2.91 x 2.44cm
264	N.S. 3639/A 18115	Relief fragment: carved	Central Asia	Stucco	7 x 8cm
265	N.S. 3639/A 18116	Relief fragment: male torso	Central Asia	Stucco	5.7 x 3.74cm
266	N.S. 3639/A 18117	Relief fragment: seated male (?)	Central Asia	Stucco	5.92 x 53.95cm
267	N.S. 3639/A 18118	Relief fragment: male torso	Central Asia	Stucco	5.07 x 4.95cm
268	N.S. 3645/A 13707	Relief fragment: bust of a headless Buddha	Central Asia	Stucco	6.5 x 6cm
269	N.S. 3646/A 18184	Pottery fragment: human face	Central Asia	Stucco	3.8 x 3.2cm
270	N.S. 3646/A 18209	Head and neck part of a miniature horse	Central Asia	Stucco	7.3cm long
271	N.S. 3664/A 13730	Relief fragment showing seated Buddha	Central Asia	Stucco	8 x 5cm
272	N.S. 3637/A 18186	Sculptured fragment	Central Asia	Stucco (?)	5.54 x 4.07cm
273	N.S. 3635/A 13799	Relief fragment: seated human figure	Central Asia	Stucco.	
274	N.S 2348/A 13648	Miniature monkey (damaged)	Central Asia	Terracotta	3cm long
275	N.S 2490/A 13578	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.5 x 2.5cm
276	N.S. 1815/A 13818	Green glazed potsherd with a boss on upper surface	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.5 x 2cm
277	N.S. 1881/A 19127	Relief fragment	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.96 x 2cm
278	N.S. 2329/A 20867	Pottery fragment: human head (probably handle of a vessel)	Central Asia	Terracotta	12.8 x 8cm
279	N.S. 2330/A 20870	Pottery fragment: human bust spout of a vessel	Central Asia	Terracotta	12 x 6.5cm
280	N.S. 2331/A 13634	Miniature camel	Central Asia	Terracotta	8.5 x 6.5cm
281	N.S. 2332/A 13635	Miniature camel	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.5 x 5cm
282	N.S. 2333/A 20929	Double humped camel with baggage on its back	Central Asia	Terracotta	7.1 x 6.4cm
283	N.S. 2334/A 13636	Male human head	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.5cm long

SL. no.	Acc. No.	Object	Site	Material	Measurements
284	N.S. 2335/A 13637	Head of a lady	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.7cm long
285	N.S. 2336/A 20880	Pottery fragment: human head mustache and beard	Central Asia	Terracotta	8.1 x 6.1cm
286	N.S. 2337/A 13638	Head of a female figure	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.5cm long
287	N.S. 2338/A 13639	Head of a monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.5cm long
288	N.S. 2339/A 13640	Pottery fragment showing a dog's (lion's) head	Central Asia	Terracotta	5 x 5cm
289	N.S. 2341/A 13641	Miniature monkey with closed hands	Central Asia	Terracotta	3cm long
290	N.S. 2342/A 13642	Miniature monkey seated and offering something	Central Asia	Terracotta	1.5cm long
291	N.S. 2344/A 13644	Miniature bird	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.5cm
292	N.S. 2345/A 13645	Miniature monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	2cm long
293	N.S. 2346/A 13646	Miniature monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	3cm long
294	N.S. 2347/A 13647	Bust of miniature grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	2cm long
295	N.S. 2349/A 13649	Miniature monkey (arms and legs broken)	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.5cm long
296	N.S. 2350/A 13650	Miniature monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	2cm long
297	N.S. 2351/A 13671	Miniature female monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	3cm long
298	N.S. 2352/A 13652	A pair of miniature monkeys embracing	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.5cm long
299	N.S. 2353/A 13653	Pottery fragment showing human face	Central Asia	Terracotta	3 x 2.5cm
300	N.S. 2354/A 13654	Pottery fragment showing human face	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.5 x 3cm
301	N.S. 2355/A 13655	Pottery fragment showing human face	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.5 x 3.5cm long
302	N.S. 2356/A 13950	Miniature monkey wearing a cap	Central Asia	Terracotta	6cm long
303	N.S. 2357/A 13656	Miniature monkey holding something by hands	Central Asia	Terracotta	4cm long
304	N.S. 2358/A 13657	Grotesque monkey head	Central Asia	Terracotta	2cm long
305	N.S. 2407/A 20891	Head of a monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	5 x 4.4cm
306	N.S. 2408/A 20884	Naga head with five hoods and pig tail	Central Asia	Terracotta	5 x 3.4cm
307	N.S. 2409/A 20939	Monkey lying on a couch and tied to it	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.2cm long
308	N.S. 2423/A 13518	Bust of a grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.5 x 4cm
309	N.S. 2424/A 13519	Miniature grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.75cm in height
310	N.S. 2425/A 13520	Grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.5 x 3cm
311	N.S. 2426/A 13521	Miniature monkey in an indecent posture	Central Asia	Terracotta	6cm in ht.
312	N.S. 2427/A 13522	Miniature grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	4cm long
313	N.S. 2428/A 20886	Grotesque monkey playing on a lute	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.7 x 3.5cm
314	N.S. 2429/A 13523	Miniature grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	2cm long
315	N.S. 2430/A 13524	Miniature grotesque monkey holding another female monkey on his left shoulder	Central Asia	Terracotta	1.5cm long
316	N.S. 2431/A 13525	Miniature grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.5cm long
317	N.S. 2432/A 13526	Miniature grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.5cm long
318	N.S. 2434/A 13528	Head of human figure with Naga hood	Central Asia	Terracotta	5cm long
319	N.S. 2435/A 13529	A lump of clay showing a dog's head	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.5cm long
320	N.S. 2436/A 13530	Bust of a human figure (clown)	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.5cm long
321	N.S. 2437/A 13531	Naga head	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.5 x 3.5cm
322	N.S. 2438/A 20888	Head of a monkey wearing cap	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.7 x 4.4cm
323	N.S. 2439/A 13532	Fragment of pottery showing lion's face	Central Asia	Terracotta	5 x 4cm
324	N.S. 2440/A 20942	Miniature dog	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.8cm long
325	N.S. 2441/A 13534	Miniature bird	Central Asia	Terracotta	4cm long
326	N.S. 2442/A 13533	Caparisoned horse, miniature	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.5 x 4.5cm
327	N.S. 2443/A 20993	Caparisoned double humped camel	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.8 x 7cm
328	N.S. 2444/A 13535	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	14.5 x 10cm
329	N.S. 2445/A 13536	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	16 x 5cm
330	N.S. 2447/A 13537	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	7 x 3cm
331	N.S. 2448/A 13538	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	10 x 2.5cm
332	N.S. 2449/A 13539	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.5 x 3.5cm
333	N.S. 2450/A 13540	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	5 x 3.5cm
334	N.S. 2451/A 13541	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.5 x 3.5cm
335	N.S. 2452/A 13542	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	7 x 3cm
336	N.S. 2453/A 13543	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	10 x 7.5cm
337	N.S. 2454/A 13544	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	7 x 5.5cm
338	N.S. 2455/A 13545	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.5 x 4.5cm
339	N.S. 2456/A 18245	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	7.17 x 4.9cm
340	N.S. 2457/A 13554	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	5 x 4cm
341	N.S. 2458/A 13556	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.5 x 4.5cm
342	N.S. 2459/A 13546	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	8 x 7cm

SL. no.	Acc. No.	Object	Site	Material	Measurements
343	N.S. 2460/A 13547	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.5 x 4.5cm
344	N.S. 2461/A 13751	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	6 x 5.5cm
345	N.S. 2462/A 13548	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	5 x 2.5cm
346	N.S. 2463/A 13543	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	4 x 4cm
347	N.S. 2464/A 13550	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.5 x 3cm
348	N.S. 2465/A 13551	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.5 x 4.5cm
349	N.S. 2466/A 13552	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	10 x 7cm
350	N.S. 2467/A 13553	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	6 x 3.5cm
351	N.S. 2468/A 13555	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.5 x 3cm
352	N.S. 2469/A 13557	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.5 x 4
353	N.S. 2470/A 13558	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.5 x 4cm
354	N.S. 2471/A 13559	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.5 x 5cm
355	N.S. 2472/A 13560	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.5 x 2.5cm
356	N.S. 2473/A 13561	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.5 x 2.5cm
357	N.S. 2474/A 13562	Pottery fragment with floral design	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.5 x 2.5cm
358	N.S. 2474/A 13563	Pottery fragment with floral design	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.5 x 2.5cm
359	N.S. 2475/A 13564	Piece of pottery design with a disc surrounded by four petals on four sides	Central Asia	Terracotta	5 x 4cm
360	N.S. 2476/A 13565	Piece of pottery designed with a disc surrounded by four petals on four sides	Central Asia	Terracotta	4 x 3cm
361	N.S. 2477/A 13566	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.5 x 4cm
362	N.S. 2478/A 13561	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.5 x 3cm
363	N.S. 2479/A 13568	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	8 x 5cm
364	N.S. 2480/A 13569	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.5 x 3.5cm
365	N.S. 2481/A 13570	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.5 x 2.5cm
366	N.S. 2482/A 13571	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.5 x 2.5cm
367	N.S. 2483/A 13572	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.5 x 5.5cm
368	N.S. 2484/A 13573	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	3 x 2.5cm
369	N.S. 2486/A 13574	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	3 x 1.5cm
370	N.S. 2487/A 13575	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	3 x 2cm
371	N.S. 2488/A 13576	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	5 x 2cm
372	N.S. 2489/A 13577	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	5 x 3cm
373	N.S. 2491/A 13579	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	4 x 2.5cm
374	N.S. 2493/A 13580	Piece of pottery with petal design	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.5 x 5cm
375	N.S. 2494/A 13581	Piece of pottery with petal design	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.5 x 2cm
376	N.S. 2495/A 13582	Piece of pottery with petal design	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.5 x 2cm
377	N.S. 2497/A 13583	Piece of pottery with zigzag designs	Central Asia	Terracotta	4 x 2cm
378	N.S. 2498/A 13584	Piece of pottery showing zigzag design	Central Asia	Terracotta	4 x 2.5cm
379	N.S. 2499/A 13585	Piece of pottery: zigzag design	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.5 x 2cm
380	N.S. 2500/A 13586	Piece of pottery: petal shaped & stamped with two fingers	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.5 x 6cm
381	N.S. 2500/A 13587	Piece of pottery: petal shaped & stamped with two fingers	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.5 x 6cm
382	N.S. 2501/A 13588	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	5 x 3cm
383	N.S. 2502/A 13589	Piece of pottery scalloped in two half lines	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.5 x 2.5cm
384	N.S. 2503/A 13590	Piece of pottery	Central Asia	Terracotta	7 x 6cm
385	N.S. 2504/A 13591	Piece of pottery, lions (human?) face	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.5 x 5.5cm
386	N.S. 2505/A 13592	Piece of pottery showing monkey's face	Central Asia	Terracotta	5 x 4.5cm
387	N.S. 2506/A 13593	Lower part of a miniature figure	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.5cm long
388	N.S. 2509/A 13595	Portion of a hand of a human figure	Central Asia	Terracotta	12.5 x 8.5cm
389	N.S. 2511/A 13597	Lump of terracotta	Central Asia	Terracotta	9.5 x 3cm
390	N.S. 3618/A 19258	Human figurine right palm broken	Central Asia	Terracotta	12.4cm in ht.
391	N.S. 3621/A 13757	Relief fragment: Buddha in meditation (crude)	Central Asia	Terracotta	10.1 x 6cm
392	N.S. 3621/A 13758	Relief fragment: headless Buddha	Central Asia	Terracotta	10.1 x 5.6cm
393	N.S. 3621/A 18131	Relief fragment: human torso	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.86 x 3.9cm
394	N.S. 3621/A 18134	Relief fragment: three pronged design	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.07 x 6.83cm
395	N.S. 3621/A 18135	Relief fragment: human head	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.25 x 3.12cm
396	N.S. 3621/A 18136	Relief fragment: human head	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.5 x 3cm
397	N.S. 3621/A 18137	Relief fragment: portion of a human figure(?)	Central Asia	Terracotta	1.7 x 1.7cm
398	N.S. 3621/A 18138	Relief fragment: human head (damaged)	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.66 x 3.64cm

SL. no.	Acc. No.	Object	Site	Material	Measurements
399	N.S. 3621/A 18139	Relief fragment: human head	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.3 x 3.37cm
400	N.S. 3621/A 18140	Relief fragment: human head	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.84 x 4.6cm
401	N.S. 3621/A 18143	Relief fragment: crescent shaped object	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.54 x 2.46cm
402	N.S. 3621/A 18187	Relief fragment: Buddha (?)	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.09 x 4.97cm
403	N.S. 3621/A 18188	Relief fragment: Buddha head	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.09 x 4.63cm
404	N.S. 3621/A 18189	Relief fragment: defaced head of Buddha	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.91 x 2.44cm
405	N.S. 3621/A 18190	Carved fragment	Central Asia	Terracotta	7.64 x 6.05cm
406	N.S. 3621/A 18194	Carved fragment	Central Asia	Terracotta	7.7 x 7.04cm
407	N.S. 3621/A 18195	Right hand and chest of Buddha figure	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.83 x 5cm
408	N.S. 3621/A 18196	Carved fragment	Central Asia	Terracotta	7.44 x 6.05 x 4.76cm
409	N.S. 3621/A 18197	Pottery fragment: grotesque animal face	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.78 x 3.66cm
410	N.S. 3621/A 18198	Fragment of a bird (?)	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.45 x 4.17 x 2.9cm
411	N.S. 3621/A 18199	Pottery fragment: lion's face	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.7 x 2.46cm
412	N.S. 3621/A 18200	Camel head	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.6 x 3.5cm
413	N.S. 3621/A 18203	Pottery fragment: animal face	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.95 x 3.9cm
414	N.S. 3621/A 18204	Pottery fragment: part of an animal face	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.4 x 3.82cm
415	N.S. 3621/A 18205	Pottery fragment: animal face	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.38 x 4.72cm
416	N.S. 3623/A 14061	Bust of a miniature monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	1.2cm long
417	N.S. 3623/A 13759	Monkey head	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.2 x 1.6cm
418	N.S. 3623/A 13760	Fragment of miniature vessel	Central Asia	Terracotta	1.4 x 1.2cm
419	N.S. 3623/A 13762	Pottery fragment: human face	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.6 x 2.9cm
420	N.S. 3623/A 13763	Part of a miniature monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	2 x 1.1cm
421	N.S. 3623/A 13764	Head of a monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	1.9 x 1.5cm
422	N.S. 3623/A 13765	Lower part of grotesque monkeys embracing each other	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.6 x 1.4cm
423	N.S. 3623/A 13766	Miniature grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.3cm long
424	N.S. 3623/A 13767	Owl-faced grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	3cm long
425	N.S. 3623/A 13768	Face of a camel	Central Asia	Terracotta	1.4 x 1.1cm
426	N.S. 3623/A 13769	Face of monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	1.6 x 1.4cm
427	N.S. 3623/A 13770	Part of a grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	1.7 x 1.9cm
428	N.S. 3623/A 13771	Grotesque monkey (owl-faced), damaged	Central Asia	Terracotta	1.5 x 1.2cm
429	N.S. 3623/A 13772	Miniature grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.2 x 1cm
430	N.S. 3623/A 18144	Relief fragment: animal face	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.77cm in ht
431	N.S. 3623/A 18145	Relief fragment: animal face	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.69cm in ht
432	N.S. 3623/A 18146	Relief fragment: animal face	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.2 x 2.4cm
433	N.S. 3623/A 18147	Pottery fragment: animal face	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.45 x 4.26cm
434	N.S. 3623/A 18148	Monkey head	Central Asia	Terracotta	1.98cm in ht
435	N.S. 3623/A 18149	Pottery fragment: animal head	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.35cm .in ht
436	N.S. 3623/A 18150	Pottery fragment: human face	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.3 x 2.31cm
437	N.S. 3623/A 18151	Terracotta fragment	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.89cm in ht
438	N.S. 3623/A 18152	Animal head (grotesque)	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.24cm long
439	N.S. 3623/A 18153	Animal face	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.49cm in ht.
440	N.S. 3623/A 18154	Animal face	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.31cm long
441	N.S. 3623/A 18155	Fragment of an animal head	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.58cm in ht.
442	N.S. 3623/A 18156	Embracing monkeys (damaged)	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.68cm in ht.
443	N.S. 3623/A 18157	Animal head	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.18cm in ht.
444	N.S. 3623/A 18158	Head of human figure (grotesque)	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.76 x 2.41cm
445	N.S. 3623/A 18160	Pottery fragment: human bust in profile	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.26 x 2.15cm
446	N.S. 3627/A 13780	Relief fragment: standing Buddha	Central Asia	Terracotta	18 x 5.5cm
447	N.S. 3627/A 18159	Fragment of a grotesque owl	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.56cm in ht.
448	N.S. 3632/A 18171	Fragment of an indistinct object	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.6 x 3.5cm
449	N.S. 3632/A 18172	Human head (damaged)	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.5cm long.
450	N.S. 3632/A 18173	Miniature monkey (grotesque)	Central Asia	Terracotta	4cm long
451	N.S. 3632/A 18174	Pottery fragment: face of grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.65cm long
452	N.S. 3632/A 18175	Grotesque monkey head	Central Asia	Terracotta	1.93cm long
453	N.S. 3632/A 18176	Two human figures seated face to face	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.87 x 3.71cm
454	N.S. 3632/A 13761	Relief fragment: face of a monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.5 x 2.3cm
455	N.S. 3632/A 13789	Grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.1 x 1.9cm
456	N.S. 3632/A 13790	Grotesque monkey (leg part broken)	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.2 x 1.3cm
457	N.S. 3632/A 13791	Grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	3cm long

SL. no.	Acc. No.	Object	Site	Material	Measurements
458	N.S. 3632/A 13792	Grotesque monkey, damaged	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.5 X 1cm
459	N.S. 3632/A 18171	Fragment of an indistinct object	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.6 x 3.5cm
460	N.S. 3632/A 18172	Human head(damaged)	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.5cm long
461	N.S. 3632/A 18173	Miniature monkey (grotesque)	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.cm long
462	N.S. 3632/A 18174	Pottery fragment: grotesque animal face	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.65cm long
463	N.S. 3632/A 18175	Grotesque monkey face	Central Asia	Terracotta	1.93cm long
464	N.S. 3632/A 18176	Two human figures seated face to face	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.87 x 3.71cm
465	N.S. 3634/A 13797	Relief fragment: part of a Buddha figure	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.35 x 1.15cm
466	N.S. 3637/A 13685	Relief fragment: left hand of a Buddha figure	Central Asia	Terracotta	7.2 x 2.2cm
467	N.S. 3637/A 13686	Relief fragment: floral motif	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.8 x 3.6cm
468	N.S. 3637/A 13687	Relief fragment: lower part of a Buddha figure	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.1 x 7.2cm
469	N.S. 3637/A 13688	Relief fragment: floral motif	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.3 x 3.3cm
470	N.S. 3637/A 13689	Relief fragment: head of a Bodhisattva	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.5 x 4.2cm
471	N.S. 3637/A 18180	Grotesque human head	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.56cm in ht
472	N.S. 3637/A 18181	Pottery fragment: but of a human figure holding a jar on shoulder	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.13 x 2.48cm
473	N.S. 3637/A 18182	Buddha head	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.51 x 3.2cm
474	N.S. 3637/A 18183	Buddha head	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.26 x 2.15cm
475	N.S. 3637/A 18184	Pottery fragment: human face	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.8 x 3.2cm
476	N.S. 3637/A 18185	Sculptured fragment	Central Asia	Terracotta	5 x 3.8cm
477	N.S. 3637/A 18186	Pottery fragment: grotesque head of a monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.57 x 1.88cm
478	N.S. 3639/A 18190	Carved fragment	Central Asia	Terracotta	7.64 x 6.05cm
479	N.S. 3639/A 18197	Pottery fragment: grotesque animal face	Central Asia	Terracotta	
480	N.S. 3640/A 18191	Part of an animal horse (?)	Central Asia	Terracotta	8.41cm long
481	N.S. 3641/A 18193	Carved fragment	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.37 x 2.63cm
482	N.S. 3641/A 18194	Carved fragment	Central Asia	Terracotta	7.7 x 7.04cm
483	N.S. 3641/A 18195	Right hand and chest of Buddha figure	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.83 x 5cm
484	N.S. 3641/A 18192	Pottery fragment: monkey head	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.07 x 3.77cm
485	N.S. 3641/A 18193	Carved fragment	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.37 x 2.63cm
486	N.S. 3641/A 20879	Pottery fragment: head of a goblin	Central Asia	Terracotta	7.5 x 6cm
487	N.S. 3641/A 20892	Pottery fragment: horned lion's face	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.1 x 4.6cm
488	N.S. 3642/A 18196	Carved fragment	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.38 x 4.72cm
489	N.S. 3642/A 18198	Fragment of a bird (?)	Central Asia	Terracotta	7.44 x 6.05 x 4.76cm
490	N.S. 3642/A 18199	Pottery fragment: lion's face	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.45 x 4.17 x 2.9cm
491	N.S. 3642/A 18200	Camel head	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.7 x 2.46cm
492	N.S. 3642/A 13693	Relief fragment: floral design	Central Asia	Terracotta	8.7 x 8.8cm
493	N.S. 3642/A 13694	Relief fragment: part of a flower with Buddha	Central Asia	Terracotta	
494	N.S. 3643/A 18203	Pottery fragment: animal face	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.78 x 3.66cm
495	N.S. 3643/A 18204	Pottery fragment: part of an animal face	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.95 x 3.9cm
496	N.S. 3643/A 18205	Pottery fragment: animal face	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.4 x 3.82cm
497	N.S. 3643/A 13695	Relief fragment	Central Asia	Terracotta	
498	N.S. 3643/A 13696	Relief fragment: floral design	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.4 x 9.9cm
499	N.S. 3643/A 13697	Relief fragment: seated Buddha	Central Asia	Terracotta	8.3 x 6.9cm
500	N.S. 3643/A 13698	Relief fragment: seated Buddha	Central Asia	Terracotta	8.2 x 5.4cm
501	N.S. 3643/A 13699	Relief fragment	Central Asia	Terracotta	
502	N.S. 3643/A 20948	Head with part of the neck of a horse or antelope	Central Asia	Terracotta	8.5 x 6.7cm
503	N.S. 3644/A 13700	Fragment of a sculpture showing a hand	Central Asia	Terracotta	8 x 6cm
504	N.S. 3644/A 13701	Fragment of a sculpture showing a hand	Central Asia	Terracotta	9 x 6cm
505	N.S. 3644/A 13702	Sculptural fragment: a hand	Central Asia	Terracotta	8.5 x 6cm
506	N.S. 3644/A 18201	Sculptural fragment palm of a Buddha figure	Central Asia	Terracotta	7.33 x 5.33cm
507	N.S. 3644/A 18202	Sculptural fragment palm of a Buddha figure	Central Asia	Terracotta	7.41 x 5.65cm
508	N.S. 3644/A 18213	Unidentifiable figurine	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.19cm in height
509	N.S. 3645/A 13703	Relief fragment lower part of a Buddha	Central Asia	Terracotta	7.3 x 6.3cm
510	N.S. 3645/A 13704	Relief fragment partial head of a Bodhisattva	Central Asia	Terracotta	7.7 x 5.6cm
511	N.S. 3645/A 13705	Relief fragment	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.5 x 3.1cm
512	N.S. 3645/A 13706	Relief fragment: partial head of a Buddha	Central Asia	Terracotta	7.6 x 6cm
513	N.S. 3646/A 18215	Human head, damaged	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.51cm in ht.
514	N.S. 3646/A 13708	Miniature grotesque monkey (upper part only)	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.9 x 2.5cm
515	N.S. 3646/A 13709	Miniature grotesque monkey (damaged)	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.3 x 4cm
516	N.S. 3646/A 13710	Miniature grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.1 x 1.8cm

SL. no.	Acc. No.	Object	Site	Material	Measurements
517	N.S. 3646/A 18	Pottery fragment: human face	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.53cm in ht
518	N.S. 3646/A 18206	Upper portion of a horse (?)	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.12cm ht.
519	N.S. 3646/A 18207	Pottery fragment grotesque human face	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.77 x 3.77cm
520	N.S. 3646/A 18208	Animal head	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.03cm in ht.
521	N.S. 3646/A 18210	Animal head	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.57cm in ht.
522	N.S. 3646/A 18211	Pottery fragment: conch shell	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.22 x 3.98cm
523	N.S. 3646/A 18212	Pottery fragment: grotesque human face	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.51 x 4.38cm
524	N.S. 3646/A 18214	Leg part of a monkey (?) seated on a pointed slab	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.45 x 2.09cm
525	N.S. 3646/A 18217	Pottery fragment: grotesque human face	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.37 x 3.51cm
526	N.S. 3646/A 18218	Pottery fragment: grotesque head of a monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.57 x 1.88cm
527	N.S. 3646/A 18219	Pottery fragment: lion face, grotesque damaged	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.6 x 2.43cm
528	N.S. 3646/A 18220	Pottery fragment: grotesque human face	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.35 x 2.98cm
529	N.S. 3646/A 20893	Pottery fragment: lion's head	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.2 x 4cm
530	N.S. 3646/A 20893	Pottery fragment: lion's head	Central Asia	Terracotta	7.3 x 5cm
531	N.S. 3647/A 18221	Pottery fragment: part of a human head	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.54 x 6.66cm
532	N.S. 3647/A 18222	Pottery fragment: animal motif	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.6cm long
533	N.S. 3647/A 18223	Pottery fragment: grotesque human head	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.46 x 3.74cm
534	N.S. 3647/A 18224	Curved pottery fragment	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.46 x 3.74cm
535	N.S. 3647/A 18225	Pottery fragment: human head	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.45 x 2.43cm
536	N.S. 3647/A 18226	Miniature vase	Central Asia	Terracotta	94 x 3.6cm
537	N.S. 3647/A 18227	Pottery fragment: animal head	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.3cm long
538	N.S. 3647/A 18228	Pottery fragment: grotesque animal face	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.37 x 2.93cm
539	N.S. 3647/A 18229	Pottery fragment: animal face	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.37 x 3.05cm
540	N.S. 3647/A 18230	Pottery fragment: animal head	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.26cm long
541	N.S. 3647/A 18231	Pottery fragment: animal face	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.15 x 1.68cm
542	N.S. 3647/A 18232	Pottery fragment: flower motif	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.33 x 2.29cm
543	N.S. 3647/A 18233	Pottery fragment: human head	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.64 x 2.38cm
544	N.S. 3647/A 18234	Pottery fragment: human head	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.24 x 2.4cm
545	N.S. 3647/A 18235	Animal head (broken)	Central Asia	Terracotta	1.65cm long
546	N.S. 3647/A 13711	Carved fragment	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.6 x 2.4cm
547	N.S. 3647/A 13713	Grotesque monkey damaged	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.6 x 1.2cm
548	N.S. 3647/A 13714	Miniature bird	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.2cm long
549	N.S. 3647/A 13715	Craved fragment	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.6 x 1.7cm
550	N.S. 3647/A 13725	Grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.1 x 1.9cm
551	N.S. 3647/A 13737	Miniature bird	Central Asia	Terracotta	3cm long
552	N.S. 3647/A 13738	Spindle whorl? (bead?)	Central Asia	Terracotta	
553	N.S. 3647/A 18221	Pottery fragment: part of a human head	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.54 x 6.66cm
554	N.S. 3651/A 13716	Miniature bird (Hopi)	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.9cm long
555	N.S. 3651/A 13717	Miniature bird	Central Asia	Terracotta	2cm long
556	N.S. 3651/A 13718	Head of a monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.3 x 1.4cm
557	N.S. 3651/A 13720	Grotesque monkey legs broken	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.4 x 2.2cm
558	N.S. 3651/A 18178	Crocodile head	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.5cm long
559	N.S. 3651/A 18179	Sculptural fragment	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.42cm long
560	N.S. 3651/A 18238	Pottery fragment: human face	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.96 x 3.94cm
561	N.S. 3651/A 18239	Pottery fragment: face of a monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.51 x 2.31cm
562	N.S. 3651/A 18240	Pottery fragment: human face, nose damaged	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.51 x 3.2cm
563	N.S. 3652/A 13719	Grotesque monkeys embracing each other	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.6 x 1.5cm
564	N.S. 3654/A 18177	Seal with floral design	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.06 x 2.97cm
565	N.S. 3656/A 18241	Human head	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.13 x 2.6cm
566	N.S. 3656/A 18242	Crocodile head	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.9cm long
567	N.S. 3656/A 18243	Miniature horse	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.66cm long
568	N.S. 3656/A 18244	Camel head	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.95cm in ht.
569	N.S. 3656/A 18246	Head of miniature horse?	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.43 x 2.3cm
570	N.S. 3656/A 18247	Grotesque monkey playing on an instrument	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.3cm in ht.
571	N.S. 3656/A 18248	Fragment of a human body	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.89cm .in ht.
572	N.S. 3656/A 18249	Bust of a grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.34cm in ht.
573	N.S. 3656/A 18251	Human head	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.2cm in ht.
574	N.S. 3656/A 18252	Fragment of a miniature bird	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.3cm long

SL. no.	Acc. No.	Object	Site	Material	Measurements
575	N.S. 3656/A 18253	Bust of monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	1.85cm in ht.
576	N.S. 3656/A 18254	Pottery fragment: human face	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.93 x 3.32cm
577	N.S. 3656/A 13722	Grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.6 x 3cm
578	N.S. 3656/A 13723	Grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	7 x 3.5cm
579	N.S. 3656/A 13724	Grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.1 x 2.7cm
580	N.S. 3656/A 13725	Grotesque monkey (broken)	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.3 x 2.7cm
581	N.S. 3656/A 13726	Bust of a grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	1.1 x 0.9cm
582	N.S. 3656/A 13727	Grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.4 x 1.5cm
583	N.S. 3656/A 13728	Grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.1 x 1.5cm
584	N.S. 3656/A 13729	Grotesque monkey joined together having hood & wings	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.2 x 1.8cm
585	N.S. 3656/A 18250	Bust of a grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.54cm in ht.
586	N.S. 3658/A 19261	Miniature monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.16cm in ht.
587	N.S. 3658/A 19262	Miniature monkey, kneeling	Central Asia	Terracotta	1.78cm in ht.
588	N.S. 3658/A 19263	Grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.4cm in ht.
589	N.S. 3658/A 19264	Miniature grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.63cm in ht.
590	N.S. 3658/A 19265	Grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.16cm in ht.
591	N.S. 3658/A 13731	Grotesque monkeys, embracing each other	Central Asia	Terracotta	5 x 2.2cm
592	N.S. 3658/A 13733	Miniature bird	Central Asia	Terracotta	3cm long
593	N.S. 3658/A 13734	Bust of a grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.9 x 2.5cm
594	N.S. 3658/A 13736	Miniature grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.2 x 1.3cm
595	N.S. 3662/A 19139	Buddha	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.32cm in ht.
596	N.S. 3668/A 19126	Relief fragment: human torso	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.36 x 2.13cm
597	N.S. 3671/A 20952	Pair of miniature shoes joined together	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.8 x 4cm
598	N.S. 3673/A 18255	Part of an animal face	Central Asia	Terracotta	8cm long
599	N.S. 3673/A 18256	Fore part of an animal	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.32 x 5.52cm
600	N.S. 3673/A 18257	Part of an animal	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.8cm long
601	N.S. 3673/A 18258	Pottery fragment: animal face	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.7 x 3.46cm
602	N.S. 3673/A 18259	Animal head (horse?)	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.37cm long
603	N.S. 3673/A 18260	Pottery fragment: grotesque human face	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.42 x 3cm
604	N.S. 3673/A 18261	Pottery fragment: animal face	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.32cm long
605	N.S. 3673/A 18262	Pottery fragment: human face	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.71 x 3.1cm
606	N.S. 3673/A 18263	Pottery fragment: face of lion	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.23 x 3.7cm
607	N.S. 3673/A 18264	Human Head	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.23cm long
608	N.S. 3673/A 18265	Pottery fragment: grotesque human face	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.58 x 3.13cm
609	N.S. 3673/A 18951	Pottery fragment: human face	Central Asia	Terracotta	9.2cm long
610	N.S. 3673/A 13739	Grotesque monkey (damaged)	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.6 x 2cm
611	N.S. 3673/A 13740	Relief fragment: part of a flower	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.2 x 3cm
612	N.S. 3673/A 13741	Piece of a pottery showing bird's wing	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.7 x 4.5cm
613	N.S. 3673/A 20881	Light red ware potsherd: standing male in low relief	Central Asia	Terracotta	8.4 x 4.3cm
614	N.S. 3673/A 20887	Head of a monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.8 x 4cm
615	N.S. 3673/A 20947	Red ware potsherd: leonine head	Central Asia	Terracotta	8.1 x 6.2cm
616	N.S. 3674/A 18266	Human head	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.37cm in ht.
617	N.S. 3674/A 18267	Grotesque human head	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.5cm in ht.
618	N.S. 3674/A 18268	Human face, damaged	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.37cm in ht.
619	N.S. 3674/A 18269	Animal head (dog?)	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.8cm in ht.
620	N.S. 3674/A 18270	Animal head (monkey)	Central Asia	Terracotta	5cm in ht.
621	N.S. 3674/A 18271	Miniature horse, head and upper portion of the rider missing	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.81 x 5.1cm
622	N.S. 3674/A 18272	Miniature camel, headless	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.9 x 4.92cm
623	N.S. 3674/A 18273	Pottery fragment: grotesque lion's face, damaged	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.07 x 6.04cm
624	N.S. 3674/A 18274	Face of a monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	5.01cm in ht.
625	N.S. 3674/A 18275	Camel (?) head	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.18cm in ht.
626	N.S. 3674/A 18276	Miniature camel, head and hind legs broken	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.32 x 5.52cm
627	N.S. 3674/A 13743	Fragment of a grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.5 x 2cm
628	N.S. 3674/A 20872	Buff red potsherd: head and bust of a male wearing a turban	Central Asia	Terracotta	8.7 x 7.4cm
629	N.S. 3674/A 20932	Pottery fragment: horse head (probably handle of a vessel)	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.7 x 4.2cm
630	N.S. 3674/A 20937	Pottery fragment: horse or lion (probably handle of a vessel)	Central Asia	Terracotta	7.2 x 3.6cm

SL. no.	Acc. No.	Object	Site	Material	Measurements
631	N.S. 3674/A 20943	Pottery fragment: spout of a vessel shaped like and animal	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.7 x 3.9cm
632	N.S. 3675/A 18277	Human body	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.32 x 5.52cm
633	N.S. 3675/A 18278	Sculptured fragment: a hand and part of a human body	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.08cm in ht.
634	N.S. 3675/A 18279	Pottery fragment: grotesque human face	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.92 x 3.65cm
635	N.S. 3675/A 18280	Animal head	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.53cm in ht.
636	N.S. 3675/A 18281	Sculptured fragment	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.32 x 5.52cm
637	N.S. 3675/A 18282	Animal head	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.33cm in ht.
638	N.S. 3675/A 18283	Upper portion of a monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	3cm in ht.
639	N.S. 3675/A 19260	Bowl base	Central Asia	Terracotta	7.26cm in ht.
640	N.S. 3675/A 13744	Pottery fragment: carved	Central Asia	Terracotta	7.2 x 7.9cm
641	N.S. 3675/A 13745	Pottery fragment: handle with a perforation	Central Asia	Terracotta	8.2cm long
642	N.S. 3675/A 13746	Slab: carved with a grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.8 x 2cm
643	N.S. 3675/A 13747	Pottery fragment: leafy design	Central Asia	Terracotta	4.9 x 3.4cm
644	N.S. 3675/A 13748	Pottery fragment: carved	Central Asia	Terracotta	6.7 x 4.9cm
645	N.S. 3675/A 20883	Head of a monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	6 x 5.8cm
646	N.S. 3676/A 20876	Pottery fragment: squatting human figure	Central Asia	Terracotta	17.7 x 9.6cm
647	N.S. 3678/A 19071	Elongated object	Central Asia	Terracotta	1.3cm long
648	N.S.3646/A 18216	Pottery fragment: grotesque human face	Central Asia	Terracotta	3.75 x 3.44cm
649	N.S.3647/A13690	Owl-faced grotesque monkey, damaged	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.6 x 1.6cm
650	N.S.3658/A13732	Owl-faced grotesque monkey	Central Asia	Terracotta	2.9 x 1.2cm
651	N.S.3674/A 20936	Pottery fragment: horse head (probably handle of a vessel)	Central Asia	Terracotta	7.3 x 5cm
652	N.S. 2009/A 19194	Stone fragment	Dandan Uiliq		1.5 x 1cm long
653	N.S. 2009/A 19195	Piece of stone	Dandan Uiliq		1.5 x 1.3cm
654	N.S. 2009/A 19196	Metal fragment	Dandan Uiliq		2.35cm long
655	N.S. 2009/A 19197	Metal fragment	Dandan Uiliq		2.16cm long
656	N.S. 2009/A 19198	Metal fragment	Dandan Uiliq		1.8cm long
657	N.S. 2009/A 19198	Metal fragment	Dandan Uiliq		2.1 x 1.8cm
658	N.S. 2009/A 19199	Metal fragment	Dandan Uiliq		2.8cm long
659	N.S. 2009/A 19200	Metal fragment	Dandan Uiliq		2.13cm long
660	N.S. 2009/A 19201	Metal fragment	Dandan Uiliq		2.5cm long
661	N.S. 2009/A 19202	Metal fragment	Dandan Uiliq		1.45cm long
662	N.S. 2009/A 19203	Metal fragment	Dandan Uiliq		1.9cm long
663	N.S. 2009/A 19204	Metal fragment	Dandan Uiliq		1.97cm long
664	N.S. 2009/A 19205	Metal fragment	Dandan Uiliq		3.23cm long
665	N.S. 2009/A 19206	Metal fragment	Dandan Uiliq		2.4cm long
666	N.S. 2009/A 19207	Metal fragment	Dandan Uiliq		1.82cm long
667	N.S. 2009/A 19208	Metal fragment	Dandan Uiliq		1.8cm long
668	N.S. 2009/A 19209	Metal fragment	Dandan Uiliq		2.1cm long
669	N.S. 2009/A 19210	Metal fragment	Dandan Uiliq		1.13cm long
670	N.S. 2009/A 19211	Metal fragment	Dandan Uiliq		1.234 x 1.23cm
671	N.S. 2009/A 19212	Metal fragment	Dandan Uiliq		1cm long
672	N.S. 2009/A 19213	Metal fragment	Dandan Uiliq		1.62cm long
673	N.S. 2009/A 19214	Metal fragment	Dandan Uiliq		1.7cm long
674	N.S. 2009/A 19215	Metal fragment	Dandan Uiliq		1.2cm long
675	N.S. 2009/A 19216	Metal fragment	Dandan Uiliq		1.1cm long
676	N.S. 2009/A 19217	Metal fragment	Dandan Uiliq		1.5cm long
677	N.S. 2009/A 19218	Metal fragment	Dandan Uiliq		1.16 x 0.99cm
678	N.S. 2009/A 19219	Metal fragment	Dandan Uiliq		1.2cm long
679	N.S. 2009/A 19220	Metal fragment	Dandan Uiliq		1. 25cm long
680	N.S. 2009/A 19221	Metal fragment	Dandan Uiliq		1.2cm long
681	N.S. 2009/A 19222	Metal fragment	Dandan Uiliq		1cm long
682	N.S. 2009/A 19223	Metal fragment	Dandan Uiliq		1cm long
683	N.S. 2009/A 19224	Metal fragment	Dandan Uiliq		1.24cm long
684	N.S. 2009/A 19225	Metal fragment	Dandan Uiliq		0.94cm long
685	N.S. 2001/A 19180	Spoon (damaged)	Dandan Uiliq	Copper	8.82cm long
686	N.S. 2009/A 19192	Bead	Dandan Uiliq	Faience	1.3cm in
687	N.S. 2009/A 19191	Pebble	Dandan Uiliq	Stone	1.95 x 1.7cm
688	N.S. 2009/A 19193	Bead	Dandan Uiliq	Stone	1.37cm in

SL. no.	Acc. No.	Object	Site	Material	Measurements
689	N.S. 1672/A 13477	Relief fragment: upper portion of a standing Buddha	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	10 x 8cm
690	N.S. 1673/A 13742	Relief fragment: torso of Buddha	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	6.5 x 5cm
691	N.S. 1676/A 13490	Relief fragment showing torso of Buddha	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	10.5 x 6cm
692	N.S. 1677/A 13478	Relief fragment showing headless Buddha	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	9.5 x 5.5cm
693	N.S. 1678/A 13479	Relief fragment showing headless Buddha	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	14.5 x 8cm
694	N.S. 1683/A 13483	Relief fragment: Buddha, feet missing	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	16.5 x 13cm
695	N.S. 1686/A 13485	Relief fragment: torso of Buddha	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	7.5 x 5cm
696	N.S. 1694/A 13487	Relief fragment: standing Buddha	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	13 x 9.5cm
697	N.S. 1695/A 13488	Relief fragment showing standing Buddha	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	19 x 10.5cm
698	N.S. 1699/A 20866	Relief fragment: torso of Buddha	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	14 x 8.7cm
699	N.S. 1702/A 12753	Relief fragment: standing Buddha	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	16.5 x 12cm
700	N.S. 1703/A 13412	Relief fragment showing seated Buddha figure	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	12.5 x 10.5cm
701	N.S. 1704/A 13413	Relief fragment showing bust of Buddha	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	8 x 4.5cm
702	N.S. 1705/A 13414	Relief fragment showing seated Buddha	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	15.5 x 9.4cm
703	N.S. 1708/A 13717	Relief fragment showing seated Buddha figure	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	12.5 x 10cm
704	N.S. 1709/A 13418	Relief fragment – standing Buddha in abhaya mudra	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	19 x 10cm
705	N.S. 1710/A 19401	Nine pieces of relief fragments: standing Buddha in abhaya	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	Different sizes
706	N.S. 1711/A 20869	Relief fragment: standing Buddha	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	17 x 7.5cm
707	N.S. 1712/A 13425	Relief fragment showing head of Buddha	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	6 x 5.5cm
708	N.S. 1714/ A13420	Relief fragment – standing Buddha in abhaya mudra	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	16.5 x 9.5cm
709	N.S. 1716/A 13421	Relief fragment showing head of Buddha	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	4.3 x 5.5cm
710	N.S. 1717/A 13423	Relief fragment showing head of Buddha	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	5.5 x 4.5cm
711	N.S. 1718/A 13424	Relief fragment showing head of Buddha	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	5 x 4cm
712	N.S. 1720/A 13426	Relief fragment showing head of Buddha	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	5 x 4.5cm
713	N.S. 1721/A 13427	Relief fragment showing head of Buddha	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	6 x 4.5cm
714	N.S. 1722/A 13428	Relief fragment showing head of Buddha	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	6.2 x 5cm
715	N.S. 1723/A 13429	Relief fragment showing head of Buddha	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	5 x 4.5cm
716	N.S. 1724/A 13430	Relief fragment showing head of Buddha	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	5.5 x 4.5cm
717	N.S. 1725/A 13431	Relief fragment showing head of Buddha	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	6.4cm
718	N.S. 1725/A 13432	Relief fragment showing head of Buddha	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	6.4cm
719	N.S. 1726/A 13433	Relief fragment: head of Buddha	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	6 x 4cm
720	N.S. 1727/A 13413	Relief fragment showing head of Buddha	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	6 x 5cm
721	N.S. 1728/A 13435	Relief fragment showing torso of Buddha	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	15 x 6.5cm
722	N.S. 1729/A 13436	Relief fragment showing two standing Buddha figures	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	17 x 12cm
723	N.S. 1730/A 13390	Relief fragment: bust of Buddha	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	4.3 x 3.8cm
724	N.S. 1738/A 13391	Relief fragment showing head of Buddha	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	4.5 x 6cm
725	N.S. 1739/A 13392	Relief fragment showing headless figure seated on lotus	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	9.5 x 9cm
726	N.S. 1740/A 13393	Relief fragment showing petal border of aureol	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	8 x 6cm
727	N.S. 1741/A 13394	Relief fragment showing lotus-petal border of aureole	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	18 x 7.5cm
728	N.S. 1747/ A 13395	Fragment of an ornamental relief	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	6 x 4cm
729	N.S. 1748/A 13396	Relief fragment showing scroll work	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	5 x 4.5cm
730	N.S. 1750/A 13397	Relief fragment showing a lotus-petal	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	7 x 7cm
731	N.S. 1752/A 13402	Fragment of a stucco relief	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	7 x 2cm
732	N.S. 1752/A 13403	Fragment of a stucco relief	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	Slightly smaller than the above
733	N.S. 1752/A 13404	Fragment of a stucco relief	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	Slightly smaller than the above
734	N.S. 1753/A 13405	Relief fragments showing two rows of flames	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	Different shapes and sizes
735	N.S. 1754/A 13449	Fragment of a carved relief	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	7.5 x 5cm
736	N.S. 1756/A 13407	Four pieces of relief fragment showing torso of human figure rising from a lotus	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	10.5 x 6cm (size of the biggest fragment)
737	N.S. 1757/A 13408	Fragment of an ornamental relief	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	7 x 4.5cm
738	N.S. 1764/A 13439	Fragment of a carved relief	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	5.5 x 3cm
739	N.S. 1770/A 13442	Relief fragment depicting tongues of flame	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	8 x 7cm
740	N.S. 1770/A 13443	Relief fragment depicting tongues of flame	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	8 x 7cm
741	N.S. 1772/A 13445	Ornamental relief fragment	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	10 x 9.5cm
742	N.S. 1772/A 13446	Ornamental relief fragment	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	10 x 9.5cm

SL. no.	Acc. No.	Object	Site	Material	Measurements
743	N.S. 1774/A 13448	Ornamental relief fragment	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	8.4 x 5cm
744	N.S. 1775/A 13450	Ornamental relief fragment	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	11 x 5.5cm
745	N.S. 1776/A 13452	Relief fragment showing carvings	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	8 x 7cm
746	N.S. 1777/A 13451	Relief fragment with ornamental carvings	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	7.5 x 4.5cm
747	N.S. 1779/A 13454	Fragment of a carved relief	Dandan Uiliq	Stucco	5 x 4cm
748	N.S. 1685/A 13886	Torso (bust?) of a headless Buddha	Dandan Uiliq	Terracotta	6 x 5.5cm
749	N.S. 2053	Painted wooden board	Dandan Uiliq	Wood	
750	N.S. 2054/A 20962	Wooden board with five figures	Dandan Uiliq	Wood	48.6 x 12.7cm
751	N.S. 2055/A 20706	Wooden board: painted on one face	Dandan Uiliq	Wood	26.3 x 13.4cm
752	N.S. 2056/A 20967	Painted wooden board	Dandan Uiliq	Wood	26.7 x 14.5cm
753	N.S. 2057/A 20966	Painted wooden board	Dandan Uiliq	Wood	20.4 x 15.3cm
754	N.S. 2058/A 20964	Painted wooden board	Dandan Uiliq	Wood	19 x 12.8cm
755	N.S. 2060/A 19554	Wooden board	Dandan Uiliq	Wood	29.5 x 9.5cm
756	N.S. 2061/A 20963	Wooden board with traces of painting on one face	Dandan Uiliq	Wood	19 x 10.5cm
757	N.S. 1922/A 19240	Glazed potsherd	Endere	Coarse terracotta	1.54 x 1.8cm
758	N.S. 1956/A 14435	Three fragments of suspending ring	Endere	Copper	Different sizes
759	N.S. 2025/A 19694	Piece of printed cotton	Endere	Cotton	
760	N.S. 2025/A 19701	Three pieces of cloth	Endere	Cotton	
761	N.S. 2025/A 19700	Pieces of blue cotton cloth with a piece of silk fabric (four pieces)	Endere	Cotton and Silk	
762	N.S. 1921/A 19380	Piece of white glass	Endere	Glass	2.34 x 2.94cm
763	N.S. 1924/A 19242	Piece of pale green glass	Endere	Glass	2.73 x 2.21cm
764	N.S. 1930/ A 19099-108	Ten fragments of vessels	Endere	Glass	Different sizes
765	N.S. 1959/ A 19427-29	Three pieces of glass	Endere	Glass	Different shapes and sizes
766	N.S. 1942/ A 19158-19177	20 fragments of metal stone glass beads etc.	Endere	Metal, stone glass beads etc	Different shapes and sizes
767	N.S. 2023/A 13692	Pieces of paper drawing	Endere	Paper	Different shapes and sizes
768	N.S. 2023/A 19692	Two pieces of paper drawing	Endere	Paper	(i)13cm long; (ii)7.5 x 7.3cm
769	N.S. 2025/A 19699	Piece of silken cloth	Endere	Silk	
770	N.S. 2004/ A 19695-98	Silk and cotton cloth four small pieces	Endere	Silk and cotton	
771	N.S. 1735/A 19267	Relief fragment: crest of Buddha's headdress	Endere	Stucco	7.01cm in height
772	N.S. 1736/A 19268	Relief fragment: profile of Buddha and other carvings	Endere	Stucco	9.02 x 8.62cm
773	N.S. 1736/A 19269	Relief fragment: profile of Buddha and other carvings	Endere	Stucco	9.23 x 8.7cm
774	N.S. 1737/A 19402	Relief fragment: pierced portion of a human earlobe	Endere	Terracotta	-
775	N.S.1843/A 13835-36	Two fragments of human figures	Endere	Terracotta	Different sizes
776	N.S.1922/ A 19242	Piece of coarse terracotta with plate green glaze on one side	Endere	Terracotta	2.63 x 1.59cm
777	N.S. 1982/A 20926	Ear ornament	Hanguya Tati	-	2.1 x 2.6cm
778	N.S. 1949/A 19432	Bead	Hanguya Tati	Blue Glass	1.22cm long
779	N.S. 1985/A 19437	Torso of a human figure	Hanguya Tati	Bronze	3.27 x 2.64cm
780	N.S. 1966/A 19433	Ring with seal (broken)	Hanguya Tati	Copper	2.7 x 2.17cm
781	N.S. 1909/A 19109	Tubular bead	Hanguya Tati	Glass	1.5cm long
782	N.S. 1908/A 19235	Finger ring	Hanguya Tati	Steatite	1.67cm in
783	N.S. 1910/A 19110	Fragment of a multi-facetted bead	Hanguya Tati	Stone	1.2cm long
784	N.S. 1836/A 13831	Fragment of red clay vessel	Jumbe-kum	Terracotta	5.5 x 4.53cm
785	N.S. 1848/A 13840	Piece of dark grey pottery	Jumbe-kum	Terracotta	6.5 x 5.5cm
786	N.S. 1755/A 13406	Fragment of an ornamental relief	Kara-dobe	Stucco	7 x 3cm
787	N.S. 1919/A 19239	Piece of glass	Karadong	Glass	5.7cm long
788	N.S. 1974/A 19439	Arrow head	Karadong	Iron	4.95cm long
789	N.S. 1983/A 19442	Bead drilled in centre	Karadong	Metal	1.6 x 1.5cm
790	N.S. 1961/ A 19094-98	Metal pin and some glass fragments	Karadong	Metal and Glass	Different shapes and sizes
791	N.S. 1838/A 13832	Fragment of a vessel	Karadong	Terracotta	3.5 x 2.5cm
792	N.S. 1828/A 13826	Bottom of a rough pottery	Keriya	Terracotta	4.5cm in ht.
793	N.S. 2052/A 19251	Almond	Khotan	Almond	2.52cm
794	N.S. 1965/A 20927	Miniature seal	Khotan	Bronze	1.7cm in ht.

SL. no.	Acc. No.	Object	Site	Material	Measurements
795	N.S. 1975/A 19179	Seated Ganesa (?)	Khotan	Bronze	2.37 x 2.37cm
796	N.S. 1977/A 19441	Seal	Khotan	Bronze	1.87 x 1.72cm
797	N.S. 1998/A 19447	Square seal (handle broken)	Khotan	Bronze	2.58 x 2.57cm
798	N.S. 2400/A 19483	Octagonal seal	Khotan	Copper	2.22cm in ht.
799	N.S. 1926/A 19341	Piece of glass	Khotan	Glass	
800	N.S. 1926/A 19342	Piece of glass	Khotan	Glass	
801	N.S. 1926/A 19343	Piece of glass	Khotan	Glass	
802	N.S. 1926/A 19344	Piece of glass	Khotan	Glass	
803	N.S. 1926/A 19345	Piece of glass	Khotan	Glass	
804	N.S. 1926/A 19346	Piece of glass	Khotan	Glass	
805	N.S. 1926/A 19347	Piece of glass	Khotan	Glass	
806	N.S. 1926/A 19348	Piece of glass	Khotan	Glass	
807	N.S. 1926/A 19349	Piece of glass	Khotan	Glass	
808	N.S. 1926/A 19350	Piece of glass	Khotan	Glass	
809	N.S. 1926/A 19351	Piece of glass	Khotan	Glass	
810	N.S. 1926/A 19352	Piece of glass	Khotan	Glass	
811	N.S. 1926/A 19353	Piece of glass	Khotan	Glass	
812	N.S. 1926/A 19354	Piece of glass	Khotan	Glass	
813	N.S. 1926/A 19355	Piece of glass	Khotan	Glass	
814	N.S. 1926/A 19356	Piece of glass	Khotan	Glass	
815	N.S. 1926/A 19357	Piece of glass	Khotan	Glass	
816	N.S. 1926/A 19358	Piece of glass	Khotan	Glass	
817	N.S. 1926/A 19359	Piece of glass	Khotan	Glass	
818	N.S. 1926/A 19360	Piece of glass	Khotan	Glass	
819	N.S. 1926/A 19361	Piece of glass	Khotan	Glass	
820	N.S. 1926/A 19362	Piece of glass	Khotan	Glass	
821	N.S. 1926/A 19363	Piece of glass	Khotan	Glass	
822	N.S. 1926/A 19364	Piece of glass	Khotan	Glass	
823	N.S. 1926/A 19365	Piece of glass	Khotan	Glass	
824	N.S. 1926/A 19366	Piece of glass	Khotan	Glass	
825	N.S. 1926/A 19367	Piece of glass	Khotan	Glass	
826	N.S. 1926/A 19368	Piece of glass	Khotan	Glass	
827	N.S. 1926/A 19369	Piece of glass	Khotan	Glass	
828	N.S. 1926/A 19370	Piece of glass	Khotan	Glass	
829	N.S. 1929/A 19416	Glass bead (broken)	Khotan	Glass	0.81cm long
830	N.S. 1938/A 19243	Bead	Khotan	Glass	1.76cm long
831	N.S. 1999/A 19418	Metal fragment	Khotan	Iron	-
832	N.S. 1999/A 19419	Metal fragment	Khotan	Iron	-
833	N.S. 1999/A 19420	Metal fragment	Khotan	Iron	-
834	N.S. 1999/A 19421	Metal fragment	Khotan	Iron	-
835	N.S. 1870/ A 1313863	Potsherd	Khotan	Red clay	4.5 x 4cm
836	N.S. 1906/A 19233	Fragment of standing figure	Khotan	Steatite	5.42cm long
837	N.S. 1907/A 19234	Human head	Khotan	Steatite	3.6cm long
838	N.S. 1916/A 19237	Seated monkey	Khotan	Steatite	2.65cm in ht.
839	N.S. 1957/A 19430	Fragment	Khotan	Steatite	4.9cm long
840	N.S. 1957/A 19430	Fragment	Khotan	Steatite	2.38cm long
841	N.S. 1903/A 13891	Buddha in dharma chakra	Khotan	Stone	5.5cm in ht.
842	N.S. 1700/A 13411	Relief fragment showing standing Buddha	Khotan	Stucco	1.6 x 75.5cm
843	N.S. 1879/A 13871	Fragment of pottery showing a dog's face	Khotan	Stucco	3.5 x 3cm
844	N.S. 1880/A 13472	Piece of pottery showing human face	Khotan	Stucco	4 x 3.5cm
845	N.S. 2010/A 19460	Relief fragment (burnt black)	Khotan	Stucco	9.08 x 6.94cm
846	N.S. 1794/A 13471	Miniature monkey climbing a pillar	Khotan	Terracotta	3 x 2.5cm
847	N.S. 1795/A 13472	Miniature grotesque monkey	Khotan	Terracotta	6 x 2cm
848	N.S. 1805/A 13808	Grotesque monkey	Khotan	Terracotta	4cm in ht.
849	N.S. 1830/A 20889	Dull red ware potsherd with appliqué relief.	Khotan	Terracotta	5.3 x 4cm
850	N.S. 1852/A 20894	Light red ware potsherd with appliqué relief	Khotan	Terracotta	6.5 x 4.5cm
851	N.S. 1855/A 20940	Neck piece of a reddish buff ware vessel	Khotan	Terracotta	6.5cm in ht.
852	N.S. 1876/A 20885	Grotesque human head	Khotan	Terracotta	6.4 x 4.3cm
853	N.S. 1882/A 13874	Head of a crocodile	Khotan	Terracotta	5.5cm long

SL. no.	Acc. No.	Object	Site	Material	Measurements
854	N.S. 1958/A 19247	Potsherd	Khotan	Terracotta	3.57 x 2.64cm
855	N.S. 1958/A 19248	Potsherd	Khotan	Terracotta	3.76 x 3.11cm
856	N.S. 1679/A 20875	Torso of Buddha	Kighillik	Stucco	13 x 12cm
857	N.S. 1680/A 13480	Relief fragment: sanghati	Kighillik	Stucco	6 x 7cm
858	N.S. 1681/A 13481	Fragment of sculpture showing robe of Buddha	Kighillik	Stucco	9 x 6.5cm
859	N.S. 1682/A 13482	Fragment of sculpture showing robe of Buddha	Kighillik	Stucco	6 .5 x 6cm
860	N.S. 1684/A 13484	Relief fragment showing torso of Buddha figure.	Kighillik	Stucco	7.5 x 4.5cm
861	N.S. 1697/A 13489	Fragment of a relief showing right hand of a Buddha figure.	Kighillik	Stucco	7 x 3cm
862	N.S. 1706/A 13415	Sculptural fragment: sanghati	Kighillik	Stucco	4.5 x 5cm
863	N.S. 1707/A 13410	Relief fragment: right hand of a human figure	Kighillik	Stucco	6.5 x 2.5cm
864	N.S. 1731/A 19266	Relief fragment: upper half of Buddha head	Kighillik	Stucco	6 x 5cm
865	N.S. 1751/A 13400	Fragment of stucco relief	Kighillik	Stucco	4 x 3cm
866	N.S. 1751/A 13401	Fragment of stucco relief	Kighillik	Stucco	Smaller than 4 x 3cm
867	N.S. 1758/A 13409	Fragment of a nimbus	Kighillik	Stucco	5.5 x 3.5cm
868	N.S. 1759/A 13398	Fragment of an ornamental relief	Kighillik	Stucco	4.5 x 2cm
869	N.S. 1761/A 13410	Fragment of carved relief	Kighillik	Stucco	2.5 x 1.5cm
870	N.S. 1761/A 13438	Fragment of carved relief	Kighillik	Stucco	2.5 x 1.5cm
871	N.S. 1762/A 13437	Relief fragment: wrist of a human (Buddha) figure	Kighillik	Stucco	3 x 2.5cm
872	N.S. 1763/A 13888	Relief fragment: part of aureole (?)	Kighillik	Stucco	2 x 1.75cm
873	N.S. 1769/A 13440	Fragment of a nimbus	Kighillik	Stucco	6 x 4.5cm
874	N.S. 1778/A 13453	Fragment of a carved relief	Kighillik	Stucco	4 x 2.75cm
875	N.S. 1780/A 13455	Fragment of a carved relief	Kighillik	Stucco	7.5 x 3.5cm
876	N.S. 1780/A 13456	Fragment of a carved relief	Kighillik	Stucco	7.5 x 3.5cm
877	N.S. 1822/A 13821	Relief fragment showing portion of the drapery of a Buddha figure	Kighillik	Stucco	4.5 x 3cm
878	N.S. 1823/A 13822	Relief fragment: part of nimbus	Kighillik	Stucco	5.5 x 2.5cm
879	N.S. 1861/A 13850	Set of teeth of human figure?	Kighillik	Stucco	3 x 2.5cm
880	N.S. 1891/A 13879	Relief fragment: portion of a nimbus	Kighillik	Stucco	4.5 x 2cm
881	N.S. 1904/A 14053	Relief fragment: robe portion of a Buddha figure	Kighillik	Stucco	5 x 4cm
882	N.S. 1844/A 13837	Piece of red pottery	Kighillik	Terracotta	7.5 x 5.55cm
883	N.S. 1853/A 13844	Fragment of a green glazed vessel	Kighillik	Terracotta	2 x 1.75cm
884	N.S. 1865/A 13856	Red clay potsherds	Kighillik	Terracotta	Different sizes
885	N.S. 1865/A 13857	Red clay potsherds	Kighillik	Terracotta	Different sizes
886	N.S. 2299/A 14055	Piece of pottery, hollowed with carving	Khotan, near	Clay	14.5 X 9cm
887	N.S. 2319/A 20926	Crescent shaped seal	Khotan, near	Copper	2.7 x 2cm
888	N.S. 2320/A 20924	Rectangular seal	Khotan, near	Copper	2.9 x 1.6cm
889	N.S. 2321/A 20925	Crescent shape seal	Khotan, near	Copper	3.5 x 2cm
890	N.S. 2300/A 19253	Piece of Stick	Khotan, near	Ivory	5.35cm
891	N.S. 2315/A 20921	Miniature cup	Khotan, near	Steatite	2.8cm in height
892	N.S. 2301/A 19252	Small comb	Khotan, near	Terracotta	6cm long
893	N.S. 2302/A 13491	Grotesque monkey	Khotan, near	Terracotta	5 x 3.5cm
894	N.S. 2303/A 13492	Pottery fragment: human face	Khotan, near	Terracotta	5 x 3.5cm
895	N.S. 2304/A 13493	Pottery fragment: female bust	Khotan, near	Terracotta	5 x 3.5cm
896	N.S. 2305/A 13502	Pottery fragment: grotesque human face	Khotan, near	Terracotta	5 x 3.5cm
897	N.S. 2306/A 13494	Pottery fragment	Khotan, near	Terracotta	5 x 3.5cm
898	N.S. 2307/A 13495	Fragment of an animal head	Khotan, near	Terracotta	4.5 x 3cm
899	N.S. 2308/A 13496	Pottery fragment: grotesque animal head	Khotan, near	Terracotta	5 x 4cm
900	N.S. 2309/A 13533	Miniature camel	Khotan, near	Terracotta	8 x 6.5cm
901	N.S. 2310/A 13497	Miniature camel	Khotan, near	Terracotta	3 x 2.5cm
902	N.S. 2311/A 13498	Pottery fragment: human face	Khotan, near	Terracotta	5 x 3.5cm
903	N.S. 2312/A 13499	Human face	Khotan, near	Terracotta	4 x 3cm
904	N.S. 2313/A 13755	Pottery fragment: human face	Khotan, near	Terracotta	3.5 x 2.5cm
905	N.S. 2314/A 20923	Bead having the shape of a betel nut	Khotan, near	Terracotta	2.3cm in ht.
906	N.S. 2316/A 13500	Pottery fragment: human figure	Khotan, near	Terracotta	5 x 3.5cm
907	N.S. 2317/A 13501	Pottery fragment: camel head	Khotan, near	Terracotta	3 x 2.5cm
908	N.S. 2318/A 13623	Piece of design of pottery camel head	Khotan, near	Terracotta	3 x 2cm
909	N.S. 2359/A 13658	Headless miniature monkey	Khotan, near	Terracotta	3cm long
910	N.S. 2360/A 13659	Miniature monkey, kneeling (hands & feet missing)	Khotan, near	Terracotta	3cm long
911	N.S. 2361/A 13667	Bust of a miniature monkey	Khotan, near	Terracotta	1.5cm long
912	N.S. 2362/A 13660	Bust of a miniature monkey	Khotan, near	Terracotta	2cm long

SL. no.	Acc. No.	Object	Site	Material	Measurements
913	N.S. 2363/A 13661	Bust of a miniature monkey	Khotan, near	Terracotta	2.75cm in height
914	N.S. 2364/A 13662	Bust of a miniature monkey with left hand holding something	Khotan, near	Terracotta	2cm long
915	N.S. 2365/A 13663	Bust of a miniature monkey	Khotan, near	Terracotta	1.5cm long
916	N.S. 2366/A 13664	Bust of a miniature monkey	Khotan, near	Terracotta	2cm long
917	N.S. 2367/A 13665	Miniature female monkey	Khotan, near	Terracotta	1.5cm long
918	N.S. 2369/A 13666	Miniature monkey	Khotan, near	Terracotta	2cm long
919	N.S. 2370/A 13668	Bust of a miniature monkey	Khotan, near	Terracotta	1.5cm long
920	N.S. 2371/A 13671	Miniature monkey seated with closed hands	Khotan, near	Terracotta	1cm long
921	N.S. 2373/A 13670	Miniature monkey	Khotan, near	Terracotta	2.75cm long
922	N.S. 2374/A 13672	Miniature monkey with closed hands	Khotan, near	Terracotta	4cm long
923	N.S. 2375/A 13673	Miniature owl-faced monkey	Khotan, near	Terracotta	2.5cm long
924	N.S. 2376/A 13674	Miniature monkey with hands on its breasts	Khotan, near	Terracotta	3.5cm long
925	N.S. 2377/A 13677	Miniature monkey, with hands on its mouth	Khotan, near	Terracotta	2.5cm long
926	N.S. 2512/A 13598	Pottery fragment: female head	Khotan, near	Terracotta	10 x 7cm
927	N.S. 2513/A 13591	Pottery fragment	Khotan, near	Terracotta	5.5cm in height
928	N.S. 2514/A 13600	Pottery fragment: 6 circular marks	Khotan, near	Terracotta	6cm long
929	N.S. 2515/A 13601	Pottery fragment: tussle design	Khotan, near	Terracotta	3.5 x 3cm
930	N.S. 2516/A 13602	Pottery fragment, ornamental	Khotan, near	Terracotta	5 x 3.5cm
931	N.S. 2517/A 13603	Fragment: tortoise	Khotan, near	Terracotta	6.5 x 3.5cm
932	N.S. 2518/A 13604	Triangular piece	Khotan, near	Terracotta	4 x 3.5cm
933	N.S. 2520/A 13605	Seated monkey engaged on strings	Khotan, near	Terracotta	5.5 x 4.5cm
934	N.S. 2521/A 13606	Miniature monkey holding something in its two hands	Khotan, near	Terracotta	5cm long
935	N.S. 2522/A 13607	Head of a female figure with a pig-tail	Khotan, near	Terracotta	6.4cm long
936	N.S. 2523/A 13608	Head of a bull	Khotan, near	Terracotta	4 x 3.5cm
937	N.S. 2524/A 13609	Head of a goat	Khotan, near	Terracotta	2.5 x 2cm
938	N.S. 2525/A 13612	Bust of a dog	Khotan, near	Terracotta	3cm long
939	N.S. 2526/A 20938	Caparisoned ram	Khotan, near	Terracotta	8.4cm long
940	N.S. 2527/A 13611	Miniature camel	Khotan, near	Terracotta	7 x 6cm
941	N.S. 2528/A 20935	Fragmentary horse: probably handle of a vessel	Khotan, near	Terracotta	6.4 x 4.1cm
942	N.S. 2529/A 13612	Fragment of a miniature camel	Khotan, near	Terracotta	5.5cm long
943	N.S. 2530/A 13613	Head of a lady	Khotan, near	Terracotta	3 x 2.5cm
944	N.S. 2531/A 13614	Pottery fragment of female head	Khotan, near	Terracotta	4 x 3.5cm
945	N.S. 2532/A 13615	Female head	Khotan, near	Terracotta	6 x 4cm
946	N.S. 2533/A 13616	Human head	Khotan, near	Terracotta	2 x 3cm
947	N.S. 2534/A 13617	Human head of grotesque tiger	Khotan, near	Terracotta	3 x 2.5cm
948	N.S. 2535/A 13618	Pottery fragments of tiger's head	Khotan, near	Terracotta	3 x 2cm
949	N.S. 2536/A 13619	Pottery fragment of goat(?) head	Khotan, near	Terracotta	4 x 3cm
950	N.S. 2537/A 13620	Grotesque human head	Khotan, near	Terracotta	5.5 x 4cm
951	N.S. 2538/A 13621	Grotesque human head	Khotan, near	Terracotta	3.2 x 2.5cm
952	N.S. 2540/A 13623	Pottery fragment: grotesque human head	Khotan, near	Terracotta	7 x 6cm
953	N.S. 2541/A 13628	Pottery fragments of monkey head	Khotan, near	Terracotta	3 x 3cm
954	N.S. 2542/A 13625	Pottery fragment: grotesque monkey head	Khotan, near	Terracotta	2.5cm long
955	N.S. 2543/A 20946	Red ware potsherd of fine fabric: garland bearer (appliqué)	Khotan, near	Terracotta	6.5 x 4.8cm
956	N.S. 2544/A 13626	Fragment: animal head	Khotan, near	Terracotta	6 x 5cm
957	N.S. 2545/A 13627	Pottery fragment of animal head	Khotan, near	Terracotta	5 x 3.5cm
958	N.S. 2546/A 13628	Pottery fragment: tiger's head	Khotan, near	Terracotta	6.2 x 6cm
959	N.S. 2547/A 13629	Pottery fragment: human head	Khotan, near	Terracotta	7 x 6cm
960	N.S. 2548/A 13630	Grotesque human head	Khotan, near	Terracotta	3.5 x 3.3cm
961	N.S. 2549/A 13631	Grotesque human head	Khotan, near	Terracotta	4 x 3.5cm
962	N.S. 3272/A 13669	Miniature monkey, broken	Khotan, near	Terracotta	4.5cm long
963	N.S.2539/A 13622	Pottery fragment: monkey head	Khotan, near	Terracotta	2 x 2cm
964	N.S. 1937/A 19111	Piece of Chinese ink	Niya site		
965	N.S. 2030/A 19273	Wings of bird	Niya site		21.5cm long is the largest
966	N.S. 1933/A 19414	Small flower with 6 petals	Niya site	Bone	1.28 x 1.18cm
967	N.S. 1954/A 19445	Thin piece of bronze with a nail	Niya site	Bronze	1.64 x 1.31cm
968	N.S. 1968/A 19435	Seal handle broken	Niya site	Bronze	2.51 x 2.57cm
969	N.S. 1979/A 19440	Ring with seal	Niya site	Bronze	2 x 1.81cm

SL. no.	Acc. No.	Object	Site	Material	Measurements
970	N.S. 1991/A 19446	Conve x ornamental disc with perforation & scalloped edge	Niya site	Bronze	1.89cm in diam.
971	N.S. 1996/A 19448	Ring with plain seal (broken into two)	Niya site	Bronze	2.1cm in dia.
972	N.S.1953/A 19376	Seal with perforation	Niya site	Bronze	1.38 x 1.22cm
973	N.S.2007/A 19377	Fragment of a bangle	Niya site	Bronze	5.5cm long
974	N.S. 2027/A 19702	Fragment of darrie	Niya site	Cotton	-
975	N.S. 2029/A 19456	Fragment of a knotted hemp cord	Niya site	Cotton	-
976	N.S 1927 /A 19134	Fragment of a glass vase	Niya site	Glass	3.5 x 2.8cm
977	N.S. 1917/A 19238	Piece of glass	Niya site	Glass	3.1cm long
978	N.S. 1923/A 19241	Piece of a white glass vessel	Niya site	Glass	4.4 x 4.3cm
979	N.S. 1944/A 19432	A string of 24 small beads	Niya site	Glass	Different sizes
980	N.S. 1946/A 19422	Yellow glass beads	Niya site	Glass	0.5cm in diam.
981	N.S. 2035/A 19556	Small broom	Niya site	Grass	27cm long
982	N.S. 2036/A 20960	Shaft of sphere(?), with a leather ferule	Niya site	Iron	38.7 long
983	N.S. 1943/A 19245	Piece of dice	Niya site	Ivory	3.83cm long
984	N.S. 1970/A 19436	Portion of a hinge	Niya site	Metal	5.75cm long
985	N.S. 1936/A 19415	Half of a bead with green coating	Niya site	Porcelain	1.91 x 1.5cm
986	N.S.2049/A 20922	Small spoon	Niya site	Rhinoceros Hide	7 x 3.6cm
987	N.S. 1894/A 19231	Touch stone piece	Niya site	Stone	8.34cm long
988	N.S. 1918/A 19116	Fragment of stone vessel	Niya site	Stone	2.6cm long
989	N.S. 1947/A 19244	Piece of stone flake	Niya site	Stone	3.02 x 1.72cm
990	N.S. 1947/A 19420	Stone flake	Niya site	Stone	2.29 x 2cm
991	N.S. 1951/A 19135	Fragment of a slate stone with a hole	Niya site	Stone	2.32 x 1.55cm
992	N.S. 2029/A 19072	Piece of stone	Niya site	Stone	3.08cm long
993	N.S. 1914/ A 19114-19116	One stone pebble and two metal fragments	Niya site	Stone & Metal	Different sizes
994	N.S. 1851/A 13843	Neck piece of hard grey pottery	Niya site	Teracotta	8.5cm long
995	N.S. 1856/A 13822	Piece of lattice of hard burnt coarse clay	Niya site	Terracota	6.5 x 5.5cm
996	N.S. 1933/A 19274	Writing pens	Niya site	Wood	23.5cm long
997	N.S. 1933/A 19280	Writing pens	Niya Site	Wood	14cm long
998	N.S. 1935/A 19414	Two beads joined together	Niya site	Wood	0.5cm in diam.
999	N.S. 2030/A 19276	Eating sticks	Niya site	Wood	21.6cm long
1000	N.S. 2030/A 19277	Eating sticks	Niya site	Wood	23.5cm long
1001	N.S. 2030/A 19278	Eating sticks	Niya site	Wood	19.7cm long
1002	N.S. 2031/A 19279	Spindle whorl (broken)	Niya site	Wood	21.3cm long
1003	N.S. 2034/A 19275	Stick	Niya site	Wood	28cm long
1004	N.S. 2037/A 20956	Miniature boot	Niya site	Wood	25.3 x 8.8cm
1005	N.S. 2038/A 13733	Discs joint together	Niya site	Wood	5.5 X 5.4cm
1006	N.S. 2039/A 20704	Carved panel	Niya site	Wood	2.9 x 1.6cm
1007	N.S. 2040/A 20964	Wooden double bracket	Niya site	Wood	5.4cm in diam.
1008	N.S. 2041/A 20958	Mouse trap	Niya site	Wood	40.6 x 10.5cm
1009	N.S. 2042/A 20959	Carve baluster	Niya site	Wood	21.5cm long
1010	N.S. 2043/A 20961	Long chair, carved	Niya site	Wood	43.3 x 7.9cm
1011	N.S. 2044/A 20957	Donkey's saddle of horse shoe shape	Niya site	Wood	31.6 X 17.8cm
1012	N.S. 2045/A 19557	Bow (in two pieces)	Niya site	Wood	109cm long when joined together
1013	N.S. 2047/A 20954	8 fragments of a casket	Niya site	Wood	6.2cm is biggest
1014	N.S. 2048/A 20941	Miniature lion	Niya site	Wood	3.4 x 3.9cm
1015	N.S. 2034/A 19450	Stick with a hole inside	Niya site	Wood (bone)?	-
1016	N.S. 2026/A 19693	Small piece of woolen (frame)	Niya site	Wool	-
1017	N.S. 1625/A 19404	Piece of glass	Rawak	Glass	-
1018	N.S. 1625/A 19405	Piece of glass	Rawak	Glass	-
1019	N.S. 1625/A 19406	Piece of glass	Rawak	Glass	-
1020	N.S. 1625/A 19407	Piece of glass	Rawak	Glass	-
1021	N.S. 1625/A 19408	Piece of glass	Rawak	Glass	-
1022	N.S. 1625/A 19411	Piece of glass	Rawak	Glass	-
1023	N.S. 1688/A 14095	Headless torso of Buddha	Rawak	Red clay	27 x 16cm
1024	N.S. 1895/A 19240	Piece of slate drilled at one side	Rawak	Slate	8.5cm long
1025	N.S. 1670/A 20875	Relief fragment: Standing Buddha in Abhaya mudra	Rawak	Stucco	16 x 8.5cm
1026	N.S. 1691/A 13486	Relief fragment: hand (of Buddha?)	Rawak	Stucco	6.5 x 2.5

SL. no.	Acc. No.	Object	Site	Material	Measurements
1027	N.S. 1713/A 13419	Relief fragment showing seated Buddha	Rawak	Stucco	8.5 x 8.5
1028	N.S. 1742/A 20874	Relief fragment: head of Buddha	Rawak	Stucco	13.1 x 9.2cm
1029	N.S. 1773/A 13447	Relief fragment: part of a human figure	Rawak	Stucco	8 x 7.5cm
1030	N.S. 1834/A 13830	Plaque: dancing peacock	Samarkand	Terracotta	13.5 x 10.5cm
1031	N.S. 1849/A 13841	Piece of die	Samarkand	Terracotta	5 x 4cm
1032	N.S. 1897/A 20930	Animal figurine, leg broken	Samarkand	Terracotta	5.7 x 4.7cm
1033	N.S. 1902/A 14052	Fragment showing a round depression figured with a lion	Samarkand	Terracotta	5.5 x 4cm
1034	N.S. 1850/A 13842	Circular die	Samarkand	Unbaked clay	7cm in diam.
1035	N.S. 1892/A 13880	Fragment of burnt bone	Togujai	Bone	3 x 2cm
1036	N.S. 2050/A 14054	Piece of bone	Togujai	Bone	5.5 x 3cm
1037	N.S. 1981/A 19446	Portion of a buckle	Togujai	Bronze	4.04cm long
1038	N.S. 1826/A 13824	Two fragments (now joined) of red thick unglazed clay	Togujai	Clay	113.5 x 9cm
1039	N.S. 1842/A 13834	Piece of red pottery	Togujai	Clay	8.5 x 7cm
1040	N.S. 1978/A 19188	Miniature bird	Togujai	Copper	3.84cm
1041	N.S. 1912/A 19236	Arm of an image	Togujai	Steatite	4.2cm long
1042	N.S. 1813/A 13816	Fragment of green glazed pottery	Togujai	Terracotta	5 x 5cm
1043	N.S. 1814/A 13817	Green glazed potsherd	Togujai	Terracotta	3.3 x 3cm
1044	N.S. 1816/A 13819	Fragment of burnt bone	Togujai	Terracotta	6.5cm in ht.
1045	N.S. 1817/A 20953	Glazed red ware potsherd	Togujai	Terracotta	4.7 x 4.3cm
1046	N.S. 1818/A 13820	Fragment of glazed pottery	Togujai	Terracotta	5 x 3.5cm
1047	N.S. 1819/A 20951	Glazed red ware potsherd	Togujai	Terracotta	6cm long
1048	N.S. 1827/A 13825	Fragment of red thick coarse pottery	Togujai	Terracotta	10.5 x 7.5cm
1049	N.S. 1839/A 13602	Fragment of a vessel	Togujai	Terracotta	8.5 x 7.5cm
1050	N.S. 1847/A 13839	Piece of coarse red pottery	Togujai	Terracotta	4 x 3.5cm
1051	N.S. 1854/A 13845	Fragment of a vessel	Togujai	Terracotta	8.5 x 6cm
1052	N.S. 1857/A 13847	Fragment of handle and rim of a vessel	Togujai	Terracotta	8.5 x 5.5cm
1053	N.S. 1868/A 13861	Piece of pale buff coarse pottery	Togujai	Terracotta	4.5 x 2.5cm
1054	N.S. 1893/A 13881	Half of a disc	Togujai	Terracotta	2cm long
1055	N.S. 1984/A 19178	Hook	Uzun-tati	Bronze	4.35cm long
1056	N.S.2003/ A 191337	Fragment	Uzun-tati	Bronze	-
1057	N.S.2003/ A 191338	Fragment	Uzun-tati	Bronze	-
1058	N.S.2003/ A 19136–38	Fragment	Uzun-tati	Bronze	-
1059	N.S. 1964/A 20907	Finger ring	Uzun-tati	Copper	1.7 x 1.8
1060	N.S. 2002/A 19117	Fragments	Uzun-tati	Copper	Different sizes
1061	N.S. 2002/A 19118	Fragments	Uzun-tati	Copper	Different sizes
1062	N.S. 2002/A 19119	Fragments	Uzun-tati	Copper	Different sizes
1063	N.S. 2002/A 19120	Fragments	Uzun-tati	Copper	Different sizes
1064	N.S. 2002/A 19132	Seal (buckle?)	Uzun-tati	Copper	6.2 x 5.14cm
1065	N.S. 1952/A 19246	Piece of glazed pottery	Uzun-tati	Porcelain	1.81 x 1.47cm
1066	N.S. 2000/ A 19393–400	Fragments	Uzun-tati	Stone and metal	Different shapes and sizes
1067	N.S. 1967/A 19434	Seal (handle broken) with impression of lion	Yotkan	Bronze	2.67 x 2.61cm
1068	N.S. 1972/A 19438	Miniature seated Buddha	Yotkan	Metal	2.23cm
1069	N.S. 1744/A 20878	Human head wearing elaborate coiffure	Yotkan	Terracotta	8.1 x 4.7mm
1070	N.S. 1745/A 20877	Human head	Yotkan	Terracotta	9.2 x 7.4cm
1071	N.S. 1782/A 13457	Miniature grotesque monkeys embracing each other	Yotkan	Terracotta	2.5 x 1.5cm
1072	N.S. 1783/A 13458	Miniature grotesque monkeys embracing each other.	Yotkan	Terracotta	3 x 1cm
1073	N.S. 1784/A 13459	Miniature grotesque monkeys embracing each other, head of one and feet of both missing	Yotkan	Terracotta	4 x 2.5cm
1074	N.S. 1786/A 13461	Miniature grotesque monkey	Yotkan	Terracotta	3.5 x 2cm
1075	N.S. 1786/A 13462	Miniature grotesque monkey	Yotkan	Terracotta	3.5 x 2cm
1076	N.S. 1787/A 13463	Miniature grotesque monkeys embracing each other	Yotkan	Terracotta	4.5 x 2cm
1077	N.S. 1788/A 13464	Miniature grotesque monkey, seated	Yotkan	Terracotta	2.5 x 1cm
1078	N.S. 1789/A 13465	Grotesque monkey playing on a violin	Yotkan	Terracotta	3 x 2.5cm
1079	N.S. 1790/A 13460	Miniature grotesque monkey playing on a musical instrument.	Yotkan	Terracotta	5.5 x 4cm
1080	N.S. 1791/A 13467	Miniature monkey seated, arms and one leg missing	Yotkan	Terracotta	3cm in height
1081	N.S. 1792/A 13469	Miniature grotesque monkey, upper portion only	Yotkan	Terracotta	1.5 x 1.5cm

SL. no.	Acc. No.	Object	Site	Material	Measurements
1082	N.S. 1793/A 13470	Miniature grotesque monkey with closed hand, legs are missing	Yotkan	Terracotta	4 x 2.5cm
1083	N.S. 1797/A 13474	Miniature grotesque monkey, seated	Yotkan	Terracotta	2.5 x 1.5cm
1084	N.S. 1798/A 13475	Miniature grotesque monkey, seated	Yotkan	Terracotta	3 x 1.75cm
1085	N.S. 1799	Miniature grotesque monkey eating something	Yotkan	Terracotta	2.52cm
1086	N.S. 1800/A 13803	Grotesque dog	Yotkan	Terracotta	2.5cm in ht.
1087	N.S. 1802/A 13805	Grotesque monkey	Yotkan	Terracotta	4cm in ht.
1088	N.S. 1803/A 13806	Grotesque monkey seated upon a log.	Yotkan	Terracotta	3cm in ht.
1089	N.S. 1804/A 13807	Grotesque monkey	Yotkan	Terracotta	3cm in ht.
1090	N.S. 1806/A 13809	Grotesque monkey	Yotkan	Terracotta	3.5cm in ht.
1091	N.S. 1807/A 13810	Grotesque monkey	Yotkan	Terracotta	5 x 2cm
1092	N.S. 1808/A 13811	Grotesque monkey	Yotkan	Terracotta	7cm in ht.
1093	N.S. 1809/A 13812	Grotesque monkey	Yotkan	Terracotta	6.5cm in ht.
1094	N.S. 1810/A 13813	Head of a grotesque monkey	Yotkan	Terracotta	2cm in ht.
1095	N.S. 1811/A 13814	Grotesque figure of a human child	Yotkan	Terracotta	3cm in ht.
1096	N.S. 1812/A 13815	Grotesque bird	Yotkan	Terracotta	2cm long
1097	N.S. 1824/A 13823	Pottery fragment: grotesque lion's head	Yotkan	Terracotta	x 7.5cm
1098	N.S. 1825/A 20868	Red ware potsherd with appliqué reliefs	Yotkan	Terracotta	8.6 x 8.7cm
1099	N.S. 1829/A 20945	Red ware potsherd with appliqué relief	Yotkan	Terracotta	9 x 6cm
1100	N.S. 1835/A 20950	Neck of a yellowish buff ware pottery vessel: three garland bearing female figure (applique)	Yotkan	Terracotta	6.5cm in ht.
1101	N.S. 1840/A 20944	Red ware potsherd: bull's head on the body	Yotkan	Terracotta	5.9 x 5cm
1102	N.S. 1860/A 13859	Spindle whorl	Yotkan	Terracotta	4 x 2.5cm
1103	N.S. 1871/A 13864	Circular piece showing a kirttimukha	Yotkan	Terracotta	5cm in
1104	N.S. 1874/A 13867	Miniature camel	Yotkan	Terracotta	5 x 4.5cm
1105	N.S. 1878/A 13870	Head of a monkey	Yotkan	Terracotta	4cm in ht.
1106	N.S. 1883/A 20934	Two monkey-like figures riding on a horse, head of one rider lost.	Yotkan	Terracotta	5.1 x 5cm
1107	N.S. 1884/A 20882	Horned lion's head	Yotkan	Terracotta	5.5 x 5.3cm
1108	N.S. 1885/A 13758	Miniature vessel	Yotkan	Terracotta	2cm in ht.
1109	N.S. 1888/A 13877	Spout of a vessel figured with animal face	Yotkan	Terracotta	4.5cm long
1110	N.S. 1898/A 20931	Horse's head with neck and shoulder	Yotkan	Terracotta	7.4 x 4.4mm
1111	N.S. 1900/A 13889	Miniature horse legs are missing	Yotkan	Terracotta	7cm long
1112	N.S. 1905/A 19232	Torso of Bodhisattva	Yotkan	Terracotta	5 x 3.67cm

Probable list of objects from Stein Collection in Central Asia

SL. no.	Acc. No.	Object	Site	Material	Measurements
	N.S. 2379/A 13676	Miniature monkey	Probably Central Asia	Steatite	2.5cm long
	N.S.2392/A 13509	Miniature monkey	Probably Central Asia	Steatite	3.5cm long
	N.S.2393/A 13508	A much deface miniature head with nimbus	Probably Central Asia	Steatite	3.5 x 3cm
	N.S. 4478/ A 16027–73	Beads	Probably Central Asia	Stone	Different shapes and sizes
	N.S. 2378/A 13505	Miniature headless monkey	Probably Central Asia	Terracotta	2.5cm long
	N.S. 2380	Miniature owl-faced monkey	Probably Central Asia	Terracotta	2cm long
	N.S. 2382/A 13680	Miniature owl-faced monkey with closed hands	Probably Central Asia	Terracotta	2cm long
	N.S. 2383/A 13681	Miniature owl-faced monkey holding something by mouth	Probably Central Asia	Terracotta	2cm long
	N.S. 2384/A 13682	Miniature owl-faced monkey carrying something on shoulder	Probably Central Asia	Terracotta	2cm long
	N.S. 2385/A 13683	Miniature monkey	Probably Central Asia	Terracotta	14.5 x 1.3cm
	N.S. 2386/A 13514	Miniature owl-faced monkey	Probably Central Asia	Terracotta	2.5cm long
	N.S. 2387/A 13503	Bust of miniature monkey	Probably Central Asia	Terracotta	3.5cm in ht.
	N.S. 2388/A 13504	Miniature monkey wearing cap	Probably Central Asia	Terracotta	3cm long
	N.S. 2389/A 13505	Miniature monkey with pigtail	Probably Central Asia	Terracotta	3.5cm long
	N.S. 2390/A 13506	Miniature bird	Probably Central Asia	Terracotta	3cm long
	N.S. 2410/A 13510	Grotesque monkey	Probably Central Asia	Terracotta	6 x 3cm
	N.S. 2411/A 13511	Human bust	Probably Central Asia	Terracotta	4.5 x 2cm
	N.S. 2412/A 13512	Miniature horse	Probably Central Asia	Terracotta	6 x 4cm
	N.S. 2413/A 13513	Fragment of human head	Probably Central Asia	Terracotta	14.5 x 13cm

	N.S. 2417/A 13514	Portion of head Buddha	Probably Central Asia	Terracotta	6.5 x 5.5cm
	N.S. 2418/A 13515	Portion of a lion's face	Probably Central Asia	Terracotta	4 x 2.5cm
	N.S. 2419/A 13516	Flower	Probably Central Asia	Terracotta	4.5 x 4.5cm
	N.S. 2420/A 13517	Three pieces of flowers	Probably Central Asia	Terracotta	4 x 3cm (biggest one)
	N.S. 2429/A 13523	Miniature grotesque monkey	Probably Central Asia	Terracotta	2cm long
	N.S. 2433/A 13527	Miniature grotesque monkeys embracing each other	Probably Central Asia	Terracotta	2cm in ht.
	N.S. 4476/ A 15821-16021 & A16026	Beads	Probably Central Asia	Terracotta	Different shapes and sizes
	N.S. 4477/ A 15721-820	Beads	Probably Central Asia	Terracotta	Different shapes and sizes
	N.S.2392/A 13507	Miniature pinnacle	Probably Central Asia	Terracotta	3cm long

Rai Bahadur Lal Singh: Sir Aurel Stein's Surveying Companion

Daniel Lal Sander* and Stephen Sander (Sukwant Singh)**[1]

*Director of Hollyburn Properties Ltd
**Father of Daniel Lal Singh and founder of Hollyburn Properties Ltd

Rai Bahadur Lal Singh (1860–1938) was one of the few people to travel with Sir Aurel Stein on his expeditions to Central Asia. He was responsible for mapping some of the most remote parts of Central Asia and northwest China, and, at times, for the safeguarding and safe passage of Sir Aurel Stein and his very important collections. He was also my great grandfather and a family legend.

Although he achieved some of the highest honours of his day, there is remarkably little record of him. In Sir Roper Lethbridge's *The Golden Book of India. A Genealogical and Biographical Dictionary of the Ruling Princes, Chiefs, Nobles and Other Personages, Titled or Decorated of the Indian Empire* (1893), his short entry reads 'Lal Singh, Rai Bahadur. The title was conferred on May 25, 1895. Residence: Naini Tal, North-Western Provinces.' This entry does not do justice to this good man and his very significant contribution to our understanding of the geography of Central Asia. It is an honour to record some of his achievements and thus to understand more of the history of this fine and inspiring man.[2]

Family background

As for many families from the Punjab, it is difficult to trace our family history through official records, because such records seldom exist. We count ourselves fortunate to be able to trace our ancestors back to the early 18th century: to Gulab Roy, father of Diwan Singh (d. 1744), father of Karam Chand (d. 1757), father of Sukha Singh. Sukha Singh (RBLS' grandfather) was a landlord of some standing, but lost everything in the Anglo-Sikh Wars (1845–9). His son Jiwan Singh had two sons: Hari Singh and Lal Singh. Lal Singh was born in 1860 in Gujranwala, the Punjab District of northwest India. He and his wife, Har Kaur, had six children (four sons and two daughters), and the family history was passed down through his youngest son, Tara Singh (my grandfather, d. 1973), who told his son, Sukwant Singh (my father, Stephen Sander, b. 1934 in Gujranwala Punjab) all he knew. Tara Singh, had a challenging life as a farmer and in the army, and was keen to remind his own six children, of the significant achievements, strength, honour and integrity of R.B. Lal Singh. According to Tara Singh, R.B. Lal Singh was a secular Sihk and believed in the equality and international consciousness of all people. This in part contributed to a warm and welcoming disposition enhancing R.B. Lal Singh's ability to communicate well with people from all walks of life. R.B. Lal Singh started the tradition of speaking a little prayer before each expedition, a tradition carried out today by our family. In difficult times, RBLS was an inspiration to the family, a pillar of strength to the family and a constant source of admiration.[3]

The most accurate records that the family have relate to visits by this Sikh family to the holy city of Hari Dawar.[4] (RBLS's office was located at Dehra Dun, at the Survey Department of India, just 15 miles away from Hari Dawar.) Rai Bahadur Lal Singh made four visits: (in chronological order) taking his grandmother's (Gulab Devi) ashes on one visit, and his mother's (Un Devi) ashes on another occasion.[5] In 1903 he took his wife and four children to Hari Dawar for a dip in the Ganges.[6] On 24 December 1910 he took his daughter-in-law's (Noran Devi)'s[7] ashes to Hari Dawar, and had a dip in the Ganges.

Rai Bahadur Lal Singh's career

In 1885, Lal Singh joined the army, serving in the cavalry. His British superiors noticed his talents, qualities and physical strength, and promoted him to the Survey of India, to work on the mapping of North West India.[8] He trained at Rurkee [Roorkee, Rurki], near Dehra Dun, approximately 200 miles northwest of New Delhi, near the foothills of the Himalayas. Dehra Dun was the home of the Survey of India, founded in 1767, and famous among other things for the Great Trigonometrical Survey (GTS), initiated in 1800 by William Lambton (1753–1823). The aim of the GTS was to create the most accurate map possible of the Indian subcontinent. Geometric instruments were used to measure the angle between an established base line and vantage points on mountain tops, and these were then charted. The GTS was originally conceived as a short-term project of a few years' duration, but eventually took over 70 years, covering over 3000km, and involving an army of trained surveyors.[9]

In his early career RBLS was known simply as Lal Singh. Singh, of course, is a fairly common Sikh surname. It harks back to the days of the tenth Sikh Guru, Guru Gobind Singh (1675–1708), who, as part of his vision of a more egalitarian society, removed all surnames that reflected caste and replaced them with just two surnames: Singh (lion) for the men, and Kaur (princess) for women. Lal means 'red' and 'endeared', and Lal Singh was quite a popular name, this being a time when shorter names were associated with greater achievements. Working for the Survey of India, he was working for the British government in India. In the early 1900s he was awarded the title of Rai ('brave') in recognition of his bravery, extraordinary hard work and distinguished service. He was further honoured with the title of Sahib ('master'), a distinction that was seldom made to the native people of India; and in 1895 his highest distinction, even rarer, was the title of Bahadur ('valiant').

By the 1900s Rai Bahadur Lal Singh had about 20 years' experience of survey work 'that extended practically over the whole of the Trans-frontier regions within the range of Indian interests from the Yemen to China proper.'[10] His formal position at the Survey of India was Extra Assistant Superintendent.[11]

Rai Bahadur Lal Singh may have met Stein at the time of his First Expedition to Central Asia (1900–1) but did not take part in it. In 1903 Stein was appointed Inspector-General of Education and Archaeological Surveyor for the North West Frontier Provinces and Baluchistan, and in 1904 made a survey of these regions. R.B. Lal Singh accompanied him to Mahaban, and charted the area.[12]

In 1905 and 1906 R.B. Lal Singh accompanied Major Charles Dalrymple Bruce (1862–1934)[13] on his journey from Leh across the Kunlun Mountains and over China to Peking.

In autumn 1907 R.B. Lal Singh joined Stein's Second Expedition to Central Asia (1906–8), replacing the surveyor Ram Singh who had fallen sick and had to return home.[14]

These were difficult expeditions. They covered large distances, in physically demanding conditions. R.B. Lal Singh was an expert surveyor, a man of great stamina and endurance, and had a positive nature that endeared him to his colleagues. These qualities shine through the accounts written by Stein and Bruce. He led by example, and quietly came to represent the excellence of the local staff of the Survey of India (see below).

In 1909, RBLS was awarded the Back Grant of the Royal Geographical Society, and this was reported in *The Times* newspaper, on 6 April 1909.[15]

R.B. Lal Singh joined Stein again on his Third Expedition to Central Asia (1913–16). It was another long and demanding expedition. Stein wrote his report of this expedition with the title *Innermost Asia*[16] and also penned numerous articles. As usual, the data R.B. Lal Singh had collected was taken back to Dehra Dun to be drawn up into the final maps for publication. Stein wrote a *Memoir* on the maps of his three expeditions to Central Asia.[17] A review of the *Memoir* was published in the *Geographical Journal* in 1917, in which the reviewer (Kenneth Mason?) clarified the scope of the expedition and the mapping that was done:[18]

> A glance at the index map shows the vast extent of ground covered by these journeys. From the Pamirs on the west to the northern headwaters of the Huang-ho of China is nearly 28° of longitude, or roughly 1500 miles as the crow flies. But a better idea of the magnitude of the surveys may be formed by noting that during the actual progress of the second expedition, there were no less than 488 shifts of camp with a marching distance of 8300 miles; while on the third, Sir Aurel himself, in spite of the loss of toes he sustained in 1908, and his riding accident in 1913, covered 7000 miles, and his surveyor, Lal Singh, probably more.'

The reviewer spotted only two errors in the maps, and concluded:

> Throughout his journeys, Sir Aurel Stein has been accompanied by surveyors lent by succeeding Surveyor-Generals. These have maintained throughout a very high standard of excellence in their topographical work. It is a great pleasure to read the leader's glowing tributes which he pays to all who worked with him in those inhospitable deserts and mountains.[19]

In 1916, R.B. Lal Singh, now in his mid-fifties and approaching retirement, was rewarded for his services to the Survey of India with a grant of land. Stein wrote of his

> great satisfaction of learning from this kind old friend [Sir Michael O'Dwyer, Lieutenant-General of the Punjab] that the splendid services which my old surveying companion Rai Bahadur Lal Singh had during a lifetime rendered to the Government were to be recognized by a jägir or grant of land. It was a reward I had always wished to secure for him ever since my journeys had acquainted me with his indefatigable zeal and energy.[20]

Hundreds of miles away, in London, the Royal Geographical Society awarded him the Murchison Grant:

> for his excellent work as Surveyor to the last Trans-Himalayan Expedition of Sir Aurel Stein. Lal Singh has spent many years in trans-frontier survey, with Sir Aurel Stein in 1904 and back again with Sir Aurel Stein 1907. For these services he was awarded the Back grant by the Society in 1909. Sir Aurel Stein tells me that it was owing mainly to Lal Singh's unremitting exertions on his third expedition in 1913–1916 that the surveys could be extended over many hundred square miles of difficult mountain country in the face of the most trying physical conditions. Whenever practicable Lal Singh travelled by independent routes, and by his work the Indian triangulation was extended along the Kun-lun range beyond Lopnor and across the Lop desert to the Central Tien-shan. We are glad to learn that his services have been

rewarded, on his approaching retirement from the Survey of India, with a grant of irrigated land. I will ask Sir Aurel Stein to receive on behalf of his devoted assistant the Murchison Grant, and to convey with it to him the cordial wishes of the Society for his long life on his well-earned estate.[21]

An exemplar of the Survey of India

Rai Bahadur Lal Singh clearly made an impression on Sir Aurel Stein. Stein is renowned for preferring to travel light, in terms of goods and people, and there cannot be many people who accompanied him on three expeditions. He also made an impression on many others, including Major C.D. Bruce, who, on 28 January 1907, gave a lecture to the Royal Geographical Society, in which he stressed the immense contribution of R.B. Lal Singh. This personal recognition, and the discussion which followed the lecture, all point to a change in attitudes – both towards the nature of exploration and towards the Indian staff at the Survey of India. It was people like R.B. Lal Singh, who, over a lifetime career of surveying, demonstrated by his own example the calibre of the Indian staff at the Survey.

Major C.D. Bruce introduced the expedition, saying that:

> … its object was not the exploration of any one tract or country in detail, but, in the first place, the acquisition of whatever knowledge, geographical and otherwise, it was possible to collect of the regions through which we passed, and, in the second, the making of a more or less detailed route-survey, day by day, mile by mile, from Leh to Peking. The second, and by far the more arduous of the two objects, was only carried through thanks to the wonderful determination and pluck of our Indian surveyor, a Sikh, Lal Sing [sic] by name, lent by the Survey of India. To carry on such work as Lal Sing [sic] did daily, with frequent night observations at altitudes over 16,000 feet in Northern Tibet so late in the year as the middle of October, moving nearly every day for nine months on end, is a feat which any man, even with the reputation which those who work for the Survey of India enjoy, may, I think you will agree, well be proud of.[22]

Bruce gave a lengthy description of one particularly dangerous part of the journey through the Kunlun Mountains which illustrated the brutal conditions of the area, and the hardships faced by those who worked on the trans-frontier surveys:

> From the northern edge of the plain the actual passage of the Kuen Lun mountains commences. This passage occupied us five days, and we covered just over 30 miles in transit. It was 2 p.m. by the time we had climbed the first pass out of the Gu Gut plain, and much too late at that season of the year to commence such a descent as that which lay before us. This pass was not that made use of by Deasy, as, our guide being most uncertain about any possible passes, we had ourselves pushed ahead, and Captain Layard, Lall Sing [sic], and myself climbed a pass the caravans were afterwards unable to negotiate. Upon the north side the snow lay 18 inches to 2 feet deep, and there a wind raged which was, even for Tibet, more cruel than usual. After rejoining the caravan, the view which met our eyes as we gazed through the falling snow northwards into and over the Kuen Lun, was one neither my companions nor myself are ever likely to forget. Below and on three sides of us, stretching apparently without end, lay the wildest and most forbidding jumble of mountain ranges, peaks, and gorges imaginable. Of all shapes – crossing and recrossing in every direction, needle-pointed, flat, or rugged and broken, they had only one common feature, and that lay in their apparently inaccessible nature. There was, however, no time to waste, whatever doubts for the moment crept through our minds, it was imperative to go on, so we commenced the first descent down a slope like the side of a house, full of holes and boulders, and over the knees of the animals in snow. For the next four days we struggled down a succession of watercourses and narrow gorges one after another, making sorry progress at times, but always in the right direction. The main gorge, known to the people of Polu at its northern end as the Zubéshie gorge, was more like a gigantic railway cutting winding through solid rock than anything else, the sides frequently sheer for hundreds of feet on either side, the bottom just sufficiently wide for a frozen brook a few yards in breadth. Into these gorges the sun rarely penetrates, and at night, when the moon is overhead, few more weird and desolate scenes can be imagined. [23]

Bruce's appreciation of Lal Singh, and of the staff of the Survey of India generally, was echoed in the discussion that followed Bruce's lecture. [24] It was time to recognise the high standards and personal commitment of the local people who worked for the Survey of India. Furthermore, survey work in Africa was not going so well, and this served to highlight the exceptional quality of staff and training in the Survey of India. On this point, Sir Thomas Holdich (1843–1929, formerly associated with the Survey, but now retired) responded to the lecture as follows:

> … There is, however, another point to which Major Bruce has made allusion to which I should like to call your attention. He has recognized, in a most generous way, the admirable assistance obtained from one of the native surveyors, who was attached to his party from the Survey of India. Now this, I am glad to say, is nothing new, for I think every explorer who has been assisted by these surveyors lately has invariably borne the same evidence to the excellence of their work. But at this time it is with new interest that we regard this matter, for we are approaching a new phase of geographical exploration. The old age of pioneer work has passed away, and we must now, when we set to work to wander through new countries (as Major Bruce has done), make use of more or less trained agency to assist our observations as simple travellers. With the enormous field that still lies before us in various parts of the world, I conceive that we shall never arrive at the solution of the great problem of mapping the world successfully without some such agency as this. Well, it happens that the Colonial Committee have lately issued a Report on Surveys in another part of the world, ie, in British Africa. It is a most admirable report, and will be, I am certain, of immense interest to all those of you interested in that country. In that report they have described the success which has, so far, attended efforts to train the natives of Africa as the natives of India have been trained in Survey duties. Taking it on the whole, I regret to say that the reports are not altogether favourable. With the single exception of Lagos, I do not think there is any one report which might lead one to hope that in future great success will attend these efforts; but I would like to warn those who are interested in the matter, that it is far too soon to arrive at any conclusion on the subject. If you will for an instant consider what the process is by which men, such as those to whom Major Bruce has alluded, arrive at the skill which they attain as surveyors, you will, I think, agree with me that it is a long process, and a laborious process, to attain such an amount of technical knowledge as they acquire. In the first place, in India, the men whom we get for this duty are drafted from all sources, both civil and military; and you must remember that from the very beginning they are well-educated men. We do not deal with quite such raw material as they find in

> Africa. The African schools have not yet arrived at the position of turning out men whose education you may consider as thoroughly sound when they are selected for survey training. In India, having got the men specially selected, in the first instance, they are again subjected to a process which we might call a process of natural selection, until finally, after some years' experience, they are drafted into the Survey Department for a further five or six years' severe training before they can take the field for such work as Major Bruce has described. All this, as you will easily recognize, is a matter of time and patience and infinite trouble; but I have every conviction that they will eventually find in Africa men quite equal in intelligence to any that we find in Asiatic fields; and I firmly believe that if they are to solve the gigantic problem of mapping the continent of Africa rapidly and cheaply, it will be through native agency; but only after the application of infinite toil and patience in training shall we succeed in getting the men we want.[25]

To which Captain Deasy[26] added:

> He has alluded in a very brief manner to the difficulties of the journey, and glossed them over in the course of a few words. But I can assure you that the difficulties which he has had to encounter, especially in that part [the route to Polu], have been exceedingly severe; indeed, far harder than you would think from listening to Major Bruce this evening. I am very glad to have heard the remarks which Sir Thomas Holdich has made concerning the assistance which I think nearly every British traveller in Central Asia has had from the Survey Department of India. Sub-surveyors, all of whom are highly trained, are always ready to volunteer to accompany any British officer, or Britisher, into no matter what parts of Central Asia. When the history of the exploration of Central Asia comes to be written, I sincerely hope we shall find adequate credit given to the Indian Government, and more especially the Survey Department of India, for all the valuable help and assistance they have given to geographical research and science in Central Asia.[27]

Stein's appreciation of Rai Bahadur Lal Singh

There can be no doubt of Sir Aurel Stein's high regard for Rai Bahadur Lal Singh. There was clearly an appreciation of his professional and technical capabilities. Stein himself had studied cartography as part of his military training in Budapest,[28] and liked to think in terms of 'archaeological reconnaissance'. But this was not the only thing they had in common. They were roughly the same age (Lal Singh was born in 1860, Stein in 1862) and they seem to have shared an appreciation of certain human qualities: of independence, self-reliance, resilience and a respect for and understanding of the physical world around them. While it is clear that they enjoyed the company of others (and that others enjoyed their company), they also welcomed a certain amount of solitude away from others.[29]

Stein had very fond memories of working with Rai Bahadur Lal Singh, and it would seem that the sentiments were mutual. On 11 August 1930, when Stein set out from Srinagar on his his Fourth Expedition to Central Asia, he wrote in his notes: 'Started from Macphersons at 3 p.m. down Chinar Bagh Canal, after farewell to dear old Lal Singh whose visits had been daily.'[30]

The legacy of Rai Bahadur Lal Singh

In terms of his career, roughly a hundred years have passed since RBLS accompanied Stein on his first three expeditions to Central Asia. There is no doubt that RBLS made a very significant contribution to the mapping of Central Asia in his own time, but how is it evaluated today? For this, we must turn to the geographers. In1993, Karl E. Ryavec, in his paper 'The present-day value of maps illustrating the archaeological surveys of Sir Aurel Stein in Xinjiang and Gansu' concluded that

> Due to the need for accurate maps of what was to the West at this time a remote and largely unsurveyed region the British Indian Government despatched professional surveyors to accompany Stein, and provided cartographers at the Survey of India office at Dehra Dun to compile maps to illustrate the results of each expedition upon its return. The maps thus contain a wealth of information on the historical, cultural and physical geography of a vast region of Central Asia. It is in part because of this interdisciplinary nature of Stein's maps that they are still the main authority on many geographical aspects of a unique region of Central Asia that in the past was an important meeting place of the ancient civilisations of India, China and the West.[31]

The legacy of Rai Bahadur Lal Singh has also lived on in his family. I have already mentioned that he had an almost legendary presence for my father's generation. But he was not merely an inspiring (and awe-inspiring) grandfather in a personal sense; his memory was also invoked when his grandson, Bhai Mehtab Singh (my uncle), was applying for the post of Assistant Sub-Inspector of Police, Lahore. Stein wrote in support of his application:

> … I do not know the applicant in person but I can fully bear out the statement as to the exceptional merits of his grandfather the late Rai Bahadur Lal Singh of the Survey of India. R.B. Lal Singh accompanied me on two long and fruitful expeditions into Central Asia and China, carried out under the orders of the Government of India for Archaeological and Geographical explorations. He was deputed with me for this purpose and rendered most efficient and devoted service during the years 1907–08 and again during the years 1913–15.
>
> I remember that most faithful travel companion as one of the most hardworking and efficient servants of Government with whom I worked during my long career in India. The exceptional merits of R.S. Lal Singh were recognised by Government by the grant of a Jagir at the special recommendation of the late Sir Michael O'Dwyer, then Lieutenant Governor of the Punjab, who had become acquainted through me with [the] very valuable services of this fine and very loyal Sikh gentleman and who long continued to take an interest in him.
>
> I am not in a position to judge of Mehtab Singh's qualification for the post he aims at; but, I believe, that in view of the great services rendered by R.B. Lal Singh both to Government and to scientific exploration, the applicant deserves of special consideration.[32]

Appendix: Recipients of the Back Grant and Murchison Grant, 1882–1982

Both of these grants are awarded by the Royal Geographical Society (R.G.S.). The Back Grant was set up with the bequest of £600 to the Society from Sir George Back (1796–1878), and is awarded for 'applied or scientific geographical studies which make an outstanding contribution to the development of national or international public policy.' The Murchison Grant was set up with the bequest of £1000 to the Society from Sir Robert Murchison (1792–1871) and is awarded for

'publications judged to contribute most to geographical science in preceding recent years.' The awards were first given in 1882. [For further details, see Back's obituary in the *Proceedings of the Royal Geographical Society*, New Series, vol. 1, no. 1 (Jan 1879), pp. 70-71; and Clements R. Markham, 'The fifty years' work of the Royal Geographical Society', *Journal of the Royal Geographical Society of London*, vol. 50 (1880), pp. 1–255. This list of recipients during the first 100 years of these grants has been prepared by Sarah Strong, Archivist at the R.G.S., to show the eminent recipients of the first hundred years of Back and Murchison Grants.]

Recipients of the Back Grant

H.E. O'Neill (1882), L'Abbé Petitot (1883), Emil Boss (1884), W.O. Hodgkinson (1885), Sgt. David L. Brainard (1886), Sarat Chandra Das (1887), No award (1888), F.C. Selous (1889), No award (1890), W.J. Steines (1891), Rev. James Sibree (1892), No award (1893), Capt. H.J. Snow (1894), Capt. C.A. Larsen (1895), J. Burr Tyrell (1896), Lieut. C. Ryder (1897), George P. Tate (1898), Capt. P. Molesworth Sykes (1899), Robert Codrington (1900), Capt. William Colbeck (& ?Bernacchi) (1901), Lieut. Georg Carl Amdrup (1902), Dr W.G. Smith (1903), M. Aurel Stein (1904), Capt. C. Maud (1905), Maj. R.G.T. Bright, C.M.G. (1906), C.E. Moss (1907), Lieut. G.F.A. Mulock (1908), **Rai Sahib Lal Singh** (1909), Hanns Vischer (1910), Dr Arthur Neve (1911), L.A. Wallace (1912), William S. Barclay (1913), I.N. Dracopoli (1914), C.W. Hobley (1915), Frank Wild (1916), Rev. Walter Weston (1917), Capt. R.A. Bartlett (1918), Ven. Archdeacon Stuck (1919), J.M. Wordie (1920), Marion Newbigin (1921), Khan Bahadur Sher Jang (1922), B. Glanvill Corney (1923), M.C. Lester (1924), Capt. Joseph-Elzéar Bernier (1925), Khan Sahib Afraz Gul Khan (1926), George Binney (1927), Capt. A.H. MacCarthy (1928), Ph. C. Visser (1929), Mrs Gordon-Gallien (1939), Col. Rowe (1931), H. Clutterbuck (1932), Freya Stark (1933), Dr D.N. Wadia (1934), Wilfred Thesiger (1935), Muhammad Ayub Khan (1936), Thomas Hay (1937), L.R. Wager (1938), Lieut.-Cmmdr R.E.D. Ryder, R.N. (1939), Gerald Seligman (1940), Alfred Stephenson (1941), Sgn-Cmmdr G. Murray Levick, R.N. (1942), Award postponed (1943), Award postponed (1944), Award postponed (1945), \ Both years awarded in 1947 to (1946), / Lieut.-Col. Andrew Croft, D.S.O. (1947), A.J. Marshall (1948), Brian Roberts (1949), R.G. Goodchild (1950), J.N. Jennings (1951), Dr H.F.P. Herdman (1952), G. de Q. Robin (1953), Cmmdr G.S. Ritchie, D.S.O., R.N. (1954), Capt. O.C.S. Robinson, G.M., R.D., R.C.N. (1955), Richard Hamilton, O.B.E. (1956), Dr R.J. Harrison Church (1957), Chief Engineer Bertrand Imbert (1958), David Stratton (1959), A.T. Grove (1960), Dr Eric H. Brown (1961), B.W. Sparks (1962), T.J. Chandler (1963), Dr Keith M. Clayton (1964), Lieut.-Cmmdr J.B. Dixon, R.N. (1965), Dr S. Evans (1966), Prof. Sigurdur Thorarinsson (1967), Dr J.D. Woods (1968), A.J. Lee (1969), Dr Nic C. Flemming (1970), Dr Claudio Vita-Finzi (1971), Dr D.R. Harris (1972), Prof. J. Leonard (1973), Capt. D.W. Haslam, O.B.E., R.N. (1974), Prof. H.C. Brookfield (1975), Dr Keith J. Miller (1976), Prof. Ronald Cooke (1977), Dr Andrew Warren (1978), Prof. J.B. Sissons (1979), Prof. Kenneth Gregory (1980), Dr Bruce Atkinson (1981), Dr Edward Derbyshire (1982).

Recipients of the Murchison Grant

Rev. Thomas Wakefield (1882), William Deans Cowan (1883), W.W. McNair (1884), Pandit Krishna (1885), F. and A. Jardine (1886), George Bourne (1887), J. McCarthy (1888), F.S. Arnott (1889), Signor Vittorio Sella (1890), William Ogilvie (1891), Robert M.W. Swan (1892), R.W. Senior (1893), Capt. Joseph Wiggins (1894), Einvind Astrup (1895), Sir Henry Thuillier (1896), Lieut. S. Vandeleur (1897), H. Warrington Smyth (1898), Albert Armitage (1899), Dr. Henri Arçtowski (1900), Henry Coles (1901), Stanley Gardiner (1902), Capt. Gunnar Isachsen (1903), Capt. William Colbeck (1904), William Wallace (1905), Maj. H.R. Davies (1906), Capt. G.E. Smith (1907), Col. Delmé-Radcliffe (1908), Capt. C.G. Rawling (1909), Dr Karl Skottsberg (1910), Dr Wilfred Grenfell (1911), Capt. W.C. Macfie, R.E. (1912), Maj. H.D. Pearson (1913), Cmmdr H.L.L. Pennell (1914), Capt. J.K. Davis (1915), Lieut.-Col. Whitlock (1916), **Rai Bahadur Lal Singh** (1917), C.A. Reid (1918), Dr W.M. Strong (1919), M.A. Czaplicka (1920), Comdt J. Maury (1921), Charles Camsell (1922), Capt. A.G. Stigand (1923), J.H. Reynolds (1924), Eric Teichman (1925), Frank Debenham (1926), Capt. C.J. Morris (1927), John Mathieson (1928), C.S. Elton (1929), Col. H. Wood, R.E. (1939), L.M. Nesbit (1931), Dr K.S. Sandford (1932), Dr Noel Humphreys (1933), John Rymill (1934), R.P. Bishop (1935), Michael Leahy (1936), Martin Lindsay (1937), Ronald Kaulback (1938), Robert Bentham (1939), Peter Mott (1940), C.T. Madigan (1941), Dr S.W. Wooldridge & Flight-Lieut. David Linton (1942), Award postponed (1943), Award postponed (1944), Lieut.-Col. W.E. Browne, M.B.E. (1945), Lieut.-Col. C.A. Hart (1946), Gordon Manley (1947), R.W. Steel (1948), Lieut.-Col. E.H. Thompson, C.B.E., R.E. (1949), Sgn-Cmmdr E.W. Bingham, R.N. (1950), Dr George Salt (1951), W.D.C. Wiggins (1952), G.B. Stigant (1953), G.R. Crone (1954), Dr H.C.K. Henderson (1955), Dr Alice Garnett (1956), Dr G.L.C. Bertram (1957), Prof. E.G. Bowen (1958), Prof. S.P. Chatterjee (1959), Prof. J. Wreford Watson (1960), Prof. K.M. Buchanan (1961), Prof. S.H. Beaver (1962), Prof. A. Austin Miller (1963), Prof. K.C. Edwards (1964), Dr J.C. Swallow (1965), Prof. S.G. Davis (1966), Prof. E.W. Gilbert (1967), C.T. Smith (1968), Prof. J.T. Coppock (1969), I.R. Bishop (1970), Prof. J.W. House (1971), Prof. Emeritus W. Gordon East (1972), Prof. W.B. Fisher (1973), Prof. H.H. Lamb (1974), Prof. Akin L. Mabogunje (1975), Prof. Emeritus W.G. Hoskins C.B.E., F.B.A. (1976), Harold Fullard (1977), Prof. Kenneth Walton (1978), Prof. Eila Campbell (1979), Clive Jermy (1980), Prof. C. Kidson (1981), Dr R.J. Bennett (1982).

Notes

1 Written by Daniel Lal Sander great grandson of R.B. Lal Singh in conjunction with Sukwant Singh (Stephen Sander) grandson of R.B. Lal Singh.

2 This paper began as a family history project. I would like to thank Helen Wang and her colleague Paramdip Khera, at the British Museum, for their help and for the invitation to contribute to this volume, and Sarah Strong at the Royal Geographical Society for providing the Appendix.

3 After Partition in 1947, Rai Bahadur Lal Singh's family home became part of Pakistan. As Sikhs, his family had to flee from their home village of Nurpur, northwest of Gujranwala District. Sukwant Singh (my father) moved to the USA and Canada, where, after humble beginnings as a schoolteacher, he developed a successful real estate business, Hollyburn Properties Ltd.

4 Hari Dawar was a Hindu holy city, to which Sikhs also made pilgrimage, and records of visits and of the deceased were kept here. Subsequently, Sikhs took family ashes to Kiratpur in Anandpur.

5 His mother, Un Devi. He brought these ashes with his brother, Hari Singh.

6 His wife, Har Kaur, and children Bulwant Singh, Sant Singh, Maya Devi and Shiv Devi.

7 Noran Devi was the first wife of his eldest son, Bulwant Singh. She died prematurely.

8 Tara Singh remembers he would bring his horse home with him when on leave.

9 Royal Geographical Society website, http://www.unlockingthearchives.rgs.org/glossary/default.aspx?word=great+trigonometrical+survey&x=49&y=4 (accessed January 2012).

10 M.A. Stein, 'Note on Maps Illustrating Dr. Stein's Explorations in Chinese Turkestan and Kansu', *The Geographical Journal*, vol. 37, no. 3 (Mar 1911), pp. 275–80, quote from p. 276.

11 M.A. Stein, 'Note on a Map of the Turfan Basin', The *Geographical Journal*, vol. 82, no. 3 (Sept 1933), pp. 236–46.

12 M.A. Stein, Report of the *Archaeological Survey Work in the North-West Frontier Province and Baluchistan*, January 1904-March 1905. Peshawar. See also Rienjang's paper in this volume.

13 Charles Dalrymple Bruce (1862–1934) served in India and China.

14 Annabel Walker, Aurel Stein, *Pioneer of the Silk Road*, John Murray, London, 1995, p. 175.

15 *The Times*, 6 April 1909, 10a.

16 M.A. Stein, *Innermost Asia: Detailed Report of Explorations in Central Asia, Kansu and Eastern Iran*, Oxford: Clarendon Press. [Reprinted 1981, New Delhi: Cosmo Publications]. For a bibliography of Stein's work see H. Wang and J. Perkins (eds), Handbook to the Collections of Sir Aurel Stein in the UK, London, 2008, Appendix 4.

17 M.A. Stein, *Memoir on Maps of Chinese Turkistan and Kansu, from the Surveys Made during Sir Aurel Stein's Explorations, 1900–1*, 1906–8, 1913–15 (with appendices by Major K. Mason and J. de Graaff Hunter), Trigonometrical Survey Office, Dehra Dun, 1923.
18 The Surveys of Sir Aurel Stein: Review (by K.M.), *Memoir on Maps of Chinese Turkistan and Kansu, from the Surveys Made during Sir Aurel Stein's Explorations, 1900–1, 1906–8, 1913–15* by Aurel Stein, *The Geographical Journal*, vol. 64, no. 2 (Aug 1924), pp. 165–8.
19 *Ibid.*, quote from p.168.
20 M.A. Stein, 'A third journey of exploration in Central Asia, 1913–16 (continued)', *The Geographical Journal*, vol. 48, no. 3 (Sept 1916), pp. 193–225, quote from p. 224.
21 'The Monthly Record', *The Geographical Journal*, vol. 49, no. 5 (May 1917), pp. 381–8; 'Meetings: Royal Geographical Society: Session 1916–1917', *The Geographical Journal*, vol. 50, no. 1 (July 1917), pp. 77–82, quote from p. 80.
22 C.D. Bruce, 'A journey across Asia from Leh to Peking', *The Geographical* Journal, vol. 29, no. 6 (June 1907), pp. 597–623, quote from p. 598. This article is illustrated with several photographs, including one of RBLS with the caption 'Surveyor Lall Sing and Rai Sahib at work on the top of Lanak La, 17,750 feet'.
23 *Ibid.*, pp. 604-6.
24 T. Holdich, Col. Bower, Capt. Deasy, N. Malcom and Major Bruce, 'A journey across Asia from Leh to Peking: Discussion, The *Geographical Journal*, vol. 29, no. 6 (June 1907), pp. 623–6, quote from pp. 623–4.
25 *Ibid.*, pp. 623–4.
26 Major Henry Hugh Peter Deasy (1866–1947).
27 *Ibid.*, p. 625.
28 Éva Apor, '*Sir Aurel Stein and his Hungarian background*', in H. Wang *(ed.) Sir Aurel Stein. Proceedings of the British Museum Study Day*, BM Research Publication 142, 2004, pp. 1–4, esp. p. 3.
29 See the paper by Sarah Strong and Helen Wang in this volume.
30 Stein's notes from his Fourth Expedition, Bodleian Library: M.S. Stein. 224, p. 127.
31 K.E. Ryavec, 'The present-day value of maps illustrating the archaeological surveys of Sir Aurel Stein in Xinjiang and Gansu', *Journal of the Royal Asiatic Society* , 3rd series, vol. 3, no. 2 (July 1993), pp. 233–43, quote from p. 233.
32 Letter from M.A. Stein to the Deputy Inspector General of Police, Lahore Circle, 2 July 1940, copy of letter in the author's possession.



Figure 1 Group at Ulugh-mazar. Ibrahim Beg, Chiang, Stein, Jasvant Singh, Lal Singh, Ram Singh, March 1908 (British Library, Photo 392/27 (376))

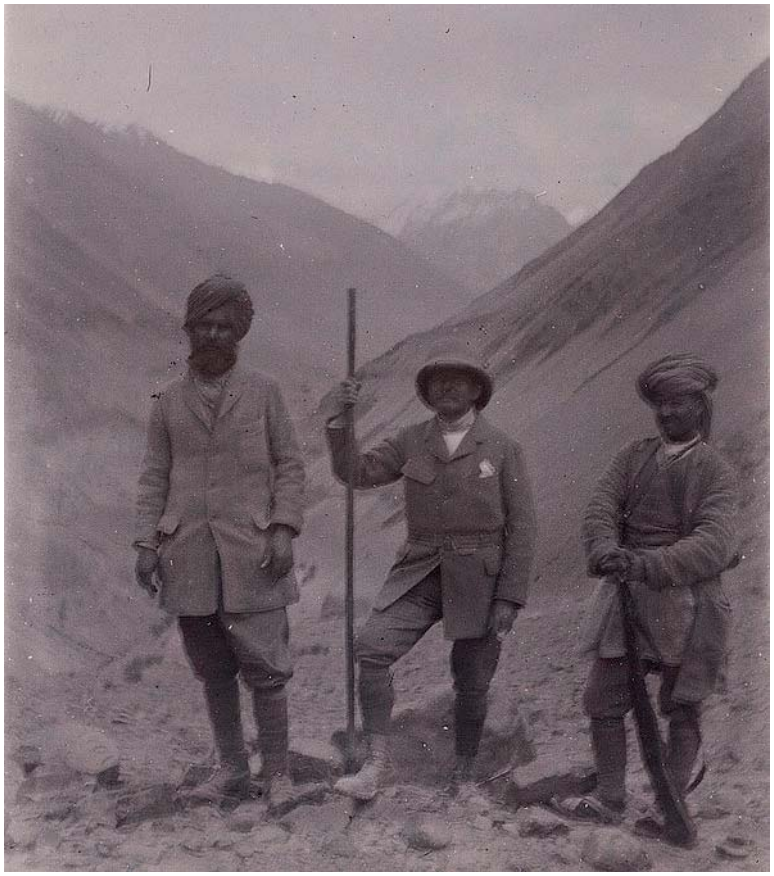


Figure 2 Group of Lal Singh, Stein and Afrazgul, at Rech, 5 September 1913 (British Library, Photo 392/28 (153))



Figure 3 Altmish-bulak. Lal Singh taking midday observation, 24 February 1914. British Library, Photo 392/28 (427) [detail]



Figure 4 Halt at Buk [Buk-tokhai], Etsingol. Lal Singh] and Isa Bai, 13 June 1914. British Library, Photo 392/28 (530)



Figure 5 Group (with Lal Singh) at Khitai Madrasa [Kara-khoja], 27 January 1915 (British Library, Photo 392/29 (243))



Figure 6 Camels with Lal Singh in centre, Yolchi-moinak, 19 July 1915 (British Library, Photo 392/29 (303))



Figure 7 Camels with Afrazgul, Lal Singh, Stein and Jasvant Singh at Yolchi-moinak, 19 July 1915 (British Library, Photo 392/29 (311))

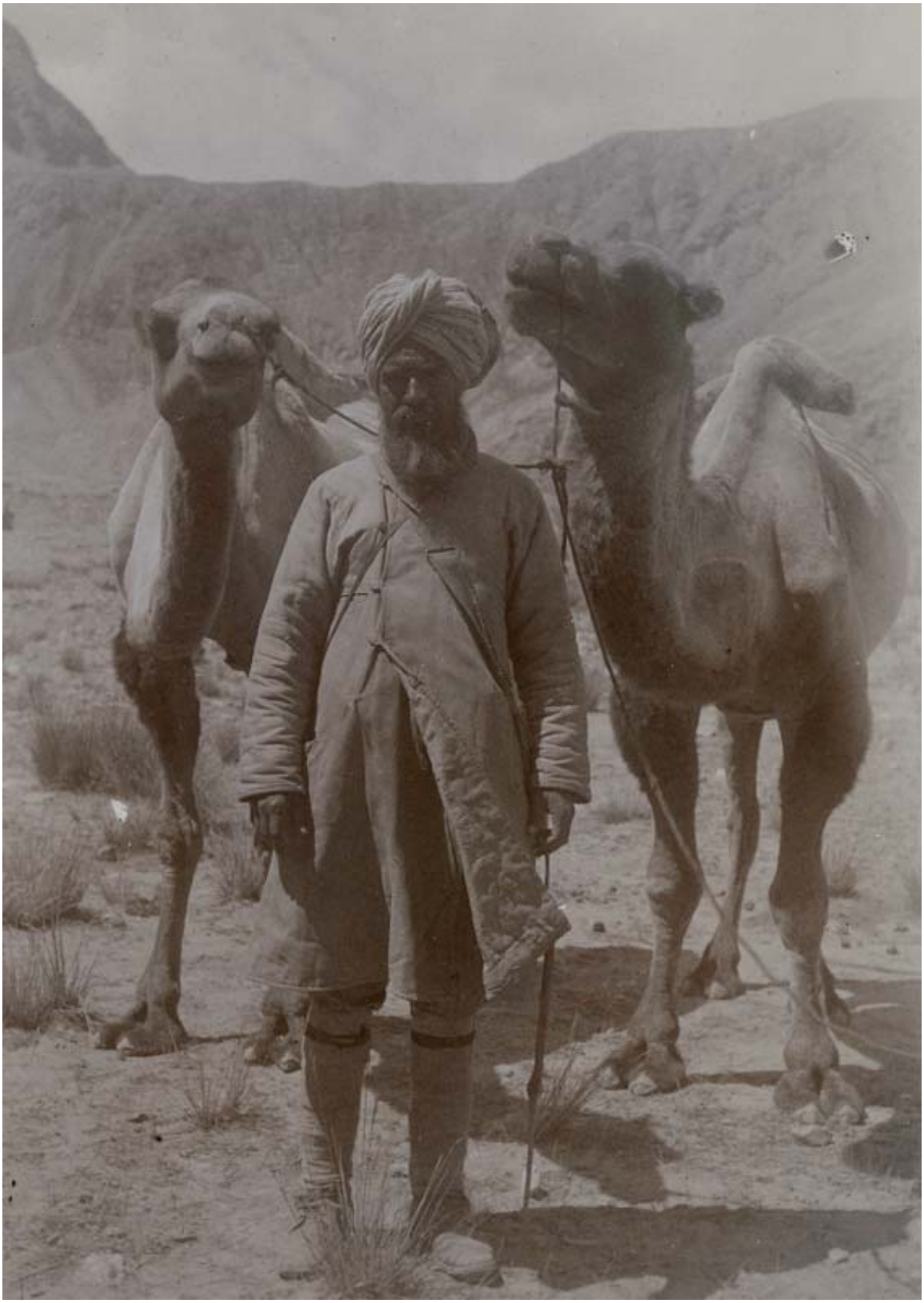


Figure 8 Lal Singh with camels, Yolchi-moinak, 19 July 1915 (British Library, Photo 392/28 (805))

‘Yours ever so sincerely’: Albert von le Coq seen through his correspondence with Aurel Stein

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‘Pray let me congratulate you to the work already done and still before you. The energy you develop is admirable & will serve as a beacon to me in my further labors’, reads a letter written in Berlin on the 9th of January 1923.[1] The addressee was the archaeologist and explorer Marc Aurel Stein, the author Albert von le Coq, then curator at the Museum of Ethnology who left no doubt as to his admiration for his colleague.

It is but one of a number of letters exchanged between 1908 and 1928 and thus this article originally set out to explore the relationship between the two men in the light of their correspondence.[2]

But when analysing the letters it became obvious that even after 20 years of correspondence, Aurel Stein maintained a polite distance, while a clear picture of the much more forthcoming von le Coq could be gained. Shifting the focus of research seemed all the more important because it turned out that the hitherto available information on von le Coq is sparse and, in part, different from what he tells. The aim of the text is therefore to correct common misconceptions and to complement our knowledge of Albert von le Coq by giving an overview of his life and career as described by his colleagues as well as himself in his letters to Aurel Stein.

Albert von le Coq (1860–1930)

As already mentioned, the information published on Albert von le Coq is patchy. In fact, the only detailed account of his life is the obituary written by the German Indologist Ernst Waldschmidt (1897–1985), who was von le Coq’s protégé and colleague at the Museum in Berlin before becoming professor for Indology at Göttingen University in 1936.[3] From what Waldschmidt tells us, Albert von le Coq was born in Berlin on the 8th of September 1860, a descendant of a Huguenot family. His father was a merchant who had inherited an already thriving business from his own father and expanded it further. Albert von le Coq was thus heir to a considerable fortune derived from wineries and breweries distributed all over Eastern and Central Europe.[4]

He went to two different secondary schools, the French secondary school (Französisches Gymnasium) in Berlin and another secondary school in Darmstadt. Shortly before getting his university-entrance diploma (Abitur), though, he was expelled because of his membership in an illegal students’ fraternity.[5] Having missed the chance to study at a German university, von le Coq went instead to London and the United States of America, where, from 1881 to 1887 he did a business apprenticeship and gained a diploma in medicine. Upon his return to Berlin, aged 27, he became a partner in the family business – a decision that seems to have been motivated by respect for his father much more than actual interest in the profession.[6] So it is not surprising that he sold the business soon after his father’s death and in 1900 he moved to Berlin where, at the age of 40, he could finally do what really interested him – he enrolled at the Seminar for Oriental languages at Berlin University.[7]

The same year he started working as a volunteer at the Museum of Ethnology in Berlin, first in the Department of Africa and Oceania, and subsequently in the Department of India. He soon became indispensable and within four years was put in charge of the second German Turfan-Expedition

(Deutsche Turfan-Expedition) upon which he embarked from September 1904 until December 1905.[8] In December 1905 the third expedition formally began when von le Coq's team was joined by Professor Albert Grünwedel in Kashgar. Although this expedition officially lasted until June 1907 von le Coq was forced to leave one year earlier than planned due to ill health. It would be another six years before he returned to the Silk Road city of Turfan and in the meantime he worked assiduously on the publication and exhibition of the finds. While some of his books proved to be very popular and sold out quickly,[9] the exhibition took far longer to arrange, and it was not until 1928 that the final installation of the objects took place.

Von le Coq's research focussed on a wide range of topics. He published on the Archaeology and Ethnology of Eastern Turkistan and translated a large number of Turkic manuscripts thereby making important contributions to the field of Manichaean studies.[10] Among art historians and archaeologists he is probably most famous for his six-volume work, *Die buddhistische Spätantike in Mittelasien*, but, like many of his contemporaries, he also wrote popular travel accounts (a 'pot-boiler', as he called one of them),[11] about the adventures of the German Turfan expeditions.[12]

In Summer 1909 le Coq received the honorary doctorate Dr Phil h[onoris] c[ausa] from the university of Kiel and on the 31st of March was additionally made Professor, which normally would not have been possible without a doctorate. Shortly afterwards, from January 1913 until February 1914, he made his last journey to the Silk Road and returned to Germany a few months before the beginning of the First World War (28th July 1914–11th Nov 1918).[13] Thereafter, he focussed exclusively on his work in the museum, a topic which features prominently in his letters. Having worked as an unpaid volunteer for 14 years, on the 1st of April 1914 he was finally made curator and on the 26th of April 1923, two years before reaching his retirement age, he became the head of the Department of India (Direktor der indischen Abteilung), a position that he held until the end of March 1930, less than one month before his death on the 21st of April.

'With best regards and thanks again for all the help' — favours and collaborations instead of competition

In terms of the Great Game and the Silk Road, much has been written about the competition among the different countries involved. For the participants of the expeditions, the pressure for success must have been extremely high and when reading some of Aurel Stein's letters to his friend and confidant Percy Stafford Allen (whom he affectionately called Publius) one can sense his tension at the arrival of teams from other European countries. While naturally all of them were competitors, in one letter Stein clearly states that the 'true race will be with the Frenchmen',[14] under the leadership of Paul Pelliot. The German team did not worry him so much, mainly because the official leader of the first and third German Turfan expedition, Albert Grünwedel, was known to be a 'slow-moving man'[15] who preferred in situ documentation over excavation and removal of objects. Nonetheless, Stein hoped that the German team would concentrate on sites north of the Taklamakan Desert, and thus stay out of his way. Learning about Grünwedel's plans for the third Turfan expedition he remarks:

> It is a relief to know that 'the party' will stick to Kuchar [a northern oasis] and may the genius loci and Grünwedel's personal disposition keep it there until I have got to Lop-nor.[16]

However, the competition between different nations seems not to have extended to a personal level and the 'rivalry' between Aurel Stein and Albert von le Coq[17] cannot be seen in the letters. On the contrary, a large part of the correspondence revolves around possible collaborations and the conditions under which these should take place. For example, nine letters written between the 20th of July and the 22nd of October 1910[18] record that Stein had contacted Friedrich Wilhelm Karl Müller at the Museum of Ethnology in Berlin to ask him for help in assessing a Manichaean manuscript acquired in Dunhuang. But Müller referred him to the person who was already in charge of the Manichaean texts found by the German Turpan expeditions – Albert von le Coq. Stein duly wrote to the latter and in his reply of the 20th of July 1910, the delighted von le Coq writes 'rest assured of my sincere gratitude for your friendly reminiscences and the honorable offer'.[19]

By October 1910 von le Coq had completed the translation of the manuscript (Ch. 0015), which turned out to be a Manichaean confession prayer, and it was published in an annotated form, with illustration, in January 1911.[20]

This was the first of several contributions that he made towards an understanding of Aurel Stein's finds and it seems to mark the beginning of a scholarly relationship of mutual 'give-and-take'. But while Aurel Stein never wrote any articles for von le Coq, the latter clearly asked for favours in return for his work. Although these were mostly rather small and flattering requests – for instance, inviting the famous explorer to become a Corresponding Member of the newly founded Gesellschaft für Ostasiatische Kunst (Society for East Asian Art)[21] – some of them were more demanding of Stein's time. Among other things, von le Coq frequently asked his English colleague for references and letters of introduction, sometimes for himself but mostly for young and promising scholars whom he supported by introducing them to already established academics or by raising money for travel scholarships. In a post-hyperinflation Weimar Republic this was a slow and difficult process, once described by von le Coq as being 'like growing teeth'.[22] But his reward would be the success of the second generation of Turfan scholars: Annemarie von Gabain, Ernst Waldschmidt and Wolfgang Lentz (to name but a few), who were among the finest experts in their field.

Stein, who had assistants rather than mentees, complied untiringly with these requests, though let slip his frustration with one of von le Coq's protégés who was sent to study the Stein Collection in the British Museum:

> I have tried to indicate to him what would be the best way for securing the extension of his permit which he is anxious about. That seems to be the matter which at present interests him most.[23]

In addition to supporting each other in their research and other things related to their academic lives, both men made sure that they sent copies of their latest publications

whenever they could. For Stein especially, this cannot have been an easy task as the list of recipients for his books must have been long. And von le Coq, clearly aware of the high demand in free copies, remarks in one letter:

> I am delighted to know, that you have again put me on the list … You certainly always treated me with great munificence & you may be sure that this great kindness will be duly appreciated.[24]

But the letters tell us more than who received which book or off-print – they give valuable insight into how both men viewed their own and each other's research. Impressed by Stein's untiring work and long list of publications, von le Coq often downplayed the value of his own books and articles. In one letter he even dismissed the impressive volumes of *Die Buddhistische Spätantike in Mittelasien* as a 'mere Bilderbuch'.[25] Stein, on the contrary, valued the information given in these richly illustrated books and remarks about the *Bilderatlas zu Kunst und Kulturgeschichte Mittel-Asiens*, a copy of which he received in 1925:

> I hasten to let you know that your splendid Bilderatlas has reached me today and to send my heartiest thanks for this charming and most welcome present. I need not assure you how much I appreciate the kind thought which prompted you in sending me this copy. Nor do I need to tell you at length what a source of most valuable information it will be for me. … Nobody can appreciate more than I do the value of the service which your atlas is furnishing to students of Central-Asian civilisation. … [I am] glad to have now in your Atlas a most convenient outil de travail at my disposal. It shall certainly accompany me to future camps, however light I must keep my baggage.[26]

Such scholarly praise and moral support clearly meant a lot to von le Coq who, being a late-starter in the fields of art history, archaeology and linguistics, must have sometimes felt insecure among more senior colleagues. His pride and joy at Stein's encouragement are best described in his own words written on the 24th of September 1922:

> I have been so pleased to hear that you got my Ethnographical work & the kind words you bestow on these labours have greatly elated me, coming from a man whom I reverence as the successful senior of the guild of central-asian investigators…[27]

Clearly, Albert von le Coq had no desire to compete with Stein, but instead valued his scholarly endorsement.

Beyond the academic relationship – tales of disputed theories and quarrels with 'the aesthetic school of art amateurs'

While the first letters written by Stein and von le Coq were rather formal, over the years mutual admiration and respect appear to have grown into friendship, at least from von le Coq's point of view. This was certainly also due to face-to-face encounters such as in the summer of 1925, when Albert von le Coq spent almost one month in London. Exactly how many times they met is impossible to tell from the correspondence, but Aurel Stein maintained his usual distance and never talked about his personal life and his feelings. The only time we sense some of the excitement and curiosity that must have been the driving force behind his work is in a letter semt from his favourite place, Mohand Marg in the Kashmir Valley, on the 25th of July 1926. Written shortly after his identification of Aornos, the site of Alexander the Great's last siege, an issue that had been debated for a long time by classicists, Stein's passion for the exploration of uncharted territory becomes obvious when he talks about his latest find:

> … what pleased me most was the opportunity I had of locating the chief site which figured in Alexander's campaign in this region… It means very strenuous work, including plenty of climbing, but I felt in my true element & enjoyed it greatly. I can scarcely hope again for a chance of working on ground both unexplored and enriched [?] by classical reminiscence.[28]

Compared with Stein's rather restrained letters, Albert von le Coq wrote on a much more personal level. From the 1920s on, he began to confide in Stein and told him openly not only of the political situation in the Weimar Republic but also of his personal trials and tribulations, health problems and his constant and painstaking search for funding. It is not entirely clear whether there was a specific reason for his trust but a comment von le Coq makes about his opus magnum *Die buddhistische Spätantike in Mittelasien* gives an interesting hint. On the 9th of January 1923 he informed Stein: 'I have this day given the text of the second volume to the printer – the old pleasure I used to feel in writing on such matters is gone & substituted by weaker emotions'.[29] He does not go into further detail himself, but a look at his obituaries clarifies the situation.

One of the central views von le Coq expressed in many of his publications – as in the *Buddhistische Spätantike* – was that Asian art had been influenced profoundly by Western, namely Greek, art. While a clear Greek (or rather Hellenistic) influence can be seen in the Gandharan-style Buddhist art found at many sites along the Silk Road, von le Coq seems to have been convinced that the exchange between East and West was almost unilateral and that Chinese culture could never have blossomed without Hellenistic influence. His approach becomes evident in titles such as *Auf Hellas Spuren in Ost-Turkistan* (1926) (In the footsteps of Hellas in East-Turkistan) and 'Die Brücke zwischen dem Hellenismus und dem Chinesentum' (The bridge between the Hellenistic and the Chinese worlds) (1924).[30] It is even more explicit in his descriptions of Silk Road cultures as 'a mixture of Indian and Iranian elements which have Hellenistic influences',[31] and the site of Khotan as a 'hearth of purely Hellenistic art exercises'.[32]

Such statements caused a stir in the academic community during von le Coq's lifetime, and different opinions were still being voiced after his death. While Waldschmidt generously credits his mentor for 'his avid contribution to the destruction of the delusion of an isolated development of the Chinese art',[33] Paul Pelliot is brutal in his dissatisfaction with von le Coq's theory. He sees him as a victim to the latest 'reverie, which, in Germany and France, denies the existence of Chinese bronzes earlier than the Han'.[34] His statement 'Many of us, and he knew it, refused to follow him on this path'[35] makes it clear that von le Coq found himself sailing against the wind.

The fact that Aurel Stein never openly criticised von le Coq but instead continued to compliment him on his work

and his publications, probably gave him the encouragement and reassurance he needed, but that other members of the academic community denied him for this particular part of his work.

These were not the only unpleasant situations von le Coq had to face. From 1922 to 1927 a large part of his time and energy was devoted to his personal differences with Otto Kümmel and William Cohn. Both men were considerably younger than von le Coq and had discovered their strong interest in Asian Art after they had gained degrees in different disciplines – Kümmel in European Art History, and Cohn in Philosophy. Years later they would not only found the Gesellschaft für Ostasiatische Kunst but also become influential figures in the development of the discipline of East Asian Art History in Germany.[36] In 1906, Otto Kümmel, then aged 32, became keeper of the Department of East Asian Art at the Ethnological Museum in Berlin. He was appointed by Wilhelm Bode, general director of all Berlin museums from 1905 to 1920. The original plan had been for the Department of Asia to become an independent museum, with Kümmel as director. But, without the necessary financial backing, the plan did not materialise and the Department of East Asian Art was integrated into the Ethnological Museum instead. This decision was not popular with the directors of the Ethnological Museum, Albert Grünwedel and Friedrich W.K. Müller.

But Kümmel did not bother them too much as he spent the first three years of his new job in Japan acquiring objects for the future Museum's collections. He also managed to organise just a single exhibition, in 1911, before he was called up to serve in the army during the First World War. Upon his return to Berlin in 1918 he intended to continue with the work already started and relied on Bode's word, the general director having promised him that he could pick objects from any other department of the Ethnological museum. This is how Kümmel, Cohn and von le Coq came to fall out – Kümmel and Cohn claimed the Central Asian objects.

Exactly when the quarrels started is unclear, and the names of Kümmel and Cohn appear for the first time in a letter dated the 24th of September 1922. Von le Coq starts to tell of the plans to restructure the display in the Museum using the collection of Indian Art as well as the Silk Road finds of the German Turfan-Expeditions. Then, he explains:

> The Generaldirektor had approved of our plans and we hoped to be able to realise a long entertained dream, when Cohn and Kümmel claimed all our Indian and Eastern Asiatic sculptures, as far as of any artistic value, for their collection.[37]

Kümmel might have been fourteen years younger than von le Coq but he had friends in high places and for a while it looked as if he was going to be successful. Von le Coq was forced to campaign for the rescue of his collection and to fight against the 'aesthetic school of art-amateurs',[38] as he called Kümmel and Cohn. But his efforts paid off and in the same letter he writes 'I saved Turfan & Gandhara, by mobilising my donators',[39] before reporting in a later letter, on the 9th of January 1923: 'the final outcome of this fight, which has kept me in a state of irritation for 9 months or more, has been a victory '.[40]

The so-called victory was short-lived though, and merely 18 months later Kümmel and Cohn appear again in the letters, because they now dismissed the objects originally selected as being worthless! One can only assume that this happened because Kümmel found it hard to cope with the unpleasant situation of being caught between Wilhelm von Bode's empty promises and Albert von le Coq's vehement protest, and that the only way to save his face was to prove that he was not interested in the objects in the first place. A rather upset von le Coq reports to Stein on the 14th of July 1924:

> The museum is in a state of chaos… Bode & his friends the Aesthetes have gained the upper hand. So I have to battle with William Cohn & O. Kümmel – men who call Turfan paintings & Gandhara sculpture trash. I have had hard times with these people whose manners as Laurence Binyon once wrote in the "Burlington" are on a level with their insight. [41]

These quarrels must have kept von le Coq busy for the better part of the next three years, and one can imagine his dismay when F.W.K. Müller retired as the director of the department of East Asian Art and Otto Kümmel was appointed as his successor. Since the post also carried the responsibility for the ethnographical collections, von le Coq worried greatly about the future of the objects

> (...) all ethnography, barring such objects as may appeal to his sense of beauty, is in his eyes only rubbish! So there are again breakers ahead! I begin to tire of these unceasing difficulties.[42]

But his fears were unnecessary as both Kümmel and Cohn made considerable efforts to restore the peace, for instance by electing von le Coq to be a member of the steering committee of the Gesellschaft für Ostasiatische Kunst which they founded in 1926.

After more than 20 years of internal quarrelling it is hardly surprising that von le Coq expressed great relief at having 'buried the tomahawk'[43] and 'smoked the peace-pipe'.[44] Stein, who had the interests of science and research uppermost in his mind, agreed with him, saying:

> I was very glad to read what you wrote about your peace with D. Kümmel. I am sure it will be for the advantage of everybody and to that to the interests of research which is the main thing.[45]

'Conditions are constantly turning from bad to worse' – financial problems and health issues

Apart from the quarrels with Kümmel and Cohn, two other topics feature quite prominently in von le Coq's letters: health issues and financial problems. It is well-known that von le Coq ruined his health when participating in the third German Turfan-Expeditions and it was due to serious health problems that he had to leave thirteen months early in June 1906. He appeared to have recovered well, and seven years later was fit enough to participate in the fourth expedition, which took place from March 1913 to March 1914.

The real extent of his health problems, though, becomes obvious in his letters, where maladies such as colds, influenza, mumps, throat infections and fatigue are often given as the reason for not replying earlier or quicker. He was susceptible to infection and what might seem like a trifle to another person was a more serious illness for von le Coq, who talks frequently about being forced to spend days and even weeks

in bed. Some of these troubles were probably self-induced. He did not cut any slack, working overtime in the museum most days without a break for lunch – a strategy that clearly backfired. At the same time, there may have been some psychosomatic elements, too: his letters reveal a man who worried about being sick and got sick because he worried so much. The tales of his illnesses are a leitmotif running through his letters and they are seldom delivered with the amount of humour displayed in a letter written on the 23rd of September 1927, in which he remarks: 'It appears that every unemployed bacillus considers my poor body as a convenient inn'.[46]

It is surprising to find that a major cause of worry for von le Coq was the state of his finances. Surprising because the average biography usually states that he inherited a great fortune thereby implying that he could study and travel to his heart's content. When von le Coq first moved to Berlin in 1900 this was probably the case but the German inflation of the years 1914 to 1923 seems to have left him as poor as many other people.

While remarks like 'Things are looking quite desperately again (…) a lb [?] of veal costing now M 3000 !'[47] are of a more general nature, a letter written in autumn 1922 leaves no doubt as to the seriousness of his personal situation. In response to Aurel Stein's request for help in finding a scholar suitable to do some work on the index of a geographical memoir, von le Coq simply replied:

> I should like to undertake the work myself & I would like to do it out of interest for the thing. But conditions are constantly turning from bad to worse & I am forced to make some money beyond what the State now allows me (…) I therefore enquire whether you can offer any employment.[48]

The matter was discussed in several letters but in the end, Stein did not employ von le Coq and somebody else finished the index. Six months later, in April 1923, von le Coq was promoted from curator to the Head of the India Department, but even this was not sufficient to alleviate his financial situation, as an interesting conversation revolving around a gift made in 1924 shows. Upon receiving the present, the German scholar writes with almost overflowing gratitude:

> When I arrived, I was delighted to find an enormous box of this delicious Kangra tea waiting for me & as there is no one to whom I can attribute so charming a gift, I hasten to send you my grateful thanks. This will be a precious gift when the cold properly sets in & I shall ever drink of it in kind remembrance of the donator.

No matter how great his joy, von le Coq had to pay tax on goods sent to him from abroad which lead to the much more pragmatic postscript: 'P.s.: If you could send me a letter or card stating that this tea is a "Liebesgabe" I should get refunded the tax put on it'. [49] As usual, Stein complied with his request and von le Coq reports on the 8th of December 1924:

> The customs people promptly handed back to me the 10|- [|- probably meaning "Rentenmark", the German currency 1923–1948] they had charged me on your generous gift, which by the way possesses a most delicious flavour.[50]

In addition to the general devaluation of the German currency, von le Coq was in a dire situation regarding his pension. By the time he reached retirement age in 1925, he had been employed for less than 12 years and was entitled to a very meagre pension. The 14 years of volunteering had cost him dearly. His refusal to accept this situation is seen clearly in a letter written on the 23rd of December 1925:

> I have been so busy fighting for a better pension – I am only entitled to a very trifling one! – that I have had to neglect all correspondence. I am glad to be able to report to you, that my endeavours have been successful & that, while this success is far from securing for me riches, I am yet protected from actual want & can make both ends meet'.[51]

It is doubtful whether both ends really met and Waldschmidt explains that von le Coq continued working for a very low salary at the museum after reaching retirement age in 1925.[52] His trip to London was only possible because he received a travel grant and while he seems to have greatly enjoyed his one-month visit to the United Kingdom, the high cost of living partly spoilt the fun for him. 'Things are so dear now in London that I am quite aghast'[53] he writes on the 20th of July 1925 in one of the last letters before his unexpectedly early return to Germany. The reason for this is mentioned in one of the next letters where he thanks Stein for providing the address of Lady Macartney 'to whom I will send those negatives on pay-day next – my exchequer having badly suffered from my London visit'.[54]

The content of the letters makes it clear that the picture hitherto given of von le Coq's finances has been oversimplified and while it was implied earlier that he was a worrier, his statements in regard to his financial troubles are confirmed by his wife Elinor von le Coq, who corresponded with Aurel Stein after her husband's death.[55] The letters therefore help us gain a better impression of a man who might have started his life as wealthy heir but whom the hyperinflation hit just as hard as millions of other Germans.

'He has always spoken with great, warm friendship of you and your colossal work'

Albert von le Coq passed away on the 21 of April 1930, at the age of 70, in his home in Berlin. The lecture he had been expected to give on 23 April at a conference in Istanbul, was replaced with a memorial service. Obituaries were published in journals such as *T'oung Pao, Artibus Asiae* and *Berliner Museen*, as well as *The Times*. The most interesting of these was written by Paul Pelliot and contains a number of personal anecdotes which give further insight into von le Coq's character. As a fellow German, I cannot help but smile at what must have been one of von le Coq's last deeds, that could be interpreted as a perfect example if not of 'Deutsche Gründlichkeit' (German thoroughness), then of 'von le Coq'sche Gründlichkeit'. Pelliot describes it as follows:

> When von le Coq felt the hour of the Great Departure [*separation supreme*] approaching, he bought mourning envelopes[56] without the knowledge of his wife, and thus we, his friends, received obituary notices with the address written in his own hand.[57]

Aurel Stein must have received one of these last hand-written envelopes too, although the regular correspondence

between the two men ceased two years earlier. The last letter from le Coq to Stein is dated the 2nd of July 1928 and repeats, as if to summarise, many of things that have been discussed in earlier paragraphs. Once again, Otto Kümmel is mentioned. At that point he had not only succeeded F.W.K. Müller as director of the East Asia section but also von le Coq 'in India, Central Asia including Turfan, Tibet & Western Asia'.[58] The latter had clearly come to terms with these circumstances and remarked in an unusually reflective mood: 'too much time, too much energy has been wasted in ceaseless wrangling – these 20 years!'[59]

Relationships might have changed but von le Coq's research paradigms had clearly stayed the same. In reaction to Aurel Stein's latest finds he writes:

> But – I always thought that some of these Border sites would bring us also Hellenistic things, say of 250 before Chr. (…) I am longing for the discovery of Ante-Buddhist Greek things & I should be extremely gratified if you succeeded in putting your hands on these as well'.[60]

Stein's response was simple yet disappointing, 'I am afraid no Hellenistic remains (…).' [61]

The last letter Albert von le Coq received in person was written on the 28th of September 1928, but after von le Coq had passed away Stein corresponded with his wife Elinor for about a year. From these letters we get to know that Frau von le Coq, who had always been very supportive of her husband's academic career,[62] made every effort to complete his work. In co-operation with Ernst Waldschmidt she even edited the seventh and last volume of *Die buddhistische Spätantike*, which was published posthumously in 1933.

A 'museum man' and a 'man of fieldwork' – an impossible friendship?

The correspondence with Aurel Stein gives us a much clearer impression of Albert von le Coq's character and life. Although a late starter in terms of the career of an academic, expedition leader or museum curator, he applied himself with determination and perseverance, often at the expense of his health. He worked hard to understand and publish the material brought back from the German Turfan-Expeditions and even fought his colleagues for the right to look after the objects he cherished so much. While some of his views were controversial and therefore unpopular with other academics, the opposition he faced could not change the fact that he was one of the foremost scholars in his field. Despite this, he remained a down-to-earth person who wrote both scholarly tomes and popular travel accounts and gave unfailing support to promising young students with a view to developing a second generation of Turfan scholars.

But the letters also hint at how unlike Albert von le Coq and Aurel Stein were. These differences can partly be explained by the way both men were raised and educated but must also be seen in the context of their individual careers, which were at different stages when most of the correspondence was written. Perhaps they are best described by Aurel Stein who once characterised himself as 'a man of fieldwork'[63] and Albert von le Coq as 'museum man'[64].

The terms should not be interpreted as a judgement, though, and each man seems to have at times even envied his respective counterpart for his profession. Von le Coq often waxes lyrically about his travels remarking 'I still love to think of the 10 months or so I spent in that out-of-the-way-place – the days … there will always be numbered amongst the happiest of my life'.[65] Aurel Stein, on the contrary, seems to have longed for some more time not just to excavate but also research his finds, and once replied to von le Coq's accounts of his work at the Museum 'I can well understand why you look upon it as a paradise – except when visitors and the like claim too much time'.[66]

The correspondence between Albert von le Coq and Aurel Stein is characterised by mutual appreciation and respect, and the fierce competition some authors claim to have existed is not visible in their letters to each other. No matter how big the differences in character and approach to research, their shared passion for the art of the Silk Road must have been a strong enough bond to overcome them.

Notes on the correspondence

Altogether four institutions hold either originals or typed transcripts of letters and postcards written by Albert von le Coq and Aurel Stein – the British Library in London (MS Stein.11), the Bodleian Library in Oxford (MS Stein.91), the Museum of Asian Art in Berlin (TA Berlin) and the Library of the Hungarian Academy of Sciences, Budapest[67]. (see Tables 1 and 2).

Most of the documents are hand-written in English or German – languages both men were fluent in – but occasionally contain single words or even whole phrases in French, Latin and Classical Greek. Since neither Stein nor von le Coq stopped writing to the other when travelling abroad letters were sent from Berlin, Oxford and London but also from more distant and hard-to-reach places such as Kashgar, Rawak Pindi, Turfan and the lower Swat Valley. 20 years (1908–1928), of communication are represented through the known documents, although there is a break lasting from February 1914 to December 1921. This could partly be connected to the First World War (28th July 1914–11th Nov 1918), but it is also generally unlikely that the complete correspondence has been preserved. Many of the letters kept in the British Library for instance are labelled 'please destroy' and it can be assumed that these orders were followed in some cases. Sadly, Aurel Stein often used a kind of ink that has faded over the years leaving some of his letters practically illegible. Thus, the bigger part of the documents taken into consideration for this article were sent by Albert von le Coq.



Figure 1 Portrait of Albert von le Coq, possibly taken at the opening of his exhibition in 1928 (Bundesarchiv; image 102-18442; photographer unknown)

Table 1: Overview of the total number of letters and the institution where they are kept

	British Library, London	Bodleian Library, Oxford	Museum of Asian Art, Berlin	Library of the Hungarian Academy of Sciences, Budapest
von le Coq → Stein	1	45	1	18
Stein → von le Coq	-	34	10	12

Table 2: Number of letters listed according to date

	1908–12	1913–17	1918–22	1923–28
British Library, London	-	1 (1914)	-	-
Bodleian Library, Oxford	-	-	4 (1921–1922)	75? (five letters without date)
Museum of Asian Art, Berlin	10	-	-	1
Library of the Hungarian Academy of Sciences, Budapest	27	-	-	3

Notes

1 MS Stein.91 folio 51v.

2 I am very much indebted to Dr Lilla-Russell Smith and CarenDreyer at the Museum of Asian Art in Berlin who kindly providedthe digitised versions of the letters from their archive. ProfessorWolfgang Klose shared a lot of interesting information about OttoKümmel, William Cohn and Wilhelm von Bode with me, for which I thank him sincerely. I would also like to extend my thanks to Dr Helen Wang for getting me interested in this correspondence in the first place. Last but not least I would like to express my gratitude forthe support given by Mr Wednesday.

3 For a brief biography of Ernst Waldschmidt see the web page of the Institute for Indology at Göttingen University http://www.indologie.uni-goettingen.de/cms/index.php?id=13.Waldschmidt's text was used as a source for other obituaries, such as the one published by Paul Pelliot in the journal *T'oung Pao* which is a translation that has been complemented with additional information as well as personal accounts. An anonymous obituary was published in *The Times*: 'Dr Le Coq. Archaeologist and Explorer (Obituaries)', *The Times*, 25 Apr 1930, p. 14; issue 45496. It should be mentioned that Peter Hopkirk gives some biographical information about von le Coq, too, but without mentioning any sources; see *P. Hopkirk, Foreign Devils on the Silk Road: the search for the lost treasures of Chinese Central Asia*, Oxford University Press, 1980; pp. 114–15 in the OUP 1984 reprint.

4 Interestingly enough, a brewery producing beer, cider and softdrinks under the name of 'Albert le Coq' exists until this day in Estonia. A look at the English webpage revealed that the trademark was established in London in 1807 by another Albert von le Coq, possibly the grandfather of the later archaeologist. Although the Albert von le Coq in focus here is not directly mentioned, the company seems to be aware of the connection and has even (ab)used the well-known photograph of von le Coq, Bartus and Isa Khan (see http://idp.bl.uk/idp_crea/pages/AK4_MIKB955.html) to create a seemingly old commercial, which shows Albert von le Coq sitting on a giant beer bottle (see http://www.alecoq.ee/eng/company/history).

5 E. Waldschmidt, 'Albert von le Coq', Berliner Museen, 51. Jahrgang, Heft 3 (1930), pp. 52–53 (this reference to p. 52).

6 H. Zimmer, 'Albert von le Coq', Artibus Asiae, vol. 4, no. 1 (1930–32), pp. 70–73 (this reference to p. 70).

7 The available documentation does not clarify whether von le Coq had the status of a proper student or was regarded as the equivalent of what would be called Gasthörer (literally 'guest listener') today, i.e. a person who studies for his or her own interest and not in order to gain a degree. The titles he was awarded later were honorary degrees.

8 Additional information about the Expeditions can be found in von le Coq's own publication *Auf Hellas Spuren in Ost-Turkistan: Berichte und Abhandlungen der II. und III. Deutschen Turfan-Expedition, Leipzig*, 1926, esp. pp. 8–9. The webpage of the International Dunhuang Project (IDP), based at the British Library, is also always an excellent source of information. cf. http://idp.bl.uk/pages/collections_de.a4d#1.

9 MS Stein.91 folio 51v.

10 P. Zieme, 'Albert von Le Coq und die manichäischen Studien', *Acta Orientalia Academiae Scientiarum Hungaricae* 63 (2010), pp. 1–8.

11 MS Stein.91 folio 133v.

12 A. von le Coq, Auf Hellas Spuren; and Von Land und Leuten in Ostturkistan: Berichte und Abenteuer der 4. Deutschen Turfanexpedition, Leipzig, 1928.

13 Even though no letters were written during those four years, it can be assumed that at the age of 54, von le Coq was considered too old to serve in the army during the war. But a letter written by his wife Elinor von le Coq, who corresponded with Aurel Stein after her husband's death, mentions the loss of their only son in the war (MS Stein.91 folio 159r). This is confirmed in the obituary written by Heinrich Zimmer, 'Albert von le Coq', *Artibus Asiae*, vol. 4, no.1 (1930–32), pp. 70–73, esp. p. 72.

14 M.A. Stein to P.S. Allen, 6th January 1906, quoted by J. Mirsky, Sir Aurel Stein. Archaeological Explorer, Chicago University Press, 1977, p. 230.

15 *Ibid.*

16 M.A. Stein to P.S. Allen, 20th January 1906, quoted by Mirsky 1977, p. 231.

17 f.i. Mirsky 1977, p. 354.

18 TA 3076-3101.

19 TA 3078: 'Ich bitte sie, für Ihr freundl. Gedenken und das ehrenvolle Angebot meines Dankes versichert zu sein.'

20 A.von le Coq, 'Dr Stein's Turkish Khuastuanift from Tun-huang. Being a confession-prayer of the Manichaean auditors', *Journal of the Royal Asiatic Society*, vol. 43, no. 2 (1911), pp. 277–314.

21 MS Stein.91 folio 146r.

22 MS Stein.91 folio 118.

23 MS Stein.91 folio 98r.

24 MS Stein.91 folio no.num.

25 MS Stein.91 folio 51v: a 'mere picture book'.

26 MS Stein.91 folio 115.

27 MS Stein.91 folio 48r.

28 MS Stein.91 folio 129v.

29 MS Stein.91 folio 51.

30 Von le Coq, *Auf Hellas Spuren in Ost-Turkistan*. The English version of *this volume* (literally 'In the footsteps of Hellas in Eastern Turkistan') was published under the title *Buried Treasures of Chinese Turkestan* in 1928. A. von le Coq, 'Die Brücke zwischen dem Hellenismus und dem Chinesentum', *Velhagen und Clasing Monatshefte* 38 (1924), Heft 10, pp. 400–21.

31 Von le Coq, *Auf Hellas Spuren*, p. 24.

32 *Ibid.*: 'Herd rein hellenistischer Kunstübungen' (ibd.).

33 Waldschmidt 1930, p. 53: 'hat eifrig dazu beigetragen, den Wahn einer isolierten Entwicklung der chinesischen Kunst zu zerstören'.

34 P. Pelliot, 'Albert von le Coq', *T'oung Pao*, second series, vol. 27, no. 2/3 (1930), pp. 241–43, esp. p. 242: 'les rêveries récentes qui, en Allemagne et en France, ont voulu nie l'éxistence de bronzes chinois antérieurs aux Han'.

35 Pelliot, 'Albert von le Coq', p. 242: 'Beaucoup d'entre nous, et il le savait, se refusaient à le suivre dans cette voie.'

36 For lack of space Cohn and Kümmel will not be introduced in great detail here, but further information can be found under the menu item 'Ostasien in Berlin' on the excellent webpage of Wolfgang and Christine Klose. http://www.w-ch-klose.de/html/ostasien_in_berlin.html (in German).

37 MS Stein.91 folio 47–48.

38 MS Stein.91 folio 51r.

39 MS Stein.91 folio 47v.

40 MS Stein.91 folio 51r.

41 MS Stein.91 folio 64v.

42 MS Stein.91 folio 145v.

43 MS Stein.91 folio 150v.

44 MS Stein.91 folio 157r.

45 MS Stein.91 folio 158r.

46 MS Stein.91 folio 150r.

47 MS Stein.91 folio 52.

48 MS Stein.91 folio 48v.

49 MS Stein.91 folio 79v.

50 MS Stein.91 folio 82r.

51 MS Stein.91 folio 123r.

52 Waldschmidt, 'Albert von le Coq', 1930, p. 53.

53 MS Stein.91 folio 109.

54 MS Stein.91 folio121v.

55 MS Stein.91 folio 172r.

56 'Mourning envelopes' are used in Germany until this day. They are usually printed with a black frame and sometimes the lining tissue of the envelopes is black, too.

57 Pelliot, 'Albert von le Coq', 1930, p. 243; 'Quand von le Coq sentit approcher l'heure de la séparation suprême, il acheta des enveloppes de deuil, a l'insu de sa femme, et nous, ses amis, avons reçu les lettres de faire-part dont l'adresse est écrite de sa propre main.'

58 MS Stein.91 folio 157r.

59 MS Stein.91 folio 156v–157r.

60 MS Stein.91 folio 156v.

61 MS Stein.91 folio 158v.

62 J. Kritzeck, 'Albert von Le Coq', The Princeton University Library Chronicle, vol. 23, no.3 (1962), pp.115–20.

63 MS Stein.91 folio 153r.

64 MS Stein.91 folio 129v.

65 MS Stein.91 folio 66r.

66 MS Stein.91 folio 152v.

67 Unfortunately, the letters kept in Budapest could not be taken into

account to write this article. They will be analysed separately at a later time.

Fraternity on the Silk Road:
The Relationship of Aurel Stein and Sven Hedin

Esteban Morin

Independent Researcher

According to a speech given by the British Indologist L.D. Barnett,[1] Aurel Stein fingered a small object in his pocket at an informal, invitation-only dinner hosted by the Royal Geographic Society in 1909.[2] Having recently returned from his second expedition to Central Asia, Stein was one of the most famed and admired men in the world, yet here among friends, he felt unusually nervous. Unsure how to return the object to its rightful owner, the explorer abruptly pulled it from his pocket and pressed it into the hand of Major Leonard Darwin, the President of the RGS. After a quick look at the object – a silver-check metal tape measure – Darwin passed it to Sven Hedin at the opposite end of the table, who examined it carefully. A smile spread across the Swede's face, as he recognized the tool he had left behind in Loulan eight years earlier. Lively conversation followed, and that night, Hedin resolved that he would recommend that his own country's geographic society should award Stein a commendation. Subsequently, Hedin presented the tape measure to the RGS as a poignant reminder of this moment, which exemplified the hundreds of ways in which the two men's careers intersected. The tape measure (or its case) is a testament to Stein and Hedin's relationship (**Fig. 1**), and bears the inscription

> LEFT BY / DR SVEN HEDIN MARCH 1901 / NORTH OF LOP-NOR, CENTRAL ASIA 1901 / FOUND DECEMBER 23 1906 / BY DR M.A. STEIN / PRESENTED BY / DR SVEN HEDIN / TO THE ROYAL GEOGRAPHICAL SOCIETY / FEBRUARY 1909.

Stein and Hedin were international celebrities by the time of the 1909 RGS dinner, and it is due in part to their reliance on each other that they each attained such fame and popularity. Although the men had very different aspirations, skills and personalities, their careers intersected early on, and remained entwined for many years. The relationship shared by the Swedish explorer and the Hungarian archaeologist was mutual, with each man taking from it what he desired the most. Hedin played an important role in first inspiring Stein and continually helping him to prove himself as a leading archaeologist. In a similar vein, Stein validated the accuracy of many of Hedin's maps and descriptions of foreign lands, which was vitally important to the Swede's reputation as a



Figure 1 Measuring tape left by Sven Hedin in Central Asia in 1901 and found by Aurel Stein in 1906. Presented to the RGS in 1909 (RGS ref: 700606/D1, Royal Geographical Society)

cartographer and explorer. Stein and Hedin shared a personal bond, and never attempted to interfere with each other's work even in a period marked by intense competition on the Silk Road. Thus, although the two men appear to have met only once in their lives – at the RGS dinner – the importance of their professional rapport cannot be overlooked.

The relationship between Sven Hedin and Aurel Stein dates back to the earliest days of Stein's career as an archaeologist, when the Swedish explorer inspired him to head out in search of the forgotten ruins of Asia. Despite a disastrous incident in the Taklamakan Desert, Hedin completed his first major expedition in 1897, and triumphantly returned to Europe an established explorer. News of the Swede's maps of previously uncharted territory and his accounts of long lost desert cities caught the public's imagination, as well as the respect of the academic world. Thus began Hedin's rise to prominence. The following years brought him the praise of virtually every major geographic institution in the world, including the Royal Geographic Society, which noted that he 'continues his work with untiring energy, and we may safely say that so rich a harvest of scientific results has rarely fallen to the lot of any traveler.'[3] Enthusiastically fanning the flames of his growing reputation as an adventurer by publishing romantic stories of his time in Asia in the popular book *Through Asia* in 1898, Hedin caught the attention of Oriental studies scholars worldwide. One of these scholars was the young Hungarian Marc Aurel Stein, whose brother, Ernst, sent him a 'clipping on Sven Hedin's travels' in 1897.[4] Were it not for the Swede's fame and the world's interest in his expeditions, Stein would not have received the fateful clipping that first inspired him to organize his own expedition. The spotlight that Hedin's early discoveries shed on the hidden treasures of Asia, however, were not the only contribution he made to the young Hungarian's career.

Many of Stein's letters and notes from 1900 indicate that Hedin played an important, albeit indirect, role in the organization and execution of his first expedition. Procuring funds and approval from the Indian and British governments for an expedition into China was a difficult task for Stein. Stein had proven himself as a capable academic, yet was now seeking to do archaeological fieldwork in largely unexplored areas. While Stein's abilities in the field were unproven, officials knew and trusted Hedin, who had reported the existence of lost cities in the deserts of Asia and had mapped their locations. It was thus imperative that Stein convince his superiors that the reports in Hedin's book, *Through Asia* were accurate in order to obtain the funds and clearance necessary to enter Khotan.[5] Additionally, Stein stirred the pot of nationalistic rivalry and hastened his clearance by emphasizing that 'Dr. Sven Hedin's explorations … are likely to be resumed.'[6] Although Stein was well aware that Hedin was an explorer and not an archaeologist, and thus not in direct competition with him, the mere presence of the famed Swede in China was enough to push the British authorities to entrust him with the resources he needed.[7] In this way, the Hungarian scholar staked his entire future on the writings of Sven Hedin, and utilized the Swede's popularity to his advantage.

Hedin's maps and writings were vital to Stein as he ventured into the Taklamakan. Reassuring his skeptical superiors that 'I have the advantages of Sven Hedin's experiences,'[8] Stein explained that 'one of the most valuable sources of information [for me] was Sven Hedin's book, *Through Asia* [which included] notes on the names of hills, deserts, and towns; stories and superstitions; the price of camels.'[9] Stein had such confidence in the Swedish explorer that he even tracked down 'the two men who had guided Hedin,'[10] a tradition which he continued in his second and third expeditions. From the start, Stein placed his trust in the accuracy of Hedin's cartographic skills, and entered into situations in which 'the sole means of finding [a location] was by compass and Hedin's sketch-map.'[11] The Hungarian's dependence on these maps was recognized by the entire world, including a smug Sven Hedin, who acknowledged that because 'nothing else existed from this part of Asia except my map I should have had a terrible responsibility for his fate if he had not found the inland or desert delta of the river.'[12] Although Hedin had a reputation for exaggeration, it is difficult to deny that Stein's fate was squarely dependent on the Swedish explorer. Hedin's maps thus ensured Stein's survival and led him straight to the ancient ruins he was seeking. Upon reaching his destination, Stein proceeded to develop Hedin's work further by excavating the sites and recording them more fully, and, with the help of experts from Dehra Dun, by adding to Hedin's record of exploration. Accordingly, when Stein returned from Central Asia, he fixed the eyes of the world on both himself and the man who blazed the trail for his discoveries.[13]

The benefits that Hedin reaped from Stein's accomplishments became evident after the Hungarian archaeologist's first expedition, and were of no small significance. While Stein directly referenced the Swede's books for vital, up-to-date information about the areas he passed through,[14] Hedin attained further validation as his maps and reports proved helpful to other known figures. The explorer's key interest and motivation was the discovery of new sites, and while he always harboured the hope that 'these ruined cities would sometime be made the subject of expert archaeological excavation and examination,'[15] his personal interests never strayed from cartography. As such, the greatest testament to his skill was the validation of his work's accuracy and authenticity by other members of the academic community. Stein's position as the first European to follow the Swede's footsteps into the depths of Asia put him in a unique position to judge Hedin. A single incorrect calculation by Hedin could have led the Hungarian to his death, and singularly discredited his entire corpus of the explorer's work. Yet far from discrediting Hedin, the overwhelming results of Stein's first expedition served as a testament to the validity of the explorer's reports and ethnographic notes, and cemented Hedin's reputation as a master cartographer.[16]

In addition to academic validation, Hedin also enjoyed popular recognition as a result of Stein's triumphs, which the Swede valued tremendously. Aurel Stein was a modest man in many regards, and openly admitted his reliance on Hedin's work in his letters and publications. Hedin, on the other hand, had a penchant for the romantic and enjoyed few things more than having his name associated with a notable



Figure 2 *The Illustrated London News*, 30 January 1909, 'Man of the moment'

discovery. While it would be unfair to accuse Hedin of taking undue credit for the work of his Hungarian colleague, the explorer never failed to mention that Stein 'was guided by my maps'[17] when interviewed, and referred to the sites that Stein excavated using his writings as 'my old cities.'[18] His efforts to gain recognition were not in vain. After Stein returned from his first expedition in 1901, respectable publications such as the *Geographic Journal* started referring to Hedin's 'characteristic thoroughness,'[19] and regarded him as an admirable adventurer. Stein's expeditions further aided the explorer's rise to prominence by supplying the Swede with additional observations and data from the sites first visited by Hedin. In fact, Hedin only reached his famous solution to the mystery concerning the lakes of Lop-nor after Stein returned from the region with the material necessary for comparison and conclusion. Stein thus provided fuel for Hedin's rise from a mere explorer to world hero and celebrity Orientalist, and ensured that the Swede would have a role in world politics and geography into the 1930s.

Beyond the professional relationship shared by Stein and Hedin, the two men also felt a personal connection to each other. Although it is inaccurate to call the archaeologist and explorer friends, the writings of the two men indicate that their respect for one another extended beyond their work. Stein had admired Hedin from his earliest days, and frequently sought to meet the man who had inspired him to explore the desert ruins of Asia. The Hungarian's desire to speak personally with Hedin was coupled with sincere disappointment when his plans fell through, as seen in a 1908 letter in which Stein expressed that, 'to my great regret, I missed Sven Hedin again.'[20] Hedin was not as anxious to meet the archaeologist who contributed so much to his fame, yet made an effort to express in public his personal fondness for Stein. In addition to referring to the Stein as a friend, the Swede sent a special telegram to the Royal Geographic Society expressing his 'sincere and deep admiration for the splendid work Dr. Stein has carried out.'[21] Hedin's books provide further evidence of his fondness for the Hungarian. In his writings, Hedin gloats that he recommended Stein for a special Swedish medal,[22] and defends Stein from the accusations of grave robbery by indignantly pointing out 'if a European goes out into the desert and finds a few wretched graves, not even of Chinese origin, he is accused of theft and robbery and subjected to persecution.'[23] Even when Hedin's pro-German beliefs were tarnishing his own reputation, his books continued to reflect great admiration for his British-affiliated colleague, who himself never spoke out against the Swede's wayward political views.

The significance of the interplay and relationship between Stein and Hedin extends far beyond the discoveries and careers of the two men. Their individual and symbiotic success in the field sparked off competition among European nations and Japan in search of missing links between the East and the West, which in turn drew increased attention from China itself.

This cumulative effort yielded thousands of artifacts and documents that could never have been unearthed by a single explorer and a single archaeologist. Yet Hedin was 'the one who started it all'[24] as a necessary component in Stein's successful first expedition. Indeed, it was not until the archaeologist returned in 1901 with tangible evidence of lost cities in the sand that other European nations sent their own archaeological teams, with learned scholars such as Paul Pelliot and Albert von Le Coq joining the international race for artifacts and documents. Although some of these newcomers used questionable methods of excavation that upset Stein and led him to comment harshly on 'the distressing traces they have left behind,'[25] the competitive spirit that their arrival fostered proved tremendously important. Even Stein – and, to a lesser extent, Hedin – felt pressured to return multiple times due to the fear of 'the scientific rivalry of Prussia, France, and Russia in that area as a result of the widespread interest [Stein's] discoveries had aroused.'[26]

A closer look at the international competition jumpstarted by Stein and Hedin provides further insight into the dynamics of their relationship. Perhaps the most apt reflection of the amiable nature of Stein and Hedin's connection was their complete lack of rivalry while they were both in Asia. They never attempted to hinder each other's progress, and actually supported one another over the numerous other archaeologists and explorers who flocked to China in the early 20th century. Stein and Hedin never directly crossed paths during their expeditions, yet at a time in which intense nationalism was a prevalent emotion, the explorer who was renowned for his 'Anglophobe bias'[27] and the fervently pro-British archaeologist openly praised each other. Although the men worked in distinct fields that overlapped only to a limited extent, it is remarkable that Stein and Hedin spoke kindly of one another, especially given their fiercely competitive natures.

Stein frequently criticized rival archaeologists, as seen in his denouncement of the German 'indifference to the fate of all that was left in situ,'[28] and allowed his contempt for others to influence his pace and route. More than once, he felt the need to 'push on … as quickly as I can'[29] because of the unexpected progress made by Pelliot, whose expeditions served as a constant source of worry and stress. Stein felt the pressure of competition, and there was only one famous non-British European who escaped the wrath of Stein's private tirades: Sven Hedin. Similarly, one of Hedin's less scathing obituaries highlighted that he was a man who 'struggled … on paper against rival explorers,'[30] a statement which seems plausible, especially when his supremely confident letters that show that he was 'convinced that I can bang just as loudly [a Swedish idiomatic expression] as any other European.'[31] This competitive spirit did not go unnoticed, and sometimes worked against Hedin. This was most evident when the British attempted to officially block Hedin's travels, leading him to lament that 'the Government of London refused me permission to enter Tibet … [it was] an obstruction harder to surmount than the Himalayas.'[32]

Sabotage and ill will were commonplace on the Silk Road, and the fact that high profile and passionate men such as Stein and Hedin remained civil to one another during this period speaks volumes about the respect they held for each another. Both men cast huge shadows that awed and intimidated their rivals,[33] and provoked harsh responses such as the British government's attempt to keep Hedin out of Tibet. Yet it is clear that the archaeologist and explorer were

not simply two adventurers who refrained from speaking out against one another. Rather, there was something distinct about how each man viewed the other, and the resulting civility and lack of rivalry undoubtedly shaped the so-called Great Game to explore and excavate Central Asia.

Ultimately, it is necessary to understand the relationship between Aurel Stein and Sven Hedin in order to unravel the story behind the excavations of the lost civilizations of the Silk Road.[34] Building on each other's success, the archaeologist and explorer turned the world's eyes to the buried cities of Central Asia, and provoked an unprecedented race for artifacts and documents that resulted in so many of them being taken overseas. The early 20th century was a time of growing nationalism, and as their reputations grew, the two men consciously and inadvertently fanned the flames of international competition. Their rivals set out on multiple expeditions and, with the published work of Stein and Hedin to guide them, were able to plan their time efficiently, recover new treasures from excavated sites, and contribute to the greater understanding of the history of this part of the world.

More than a hundred years have passed since Stein and Hedin visited sites in the Lop Desert. Today, archaeologists working in Xinjiang and Gansu can move quickly between cities, by plane, train or motorway. Modern scholars also have the opportunity to visit more remote sites by four-wheel drive or camel, and keep in touch by satellite communication. It is a different world. The tape measure presented to the RGS in 1909 – lost by Hedin in Lop-Nor in 1901, found by Stein in 1906, and reunited with its owner in London in 1909 – may have started its life as a scientific instrument of its time, but it has come to represent so much more. It embodies the mutual respect of two men of different nationalities, of different political beliefs, and with different motivations, whose trust in each other not only preserved their lives and made their careers, but laid a path for others to follow.

Notes

1 Lionel David Barnett (1871–1960).
2 George Macartney *et al.*, 'Explorations in Central Asia, 1906–08 Discussion', The Geographical Journal, vol. 34, no. 3 (Sept, 1909), p, 266.
3 'Dr. Sven Hedin's Explorations: 1899–1900', *The Geographical Journal*, vol. 17, no. 2 (Feb, 1901), p. 181. This is a summary drawn from letters written from Hedin to the RGS.
4 Jeannette Mirsky, *Sir Aurel Stein: Archaeological Explorer*, University of Chicago Press, Chicago, 1998, p. 70 (first published 1977)..
5 Annabel Walker, *Aurel Stein: Pioneer of the Silk Road*, John Murray Publishers, London, 1995, p. 60.
6 Mirsky, *op. cit.*, p. 79.
7 Mirsky, *op. cit.*, p. 79.
8 Mirsky, *op. cit.*, p. 88.
9 Walker, *op. cit.*, pp. 60–61.
10 Walker, *op. cit.*, p. 99.
11 Walker, *op. cit.*, p. 153.
12 Ágnes Kelecsényi, 'A Hungarian on the Silk Road', *The Hungarian Quarterly*, vol. 43, no. 167 (Fall 2002), p. 82.
13 See, for example, the page entitled 'Lured by the unknown: men who fill in the gaps / The great explorers of the moment', *The Illustrated London News*, 30 January 1909, p. 170, which has 15 photographs, placing Stein at no. 1 and Hedin at no. 15. This image is reproduced in H. Wang, 'Sir Aurel Stein: the next generation', in E. Errington and V.S. Curtis (eds) *From Persepolis to the Punjab. Exploring ancient Iran, Afghanistan and Pakistan*, British Museum Press, London, 2007, pp. 227-234 (reprinted 2011).
14 Walker, *op. cit.*, p. 75.
15 Sven Hedin. *My Life as An Explorer*, (New York: Kodansha Publishers, 1995), p. 209 (first published 1898).
16 S. Linne, 'Dr. Sven Hedin's Significance to the Ethnographical Museum of Stockholm', *Geografiska Annaler*, vol. 17, Supplement: Hyllningsskrift Tillagnad Sven Hedin, 1935, p. 168.
17 Hedin, *op. cit.*, p. 209.
18 Hedin, *op. cit.*, p. 209.
19 'Dr. Sven Hedin's Explorations: 1899–1900', *op. cit.*, p. 181.
20 Mirsky, *op. cit.*, p. 200.
21 Macartney *et al.*, *op. cit.*, p. 269.
22 C.E.A.W. Oldham, 'Sir Aurel Stein (1862–1943)', *Proceedings of the British Academy* 29 (1943), pp. 453–65,
23 Sven Hedin, *The Silk Road*, E.P. Dutton & Co., New York, 1938, p. 243.
24 Peter Hopkirk, *Foreign Devils on the Silk Roa*d. *The search for the lost cities and treasures of Chinese Central Asia*, University of Massachusetts Press, Amherst, 1980, p. 240.
25 Hopkirk, *op. cit.*, p. 170.
26 Frank W. Ikle, 'Sir Aurel Stein: s Victorian geographer in the tracks of Alexander', *Isis*, vol. 59, no. 2 (Summer, 1968), p. 147.
27 C.P.S. [Clarmont Percival Skrine], 'Obituary: Sven Hedin', *The Geographical Journal*, vol. 119, no. 2 (June 1953), pp. 252–53.
28 Hopkirk, *op. cit.*, p. 170
29 Mirsky, *op. cit.*, p. 243
30 Obituary: Sven Hedin, *op. cit.*, p. 253.
31 Lothar von Falkenhausen, 'Review of Bernhard Karlgren: Ett Forskarporträtt'. *China Review International*, vol. 8, no. 1 (Spring 2001), p. 26.
32 Hedin, *op. cit.*, p. 378.
33 Hopkirk, *op. cit.*, p. 54.
34 In addition to Hedin's early expeditions in the 1890s, Russian officials discovered and excavated archaeological sites in Turfan starting in 1893. However, these expeditions do not appear to have served as an inspiration to Stein or Hedin. See Zhang Guangda and Rong Xinjiang, 'A Concise History of the Turfan Oasis and Its Exploration', *Asia Minor*, 3rd Series, vol. 11, part 2 (1998, Academia Sinica), p. 23.

Sir Aurel Stein's Medals at the Royal Geographical Society

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A stream of awards and honorary degrees were presented to Sir Aurel Stein between 1904 and 1939, reflecting the very high esteem in which he was held in Europe and the USA in the early decades of the 20th century. They included the following accolades:[2]

1904 Back Grant, Royal Geographical Society
1909 Founder's Medal, Royal Geographical Society*
1909 Diploma, Geographical Society, Munich
1909 D.Litt degree, Oxford University
1909 Campbell Memorial Gold Medal, Royal Asiatic Society, Bombay*
1909 Stanislas Julien prize, Académie des Inscriptions et Belles-Lettres
1909 Hardy prize, Royal Bavarian Academy
1910 Honorary Doctor of Science, Cambridge University
1910 Diploma, Royal Scottish Geographical Society
1910 C.I.E. [Commander of the Indian Empire]
1911 Member of the Anthopologische Gesellschaft, Vienna
1912 K.C.I.E. [Knight Commander of the Indian Empire]
1912 Lucy Wharton Drexel Medal, University of Pennsylvania, Museum*
1917 Honorary Member, Russian Geographical Society
1918 Tchihatchef Prize, Académie des Sciences, Paris
1921 Fellow, British Academy
1923 Gold Medal, Société de Géographie, France*
1923 Anders Retzius medal, Swedish Anthropological and Geographical Society
1925 Honorary Member, Hungarian Archaeological Society
1928 Flinders Petrie Medal for Archaeology, London University*
1930 Medal, Hungarian Geographical Society*
1931 Medal (In Memoriam Ludovici L'oczy), Hungarian Geographical Society*
1931 Honorary Member, Société Asiatique
1932 Gold Medal, Royal Asiatic Society†
1934 Huxley Memorial Medal, Royal Anthropological Institute*
1935 Gold Medal, Society of Antiquaries*
1939 Member, American Philosophical Society
1939 Honorary Doctorate, University of St. Andrews

Nine of these medals (those marked *) are now in the Collections of the Royal Geographical Society, though one (the Royal Asiatic Society medal Society, marked †)[3] has been recorded as missing for some years. These are discussed below in chronological order. For each medal we have prepared a short description, a summary of the criteria by which the medal was awarded, and a list of recipients. The purpose of listing the recipients is to enable us to see Stein's position among his very distinguished contemporaries, his predecessors and followers. The Royal Geographical Society also holds extensive archives relating to Stein, consisting mostly of over 700 letters of correspondence between Stein and officers of the Society,[4] and a summary of the papers relevant to the medals is given at the end of this paper.

1. 1909 Founder's Medal, Royal Geographical Society[5]

Description of the medal

Circular medal. Gold. Glazed and framed. 54mm diameter. The obverse features a bust of a bare-headed King William IV, facing right. The Latin inscription reads GULIELMUS IIII D.G. BRITANNARIUM REX MDCCCXXX FUNDATOR [William IV, By the Grace of God, King of the Britons, 1830, founder]. Below bust: W. WYON. The reverse shows Minerva, standing and facing left, wreath-crown in right hand, map in left hand.

Behind her are measuring instruments (a sextant and telescope) and a globe. The Latin inscription above Minerva reads: OB TERRAS RECLUSAS [To lands unknown, or for lands yet to be discovered]. Inscription in exergue: ROYAL GEOGRAPHICAL SOCIETY OF LONDON. Above exergue: W. WYON A.R.A (to left), and MINT 1836 (to right). Inscription on gold band edge: DR. M. AUREL STEIN, 1909.
In square red box, 96mm, inscribed 'Wyon, 2 Langham Chambers, London W.'
RGS ref: 700446/D4 (1)

About the medal
The Society's Gold Medals (Founder's and Patron's Medals) originated as an annual gift of 50 guineas from King William IV. They were awarded for the first time in 1832, for the encouragement and promotion of geographical science and discovery. In 1839 the Society decided that this sum should be converted into two gold medals of equal value, to be designated the Founder's Medal and the Patron's medal. These have been awarded annually, with some omissions, to the present day, and are currently awarded with the approval of Her Majesty the Queen.

The Founder's Medal was in fine gold except for 1918–21, when the medals were bronze and the value of the award was made up in War Bonds, and from 1975 being made in silver gilt. It was designed by William Wyon (1795–1851), who was an Associate Royal Academician (ARA.) at that time. With some minor alterations over the years, it continued to be made by the Wyon firm until 1923, when production switched to the Royal Mint.

About Stein's medal
Stein was notified of his award whilst he was in England during April 1909. It was conferred on him at the Society's anniversary meeting on 24 May 1909, by the Society's President, Major Leonard Darwin (1850–1943). In his acceptance speech, Stein acknowledged the assistance of Lord Curzon, Lord Minto, the Survey of India and the Royal Geographical Society.[6] His letter to the Secretary (as the position of Director was then called), John Scott Keltie (1840–1927). Stein expresses in sincere tones his 'lasting gratitude for the truly great distinction', noting that the medal was the 'highest recognition which my archaeological labours could have possibly received'.[7]

Recipients of the medal
Richard Lander (1832), John Biscoe (1833), Captain Sir John Ross (1834), Sir Alexander Burnes (1835), Captain Sir George Back (1836), Captain Robert Fitzroy (1837), Col. Francis Rawdon Chesney (1838), Thomas Simpson (1839), Major Henry Rawlinson (1840), Lt. H. Raper (1841), Captain Sir James Clark Ross (1842), Edward John Eyre (1843), W.J. Hamilton (1844), Dr Charles Beke (1845), Count P.E. de Strzelecki (1846), Captain Charles Sturt (1847), Sir James Brooke (1848), Austen Henry Layard (1849), John Charles Frémont (1850), Dr George Wallin (1851), Dr John Rae (1852), Francis Galton (1853), Admiral William Smyth (1854), Rev. David Livingstone (1855), Elisha Kent Kane (1856), Augustus C. Gregory (1857), Captain Richard Collinson (1858), Captain Richard F. Burton (1859), Lady Franklin (1860), Captain John Hanning Speke (1861), Richard O'Hara Burke (1862), Frank T. Gregory (1863), Captain J.A. Grant (1864), Captain T.G. Montgomerie (1865), Dr Thomas Thomson (1866), Admiral Alexis Boutakoff (1867), Dr Augustus Petermann (1868), Prof. A.E. Nordenskiöld (1869), George W. Hayward (1870), Sir Roderick Murchison (1871), Col. Henry Yule (1872), Ney Elias (1873), Dr Georg Schweinfurth (1874), Lt. Karl Weyprecht (1875), Lt. Verney Lovett Cameron (1876), Captain Sir George Nares (1877), Baron F. von Richthofen (1878), Col. N. Prejevalsky (1879), Lt. A. Louis Palander (1880), Major Serpa Pinto (1881), Dr Gustav Nachtigal (1882), Sir Joseph Hooker (1883), A.R. Colquhoun (1884), Joseph Thomson (1885), Major A.W. Greely (1886), Col. T.H. Holdich (1887), Clements R. Markham (1888), A.D. Carey (1889), Emin Pasha (1890), Sir James Hector (1891), Alfred Russel Wallace (1892), Frederick Selous (1893), Captain H. Bower (1894), Dr John Murray (1895), Sir William MacGregor (1896), P. Semenoff (1897), Dr Sven Hedin (1898), Captain G.L. Binger (1899), Captain H.H.P. Deasy (1900), H.R.H. The Duke of Abruzzi (1901), General Sir Frederick Lugard (1902), Douglas Freshfield (1903), Sir Harry Johnston (1904), Sir Martin Conway (1905), Alfred Grandidier (1906), Dr Francisco Moreno (1907), Lt Boyd Alexander (1908), **Sir Aurel Stein (1909)**, Col. H.H. Godwin-Austen (1910), Col. P.K. Kozloff (1911), Charles M. Doughty (1912), Prof. Albrecht Penck (1914), Sir Douglas Mawson (1915), Col. P.H. Fawcett (1916), Commander D.G. Howarth (1917), Gertrude Bell (1918), Col. E.M. Jack (1919), H. St John B. Philby (1920), Vilhjalmur Stefansson (1921), Col. C.K. Howard-Bury (1922), Dr Knud Rasmussen (1923), Ahmed Hassanein Bey (1924), Brigadier-General C.G. Bruce (1924), Col. E.F. Norton (1926), Major Kenneth Mason (1927), Dr Tom Longstaff (1928), Francis Rennell Rodd (1929), F. Kingdon-Ward (1930), Bertram Thomas (1931), Henry George Watkins (1932), J.M. Wordie (1933), Hugh Ruttledge (1934), Major R.A. Bagnold (1935), G.W. Murray (1936), Col. C.G. Lewis (1937), John Rymill (1938), Arthur M. Champion (1939), Mr and Mrs Harold Ingrams (1940), Captain P.A. Clayton (1941), Freya Stark (1942), Dr Charles Camsell (1945), Brigadier Edward A. Glennie (1946), Brigadier M. Hotine (1947), Wilfred Thesiger (1948), Prof. L. Dudley Stamp (1949), George F. Walpole (1950), Dr Vivian E. Fuchs (1951), H.W. Tilman (1952), P.D. Baird (1953), Brigadier Sir John Hunt (1954), Dr John K. Wright (1955), John Giaever (1956), Prof. Ardito Desio (1957), Dr Paul A. Siple (1958), Commander W.R. Anderson (1959), Phillip G. Law (1960), Dr Mikhail M. Somov (1961), Captain Erwin McDonald (1962), Captain Jacques-Yves Cousteau (1963), Dr L.S.H. Leakey (1964), Dr E.F. Rootes (1965), Prof. E.J.H. Corner (1966), Claudio and Orlando Vilas Boas (1967), Dr W. Brian Harland (1968), Rear Admiral Rodolfo N.M. Panzarini (1969), Walter William Herbert (1970), Sir George Deacon (1971), Rear Admiral G.S. Ritchie (1972), N.L. Falcon (1973), Christian J.S. Bonnington (1974), Sir Laurence Kirwan (1975), Dr Brian B. Roberts (1976), Prof. Michael Wise (1977), Major-General R. Brown (1978), Dr David Stoddart (1979), Prof. William R. Mead (1980), Prof. Keith J. Miller (1981), Mr Michael Ward (1982), Sir Peter Scott (1983), Sir Ranulph Twistleton-Wykeham-Fiennes (1984), David Attenborough (1985), Timothy Severin (1986), Dr Anthony Laughton (1987), Prof. Peter Hall (1988), Dr Monica Kristensen (1989), Dr John Hemming (1990), Prof. Andrew Goudie (1991), Prof. Alan Wilson (1992), Prof. Kenneth Gregory (1993), Prof. Ronald Cooke (1994), The Earl of Cranbrook (1995), Prof. John Woods (1996), Prof. Sir Tony Wrigley (1997), Prof. Robert Bennett (1998), Prof. Mike Kirby (1999), Prof. Brian Robson (2000), Prof. William Graf (2001), Bruno Messerli (2002), Prof. Mike Goodchild (2003), Prof. Leszek Starkel (2004), Prof. Sir Nicholas Shackleton (2005), Prof. Derek Gregory (2006), Prof. Roger Barry (2007), Prof. Julian Dowdeswell (2008), Dr Alan Baker (2009).

2. 1909 Campbell Memorial Gold Medal, Royal Asiatic Society, Bombay

Description of the medal
Circular medal, Gold, 52mm diameter.
The obverse features a bust of Sir James McNabb Campbell, facing left. The reverse has a shield enclosing the engraved inscription AWARDED TO M. AUREL STEIN 1908. Above the shield is the inscription CAMPBELL MEMORIAL MEDAL.
In dark blue box, 88mm square.
RGS ref: 700446/D4(5)

About the medal
The Campbell Memorial Medal Fund was subscribed by members of the Indian Civil Service in order to found a gold medal in memory of Sir James McNabb Campbell (1846–

1903), an Indian administrator and ethnologist.[8] In 1907 his friends founded the gold medal in his memory, to be awarded triennially by the Bombay Branch of the Royal Asiatic Society for the best original work on Indian folklore, history or ethnology. . The Fund is administered by the Royal Asiatic Society and the first medal was awarded 1907 and awarded every three years for exceptional work in the field of Oriental research.

The Asiatic Society of Mumbai (the renaming took place in 1955) continues to award the Campbell Memorial Medal 'in recognition of distinguished services on the subject of oriental history, folklore or ethnology, [which] further the object of the Society, namely the investigation and encouragement of oriental arts, sciences and literature.'[9]

About Stein's medal

Stein was the first recipient of this medal, and was awarded it in recognition of his book *Ancient Khotan*.[10] It was conferred upon him at a meeting of the Bombay branch of the Royal Asiatic Society on 2 March 1909, by Sir George Sydenham Clarke (1848-1933), Governor of Bombay. As Stein could not attend in person, the medal was handed to A.M.T. Jackson, trustee of the medal fund, to be forwarded to him. Jackson accepted the medal, and paid tribute to Stein.[11]

Recipients of the medal[12]

Dr Aurel Stein (1908), Dr D.R. Bhandarkar (1911), Prof. A.A. Macdonell (1914), Dr Jivanji J. Modi (1917), Dr Shama Shastry (1920), R.B.P.B. Joshi (1921, Special), Sir G. Grierson (1923), Dr Sir Jadunath Sarkar (1926), Prof. S.H. Hodivala (1929), Sir John Marshall (1932), MM Dr Ganganath Jha (1935), Dewan Bahadur Dr S.K. Aiyangar (1938), MM Dr P.V. Kane (1941), Dr B.C. Law (1944), Dr F.W. Thomas (1947), Dr R.C. Majumdar (1950), Chevalier P.S.S. Pisurlencar (1953), Dr Verrier Elwin (1956), Dr S.K. Belvalkar (1959), Dr R.B. Whitehead (1962), Sir Ralph Lilley Turner, Kt. (1965), MM Pandit Gopinath Kaviraj (1968), Dr K.A. Nilakantha Sastri (1971), Dr H.D. Sankalia (1974), Dr G.S. Ghurye (1977), Dr (Mrs) Kapila Vatsyayan (1980), Dr C. Sivaramamurti (1981, Special), Dr R.S. Sharma (1983), Shri K. Shivram Karanth (1986), Shri Karl J. Khandalwala (1989), Prof. Madhusudan A. Dhaky (1992), Prof. Ajay Mitra Shastri (1995), Dr B.N. Mukherjee (1998), Dr I.K. Sharma (2002), Prof. A.K. Narain (2003–6), Dr R.C. Dhere (2006–9).

3. 1912 Lucy Wharton Drexel Medal, University of Pennsylvania, Museum[13]

Description of the medal

Circular. Gold medal. 55mm diameter.

The obverse features an inscription placed within a wreath: THE MUSEUM OF SCIENCE AND ART OF THE UNIVERSITY OF PENNSYLVANIA TO M. AUREL STEIN (his name is engraved at the centre of the medal) FOR SERVICES TO ARCHAEOLOGY 1912 (date engraved). Below this is the name of the designer: STERN A PARIS. The whole is surrounded by a stylised wreath of lotuses and other flowers.

The reverse has the inscription UNIVERSITY OF PENNSYLVANIA. DEPARTMENT OF ARCHAEOLOGY. THE LUCY WHARTON DREXEL MEDAL. At the centre is a Menorah surmounting a sacred pillar, with a pair of confronting animals: a winged horse kneeling on its front legs (to left), and a winged bull kneeling on its front legs (right). The Hebrew inscription to the base of the Menorah translates as *Let There Be Light*.[14] The winged beasts are supported by a platform with cavetto cornice below featuring a winged disc with a serpent on either side. There is a repeated stylised lotus and fleur-de-lys floral pattern at the edge.

In maroon box, 134mm x 110mm, inscribed 'Sir Aurel Stein, Lucy Wharton Drexel Medal, Department of Archaeology, University of Pennsylvania, 1912.'

RGS Ref: 700446/D4(7)

About the medal

The medal was established in 1898 by Lucy Wharton Drexel (1867-1944). The Board of Managers of the Museum confirmed the criteria for awarding the medal in 1905 as follows: 'The medal is to be awarded to English speaking archaeologists or those working for English speaking countries, for work, excavation, or publication done within the previous five years, no medal to be awarded more frequently than once in a year. The first four medallists will be chosen by the Board [of the University of Pennsylvania Museum]. In the future all awards will be made by those holding the Lucy Wharton Drexel medal, unless at any time the number holding this medal falls below three, when the Board will make an additional award, awards thereafter being made by holders.'[15]

The medal was made by Maison Stern Graveur, in Paris.

About Stein's medal

The Lucy Wharton Drexel was awarded to Stein for his explorations in Central Asia.[16] The documentation for this medal is in the Library of the Hungarian Academy of Sciences, Budapest.[17]

Recipients of the medal

Arthur J. Evans (1902), Hermann V. Hilprechet (1902), W.M. Flinders Petrie (1902), Frederick W. Putnam (1902), Bernard P. Grenfell (1904), Sir William M. Ramsay (1906), David G. Hogarth (1908), Rudolph E. Brunnow (1909), Howard C. Butler (1910), **Sir Aurel Stein (1912)**, Arthur S. Hunt (1913), [no medals awarded 1913-51], Sir R.E. Mortimer Wheeler (1952), Sir C. Leonard Woolley (1955), M.E.L. Mallowan (1957), Alfred V. Kidder (1958), Sir J. Eric S. Thompson (1962), Richard S. MacNeish (1966), Ignacio Bernal y Garcia Pimentel (1971), J. Grahame D. Clark (1974), Homer A. Thompson (1978), Gordon R. Willy (1981), Kwang-Chih Chang (1986), William R. Coe (1991), Machtheld J. Mellink (1994), Fred Wendorf (1996), Frederica de Laguna (1999), Robert McC. Adams (2000), Lord Colin Renfrew (2003), Ian Hodder (2009), George F. Bass (2010).

4. 1923 Gold Medal (Société de Géographie, France)[18]

Description of the medal

Circular. Gold medal. 67mm diameter.

The obverse features a wreath at the centre, enclosing the inscription SIR AUREL STEIN EXPLORATION DE L'ASIE CENTRALE 1923. Above is the inscription SOCIÉTÉ DE GÉOGRAPHIE. Below is the inscription FONDÉE A PARIS EN 1821.

The reverse shows Minerva, seated, facing left, holding a wreath in both left and, outstretched, right hand. She wears a helmet with a small bird, presumably an owl, perched on the crown. The inscription reads DE PUYMAURIN DI [Baron de Puymaurin direxit] on the right of Minerva, ANDRIEU FECIT [made by Andrieu] on the left. On the edge: &30R.

In red box, 116mm square, inscribed 'Sir Aurel Stein' in gold.

RGS ref: 700446/D4(6)

About the medal

The Grande Médaille d'or des explorations et voyages de découverte has been awarded since 1829 for a journey, the results of which have enriched the Society. The medal was made under the direction of Jean Pierre Casimir de Marcassus, Baron de Puymaurin (1757–1841), who was Master of the Mint at Paris, 1816–30. The engraver was the renowned French medallist Bertrand Andrieu (1761–1822).

About Stein's medal

Stein was awarded this medal for his exploration work in Central Asia.[19]

Recipients of the medal

Captain John Franklin (1829), René Caillé and Major Laing (1830), Douville (1832), Captain John Ross (1834), Alcide d'Orbigny (1835), Captain Callier (1836), Captain Back (1837), Dubois de Montpereux (1838), Contre-amiral d'Urville (1841), Captain James Clark Ross (1843), Hommaire de Hel (1844), D'Arnaud (1844), Claude Gay (1845), Ferret and Galinier (1845), Dr C.T. Beke and T. Lefebvre (1846), Dr F.W.L. Leichhardt (1847), Rochet d'Hericourt (1847), Antoine d'Abbadie and Arnaud d'Abbadie (1850), Captain MacClure (1855), Dr Henry Barth (1856), David Livingstone (1857), Dr E.K. Kane (1858), Robert Hermann and Adolf von Schalgintweit (1859), R.F. Burton and J.H. Speke (1860), Nicolas de Khanikof (1861), Henri Duveyrier (1864), Sir Samuel W. Baker (1867), Doudart de la Gree and Francis Garnier (1869), Alfred Grandidier (1872), Dr Gustave Nachtigal (1876), Commandant Verney Lovett Cameron (1877), Henry M. Stanely (1878), P. Savorgnan de Brazza (1879), Adolf Erick Nordenskjold (1880), Major de Serpa Pinto (1881), Alphonse Milne-Edwards (1884), Ch. de Brito Capello (1886), Captain Binger (1890), Gabriel Bonvalot (1891), Commandant P.-Louis Monteil (1893), Prince Henri d'Orleans (1896), Dr Fridtjof Nansen (1897), Edouard Foa (1898), Emile Gentil (1899), Commandant J.-B. Marchand (1900), Fernand Foureau (1901), Captain P.J. Joalland (1902), Auguste Pavie (1903), Sven Hedin (1904), Colonel Bourgeois (1907), Sir E. Shackleton (1910), Dr J.B. Charcot (1912), Captain R. Amundsen (1913), Admiral Robert E. Peary (1914), Commandant Jean Tilho (1918), Gl. Bruce (1922), Cl. Howard Bury (1922), Mme Rosita Forbess (1923), **Sir Aurel Stein (1923)**, Bruneau de Laborie (1924), Prof. Olufsen (1924), Cdt Baron A. de Guerlache de Gomery (1925), Charles Lindbergh (1927), Jacques de Rohan-Chabot (1928), Hasssanein-Bey and S.A.S. le prince Kemal el Dine (1929), Wickliffe P. Draper (1932), Audoin-Dubreuil Haardt (1933), Dr A. Hamilton Rice (1939), M. Herzog (1950), Théodore Monod (1952), Augustin Lombard (1953), Cdt Georges Houot and Ingén. G.P. Wilm (1954), Sir John Hunt, Sir Edmund Hillary and Sherpa Norkay Tenzing (1955), Henri Lhote (1957), V.E. Fuchs (1958), Neil Armstrong, Eldwin Aldrin and Michael Collins (1970), Germaine Dieterlen (1977), Norbert Casteret (1979), Jean-Louis Etienne (1991), Jean-Yves Empereur (2002), Nicolas Hulot (2003), Gilles ElkaÏ (2004), Jean-Marc Pineau (2005), Erik Orsenna (2006), Jean Raspail (2007).

(5) 1928 Flinders Petrie Medal for Archaeology (London University)[20]

Description of the medal

Circular, 90mm diameter.

The obverse shows the bearded head and shoulders of Sir Flinders Petrie, facing left. The raised inscription gives his full name WILLIAM MATTHEW FLINDERS PETRIE and the year of his 70th birthday MCMXXIII (1923). The reverse features an ibis (sacred to Thoth, god of knowledge) facing right with head lowered, and the head of a statuette of King Khufu (also known as Kheops), for whom the Great Pyramid at Giza was built. Petrie had excavated this statuette at Abydos in 1903. Below, to the left of the ibis' beak is the name of the designer Carline in a shallow inscription.

The inscription on the reverse says PRESENTED FOR WORK IN ARCHAEOLOGY.

Engraved around the edge: AWARDED BY THE SENATE OF THE UNIVERSITY OF LONDON TO SIR AUREL STEIN 1928.

In black box, 123mm square.

RGS ref: 700446/D4(2)

About the medal

To celebrate the 70th birthday of the distinguished archaeologist Sir Flinders Petrie (1853–1942), a fund was created, which allowed for the production of 20 medals, and a capital sum which could be invested. The medal was to be awarded 'once in every three years for distinguished work in Archaeology, preferably to a British subject [and that the] name of the recipient shall be engraved on the rim of the medal.'[21]

The Petrie Medal was issued to Sir Flinders Petrie and then to seven recipients in this way. There is then a gap of over 20 years until 1984/5 when a Working Party of the Scholarships Committee at University College London, clarified that 'The Petrie Prize, value £100, has been established from funds raised on the occasion of the 70th birthday of Sir W.M. Flinders Petrie in 1923 to create a memorial to his work in Archaeology. In addition a number of Petrie Medals were provided from the Fund when the University accepted its administration in 1926. The Petrie Prize will be accompanied by the award of a Petrie Medal while the existing stocks of the Medal permit. The Prize will be awarded annually … to the best candidate at the examination for the MA/MSc degrees under the aegis of the Board of Studies in Archaeology.' The last of the original Petrie Medals was awarded in 1993. A further two casts were made, with the last of these presented in 1995.

In 2005, the Institute of Archaeology's Policy Group and Staff Meeting decided to reinstate the Petrie Medal as a three-yearly award to an outstanding international archaeologist.

The Petrie medal was designed and modelled by the sculptor and medallist Sydney W. Carline (1888–1929).

About Stein's medal

The Petrie medal was awarded to Stein 'in recognition of his great work in Central Asia and Western China.' It was presented to him by Sir Gregory Foster, Vice-Chancellor of London University on 5 July 1929, and the occasion was followed by a reception given by Sir Flinders and Lady Petrie in the Exhibition Room, University College. Sir Flinders Petrie's tribute to Stein, and the latter's response, were published in *The Times*, 8 July 1929.[22]

Recipients of the medal

Sir Flinders Petrie (1925), **Sir Aurel Stein** (**1928**), Sir Arthur Evans (1931), Abbé Henri Breuil (1934), Prof. J.D. Beazley (1937), Sir Mortimer Wheeler (1950), Prof. J.B. Wace (1953), Sir Leonard Woolley (1957). These medals have the name of the recipient engraved on the rim.

(6) 1930 Medal of the Hungarian Geographical Society[23]

Description of the medal

Circular. Silver medal, 60mm diameter.

The obverse features a portrait of Sir Aurel Stein, the monogram of Beck Ö. Fülöp, and the Latin inscription AURELIO STEI HOSPITI CLARISSIMO IN URBEM NATALEM REVERSO

BUDAPESTINUM MCMXXIX [For Sir Aurel Stein, a most distinguished guest, on his return to his native city, Budapest 1929]. Stein's portrait is similar to, and may have been adapted from, his famous portrait photograph by Bassano in 1924.[24] On the photograph Stein faces left, on the medal Stein faces right.
The reverse of the medal shows Minerva, seated and facing left. A scroll map is open on her lap and supported by her right arm. Her left arm is raised, with forefinger pointing to the map behind. Beck's name appears in full below. Around Minerva are the names and dates of Stein's famous expeditions to Khotan 1900, the Taklamakan Desert 1906–8, the Lop Desert 1907, Tun-huang [Dunhuang] 1914, Sistan 1915, Swat 1926, and Gedrosia 1927–8.
The edge of the medal holds the number '987' and two other hallmarks.
In dark navy box, 93mm square, embossed 'Sir Aurel Stein Medallion'.
RGS ref: 700446/D4(9)

About the medal
Stein had been an Honorary Member of the Hungarian Geographical Society since 1903.[25] The medal commemorates Stein's visit to Budapest, to give a lecture entitled 'On Alexander's Track to the Indus', on 12 October 1929. It was apparently commissioned by a group of admirers, who approached the foremost Hungarian medallist, Beck Ö. Fülöp. Beck Ödon Fülöp (1873–1945) was the founder of modern Hungarian sculpture, and is well known for reviving the art medal in Hungary.

The medal was cast in bronze and was probably presented to Stein during his visit. At least four examples were made; these are now in the collections of the Hungarian National Gallery, the National Museum of Hungary, the Fruchter Collection (Hungary), and the British Library. At some stage, the Hungarian National Gallery also acquired, from Beck's family, a plaster cast with an alternative reverse, showing a figure with two animals (cattle?) in place of the seated Minerva. The text is the same as on the Minerva version.

The silver version of the medal was commissioned after the lecture by the Hungarian Academy of Sciences, with the intention of presenting it to Stein on his next visit to Budapest. However, the medal was posted to Stein, care of P.S. Allen in Oxford in 1930. (Stein was away in China during the spring of 1930, and left Shanghai on 13 May for Calcutta via Singapore and Rangoon.) A handwritten letter in the RGS from A. Rethly, General Secretary of the Hungarian Geographical Society, to P.S. Allen, dated 5 May 1930, reads:

> I am glad to return to you Sir STEIN Aurel's medal and request you to kindly keep it for him until his coming back from India. At the same time I write to Sir Aurel Stein too. Do kindly forward it.

The medal was posted on 26 May 1930. In Stein's absence, Allen acknowledged receipt of the parcel, and his handwritten letter (in the archives of the Hungarian Geographical Society), dated 31 May 1930, acknowledges that 'Sir Aurel Stein's medal has reached me safely. It shall be kept for him, until his return.'[26] On 9 July 1930 Stein sent a letter of thanks from Mohand Marg, Kashmir, on 9 July 1930.[27]

(7) 1931 Medal of the Hungarian Geographical Society – in memoriam Ludovici L'oczy*

Description of the medal
Circular, 92mm diameter.
The obverse shows a half-figure seated, facing right, with left hand pointing to a globe (approximate area of China), and right hand holding a scroll. The Latin inscription in the exergue reads IN MEMORIAM LUDOVICI L'OCZY 1849–1920.
The reverse shows footprints in sand leading to a stupa with a rising sun behind, and the date 1872. The inscription around the edge reads SOCIETAS GEOGRAPHICA HUNGARICA AURELIO STEIN.
In green square box.
RGS ref: 700446/D4(8)

About the medal
This is a commemorative medal, founded in 1922 in honour of Ludovici L'oczy, the late President of the Hungarian Geographical Society. Aurel Stein was the first Hungarian scholar to receive this award. It was L'oczy who first alerted Stein to the Buddhist caves at Dunhuang[28] and alpine flowers sent from Kashmir by Stein to L'oczy in 1920 can still be found, pressed behind glass, at L'oczy's tomb in the cemetery at Balatonarács in western Hungary.[29] Stein had been an Honorary Member of the Hungarian Geographical Society since 1903.[30]

(8) 1934 Huxley Memorial Medal (Royal Anthropological Institute)

Description of the medal
Circular. Bronze medal, 63mm diameter.
The obverse features a bust of Thomas Huxley, facing left. The inscription reads THOMAS HENRY HUXLEY B. 1825 D. 1895.
The reverse has an inscription at the centre: AUREL STEIN 31ST JULY HUXLEY MEMORIAL LECTURER. The inscription around the edge reads ROYAL ANTHROPOLOGICAL INSTITUTE OF GREAT BRITAIN & IRELAND.
In dark tan box, 105mm square.
RGS ref: 700446/D4(4)

About the medal
The medal was instituted in 1900 in memory of the biologist and science educationist Thomas Henry Huxley (1825–95), and is the highest honour awarded by the Royal Anthropological Institute. It is awarded annually, 'by ballot of the Council, to a scientist, British or foreign, distinguished in any field of anthropological research in the widest sense.'[31]

About Stein's medal
Although Stein's work was primarily archaeological and geographical in nature, he also collected information of interest to anthropologists, in particular Thomas Athol Joyce (1878–1942), President of the RAI.[32] As the recipient of this medal, Stein delivered a paper to the Society on 31 July 1934, entitled 'The Indo-Iranian Borderlands: Their Prehistory in the Light of Geography and of Recent Explorations'.[33] Stein's Huxley Memorial Lecture was arranged one of the events of the International Congress of Anthropological and Ethnological Sciences, London Session, 30 Jul–4 Aug 1934, and was subsequently published in the Society's *Journal*.[34]

Recipients of the medal[35]

Lord Avebury (1900), Sir Francis Galton (1901), D.J. Cunningham (1902), Karl Pearson (1903), J. Deniker (1904), John Beddoe (1905), W.M. Flinders Petrie (1906), Edward Barnett Tylor (1907), William Z. Ripley (1908), Gustaf Retzius (1909), W. Boyd Dawkins (1910), Felix von Luschan (1911), William Gowland (1912), W.J. Sollas (1913), M. Emile Catailhac (1915), Sir James G. Frazer (1916), A.C. Haddon (1920), Henry Balfour (1921), Marcelin Boule (1922), E.S. Hartland (1923), R. Verneau (1924), Sir Arthur Evans (1925), Sir William Ridgeway (1926), Ales Hrdlicka (1927), Sir Arthur Keith (1928), Erlan Nordenskiold (1929), A.H. Sayce (1930), Georg Thilenius (1931), C.G. Seligman (1932), J.L. Myers (1933), **Sir Aurel Stein (1934)**, Sir Grafton Elliott Smith (1935), Edward Westermarck (1936), H.J. Fleure (1937), Marcel Mauss (1938), R.R. Marett (1939), H.J.E. Peake (1940), Henri Breuil (1941), Sir Leonard Woolley (1942), F.C. Bartlett 91943), V.Gordon Childe (1944), A.L. Kroeber (1945), G. Caton-Thompson (1946), W.L.H. Duckworth (1947), Robert H. Lowie (1948), James Hornell (1949), Julian S. Huxley (1950), A.R. Radcliffe-Brown (1951), Kaj Hirkett_Smith (1952), M. Ginsberg (1953), Henri V. Vallois (1954), Robert Redfield (1955), J.B.S. Haldane (1956), J.E.S. Linne (1957), Sir Wilfred Le Gros Clark (1958), R. Firth (1959), S. Lothrop (1960), A.E. Mourant (1961), A.E. Garrod (1962), E.E. Evans-Pritchard (1963), G.H.R. Von Koenigswald (1964), C. Lévi-Strauss (1965), J.E.S. Thompson (1966), S.L. Washburn (1967), G.H. Rivière (1968), I. Schapera (1969), C.D. Forde (1970), G.P. Murdock (1971), L.L.Cavalli-Sforza (1972), K. Wachsmann (1973), J.D. Clark (1974), G. Reichel-Dolmatoff (1975), M.N. Srinivas (1976), M. Fortes (1977), J.S. Weiner (1978), Gordon Willey (1979), Sir Edmund Leach (1980), Fei Hsiao-Tung (1981), Paul T. Baker (1982), Clifford Geertz (1983), Junichiro Itani (1984), Louis Dumont (1985), Lewis Binford (1986), G. Ainsworth Harrison (1987), Carleton Gajdusek (1988), Fredrik Barth (1989), Robert Hinde (1990), Colin Renfrew (1991), Mary Douglas (1992), George Stocking (1993), Sidney W. Mintz (1994), Jack Goody (1995), Philip Tobias (1996), Stanley Tambiah (1997), Marshall Sahlins (1998), Sally Falk Moore (1999), Pierre Bourdieu (2000), John Middleton (2001), Jane Goodall (2002), Gannanath Obeyesekere (2003), Dame Marilyn Strathern (2004), Peter Ucko (2005), Leslie Aiello (2006), Adam Kuper (2007), Maurice Godelier (2008), Ian Hodder (2009).

(9) 1935 Gold Medal (Society of Antiquaries) [36]

Description of the medal

Oval. Gold medal, with gold link and blue ribbon, 57mm (length) x 42mm (width).

The obverse shows the date of the Society's notional foundation (1707) against the image of the 'Roman' lamp (actually medieval) which forms the Society's device. Below this, within a scroll is the motto of the Society NON EXTINGUETUR [(The lamp of knowledge) will not be extinguished]. This device is largely as drawn by John Talman for the Society in 1718. The medal is emblazoned with the cross of St George and the British crown, after the Society's flag.

The reverse has the inscription THE GOLD MEDAL OF THE SOCIETY OF ANTIQUARIES, and is engraved with 'Sir Aurel Stein 1935', and five hallmarks (R.J, gothic 'S', crown, no.18 and lion's head.

In maroon box, 98 x 149mm, embossed 'Sir Aurel Stein: Gold medal of the Society of Antiquaries, 1935.'

RGS ref: 700446/D4(11)

About the medal

The gold medal is awarded to British and foreign scholars for outstanding services to archaeology. It was designed by the medallist and coin-engraver George Kruger Gray (1880–1943).[37]

About Stein's medal

Stein was awarded this medal for distinguished services to archaeology at the anniversary meeting of the Society on 30 April 1935. At the meeting, Sir Frederic Kenyon made his presidential address, focussing on archaeological research, and concluded with a brief survey of Stein's archaeological work in Kashmir, Central Asia and China. Stein's words of thanks (to the Society and all people who had helped him 'from officials of the British Museum to native employees, who had made possible his achievements in Eastern archaeology').[38]

Recipients of the medal

Sir Arthur Evans (1934), **Sir Aurel Stein (1935)**, L'Abbé Henri Breuil (1937), Sir Charles Peers (1938), Dr Haakon Shetelig (1939), Sr Aarne Tallgren (1940), Prof. Sir John Nowell Linton Myers (1942), Prof. Sir Ellis Hovell Minns (1943), Sir Mortimer Wheeler (1944), Edward Thurlow Leeds (1946), Sir Alfred Clapham (1948), Dr Albert Egges van Giffen (1950), Sir Cyril Fox (1952), Dr Johannes Brøndsted (1954), Prof. Vere Gordon Childe (1956), Dr Claude F.A. Schaeffer (1958), Sir Leonard Woolley (1960), Prof. Gerhard Bersu (1962), Dr H.J. Plenderleith (1964), Prof. Carl William Blegen (1966), Dorothy Annie Elizabeth Garrod (1968), Prof. Emerita Sirarpie Der Nersessian (1970), Dr Courtenay Arthur Ralegh Radford (1972), Dame Joan Evans (1973), Prof. Sir John Nowell Linton Myres (1976), Dr Donald Benjamin Harden (1977), Prof. John Grahame Douglas Clark (1978), Prof. Charles Francis Christopher Hawkes (1981), Emeritus Prof. Stuart Piggott (1982), Prof. Desmond Clark (1985), Prof. George Zarnecki (1986), Dr Arnold Joseph Taylor (1988), Prof. Sheppard Sunderland Frere (1989), Prof. Charles Thurstan Shaw (1990), Sir David Mackenzie Wilson (1995), Prof. Philip Grierson (1995), Claude Blair (1995), Prof. Gordon Willey (2000), Prof. John Coles (2002), Joyce Reynolds (2004), Prof. Rosemary Cramp (2008).

Further information from the RGS archives

The RGS did store, for a short time, Stein's award from the Swedish Anthropological and Geographical Society (SAGS) – the Anders Retzius medal. It was passed to the Society via the Foreign Office in April 1923, having been handed to Sir Colville Barclay[39] by the Crown Prince of Sweden on the 50th anniversary of the Society the previous month. It was known that Stein was in Kashmir, though thought to be back in England shortly, so the RGS was requested to hold it until his return. The RGS Secretary, Arthur Hinks,[40] wrote to Stein on 13 April suggesting that it be kept in the Society's safe: 'They evidently imagine you are simply on a journey… It is a good heavy lump of metal worth quite a bit.'[41] The letter also records information provided by SAGS that this medal was rarely awarded, and that there were only two



Figure 1 Measuring tape left by Sven Hedin in Central Asia in 1901 and found by Aurel Stein in 1906. Presented to the RGS in 1909 (RGS ref: 700606/D1, Royal Geographical Society)

previous recipients: Professor Oscar Montelius in 1910 and Sir Arthur Evans in 1921.

The missives between Stein and Hinks at this time was very amiable, though when Stein requested that the Anders Retzius medal be sent by registered post to P.S. Allen in Oxford 18 months later the tone between the two men seems to have cooled a little and Stein appears to be in direct correspondence with the Librarian, Edward Heawood, for much of 1926. The letters between Hinks and Stein seem to regain some of the former familiarity by the following year. The correspondence from Stein held by the Society also records his donation of the block of wind-sculpted wood from Lop-Nor.[42] More recent donations, yet to be catalogued, are a pedometer used by Stein and a small assortment of letters, photographs and ephemera sent to his secretary at Oxford, Mrs Ida May Brown,[43] and given to the Society by her son, Richard. Amongst the latter is a clipping from *The Daily Mirror* of 17 June 1932 with a photograph of Stein receiving the gold medal from the Royal Asiatic Society and an edition of *The Illustrated London News* of 8 August 1925 featuring a four-page article on the exhibition at the British Museum of finds from Stein's Third Expedition. The Society also holds the tape measure that Stein recovered from the south-west base of a stupa, north of Lop-Nor, in December 1906 which Sven Hedin had left behind in March 1901. The tape measure was returned to Hedin during a Society dinner of 23 February 1909 at which the President, Sir Leonard Darwin, is said to have sat between the two men as the exchange took place. Hedin accepted the tape measure and presented it that evening to the Society (**Fig. 2**).[44]

In 1907 Stein had expressed to the Secretary, Sir John Scott Keltie, his wish to 'move about like [Ellsworth] Huntington with a minimum of people and baggage'[45] and he discouraged the sending of personal items of value to Kashmir. In 1923 he wrote to Hinks that it would have been preferable for the Société de Géographié to follow the example set by the Swedes and send his medal to the RGS for safe-keeping.[46] Stein's K.C.I.E. insignia had been stolen from Mohand Marg just two years previously, so it is not surprising that he did not wish to keep such items close by in Kashmir. By the mid–1930s honours and awards were being conferred upon Stein, though his enthusiasm for the ceremony and pomp of the official presentations seems to have left him. Writing to Hinks from Agrigento, Italy, on 14 February 1935 he states his plan to be in London in March but return to Kashmir in May and in between,

> shall have to get through another medal award, one from the Society of Antiquaries, quite undreamt of. But the one which I value most, a real encouragement, came from the RGS 26 years before. [47]

Certainly, Stein wrote to Keltie in April 1909 (before the RGS medal was formally awarded) that he was already looking forward to the day of the presentation 'as the proudest day of my life.'[48]

Although plenty of medals were presented to Stein he was never negligent in commending the contribution made by his surveyors and later in 1909 was recommending Muhammad Ayub Khan for recognition from the RGS for his work. Muhammad Ayub was awarded the Back Grant the following year (Stein himself received it in 1904). The following awards were made by the RGS to Stein's colleagues: Ram Singh, Cuthbert Peek Grant (1908); Lal Singh, Back Grant (1909); Lal Singh, Murchison Award (1917); Afraz Gul Khan, Back Grant (1926); Afraz Gul Khan, Gill Memorial Award (1933) and Muhammad Ayub Khan, Back Grant (1936).[49]

The consistency and concentration of communication from Stein between the beginning of the 20th century to the end of the 1930s testifies to his focus and determination when it came to his area of study, and to his very specific requests (sometimes perceived as exacting demands). Many of the 700+ letters relating to him and his work contain capacious details and specifications – on the number of off-prints he wished to order, what type of postage they should be sent by, specifics of finds, pages of articles, etc., even calculating the number of pages of the *Geographical Journal* his articles would cover. As Hinks wrote to the historiographer William Foster (1863–1951), when the latter had to proof-read (yet) another revision of Stein's Marco Polo article for the *Geographical Journal*,

> There are certain penalties attached to friendship with this great man, and I'm sure you will pay them cheerfully.

Foster's reply was not so airy,

> Stein did not tell me of the honour he was thrusting upon me. But perhaps he had used up all his notepaper in giving me voluminous instructions on other matters.[50]

The notice of Stein's death in the *Geographical Journal* conveys a tone of great respect and the subsequent tribute by the President at the Annual General Meeting in June 1944 mentioned 'some twenty massive papers' that Stein had contributed to the *Journal*, and he concluded by saying, 'Sir Aurel Stein's name will always stand amongst the highest in our Annals.' The medals presented to Stein that are now in the RGS Collections are records from a small number of other venerable institutions that held him in the same high regard.

Notes

1 This paper includes information from notes prepared for a paper on the Hungarian medal designed by Beck-Ö-Fülöp, by Pallós Lajos and Helen Wang (2000, unpublished). The authors are particularly grateful to Lajos for allowing us to include his work here. We would also like to thank Philip Attwood for checking the descriptions of the medals.

2 For references and current locations of these certificates and medals, see 'Appendix 4 – Bibliography', in H. Wang and J. Perkins, *Handbook to the Stein Collections in the UK* (London, BM Research Publication 129, 2008), pp. 56-57, http://www.britishmuseum.org/research/research_publications/research_publications_online/handbook_stein_collection.aspx

3 RGS ref: 700446/D4(3). For details of the presentation of this medal, see *The Times*, 17 June 1932, 16c.

4 See the Royal Geographical Society pages in Wang and Perkins, *op. cit.*, pp. 21-22.

5 See http://www.rgs.org/AboutUs/Medals+and+Awards/Recent+Awards.htm (accessed 6 April 2011).

6 *The Times*, 25 May 1909, 10a.

7 RGS Archives: [ar RGS/CB9/Stein]

8 Oxford Dictionary of National Biography, www.oxforddnb.com (accessed 19 Dec 2011).

9 http://www.asiaticsocietymumbai.org/as/fellowship.php (accessed 19 Dec 2011).
10 P.B. Qothoskar, *General Catalogue of the Library of the Bombay Branch of the Royal Asiatic Society, revised and brought up to the end of 1915*, British India Press, Bombay, 1917; http://www.archive.org/details/generalcatalogueoolibriala (accessed 12 March 2012).
11 *The Times*, 2 March 1909, 11b and 8 April 1909, 3f, the latter referring to an account of the meeting reported in *The Times of India*.
12 We are grateful to V.V. Ganpule, Honorary Secretary of the Asiatic Society of Mumbai, for supplying this information.
13 We are grateful to Eric W. Schnittke of the University of Pennsylvania Museum of Archaeology and Anthropology Archives for his help.
14 We are grateful to Aaron Goldstein, of Northwood and Pinner Liberal Synagogue, and his cousin, Josh Vulgar, for this translation.
15 Minutes of the Board of Managers (June, 1902–May, 1905, p. 33).
16 The honour was reported in *The Times*, 29 July 1912, 11e.
17 J. Falconer *et al.*, *Catalogue of the Collections of Sir Aurel Stein in the Library of the Hungarian Academy of Sciences*, BM/LHAS, Budapest, 2002, p. 118.
18 For details, see http://www.socgeo.org/12.htm
19 A. Fierro, *La Société de géographie: 1821-1946*, Librairie Droz, Paris, 1983, p. 208; and *The Times*, 29 May 1923, 13g.
20 See Peter J. Ucko and S. Quirke, 'The Petrie Medal', *Public Archaeology* vol. 5, no. 1 (2006), pp. 15-25. We are grateful to Stephen Quirke, Curator, Petrie Museum of Egyptian Archaeology, for bringing this article to our attention.
21 Ucko and Quirke, 2006, p. 15.
22 See *The Times*, 29 June 1929, 7e (announcing the award and giving details of the presentation); 6 July 1929, 17d (giving details of the reception and the guests who attended); and 8 July 1929. See H. Wang, *Sir Aurel Stein in The Times*, Saffron Books, London 2002, pp. 99-101.
23 The authors are grateful to Hungarian Geographical Society, Budapest; the Royal Geographical Society, London; also Ágnes Kelecsényi of the Library of the Hungarian Academy of Sciences for her help and Jonathan Williams of the British Museum for translating the Latin inscription. For details of the medal in the British Library (BL ref: F580) see S. Whitfield, 'Aurel Stein medal', in A. Gallop (ed), *A Cabinet of Oriental Curiosities: An Album for Graham Shaw from his Colleagues*, British Library, London, 2006.
24 The Heinz Archive and Library, London, has a print from the original glass negative taken on 3 March 1924 by Bassano, no.71914 [Coll: NPG Acq no.x]. It was also reproduced in CEAW Oldham's obituary of Stein in the Proceedings of the British Academy, 1943: 1-20. The same photograph was adapted for Ian Rank-Broadley's medal depicting Stein, presented to Professor Ikuo Hirayama in 1993, see *The Medal* 23, 1993, pp. 25-26.
25 See J. Falconer *et al.*, *op. cit.*, p. 118.
26 Magyar Földrajzi Társaság: 19/1930.
27 Library of the Hungarian Academy of Sciences, Dept of MSS and Rare Books: RAL 444/1930.
28 See Lilla Russell-Smith, 'Hungarian Explorers in Dunhuang, *Journal of the Royal Asiatic Society* , Third Series, vol. 10, no. 3 (Nov 2000), pp. 341–362.
29 In 1910 Stein requested that the RGS (i.e. Sir John Scott Keltie) send proofs of his Nan-shan notes to a select group of people, including Professor Ludovici L'oczy, Fred Andrews and P.S. Allen [ar RGS/CB7/Stein].
30 31 See http://www.therai.org.uk/awards/honours/huxley-memorial-medal-and-lecture/ (accessed 5 April 2011).
32 T.A. Joyce, 'Notes on the physical anthropology of Chinese Turkestan and the Pamirs,' *Journal of the Royal Anthropological Institute*, vol. 42, (July–Dec 1912), reprinted in M.A. Stein, *Serindia*: *Detailed Report of Explorations in Central Asia and Westernmost China*, vol. 3, Appendix C, Oxford, 1921, pp. 1351–1389.
33 In the preface to his lecture, he notes 'Had it not been for the self-sacrificing labour which my ever helpful friend, Mr T.A. Joyce, your distinguished ex-President, bestowed after each of my Central-Asian expeditions upon the elucidation of the anthropometrical materials gathered by me between the Sistan basin in the south-west and the extreme north-east of Chinese Turkestan, my contribution to the aims of proper anthropological study would not have merited mention', *ibid.*, p. 179.
34 A. Stein, 'The Indo-Iranian borderlands: their prehistory in the light of geography and of recent explorations', *The Journal of the Royal Anthropological Institute of Great Britain and Ireland*, vol. 64, (Jul–Dec 1934), pp. 179–202.
35 A full list of the recipients of the Huxley Memorial Medal and the lectures they gave is available on http://www.therai.org.uk/awards/honours-prior-recipients/huxley-memorial-medal-and-lecture-prior-recipients
36 This description was supplied by Adrian James of the Society of Antiquaries, 6 April 2011.
37 F.H. Thompson, 'The Society of Antiquaries of London: Its History and Activities', *Proceedings of the Massachusetts Historical Society* , 3rd series, vol. 93 (1981), pp. 1-16, esp. p. 15. Kruger Grey designed Britain's pre-war silver coinage.
38 *The Times*, 18 April 1935, 10c and 1 May 1935, 11b.
39 Sir Colville Adrian de Rune Barclay (1869–1929), British Envoy Extraordinary and Minister Plenipotentiary to Sweden, 1919–24, and then to Hungary, 1924–28.
40 Arthur Robert Hinks (1873–1945), Vice-President, Royal Astronomical Society, 1919–31; Secretary, Royal Geographical Society, 1915–45.
41 RGS archives: ar RGS/CB9/Stein.
42 RGS ref.: 700619/D2.
43 Mrs Brown (nee Moulder, 1904–83), secretary, had worked for Charles Singer (1876-1960), historian of science, technology and medicine, and was introduced to Stein by John de Monins Johnson (1882–1956) of Oxford University Press, who was working on the publication of *Innermost Asia*. After Stein's return to Kashmir, she continued to work for him by correspondence, checking references etc at the Bodlean Library, until his death in 1943.
44 RGS ref.: 700606/D1. See also the RGS website, http://images.rgs.org/index.aspx Reproduced with the permission of the Royal Geographical Society.
45 Ellsworth Huntington (1876–1947), Professor of Geography, Yale University; RGS archive: ar RGS/CB7/Stein.
46 RGS archives: ar RGS/CB9/Stein.
47 RGS archives: ar RGS/CB10/Stein.
48 RGS archives: ar RGS/CB7/Stein.
49 These awards were made from the interest accrued by various premiums by, bequests from, or memorials to, various Fellows, the initial gifted amount usually being £1,000.
50 RGS archives: ar RGS/CB8/Stein.




Figure 2 (a-c) Founder's Medal, Royal Geographical Society (obverse, reverse, edge)

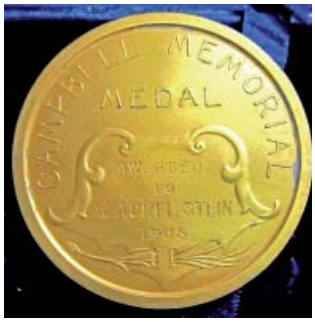



Figure 3 (a-b) Campbell Memorial Gold Medal, Royal Asiatic Society, Bombay (obverse, reverse)







Figure 4 (a-b) Lucy Wharton Drexel Medal, University of Pennsylvania, Museum (obverse, reverse)





Figure 5 (a-b) Gold Medal, Société de Géographie, France (obverse, reverse)







Figure 6 (a-c) Flinders Petrie Medal for Archaeology, London University (obverse, reverse, edge)





Figure 7 (a-b) Medal, Hungarian Geographical Society (obverse, reverse)





Figure 8 (a-b) Medal (In Memoriam Ludovici L'oczy), Hungarian Geographical Society (obverse, reverse)





Figure 9 (a-b) Huxley Memorial Medal, Royal Anthropological Institute (obverse, reverse)



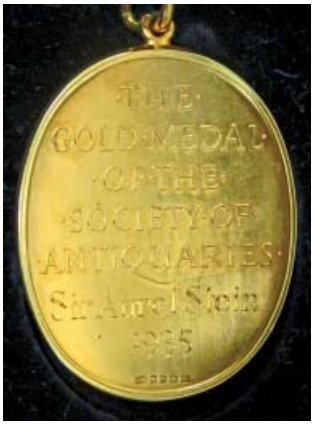


Figure 10 (a-b) Gold Medal, Society of Antiquaries (obverse, reverse)

Aurel Stein's Correspondence with Paul Pelliot and Lionel Barnett

Ursula Sims-Williams

Curator, Iranian Collections, British Library

Although they have very different origins, the two collections described in this paper have been bound together in one volume, British Library MS Or.13114. The first (Or.13114/1), is an official file kept by the 'Stein Collection' recording the Sinologist Paul Pelliot's (1878–1945) involvement in cataloguing the Chinese manuscripts from Stein's second expedition (1906–1908);[1] the second (Or.13114/2) is the private correspondence between Aurel Stein and Lionel Barnett (1871–1960), Keeper in the Department of Oriental Printed Books and Manuscripts at the British Museum.

Both these collections, however, relate to the daily workings of the 'Stein Collection'.[2] Although this term is now used generally to refer to objects and manuscripts collected by Aurel Stein in the first decades of the 20th century, 'The Stein Collection' in this context referred specifically to the basement accommodation at the British Museum which was made available to Stein and his assistants. It was the 'headquarters' for the safe storage of the objects and documents collected on Stein's expeditions and was managed by Fred Andrews and Miss Lorimer, under instruction from Stein. Although located on the premises of the British Museum, The Stein Collection was separate from the British Museum collections, and had its own key(s). It was only after the objects and documents had been studied and prepared for publication that the Stein Collection was distributed to different locations, and formally entered the collections of the British Museum, the India Office Library and other institutions. For the locations of the papers and archives from The Stein Collection see *Stein Handbook* 2008 for details.

British Library MS Or.13114 has recently been digitised and will shortly be available to read on the International Dunhuang Project Database (www.idp.bl.uk).

Brief list of persons mentioned

Andrews, Frederick Henry (1864–1957), Vice-Principal, Mayo School of Art, Lahore, 1890; Director, Art Department, Battersea Polytechnic 1906; Director, Technical Institute, Srinagar 1913

Arnold, Thomas Walker (1864–1930), Professor of Philosophy, Government College, Lahore, 1898; Dean of Oriental Faculty, Punjab University; Professor of Arabic, University College, London, 1904 and School of Oriental Studies, University of London, 1917

Barnett, Lionel David (1871–1960), Indologist; Assistant Keeper, 1899, Keeper, Department of Oriental Printed Books and Manuscripts, British Museum, 1908–36; Professor of Sanskrit, University College, London, 1906–17; Lecturer in Sanskrit, School of Oriental Studies, University of London, 1917–48

Chavannes, Edouard (1865–1918), Sinologist; Professor, Collège de France, 1893

De Filippi, Count Filippo (1869–1938), explorer; surgeon, Italian Medical Service

Droop, John Percival (1882–1963), Assistant at the Stein Collection, British Museum, 1909–11; Professor of Classical Archaeology, University of Liverpool, 1921–48

Foucher, Alfred Charles Auguste (1865–1952) archaeologist; founded Délégation archéologique française en Afghanistan, 1922; Professor, Sorbonne, Paris

Francke, August Hermann (1870–1930), Tibetologist; Moravian missionary at Leh, 1896-1909; Professor of Tibetan, University of Berlin, 1925

Gauthiot, Robert Edmond (1876–1916), Sogdianist; École Pratique des Hautes Études

Giles, Lionel (1875–1958), Sinologist; Keeper, Department of Oriental Printed Books and Manuscripts, British Museum

Grierson, George Abraham (1851–1941), Indologist; Superintendent, Linguistic Survey of India
Haneda Toru (1882–1955), historian and Uighur specialist; Rector, Kyoto University
Hardinge (of Penshurst), Charles Hardinge, 1st Baron (1858–1944), British diplomat; Viceroy of India, 1910–16
Hari Kishan Kaul, Raja Pandit Sir (1869–1942), Prime Minister of Kashmir, 1931
Hertel, Johannes (1872–1955), Indologist and Iranist; Professor, University of Leipzig
Hoernle, August Friedrich Rudolf (1841–1918), Indologist; Principal, Calcutta Madrasa, 1881–99; Stein's main collaborator on Brahmi script materials
Hopkins, Lionel Charles (1854–1952), Sinologist; Consul-General, Tianjin, China
Ivanov, Vladimir Aleksevich, Persian scholar and Arabist; Librarian, Asiatic Society of Bengal
Jackson, Abraham Valentine Williams (1862–1937), Professor of Indo-Iranian Languages, Columbia University
Kenyon, Sir Frederic George (1863–1952), Director and Principal Librarian, British Museum, 1909–30
Konow, Sten (1867–1948), Indologist; Government Epigraphist for the Archaeological Survey in India 1906–08; Professor, Hamburg University, 1914–19; University of Oslo 1910, 1919–37
Lampson, Sir Miles Wedderburn (Baron Killearn) (1880–1964), diplomat; British representative at Nanjing
La Vallée Poussin, Louis de (1869–1938), Indologist; Professor, University of Ghent, 1893–1929
Laufer, Berthold (1874–1934), Sinologist and anthropologist; Curator, Field Museum of National History, Chicago
Le Coq, Albert von (1860–1930), archaeologist; Ethnologisches Museum, Berlin
Lévi, Sylvain (1863–1935), Indologist; Professor, Collège de France
Lorimer, Florence Mary Glen (1883–1967), known amongst Stein's associates as the R.A. or 'Recording Angel'; Assistant, Stein Collection, British Museum and in Kashmir
Macartney, Sir George (1867–1945), administrator; Special Assistant for Chinese Affairs, 1890; Consul General, Chinese Turkestan, 1910–18
Maspéro, Henri (1883–1945), Sinologist; Professor of Chinese, Collège de France; Professor, École Pratique des Hautes Études
McGovern, William Montgomery (1897–1964), explorer and far-eastern specialist; Lecturer at School of Oriental Studies University of London 1919–24; Professor at Northwestern University, 1929–64
Müller, Friedrich Wilhelm Karl (1863–1930), Iranist and ethnologist; Assistant to Albert Grünwedel, and later Director, East Asian Department, Museum für Völkerkunde, Berlin.
Pan Ta-jen, Amban of Khotan, afterwards Tao-tai at Aksu
Pargiter, Frederick Eden (1852–1927), Sanskritist; Judge of High Court, Calcutta; Secretary, President, Bengal Asiatic Society
Pelliot, Paul (1878–1945), Sinologist and explorer; Professor, Collège de France
Petrucci, Raphael (1872–1917), art historian
Rapson, Edward James (1861–1937), Indologist; Coin Department, British Museum, 1887; Professor of Sanskrit, Cambridge University, 1906–36
Reichelt, Hans (1877–1939), Iranist; Professor at University of Hamburg, 1926; Professor at University of Graz, 1930
Ross, Sir Edward Denison (1871–1940), linguist; Principal, Calcutta Madrasa, 1901–11; Keeper of Stein Collection, British Museum, 1914–16; Director and Professor of Persian, School of Oriental Studies, University of London, 1916–37
Sherriff, George (1898–1967), administrator; Vice-Consul at Kashgar 1927–30, Consul-General 1930–31
Strzygowski, Josef (1862–1941), Professor of Art History, University of Vienna
Taki, Seiichi 滝精一 (1873–1945), art historian; Professor, Faculty of Letters, Tokyo Imperial University
Thomsen, Vilhelm Ludwig Peter (1842–1927), Turkologist; Professor, Copenhagen University
Togan, Ahmet Zeki Velidi (1890–1970), Orientalist and nationalist; Professor, Istanbul University
Vogel, Jean Philippe (1871–1958), Sanskritist and archaeologist; Archeological Survey of India 1901–14; Professor of Sanskrit and Indian Archaeology, Leiden University, 1914–39
Yabuki, Keiki 矢吹慶輝 (1879–1939), Professor of the History of Religion, Taisho University, Japan

Note

The arrangement of this list is largely chronological, following the order in which the letters have been bound. The many enclosures, however, were often bound out of sequence. Wherever possible I have listed them with the letters they were originally enclosed with, but in some cases, when it was impossible to decide which those were, they have been listed by date. Chinese names remain as they appear in the correspondence.

Or.13114/1: Stein Collection file containing correspondence between Stein and Pelliot regarding Chinese documents, 1910–17

Pelliot first visited the Stein Collection in 1910 in the basement of the British Museum where it had been transferred in August 1909.[3] At that time the majority of manuscripts were numbered only by the numbers of the boxes they came from. Nevertheless on the basis of a preliminary examination Pelliot proposed in a memorandum of July 1910 (ff. 37–44) to prepare an inventory of the 3000 or so mainly Buddhist scrolls and the 5000–6000 detached fragments amongst which were many important texts of popular literature, geography and lexicography. Pelliot estimated that the work would take at least a year. His conditions were that the manuscripts should be sent in several batches to him at home in Paris; that the inventory would be published; that he would receive 5,000 francs on completion as compensation for his time; and that he should be given publication rights for certain documents.

Pelliot received the first installment consisting of two cases containing 15 and 14 bundles of mss. numbered 1–443 (excepting nos. 55, 218 and 237) on 13 January 1911. Stein wrote a month later (ff. 23–24) offering to send two more boxes. However, an appointment to the Collège de France in 1911, in addition to work on his own collection, kept Pelliot fully occupied, though he found time to advise on a selection of manuscripts to be illustrated in Stein's Second Expedition Report (f. 31).

Barnett wrote apparently to Pelliot again on 12 June 1913 and received the reply (f. 9) that Pelliot had not only been unable to do any work on the inventory, but could not undertake any further work on it for a year. Despite the Trustees' resolve to ask for the mss to be returned for exhibition and to get an inventory done locally (f.9), Pelliot still had the manuscripts in spring 1914 when he promised Barnett that he would finish the inventory and return the two cases of mss by the end of June 1914 (f. 7).

Meanwhile, Dr. Ross was doing a preliminary listing of the remaining Chinese manuscripts 'and is getting on with them quite regularly,'[4] reserving queries for Pelliot who was

due to visit in July 1914. However with the outbreak of war, Pelliot became engaged in active service, and Dr. Ross, who had completed descriptions of 600 Chinese mss, was transferred to the War Office.[5]

By September 1917, the date of the last of these papers, when Stein was about to leave for India, he wrote to Sir Frederic Kenyon, giving a short history of the whole affair (ff. 10–15). Pelliot not only had not returned the two cases as requested, he had produced no descriptions and 'the great mass of Chinese MSS. …has so far remained wholly uncatalogued and even without a rough inventory'. Stein's recommendation was to bring over a young Japanese scholar to do the work as soon as possible. The saga of the cataloguing of the Chinese documents is continued in the second part of this volume (Or.13114/2) when the two boxes were finally returned in 1919 (ff. 125–6) and Lionel Giles began working on them.

Or.13114/1/ff. 1–2
Folder covers
Note by F.M.G. Lorimer (unsigned) 'Correspondence with M. Pelliot regarding Chinese documents. July 1910,' added note mentions Pelliot's memorandum of 7 July 1910 (see below) which was sent to Stein 5 May 1911.

Or.13114/1/ff. 37–42
Pelliot's notes, July 1910
Handwritten notes (ff. 37–38) dating from July 1910 (as specified on the cover, see above), and two typed copies (ff. 39–40; 41–42) headed 'Copy of memorandum of M. Pelliot regarding inventory of Chinese mss, from Tun-Huang'.

Or.13114/1/f. 2 bis
Delivery slip from Thos. Cook, 11 Jan 1911
Two cases via Thos. Cook for delivery to M.A. Stein or Mr. Droop at British Museum, for Paris.

Or.13114/1/f. 4
Thos. Cook shipping declaration form
Two cases of mss valued at £200 for delivery to P. Pelliot.

Or.13114/1/f. 3
Receipt, 13 Jan 1911
Receipt for two cases of Chinese mss from Stein collection, one containing 15 bundles of mss numbered 1–233 (excepting nos 55 & 218), the other containing 14 bundles of mss numbered 234–443 (excepting no. 237 (not found). Received and signed by Paul Pelliot.

Or.13114/1/f. 6
List: British Museum's share of Stein's 2nd expedition.

Or.13114/1/f. 19–22
Stein, Merton College Oxford, to Pelliot (copy), 16 Jan 1911
Discusses cataloguing and asks Pelliot to take particular note of any peculiarities in the paper.

Or.13114/1 /ff. 17–18
Stein, British Museum, to Frederic Kenyon (copy), 26 Jan 1911
Requests on Pelliot's behalf whether Trustees will be willing, in principle, to give him publication rights of certain texts for two years.

Or.13114/1/f. 16
Kenyon, British Museum, to Stein (copy), 18 Feb 1911
Responding to Stein's request (ff. 17–18), the Trustees 'will not give a definite pledge to reserve any of the Chinese MSS. from Tun-huang exclusively for M. Pelliot's use and prior publication, but they will be disposed to consider favourably any application that he may make.'

Or.13114/1/ff. 23–24
Stein, Merton College Oxford, to Pelliot (copy), 27 Feb 1911
Congratulations on Pelliot's appointment to Collège de France. A second set of two boxes is ready to be despatched when he is ready.

Or.13114/1/f. 25–26
Stein, Merton College Oxford, to Pelliot (copy), 11 Sept 1911
Asks whether Pelliot will visit Stein Collection in September as agreed previously?

Or.13114/1/ff. 27–28
Stein, Merton College Oxford, to Pelliot (copy), 22 Sept 1911
Regrets that Pelliot is not able to come, particularly since Stein will be leaving for India in December. Discusses possibility of visit in 1912.

Or.13114/1/ff. 29–30
L.D. Barnett (unsigned), Stein Collection, to Pelliot (copy), 16 Sept 1912
Asks for assistance in selecting items to be illustrated in Stein's report. Refers to Pelliot's visit in 1910.

Or.13114/1/f. 31
Pelliot, 52 Boulevard Edgar Quinet, to Barnett (unnamed), 2 Oct 1912
Mentions noteworthy items from his notes made on previous visit in 1910.

Or.13114/1/f. 32–33
Barnett, Stein Collection, to Pelliot (copy), 12 Dec 1912
Requests additional dated mss to be selected and returned for photography.

Or.13114/1/f. 34
Barnett or Miss Lorimer (unsigned), Stein Collection, to Pelliot (copy), 6 Feb 1913
Has heard via Dr Ross that Pelliot was sending dated mss for photography, but they have not been received, has he in fact sent them, if not could he?

Or.13114/1/f. 35
Pelliot, 52 Boulevard Edgar Quinet, to Mlle [Lorimer], Sunday [Feb 1913]
Explains the misunderstanding: Ross had offered to bring the mss with him on his return to London. He will see him on Monday and confirm arrangements.

Or.13114/1/f. 36
Barnett to Pelliot (copy), 15 May 1913
Asks for progress on inventory.

Or.13114/1/f. 8
Barnett to Pelliot (copy), 5 Aug 1913
Recommends sadly that Pelliot gives up Chinese cataloguing project though ultimate decision will be made by the Trustees in October. Asks how many mss Pelliot has completed.

Or.13114/1/f. 44
Barnett to Pelliot (copy), 5 Aug 1913
Duplicate copy of Or.13114/1/f. 8 above

Or.13114/1/f. 9
Memorandum
Copy of memo. by Dr. Barnett regarding Pelliot's Chinese mss inventory, August 11 1913; copy of letter from Pelliot to Barnett, 31 July 1913; extract from Minutes of Trustees Administration, 11 October 1913, approving the suggestion that Pelliot return the the Chinese mss with a view to their being included in the proposed exhibition, and that the inventory be done locally.

Or.13114/1/f. 43
Memorandum
Duplicate copy of memorandum above.

Or.13114/1/f. 7
Note
Stein's? note (unsigned) on correspondence in folder between L.D. Barnett and P. Pelliot, 1913–14.

Or.13114/1/ff. 10–15
Stein, British Museum, to Sir Frederic Kenyon (draft), 25 Sept 1917
Pelliot still has 2 boxes of uncatalogued Chinese mss. Suggests that Japanese Embassy is asked to recommend a scholar to undertake the work in Pelliot's place.

Or.13114/1/f. 5
Note containing ms. numbers, 18 March 1920.

Or.13114/2: Correspondence between M.A. Stein and L.D. Barnett 1912–36

This collection forms part of the private papers of Lionel David Barnett (1871–1960)[6] and contains his personal correspondence with Sir Aurel Stein during a period when Barnett, except between spring 1914 and November 1916 when Denison Ross was in charge, had responsibility, in Stein's absence, for the Stein Collection housed in a basement room of the British Museum.

Barnett joined the Museum in 1899 as Assistant Keeper in the Department of Oriental Printed Books and Manuscripts, and in 1908 succeeded Sir Robert Douglas as Keeper until his retirement in 1936. His involvement with Stein's expedition material began in the summer of 1901 when the finds from Stein's First Expedition were deposited in the British Museum. In 1903 Barnett published a 'Preliminary notice of the Tibetan manuscripts in the Stein Collection', and from 1906 he acted as one of Rudolf Hoernle's collaborators, being sent 139 Sanskrit fragments to edit and prepare for publication.[7]

Stein's letters to Barnett are largely concerned with the administration of The Stein Collection at the Museum and the recruitment of experts to decipher and publish his manuscript finds, and as such they include detailed descriptions of his work besides containing quite frank opinions about his contemporaries. In addition, his letters describe his third and fourth expeditions to Central Asia (July 1913–February 1917; August 1930–June 1931), his failed proposals to excavate in Afghanistan (1912; 1919–22), his two expeditions to Baluchistan (January–April 1927; December 1927–May 1928), and his first and fourth expeditions to Iran (January–April 1932; November 1935–November 1936).

Or.13114/2/ff. 45–47
Envelope from Stein, on Special Duty, to Barnett, Keeper of Oriental Books and MSS, British Museum, undated
Contains five prints: 'Camp ridge, Mohand Marg (Tents between trees)', 'On Kanyadalo ridge, Mohand Marg', 'Camp on Mohand Marg with view to Sind V. June 1, 1912', 'View tow. Haromukh peaks from camp, Mohand Marg' and 'My "rock garden" Mohand Marg'.

Or.13114/2/ff. 48–50
Stein, Camp Mohand Marg, to Barnett, 8 July 1912
Is grateful for his collection being under Barnett's care and for the weekly reports received from Andrews and Miss Lorimer. Discusses progress on the Second Expedition manuscript material by Hoernle (Brahmi), Lévi (Tocharian), and Francke (Tibetan), but is very anxious about Pelliot's catalogue (Chinese). Acceptance by Govt. of India of proposed exploration along Oxus, but as yet no confirmation received from Kabul. All this to be kept 'entre nous'.

Or.13114/2/f. 50
Stein, Mohand Marg, to Barnett, 16 Sept 1912
Reports that the Amir of Afghanistan, while grateful to receive a copy of Stein's *Desert Cathay*,[8] requires it to be translated into Persian before inviting Stein on an archaeological tour of Afghanistan.

Or.13114/2/f. 51
Stein, Srinagar, to Barnett, 1 Dec 1912
Has requested India Office to allow publication of his photos in Barnett's projected book. Inventory slips have been received regularly from Hoernle, Francke and Poussin. Requests that Ross should put essential facts about the Uighur mss into a preliminary report for the *Journal of the Royal Asiatic Society*.

Or.13114/2/ff. 52–3
Stein, Srinagar, to Barnett, 29 Dec 1912
Is anxious on progress with Sogdian. F.W.K. Müller has had photos for over two years without any tangible results. Suggests that R. Gauthiot be asked to replace him. Ross should not be entrusted with this material. Has heard indirectly from Miss Lorimer and also from J. Strzygowski in Vienna that Ross had found the date AD 1350 in one of the Uighur documents from Tun-huang. 'If you could induce Ross to put me into possession of his observations direct instead of communicating news in scraps through Miss L. or via Berlin, I should feel very grateful, indeed'. Suggests Hoernle, who is 'an ideal collaborator for inventories', be asked to deal with the small Sanskrit fragments from Khadalik rather than Poussin.

Or.13114/2/ff. 54–5
Stein, Srinagar, to Barnett, 2 Feb 1913
Discusses possible opening for Andrews in Kashmir at proposed Industrial Art School. Has heard from Ross, 'but without any of the hoped-for information about the dated Uighur MS. book.' Suggests that Giles, 'a sober & reliable worker', should look carefully at the paper used in the different Uighur mss. with a view to noticing its relation to that of dated Chinese mss. Rapson has discovered some Sanskrit ślokas and Dhammapada verses in one of the Kharoṣṭhī tablets.

Or.13114/2/ff. 56–9
Stein, Srinagar, to E.D. Ross (copy), 2 Feb 1913
Is glad Ross has found it possible 'in the midst of your peregrinations' to examine the Uighur materials. Questions his conclusions, particularly the date AD 1350, also 'the indications which led you to recognize bamboo paper in several of the fragments containing apparently Sogdian texts and to date the ink of one of them [Ch.00284][9] as of the 14th cent. I am equally curious, of course, about the Sogdian fragment [Ch.00289][10] on what you consider "mulberry paper of the Ming dynasty".'

Or.13114/2/ff. 60–61
Stein, Srinagar, to Barnett, 2 Mar 1913
Is grateful for Barnett's attempts to retrieve materials from Müller. Suggests that Gauthiot be invited to edit Sogdian materials in Müller's place. Has received some meagre inventory slips from Ross. Reflects on Ross' ambition 'to edit, elucidate, etc., that commentary on the Abhi-dharma to which he thought it worth while to devote half a life time! S. Lévi who wanted to use it for a comprehensive edition of the text in all its versions, is being kept away from it by this "ambition", I fear with no possible advantage to anybody.' Writes, in confidence, that plans for a third Central Asian expedition have been accepted. 'I interested Lord Hardinge and other kind patrons on the Indian Olympus in the plan I had kept in view ever since 1908. Macartney opportunely urged their early commencement in view of German competition, and this practical argument helped.' Hopes to complete bulk of work on *Serindia*[11] before starting out in the late summer.

Or.13114/2/f. 62
Stein, Srinagar, to Barnett, 31 Mar 1913
Is grateful for Ross' help in getting hold of Müller's notes. Is pleased Poussin has finished with his materials[12] 'I only wished, he could have spared you the editing of his notes!–Hoernle can be trusted to make best use of the remaining Brāhmī MS. fragments from Khadalik etc.'

Or.13114/2/f. 63
Stein, Srinagar, to Barnett, 14 Apr 1913
Is pleased Müller's paper is to be published in *Journal of the Royal Asiatic Society*, thanks to Ross, 'so his meteoric flittings were of use here.' On Poussin's transliterations of the Khadaliq texts 'What a pity, though, that our excellent and aimiable friend does not seem to realize himself the advantages of orderly presentation!' Is busy with *Serindia* plates.

Or.13114/2/f. 64
Stein, Srinagar, to Barnett, 12 May 1913
Is waiting for formal approval for third Central Asian expedition, 'In the meantime I must wish that Lecoq & party will find plenty to keep them busy at Turfan, and–that other competition may not deprive me of my goals.' Agrees that Ross may continue to work on Sogdian. 'I was only anxious that this protracted occupation should not debar others from making real progress with the help of our materials.' On Gauthiot's plans to to study Yaghnobi.

Or.13114/2/ff. 65–6
Stein, Mohand Marg, to Barnett, 8 June 1913

Is grateful for Barnett's editorial work in getting 'all those philological materials into shape for the J.R.A.S. Given the peculiar ways of certain estimed [sic] collaborators, I often feel doubts as to whether the results would ever see the light without your devoted help and skill in getting things ship-shape.' Mention of Japanese art historian Taki's visit to Stein collection. Has received telegram confirming Govt. of India's sanction for Central Asian expedition. Is concerned for care of Stein Collection while he is absent in Central Asia.

Or.13114/2/f. 67
Stein, Camp, P.O. Srinagar, to Barnett, 4 July 1913
On Pelliot: 'What you have achieved with Pelliot is a great comfort to me'. Is glad Japanese visitors are making interesting discoveries. Encloses Francke's draft article on Tibetan documents for publication in *Journal of the Royal Asiatic Society*.[13]

Or.13114/2 /ff. 68–9
Stein, Camp Maralbashi, to Barnett, 20 Oct 1913
Describes journey to Kashgar, through unexplored Darel and Tangīr. At Kashgar spent fortnight organising caravan, then 12 days travelling on unsurveyed route along foot of Tien-shan. Regrets Rapson's work on Kharoṣṭhī tablets is still unpublished and that Pelliot will not prepare his inventory of Chinese mss.

Or.13114/2/ff. 70–1
Stein, Camp Hsi-êrh-tun, Kansu, to Barnett, 24 Apr 1914
Re-assured over Collection move to new quarters, and plans for exhibition.[14] On progress at Niya, Charklik and Miran. Worked for six weeks in the waterless desert to the North including Lou-lan. Secured 'a good lot of Chinese MSS. left behind in the "Thousand Buddhas"'.

Or.13114/2/ff. 72–5
Stein, Kanchou, to Barnett, 14 Aug 1914
En route from Mongolia to Barkul. Was laid up for two weeks after a riding accident. Travelled down Etsingol into Mongolia and discovered plenty of interesting mss from Karakhoto. Regrets Ross's recent appointment in charge of the Stein Collection 'I know of our friend Ross' arrival [Spring 1914] - and the difficulty of finding for him suitable occupation, anyhow at our collection… The way in which his "translation" was arranged suggests some specially powerful patronage in the background, probably that of Lord Curzon… To me it is a real loss and grief that our collection should have been deprived of your special guidance & help which had proved a great boon all through. But I trust, the autocratic change will not prevent Miss L. from having the benefit of your private advice when the occasion arises'. Has learned from Miss Lorimer that Ross 'without completing the work undertaken for our Turki texts, is now eager to occupy himself with the Sogdian rolls.' Mentions Ross' lack of Iranian linguistic qualifications.

Or.13114/2/ff. 76–7
Stein, Camp, Turfan, to Barnett, 19 Dec 1914
On war. Since writing from Kanchou, crossed desert through easternmost portion of the Pei-shan to southern Dzhungaria and along north foot of Tienshan to Barkul and Guchen. Reached Turfan at end of October 'In spite of German & Japanese expeditions and most destructive exploitation by burrowing villagers its ruins proved by no means yet exhausted'. Has acquired many frescoes.

Or.13114/2/ff. 78–80
Stein, Kashgar, to Barnett, 10 June 1915
Has visited sites around Kucha and Bai. Put in three months hard work around Turfan. His camel convoy reached Kashgar safely. On distribution and division of the Stein's Second Expedition material. Material from the Third Expedition is to be sent to Kashmir and stored at Lahore.

Or.13114/2/ff. 81–2
Stein, Camp Kala-i-Wamar, Roshan, to Barnett, 26 Sept 1915
Packed 180 cases for despatch to Kashmir. Left by 2nd week of July. Visited Roshan and Shugnan valleys, then Lake Victoria and down the Oxus, to Wakhan. Hopes to start archaeological work in Sistan in December.

Or.13114/2/ff. 83–6
Stein, Camp, Sistan, to Barnett, 10 Jan 1916
Travelled to Sistan via Wakhan corridor, Samarkand, Bukhara, and Mashhad. Excavating at Buddhist sanctuary at Kuh-i Khwaja. Frescoes despatched to India. Also discovered old watch stations, relics of boundary. The 182 cases despatched from Kashgar reached Andrews in October.

Or.13114/2/ff. 88–9
Stein, Govt. House, Lahore, to Barnett, 10 Mar 1916
Sistan to Lahore via Quetta. Found pottery with possible Aramaic inscriptions. Travel arrangements to England in summer of 1917.

Or.13114/2/ff. 87A,B,C
Stein, Middlecott, Ilsington, S. Devon, to Barnett, 12 Jan 1916 [in error for 1917]
Asks about an enclosed Tibetan inscription. Is relieved that Miss Lorimer decided for Kashmir instead of Finsbury Square.

Or.13114/2/f. 90
Stein, Middlecote, Ilsington, S. Devon, to Barnett, 2 Aug 1917
Regrets that L.C. Hopkins is unwilling to provide a list of non-Buddhist Chinese mss from Tun-huang. Despairs at lack of a good Sinologist.

Or.13114/2/f. 91
Stein, on board Caledonia off Perim, to Barnett, 22 Oct 1917
Met Foucher, Chavannes and Lévi in Paris.

Or.13114/2/f. 92
Stein, Srinagar, to Barnett, 5 Feb 1918
Requests help for Miss Lorimer so that she may complete her work before starting for India. Asks for news about his proposal of September 1917 to enlist Japanese help for cataloguing the Chinese mss.

Or.13114/2/f. 93
Stein, Srinagar, to Barnett, 31 Jan 1918
On arrangements concerning the Stein Collection after Miss Lorimer has left.

Or.13114/2/ff. 94–5
Stein, Srinagar, to Barnett, 28 Feb 1918
Awaits news of Miss Lorimer's departure for India. Has heard indirectly from Sir F. Kenyon that the Stein Collection will remain accessible to him until the actual distribution takes place after the war. Speaks of plans for Foucher to prepare monograph on Ajanta, Sanchi etc. for Archaeological Survey of India.

Or.13114/2/f. 96
Stein, Srinagar, to Barnett, 10 Mar 1918
Last minute instructions to Miss Lorimer before departure.

Or.13114/2/f. 99
Stein, Srinagar, to Barnett, 9 Apr 1918
Passing on request for Miss Lorimer.

Or.13114/2/f. 100
Stein, Srinagar, to Barnett, 22 Apr 1918
On death of Chavannes and war in France. Is working hard on *Serindia*.

Or.13114/2/ff. 97-8; 101–2
Stein, Camp Mohand Marg, to Barnett, 22 June 1918
Is glad that the British Museum has in principle taken up his recommendation on the cataloguing of the Chinese mss. Reports on Yabuki's progress enclosing his letter. Writes of Russian turmoil and the plight of V. Ivanow, Arabic and Persian specialist at Oriental Museum, Petrograd.
Enclosure (ff. 97–8): K. Yabuki, Sugamomura, Tokyo, to Stein, 1 April 1918 (copy), on progress with preliminary report of Stein's Chinese mss. Has published two articles in Japanese. Writes about the Chinese Manichaean MS [Or.8210/S.2659].

Or.13114/2/f. 103
Stein, Camp, Mohand Marg, to Barnett, 16 Aug 1918
Is grateful that the Museum's share of the collection will be left in its present quarters until the end of the war. Asks about Chinese cataloguing and requests that a photo of Runic Turki Mi.xx.001 be sent to Prof. Thomsen.

Or.13114/2/f. 104
Stein, Camp Mohand Marg, to Barnett, 5 Sept 1918
Announces completion of *Serindia*, 'It was announced to Andrews at Srinagar, some 20 miles off and 6000 feet below, by a bonfire such as I had lit 22 years ago when my Rājataraṅginī translation was completed'.

Greatly regrets loss of Chavannes and Petrucci.

Or.13114/2/f. 105
List of India Office Property at British Museum, 17 Oct 1918

Or.13114/2/f. 106
Stein, Camp, Diwan Amarnath's Bagh, Dal, to Barnett, 31 Oct 1918
On hopes of war ending. Chinese mss from Third Expedition are in Andrew's annexe. Hopes they will also go to Barnett in the end. Foucher has arrived to work at Taxila, Sanchi and Ajanta.

Or.13114/2/ff. 107–15
Stein, Srinagar, to Barnett, 11 Dec 1918
On Bolshevik revolution. Visit of G. Macartney on his way home from Kashgar, and Foucher's arrival at Colombo. On deposit room for his new collection being built at Delhi near the new Museum. On hearing the news of Hoernle's death. Encloses lists of books which he requires to be sent to him from the Stein Collection.

Or.13114/2/ff. 116–19
Stein, Lieutenant Governor's Camp, United Provinces, Lucknow, to Barnett, 13 Feb 1919
On Hoernle's death. Has been on visit to Delhi, Sanchi, and Ajanta. Has worked on map memoir being printed at Dehra Dun.

Or.13114/2/ff. 120; 221–7
Stein, Srinagar, to Barnett, 22 Mar 1919
Is glad that Giles has started listing Chinese mss, but is still hoping for Japanese help for the catalogue. Intends to write to Giles enclosing copy of letter from Yabuki about recent discoveries. The plan for a Delhi work and deposit room has been sanctioned.
Enclosure (ff. 221–7, this has been bound out of sequence but seems logically to belong here): K. Yabuki, Sugamomura-Tokyo, to Stein, 20 January 1919 (copy).
Thanks for letters, apologises for delay in answering and encloses works. Asks if his note of 16 pages on Stein's Chinese MSS could be published. Has been working on rotographs of the Chinese mss, especially, since the summer of 1917, on the Manichaean ms [Or.8210/S.2659]. Ff. 224–7 contain a list of Chinese mss examined and comments.

Or.13114/2/ff. 121–22
Stein, Srinagar, to Barnett, 19 Apr 1919
Third Expedition material now completely unpacked and being organised by Miss Lorimer and Andrews. Hopes to get Maspero to work on Chinese documents. Asks about successor to Hoernle and whether Laufer of Chicago might do Tangut. The new Chinese material from Tun-huang will be sent to British Museum for inventory and safe-keeping if Govt. of India agrees. Is glad to hear Giles is working on Chinese Second Expedition material and congratulates him on getting help from Mr. McGovern.

Or.13114/2/ff. 123–4
Stein, Camp Mohand Marg, to Barnett, 10 July 1919
On Giles' progress, hopes to secure Laufer for Tangut. Requests papers as per attached list.

Or.13114/2/ff. 228–30
K. Yabuki, to Stein, 30 Aug 1919 (copy)
Has been publishing results of his research in Japanese. Has received funding for ordering about 3500 rotographs of 400–500 fragments.

Or.13114/2/ff. 125–6
Stein, Srinagar, to Barnett, 18 Oct 1919
On Chinese mss: 'It is a comfort to know that you have recovered the Chinese MSS. sent to Paris with so little profit, and that Giles' work is making steady progress.' Refers to Giles' review of Barnett's exhibition in *Times Literary Supplement*. Printing of *Serindia* is resumed. Foucher has interceded on his behalf with 'the divinities of Āryavarta' to get support for his Balkh plan. Hopes to leave in December to meet his sister-in-law in Switzerland whom he has not seen for eight years.

Or.13114/2/f. 127
Stein, Srinagar, to Barnett, 16 Nov 1919
Refers to French exclusive right to excavate in Iran. Will start from Bombay at Christmas and will get to Oxford after a few months in Switzerland.

Or.13114/2/f. 128
Stein, Brescia, to Barnett, 9 Feb 1920
Has been travelling with sister-in-law in Italy. Is hoping to stay with her until April. Not surprised Barnett could not meet Yabuki's demands for rotographs. Speaks of relief that the manuscript materials from the Third Expedition will temporarily go to British Museum. Previously Govt. of India had stipulated that they should go to India Office Library and be distributed thence to collaborators. Eight cases should have reached British Museum by now. Contents were all site-marked and roughly listed before he left Kashmir 'But how to secure adequate collaboration? No one can replace Chavannes or Hoernle either'.

Or.13114/2/f. 129
Stein, Cernobbio, Lago di Coma, to Barnett, 19 Feb 1920
Requests papers to be sent to him in Italy.

Or.13114/2/ff. 130–31
Stein, Cernobbio, Lago di Coma, to Barnett, 16 Mar 1920
About arrangements for eight cases of manuscripts from Stein's Third Expedition. Assumes the British Museum basement would be available. Two or three years should be sufficient for examination of new finds and to come to a decision as regards their eventual disposal. Hopes to reach London about 25 April. Is trying to secure Maspero for Chinese documents from *Limes*, and Laufer for Hsi-hsia [Tangut]. Concern about 'peace' conditions and break-up of Austro-Hungarian empire, 'the bleeding remnant of Hungary'. Is reading Thomas Hardy's *The Dynasts* to his sister-in-law.

Or.13114/2 f. 132
Stein, 23 Merton Street, Oxford, to Barnett. 2 May 1920
Refers to 'that happily discovered basket of Kharoṣṭhī tablets' which Rapson has been searching for. Transfer of mss cases of recent expedition material to Barnett's care now agreed by the British Museum Trustees and the India Office, Asks for them to be put 'in our old cave'. Laufer is to do Tangut and also Tibetan, but material will have to be sent to Chicago.

Or.13114/2/f. 133
Stein, 23 Merton Street, Oxford, to Barnett, 18 July 1920
Is grateful for Barnett's offer to help with Tibetan inscriptions on drawings for *Serindia*.

Or.13114/2/f. 134
Stein, Srinagar, to Barnett, 2 Apr 1922
May get permission to go to Bactria, possibly starting in May, since Foucher has got permission to go to Kabul. Regrets Andrews has decided to leave Kashmir in May.

Or.13114/2/ff. 135–142
Stein, Kashmir, to Barnett, 2 Apr 1922
Concerning his *Memoir* on new maps containing all Central Asian surveys which is now going through the press at Dehra Dun.[15] Asks for plates (list ff. 140–142) to illustrate it.

Or.13114/2/ff. 143–4
Stein, Camp, P.O. Srinagar, to Barnett, 27 May 1922
Thanks him for help with photos. Writes of Afghan obstructions and difficulties in negotiating his 'Bactrian plan', despite Foucher having arrived in Kabul. Is working on report of his Third Expedition.

Or.13114/2/f. 145
Stein, Camp, Mohand Marg, to Barnett, 4 Sept 1922
Negotiations on Afghan trip still ongoing.

Or.13114/2/f. 146
Stein, Camp, Mohand Marg, to Barnett, 1 Oct 1922
Progress on report. On theories about Aryan invasions. Is incredulous about Aryans invading India via Western Tibet, 'I think those excellent Calcutta & Simla scholar-civilians have but a very imperfect idea as to what a barrier the Himalayas main range & still more that lifeless desert plateau of W. Tibet really are'. Meanwhile has received Amir's refusal for Afghan expedition although Foucher has been given permission.

Or.13114/2/ff. 147-8
Stein, Srinagar, to Barnett, 29 Oct 1922
Heard from British Minister at Kabul that request for Afghan tour was refused. Promised explanation has not arrived, but received a fortnight ago a letter from Foucher containing 'expressions of regret, etc., how the

wily Afghans had induced him against his original intentions to negotiate a convention for France which secures its "Délégation" what amounts to practically preclusive archaeological rights in Afghanistan'. Feels bitterly disappointed and betrayed.

Or.13114/2/f. 149
Stein, Srinagar, to Barnett, 18 Dec 1922
Thanks for copy of Barnett's book *Hindu gods and heroes* (London, 1922).

Or.13114/2/f. 150
Stein, Srinagar, to Barnett, 1 Apr 1923
On his presentation of some Turkish manuscripts to British Museum. They had been acquired privately by Stein on his first journey to Turkestan. Has been in Delhi where Andrews has been setting up frescoes. Has been sorting books which are to be given to Hungary. Hints that the reception of the French monopoly in Afghanistan is not being well received.

Or.13114/2/ff. 151–2
Stein, Camp, Mohand Marg, to Barnett, 10 June 1923
Is working on report of his Third Expedition. Plans to visit England in May 1924 to photograph objects for plates. If he is allowed to take objects to England, could British Museum accommodate them for 4–5 months in summer 1924, in the basement? Mentions that Govt. of India will not this time be prepared to offer a share of the 'proceeds' to the Trustees with the exception, perhaps, of the Chinese records. Asks Barnett to sound out Sir F. Kenyon. Is Haneda still available to prepare an inventory of the Uighur materials? Maspero has not supplied any of the promised translations, nor has he heard anything from Laufer on Hsi-hsia [Tangut] or Tibetan.

Or.13114/2/f. 153
Stein, Camp, Mohand Marg, to Barnett, 8 Sept 1923
Kenyon has granted permission for use of British Museum basement. Pargiter has listed Brahmi finds 'with a thoroughness worthy of Hoernle', and Sten Konow has listed the Khotanese fragments. Still has heard nothing from Laufer 'to whom the rather plentiful Hsi-hsia and Tibetan materials went'. Has heard nothing from Maspero except note received more than a year ago. For Uighur he suggests Le Coq. Thomsen is too big a scholar and too old.

Or.13114/2/f. 154B + 6 photos
Stein, Camp, Srinagar, to Lionel Giles, 29 Sept 1923
Congratulates him on the discovery of the Manichaean Chinese text [Or.8212/S.3969] and on his decision to let Pelliot publish it: 'I trust P. will settle down to the task promptly and not direct his energy to some other attractive field.— You know, no doubt, that Yabuki in 1816 had found another text among the Tun-huang MSS. which he took to be Manichaean & about which he repeatedly wrote to me from Japan.' Maspero's silence is a drawback. Encloses photo of a Chinese inscription from Idikut Shahri [Karakhoja, Turfan] which he missed handing over to Maspero. Hopes to complete report on Third Expedition by January and if 'gods of Indian Olympus' agree to his publication proposals, will come to England in May to see to photography, printing etc.

Or.13114/2/f. 154
Stein, Srinagar, to Barnett, 18 Nov 1923
Has written formally to Kenyon for permission to work in British Museum. Plans to send 30 cases before leaving in third week of February. Glad to see publication at long last of *Hatim's Tales*.[16]

Or.13114/2/f. 155
Stein, Raisina, Delhi, to Barnett, 7 February 1924
Addresses Barnett in error as 'Baron'. 34 cases are being sent. Discusses his and Andrew's furniture requirements. Andrews plans to arrive in London in the last week of April. Asks Barnett to remind Laufer 'of what he offered to do for the inventory of Hsi-hsia and Tibetan MS. materials. Neither from him nor from Maspero have I been able [to] secure answers to my reminders'.

Or.13114/2/ff. 156–7
Times of India cutting of 5 Oct 1926
'The rock which is called Aornos', report from Simla, 2 October.

Or.13114/2/f. 158-9
Stein, Srinagar, to Barnett, 13 Nov 1926
Enclosing request from Prof. Hans Reichelt to study Sogdian. Hopes that since the mss are now the property of the British Museum there will be no difficulty about letting him have rotographs.
Enclosure (f. 158): Reichelt, Hamburg, to Stein, 18 October 1926, asking for permission to work on the Buddhist Sogdian manuscripts: Ch.0093, 00285, 00286, 00334, 00335, 00349, 00352, 00353, 00354, 001 and also T.XII.a.1–8. Requests photos or rotographs of mss.

Or.13114/2/f. 160
Stein, Srinagar, to Barnett, 18 Dec 1926
Has despatched to Oxford University Press last 'copy' for *Innermost Asia*[17] and asks for help with Appendix L by Francke. Is preparing a long tour of Baluchistan.

Or.13114/2/ff. 161–2
Stein, Srinagar, to Giles, 8 May 1927
Thanks for offprint and help with proofs for *Innermost Asia*.

Or.13114/2 /ff. 163–4
Stein, Srinagar, to Barnett, 14 Aug 1927
Survey of prehistoric sites of Northern Baluchistan. Mentions Rigvedic sites of Kurram, Gumal and Yavyāvatī and establishing sequence of painted pottery. Asks Barnett to interest Ross in Ivanow's offer to purchase books and mss while on bookbuying tour of India.
Enclosure (f. 164): extract from W. Ivanow, Calcutta, to Stein 25 July 1927 (copy).

Or.13114/2/f. 165
Stein, Srinagar, to Barnett, 16 Oct 1927
Thanks him for thinking of Ivanow. Plans to visit Kalat and Makran in mid-November. Andrews has just left for Delhi.

Or.13114/2/f. 166–7
Stein, Dehra Dun, to Barnett, 16 Nov 1927
On his way to Quetta, then Gedrosia.
Enclosure (f. 166): V. Ivanow to Stein, 18 October 1927 (marked 'Destroy') thanking Stein for his efforts on his behalf. Regrets that while libraries in Europe and America are willing to buy rare mss when presented with them, they are not interested in seeking them out which is more difficult. It seems no institution was interested in him procuring mss for them.

Or.13114/2/ff. 168–9
Stein, Camp, Gwadur, Makran to Barnett, 26 Jan 1928
Is glad that Barnett will use Ivanow's expertise in acquiring literary remains. Will read Hertel's views on Sistan with interest since 'It is not ground where nomads in any numbers could make a home for themselves'. Shares concern for Grierson's health.

Or.13114/2/ff. 170–1
Stein, Camp Manygam, to Barnett, 20 May 1928
On pre-historic sites of Gedrosia. Hopes Ivanow will secure leave on pay from the Asiatic Society of Bengal to collect mss from Iran in summer. Is trying to get help for him from Jackson in the United States. Had a fruitful time in Makran and Kharan, Jhaluwan. Writes of prehistoric sites, bronze age, painted pottery, resemblance to Mohenjodaro.

Or.13114/2/f. 172
Stein, Camp. P.O. Srinagar, to Barnett, 25 Aug 1928
Ivanow has four months leave to buy mss in Iran. On Hertel 'I am rather sorry for the ease with which he disregards plain geographical facts, eg. about the utterly desert character of the valleys around Sistan wherever laborious irrigation is not practicable'. Winter tour will take him through Mesopotamia, Syria, Asia Minor, Greece. Expects to reach England towards end of May.

Or.13114/2 f. 173–5
Reprint from Geographical Journal, Feb 1929
'Note on explorations in Makran and other parts of Southern Baluchistan'.

Or.13114/2/f. 176
Stein, Camp, Mohand Marg, to Barnett, 11 July 1930
On his friend Thomas Arnold's death: 'For over 32 years he had brightened my life more than anyone else could; whether near or far my feelings turned towards him as a much beloved and admired brother'. Thanks to support of Sir Miles Lampson, British representative at

Nanking, and his United States colleague, Stein got passport for proposed expedition to Central Asia and proposes to start early in August.

Or.13114/2/f. 177
Stein, Kashgar, to Barnett, 12 Oct 1930
Mentions obstructive tactics forced on Nanking Government by 'Young China' agitation in oppostion to his planned exploration. Has just reached Kashgar. Welcomed by son [Pan Tsi-lu] of his old Mandarin friend Pan Ta-jen. Captain Sherrif, the recently appointed Consul-General has been very helpful.

Or.13114/2/ff. 178–80
Stein, Kashgar, to Barnett, 27 Apr 1931
Has just got back to Kashgar. Is sorry to hear about Grierson's eye problems and his wish to sell his library. On difficulties encountered during expedition. Despite an anti-foreign official being in charge at Keriya where he had hoped to excavate, his visits were not altogether without profit. Went from Shanshan to Lop and North for geographical observations.

Or.13114/2/ff. 181–200
Stein, Camp Gurez, to Barnett, 27 June 1931
Is going to Southern Iran to do a survey similar to what he did in Makran. Reports a very recent discovery at Gilgit, where villagers had found under a ruined stupa a box of excellently preserved Sanskrit Bhūrja mss. A rapid examination showed they were similar to the oldest found in Central Asia. News of Ivanow distressing: 'A recent letter showed no sign of derangement'.
Enclosure (ff.181–98): Stein, Camp, Astor, 25 June 1931 (copy): Memorandum on statements of the Chinese Ministry of Foreign Affairs and the 'National Commission for the Preservation of antiquities', Peiping, communicated by H.B.M.'s Legation, Peking, through H.B.M.'s Consul-General, Kashgar.

Or.13114/2/f. 201–5
Stein, Camp, Mohand Marg, to Barnett, 25 July 1931
Enclosing his note to Jean Philippe Vogel for information, also his communication to the *Times* on his Fourth Expedition to Central Asia.
Enclosure (ff. 201–4): Stein, Camp, P.O. Srinagar, to Vogel, 23 July 1931 (copy). Gives account of expedition and encloses his memorandum on the subject for information.

Or.13114/2/f. 206
Stein. Camp, P.O. Srinagar, to Barnett, 13 Sept 1931
Is grateful for sympathy from colleagues about failure of expedition. Is preparing Lowell lectures for popular book. No news from Maspero.

Or.13114/2/ff. 207–8
Stein, New Delhi, to Barnett, 4 Nov 1931
About to leave for S. Persia. Has sent Barnett 'a parcel containing a modest acquisition from that great MS. find in Gilgit. Those 11 big Bhurja folia and the 6 on Central-Asian paper were handed to me by Todd, then Political Agent in Gilgit, to be disposed of in my discretion. They were picked up by a clerk of his office from what had passed into villagers' hands before the local Wazir took charge of the great bulk of the deposit'. Asks Barnett to examine them. Is not sure where they will finally go but hopes they may stay at British Museum after consultation with his friends at Harvard. Is very worried about what will happen to remaining mss. Has urged his old pupil Raja Hari Kishan Kaul, since July Prime Minister, that mss should be brought to Kashmir in batches and be made available for study. The Persian Government has agreed to Stein taking all objects abroad for examination, for eventual return to Persia. Persian officials will accompany him on tour.

Or.13114/2/f. 209
Stein, Lahore, to Barnett, 19 Nov 1931
Sylvain Lévi, who has independently been sent two folios, has asked Stein to help him get access to the Gilgit mss. Suggests that Barnett might consider letting Lévi do the work on loan. Asks to see any note before publication: 'This is desirable to prevent any claim being raised to those materials by some protagonist of "national interest".' Stein is about to tour between the Indus and the Hydaspes.

Or.13114/2/f. 210
Stein, Camp Ladak, Persian Makran, to Barnett, 14 Jan 1932
Is glad Barnett has approved idea of loaning Gilgit mss to Lévi. Persian arrangements now completed.

Or.13114/2/ff. 211–12
Stein, Basra, to Barnett, 12 May 1932
Discovered chalcolithic sites in the Bampur Basin. Painted pottery similar to that of Sistan. Hopes to bring them to the British Museum for study. Will travel home via Baghdad, Aleppo to Constantinople, then Budapest, Vienna then London. Hopes to have 'modest corner' in British Museum to study Baluchistan finds before returning to South Persia in October.

Or.13114/2/f. 213
Stein, Camp, P.O. Srinagar, to Lionel Giles, British Museum, 8 May 1933
Is not surprised to learn of the difficulties in interpreting the archaic Chinese writing in the Chinese Niya tablets. Offers to pay for help if it can be found. No news from Maspero who has had finds in his hands for 'the last ten years or so'. Thinks Barnett should send him a reminder. Hopes to resume South Persia exploration in autumn.

Or.13114/2/ff. 214–5
Stein, Naples, to Barnett, 25 Jan 1935
Introducing Prof. Ahmet Zeki Velidi Togan who asks for a photographic copy of Or.5849, *Kītāb al-s·aydanah* by al-Bīrūnī. Stein is anxious to help him and is prepared to pay his costs since he has lost his chair in Istanbul on account of 'the bias of Turkish nationalism'. Since leaving the Cotswolds, Stein visited Hungary and then his old friend De Filippi near Florence. Will be back in London and Oxford at the beginning of March to arrange plates for Persian report etc. before returning to Kashmir for summer.

Or.13114/2/ff. 216–7
Stein, Palermo, to Barnett, 7 Feb 1935
Hopes to spend three weeks visiting classical sites before returning.

Or.13114/2/f. 218
Stein, Camp Hulailan, Luristan, to Barnett, 18 Apr 1936
Speaks of 'German menace', Grierson's 85th birthday, and the death of Sylvain Lévi: 'His sympathy, his interest in my efforts was a constant encouragement. I could offer so little in return for all the help I derived from his noble example, his ever cheering welcome and letters'. Since leaving Shiraz in November has discovered bronze age and Parthian sites.

Or.13114/2/ff. 219–20
Stein, Camp, Senna, Kurdistan, to Barnett, 19 June 1936
Is glad Giles' catalogue is to be printed next year. Work in Luristan work was successful, and he hopes to continue in Kurdistan. Is glad Maspero's work is finally being published: 'I saw his voluminous MS. last year at Paris and trust that his rather dilatorious ways will not prove a serious obstacle'.

Notes

All quotes from the Sir Aurel Stein Collection housed in the Bodleian Library are reproduced with the kind permission of the British Academy.

1 For a detailed study of Paul Pelliot's work on the Stein Collection, see Frances Wood's contribution in this volume.
2 I am grateful to Helen Wang for this information.
3 F. Andrews to Under Secretary of State, India Office (copy), 5 August 1909 [British Library IOR MSS Eur/D815, f. 383].
4 F.M.G. Lorimer to M.A. Stein, 9 July 1914 [Bodleian: MS Stein 94, f. 173]
5 F.M.G. Lorimer to M.A. Stein, 18 Sep 1914 [Bodleian: MS Stein 94, f. 176]
6 Obituaries: A.S. Fulton, 'L.D. Barnett, C.B., F.B.A., Litt.D. (1871–1960)', *The Journal of the Royal Asiatic Society of Great Britain and Ireland* (1960), pp. 200–202, 206; A.L. Basham, 'Lionel David Barnett', *Proceedings of the British Academy* 46 (1960), pp. 333–9.
7 U. Sims-Williams, 'The papers of the Central Asian scholar and Sanskritist Rudolf Hoernle', in S. Karashima and K. Wille (eds), *British Library Sanskrit fragments 1*, Tokyo, 2006, pp. 1–26.
8 M.A.Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, 2 vols, London, 1912.
9 British Library MS Or.8212/123, a Uighur letter of the 9th or 10th century. See J. Hamilton, *Manuscrits ouïgours du IXe-Xe siècle de Touen-Houang*, Paris, 1986, no. 23.

10 British Library MS Or.8212/84, probably dating from the 9th century ad. See N. Sims-Williams, 'The Sogdian Fragments of the British Library', *Indo-Iranian Journal* 18 (1976), pp. 43–82, fragment 4.

11 M.A. Stein, *Serindia: Detailed Report of Explorations in Central Asia and Westernmost China*, Oxford, 1921.

12 L. de La Vallée Poussin had been publishing Stein's Sanskrit materials in a series of articles from 1911 onwards: 'Documents Sanscrits de la Seconde Collection M.A. Stein', *Journal of the Royal Asiatic Society of Great Britain and Ireland* (1911), pp. 759–77 and pp. 1063–79, (1913), pp. 569–80; 'Nouveaux Fragments de la Collection Stein', *Journal of the Royal Asiatic Society of Great Britain and Ireland* (1913), pp. 843–55.

13 A.H. Francke , 'Notes on Sir Aurel Stein's Collection of Tibetan Documents from Chinese Turkestan', *Journal of the Royal Asiatic Society of Great Britain and Ireland* (1914), pp. 37–59.

14 This was an exhibition designed to show the most valuable results of Stein's Second Expedition (1906–8). See British Museum, *Guide to an Exhibition of Paintings, Manuscripts and other Archaeological Objects collected by Sir Aurel Stein in Chinese Turkestan* (London, 1914).

15 M.A. Stein, *Memoir on Maps of Chinese Turkestan and Kansu from the Surveys Made during Sir Aurel Stein's Explorations 1900–1901, 1906–1908, 1913–1915*, Dehra Dun, 1923.

16 G.A. Grierson, *Hatim's Tales: Kashmiri Stories and Songs recorded with the Assistance of Pandit Govind Kaul, by Aurel Stein, and edited with a Translation, Linguistic Analysis, Vocabulary, Indexes, etc., by George A. Grierson, with a Note on the Folklore of the Tales by W. Crooke*, London, 1923.

17 M.A. Stein, *Innermost Asia: Detailed Report of Explorations in Central Asia, Kansu and Eastern Iran*, Oxford, 1928.

A Tentative Listing of the Stein Manuscripts in Paris 1911–19

Frances Wood

Curator of the Chinese Collections, British Library

In January 1911, over 400 Dunhuang manuscripts collected by Aurel Stein in 1907 were sent to Paul Pelliot in Paris for cataloguing. By the end of 1913, newly appointed to the Collège de France, and, having taken on far more than he could manage, Pelliot finally admitted that he could not produce the catalogue, but the manuscripts were not immediately returned to London, remaining in Paris throughout the First World War I.

Making his collections available to specialists and acquiring scholarly descriptions that he could use in his publications was always a priority for Stein. Faced with the contents of Cave 17 at Dunhuang, he lamented his

> total want of Sinologist training with reference to those masses of Chinese manuscript which formed the preponderating bulk both of the hidden library and of what I was able to bring away from it.'

Always preoccupied with the significance of his finds, he continued:

> So it was a particular satisfaction for me when M. Pelliot, after his own return [from Dunhuang] early in 1910, expressed the wish to examine my collection of Chinese manuscripts from the cave, and eventually to undertake its catalogue. The results of the first rapid scrutiny to which he was good enough to devote a fortnight of unremitting labour, were as gratifying as they well could be. It showed that the total number of Chinese manuscripts amounted to over 9000, about one-third of these consisting of complete text rolls, and about two thirds of detached records and fragmentary texts.

Pelliot's preliminary report stressed the significance of the fragmentary texts, 'detached records, acts of ordination, bans, accounts etc, often exactly dated; these illustrate all the varied aspects of local life, and represent a category of documents of which, until the Tun-huang discoveries, practically no ancient specimens were known to exist. Finally, it is among the fragmentary manuscripts that there are found most frequently those texts of secular literature, historical, geographical, lexicographical etc., which are of the greatest importance for the advance of learned Sinological research.'[2]

In the autumn of 1910, after Pelliot's rapid survey, Stein sent a letter to the Under Secretary of State for India, accompanying a proposal from Pelliot that he produce a catalogue in about a year, on condition that the manuscripts were sent to him in Paris, that the catalogue would be published, that he would be paid 5000 francs and would have a reasonable priority for the publication of certain documents.[3]

In order to facilitate Pelliot's cataloguing work, two crates containing 440 manuscripts were sent from the British Museum to 59 Boulevard Edgar Quinet in Paris where Pelliot signed a receipt for them on 13 January 1911. No list of the manuscripts survives other than the simple description on the packing list: '15 bundles of mss., numbered 1–233, except no. 55 (Brahmi) and 213 (a painting)' and '14 bundles of mss., numbered 234–443, except no. 237 (not found).'[4] This paper represents a first attempt to establish which of the 9000 or so Stein manuscripts surveyed by Pelliot were actually sent to Paris, an attempt which is complicated by the absence of precise pressmarks or numbers in either the packing lists or in Pelliot's various series of notes on the items sent to Paris.

Pelliot's descriptions of the manuscripts can be found in the archives of the Musée Guimet (Pel.C.62c).[5] It would appear that he made no coherent list, nor did he consistently refer to Stein's site numbers which seemed to have been inscribed on some of the manuscripts. Pelliot frequently refers to numbers in what he describes as 'Stein inventaire chinois'. This may be the same as the 'fiches du catalogue des manuscrits du Dr. Stein qu'a dressé son garçon chinois' [the catalogue slips prepared for Dr Stein by his Chinese boy, presumably Jiang Xiaowan].[6] A number of the manuscripts identified below bear numbers written in red by Jiang Xiaowan in what is sometimes described as the 'business form of numerals' (*mazi* 码子).[7] Some also bear the same number written out in roman numerals in blue pencil, possibly by Edward Denison Ross, who was very briefly employed in early 1914 in the British Museum to work on the Stein collection (somewhat to Stein's dismay). According to Miss Lorimer, Stein's assistant, Denison Ross 'catalogued' 600 manuscripts — although in the absence of any catalogue slips, it is more likely that he simply transcribed Jiang Xiaowan's numbers.

Some manuscripts have a number in a three-part form such as 74.III.4 (which I think may be S.2263). Pelliot refers to 'Caisse 74' and 'Caisse 83' and these are the numbers of the crates in which the manuscripts were transported to England. When Pelliot made his flying trips to England in 1910 to survey the collection, he seems to have chosen to visit when Stein was not present, which worried Fred Andrews who was unpacking the cases in the basement of the British Museum. At that stage, the crate number seems to have served as a form of distinct identification. The second, roman numeral, appears to be that assigned to a bundle of manuscripts, and the last to the individual manuscript within a bundle.[8] Pelliot made a list of 45 manuscripts using these numbers, from 'Caisse' 75, 76, 79, 81, 83 and 87. Unfortunately, his descriptions are so brief as to make identification difficult, an example being 'Caisse 97, portions de Lunyu' of which there are many and there are no further clues as to which particular 'portions' are meant. Nor is it easy to pin down 'Caisse 83: Ouvrage magique de caractère bouddhiste, composé en Chine?' Only 15 of the 51 manuscripts thus listed by crate or packing number can be firmly identified at this time.

Stein assigned the prefix 'Ch' (for Ch'ien-fo-tung 千佛洞 or Caves of the Thousand Buddhas in the old Wade-Giles romanisation) to items collected at Dunhuang on his second expedition, and began the process of listing them in Anxi in the summer of 1907, but such was the quantity of manuscripts that many were only assigned site marks after arriving in London in January 1909.[9] Whilst the Stein paintings from Dunhuang now in the British Museum have 'Ch' numbers, not many of the manuscripts have full site numbers. There is only one reference to 'Ch' numbers in Pelliot's lists where he notes the manuscripts chosen for illustration in *Serindia*, most of which have 'Ch' numbers: 'L. Giles a fait reproduire Ch.759, Ch.905, 906, 922, 935, 936, 1181 et Ch.cv.001. J'ai conseillé d'ajouter Ch.917, 1024, 1073, 1080 et le Vajracchedika imprimé en 868.'[10]

It is clear from the notes that Pelliot made on the Stein manuscripts he received in Paris that he was interested in dating them and identifying them, often in the context of the manuscripts from Dunhuang that he had collected himself. Of number 29 (Or.8210/S.1857) he writes, 'Bon mss. analogue au mien… endommagé mais moins que le mien'. Lionel Giles, by contrast, describes this 'Interpretation of dreams' as a 'mediocre mss.'[11] It is clear from Pelliot's notes that they were largely personal, made for his own interest. Nowhere does he use the special 'slips' that Stein had Miss Lorimer send out to all his cataloguers, nor did he take measurements or make any bibliographic description other than an identification and, in the case of interesting manuscripts, notes to himself: 'intéressant', 'très important', 'à copier'. Though he had been asked to use the Giles romanisation in his catalogue, he never did, sticking to the French system.

Pelliot's notes consist of seven separate lists. The first is of four manuscripts that interested him in particular, numbered according to the 'Stein inventaire chinois'. No. 910 is described as a 'prière daté de 道至元 二年' and can be identified as Or.8210/S.374. The manuscript still bears the 'business' number 910 in red ink by Jiang Xiaowan and 910 in Roman numerals written blue pencil in a European hand.

Number 955 is a 'rouleau lexicographique…bon mss. quoique copié assez tardivement' and may be identified as Or.8210/S.388. Like the previous manuscript, it has Jiang Xiaowan's red ink number for 955. The third manuscript, no. 1264, can be identified as Or.8210/S.1635. It has Jiang Xiaowan's red number 1264 but there is no sign of the blue pencil roman numeral version. Similarly, the last manuscript to be described at length (and therefore much easier to identify), no. 79, a 老子化胡经 also bears the packing number 79.X.17 and can be identified as Or.8210/S.1857.

There follows a fairly detailed list of 12 manuscripts by crate number. From Crate 80, we may identify a 'calendrier' (Or.8210/S.6886), 'un receuil de mirabilia' (Or.8210/S.610), the 'manuel d'oniromancie' (Or.8210/S.620) and the dictionary (Or.8210/S.617). From Crate 77, Or.8210/S.2073, another 老子化胡经 (Or.8210/S.2081) and Or.8210/S.1441. Two numbers, Or. 8210/S.1393 and Or. 8210/S.2081 are less certain.

From 'Caisse 82' we can identify a *Lunyu* (Or.8210/S.5972), Or.8210/S.1722 which includes the 兔园策府, and a booklet (Or.8210/S.5439).

There follows a detailed description of 'Stein inventaire de chinois, no. 1069', a description of Shazhou (Or.8210/S.2593) and then a list of 140 manuscripts described as 'textes chinois de Stein' listed by number from 45 to 1283 though not all numbers appear and the source of the numbers is mysterious. From the description, it can be determined that number 45 is Or.8210/S.75 but it does not bear the number 45, nor a 'Ch' number, nor a packing number. Number 79 however, a Diamond sutra which can be identified as Or.8210/S.87, has Jiang Xiaowan's business number for 79, and 79 is also written in roman numerals in blue pencil. Number 86 is Or.8210/S.80 but has no further identifying numbers, nor does the next number listed, 103, which can be identified as S.976, or the subsequent number 107 which is probably Or.8210/S.2732.

The rest of the manuscripts in this list which can be identified are (in the order in which they appear in the list): Or.8210/S.996, Or.8210/S. 4126, Or.8210/S.5574,

Or.8210/S.1155, Or.8210/S.1156, Or.8210/S.1324, Or.8210/S.1285, Or.8210/S.1284, Or.8210/S.86, Or.8210/S.1350, Or.8210/S.1351, Or.8210/S.2724, Or.8210/S.1380, Or.8210/S.1386, Or.8210/S.95, Or.8210/S.2048, Or.8210/S.238, Or.8210/S.785, Or.8210/S.173, Or.8210/S.5973, Or.8210/S.298, Or.8210/S.289, Or.8210/S.276, Or.8210/S.381, Or.8210/S.528, Or.8210/S.389, Or.8210/S.406, Or.8210/S.560, Or.8210/S.2729, Or.8210/S.3877, Or.8210/S.568, Or.8210/S.2593, Or.8210/S.5448, Or.8210/S.1946, Or.8210/S.1931, Or.8210/S.525, Or.8210/S.1891, Or.8210/S.1947, Or.8210/S.482, Or.8210/S.1731, Or.8210/1605 and Or.8210/S.1635.

The next series of notes consists of quite lengthy descriptions of manuscripts that interested Pelliot, such as the small notebook containing the 敦煌录 which he copied out in its entirety (Or.8210/S.5448), the 东京至西天路程 (Or.8210/S.383), Or.8210/S.389, Or.8210/S.525 and Or.8210/S.113. There follows a description of the woodblock print Diamond Sutra of 868 (Or.8210/P.2) where he notes the running margin and mentions the all-important colophon. It is worth noting that at this stage, the Diamond sutra had absolutely no numbers written on it, no 'Ch' number, no packing number, no business number and Pelliot simply referred to it as 'le Vajracchedika imprimé en 868' or in this case 金刚般若波罗蜜经 'long rouleau imprimé'. The description suggests that it was one of the items sent to Paris which may have been returned to London in 1913 (carried by Denison Ross) for photography for *Serindia* and for inclusion in the first exhibition of the finds in the British Museum in 1914. Also included in the Pelliot archive is a letter from Lionel Barnett of the British Museum to Pelliot dated 7 March 1913 in which he wrote, 'Our friend Ross has returned home with the mss. and the notes.'[12]

The next series of manuscripts are listed in no particular order, sometimes with reference to the mysterious list of numbers 45 to 1383. They include: Or.8210/S.1344, Or. 8210/S.5475, Or.8210/S.5574, Or.8210/S.1563, Or.8210/S.2052, Or.8210/S.2055, Or.8210/S. 2054, Or.8210/S.2056. Or.8210/S.2051, Or.8210/S.2053,[13] Or.8210/S.5257, and Or.8210/S.87.

There follows a series of manuscripts listed, once again, by crate numbers. From 'Caisse 85' it is possible to identify Or.8210/S.2103; from Caisse 80, Or.8210/S.619 and Or.8210/P.1; from Caisse 87, Or.8210/S.3747 and from Caisse 84, Or.8210/S.2922. Listed in Caisse 97 were Or.8210/3016, Or.8210/S.2075, Or.8210/S.3135, Or.8210/S.2708 and in Caisse 79, Or.8210/S.3618, Or.8210/S.4366 and Or.8210/S.1857. The list from Caisse 83 includes Or.8210/S.4610, and Caisse 76 included Or.8210/S.1513.

Pelliot's final list is arranged by packing number. So, 74.V.5 can be identified as: Or.8210/S.737, 74.V.1 as Or.8210/S.2327, 74.VI.19 as Or.8210/S, 74.VI.19 as Or.8210/S.2367, 74.VI.15 as Or.8210/S.799, 75.XVI.20 as Or.8210/S.5614, 81.VIII.10 as Or.8210/S.4160, 76 II.18 as Or.8210/S.2474, and 75.XI.5 as Or.8210/S.5507.

As can be seen, the complexities of numbering systems, lists of various sorts that have disappeared and, above, all, the lack of a systematic numbering system before 1919 makes it very difficult to identify securely many more of the Stein manuscripts examined by Pelliot in 1911–1919. Much work remains to be done but the identification of these 108 manuscripts can provide a basis for continuing research.[14]

Notes

1 An account of Stein and Pelliot's relationship and the failure of the catalogue will appear in the papers of the Colloque Pelliot (forthcoming). Colloque 'Paul Pelliot (1878–1945). De l'histoire à la legende', Collège de France, Paris, 2–3 October 2008.

2 M.A. Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay: Personal Narrative of Explorations in Central Asia and Westernmost China*, London, 1912, pp. 216–218.

3 British Museum Archive, CE32/23/35/2; also British Library, Correspondence with M. Pelliot regarding Chinese documents (kept by Dr. Stein) Or. 13114, f. 7, my translation from the French.

4 Worryingly, one of Pelliot's lists of Stein's manuscripts in the Musée Guimet archives lists numbers running from 45 to 1283, although it is not a complete series.

5 I am grateful to Francis Macouin, Librarian of the Musée Guimet, his successor, Cristina Cramerotti and the staff for their kindness in letting me see the archives.

6 Musée Guimet, Pel. 62 C. These slips were mentioned by Stein in a letter to Pelliot, described as 'rough slips on which constitutes probably a little over one third of our Chinese collection.' They were apparently sent to Pelliot by Lionel Giles on 3 May 1910. They must have been made in Anxi and beyond by Jiang Xiaowan. The whereabouts of these catalogue slips is, sadly, unknown.

7 See *Mathew's Chinese-English Dictionary*, Cambridge, Mass., 1956, p. 1178, table VIII.

8 Andrews to Stein, Bodleian Library, Stein MSS.38/23, 26, 32.

9 Stein described the difference between site numbers assigned in China and those assigned in London (with an extra two zeros) in *Serindia*, London, 1921, vol. 1, p. xv, fn. 16. The current pressmarks (Or.8210 for the whole collection and S for each individual manuscript) were assigned by Lionel Giles in 1919 when the collection was finally deposited in the British Museum. Some of the packing numbers have been added to the International Dunhnang Project (IDP) database but have to be searched for by adding the prefix 'Ch' (the site number for Ch'ien-fo-tung) to the packing number. Thus, 'Pelliot's final list: 74.V.5' on the concordance table has been entered on the IDP dadtabase as 'Ch.74.V.5'. Very few manuscripts were actually assigned a 'Ch' number so the addition of the 'Ch' prefix is potentially misleading.

10 Musée Guimet, Pel.62.C.

11 Lionel Giles, *Descriptive Catalogue of the Chinese Manuscripts from Dunhuang in the British Museum*, London, 1957, p. 225.

12 Musée Guimet, Pel.62.C.a. The letter follows one from Miss Lorimer to Pelliot dated 6 February 1913 in which she states that she has not received the manuscripts required for photography: 'I trust they have not been delayed in the post.'

13 It is interesting for find a sequence which suggests that these manuscripts were kept together by Lionel Giles when the returned to London and were given S. numbers.

14 I have some 35 tentative identifications to pursue and hope that further work on packing lists, 'business numbers' and blue pencil numbers may help identify more of the 440 manuscripts sent to Paris.

Concordance (in the order they appear in Pellíot's Papers)

Pelliot no.	Stein no.	BL no.	Contents (as described by Pelliot)
Caisse 74.III.4		S.2263	
Caisse 75			
Caisse 76			
Caisse 79			
Caisse 81			
Caisse 83			
Caisse 87			'Ouvrage magique de caractère bouddhiste, composé en Chine?'
Caisse 97			'Portions de Lunyu'
	No. 29	Or.8210/S.1857	'Bon mss. analogue au mien… endommagé mais moins que le mien'
	No. 910	Or.8210/S.374	'prière daté de 道至元 二年' *Daozhi yuan er nian*
	No. 955	Or.8210/S.388	'rouleau lexicographique…bon mss. quoique copié assez tardivement'
	No. 1264	Or.8210/S.1635	
Caisse 79.X.17	No. 79	Or.8210/S.1857	老子化胡经 *Laozi hua hu jing*
Caisse 80		Or.8210/S.6886	'Calendrier'
Caisse 80		Or.8210/S.610	'un receuil de mirabilia'
Caisse 80		Or.8210/S.620	'manuel d'oniromancie'
Caisse 80		Or.8210/S.617	Dictionary
Caisse 77		Or.8210/S.2073	
Caisse 77		Or.8210/S.2081	老子化胡经 *Laozi hua hu jing*
Caisse 77		Or.8210/S.1441	
Caisse 77		Or. 8210/S.1393	
Caisse 77		Or. 8210/S.2081	
Caisse 82		Or.8210/S.5972	Lunyu
Caisse 82		Or.8210/S.1722	Includes the 兔园策府 *Tuyuan cefu*
Caisse 82		Or.8210/S.5439	Booklet
Stein inventaire de chinois, no. 1069		Or.8210/S.2593	A description of Shazhou
Textes chinois de Stein no. 45		Or.8210/S.75	
Textes chinois de Stein no. 79		Or.8210/S.87	Diamond sutra
Textes chinois de Stein no. 86		Or.8210/S.80	
Textes chinois de Stein no. 103		Or.8210/S.976	
Textes chinois de Stein no. 107		Or.8210/S.2732	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.996	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S. 4126	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.5574	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.1155	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.1156	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.1324	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.1285	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.1284	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.86	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.1350	

Pelliot no.	Stein no.	BL no.	Contents (as described by Pelliot)
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.1351	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.2724	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.1380	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.1386	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.95	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.2048	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.238	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.785	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.173	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.5973	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.298	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.289	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.276	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.381	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.528	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.389	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.406	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.560	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.2729	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.3877	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.568	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.2593	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.5448	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.1946	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.1931	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.525	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.1891	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.1947	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.482	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.1731	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/1605	
Textes chinois de Stein		Or.8210/S.1635	
Next series of notes		Or.8210/S.5448	Small notebook containing the 敦煌录 *Dunhuang lu*
Next series of notes		Or.8210/S.383	东京至西天路程 *Dongjing zhi xi tian lucheng*
Next series of notes		Or.8210/S.389	
Next series of notes		Or.8210/S.525	
Next series of notes		Or.8210/S.113	
		Or.8210/P.2	Woodblock print Diamond Sutra of 868 / le Vajracchedika imprimé en 868 /金刚般若波罗蜜经 *Jingang ban ruo poluomijing* 'long rouleau imprimé'
Next series of manuscripts		Or.8210/S.1344	
Next series of manuscripts		Or. 8210/S.5475	
Next series of manuscripts		Or.8210/S.5574	

Pelliot no.	Stein no.	BL no.	Contents (as described by Pelliot)
Next series of manuscripts		Or.8210/S.1563	
Next series of manuscripts		Or.8210/S.2052	
Next series of manuscripts		Or.8210/S.2055	
Next series of manuscripts		Or.8210/S. 2054	
Next series of manuscripts		Or.8210/S.2056	
Next series of manuscripts		Or.8210/S.2051	
Next series of manuscripts		Or.8210/S.2053	
Next series of manuscripts		Or.8210/S.5257	
Next series of manuscripts		Or.8210/S.87	
Caisse 80		Or.8210/S.2103	
Caisse 80		Or.8210/S.619	
Caisse 80		Or.8210/P.1	
Caisse 87		Or.8210/S.3747	
Caisse 84		Or.8210/S.2922	
Caisse 97		Or.8210/S.3016	
Caisse 97		Or.8210/S.2075	
Caisse 97		Or.8210/S.3135	
Caisse 97		Or.8210/S.2708	
Caisse 79		Or.8210/S.3618	
Caisse 79		Or.8210/S.4366	
Caisse 79		Or.8210/S.1857	
Caisse 83		Or.8210/S.4610	
Caisse 76		Or.8210/S.1513	
Pelliot's final list: 74.V.5		Or.8210/S.737	
Pelliot's final list: 74.V.1		Or.8210/S.2327	
Pelliot's final list: 74.VI.19		Or.8210/S.2367	
Pelliot's final list: 74.VI.15		Or.8210/S.799	
Pelliot's final list: 75.XVI.20		Or.8210/S.5614	
Pelliot's final list: 81.VIII.10		Or.8210/S.4160	
Pelliot's final list: 76 II.18		Or.8210/S.2474	
Pelliot's final list: 75.XI.5		Or.8210/S.5507	

New Data Relating to Aurel Stein's Expeditions to Iran: Correspondence with Fred Andrews, 1936–37

Ursula Sims-Williams

Curator, Iranian collections, British Library

Stein's correspondence files, preserved mainly at the Bodleian Library, Oxford, and the Hungarian Academy of Sciences, Budapest, provide a wealth of information about Stein's work and many other aspects of his collections. The major part of his correspondence with his long time friend and assistant Fred Andrews is preserved at the Bodleian, but in 2006 the British Library acquired this small complementary collection (British Library MS EUR/F545) which gives the other side of the story, containing Andrews' letters to Stein, addressed as 'General,' as opposed to Stein's letters to Andrews, whom he called 'Baron'.

Frederick Henry Andrews (1864–1957)[1] was trained as an artist and in 1890 became Vice-Principal of the Mayo School of Art, Lahore. It was there that he first met and became a close friend of Aurel Stein who at the time was Principal of the Oriental College, Lahore. Andrews returned to England to be Head of the Art Department of the People's Palace, Whitechapel, in 1898 and Head of the Art School of Battersea Polytechnic in 1906. He returned to Kashmir in 1913 to become Director of a new Technical Institute in Srinagar. In 1920 he resigned this post to devote time to mounting, arranging and describing the wall paintings in Delhi before returning finally to England in 1929. Whether in Britain or India, Andrews dedicated himself wholeheartedly, even after Stein's death in 1943, to cataloguing and describing Stein's collections. He read the proofs of Stein's books, administered the collections and compiled many of his inventory lists, illustrating them with immaculate diagrams, a debt which Stein fully acknowledged, writing, as he did, in the introduction to *Serindia* of his gratitude for Andrews' 'untiring efforts' all the greater because of his 'sacrifice of what hard-earned leisure he could spare'.[2]

This correspondence begins in November 1936 when Stein was at the British Consulate in Kermanshah at the end of his fourth expedition to Iran (November 1935–November 1936),[3] awaiting permission to visit the area bordering Iraq. This was refused and an acute attack of dyspepsia made him decide to travel by train and sea to Brindisi and then in January to La Capponcina, Florence, the home of his friend Sir Filippo De Filippi. From there he travelled via Budapest to Vienna where he had a two part operation on his prostate gland from which he had been suffering for over two years. In June he arrived in Oxford to convalesce and work. In October Stein went for a short holiday to Budapest returning to Oxford where he remained until mid-December 1937 when he set off to the Middle East to prepare for the first of his aerial surveys of the ancient Roman *Limes* in Iraq and Trans-Jordan.

The letters partly touch on Stein's fourth Iranian expedition but are mostly concerned with the arrangement, listing and division of its finds in addition to those of his three earlier expeditions (1932; 1932–33; 1933–34).[4] From the beginning it had been agreed that the finds would be deposited in the British Museum for study and then 'in accordance with the usual practice, the objects found should be partitioned in two equal parts'.[5] Since the first two expeditions had been partly financed by Harvard University, a share was also to be given to the Fogg Art Museum. Material was despatched to Iran in February 1936 (no. 81) and two cases also reached the Peabody Museum later that

year in September (no. 9). In February 1937 Andrews wrote to Stein that 11 cases of material from the fourth expedition had arrived and were now safely stored in the Ceramics Basement (no. 24), meanwhile he was arranging the material from the third exhibition and arranged to show a selection of second expedition material to the Iranian Legation in June (no. 54). A division of the 'spoil' was arranged for 5 July (no. 59). Details for the shipment of the third expedition material were being negotiated in August and September (nos 81, 98).

These letters are arranged, as they were on acquisition, in the order that Stein received or wrote them. Some of Stein's copies are typewritten, for example the ones from Florence where he presumably had access to a typewriter. The remainder are Stein's handwritten carbon copies and are virtually illegible, but the originals are preserved in the Stein papers preserved in the Bodleian Library, Oxford. Details of address of the writers and recipients are cited as given in the correspondence with the exception of Andrews whose letters, unless otherwise stated, were all written from 33 Sydenham Hill London SE 26. As the correspondence has not been foliated, each item has been given a separate number. The whole collection consists of 124 pages.

Brief biographical list of persons mentioned

Allen, Helen Mary, addressed as Madam (1872–1952), wife of Stein's great friend Percy Stafford Allen (1869–1933)

Bowcher, Frank (1864–1938), sculptor, designer, medallist; founder member of the Royal Society of British Sculptors

Forsdyke, Sir Edgar John (1883–1979), Keeper of Greek and Roman Antiquities at the British Museum from 1932 to 1936; Director of the British Museum, 1936-1950

Fleming, R.B., photographer: R.B. Fleming & Co Ltd., Technical Photographers and Photographic Dealers, 18 Bury Street, Bloomsbury, London WC1

Gadd, Cyril John (1893–1969), Assyriologist; Department of Egyptian and Assyrian Antiquities, British Museum, 1919-55; Professor, School of Oriental and African Studies, University of London, 1955-60

Hill, Sir George Francis (1867–1948), numismatist; Director and Principal Librarian, British Museum, 1931–36

Hobson, Robert Lockhart (1872–1941), Keeper, Department of Oriental Antiquities and Ethnography, British Museum

Johnson, John de Monins (1882–1956), papyrologist; printer, Oxford University Press

Lawrence, Arnold Walter (1900–91), archaeologist; Professor of Classical Archaeology, University of Cambridge, 1944–51

Mackay, Ernest John Henry (1880–1943), archaeologist

Mallowan, Sir Max Edgar Lucien (1904–78), archaeologist, Professor of Western Asiatic Archaeology, University of London, 1947-62

Scott, Alexander (1853–1947), Director of the Research Laboratory, British Museum, 1931–8

Smith, Sir Sidney (1889–1979), Assyriologist; Keeper, Department of Egyptian and Assyrian Antiquities, British Museum, 1915–47; Professor of Near Eastern Archaeology and Ancient Semitic Languages, School of Oriental and African Studies, University of London, 1948–55

Ujalfy, Charles de (1842–1904), Hungarian ethnographer and linguist

Ward, Lauriston (1882–1960), Curator of Asiatic Archaeology, Peabody Museum, Harvard University, 1937

Warner, Langdon (1881–1955), explorer; Curator of Oriental Art, Fogg Art Museum, Harvard University

BL MSS EUR/F545

1. Andrews, Kermanshah, to Stein, 18 Nov 1936
In answer to letter of 21 October from Mahidasht. Refers to negatives sent, now being developed. 'You will not recognise the B.M. when you return. The inside is now all being painted light stone-colour.' Received 22 December.

2. Stein, Consulate Mohammarah, to Andrews, 18 Dec 1936 (copy)

3. Stein, Beyrouth, to Andrews, 4 Jan 1937 (copy)
En route to Brindisi, and thence to Florence. In receipt of letter of 18 November.

4. Stein, Aegean Sea, to Andrews 8 Jan 1937 (copy)
Asks for prints of negatives on enclosed list.

5. Andrews to Stein, 26/27 Nov 1936
In reply to letters of 30 October from Camp Simani, Guran, and 12 November. Refers to Stein having finished revision of *Archaeological reconnaissances*.[6] Discusses cylinder seals and pottery in Max Mallowan's 'new collection'. Disappointed to hear that Stein had been denied access through the Pusht-i-koh. Received 16 February 1937. Contains enclosures:

27 November 1936. Copy of list of expenses: 'Personal account April 1st. to Nov. 27th. 1936'.
27 November 1936. Copy of 'State of Harvard imprest on Nov 27th 1936' (£29.10.1).[7]

6. Andrews to Stein, 24 Dec 1936
In receipt of letters of 2 and 10 December forwarded by Madam [Helen Allen]. Has received *Iraq* paper and revises of prelims of *Archaeological Reconaissances*. Received 16 January 1937.

7. Andrews to Stein, 11 Jan 1936
In receipt of letters of 18 December and 4 January: 'I should indeed have liked to see, with you, the wall decoration from Dura. The resemblances to Miran are interesting but not surprising'. Discussion of pottery glaze. Received 16 January 1937.

8. Stein, La Capponcina, Florence, to Andrews, 17 Jan 1937 (copy)

9. Andrews to Stein, 3 Dec 1936
Enclosing revisions of site marks. Discussion of article by Mackay in *Illustrated London News* on 'Jhukar' ware occurring in layer above stratum of Harappa ware. Description of Crystal Palace fire 'I went out to watch the blaze and saw the great transepts crumple up and crash to the ground.' Received ca. 19 January 1937. Contains enclosures:
22 September 1936: copy of letter from Mr. L. Ward, Peabody Museum, to Andrews announcing arrival of two cases of their share of the Stein collection.
30 November 1936: copy of letter from Henry Stone & Son re *Archaeological Reconnaissances*.

10. Stein, La Capponcina, Florence, to Andrews, 19 Jan 1937 (copy)In continuation of his letter of 17 January. Discussion of editing indexes of *Archaeological Reconaissances* etc.

11. Stein, La Capponcina, Florence, to Andrews, 19 Jan 1937 (copy)A second letter written in receipt of Andrew's letter of 3 December.

12. John Johnson, Oxford University Press, to Stein, British Consulate Kermanshah.8 Dec 1936
Enclosing offprints of his article in *Iraq* vol. 3, part 2.

13. Johnson, Oxford University Press, to Stein, Florence, 13 Jan 1937
Encloses proofs of prelims and index of *Archaeological Reconaissances*.

14. Stein, Florence, to Johnson, at Oxford University Press, 19 Jan 1937 (copy)
Requests copy of letter press of *Archaeological Reconaissances*. to check index.

15. Stein, Genova, to Andrews, 23 Jan 1937 (copy)
Arranging meeting in Genova on 2 February. Asks for Andrews to bring prints for 'Persian Inspector', and for information about arrangements for the new collection in the British Museum.

16. Andrews to Stein, 20 Jan 1937
In receipt of Stein's letter of 17 January. Mentions that Hobson is willing

to allow him to continue in his present accommodation in Museum basement, but has no additional funds. Answered 24 January 1937.

17. Andrews to Stein, 24 Jan 1937
In receipt of Stein's letter of 19 January. Discusses arrangements for his forthcoming visit to Italy. Regrets failure to locate certain prints: 'The great number of photoprints of yours, which have been used in your successive books, have become so mixed through being used (many of them) two or three times, that any particular print is difficult to trace.' Received 28 January 1937.

18. Andrews to Stein, 4 Nov 1936
In receipt of Stein's letter of 20 October. Discussion of proofs. Regrets Stein's delay at Kermanshah and asks whether the 11 cases of finds are packed up ready for transport to London. Answered 19 February 1937.

19. Andrews to Stein, 27 Jan 1937
In receipt of Stein's letters of 23 and 24 January. Regarding meeting on 3 February. Reports that Forsdyke has decided that £100 could be allocated for paying Andrews to unpack, list and arrange collection. Received 30 January 1937.

20. Andrews to Stein, 28 Jan 1937
Regarding forthcoming visit. Received 31 January 1937.

21. Invoice from R.B. Fleming, 30 Nov 1936
For developing films of plates, numbered LO73–LO84, L214–273.

22. Expense statement of 23 Jan 1937 (copy)
'M.A.S. Personal expenses from Nov. 27, 1936 to Jan. 23, 1937'. Paid 6 February 1937.

23. Stein, Portofino, to Hobson, 11 Feb 1937 (copy)

24. Andrews to Stein, 15 Feb 1937
Announces arrival at Museum of 11 packing cases. Meanwhile he has started arranging antiquities of the third Iranian expedition. Asks to be informed as soon as possible whether Iranian authorities have approved proposal for division. Received 18 February 1937.

25. Stein to Andrews from Budapest, 19 Feb 1937 (copy)
In receipt of Andrew's letter of 15 February.

26. Andrews to Stein, 24 Feb 1937
Glad to hear 'accident' reported in *Times* was not serious. Reports that the 11 packing cases are in the Ceramic Basement.

27. Andrews to Stein, 3 Mar 1937
Sends information on division of previous Persian collections. Reports that Hobson and S. Smith have removed some of the earlier finds, 'This leaves a little more room, but not much'. Received 8 March 1937.

28. Andrews to Stein, 9 Mar 1937
Pleased to hear the first part of Stein's treatment [in Vienna on enlarged prostate gland] went well. Andrews has now divided the 'selected' objects of the third expedition into two sections (A & B), tentatively, ready for the proposed allocation. Mentions visit of Pelliot's protegé Bernard Vuilleumier who hopes to set up exhibition of Chinese textiles. Received and answered 13 March 1937.

29. R.L. Hobson, Department of Oriental Antiquities and of Ethnography, British Museum, to Stein, 26 Feb 1937
Informs Stein that Society of Antiquaries was unhelpful in search for funding for Andrews. Forsdyke asks how much Andrews should be paid, what material will come to the Museum, and whether publication would be provided elsewhere.

30. Andrews to Stein, 19 Mar 1937
In receipt of Stein's letter of 13 March with good news of health. Andrews has unpacked cases 1, 2 and 11 and is working on 3. Suggests payment of £400 as an amount which would perhaps be possible from two years' grants of the British Museum. Mentions possible assistance from Mackay.

31. Andrews to Stein, 20 Mar 1937
Unpacking continues. Shami bronzes to go to laboratory for treatment.

32. Stein, Vienna, to Andrews, 23 Mar 1937 (copy)
In receipt of Andrew's letter of 20 March.

33. Andrews to Stein, 25 Mar 1937
Is unpacking box 5, having unpacked boxes 1–4 and 11. Still has not heard from Mackay.

34. Stein, Vienna, to Andrews, 30 Mar. 1937 (copy)
Has received Andrews' letter of 25 March. Advises Andrews to recruit someone else instead of Mackay if he has no news soon.

35. Stein, Vienna, to Hobson, 31 Mar 1937 (copy)
In answer to Hobson's letter of 26 February. Requests remuneration for Andrews.

36. Andrews to Stein, 4 Apr 1937
Has recruited a Mr. Cox 'a student of Egyptology, who has some experience of Palestine and whose father is an old friend of Hobson' to help for £16 a month. Mentions display of Serindia objects in Museum. Sympathises at delay in treatment.

37. Stein to Andrews from Vienna, 7 Apr 1937 (copy)
In receipt of Andrews' letter of 4 April.

38. Stein to City Manager, National Provincial Bank, 15 Bishopsgate E.C.2, 12 Apr 1937 (copy)

39. Stein, Vienna, to Andrews, 13 Apr 1937 (copy)

40. Andrews to Stein, 10 Apr 1937
Discussion of Pfister's [Rodolphe Pfister (1867–1955)] 'Egyptian' textiles and comparisons with Dunhuang ones. On Mr Cox. Received 17 April, answered 18 April.

41. Andrews to Stein, 22 Apr 1937
Congratulations on success of second operation.

42. Andrews to Stein, 25 Apr 1937
Reports on cleaning of bronzes and good work of Mr Cox.

43. Stein, Vienna, to Helen Allen, 27 Apr 1937 (copy)

44. Stein, Vienna, to Andrews, 28 Apr 1937 (copy)
Has received letter of 25 April.

45. Andrews, British Museum, to Stein, 28 Apr 1937
Asks whether he should pay the bill for the shipping of the 11 cases of antiquities (£15.1.0).

46. Stein, Vienna, to Andrews, 30 Apr 1937 (copy)
In receipt of Andrews' letter of 28 Apr.

47. Andrews to Stein, 1 May 1937
Has received Stein's letter of 28 April 'I should be extremely sorry to be the cause of Harvard again having the pick of your present collection… Before Harvard lays its grasp on things, I think the B.M. should have such specimens as are most desirable for their collections. This is a matter that can well await your return to London'. The unpacking has been finished, Andrews and Cox are working on descriptive notes. All specimens sent to S.S. [Sidney Smith] are site-marked. Discussion of mud on the Shami bronzes which Dr Scott of the laboratory has offered to analyse. Reports that 'All seven of the Miran III angels are set up in New Delhi.' By separate cover he sends some of Cox's notes. Received 5 May 1937.

48. Stein, Vienna, to Andrews, 6 May 1937 (copy)

49. Andrews to Stein, 9 May 1937
Dr Scott has found nearly 30% lead in the bronzes, possibly because of the mud sticking to it.

50. Stein, Vienna, to Andrews, 14 May 1937 (copy)
In receipt of Andrews' letter of 9 May.

51. Andrews to Stein, 16 May 1937
In receipt of Stein's letter of 6 May. Thanks for his criticism of the pottery notes. 'I have explained to Cox how he is to modify his style, and hope he will be able to carry out instructions satisfactorily. It is a pity that his writing is not more clear.' The Iranian Minister has been invited to visit 19 or 21 May. Has had to make a revised list of fourth expedition sites which he encloses for correction. Third expedition material is divided into two parts (A and B). S. Smith deputed Gadd to go through it, but he found nothing to alter. Received 19 May.
Enclosure: List of sites and dates visited on 4th Iranian expedition (5ff).

52. Stein, Vienna, to Andrews, 20 May 1937 (copy)
In receipt of Andrews' letter of 16 May.

53. Andrews to Stein, 23 May 1937
In receipt of Stein's letters of 14 and 20 May. Has received Langdon Warner's letter. The face and hands of the bronzes are now cleaned sufficiently for photography. The laboratory is still trying to soak off the mud on the other bronze fragments without resorting to acid. Is pleased Stein has left hospital.

54. Andrews to Stein, Barton House, 10 June 1937
In receipt of letter of 6 June. Reports the visit of the Iranian Minister. He was pleased to see the selection of material from the second expedition. Cox has nearly finished his work and will leave to take up new job.

55. Stein, Barton House, to Andrews, 13 June 1937 (copy)
In receipt of Andrew's letter of 10/11 June.

56. Andrews to Stein, 13 Manor Place, Oxford, 14 June 1937
Post card written in receipt of Stein's letter and postcard of 13 June. Andrews has just posted all notes on miscellaneous sherds. Notes on bronzes, other metal and complete pots to follow. Received 16 June.

57. Andrews to Stein, 15 June 1937
Further to receipt of Stein's letter of 13 June. The pottery specimens recently selected for Iranian Legation were from the second expedition. No selection has been made for this purpose for the third expedition objects. This will be arranged later. Complains of erratic behaviour of Cox who seems to have left. Received 17 June.

58. Stein, Barton House, to Andrews, 17 June 1937 (copy)
In receipt of Andrew's letter of 15 June.

59. Andrews to Stein, 18 June 1937
'I am very glad that you will write to the Iranian Minister and that you will be present at the dividing of the "spoil". July 5th at 11.30 will be quite convenient for me'. All the potsherds have been site-marked. Andrews is now going through the metal objects.

60. Stein, Barton House, to Andrews, 19 June 1937 (copy)

61. Stein, Barton House, to Andrews, 23 June 1937 (copy)

62. Andrews to Stein, 21/23 June 1937
In receipt of Stein's letter of 19 June. Lawrence and his wife have been to British Museum for further examination of the Shami face.

63. Stein, Barton House, to Andrews, 24 June 1937 (copy)
In receipt of Andrew's letter of 21/23 June.

64. Andrews to Stein, 24 June 1937
In receipt of Stein's letter of 23 June.

65. Andrews to Stein, 30 June 1937
In receipt of Stein's letter of 24 June. Discussion of the Shami bronzes: thinks the face is about life size and the smaller of the two hands could belong to it, whereas the other hand must belong to a figure 10–12 ft. high. Received 1 July 1937.

66. Stein, 22 Manor Place, Oxford, to Sir Edgar Forsdyke, 8 July 1937 (copy)
Thanking him for his payable order of 7 July for £300. This will be used to pay Andrews.

67. Stein, 22 Manor Place, Oxford, to National Provincial Bank, 8 July 1937 (copy)
Paying in payable order of £300.

68. Andrews to Stein, 8 July 1937
His copy of *Archaeological Reconaissances* has arrived. Arranges to meet Stein at British Museum the following week.

69. Andrews to Stein, 20 July 1937
Discusses possible mould for casting or squeezing a copy of the Shami bronze face. 'I believe it was Lawrence's suggestion to do this, but the more I think of it, the less I favour the experiment'. The Iranians have been to sign the document regarding the third expedition. Will arrange the packing immediately.

70. Stein, Barton House, to Andrews, 22 July 1937 (copy)
In receipt of Andrew's letter of 20 July.

71. Andrews to Stein, 22 July 1937
On the balance of Harvard imprest (£29.10.1 at 27 November 1936).

72. Stein, Barton House, to Andrews, 23 July 1937 (copy)
In receipt of Andrew's letter of 22 July.

73. Andrews to Stein, 24 July 1937
In receipt of letter of 23 July. Payment of bills including £15.1.0 for the 11 cases containing the fourth Persian collection. The bill for the cases sent to Tehran on 17 February 1936 were never charged to Stein, evidently being paid for by the British Museum.

74. Stein, Barton House, to Andrews, 26 July 1937 (copy)
In receipt of Andrew's letter of 24 July.

75. Stein, Barton House, to Andrews, 27 July 1937 (copy)

76. Andrews to Stein, 28 July 1937
In receipt of Stein's letters of 26 and 27 July. Discusses packing of third Persian collection to be shipped to Tehran. Both Lawrence and Hill are bringing in sculptors with a view to working on the Shami mask.

77. Stein, Barton House, to Andrews, 29 July 1937 (copy)
In receipt of Andrew's letter of 28 July. Recommends Hill's sculptor.

78. Andrews to Stein, 30 July 1937
Reports visit of Hill's sculptor, Mr Bowcher.

79. Stein, Barton House, to Andrews, 2 Aug 1937 (copy)

80. Andrews to Stein, 7 Aug 1937
Re errands. Answered 9 August.

81. Stein, 22 Manor Place, Oxford, to H.E. Iranian Minister, Iranian Legation, 9 Aug 1937 (copy)
Regarding transportation of third expedition material to Tehran and requesting news of receipt. Refers to the safe despatch of antiquities from the first two expeditions in February 1936.

82. Andrews to Stein, 10 Aug 1937
Enclosing Mr Bowcher's estimate.

83. Stein, Barton House, to Andrews, 12 Aug 1937 (copy)
In receipt of Andrew's letter of 10 August.

84. Stein, Barton House, to Andrews, 14 Aug 1937 (copy)
Enclosing Forsdyke's letter refusing to fund Bowcher's work, also a copy of his letter to Bowcher asking for the fragments to be returned. They should be taken to the Keeper of the Greek and Roman Antiquities to ascertain, on the strength of the Director's letter, what can be done about the moulding in gelatine.

85. Andrews to Stein, 13 Aug 1937
In receipt of Stein's two notes of 12 August. Hopes the Director will be able to meet Mr. Bowcher's estimate as he has already done a lot of work on the restoration. Received 16 August 1937.

86. Stein, Barton House, to Andrews, 17 Aug 1937 (copy)
In reply to Andrews' letter of 13 August received the previous day.

87. Frank Bowcher, 7 Woodstock Road, Bedfored Park London W4, to Stein, Barton House, 16 Aug 1937
On the cleaning the bronze pieces (Shami I): 'I can understand the B.M.'s attitude. However I have now cleaned off by mechanical means all the softish earthy layer from your 2 bronze pieces and am surprised at the perfect preservation of the bronze surface (for there has not been any vitrious patina on it[)] and its beautifully modelled smooth surface now reveals new details.' Has half completed a plaster piece-mould. As the work was so interesting and he was not instructed to proceed, he proposes not to charge for the work he has done so far.

88. Stein, Barton House, to Bowcher, 19 Aug 1937 (copy)
In reply to Bowcher's letter of 16 August. Thanks him for his work and regrets the British Museum's unwillingness to pay for a replica.

89. Andrews, British Museum, to Stein, 18 Aug 1937
In explanation of Bowcher's piece-mould, and the use for it. Suggests Bowcher is offered £5 for expenses and that the Fogg Art Museum might possibly order a replica.

90. Stein, Barton House, to Andrews, 20 Aug 1937 (copy)
In receipt of Andrew's letter of 18 August.

91. Stein, Barton House, to Andrews, 29 Aug 1937 (copy)
Thanking him for Hasanlu slips. Is sending Bowcher a cheque for £5.

92. Stein, Barton House, to Bowcher, 29 Aug 1937 (copy)
In receipt of Bowcher's letter of 22 August. Encloses a copy of his report on a journey in South Persia.

93. Frank Bowcher, 7 Woodstock Road, Bedford Park, W4, to Stein, Barton House, 30 Aug 1937
Thanking him for the £5 for his work 're the plaster piece-moulds now in the making'. Has learned 'most of the mannerisms in the features & hair of your two fragments, and if you can advise me what books I may find with similar bronzes I would be able to detect any relationship. Otherwise I thought of looking at the Alma-Tadema collection of books at the library of Victoria and Albert Museum'.

94. Frank Bowcher, 7 Woodstock Road, Bedford Park, W4, to Stein, 2 Sept 1937
Thanks for copy of 'An archaeological tour in the ancient Persis'. Notes the plain flat filet of the diadem, as seen on Greek coins, which was attached to bronze.

95. Stein, Barton House, to Bowcher, 4 Sept 1937 (copy)
In receipt of Bowcher's letters of 30 August and 2 September.

96. Andrews to Stein, 8 Sept 1937
In receipt of postcard of 5 September. Mr Bowcher has returned bronze mask.

97. Stein, Barton House, to Andrews, 9 Sept 1937 (copy)
In receipt of Andrews' letter of 8 September.

98. Andrews to Stein, 11 Sept 1937
In receipt of Stein's letter of 9 September. 'S. Smith is going to take away all the 3rd expedition things, on Wednesday.' and 'The Coin Depart. have asked that they may see all the coins before their (the coins) return to Iran. I do not think any coins need be returned. So far, we have not included coins in our plates, and therefore not in the partitioning of objects.'

99. Andrews to Stein, Barton House, 13 Sept 1937
Post card discussing visit of Stein to British Museum. Answered 15 September 1937.

100. Frank Bowcher, 7 Woodstock Road, Bedford Park, W4, to Stein, 20 Sept 1937
Re mask (Shami I): 'It is my conviction that your bronze mask fragments in their perfect and original state represented Alexander the Great.'

101. Stein, Barton House, to Andrews, 25 Sept 1937 (copy)
Includes list of 52 slides suggested for lecture on 1935/6 expedition. Forwarding Bowcher's letter of 20 August and requests Ujfalvy's work on the prosopography of Alexander to be brought over from the library.

102. Stein to Bowcher, undated (copy)
Thanks for letter of 20 September. Asks for photo of mask.

103. Stein's revisions to list of photos for slides, dated 30 Sept 1937

104. Stein, 22 Manor Place, Oxford, to Andrews, 1 Oct 1937 (copy)
Includes final selection of slides for Royal Asiatic Society and Royal Central Asian Society lectures. Is leaving with Helen Allen for Budapest via Vienna returning 23 October.

105. Andrews to Stein, Budapest, 12 Oct 1937
Has handed over the completed lead replica of the mask to Bowcher who is greatly interested in the reconstruction he is making. Cox turned up unexpectedly and received £10.3.0., the balance for his work.

106. Andrews to Stein, 30 Oct 1937
In expectation of Stein's visit the following Tuesday evening. Fleming has been doing photography.

107. Stein's list of 20 Nov 1937
Headed 'Notes on memos. with F.H.A. [Frederick Henry Andrews]' including: notebooks with plan sketches of 1935/6 to be looked for in tracings or yakdans; measurements in clean drawings to be cut out; tracings to be taken from B.M. to Marg; List of photos (1935/6) to be copied for F.H.A.

108. Andrew's list of 24 Nov 1937
List of sites from which specimens are wanting.

109. Stein, 22 Manor Place, Oxford, to Andrews, 25 Nov 1937 (copy)
Has made preliminary selection of photographs for report. 'I am sorry you couldn't come to tea with the Macartneys [Sir George Macartney, retired Consul-General at Kashgar, and his wife], Macphersons & Carmichaels… I also enjoyed much the gathering at 11 Downing Street making interesting acquaintances thanks to Mrs. Neville Chamberlain's [wife of Prime Minister] attention and having a welcome talk with Lady (Austin) Chamberlain.' Instructs Andrews to look for the photoprints of 'MSS (Brahmi) taken at Kashgar and reprinted by Fleming'.[8]

Notes

1 *Times* obituary: 'Mr. Fred Andrews: The Stein Explorations', *The Times* (2 November 1957); p. 8.

2 M.A. Stein, *Serindia*, London, 1921, p. xiv.

3 For more on Stein's fourth expedition to Iran see V.S. Curtis and N. Pazooki, 'Aurel Stein and Bahman Karimi on Old Routes of Western Iran', in H. Wang (ed.), *Sir Aurel Stein. Proceedings of the British Museum Study Day 2002*, London 2004, pp. 23–28.

4 For the location of the Stein Iranian expedition material today, See H. Wang and J. Perkins, *Handbook to the collections of Sir Aurel Stein in the UK*. London 2008 (http://www.britishmuseum.org/pdf/Stein%20Handbook%20final(3).pdf), p. 14.

5 Hoseyn Khan 'Ala to Stein, 27 April 1935, quoted by Curtis and Pazooki, op. cit, p. 24.

6 M.A. Stein, *Archaeological Reconnaissances in North-Western India and South-Eastern Īrān*, London, 1937.

7 This was money left over from Harvard's contribution to Stein's Fourth Central Asian Expedition (1930–31) and his First and Second Persian Expeditions (1932–33). The residue helped to finance the publication of Stein's report on the fourth expedition *Old Routes of Western Iran*, London, 1940, see pp. xvii–xviii.

8 i.e. photographs of the Brahmi documents and forgeries from Stein's Fourth Central Asian Expedition. Stein had already sent copies to various Iranists to decipher but was still waiting to receive results; see U. Sims-Williams, 'Forgeries from Chinese Turkestan in the British Library's Hoernle and Stein collections,' *Bulletin of the Asia Institute* 14, 2000 (2003), pp. 111–29.

The Stein Collection and World War II

Joyce Morgan

Co-author of *Journeys on the Silk Road*

In the summer of 1918, Lionel Barnett, the British Museum's Keeper of Oriental Printed Books and Manuscripts, penned a letter to his friend Aurel Stein. By then Stein had returned from his Third Expedition to Central Asia, and his reputation as a pioneer in Central Asian scholarship was well established. Barnett began by paying tribute to Stein's contribution: 'You have been, both literally and figuratively, a Columbus of science, discovering and charting new worlds of precious knowledge.'[1]

At the time Stein was camped on Mohand Marg, the Kashmiri alpine hillside to which he retreated throughout his long life. There Stein was putting the final touches to *Serindia*, his scholarly account of his second expedition from which he returned with the Dunhuang manuscripts. Barnett was in Wales, where high above the seaside town of Aberystwyth the neo-classical grandeur of the newly constructed National Library of Wales impressed Stein's friend. Barnett continued:

> In one respect I am (for the time being) like you: I am on the top of a hill. The National Library of Wales has been built with fine judgment on the summit of the hills which surround Aberystwyth in a semicircle, so that we have on the one side the sea in all its glory and on the other the everlasting hills, green and purple. The Library has been designed on fine generous lines: would to Heaven the builders of the B.M. had had equal foresight. I shall be here until the 5th September… For the present (i.e. for some years to come) the mss. that are to revert to our Department will be kept in their present home, all together in glass cases.[2]

The manuscripts in the Stein Collection were not destined to remain in their London home for many more years. They would take temporary shelter in Aberystwyth on the same hill from where Barnett wrote to Stein in the closing months of World War I. No one could have anticipated then that little more than 20 years later the world would again be at war, or that this would prompt an unprecedented movement of cultural treasures across Britain.

The National Library of Wales was in its infancy in 1918, and the imposing grey stone building had been occupied for just two years. Yet when Barnett wrote, it was providing war-time refuge to material from the British Museum. A consignment had been sent by rail from London in February 1918. It included 22 cases of Oriental books and manuscripts, 21 cases of printed books and maps, 47 of manuscripts, parcels of prints and drawings and records of the British Museum's trustees. Although World War I was in its final months, other loads followed in March and May. Stein's antiquities, including the Dunhuang manuscripts, remained in London. The main impact of World War I on the Stein Collection was that the planned transfer to India of part of it was delayed until the end of hostilities for fear of destruction of the treasures en route.

The storage of British Museum material in Aberystwyth in World War I was relatively brief. By January 1919 most of it had returned to Bloomsbury. Nonetheless, the war-time safe-keeping provided in Wales set a precedent.

During the 1920s, Lionel Giles, the British Museum's Assistant Keeper of Oriental Printed Books and Manuscripts, continued to catalogue Stein's Chinese manuscripts, and Stein's magnum opus *Serindia* was published in 1921. By the end of the decade, Stein was planning his

fourth Central Asian expedition. But hostility to his activities forced him to abandon the venture mid-way in 1931. In Europe, the political climate was becoming increasingly ominous. When Hitler became German Chancellor in 1933 concerns grew about the possibility of another European conflict. The directors of Britain's national cultural institutions met with the Minister (then First Commissioner) of Works, William Ormsby-Gore, to discuss plans to evacuate the most valuable treasures in the event of another war. After that meeting, the Secretary of the British Museum, Dr Arundell Esdaile wrote to the National Library of Wales in January 1934 asking whether it might again provide the 'hospitality' extended during the war of 1914–18:

> The deposit would consist of books, manuscripts, and prints and drawing, and not, of course, of antiquities, for which other repositories are being sought.[3]

The National Library of Wales promptly agreed to Esdaile's request. But it was another three years before an idea was raised that would have repercussions for the Stein Collection. Questions were asked at a meeting of the council of the National Library of Wales in October 1937 about what precautions had been taken to safeguard its own treasures in the event of air raids.[4] In the ensuing discussion, the library's vice-president, Sir Evan Davies Jones, a civil engineer who had been involved in the construction of the Severn Tunnel and the Manchester Ship Canal, suggested an innovative solution: the creation of an underground tunnel.

The idea was well received and the library's architect, Dr Charles Holden, was asked to draw plans for a horseshoe-shaped chamber tunnelled into rock on nearby land belonging to the library. Holden is best known today for having designed many of London's Underground stations, the University of London's Senate House and, with sculptor Jacob Epstein, Oscar Wilde's tomb in the Père Lachaise cemetery, in Paris.

The National Library of Wales sought funding, but Treasury opposed financing a purpose-built underground repository since this would open the floodgates to other provincial institutions wanting similar accommodation. Officials argued it was inappropriate to provide a bomb-proof shelter to an institution located in a safe area when facilities had been denied to national museums and galleries. Treasury also feared that funding a shelter for art treasures would hinder its ability to resist requests for the construction of shelters for humans.[5]

Nonetheless, the National Library of Wales went ahead with its plan and contracted Wolverhampton builders Henry Willcock and Company. Construction began in August 1938, a month before the major European powers signed the Munich Agreement, an act of appeasement towards Nazi Germany. By then many believed war was inevitable, but the agreement bought time to prepare – as much as was possible – for another conflict. The effects of a war fought for the first time from the air rather than on land could not be predicted. As a war-time engineering scientist, Sir Derman Christopherson, later reflected:

> The starting point of any account of the situation with regard to air warfare or its consequences for the civilian population, as they appeared in 1939, must be to emphasize the total ignorance at that time of everybody and everything to do with the subject. The only evidence which existed of what happens when high explosive is dropped on a town was derived from experience in the Spanish Civil War, mainly from on attack on Guernica.[6]

At the beginning of the war, Wales was assumed to be safe from ground invasion and air attack. Naïve as this sounds today, it was even believed that the visibility of the National Library of Wales – atop a hillside known as Grogythan or Hangman's Hill – would help ensure its safety. David Jenkins, Librarian of the National Library of Wales from 1969 to 1979, described the prevailing attitude:

> There was a general feeling during the late 1930s that in the event of war any land invasion from Europe would be targeted on the home counties of southern England, and that the Welsh coast would be immune from attack. Although there was nothing on the coast of Cardigan Bay to attract the attention of enemy bombers, a prominent building such as the National Library, which defied camouflage, actually lent itself as a navigational aid to bombers passing up the west coast of Britain, thus enhancing its security as a place of refuge.[7]

In this context, the decision to build the tunnel, made when the library was itself considered impregnable, was a singular one. With construction underway, the British Museum's director, Sir John Forsdyke, raised with the museum's standing committee the possibility of taking a stake in the chamber. The National Library of Wales had offered accommodation in the bomb-proof tunnel. This would cost the museum about £3000, half the estimated cost of building the tunnel. The committee agreed and asked Forsdyke to approach Treasury for a grant.[8] Treasury approved, provided savings were made elsewhere. The museum's Chief Scientific Officer, Dr Harold Plenderleith, travelled to Aberystwyth to inspect the excavation underway and reported that the tunnel was suitable for storing books and manuscripts.[9]

Throughout the British Museum, priority lists had been prepared of portable objects to be saved in case of an emergency. As Forsdyke noted:

> In all the departments of the Museum and Library the material for evacuation had long been specified in order of priority as part of the routine precautions against fire.[10]

These lists formed the basis for the war-time evacuation. On the fire salvage list for the Department of Oriental Printed Books and Manuscripts in October 1938 were six items from the King's Library, including Stein's printed Diamond Sutra of 868 and, from the Chinese Library, Stein's collection of Chinese scrolls.[11] Their inclusion indicates how highly Stein's collection was regarded by the late 1930s, especially when viewed alongside the lists from other sections of the museum. The Greek and Roman priorities included the cameo-glass Portland Vase and the Chatsworth Head of Apollo while the Medieval priorities included the Lewis Chessmen and the Sutton Hoo treasure.[12]

The museum had stockpiled boxes in which to pack material for evacuation. 40 boxes were required for Stein's manuscript rolls. A number of disused cupboards and open presses were sent from the museum to Aberystwyth. According to Jacob Leveen, Deputy Keeper in the

Department of Oriental Printed Books and Manuscripts:

> The cream of the collections in the Departments of Printed Books, Manuscripts, Oriental Printed Books and Manuscripts, and practically the whole of the Department of Prints and Drawings and drawings belonging to the Department of Oriental Antiquities, were scheduled for removal to Aberystwyth.[13]

As Hitler invaded Czechoslovakia in March 1939 and tensions increased across Europe, in Wales excavation of the tunnel in the slate hillside hit technical problems. Additional work would be needed to line the structure, strengthen the walls and reinforce the floor with a concrete slab. It would take extra time and money. The total cost increased to £7000.

On 23 August, the Nazi-Soviet non-aggression pact was signed in Moscow. In London, the Home Office notified Forsdyke at the British Museum that war was imminent. It was time to evacuate the nation's treasures. Large sculptures were to go into the Aldwych tube, smaller antiquities were to go to Broughton House and Drayton House in Northamptonshire and books, manuscripts, prints and drawings were to go to the National Library of Wales. Several British Museum staff, headed by Dr Robin Flower, Deputy Keeper in the Department of Manuscripts, arrived in Aberystwyth on August 24 ready to receive the first consignment. The removal of material from the library began the same day, including ten tons of Western and Oriental books and manuscripts destined for Aberystwyth. The first container load arrived by rail on 25 August together with a British Museum escort. Forsdyke reported:

> By noon on the third day… the most valuable material of every Department was in safety. Evacuation of Library material was continued for another week, by which time about 100 tons of it had been received at Aberystwyth, and the Keepers of the Departments did not wish to send any more. This quantity was made up of some 12,000 books, and about the same number of volumes of manuscripts and three-quarters of the collection of prints and drawings.[14]

The material included 171 cases from the Department of Oriental Books and Manuscripts containing 6000 books and manuscripts.[15] Leveen, a Hebrew scholar who was based in Aberystwyth during the war, later described some of the most precious items from his department that were removed to Wales. They included Syriac manuscripts, early illuminated Bibles, Haggadas and Korans. He also singled out the Stein Collection:

> Of Chinese manuscripts which went to Aberystwyth, those discovered by that intrepid explorer, the late Sir Aurel Stein, in a walled-up chapel in the Caves of the Thousand Buddhas at Tunhuang in Chinese Turkestan, take first place.[16]

Exactly when the Stein Collection was sent to Aberystwyth is unclear. The importance afforded to the Diamond Sutra and other Stein scrolls suggests they would have been evacuated early, possibly in the first load sent from London before war was declared. Giles referred to their removal when he gave a lecture on Stein's Chinese manuscripts in London on 14 October 1941. He commented that his unprinted catalogue had been completed 'some years ago, just before the MSS. were removed from the Museum for safety.'[17]

With the underground tunnel under construction when war broke out, Stein's scrolls were initially housed in the main building of the National Library of Wales along with other British Museum material. The available space was shared with treasures from other cultural institutions, including The National Gallery which sent several hundred pictures, items from Hampton Court and the Royal Society. With the influx of so much material, for several years the library building resembled a 'vast furniture repository'.[18] Its print room was allocated to the British Museum's Department of Prints and Drawings and the Department of Printed Books while Dr Flower, overseeing the British Museum staff, was assigned the president's room. The Department of Oriental Printed Books and Manuscripts was accommodated at one end of the Readers Room. This worried Leveen. Although the library was closed to the general public for about six years, the Readers Room remained open to permit holders throughout the war. Giles took up Leveen's concerns with Forsdyke:

> Subject to your approval, I have decided that Leveen shall stay in Aberystwyth for the winter…[Leveen] reports the desirability of padlocks (with chains) for the presses containing our MSS, the locks of which are very flimsy and insecure. The total cost would probably not exceed £4.[19]

Forsdyke agreed. The director visited the National Library of Wales in October 1939, where he attended the annual meeting of its governing body, and wrote to Giles on his return:

> I inspected Leveen's bookcase locks when I was at Aberystwyth, and it is true that anyone who wished to break them off could do so. Chains & padlocks will not stop such thieves, if they exist, but if such visual security will comfort Leveen's soul there is no reason why he should not have them.[20]

After more than a year's work, construction of the tunnel 200 metres down hill from the library was finished on 30 October 1939. As a result of the geological problems, the tunnel in the grey slate hillside was lined with a brick wall and an arched roof was built for extra protection. This meant the capacity of the tunnel was less than initially envisioned. The completed tunnel was approximately 2m wide, 3m high and 25m long. In width and height, although not in length, its dimensions were similar to those of Dunhuang's cave 17, the manuscript cave, from which Stein obtained the scrolls.

Having returned from nine months undertaking aerial surveying work in the Middle East in June 1939, Stein was in England when war was declared. He visited Oxford, Barton House in the Cotswolds – where Helen Allen, widow of his friend P.S. Allen, had a home – and spent time in London with Fred Andrews. Stein, then 76, was preparing to depart once again for India. Although he maintained an interest in the fate of his Turkestan finds long after they arrived in Britain, Stein does not appear to have been aware of the secret activity to shelter them underway in Wales. Mrs Allen bade farewell to Stein from Victoria Station on 9 November 1939. He would never see England, or the Dunhuang manuscripts, again.

As Stein left for India, in Wales atmospheric checks on the empty tunnel began. This would take months. Fans and electric heaters to regulate humidity and temperature had to be installed and tested before fragile works on paper, vellum, papyri and paper could be housed within it. Emergency equipment was also installed, including a hand-driven ventilation system in case of a power failure or the immobilisation of the supply by enemy action. It was Britain's first experiment in air-conditioned underground storage.[21] Steel racks were erected in the British Museum's section of the tunnel to house printed books and manuscripts that had been packed into millboard boxes. The tunnel – or Air Raid Precaution Chamber as it was called – began operation on 18 July 1940. The transfer of priority material from the National Library of Wales building into the tunnel began on 2 August 1940, and the move was completed by 22 August. Stein's scrolls were almost certainly moved into the tunnel at this time.

Additional material continued to arrive in Aberystwyth from Bloomsbury. Three small loads of manuscripts were sent to the National Library of Wales between January and June 1940, increasing the total number evacuated to 13,000. By then the most significant treasures had been removed from London and further dispersal was considered impracticable. The war intensified throughout 1940. By the middle of the year France fell to the Germans, and the threat of an invasion of Britain grew. The Blitz began in September, during which London and other cities across Britain including Liverpool, Birmingham and Cardiff, suffered eight months of repeated air attacks.

The unprecedented destruction prompted a fundamental rethink of the wisdom of storing the cultural treasures above ground. No building could be considered immune from aerial attack. This included the country houses to which the British Museum had sent material. Some were effectively tinder boxes with timber roofs that would be easily ignited by incendiary bombs. The location of military barracks and aerodromes near the houses also increased concerns, including the construction of an airfield less than two kilometres from Broughton House, in which were held the British Museum's collection of coins, medals and some portable antiquities.

By October 1940, not even the National Library of Wales was considered safe. There were fears that an attack could be mounted from neutral Ireland, across from Cardigan Bay. In addition, the library was on a route used by enemy aircraft. This posed the risk that stray bombs could be dropped by aeroplanes flying to or from more obvious targets such as the port city of Liverpool. The Ministry of Home Security decided not to camouflage the immense Aberystwyth building. It recommended evacuation as the least expensive means to protect the material.

The British Museum asked the Office of Works to remove everything in Aberystwyth not stored in the tunnel to a safer place.[22] Finding such a place would not be easy. Yorkshire's Skipton Castle, 25km north-west of Bradford, was one possibility. But the museum believed that the only truly safe storage was a purpose-built underground repository such as at Aberystwyth. As Forsdyke wrote:

> The successful construction and use of the small air-conditioned tunnel at Aberystwyth showed that deep underground storage would be the best kind of protection if it could be provided on a large enough scale.[23]

The search for underground storage proved frustrating. Several quarries across Britain suitable for housing the Museum's cultural treasures had been requisitioned for military use. Eventually, a former stone quarry at Westwood, near Bradford-on-Avon in Wiltshire, was obtained for conversion into an air-conditioned repository. The top-secret site would be shared with the Victoria and Albert Museum. But work was needed before material could be transferred into the quarry, then being used to grow mushrooms. That work had yet to begin in April 1941 and it would be at least another six months before the quarry could be used, Forsdyke reported as the Blitz continued.[24] The National Gallery, meanwhile, had secured alternative underground accommodation. It began relocating its paintings to Manod Quarry, near Blaenau Ffestiniog in north-west Wales, in August 1941. The gallery, which had occupied the top floor of the National Library of Wales, vacated a month later and the space was taken by historians from the War Cabinet.[25]

As the British Museum waited for work on Westwood Quarry to be completed, rooms at Skipton Castle were prepared to receive all the books and manuscripts not held in the tunnel. But as Forsdyke noted: 'The castle afforded no better protection against bombs than the country houses.'[26] The need for safe refuge became even more acute after May 1941, when the British Museum in London was bombed. It was not the first time the building had been hit: a bomb had exploded in the King's Library in September 1940 – where the Diamond Sutra had previously been on display – destroying more than 400 volumes. But of all the attacks throughout the war this was the most destructive for the Museum. In the wake of the bombing on the night of 10-11 May, more than 200,000 volumes were lost, either in the flames or water damaged by fire hoses. The destruction prompted the removal to Aberystwyth of more material.

In April 1941 Leveen, based at the National Library of Wales, updated the new Keeper of Oriental Printed Books and Manuscripts, Alexander Fulton. (Fulton replaced Giles who had retired the previous year.) Leveen wrote that the 'cream of the collection' had not been sent to Skipton but remained in Aberystwyth.[27] The cream included Stein's manuscripts**.** Leveen referred to them a few days later when he again wrote to Fulton: 'The following Stein Rolls were accidentally omitted from my list of objects deposited in the tunnel.'[28] His omissions consisted of four boxes of rolls, including one of exhibited rolls.

Unlike the dry desert atmosphere that had preserved the scrolls for 1000 years in the Caves of the Thousand Buddhas, the chamber in the Welsh hillside – within sight of the sea – needed special equipment and monitoring to regulate the humid environment. Leveen described conditions in the tunnel:

> A system of inspection was instituted in conjunction with the National Library. The Tunnel was visited at regular intervals day and night. In addition, it was patrolled by the guards during the night. Portions of the contents were examined in turn to see how

> the material stood up to its new surroundings. The results were highly satisfactory. Humidity and temperature readings were taken both in the day and at night. By means of an extremely sensitive instrument called a hygrometer it was possible to gauge the relative air humidity in the Tunnel. It was gratifying to find the needle plot as a rule an even and steady line on the chart and rarely rise above 65% of relative air humidity (the danger point was 70%). The temperature too was maintained at a reasonably constant level, dropping a few degrees, as was to be expected at night. It kept well within the margin of safety.[29]

By November 1941, structural work on Westwood Quarry was complete. But cultural material could not be transferred to the quarry until the longer days of the next year. The move to the quarry of the British Museum's printed books, manuscripts, prints and drawings held in Aberystwyth began on 24 February 1942 and took four months. The most valuable books and manuscripts stored in the tunnel were transferred last.[30]

With the move nearing completion, Leveen again updated Fulton. More than 300 boxes had been moved to the quarry. More than 40 boxes were scheduled for removal. But some items were to be retained at Aberystwyth. These included a number of Hebrew and Judao-Arabic books and manuscripts, which Leveen intended to study, Kharosthi documents, shelf-lists, descriptive lists and inventories. Also to be retained were Stein's rolls and tablets.[31]

In London, British Museum staff numbers were reduced. Staff became liable to conscription after 1941 when they were removed from the list of exempt occupations and the call-up age was raised. Fulton saw the specialists in his department reduced to half by 1943. During this period of staff reductions the location of one vital document connected to the Stein Collection raised concerns in London. Giles's unpublished Descriptive Catalogue, on which he had laboured for years, was missing. The British Museum's secretary J.H. Witney (who had replaced Esdaile after his retirement three years earlier) learned of its misplacement in a letter from the Department or Oriental Printed Books and Manuscripts. It reads:

> In checking over the lists of material evacuated from this Department, I find the location of one item is uncertain. It is Giles's Descriptive Catalogue (ready for press) of the Stein or Tun-huang Manuscripts. It is done up in a package measuring 12×10×10 inches, or a little less, and was handed in by Giles at the Director's office in October 1940 for dispatch to Aberystwyth. The people at Aberystwyth have no record of its arrival there. Probably it has been placed in the security of the Director's Store (Basement Room 39). Would you be so kind as to let me have confirmation of this for entry in the Departmental records.[32]

A handwritten file note three days later could find no trace of Giles's manuscript. It was another three years before the document was discovered by the museum's assistant secretary Bentley Bridgewater: 'Found by Bridgewater in steel cupboard under Director's office & returned to this Dept.'[33] By then the war was over and Stein himself was dead. He died in Kabul in October 1943 without seeing in print the much-anticipated catalogue of the Dunhuang manuscripts. It would not be published until 1957.

With victory in Europe declared on 8 May 1945, little time was lost in transferring material in the tunnel back up the hill and into the National Library of Wales. By 23 May the tunnel had been emptied of its contents. After five years continuous operation, the power was turned off the next day. The material in the tunnel could not return to London immediately as the National Library of Wales librarian's report to the governors on June 14, 1945 made clear:

> Now, with the passing of the danger which has hovered over us for five years and more, the evacuated collections are beginning to return to their homes… Some of them, however, have at present no homes – or only bomb-damaged homes – to which to return, and the sanctuary which we have afforded them will obviously have to be continued for some time longer.[34]

It was a year before the British Museum's collections at Aberystwyth returned to Bloomsbury. Between 2 May and 14 May 1946, they were loaded into railway containers for the return journey to London. Altogether 25 containers were used and the material weighed more than 90 tons.[35] Leveen remained grateful for the refuge in Wales where he noted friendships were formed, manuscripts were microfilmed and scholars and historians visited. He wrote that: 'The torch of learning was far from being extinguished in Aberystwyth during these years.'[36]

In London, war losses to the British Museum in Bloomsbury and to the Newspaper Library at Colindale – where more than 5000 volumes of English provincial newspapers were destroyed – justified the policy of unprecedented evacuation of treasures. Forsdyke would later write: 'Of the collections that had been dispersed nothing was lost, nothing damaged.'[37]

The Aberystwyth tunnel is derelict today. Its entrance is behind a locked metal door. The National Library of Wales receives few requests to view it. Inside, dangling electrical wires are the only indication that it once had power. Flashlights illuminate graffiti on the white-washed walls, the result of recent unauthorised visitors. Whether painted by Buddhist monks in Dunhuang's caves or scrawled by Welsh graffitists, the impulse to leave an enduring mark on walls seems irresistible. Midway along the tunnel is a second metal door that once secured the British Museum's section. Its rusty bars, redolent of a jail cell, stand open as though its captive has long fled.

Stein's manuscripts were among the many beneficiaries of the decision to remove cultural treasures from London during World War II. The construction of the Aberystwyth tunnel in which the Dunhuang scrolls were stored was a bold and far-sighted experiment that prompted the creation of other underground refuges for works of artistic, literary and cultural significance. The tunnel proved to be among the safest of all the war-time repositories. For the second time in their long life, Aurel Stein's scrolls owe their continued survival in part to their concealment in a man-made chamber.

Notes

1 Lionel Barnett to Aurel Stein, 20 August 1918. Bodleian Stein MS.65.
2 *Ibid.*
3 William L. Davies, 'War-time Evacuation to the National Library of Wales', *Transactions of the Honourable Society of Cymmrodorion: Session 1945*. London, 1946, p. 171.
4 National Library of Wales council minutes, 21 October, 1937.
5 N.J. McCamley, *Saving Britain's Art Treasures from the Nazis*, Barnsley, 2003, pp. 14–18.
6 Derman Christopherson, 'Reminiscences of Operational Research in World War II by some of its practitioners', *The Journal of Operational Research Society*, Vol 43, Issue 6 (1992), pp. 569–573.
7 David Jenkins, A Refuge in Peace and War, Aberystwyth, 2002, p. 267.
8 British Museum Standing Committee Minutes, 8 October 1938.
9 British Museum Standing Committee Minutes, 10 December 1938.
10 John Forsdyke, 'The Museum in War-time', in The British *Museum Quarterly* 15 (1952), pp. 1–8.
11 Fire salvage list, 21 October 1938. Air Raid Precautions, file 1 of 2. Department of Oriental Printed Books and Manuscripts. British Library archives.
12 Marjorie Caygill, '1939: Evacuating the BM's treasures', *British Museum Society Bulletin* 62 (1989), pp. 17–21.
13 Jacob Leveen, 'The British Museum Collections in Aberystwyth', reprinted from Transactions of the Honourable Society of Cymmrodorion (1946), pp. 1–7.
14 British Museum Standing Committee Minutes, 14 October, 1939.
15 P.R. Harris, *A History of the British Museum Library*, London, 1998, p. 553.
16 Jacob Leveen, op. cit.
17 Lionel Giles, *Six Centuries at Tunhuang*, London, 1944, p. 6. See also Frances Wood and Mark Barnard, The Diamond Sutra, The Story of the World's Earliest Date Printed Book, London, 2010, p. 86.
18 Librarian's Report to the Governors, June 14, 1945. National Library of Wales: Grant in Aid, December 1944-October 1946. National Archives file T162/851.
19 Giles to Forsdyke, 11 November 1939. Air Raid Precautions, file 2 of 2. British Library archives.
20 Forsdyke to Giles, 18 November 1939. *Ibid.*
21 John Forsdyke, 'The Museum in War-time', *op. cit.*
22 British Museum Standing Committee Minutes, 12 October 1940.
23 Forsdyke, John. '*The Museum in War-time*', *op. cit.*
24 British Museum Standing Committee Minutes, 5 April 1942.
25 After the war, a plaque at the library's entrance acknowledged that the official military history of World War I was completed and World War II's was begun during the residence there of the historical section of the War Cabinet.
26 John Forsdyke, *'The Museum in War-time', op. cit.*
27 Leveen to Fulton 5 April 1941. Air Raid Precautions, file 2 of 2. British Library archives.
28 Leveen to Fulton, 9 April 1941. *Ibid.*
29 Jacob Leveen, 'The British Museum Collections in Aberystwyth', *op. cit.*
30 British Museum Standing Committee Minutes, 11 July 1942.
31 Leveen to Fulton, 8 June 1942. Air Raid Precautions, file 2 of 2, *op. cit.*
32 Department of Oriental Printed Books and Manuscripts to Whitney, 5 June 1943 (unsigned copy). Air Raid Precautions, file 2 of 2. British Library archives.
33 File note, 28 May 1946, *ibid.*
34 Librarian's Report to the Governors, 14 June, 1945, *op. cit.*
35 Jacob Leveen, 'The British Museum Collections in Aberystwyth', *op. cit.*
36 Jacob Leveen, *ibid.*
37 Report of the Trustees, 1966. British Museum, London, 1967, p. 20.

Paul Pelliot, Aurel Stein and Chinese Opposition to the Royal Academy's International Exhibition of Chinese Art 1935–36

Frances Wood

Curator of the Chinese Collections, British Library

The failure of Stein's Fourth Expedition to Central Asia of 1930–1 has been shown to have resulted from opposition led by the historian and bibliographer William Hung of Harvard and Yenching, but a similar attempt at opposition by young Chinese intellectuals to the Royal Academy's International Exhibition of Chinese Art, and Paul Pelliot's part in it, is less well known. In their opposition to the proposed loan to London of China's major art treasures, a group of intellectuals, this time from Tsing Hua not Yenching University, linked the names of Pelliot and Stein for their previous removal of art treasures from China.[1]

The International Exhibition of Chinese Art, held at the Royal Academy of Arts in Burlington House from November 1935 to March 1936, was a massive undertaking, planned and executed within a very short space of time and generally acknowledged in Europe to be a great success.[2] Yet the Royal Academy archives include three newspaper clippings that indicate considerable opposition to the exhibition from an impressive group of Chinese intellectuals based in Tsing Hua University.[3]

The fact that Chinese national treasures selected from the imperial collections of the Palace Museum were not to be insured was one aspect that provoked their anger. The first article from the *Peiping Chronicle* clipped and pasted into the archive is dated January 22, 1935 and headed 'Chinese here oppose plans for exhibition. Object to arrangements for sending art treasures to London. Tsing Hua group objects to British experts being sent to make selection.' The article refers to a 'long manifesto issued by a number of local Chinese professors and intellectuals' including the Dean of the College of Public Affairs at Tsing Hua University, the playwright Hsiung Fu-hsi,[4] Mr Liang Ssu-cheng (son of the late Liang Ch'i-ch'ao and research fellow of the Society for Research in Chinese Architecture),[5] Mrs Liang (née Lin),[6] Dr. Chin Yueh-lin[7] and Dr Chou Pai-yuan[8] (all of Tsing Hua)'. The group opposed the proposal that the works of art be sent uninsured and 'pointed out that once an object of art is acquired by the British Museum it will never be allowed to leave its portals whatever may be its value.'

'[T]he manifesto also raises concern about the report that one of the British experts to be sent out to China to collect art treasures is Dr Pelliot, the French Sinologue… It is said that Dr Pelliot was associated with Sir Aurel Stein in the excavations at Tun-huang in Kansu over 20 years ago when they carried away many valuable Buddhist classics to France and England. It is recalled that when Sir Aurel Stein tried to enter Sinkiang about four years ago, he was denied entry. For China to welcome Dr Pelliot now whilst forbidding his colleague to enter Sinkiang four years ago constitutes such a startling reversal of attitude as is likely to lower her prestige.'

The manifesto appears to be faintly confused: Pelliot was not, after all, a 'British expert' and mention of the British Museum seems to hint at inalienable acquisition (despite the fact that the exhibition was to be held in the Royal Academy, not the British Museum). Stein and Pelliot were rivals rather than associates. However, Stein and Pelliot had carried material away from Dunhuang and were thus both to be feared in the context of Chinese art treasures. Stein was not denied entry to Xinjiang (he was in Xinjiang for several months), but his Fourth Expedition to Central Asia had,

indeed, ended in failure as a result of pressure from 'Young China' and William Hung of Yenching University in particular.[9] This time, the intellectuals were associated, not with Yenching but with nearby Tsing Hua University.

Another article in the same newspaper quotes from the *Ta Kung Pao* of Tientsin, expressing surprise that the Chinese Government had decided not to insure its art treasures: 'This is really surprising. In spite of the elaborate precautions taken by the Palace Museum, several cases of theft have occurred during the last 10 years.' The article continues with the stipulation that exhibits should be chosen 'by China herself' (something that Sir Percival David was determined would not happen), that 'China should stick to the principle that important and valuable treasures should not be sent abroad' and that 'the treasures must be insured' (which did not happen as the expense would have been prohibitive – to the organisers).[10]

In what appears to be an editorial from the same issue of the *Peiping Chronicle*, the worries of the manifesto-writers are dismissed:

> The idea that Professor Pelliot has anything to do with the exhibition is also a misconception and he is certainly not amongst the group now on its way to China to make, in association with the representatives of the Chinese government, the selection of art objects required…[11]

In fact, Pelliot was closely involved with the selection and with the exhibition. His name first appears in the Chinese exhibition archives in a letter from Sir Percival David in the Dorchester Hotel to W.R.M. Lamb, Secretary to the Royal Academy, dated 8 January 1935, when he asks that all minutes of the [Exhibition's] Executive Committee 'from its inception' (in August 1934) be sent to Pelliot at 59, Avenue Foch, Paris. In another letter to the Academy written in Peking in April 1935, he describes how Pelliot was present for four days when the 'preliminary exhibition' of potential exhibits was installed in 'the old Bank of China'.[12] These potential exhibits had been extracted from the temporary storage of the contents of the Palace Museum, described in an internal memorandum written in late 1934 by the Secretary of the Royal Academy: 'the Palace treasures are stored at present in a Shanghai warehouse in 21,000 cases… stacked one above the other.'[13] As a final contribution to the preparations for the Exhibition, Major General Neil Malcolm wrote to Bernard Rackham (of the V&A) from the Grand Hotel des Wagons-Lits in Peking on 29 May 1935, 'Pelliot is leaving here to supervise the loading and shipping in HMS Suffolk'. As part of his campaign to persuade the Chinese Government that insurance was not necessary, Sir Percival David had persuaded the Foreign and Commonwealth Office to allocate space on HMS Suffolk, a war ship, in order to transport safely the 760 art treasures in their 93 cases.[14]

Pelliot's involvement with the exhibition did not end there. He gave two lectures in Burlington House in January 1935 and six of the exhibits were personal loans. According to the Catalogue of the Exhibition, he lent a bronze belt-hook inlaid with turquoise dated to the Six Dynasties, an early Tang gilt bronze miniature stele supported on a tortoise, a printed Abhidharmavijnanakayapada-sastra dated 1099 'from the library of the Ku-shan monastery', a 'pair of Nestorian doves' in bronze and a bronze Nestorian cross, both dated to the fourteenth century and a Tang dynasty 'woodblock for printing Buddhas on Dharanis'.[15] Most of these must surely have been acquired on Pelliot's Central Asian exploration of 1906–9.[16]

Aside from his own personal exhibits, loans from the Louvre, the Musée Guimet and the Bibliothèque nationale de France, as well as the fruits of his Central Asian exploration, were all labelled 'Pelliot Collection'.

Pelliot's hand can perhaps be seen in the selection of exhibits from Dunhuang that were included in the Exhibition. The printed prayer sheet of Vaisravana is identical with the British Museum's Stein painting 245;[17] there are several stencils used for creating Buddha images in the British Museum; half of the rubbing of Ouyang Xun's epitaph is at Or.8210/S.5791 (now in the British Library) and there are several illustrated booklet versions of the *Guanyinjing* in London. Yet in all these cases, instead of choosing the ones that were already in London, items from the 'Pelliot Collection', whether in the Louvre, Musée Guimet or Bibliothèque nationale, were selected and transported across the Channel. It is possible that Pelliot chose these items because he was more familiar with them and his access to the Stein Collection items was more restricted, but it seems extraordinary that he chose a small printed booklet of the Diamond sutra (catalogue no. 2990) dated 930 or 949, rather than the splendid Diamond sutra of AD 868 in the Stein Collection, particularly since it was Pelliot himself, rather than Stein, who first realised its significance as the world's earliest securely dated printed book.[18]

The Tsing Hua intellectuals were right to suspect Pelliot's involvement in the International Exhibition of Chinese Art and they might have been angrier had they known that 'the insurance of all the loans by French museums was arranged in Paris by Professor Paul Pelliot…'.[19]

Notes

1 Shareen Blair Brysac has written several papers on the subject: Shareen Brysac, 'Sir Aurel Stein's Fourth "American" Expedition', in H. Wang (ed.), *Sir Aurel Stein. Proceedings of the British Museum study* day, 23 March 2002, British Museum Research Publication 142, 2004, pp. 17–22, www.britishmuseum.org/pdf/Stein%02Brysac.pdf (seen 3.1.2011); and 'Last of the Foreign Devils', Archaeology, Nov–Dec 1997, pp. 53–9. For William Hung, see Susan Chan Egan, The Last Confucian, Harvard, 1987. Opposition to Stein's Fourth Expedition was not limited to Hung and Yenching University for the newly formed National Commission for the Preservation of Antiquities included representatives of the Palace Museum, National Library of China, Academic Sinica, the National University, Tsing Hua and Yenching universities (British Library IOL L/PS/10/1218. Despatch no. 94 to FO, 13th January, 1931).

2 For a description of the organisation of the exhibition see Stacey Pierson, Collectors, *Collections and Museums: the field of Chinese ceramics in Britain*, 1560–1960, Peter Lang, Bern, 2007, chapter 3.

3 The quotes from the Royal Academy Archives (RRA) are reproduced with the permission of the Royal Academy. I am very grateful to the Archivist, Mark Pomeroy for his warm welcome and access to the archives.

4 Xiong Fuxi 1900–65.

5 Liang Sicheng 1901–72, architectural historian and designer.

6 Lin Huiyin 1904–55, poet, architectural historian and designer.

7 Jin Yuelin 1895–1984, philosopher and logician, although internet references in Chinese mainly refer to his lifelong passion for Liang Sicheng's wife, Lin Huiyin.

8 Presumably the theoretical physicist Zhou Peiyuan 1902-1993.

9 Shareen Blair Brysac, 'Last of the Foreign Devils', *op. cit.*

10 For opposition to the selection of material by Chinese experts see, for example, Lamb's memo to the Chinese Ambassador of November 1934, *Catalogue of the International Exhibition*, op.cit., RAA/SEC/24/25/1 and Percival David's letter to Oscar Raphael of 7 November 1934, in the same volume.

11 From the *Peiping Chronicle* articles pasted into the Royal Academy archives RAA/SEC/24/25/1.

12 Confidential: Work of the Selection Committee in Shanghai, Percival David, 22 April 1935, RAA/SEC/24/25/1

13 Memo from Lamb to the Chinese Ambassador, November 1934, RAA/SEC/24/25/1.

14 Malcolm to Rackham, RAA/SEC/24/25/6.

15 Royal Academy of Arts, Catalogue of the *International Exhibition of Chinese Art 1935–36* (third edition), London, 1935, p. 55, 255, 258–9.

16 The exhibition was something of a showcase for the personal collections of the Organising Committee: Sir Percival David showed 314 items from his own collection on show and the 187 exhibits from the British Museum were all labelled with the name of the previous owner, George Eumorfopoulos; see Catalogue of the International Exhibition, op.cit., p. xxvii-xxxv.

17 BM registration no. 1919,0101,0.245; Stein no. Ch.xxx.002.

18 *Catalogue of the International Exhibition*, *op.cit.*, p. 256. For Pelliot's discovery of the *Diamond sutra's significance see F. Wood and M. Barnard, The Diamond Sutra: the story of the world's earliest dated printed book*, British Library, London, 2010, p. 78.

19 Lamb to Henri Verne of the Musées nationaux, Palais du Louvre, 27 April 1936. There were some insurance claims including one from Mrs Holmes, who was told, when she complained that her ivory dragon had fallen apart, that 'your butler inspected them', RAA/SEC/24/25/4.

Bodleian Library, Oxford: Catalogue of the Papers of Sir (Marc) Aurel Stein (1862–1943)

Elizabeth Diamond and T.D. Rogers

Both formerly of the Bodleian Library

Updated by Christopher Fletcher, Keeper of Special Collections, Bodleian Libraries

Editor's note: This catalogue has existed in typescript form since 1983 and has been prepared for publication here, with a few minor revisions, with the kind permission of T.D. Rogers, and C. Fletcher. Since 1983 the Bodleian has acquired additional papers, namely those bequeathed by F.H. Andrews to the Ashmolean in 1958, and given to the Bodleian by the Ashmolean in 1988. For convenience, they are included at the end of this paper, with cross-references to the Index. Details of these additional papers are also available on the Bodleian website: http://www.bodley.ox.ac.uk/dept/scwmss/wmss/online/modern/stein/stein-add.html

A. Papers and correspondence of Sir Aurel Stein (1862-1943)

The papers, mainly files as kept by Stein, are arranged as follows: (1) letters to P.S. Allen and Helen Allen, 1898–1943; (2) correspondence with F.H. Andrews, 1899–1943; (3) general correspondence, arranged alphabetically; (4) family correspondence; (5) notebooks, field diaries, personal diaries and 'personal narratives', 1899–1943; (6) miscellaneous and personal papers, including catalogue of Stein's library; (7) correspondence and papers concerning expeditions; (8) drafts of, and papers and correspondence concerning, publications; (9) maps and photographs. Oriental manuscripts collected by Stein are in the Department of Oriental Books. The biography by Jeanette Mirsky, *Sir Aurel Stein, archaeological explorer* (Chicago & London, 1977) is based partly on these papers. Bequeathed by Stein to the Indian Institute, Oxford, 1943.
MS. Stein 1–458

1. Letters from Stein to P.S. Allen (1869–1933) and Helen Mary Allen, 1899–1943, with some enclosures (mainly letters from others to Stein, and photographs). The Allens' letters to Stein are Bodleian (P.S. Allen papers), with the exception of MS. Stein 12.

MS. Stein 1–11

1	1898–1904 lviii + 268 leaves	
2	1905	285 leaves
3	1906	269 leaves
4	1907	171 leaves
5	1908	221 leaves
6	1909	116 leaves
7	1910–11	144 leaves
8	Jan–June 1912	158 leaves
9	July–Dec. 1912	167 leaves
10	1913	250 leaves
11	1914	174 leaves

MS. Stein 12
Letters from P.S. Allen to Stein, 1912–14, with some of Allen's papers relating to Stein, 1907–31.
83 leaves

MS. Stein 13–34

13	1915	213 leaves
14	1916	149 leaves
15	1917–18	233 leaves
16	1919	115 leaves
17	1920–1	196 leaves
18	1922–3	204 leaves
19	1924–6	217 leaves
20	1927–8	210 leaves
21	1929–30	249 leaves
22	1931	196 leaves
23	1932	139 leaves
24	1933	201 leaves
25	1934	119 leaves

26	1935	226 leaves
27	1936	172 leaves
28	1937	215 leaves
29	1938	261 leaves
30	1939	149 leaves
31	1940	267 leaves
32	1941	207 leaves
33	1942	184 leaves
34	1943	147 leaves

MS. Stein 35
Typescript draft of Letters of P.S. Allen, ed. H.M. Allen (Oxford & London, 1939), with manuscript corrections and notes, some by H.W. Garrod, and a number of passages not included in the published text, *c.*1938. vii + 447 leaves

2. Correspondence with F.H. Andrews, 1899–1943, with some papers of Andrews, 1894–1953

MS. Stein 36–60

36	1899–1905	286 leaves
37	1906–9	243 leaves
38	1 Nov. 1906, on wooden writing tablet	2 leaves
39	1910–Apr 1912	140 leaves
40	May–Dec 1912	186 leaves
41	Jan–May 1913	146 leaves
42	June 1913–June 1915	145 leaves
43	July 1915–16	219 leaves
44	1917–18	211 leaves
45	Jan–June 1919	147 leaves
46	July–Dec 1919	140 leaves
47	1920–1	138 leaves
48	1922	103 leaves
49	1923–4	251 leaves
50	1925–6	184 leaves
51	1927–June 1928	147 leaves
52	July 1928–30	214 leaves
53	1931–2	222 leaves
54	1933–July 1934	255 leaves
55	Aug 1934–Feb 1935	148 leaves
56	Mar–Dec 1935	185 leaves
57	1936–July 1937	192 leaves
58	Aug 1937–1938	225 leaves
59	1939	145 leaves
60	1940–3	223 leaves

MS. Stein 61–62
Papers and correspondence of F.H. Andrews, 1894–1921, 1922–53, n.d., some relating to his own career, mainly relating to Stein, including correspondence of Stein and papers concerning the Stein collection at the Museum of Central Asian Antiquities, Delhi, with (a) (62, fols 623–119) correspondence with Macmillan & Co., publishers, 1935–6, and (b) (62, fols 145–60) notes on and samples of thread from ancient textiles. 148, 173 leaves.

3. General correspondence, letters to Stein, arranged alphabetically, with copies of many of Stein's replies, 1891–1943

MS. Stein 63–113

63	Abbott–Armstrong	227 leaves
64	Arnold–Baptist Mission Press	234 leaves
65	Barnett–Binyon	256 leaves
66	Black–Brown (F.H.)	219 leaves
67	Brown (I.M.)–Bushell	232 leaves
68	Butler–Chartraire	188 leaves
69	Chavannes (E.), 1892–1913	197 leaves
70	Chavannes (E.), 1916–17, with letters of his widow, 1918–28	161 leaves
71	Chesney–Cotton	212 leaves
72	Couling–Deane	112 leaves
73	De Filippi–Deva	162 leaves
74	Devakaka–Duvendak	218 leaves
75	Edgerton–Ficker	182 leaves
76	Field–Foster	109 leaves
77	Foucher–Frankfort	178 leaves
78	Fraser–Gergan	190 leaves
79	Ghirsman–Gray	194 leaves
80	Grenard–Grierson (G.A.), 1897–1917	146 leaves
81	Grierson (G.A.), 1918–26	210 leaves
82	Grierson (G.A.), 1927–35, – Hailey	198 leaves
83	Halász–Hedin	177 leaves
84	Hendley–Hillebrandt	200 leaves
85	Hiller–Hole	170 leaves
86	Holroyd–Ivanow	211 leaves
87	Jacobi–Joyce	151 leaves
88	Kali Sil–Kaul	195 leaves
89	Keen–Kingsford	197 leaves
90	Kipling–Lanman	162 leaves
91	Laufer–Le Coq	175 leaves
92	Lefebvre–Lloyd	155 leaves
93	Lóczy–Longstaff	131 leaves
94	Lorimer	224 leaves
95	Lutyens–Lyon	122 leaves
96	Macartney (Sir George), 1900–13	214 leaves
97	Macartney (Sir George), 1914–39	156 leaves
98	McCallum–Margoliouth	174 leaves
99	Marshall–Merzbacher	223 leaves
100	Messinger–Neve	165 leaves
101	Niazal–Penzer	197 leaves
102	Peter–Poussin	227 leaves
103	Powell–Rapson	263 leaves
104	Raquette–Sadler	217 leaves
105	Sahajabhatta_Seligmann	224 leaves
106	Senart–Simpson	182 leaves
107	Singh–Sollas	217 leaves
108	Soothill–Tarn	176 leaves
109	Tattersall–*Travel & Exploration*	155 leaves
110	Trinkler–Vero	157 leaves
111	Vogel–Wheeler	174 leaves
112	White–Wu	130 leaves
113	Yabuki–Zollinger, with unidentified writers, and (fols 102–47) a separate file of letters, 1895–6, many from Sahajabhatta	147 leaves

4. Family correspondence, mainly in German

MS. Stein 114
Letters to Stein from his parents, 1873–6 n.d.
159 leaves

MS. Stein 115
Letters to Stein from his father, Nathan, some enclosing other family correspondence, 1887–9, with (a) (fols 139–51) letters from Stein to his parents, 1870–87; (b) (fols 152–83) correspondence between Ernst Stein and his parents, 1877, 1888, and (c) (fols 184–99) papers of Nathan Stein, 1855–65.
199 leaves

MS. Stein 116
Miscellaneous correspondence of the Stein family, 1873–1943, mainly letters of Stein, with (fols 161–222) correspondence of Stein with his nephew Ernst and family, 1928, 1939–43.
224 leaves

MS. Stein 117
Letters from Ernst and (fols 172–241) Aurel Stein to their uncle Ignaz Hirschler, 1885–91.
243 leaves

MS.Stein 118
Letters from Aurel to Ernst Stein, 1879–1901.
276 leaves

MS. Stein 119–20
Letters from Ernst to Aurel Stein, 1873–98, 1899–1901.
287, 312 leaves

MS. Stein 121–8
Letters from Harriet Stein, wife of Ernst, with some letters from Ernst and their children, 1888–1933.
121 1888–1904
314 leaves
122 1905–6, 1913 263 leaves
123 1915–19 140 leaves
124 1920 128 leaves
125 1921–2 110 leaves
126 1925–6 118 leaves
127 1927–8 112 leaves
128 1930–3 123 leaves

5. Notebooks, field diaries, personal diaries and 'personal narratives', 1889–1943.

MS. Stein 129–30
Loose papers removed from some of the volumes are now *MS. Stein 272*.
Chronological lists of letters written, 1895–1901, 1911–21 (personal correspondence), with some miscellaneous notes.
58, 120 leaves

MS. Stein 131
Stein's address book, 1880s. 74 leaves

MS. Stein 132–83
Pocket notebooks containing miscellaneous entries made during expeditions, including lists of expenses, notes on travelling conditions and geographical features, lists of finds and some sketches, 1889–1943.

132	1889	55 leaves
133	Mar 1900–Jun 1901	53 leaves
134	May–Aug 1900	26 leaves
135	Jun 1900–Oct 1901	122 leaves, 40–122 blank
136	Jul–Aug 1900	25 leaves
137	Sep 1900–Feb 1901	26 leaves
138	Apr–Aug 1906	63 leaves
139	Sep–Nov 1906	63 leaves
140	Nov 1906–Feb 1907	63 leaves
141	Feb–May 1907	61 leaves
142	Jun–Oct 1907	63 leaves
143	Dec 1907–Apr 1908	63 leaves
144	Apr–Jul 1908	53 leaves
145	Aug–1908–Jan 1909	63 leaves
146	Jul 1909–Sep 1912	63 leaves
147	May 1910–Jun 1911	61 leaves
148	Oct–Dec 1910	18 leaves
149	Jul–Sep 1913	53 leaves
150	Sep–Dec 1913	53 leaves
151	Jan–Mar 1914	53 leaves
152	Mar–Apr 1914	53 leaves
153	May–Aug 1914	53 leaves
154	Aug–Dec 1914	53 leaves
155	Jan–Feb 1915	53 leaves
156	Apr–Jul 1915	53 leaves
157	Jul–Sep 1915	53 leaves
158	Sep–Dec 1915	53 leaves
159	Dec 1915–Mar 1916	53 leaves
160	Mar–Apr 1926	44 leaves
161	Apr–May 1926	42 leaves
162	Jan–Feb 1927	51 leaves
163	Mar–Jun 1927	51 leaves
164	Dec 1927–Feb 1928	51 leaves
165	Feb–Mar 1928	50 leaves
166	Mar–May 1928	51 leaves
167	Feb–Nov 1933	51 leaves
168	Nov 1933–Feb 1934	51 leaves
169	Feb–Apr 1934	51 leaves
170	Apr 1934–Jan 1935	51 leaves
171	Jan– Nov 1935	51 leaves
172	Dec 1935–Feb 1936	50 leaves
173	Mar–May 1936	51 leaves
174	Jun–Oct 1936	51 leaves
175	Oct 1936–Oct 1937	51 leaves
176	Dec 1937–May 1938	51 leaves
177	Jun 1938–Jan 1939	51 leaves
178	Jan–Mar 1939	51 leaves
179	Apr–Oct 1939	51 leaves
180	Nov 1939–Dec 1940	51 leaves
181	Dec 1940–Feb 1941	51 leaves
182	Feb–Dec 1942	51 leaves
183	Dec 1942–Jan 1943	51 leaves

MS. Stein 184
Notes for explorations, lists of equipment and agenda, and chronology of expeditions and travels, 1895–1921, 1930.
80 leaves

MS. Stein 185–232
Field diaries, containing records of expeditions and archaeological work 1889–1943. See below MS. Stein 285–360 for details of expeditions.

185	1889–92	114 leaves, 77–111 blank
186	Jul–Sep 1891	129 leaves
187	Oct 1891–Jun 1895	141 leaves
188	Sep 1895–Dec 1896	122 leaves
189	Dec 1897–Oct 1899	82 leaves
190	Jan–Mar 1898	97 leaves, 53–97 blank
191	Nov 1899–Feb 1904	79 leaves
192	Jul 1900–Jan 1901	164 leaves
193	Jan–Apr 1901	113 leaves
194	Apr–Jun 1901	92 leaves
195	Feb 1904–Jan 1905	118 leaves
196	Apr–Aug 1906	119 leaves
197	Aug–Nov 1906	114 leaves
198	Nov 1906–Mar 1907	115 leaves
199	Mar–Aug 1907	118 leaves
200	Aug–Dec 1907	116 leaves
201	Dec 1907–Apr 1908	115 leaves
202	Apr–Aug 1908	119 leaves
203	Aug–Sep 1908	114 leaves, 69–112 blank
204–5	Typed transcript of diaries, Dec 1906–Aug 1908	ii + 424, ii + 601 leaves
206	Feb–Apr 1912	97 leaves
207	Jul–Nov 1913	116 leaves
208	Nov 1913–Mar 1914	143 leaves
209	Mar–Sep 1914	142 leaves
210	Sep 1914–Mar 1915	146 leaves
211	Mar–Jul 1915	146 leaves
212	Jul–Oct 1915	147 leaves
213	Oct 1915–Jan 1916	141 leaves
214	Jan–Feb 1916	48 leaves
215–8	Typed transcript for July 1913–Feb 1916	367, ii + 477, ii + 399, ii + 251 leaves
219	Dec 1921	95 leaves, 14–93 blank
220	Apr 1924	73 leaves
221	Mar–May 1926	240 leaves, 104–237 blank
222	Jan 1927–Mar 1928	471 pages
223	Jan–May 1929	ii + 148 leaves, 103–47 blank
224	Mar–Apr 1928; Apr 1930–Apr 1931	iv + 456 pages
225	Apr–Jul 1931; Nov 1931–Jun 1932	iv + 472 pages
226	Nov 1932–Oct 1933	ii + 473 pages, 335–467 blank
227	Oct 1933–May 1934	473 pages, 372–463 blank
228	Oct 1935–Sep 1936	492 pages
229	Sep 1936–Feb 1939	239 leaves
230	Feb–May 1939; Nov 1939	237 leaves
231	Sep 1940–Oct 1941	246 leaves
232	Apr–Oct 1943	210 leaves, 46–210 blank

MS. Stein 233–58
Personal diaries, 1899–1940 (incomplete series)

233	1899	200 leaves
234	1900	201 leaves
235	1902	201 leaves
236	1906	201 leaves, 83–197 blank
237	1909	202 leaves
238	1910	203 leaves
239	1913	208 leaves
240	1916 (engagements)	84 leaves
241	1916 (diary)	191 leaves

242	1917	208 leaves
243	1918	208 leaves
244	1924	217 leaves
245	1925	217 leaves
246	1926	217 leaves
247	31 Dec 1926–8 Jan 1927	125 leaves. 27–125 blank
248	1927	216 leaves
249	1928	217 leaves
250	1930	217 leaves, 133–217 blank
251	1931	208 leaves, 13–107, 170–208 blank
252	1932	215 leaves, 15–97, 172–215 blank
253	1934	217 leaves, 15–86 blank
254	1935	217 leaves, 183–217 blank
255	1937 (engagements)	62 leaves
256	1937 (diary)	233 leaves
257	1938	232 leaves, 189–232 blank
258/1	1939	232 leaves, 26–104 blank
258/2	1940	231 leaves

MS. Stein 259
Volume containing a few pages of diary entries and accounts by an unidentified member of the Stein family, late 19th century.
54 leaves, 6–51 blank

MS. Stein 260/1–12
Miniature printed almanacs, Hungarian (1897–8), German (1895, 1902–14) and English (1914).

260/1	1895	32 leaves
260/2	1897	32 leaves
260/3	1898	34 leaves
260/4	1898	34 leaves
260/5	1902	33 leaves
260/6	1906	34 leaves
260/7	1909	33 leaves
260/8	1910	31 leaves
260/9	1912	34 leaves
260/10	1913	32 leaves
260/11	1914	34 leaves
260/12	1914	16 leaves

MS. Stein 261–6
'Personal narratives', an informal record of expeditions by Stein, addressed usually to P.S. Allen and his wife, 1904–43.

261/1–2	1904, 1906–8, 1935–6	i + 124, 270 leaves
262	1926	i + 92 leaves
263	1928–9	iv + 220 pages
264	1930, 1933–4	i + 115 leaves
265	1938–9	183 leaves
266	1941–3	226 leaves

6. Miscellaneous papers

MS. Stein 267–9
Catalogue, on slips, of Sanskrit manuscripts bought by Stein, 1888–94, containing fuller descriptions, in Sanskrit, than those by G.L.M. Clauson, 'Catalogue of the Stein collection of Sanskrit MS. from Kashmir', Journal of the Royal Asiatic Society, 1912, 587–627. Some of the manuscripts were bequeathed by Stein to the Indian Institute, Oxford, and are now in the Bodleian; others were given to the University Library, Tübingen, and the National Library, Vienna, and a few given to friends, 1894–5 (see note by Stein, *MS. Stein 267*, fol. 1). 274, 73, 118 leaves

MS. Stein 270
Catalogues, on slips, of Oriental manuscripts (a) (fols 1–60) offered for sale to Stein at Srinagar, but not bought, 1894; (b) (fols 61–83) bought at Srinagar, 1894; (c) (fols 84–131) sent to the K.K. Hof–Bibliothek, Vienna, 1894; (d) (fols 132–75) sent to the University Library, Tübingen, 1895, with (e) (fols 176–270) various lists and descriptions of manuscripts, with a few transcripts. 270 leaves

MS. Stein 271
Miscellaneous papers, 1894–1943, including (a) (fols 64–78) lists of archaeological finds, 1922–3; (b) (fols 82–96) memorandum by Stein on accusations against him by the Chinese Ministry of Foreign Affairs, 1931; (c) (fols 1467–221) lists of negatives and photographs, 1904–42; (d) (fols 222–48) some official correspondence of Stein, 1939–43.
248 leaves

MS. Stein 272
Loose papers removed from some of Stein's notebooks and diaries, 1891–1941, with a note (on the first leaf of each group of papers) of the manuscripts from which they were removed.
203 leaves

MS. Stein 273
Copies of reports used by Stein, mainly relating to Indian geography and archaeology, 1884–1919, n.d., including (a) (fols 1–38) report on the soma plant, compiled from official records of 1884; (b) (fols 39–101) copy of report and notes by M.G. Talbot on a journey from Heart to Bamian, and (c) (fols 151–205) 'Das Honor–Problem' by Emil Trinkler, 1920. 205 leaves

MS. Stein 274
Subject files of correspondence concerning (a) (fols 1–33) Tibetan rock–inscriptions, 1901–4; (b) (fols 34–135) a proposed India Museum in London, 1909–12; (c) (fols 136–74) Indian manuscripts collected by Stein, 1910–12, and (d) (fols 175–211) manuscripts found (1931) at Gilgit, 1931–3.
211 leaves

MS. Stein 275–6
Lists of equipment, furniture, papers and books, with some related correspondence, 1900–25, 1926–44, n.d.337 leaves

MS. Stein 277–9
Files of official correspondence and papers relating to Stein's posts (and salary) in India, 1892–1929, with (MS. Stein 278, fols 1–152) correspondence, mainly with A.F.R. Hoernle, about Stein's transfer to Calcutta.
277 1892–7, 1892–9130 leaves
2781898–1900, 1899–1901 196 leaves
2791902–29 183 leaves

MS. Stein 280
Biographical papers of Stein, including (a) (fosl 1–30) curricula vitae in English and Hungarian, 1897–1900, and (b) (fols 31–74) drafts of autobiographical notices, 1905, 1917, with (c) (fols 81–199) files concerning the preservation of Mohand Marg, 1905–33.
199 leaves

MS. Stein 281–2
Financial papers: correspondence with banks (including statements and lists of securities) in (a) (281, fols 1–53) India, 1901–4, 1937–41; (b) (281, fols 54–211) England, 1922, 1934–40; (c) (282, fols 1–75) USA, 1935–40, and (d) (282, fols 76–128) Austria, Switzerland and Hungary, 1937–40, with (e) (281, fols 212–25) correspondence with the Income Tax Department, Bombay, 1943.
225, 128 leaves

MS. Stein 283
Miscellaneous large–format documents, with related papers, including (a) (fols 5–10, 18–21) Chinese passports, 1906–30; (b) (fols 17–60, 87–97) papers relating to the 3rd Central Asian expedition, 1913–16; (c) (fols 61–73) papers relating to the publication of the Khotan map, 1900–4; (d) (fol. 79) copy of a Chinese inscription of 857 AD, and (e) (fols 83–103) drawings of antiquities, mainly frescoes, with a few maps and plans.
103 leaves

MS. Stein 284
Slip–catalogue of Stein's library to *c.*1940, with a few separate sections at the end, including (a) (fols 2314–2457) 'Books deposited at Oxford, 1911, 1920', and (b) (fols 2513–2816) a subject–index (not relating to the library) compiled by Stein, mainly concerning Indian history and archaeology.
2816 leaves

7. Correspondence and papers concerning expeditions, with (MS. Stein 344–60) files of correspondence with the Survey of India Department and the Director General of Archaeology. Official correspondence has not been indexed. See above, MS. Stein 132–258, for related notebooks and field diaries.

MS. Stein 285
Notes on Indian manuscripts seen by Stein, mainly in Kashmir, 1888.
40 leaves

MS. Stein 286
Papers relating to expeditions in (a) (fols 1–74) Murti and the Salt Range, Punjab (1889–90), 1890–2, with (fols 19–56) reports on the expedition, and (b) (fols 75–145) Kashmir (1891), 1891–4, with (fols 91–142) report.
145 leaves

MS. Stein 287
Papers relating to expeditions in (a) (fols 1–27) Kashmir (1891), 1891–6, and (b) (fols 27–95) Buner (1898), 1897–8.
95 leaves

MS. Stein 288
Papers relating to the expedition in Bihar (1899), 1899–1900.
132 leaves

MS. Stein 289–92
Papers relating to the 1st Central Asian expedition (1900–1).

289	1898–9	140 leaves
290	1900	186 leaves
291	1901	157 leaves
292	1902–6	127 leaves

MS. Stein 293
Papers relating to (a) (fols 1–29) an attempted expedition to Tibet, 1903–4, aqnd (b) (fols 30–108) the expedition to Mahaban (1904), 1904–5.
108 leaves

MS. Stein 294–9
Papers relating to the 2nd Central Asian expedition (1906–8), including (MS. Stein 299) packing lists of artefacts.

294	Aug–Dec 1904	109 leaves
295	Jan–Aug 1905	216 leaves
296	Sept–Dec 1905	172 leaves
297	Jan–Feb 1906	201 leaves
298	Mar–May 1906	149 leaves
299	1906–8	214 leaves

MS. Stein 300–304
Papers relating to the 3rd Central Asian expedition (1913–16), including (MS. Stein 304, fols 110–50) passports, route diary, 1914, and copies of 7th–century Chinese inscriptions. Further papers are in MS. Stein 283, fols 17–60, 87–97.

300	Nov 1912–Jun 1913	182 leaves
301	July–Dec 1913	126 leaves
302	Correspondence and papers of T.R.J. Ward concerning water–flow, 1913	244 leaves
303	1914–15	232 leaves
304	1916, with miscellaneous papers, 1913–16	150 leaves

MS. Stein 305/1–6, 306
Notebooks of Stein's assistant, Afrazgul Khan, on the 3rd Central Asian expedition, containing itineraries and barometer and chronometer readings, 1913–16. 35 leaves, ii + 44 pages, 10, 6, 32, 13 leaves, and (306) 110 leaves, 22–82 blank.

MS. Stein 307
Lists of place names for maps, compiled on the 3rd Central Asian expedition.
203 leaves

MS. Stein 308
Papers, 1915–17, 1925–6, relating mainly to work being done in England, in connection with the 3rd Central Asian expedition, with (a) (fols 165–77) list of objects to be presented to the British Museum, 1925, and (b) (fols 178–223) lists of objects for exhibition at the British Museum, 1925–6.
223 leaves

MS. Stein 309
Papers relating to the disposal in Kashmir of antiquities from the 3rd Central Asian expedition, 1917–18.
151 leaves

MS. Stein 310–11
Papers relating to the expedition in Swat (1926), 1925–May 1926, June 1926–1928, with (MS. Stein 311, fols 88–192) drawings of ground plans and architectural details, maps, and stories and word–lists in local languages.
174, 192 leaves

MS. Stein 312
Papers relating to the expedition in Baluchistan (1927), 1926–7.
96 leaves

MS. Stein 313–14
Papers relating to the 4th Central Asian expedition (1930), 1924–9, 1930–1, including (MS. Stein 314, fols 76–119) anthropometrical records, 1930–1.
180, 119 leaves

MS. Stein 315
Papers relating to the Punjab tour, 1931.
84 leaves

MS. Stein 316–21
Papers relating to Persian expeditions (1931–6).

316	1931–May 1932	190 leaves
317	June–Dec 1932	168 leaves
318	Jan–Mar 1933	118 leaves
319	Apr–Dec 1933	177 leaves
320	1934–5	149 leaves
321	1936–7	11F8 leaves

MS. Stein 322
Diary of excavations during the Persian expedition, 1931–2, with (fols 63–85) copies of ground plans.
101 leaves

MS. Stein 323
Notebook containing hypsometrical and aneroid readings, Persia, 1933–4. 46 leaves, 11–46 blank

MS. Stein 324–6
Sketch–books containing groundplans and a few other sketches, made during Persian expeditions, 1930–3, 1934–5, 1935–6.
53, 50, 37 leaves

MS. Stein 327
Descriptions and drawings of pottery and glass fragments found on Persian expeditions, n.d.
170 leaves

MS. Stein 328–9
Papers relating to expeditions in Iraq and Jordan (1938–9), 1929–February 1938, March 1938–39.
161, 203 leaves

MS. Stein 330
Groundplans of sites in Iraq and Jordan, 1938–9.
55 leaves, 17–53 blank

MS. Stein 331
Photographs of and notes on Roman remains in Trans–jordan, 1938.
63 leaves

MS. Stein 332–3
Papers relating to the expedition in Bikaner (1940–1), 1940, 1941.
110, 114 leaves

MS. Stein 334–6
Papers relating to the expedition in Kohistan (1941–2).

334	1939–41	232 leaves
335	Jan–July 1942	154 leaves
336	Aug 1942–1943	207 leaves

MS. Stein 337–40
Papers relating to the expedition in Afghanistan (1943).

337	1854–Apr 1912	121 leaves

338	May 1912–1919	172 leaves
339	1921–2	178 leaves
340	1923–4, 1943	194 leaves

MS. Stein 341–2
Letters and papers in Chinese, relating to Steins' expeditions, 1900–32.

MS. Stein 343
Correspondence with government departments, 1890–1910, mainly relating to publications by Stein. 176 leaves

MS. Stein 344–54
Correspondence with the Survey of India Department, with related papers, 1901–42, including (MS. Stein 350, fols 170–208) 'histories' of the compilation of map sheets.

344	1901–7	135 leaves
345	1912–Jun 1913	169 leaves
346	Jul 1913–1914	127 leaves
347	1915–16	164 leaves
348	1917–Mar 1918	131 leaves
349	Apr–Dec 1918	96 leaves
350	1919–21	207 leaves
351	1923–6	153 leaves
352	1930	132 leaves
353	1931	110 leaves
354	1932–4, 1938, 1942	175 leaves

MS. Stein 355–60
Correspondence with the Director General of Archaeology in India, 1904–43, with related papers and correspondence.

355	1904–May 1928	151 leaves
356	Jun–Dec 1928	222 leaves
357	Jan–Sep 1929	121 leaves
358	Oct 1929–1930	97 leaves
359	1931–Mar 1940	161 leaves
360	Apr 1940–1943	234 leaves

MS. Stein 361–9
Account books, mainly relating to expeditions, but including some personal accounts, 1892–1939.

361	Personal, 1892–6	70 leaves
362	Personal, 1897–1900	68 leaves
363	Survey of India, 1900–1	21 leaves
364	Expeditions, 1900–1, 1905–8, 1912–14	164 leaves
365	Personal, 1901–2	78 leaves, 42–68 blank
366	Expeditions, 1914–16, 1930–32	127 leaves
367	Personal, 1931–7	77 leaves
368	Expeditions, 1933–8	128 leaves, 36–122 blank
369	Expeditions, 1937–9	50 leaves, 28–45 blank

MS. Stein 370
Expedition accounts, vouchers and related correspondence, 1900–39.
Monthly cash accounts, Apr 1900– Nov 1901, with related papers, 1900–4. 197 leaves

MS. Stein 371–2
Accounts and papers, 1905–8.
108, 108 leaves

MS. Stein 373
Accounts, 1912–15, with monthly cash accounts, July 1913–Oct 1915.
209 leaves

MS. Stein 374
Accounts, 1913–16, with monthly cash accounts, April 1914–Feb 1916.
165 leaves

MS. Stein 375
Accounts, 1913–17.
93 leaves

MS. Stein 376
Accounts, 1913–17, 1919–20.
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8. Drafts of, and papers and correspondence concerning, publications by Stein. See also MS. Stein 323.

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378	1903–13	93 leaves
379	1911–25	126 leaves, 82–124 blank
380	1912–17	103 leaves
381	1932, 1938–43	94 leaves

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383/1	1888	42 leaves
383/2	1889	20 leaves
383/3	1889	20 leaves
384	1891–5	67 leaves
385	1890–1	ii + 74 leaves
386	1891–2	69 leaves
387	1892	70 leaves

MS. Stein 388
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Manuscript of Ruins of Desert Cathay (2 vols, London 1912). Foliated in one sequence,
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MS. Stein 402

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199 leaves

MS. Stein 403–7
Part of a draft, showing some differences from the published text, of Serindia (5 vols, Oxford, 1921).
c.3500 leaves

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MS. Stein 409–12
Correspondence and papers, 1916–41, concerning The Thousand Buddhas: ancient Buddhist paintings (London, 1921), and a projected portfolio of reproductions.

409	1916	i + 101 leaves
410	1917–20	145 leaves
411	1929–38	146 leaves
412	1939–41	94 leaves

MS. Stein 413/1–2
Drafts of introduction by Stein, and (MS. Stein 413/2) descriptive catalogue by F.H. Andrews of Buddhist wall paintings from Stein's expeditions of 1906–8 and 1913–16, for a projected portfolio of reproductions.
130, 235 leaves

MS. Stein 414/1–2
Text of the Lowell lectures (Harvard) given by Stein in 1929, revised 1931 for On Ancient Central Asian Tracks, published, London 1933.
i + 203, i _ 284 leaves

MS. Stein 415
'Limes report', 1940, on Stein's survey of Roman frontier defences in Iraq and Trans–Jordan (1938–9).
654 pages

MS. Stein 416
Correspondence relating mainly to the 'Limes report', 1934–41.
58 leaves

MS. Stein 417
Manuscript of 'On ancient Persian tracks', title altered to 'On old routes of Western Iran', published as Old Routes of Western Iran (London, 1940). iv + 560 pages

MS. Stein 418
Manuscripts of 'An archaeological tour in Western Rajputana and Bahawalpur' (Bikaner expedition of 1940–1), with plans and (fols 149–67) photographs of pottery fragments.
167 leaves

MS. Stein 419
Transcripts, translations and notes by Henri Maspero, 1920s, for Documents chinois (London, 1953).
iii + 133 leaves

MS. Stein 420–2
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211, i + 281, 306 leaves

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255 leaves

9. Maps, and photographs (mainly archaeological); one box of quarterplate glass negatives is kept in the Photographic Department, box 924/1–21.

MS. Stein 427
Cards containing details of printed and manuscript maps from Stein's papers, now kept in the Map Room.

MS. Stein 428–34
Volumes of "Wellcome" photographic exposure calculator handbook and diary, containing lists, with brief descriptions, of negatives taken by Stein; the dates given below are those of the negatives.

428	1916–19	278 pages
429	1925–6	230 pages
430	1926	236 pages
431	1927–8	236 pages
432	1928	236 pages
433	1938	236 pages
434	1939	236 pages

MS. Stein 435
Watercolour of Stein's father, Nathan, 1854.
1 item

MS. Stein 436–7 [MS. Stein 438 omitted from original typescript]
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14, 59 leaves

MS. Stein 439
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92, 18 leaves

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i + 80 leaves

MS. Stein 443
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50 leaves

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92 leaves

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95 leaves

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i + 169 leaves

MS. Stein 449
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122 leaves

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81 leaves

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http://www.bodley.ox.ac.uk/dept/scwmss/wmss/online/modern/stein/stein-add.html

A. Photographs, 1894–1938 (MSS. Photogr.c.146, d.32-4, e.16-21)

MS. Photogr.c.146
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(fols 1–2) pictures of Christchurch, Oxford, n.d.
(fols 1–31) photographs mostly of mountain views, Kaghan, 1898–1928
(fols 32–122) photographs mainly of India, 1898–1928, including
(fols 44–5) buildings and ruins in Delhi, 1899
(fols 48–51) temples and other buildings in Nasik
(fol. 65) Buddhist monks at Sikkim, 1899
(fols 94–105) Mohand Marg
(fols 123–86) photographs probably taken by F.W. Thomas, *c.*1940, including
(fol. 129) Annamalia University, Chidambaram, India
(fols 132–8) buildings and people in Kathmandu, Nepal
(fols 139–45) temples in Bhatgaon [Bhaktapur], Nepal
(fols 146–7) Udagagin Fort, Travancore, India
(fols 151–2) buildings in Patan, India
(fols 153–4) Lt. Col. Sir Geoffrey Lawrence Betham, Nepal
188 leaves

MS. Photogr.d.32
Photograph album, no. XVIII, labelled 'Mohand Marg', n.d. Binding: brown paper wrappers, embossed design on front wrapper. With a typescript description of most of the photographs.
54 leaves

MS. Photogr.d.33
Photograph album, no. XIX, labelled 'Mohand Marg', n.d. Binding: as MS. Photogr.d.32. With a typescript description of most of the photographs.
53 leaves

MS. Photogr.d.34
Photograph album, no. XX, of Mohand Marg, n.d. Binding: as MS. Photogr.d.32. With (fols. 15–18) photographs of Stein with dogs.
30 leaves, 28-30 blank

MS. Photogr.e.16
Mounted photographs, mostly of mountainous landscapes, 1894–5
With: (fols 32–45) photographs of Mohand Marg, Kashmir, 1894–5. Most of the photographs are identified and dated.
45 leaves

MS. Photogr.e.17
Photograph album labelled 'Kashmir', 1921–2. Binding: grey boards, bookplate of Stein. Some of the photographs are identified in pencil, some are missing.
52 leaves

MS. Photogr.e.18
Photographs of excavations, architectural finds, ruins and landscapes, probably Iran and Iraq, *c.*1938. Many of the photographs are described on the reverse and have negative nos. L1-128, with gaps.
220 leaves

MS. Photogr.e.19
Photographs of excavations, local workers and landscapes, including Iran, 1938. Many of the photographs are described on the reverse and have negative nos. L129-312. Including pictures of the Roman limes, Iran.
200 leaves

MS. Photogr.e.20
Photographs of desert landscapes and ruins, some in Iran, *c.*1938. Includes (fols. 245–50, 271–4, 280) rock sculptures and tombs at Naqsh-e-Rostam, Iran, n.d. The photographs are identified with negative nos. F1-286, F01-F052
333 leaves

MS. Photogr.e.21
Photographs of desert landscapes, architectural structures, excavation finds, possibly in Pakistan (Kaghan), 1904–5, n.d. Many of the photographs are described on the reverse. They are further identified with negative nos. P87-280, P0101-0205.
217 leaves

B. Other papers, 1903-44 (MS. Eng.d.3408-9, e.3349)

MS. Eng.d.3408
'Personal narrative of travels in S.W. Persia (unrevised)', 1935–6. With:
(fols. 270–340) separate account of a journey in the same region, *c.*1935
(fols. 341–54) brief description of visit to the region between Tibet and China, *c.* 1935
i + 354 leaves

MS. Eng.d.3409
Miscellaneous papers, 1924–33, n.d. Includes:
(fols. 1–19) typescript copies of correspondence between Stein and his printers, Henry Stone & Son, 1924
(fols. 20–62) typescript copy with manuscript annotations of 'Paintings from the Caves of the Thousand Buddhas', a lecture delivered by Stein at the Freer Art Gallery, Washington, 6 Jan. 1930
(fols. 63–84) printed material, 1924–44
84 leaves

MS. Eng.e.3349
Postcards from Stein to F.H. Andrews, 1903–38
93 leaves

Archives relating to Sir Aurel Stein's Fourth Expedition to Central Asia (1930–31)

Helen Wang

Curator of East Asian Money, British Museum

English archives in the UK and USA

After his first three expeditions to Central Asia, Stein published a variety of books and articles. Stein's Fourth Expedition (1930–31) was beset with problems of all kinds and, having moved on to Iran, he did not publish a report of his last visit to Xinjiang. Nor did the American geologist Milton Bramlette (1896–1977), who was also a member of this expedition until he fell ill and was forced to return to base. Of course, Stein kept a diary and notes while in the field, and took photographs of the finds he was required to deposit at the British Legation in Kashgar before he left China, but for decades the records of this expedition lay largely ignored in archival collections. Since the 1990s, two people in particular have sought to document Stein's Fourth Expedition by consulting the English language archives. Shareen Brysac reconstructed the story of 'Sir Aurel Stein's fourth "American" expedition' by bringing together archives in the UK and the USA (at the Bodleian Library, Oxford; the British Library and the Royal Geographical Society, London; the Fogg Art Museum and other archives at Harvard and Georgetown University). Wang Jiqing, of Lanzhou University, has devoted years to these archive materials, tracking down Stein's photographic record and the finds he left at Kashgar. In 2004 he produced an annotated translation of Stein's diary of the expedition. The original handwritten diary is in the Bodleian Library, Oxford (a microfilm copy is also available at the British Library), and is not always easy to read. In the last few months I have been transcribing the diary myself, and can vouch for the enormity of his achievement.

Key references to the English archives

Brysac, Shareen Blair, 'Sir Aurel Stein's fourth "American" expedition', in H. Wang (ed.), *Sir Aurel Stein, Proceedings of the British Museum Study Day, 23 March 2002*, British Museum Research Publication 142, 2004, pp. 17–22, http://www.britishmuseum.org/research/research_publications/online_publications/sir_aurel_stein.aspx (accessed 23 October 2011).

Wang Jiqing, 'Photographs in the British Library of Documents and Manuscripts from Sir Aurel Stein's Fourth Central Asian Expedition in China', *British Library Journal*, vol. 24, no. 1 (Spring 1998), pp. 23–74.

Wang Jiqing, 'The Chinese texts aquired by A. Stein in his Fourth Central Asian exploration', *Journal of Dunhuang and Turfan Studies* (Peking University, in Chinese), vol. 3.

Wang Jiqing, *Sitanyin di si ci Zhongguo kaogu riji kaoshi*, Gansu jiaoyu chubanshe, Lanzhou, 2004 / 王冀青著《斯坦因第四次中国考古日记考释》兰州：甘肃教育出版社, 2004年.

Chinese archives in Xinjiang, China

There is also archival material in China. In 2007 the results of a collaborative project between the Xinjiang Uighur Autonomous Region Archives (中国新疆维吾尔自治区档案馆) and the Niya Site Research Agency of Bukkyo University, Japan (日本佛教大学尼雅遗址学术研究机关) were published in *Sidanyin di si ci Xinjiang tanxian dang'an shiliao* 斯坦因第四次新疆探险档案史料 / Archival *Historical Documents of Stein's 4th Exploring in Xinjiang*, by the Xinjiang

meishu sheying chubanshe, Urumqi, 2007 (ISBN 978-7-80744-088-8). This book gives a brief introduction to the archive collections in Xinjiang, and presents 108 documents from the period 1930–32 that were selected from those archives for the light they throw on Stein's Fourth Expedition, the Chinese opposition towards this expedition and Stein's eventual departure from China

Briefly, there are 107 archives in Xinjiang (1 at provincial/regional level, 14 at prefecture/city level, and 92 at county/district level) that together contain over 2.6 million files, mostly relating to the period after 1949. The Xinjiang Uighur Autonomous Region Archives is the provincial/regional level archives and was founded in October 1965. Located at 13 Sandaowan Road, Urumqi, it is the largest archive in Xinjiang, and contains 370,000 volumes of files, including 110,000 files dating from before 1 October 1949 (the establishment of the People's Republic of China): over 20,000 files from the Qing dynasty and 80,000 from the Republican period. The Qing dynasty files are mainly copies of imperial orders from the Kangxi, Yongzheng and Qianlong emperors to the Tuerhute (a Mongolian tribe) and files relating to the politics, economy, culture and military affairs of the Xinjiang Turfan Department and its branch organisations during the Guangxu and Xuantong periods. The Republican period files mainly relate to the government of Xinjiang province (as it was known between 1884–1955) and its branch organisations, and to the supervision of the frontier from 1912 to September 1949. These are arranged in 13 categories: the Kuomintang, regional government affairs, civil administration, judicial affairs, police service, local organisations, military affairs, foreign affairs, financial affairs, construction, communications, culture/education and Xinjiang special affairs.

Archives relating to Stein's Fourth Expedition to Xinjiang

In the book *Archival Historical Documents of Stein's 4th Exploring in Xinjiang* 108 documents are presented. Of these, 82 documents are from the Xinjiang Uighur Autonomous Region Archives (document numbers for these are given), and 26 are from other archival collections (the location and reference numbers for these are not given). Each document is illustrated in colour and has a trilingual caption in Chinese, Japanese and English. To give an idea of the contents of this book, brief details of each document are given below: a running number, the English caption as it appears in the book, the document's reference number, the number of pages, and the dimensions of the document. The documents are presented in chronological order.

1. Telegraph of Ministry of Foreign Affairs to the provincial government for permitting Stein to enter Xinjiang via India and survey in Xinjiang, Inner Mongolia, 6 May 1930.
[政2-1-328-180: 1 p., 18.6 x 28cm]

2. Lettergram of the provincial government to Kashi Administrative Office for permitting Stein et al. to enter Xinjiang, 12 May 1930.
[政2-1-328-181: 1 p., 22 x 27cm]

3. Lettergram of the provincial government to Ministry of Foreign Affairs for having ordered the border checkpoint to permit Stein's entry, 12 May 1930.
[政2-1-328-182: 1 p., 14.5 x 27cm]

4. Official letter of the Central Research Institute to Ministry of Foreign Affairs about the strict check of Stein's survey aim in Xinjiang, 20 May 1930.
[no ref. no.: 3 pp., 17.7 x 29cm]

5. Official letter of Ministry of Foreign Affairs to the Central Research Institute about Stein's having gotten his passport, 27 May 1930.
[no ref. no.: 5 pp., 15.5 x 27.6cm]

6. Official letter of the Central Research Institute to the Administrative Council for restricting Stein's activities from stealing and transporting antiquities abroad, 31 May 1930.
[no ref. no.: 3 pp., 18.8 x 29cm]

7. Official letter of the Administrative Council to the Central Research Institute about having given orders by telegraph to Xinjiang Provincial Government to keep watch on Stein's activities strictly, 4 June 1930.
[no ref. no.: 3 pp., 18.5 x 27cm]

8. Official letter of Xinjiang Resident Office in Nanjing to the provincial government for providing proper convenience to Stein's entry to Xinjiang, 2 Aug 1930.
[政2-2-1073-1: 3 pp., 23.1 x 27cm]

9. Telegraph of Shufu County to the provincial government for permitting Stein's entry requested by Britain Consul in Kashi, 24 August 1930.
[+2-1-329(2)-34: 1 p., 27 x 27cm]

10. Telegraph of the provincial government to Kashi Administrative Office for permitting Stein to enter Kashi at first and then discuss his survey, 26 August 1930.
[政2-1-329(2)-37: 1 p., 22 x 27cm]

11. Administrative Council's urgent message to the provincial government for allowing Stein to travel in Xinjiang, but forbidding him from excavating antiques, 21 Sept 1930.
[政2-2-900-8: 4 pp., 14 x 19.7cm]

12. Someone's telegraph to the provincial government for allowing Stein to travel in Xinjiang, but forbidding him from excavating antiques, 22 Sept 1930.
[政2-2-946-105: 4 pp., 12.5 x 17 (damaged)]

13. Ministry of Foreign Affairs' telegraph to the provincial government for allowing Stein to travel in Xinjiang but forbidding him from excavating antiques, 22 Sept 1930.
[政2-2-688-25: 1 p., 27 x 22.6]

14. Telegraph of the provincial government to the Council of Antique Protection for forbidding to travel in Xinjiang to do his archaeological work and its instruction to Kashi Administrative Office, 23 Sept 1930.
[政2-2-688-23: 1 p., 43 x 25cm]

15. Secretly telegraph of the provincial government to the Administrative Council and Ministry of Foreign Affairs about Stein's travel in Xinjiang, but forbidding him from excavating antiques, 27 Sept 1930.
[政2-2-688-27: 1 p., 20 x 24.5cm]

16. Secretly telegraph of the provincial government to Kashi Administrative Office for allowing Stein to enter Xinjiang, but restricting his activities, 27 Sept 1930.
[政2-2-688-29: 1 p., 35 x 24.8cm]

17. Telegraph of Kashi Administrative Office to the provincial government for allowing whether Stein would make his survey by his route, 8 Oct 1930.
[政2-2-688-19: 3 pp., 17.8 x 22cm]

18. Telegraph of Shufu County to the provincial government for allowing Stein to make his survey, 9 Oct 1930.
[政2-2-688-31: 1 p., 19.8 x 25cm]

19. Telegraph of the provincial government to Kashi Administrative Office for prohibiting Stein to take the main road from Kashi to Dihua and keep watch on his activities, 15 Oct 1930.
[政2-2-688-32: 1 p., 40 x 27cm]

20. Telegraph of Britain Consul in Kashi to the provincial government for permitting Stein to make his archaeological tour in desert, 15 Oct 1930.
[政2-2-902-22: 2 pp., 16.3 x 23.2cm]

21. Secretly telegraph of Kashi Administrative Office to the provincial government for reporting Stein's insisting on making his archaeological tour in desert, 18 Oct 1930.
[政2-2-688-42: 1 p., 41.3 x 27cm (damaged)]

22. Telegraph of the provincial government to Britain Consul in Kashi for inviting Stein to Dihua to discuss his tour route of survey, 20 Oct 1930.
[政2-2-902-24: 1 p., 22.5 x 26.5cm]

23. Telegraph of Shufu County to the provincial government for permitting Stein to take Yutian track via Yanqi to Dihua, 21 Oct 1930.
[政2-2-688-37: 1 p., 43 x 26.6cm]

24. Telegraph of the provincial government to Kashi Administrative Office for permitting Stein to take Yutian track via Yanqi to Dihua and send officials in company with him, 23 Oct 1930.
[政2-2-688-43: 1 p., 46 x 27.5cm]

25. Telegraph of the provincial government to Kashi Administrative Office for allowing to send Tao Mingyue in company with Stein to Dihua, 23 Oct 1930.
[政2-2-688-39: 1 p., 25 x 27cm]

26. Telegraph of the provincial government to Britain Consul in Kashi for permitting Stein to take Yutian track via Yanqi to Dihua, 23 Oct 1930.
[政2-2-1034-43: 1 p., 20 x 27cm]

27. Instruction of the provincial government to the diplomatic office about Stein's entry to the country, 29 Oct 1930.
[外 1-3-176-17: 1 p., 24.5 x 24cm]

28. Telegraph of Kashi Administrative Office to the provincial government about the request of Britain Counsel for permitting Stein to go travelling in Hotian and so on, 29 Oct 1930.
[政2-2-900-12: 2 pp., 27.8 x 23.8cm]

29. Official letter of Britain Consul in Kashi to the provincial government for permitting Stein to do the archaeological work in Xinjiang, 30 Oct 1930.
[政2-2-902-35: 4 pp., 16 x 24.5cm]

30. Lettergram of the provincial government to Kashi, Hotian Administrative Offices for forbidding Stein to excavate antiques, 7 Nov 1930.
[政2-2-742-71: 1 p.,44.7 x 28cm]

31. Instruction of the provincial government to the diplomatic office about forbidding Stein to excavate antiques, 10 Nov 1930.
[外 1-3-176-1: 1 p., 63 x 24cm]

32. Official letter of Britain Consul in Kashi for the provincial government for reporting Stein's starting on his journey to Hotian, 11 Nov 1930.
[政2-3-1125-58: 2 pp., 16 x 24.5

33. Shufu County's petition to the diplomatic office concerning Stein and Zhang Hongsheng's departure date from Kashi, 14 Nov 1930.
[外 1-3-176-18: 1 p., 57 x 25.6cm]

34. Telegraph of Shufu County to the provincial government for permitting Stein to start on his journey according to the original plan, 17 Nov 1930.
[政2-2-962-70: 1 p., 35 x 26cm]

35. Instruction of the provincial government to the diplomatic office for permitting Stein to enter Xinjiang, forbidding him to excavate antiques, 18 Nov 1930.
[外 1-3-176-10: 1 p., 105 x 24.5cm]

36. Instruction of the provincial government to the diplomatic office about Stein's having started his journey to the capital, 19 Nov 1930.
[外 1-3-176-5: 1 p., 64 x 24.6cm]

37. Official letter of the provincial government to Britain Consul in Kashi for permitting Stein to take Yutian track via Yanqi to the capital, 19 Nov 1930.
[政2-2-902-39: 1 p., 28 x 26.8cm]

38. Report of the Council of Antique Protection on Stein's archaeological work in China, 20 Nov 1930.
[政2-3-1145-10: 4 pp., 21 x 27.5cm]

39. Secretly telegraph of the provincial government to Shule County for permitting Stein to tour in Xinjiang and buy something no related to firearms, 20 Nov 1930.
[政2-2-962-72: 1 p., 30 x 25cm]

40. Instruction of the diplomatic office to the 4th and 6th branches of the public security bureau for forbidding Stein to excavate antiques, 20 Nov 1930.
[外 1-3-176-16: 1 p., 55.5 x 28.5cm (damaged)]

41. Secretly telegraph of the provincial government to Kashi Administrative Office for allowing Stein to take the track from Yutian via Yanqi to the capital, 21 Nov 1931.
[政2-2-900-14: 1 p., 40.5 x 27cm]

42. Petition of the Central Research Institute to the national government for withdrawing Stein's passport and ordering him to leave the country, 26 Nov 1930.
[no ref. no.: 7 pp., 17.2 x 26.3cm]

43. Instruction of the diplomatic office to Shufu County for Stein's starting his journey from Kashi, 3 Dec 1930.
[外 1-3-176-20: 1 p., 62.5 x 28.4cm]

44. Official letter of the Department of Civil Officials to the Central Research Institute for allowing to withdraw Stein's passport and order him to leave the country, 3 Dec 1930.
[no ref. no.: 3 pp., 17.6 x 27cm]

45. Telegraph of the Administrative Council to the provincial government for withdrawing Stein's passport and ordering him to leave the country, 19 Dec 1930.
[政2-2-684-15(1): 2 pp., 25.2 x 32cm]

46. Official letter of Xinjiang Resident Office in Nanjing to the provincial government for ordering Stein to leave the country and Jin Shuren's reply, 20 Dec 1930.
[政2-2-1074-94: 1 p., 23 x 32.5cm]

47. Secretly telegraph of the provincial government to the Administrative Council for ordering Stein to leave the country, 26 Dec 1930.
[政2-2-684-15(3): 1 p., 21 x 27cm]

48. Zhang Hongsheng's lettergram to the provincial government for reporting Stein's activities in Hotian, 28 Dec 1930.
[政2-2-976-26: 1 p., 52 x 23cm]

49. Secretly telegraph of the Administrative Council to the provincial government for ordering Stein to stop working and leave the country immediately, 28 Dec 1930.
[政2-2-685-59: 1 p., 32.2 x 27cm]

50. Petition of Ministry of Education to the Administrative Council about Stein's aim to enter Xinjiang and the survey of the provincial government, 29 Dec 1930.
[no ref. no.: 13 pages, 18 x 26cm]

51. Secretly telegraph of the provincial government to the Administrative Council for having ordered Stein to leave the country along the old road, 31 Dec 1930.
[政2-2-688-57: 1 p., 14 x 26.8cm]

52. Secretly telegraph of the provincial government to Kashi Administrative Office for ordering Stein to leave the country and prevent him from excavating antiques, 31 Dec 1930.
[政2-2-688-58: 1 p., 25 x 26.8cm]

53. Secretly telegraph of the Administrative Council to the provincial government for ordering Stein to leave the country immediately, 31 Dec 1930. [外 1-2-968-33: 1 p., 20 x 26.5cm]

54. Secretly telegraph of the Administrative Council to the provincial government for reporting Stein to leave the country immediately, 31 Dec 1930.
[外 1-2-968-36: 1 p., 23.5 x 26cm]

55. Telegraph of Kashi Administrative Office to the provincial government for reporting Stein to take Yutian track via Yanqi to the capital, 3 Jan 1931.
[政2-2-961-77: 1 p., 17.3 x 23.3cm (damaged)]

56. Secretly telegraph of the provincial government to the Administrative Council for having ordered all counties along the road to forbid Stein's activities and impel him to leave the country, 5 Jan 1931.
[外 1-2-968-37: 1 p., 10 x 26cm (damaged)]

57. Secretly telegraph of the provincial government to Kashi Administrative Ofice for ordering Stein to leave the country earlier, 6 Jan 1931.
[政2-2-961-78: 1 p., 20.5 x 27cm (damaged)]

58. Telegraph of the provincial government to Shufu County for having withdrawn Stein's passport and ordering him to go back home, 6 Jan 1931.
[外 1-2-968-38: 1 p., 31.5 x 27cm]

59. Secretly telegraph of Kashi Administrative Office to the provincial government for having informed Hotian Administrative Office to order Stein to leave the country, 7 Jan 1931.
[政2-2-965-40: 1 p., 19 x 26.7cm]

60. Secretly telegraph of the provincial government to the Administrative Council for impelling Stein to leave the country immediately, 8 Jan 1931.
[政2-2-696-88: 1 p., 22 x 26cm]

61. Telegraph of the provincial government to Kashi Administrative Office for impelling Stein to leave the country earlier, 12 Jan 1931.
[政2-2-965-38: 1 p., 20 x 27cm]

62. Instruction of the Administrative Council to Ministry of Education for informing that Xinjiang provincial government ordered all counties along the road to forbid Stein to do his archaeological work and compel him to leave the country, 13 Jan 1931.
[no ref. no.: 3 pp., 19 x 25cm]

63. Official letter of the Department of Civil Officials to the Central Research Institute about Xinjiang provincial government's order for Stein to leave the country, 15 Jan 1931.
[no ref. no.: 5 pp., 17.6 x 27cm]

64. Lettergram of the provincial government to Yutian County for advising Stein to go back home earlier, 28 Jan 1931.
[政2-2-976-29: 1 p., 21 x 26cm]

65. Jin Shuren's secretly petition to Jiang Gaishek for having ordered Stein to leave the country immediately, 28 Jan 1931.
[政2-2-1042-33: 1 p., 43 x 26.5cm]

66. Petition of the provincial government to the Administrative Council for having ordered Stein to leave the country immediately, 29 Jan 1931. [no ref. no.: 3 pp., 19.5 x 26cm]

67. Jin Shuren's reply to Yuan Fuli for having ordered Stein to go back home and his refusing to accept the medal conferred by Swedish king, 9 Feb 1931.
[政2-2-1098-35: 1 p., 40 x 27cm]

68. Instruction of provincial government to the diplomatic office for the Council of Antique Protection's exposing Stein's aim to come to China, 13 Feb 1931.
[外 1-3-176-21: 1 p., 293 x 24cm]

69. Zhang Hongsheng's lettergram to Jin Shuren about Stein's activities in Yutian, 15 Feb 1931.
[政2-2-1053-185: 3 pp., 27 x 19cm]

70. Lettergram of Qiemo County and others to the provincial government for reporting Stein to take the main road via Korla to Kashi, then go hack home, 15 Feb 1931.
[政2-2-972-119: 3 pp., 18 x 29cm]

71. Yuan Fuli's letter to Jin Shuren for understanding Stein's activities in Xinjiang, 18 Feb 1931.
[政2-2-1098-43: 3 pp., 17 x 25.3cm]

72. Yuan Fuli's letter to Jin Shuren for halting Stein's archaeological work in Xinjiang, 2 March 1931.
[政2-2-1098-7: 3 pp., 15.5 x 27.5cm]

73. Jin Shuren's reply to Yuan Fuli for stopping Stein's archaeological work, 3 March 1931.
[政2-2-1098-6: 1 p., 22 x 24.5cm]

74. Lettergram of the provincial government to Qiemo County for keeping the close watch over Stein's tracks, 10 March 1931.
[政2-2-972-121: 1 p., 23.5 x 27cm]

75. Lettergram of the provincial government to the resident office in Nanjing for reporting Stein to leave the country within the next few days, 11 March 1931.
[政2-2-1053-183: 1 p., 22 x 24cm]

76. Official letter of the provincial government to the resident office in Nanjing for reporting Stein to leave the country within next few days, 11 March 1931.
[政2-2-1074-93: 1 p., 26 x 26cm]

77. Telegraph of Kashi Administrative Office to the provincial government for asking Ministry of Foreign Affairs whether Stein would be allowed to continue to have his passport and travel in Xinjiang, 25 March 1931.
[政2-1-330-68: 1 p., 18.5 x 24.2cm]

78. Telegraph of the provincial government to Kashi Administrative Office for not having received the instruction for Stein to continue to travel in Xinjiang, 27 March 1931.
[政2-1-330-68(2): 1 p., 21 x 27cm]

79. Telegraph of Kashi Administrative Office to the provincial government for asking whether Stein would be allowed to continue to travel in Xinjiang, 26 April 1931.
[政2-2-964-10: 2 pp., 13 x 19cm]

80. Petition of the Council of Antique Protection to the Administrative Council for allowing to deport Stein in order to safeguard state sovereignty, 2 May 1931.
[no ref. no.: 5 pp., 19 x 28cm]

81. Telegraph of the provincial government to Kashi Administrative Office for not having received the telegraph of Ministry of Foreign Affairs for allowing Stein to continue to travel in Xinjiang, 4 May 1931.
[政2-2-964-9: 1 p., 25 x 27cm (damaged)]

82. Petition of Ministry of Education to the Administrative Council for asking Xinjiang provincial government to compel Stein to leave the country immediately, 6 May 1931.
[no ref. no.: 8 pp., 20 x 28cm]

83. Instruction of the national government to the Administrative Council for ordering Ministry of Foreign Affairs to withdraw Stein's passport and compel him to leave the country immediately, 6 May 1931.
[no ref. no.: 8 pp., 19 x 28cm]

84. Instruction of the national government to the Central Research Institute for withdrawing Stein's passport and compelling him to leave the country immediately, 6 May 1931.
[no ref. no.: 2 pp., 20 x 27cm]

85. Secretly telegraph of the Administrative Council to Jin Shuren for ordering Stein to leave the country, 11 May 1931.
[政2-2-696-97: 1 p., 40 x 25.5cm]

86. Instruction of the Administrative Council to Ministry of Education for ordering Xinjiang provincial government to compel Stein to leave the country immediately, 12 May 1931.
[no ref. no.: 2 pp., 20 x 28cm]

87. Instruction of the Administrative Council to the provincial government for ordering Stein to leave the country and detaining his obtained antiques, 13 May 1931.
[no ref. no.: 8 pp., 19.5 x 28cm]

88. Official leave of the Department of Civil Officials of the national government to the Central Research Institute for compelling Stein to leave the country and confiscating his obtained antiques, 15 May 1931.
[no ref. no.: 3 pp., 19 x 27cm]

89. Telegraph of the provincial government to the Administrative Council for compelling Stein to leave the country, 16 May 1931.
[政2-2-696-99: 1 p., 44 x 30cm]

90. Official letter of the Department of Civil Officials of the national government to the Central Research Institute for withdrawing Stein's passport and compelling him to leave the country, 25 May 1931.
[no ref. no.: 4 pp., 20 x 29.3cm]

91. Instruction of the provincial government to the diplomatic office for dealing with Stein's obtained antiques, 15 June 1931.
[政3-1-436-1: 1 p., 285 x 25cm]

92. Instruction of the provincial government to the diplomatic office for Stein's leaving the country, 18 June 1931.
[政3-1-436-34: 1 p., 53.5 x 24cm]

93. Instruction of the provincial government to the diplomatic office for Stein's leaving the country without antiques, 23 July 1931.
[政3-1-436-40: 1 p., 100 x 25.5cm]

94. Official letter of Ministry of Education to the Central Research Institute for allowing Britain Embassy in Nanjing to carry Stein's obtained antiques to be studied to London, 1 Aug 1931.
[no ref. no.: 3 pp., 18.6 x 26.5cm]

95. Official letter of Ministry of Foreign Affairs to the Central Research Institute for asking whether Stein would be allowed to carry his obtained antiques to London, 4 Aug 1931.
[no ref. no.: 3 pp., 18.6 x 27.5cm]

96. Official letter of Ministry of Education to the Central Research Institute for asking whether Stein would be allowed to carry antiques with him and leave the country, 22 Aug 1931.
[no ref. no.: 3 pp., 18.6 x 25.5cm]

97. Official letter of the Central Research Institute to Ministry of Education for informing Stein's obtained antiques would be transported to Beiping to be determined, 26 Aug 1931.
[no ref. no.: 2 pp., 18 x 27.5cm]

98. Official letter of Ministry of Education to the Central Research Institute for consenting to transport Stein's obtained antiques to Beiping, 31 Aug 1931.
[no ref. no.: 3 pp., 19 x 23cm]

99. Instruction of the provincial government to the diplomatic office for handing over all of Stein's obtained antiques to our side, 31 Aug 1931.
[政3-1-436-50: 1 p., 136 x 24.5cm]

100. Official letter of Ministry of Foreign Affairs to the Central Research Institute for asking Stein's obtained antiques to be examined nearby in Xinjiang, 8 Sept 1931.
[no ref. no.: 3 pp., 18 x 27.8cm]

101. Official letter of the Central Research Institute and Ministry of Education to Ministry of Foreign Affairs for asking Stein's obtained antiques would be transported to Beiping to be examined, 16 Sept 1931.
[no ref. no.: 15 pp., 18.5 x 28cm]

102. Official letter of the Central Research Institute and Ministry of Education to Ministry of Foreign Affairs for asking to refuse the request of Britain Consulate in Nanjing in order to take back Stein's obtained antiques, 13 Oct 1931.
[政3-2-1879-11: 1 p., 27 x 27cm]

103. Instruction of the provincial government to the diplomatic office to refuse the request of Britain Consulate in Nanjing in order to take back Stein's obtained antiques, 17 Oct 1931.
[政3-1-436-65: 1 p., 120 x 25cm]

104. Instruction of the provincial government to the diplomatic office for ordering Kashi Administrative Office to continue its negotiating in order to take back Stein's obtained antiques, 3 Nov 1931.
[政3-1-436-80: 1 p., 95 x 25cm]

105. Official letter of Ministry of Foreign Affairs to the Central Research Institute for having asked the provincial government to send officials to take over Stein's obtained antiques and transport them to Beiping, 3 Dec 1931.
[no ref. no.: 4 pp., 18.5 x 27cm // English translation: 3 pp., 21 x 27.5cm]

106. Instruction of the provincial government to the diplomatic office for informing Kashi Administrative Office to take over Stein's obtained antiques, 11 Dec 1931.
[政3-1-436-92: 1 p., 67.5 x 24.6cm]

107. Instruction of the provincial government to the diplomatic office for ordering to carry Stein's obtained antiques from Kashi to the capital then transport them to Beiping, 11 Jan 1932.
[政3-1-436-99: 1 p., 102 x 24cm]

108. Instruction of the provincial government to the diplomatic office for informing Kashi Administrative Office had transported Stein's obtained antiques to Dihua, 5 Sept 1932.
[政3-1-436-111: 1 p., 86 x 24.6cm]

A History of the Stein and Central Asian Digitisation Project at the British Museum

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Introduction

The Stein Collection at the British Museum is of world-renown and unique in many aspects. When it first arrived in Bloomsbury, the British Museum and the British Library were one and the same institution. In 1973, the British Museum and British Library became separate, independent, entities. The paintings and three dimensional artefacts were classed as objects and remained at the British Museum. The manuscripts were classed as texts or documents, and became part of the British Library.[1] The anomaly in this division of the collection was Stein's collection of coins, which had been associated with the manuscripts, but were transferred to the British Museum's Department of Coins and Medals.[2]

The digitisation of the British Museum's Stein Collection, and some other Central Asia-related material (collected and donated by Rudolf Hoernle,[3] George Eumorfopoulos,[4] C.P. Skrine[5] and Joseph Needham[6]) , began in 2000 and is still ongoing as this paper goes to press. It has been done in three stages, known within the British Museum as Stein One, Two and Three. Many people within the Museum and outside have been involved, and I hope that I have paid due credit to all those who have been so helpful in bringing this project to fruition.

Stein One included the major paintings and two-dimensional material. Stein Two encompassed most of the major three-dimensional material. Stein Three, which is still ongoing, includes the remainder of the three-dimensional material. Other projects included under the overall heading of the digitisation project involved the Dunhuang Textiles Project (a study of the Museum's Chinese and Central Asian textiles) and a translation project to ensure that the unique paintings should be made more accessible to a Chinese audience by having the metadata translated into Chinese.

Background to the Stein and Central Asian Digitisation Project

A large proportion of the Chinese material in the Stein Collection at the British Museum came from Cave 17 ('the hidden library') at the Mogao Buddhist Caves, about 25km south-east of Dunhuang, in Gansu province, China. Cave 17 was a side room accessed through Cave 16. A very large quantity of manuscripts, paintings and smaller items had been placed there in the 11th century, and had remained hidden away until their chance discovery in 1900. They were remarkably well preserved owing to a unique combination of factors; essentially they had lain untouched for 900 years in a dark dry cave in the desert climate at Dunhuang.[7] The contents of Cave 17 are now in various museums, libraries and holdings around the world: in China, France, India, Japan, Korea, Russia, the UK and USA.[8]

The material from Cave 17 acquired by Stein, together with the material collected by Hoernle, Eumorfopoulos, Skrine and Needham, includes over 320 paintings, plus many more fragments of paintings and murals, and about 1600 three-dimensional objects. These include some well-known textiles, wooden architectural fittings, pottery vases and figures, shoes, horses, pastries, tools (such as weavers' combs and beaters), paper flowers, Buddhist figures in stucco and on wooden, painted panels, and votive plaques. The collection is particularly important because it encompasses both Buddhist

and secular items dating back to the first millennium AD. These are unique and of outstanding importance in the history of Chinese Buddhist and secular art of the period.

The Joseph E. Hotung Gallery is the British Museum's main gallery devoted to the Asian collections. It is on the first floor of the King Edward building on the north side of the Museum. Originally known as the King Edward VII Gallery,[9] it was built in the early 20th century. When it opened to the public in May 1914, the first objects displayed in this gallery were those collected by Stein on his Second Expedition to Chinese Central Asia.[10] Today, material from the Stein Collection is displayed on the north side of this gallery to the right side of the entrance. A selection of architectural fittings, ceramics, and other three dimensional objects, including stucco sculpture, and coins are on permanent view. However, as there are large windows on either side of the Hotung Gallery this means that especially light sensitive material, such as textiles, woodblock prints and paintings which are amongst the rarest finds from Dunhuang, cannot be displayed. It has always been a policy of the Museum whenever practical, and in accordance with the observation of strict conservation protocols to limit the amount of handling any collection item receives to what is appropriate for its long term protection, to show this material to researchers, who have made a special advance request to see it.

It was therefore the need to 'showcase' this light sensitive material for the public that prompted the Museum to consider a project to digitise the collection. The aim was that it might then be viewed internationally by scholars and the general public alike, and at a standard that would enable the viewer to see it as effectively as viewing it with a magnifying glass in person. Although much of the material had been published in works of reference over the years, not least by Stein himself,[11] many of these publications were out of print and expensive. The latest publication on the British Museum's Stein Collection, was Roderick Whitfield's (then a curator at the Museum),[12] *The Art of Central Asia. The Stein Collection in the British Museum*, in three volumes, published *c.* 1982–1985, but these books, the photographs of which were also the copyright of the Japanese publishers and not the British Museum, were also out of print as the print run was fairly small.[13] His shorter book, *Caves of the Thousand Buddhas: Chinese Art from the Silk Route*, co-authored with Anne Farrer, also a curator at the Museum,[14] in 1990, was more generally available.[15]

The Museum had to raise money to pursue a digitisation project. The experience of the British Library in achieving external funding to set up the International Dunhuang Project (IDP) had demonstrated how such a successful collaboration could work and it was decided that the British Museum should also follow this route, if possible. Anne Farrer was involved in the project when it began in 1999, but after she left the Museum in 2000 I was put in charge of managing it and set about applying for funds from the Andrew Mellon Foundation, which at that time was funding the digitisation of Dunhuang manuscripts under the auspices of the IDP at the British Library for inclusion on ArtStor. Susan Whitfield, Head of the IDP at the British Library, was extremely helpful at every stage of this project, giving assistance and advice on how to apply for funds and with help on running the project generally.

Stein One

Having decided internally to do the project in stages, the Museum applied to the Mellon Foundation in 2000 for funds to begin by digitising the outstanding collection of 323 paintings. We applied on the grounds that the project would provide a new resource for academics, teachers, students and travellers interested in Stein and his discoveries. It would also benefit many institutions of learning including departments of history, art history, history of religion, history of medicine, Central Asian studies, Chinese studies, archaeology and conservation. We suggested that if we received the money it would allow access to a worldwide collection of international significance which, before, had been difficult for the general public to access, especially due to the conservation and handling restrictions that need to be imposed on the collection to ensure its long-term preservation. The project would provide quality assured documentation on the collection as the Museum's database, Merlin, would be updated with new information by scholars working on the digitisation programme. Their changes would go live on the public database soon after any changes and additions were made. It was also suggested that the project could stimulate innovative approaches to accessing and using global academic resources both effectively and efficiently. It is well known that the British Museum and the British Library, as well as other institutions with holdings of Dunhuang and Central Asian material, have a great number of fragmentary woodslips (early texts written in ink on strips of wood) and painting fragments. Publishing them on line might make it possible to recognise 'virtually' those pieces that 'belonged' together and subsequently to publish them as 'reunited' entities.[16]

The first tranche of money was secured from the Mellon Foundation in 2001 and Stein One ran from 2001–2. I was appointed the Project Director overall, supervising the management of the project on behalf of the Museum, in addition to my other curatorial duties. The intellectual input of the project was administered by an Administrative Assistant, working on a full time basis for a year, and this post was advertised and eventually filled by Lilla Russell-Smith, a Central Asian art-historian.[17] Lilla worked on selecting the order in which the paintings were to be digitised, organizing their transport to the photographic studio, writing up the Merlin database entries and was generally in charge of the day-to-day running of the project. For the metadata, she followed the detailed entries for the paintings written by Roderick Whitfield in *The Art of Central Asia*, volume 1, but put them in an abbreviated form.

New digital photography

The Museum's photographers trialled a number of digital scanning backs for the project and decided on a Phaseone digital back. The supplier of this camera back, DTEK Systems, then provided training, through Tony Bhalla, in digital back software. As a result of this, the Department of Asia (known then as the Department of Oriental Antiquities),[18] was the first department in the Museum to use

digital photography and the skills of our two photographers involved in the project, John Williams and Kevin Lovelock, were then 'cascaded' down to all other photographers in the Museum, which now uses digital photography for all Museum work.

Involving other departments in the museum

The stitching together and manipulation of digital images was another technique which had to be acquired by the Museum. This was skilfully done by Martin Buttery and Dolors Grau-Vilaseca of the Museum's New Media Unit, led by Matthew Cock.

The production of so many images on CDs also provided the catalyst for addressing the question of long-term storage of so many new images within the Museum. This problem was eventually resolved by the creation of another database, the Digital Assets database, which was formed at this time specifically to store the Stein images but was later expanded to include images of all British Museum material.

Another department which was heavily involved in all stages of the digitisation project was that of the Documentation section of the British Museum, and here Tanya Szrajber, Head of Documentation, provided invaluable help. New terminology needed to be inserted into the database both for use by Mellon on their own database, as well as by the British Museum, and expanded lists of place names and other technical matters associated with the much enlarged metadata were needed for the project. Tanya, together with Peter Main, was also heavily involved in the necessary restructuring of the database to accommodate the new fields necessary for the Chinese language input and to help resolve the problems of inputting in a foreign script. Our project assistants worked very closely with Tanya[19] on all the data work relating to this project.

During the year of running this part of the project the Museum not only gained new camera equipment and knowledge, it also acquired various new computers and programmes with the ability to write Chinese, and money for books associated with the Stein project generally. In return, the Mellon Foundation requested that the digitised material should be available in a format on our database in a way that would allow us to extract certain fields that could then be used on their own database. It was agreed that images of the objects would be provided to Mellon for their use along with information about the object and a caption for detailed shots. These images were stitched and manipulated by our New Media Unit staff and then CDs containing the photographic images were combined with metadata in Excel form and sent in batches on a regular basis to Mellon. Mellon had agreed to fund several Stein projects around the world and intended to collate this material within one global database. At the same time, the British Museum agreed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) in 2001 with the British Library for collaboration with the IDP that included the IDP adding the above material to their website. (In the long run, the Mellon International Dunhuang Archive (MIDA) has been merged into ArtStor, available on subscription only, and the British Library is now the lead institution in collating the images and data on the various Stein collections around the world under the leadership of Susan Whitfield.)

Conservation of Stein material

An important issue which emerged during this first part of the digitisation project was that of conservation, an aspect which continued to be important at all stages of the project. The issue was first flagged up when we began to look at the fragments of murals and paintings. Karen Birkhölzer, then Senior Conservator, Inorganic Material Section,[20] in the British Museum's Department of Conservation, Documentation and Science (now renamed as the Department of Conservation and Scientific Research), was involved in this process. It was obvious that the fragments needed to be backed and mounted before photography would be possible. It soon became apparent that our conservation studio could not cope with all the extra work this entailed, let alone the conservation of the silk paintings and fragments, without further assistance so it was suggested that a Chinese conservator from the Shanghai Museum might be invited to come and help with this process. Mrs Qiu Jinxian,[21] Conservator of Eastern Pictorial Art, had been at the British Museum since April 1988 and it was agreed that her former colleague at the Shanghai Museum, Mrs Zu Pingfang should come to London to work on a four-month contract to help conserve and mount the Stein fragments. It took many months to organise this visit, because of visa complications and other issues, before Mrs Zu eventually arrived in 2002. Her highly skilled work involved removing previously applied backings, subsequently considered inappropriate.[22] We also purchased new housing for this newly conserved material which is now stored in specially made storage cabinets and boxes. It was decided that the conservation of the mural fragments would have to wait until later in the project.

Stein Two

With the successful completion of this first part of the project, the Museum decided to apply to Mellon for a further grant to digitise the three dimensional Stein material amounting to over 1000 objects. We reckoned it might take up to three years to digitise these and in the event Mellon decided only to fund a further year. This inevitably meant that the project had to be scaled down. As the grant clearly could not cover photographing and cataloguing all the 3D material it was decided to concentrate on the major items, which were thought to include around 600 items, excluding many of the textiles. We received money from the Mellon Foundation for this further one year grant in late 2002.

Project assistant and data management

Cecilia Braghin, a Sinologist, was appointed as the project assistant for Stein Two, and worked in the British Museum from April 2003 to June 2004.[23] She surveyed, then selected which textiles and three-dimensional artefacts should be included in the project and moved these in batches to the photographic studio. She also worked with the Museum's New Media Unit whose staff did the manipulation of the images and burned them onto CDs, the contents of which are now on the Museum's Digital Assets database, linked to the Merlin database. Cecilia was responsible for the final approval and identification of the images and for composing the metadata which went with each image, including its

Chinese title.

The process followed was the same as Stein One: first, digital photographs were taken of the objects, and subsequently manipulated by our New Media Unit staff. The photographic images (TIFF) were then combined with metadata in Excel form, burned on CDs and sent to Mellon in batches on a regular basis. A sample CD was sent to Mellon at the beginning of the project to make sure the quality of the images and the data attached to them responded to their requirements. Upon agreement, the rest of the material was digitised. This amounted to approximately 100 textiles and 450 other 3D objects from the Stein collection. All these images are now on the Museum's Digital Assets database.

Photography of Stein Two objects

Digital photography was again carried out by the two British Museum photographers attached to the Department of Asia, John Williams and Kevin Lovelock.

Rather than buying a new camera for Stein Two it was found that attaching a new camera back (a Phaseone H25) to another British Museum Sinar P2 camera, sufficed. Other expenses in the photographic budget included an additional G5 MAC computer with attached monitor to enable both photographers to work simultaneously on the manipulation of the images. We also had to replace pieces of lighting equipment.

It took some time and experimenting to set up the process of photographing 3D objects, rather than flat 2D items as for the paintings. Dealing with objects of different shapes and sizes meant the photographers had to spend time on moving the objects around, arranging them on stands or mounts and setting up camera and lighting appropriate to the individual pieces. This was a more complicated process than with the paintings but was compensated for by the fact that many items were photographed in groups, rather than singly. As it was possible to photograph a considerable number of objects in groups, we digitised a greater number of objects than was achieved in Stein One. However we burned fewer CDs during Stein Two than Stein One, because textiles and three-dimensional artefacts, are, over-all, smaller in size than paintings, and therefore take less electronic space which meant that more images could be stored on one CD.

Two versions of each image were processed: a master image and a cropped image. Two versions of each CD were sent to Mellon, amounting to 118 CDs in total.

Conservation of Stein Two objects

During Stein Two, a major conservation programme was carried out on the textiles in the Stein Collection, which, except for routine conservation checking, had not been looked at for about twenty years. These needed treatment and/or mounting before photography was possible. We appointed Thordis Baldursdottir, a textile conservator, for fifteen months to work exclusively on the Stein material. Cecilia and Thordis surveyed all the Stein textiles at the British Museum and organised the conservation work in stages, so that the material could be ready in batches to suit the photographers' schedule. We also acquired new storage cabinets with wide drawers suitable for housing long banners and streamers. The conserved textiles are now stored in ideal conditions, which combine maximum safety with easy accessibility. After finishing her work at the British Museum on Stein Two, Thordis then went to work on the Stein textiles at the V&A for nine months.

Other initiatives connected to the Stein material and the Digitisation Project

Other initiatives involving the Stein Collection in the period 2000–11, and using money from the Mellon Foundation, included the translation of much of the metadata of the major Stein paintings into Chinese in order to make the Museum's database as accessible as possible, particularly to a Chinese audience. We looked into the question of hiring a Chinese assistant to work on this translation in the Museum. However, in view of the difficulties of obtaining work permits, it was decided instead to send the material to be translated in China, engaging staff in the IDP Centre at the National Library of China in Beijing to do this translation work for us. A Chinese assistant, Zhang Wenhui, who was temporarily based at the British Library,[24] gave us additional help in inputting the Chinese captions into the Excel files. We retained Cecilia's services for an additional few months to manage this work and to input the new and translated material into the Merlin database. She identified which paintings should be singled out for translating into Chinese in an expanded form and liaised with the Lin Shitian at the National Library of China over the translation work.[25]

Each major painting is now accompanied by detailed information in Chinese and English. This includes the name of the painting, a description of the painting, its size, inscriptions on the painting, and also bibliographic references. We were able to use the full text from Roderick Whitfield's entries in *The Art of Central Asia*, which were then used as the source text for the translation into Chinese.

I should also like to acknowledge the assistance of my former colleague, Mary Ginsberg, a curator in the Department of Asia, who was extremely helpful at all stages of the Stein digitisation project. She not only contributed to the many cross-departmental meetings that were organized in relation to both Stein One and Stein Two, but provided essential continuity throughout the project, working with both Lilla and Cecilia.

Digitisation of the textiles

Another stage of the Stein digitisation project, separate from the work funded by Mellon, emerged when Carol Michaelson re-encountered Professor Zhao Feng at a Metropolitan Museum seminar in New York in 2000. Professor Zhao was then Vice-Director of the Hangzhou Silk Museum,[26] and Professor of Textile Technology at Donghua University, Shanghai. He is a world expert in Chinese silk and textile technology, and it became apparent that if the British Museum could arrange the necessary financing Professor Zhao was willing to come to the Museum to work on the textile fragments in the Stein Collection. Over the next year, Carol Michaelson applied for and obtained a British Academy grant which would pay for Professor Zhao's work, subsistence and airfares, and the British Museum agreed to house Professor Zhao in the Museum's visitors' flat.[27]

Although it is associated with Stein Two, this project was not funded by Mellon, and thus can be seen as a separate project. Details of this project are given at the end of this paper.

Stein Three

The last stage in the process of digitising the Stein collection began in 2011 and will finish in late 2012. The Mellon fund for Stage Two had not been entirely exhausted, and it had been agreed with the Mellon Foundation that the Museum could retain the money for the future hire of a staff member to complete the documentation and digitisation of the remaining 3D material in the Stein Collection and related Central Asian material. The total number of objects in Stein Three is about 1360. The post was advertised and Catrin Kost, whose doctoral work had focused on Chinese archaeology, was hired in April 2011 to research and manage the day to day running of this project, under the general supervision of Clarissa von Spee, Curator of Chinese Paintings, who had taken over the management of the Stein Collection on Carol Michaelson's retirement from full time work at the British Museum in 2008.

This particular part of the project has again benefitted considerably by input from the IDP at the British Library. This collaboration was carried out under a renewal of the 2001 MoU between the British Museum and the British Library for adding the new material onto IDP, alongside the material previously entered from the earlier two stages. Because there were insufficient resources at the British Museum for photography during this period, the IDP provided a photographer, Rachel Roberts, to come to the British Museum to carry out the work in situ. The IDP used funding from a grant at the Research Institute of Korean Studies at Korea University to help fund Rachel (as the IDP staff are externally funded) and also sought additional individual donations to enable the work. The images are taken according to the IDP's high standards, also using a Phase One digital back on a medium format camera, and with at least one recto and one verso shot per object. If required, angle shots are also taken, so that sometimes there may be five or more images per object. These are then uploaded into the British Museum's Digital Assets database. This thorough photographic documentation should ensure that these fragile objects should need to be handled much less frequently in the future as they will be recorded so clearly on the database. The images, along with metadata updated by Catrin Kost and additional metadata prepared by the IDP, are also available on the IDP website. As part of this project, and with funds from the World Collections Programme, Hu Wanglin (of the Xinjiang Institute of Archaeology), and Mandira Sharma (of the National Museum Institute, New Delhi), who have been based at the British Library, have also helped with this work at the British Museum.[28]

Conservation issues relating to Stein Three

Catrin has spent much time collaborating with colleagues in the Department of Conservation and with Museum Assistants in the Department of Asia in order to ensure the best possible storage conditions for the objects. The majority are now stored in drawers with many of the individual objects set inside foam cushions customised (cut-out) for each item to prevent object movement during the opening and closing of the drawers. The precise metric measurements of each object have also been checked, and noted on the Merlin database. The conservation and stabilization of the wall painting fragments (mentioned above in Stein One), as well as various groups of material, were undertaken at this stage of the project.

Completion of the Stein and Central Asian Digitisation Project

By the end of 2012 we will have successfully completed the digitisation of the majority of the items in this world-renowned collection of Central Asian material thanks to the generosity of the Mellon Foundation, the British Academy, the dedicated staff at the British Museum and specialist visitors, and the continued assistance and practical support of the International Dunhuang Project at the British Library.[29] We are delighted that the collection will be easily accessible to the world in pictures and in English text, and, importantly, with the metadata of a wide range of this material having been translated into Chinese for those readers more comfortable in that language.

The Dunhuang Textiles Project

As mentioned above, this project was funded separately from the Stein and Central Asian Digitisation Project. The recipient of a British Academy grant, Zhao Feng arrived in the UK on 18 April 2006. He had intended to leave around the middle of August, however, on arrival, and having ascertained that there would be more work to do on the textiles than he had envisaged, he arranged to stay an extra month and left the UK on 19 September. During these months, Professor Zhao arranged for two of his PhD students, Ms Wang Le and Xu Zheng, to join him in London and work with him on this project. The combined efforts and expertise of this team immeasurably increased the number of textiles that were able to be digitised.

Summary of the work carried out

Zhao Feng, Wang Le and Xu Zheng analyzed and studied approximately 250 complete textiles and approximately 400 fragments in the Stein and Central Asian Collections at the British Museum. The textiles date from the Han dynasty (206 BC–AD 220) to the end of the Tang dynasty (AD 618–906). The team wrote detailed descriptive and technical information about all the complete textiles, in both English and Chinese. Where it was possible to reconstruct their original pattern or original shape, this was done, using a computer programme, and recorded on the British Museum's Digital Assets database. The team also took microphotographs of the textiles (it is possible to see and count the weft and warp threads), where the original photography, which pre-dated the Stein digitisation project, was thought to be inadequate or not available, and these were also put onto the Museum's Digital Assets database. They used their own photographic equipment to do this digital photography; the Museum's photographers were not involved in this particular part of the project.

Whilst in London, they also studied the Dunhuang textiles in the Stein Collection at the V&A Museum (around 200 pieces), and the many textiles which were used to wrap or tie

manuscripts in the Stein Collection at the British Library.

Another generous donor to the Museum, Tim Simon, who has an interest in the Silk Road, kindly provided additional financing for this project via the Pidem Trust, of which he is a trustee. This additional money enabled Zhao Feng to spend a short period of time in Central Asia and Russia studying Central Asian textile materials there. These materials included textiles (around 56 pieces) in the Oldenberg Collection[30] at the State Hermitage Museum, St. Petersburg.

New information on textile technology

The team's detailed examination of the textiles from Dunhuang revealed some important technological information. Different types of textiles with different weave structures were identified, including warp-faced compound tabby (plain weave) and twill, weft compound twill, damask on tabby (plain weave) and twill damask, simple and complex gauze, different types of brocades, embroidered textiles in chain-, split-, satin- and couch-stitches, and clamp resist-dyed silk tabby (plain weave). Most of these textiles can be compared with other textiles excavated from along the Silk Road. The detailed and systematic investigation of the BM's Dunhuang textiles therefore provides us with sound data for comparison. It also provides new information about the history of the interaction of Chinese and Western Asiatic methods and the spread of textile technology in Central Asia from the first century to the 9th century.

New light thrown on art history

The detailed study of the textiles and the reconstruction of the textile patterns can also be used as comparative material for other works of art found along the Silk Road; for instance, the murals, the metal work and pottery figures. The Dunhuang textiles thus help to flesh out some of the missing artistic heritage of the Silk Road by showing common decorative patterns that had only been partially preserved in other media. Some new patterns were identified that had not seen before. This offers great potential for future research in art history. The findings are now available in Chinese and English on the British Museum's Digital Assets and Merlin databases, and on Collections Online (the online version of Merlin, accessible on the British Museum website).

Publications relating to the Dunhuang Textiles Project

Prior to Professor Zhao's arrival at the British Museum in April 2006, Helen Persson had completed her work on the Stein textiles at the V&A (following conservation work by Thordis Baldursdottir, textile analysis and cataloguing by Helen Persson and Sonia Solicari, and photography of all the pieces). The question of a joint publication covering the Dunhuang textiles in the Stein collections in the British Museum, V&A and British Library was raised independently by Zhao Feng, Helen Wang (British Museum), Helen Persson (V&A) and Frances Wood (British Library). Zhao Feng offered to arrange publication by the Donghua University Press, Shanghai, and a year later the book *Textiles from Dunhuang in UK Collections* was in print. Two separate editions were produced: one in Chinese and one in English.[31] The Chinese edition was launched at the 'Silk Road Art and Life' conference, in Hangzhou in April 2007. The English edition was launched at the 'A Hundred Years of Dunhuang, 1907–2007' conference in London in June 2007.

Donghua University's project 'A Comprehensive Study of Dunhuang Textiles', was one of the key publication projects of China's Eleventh Five Year Plan.

The catalogue of the Dunhuang textiles in France has already appeared, with separate Chinese and French volumes, and an English edition is imminent.[32] These are the textiles collected by Paul Pelliot, and housed in the Bibliothèque nationale de France and the Musée Guimet, Paris. Catalogues of the Dunhuang textiles in Russia, India and China are also planned.

Website information

The British Museum's website www.britishmuseum.org.uk has links to the IDP's multilingual websites, where the British Museum's holdings are viewable alongside other collections relating to Stein and Central Asia. Together these websites provide an illuminating insight into Silk Road life during the first millennium AD, for scholars and general readers alike.[33]

Notes

1 For details of the history of the collection, H. Wang, H. Persson and F. Wood, 'Dunhuang Textiles in London', in Zhao Feng et al. (eds), *Textiles from Dunhuang in UK Collections*, Donghua University Press, Shanghai, pp. 12–21 (and in this volume); also H. Wang and J. Perkins (eds), *Handbook to the Collections of Sir Aurel Stein* in the UK, British Museum Research Publication 129, London, 2008, http://www.britishmuseum.org/research/research_publications/online_research_publications/handbook_stein_collection.aspx (accessed Jan 2012).

2 For the history of the coins collected by Stein, see Chapter 3 of H. Wang, *Money on the Silk Road. The Evidence from Eastern Central Asia to c. AD 800*, British Museum Press, London, 2004, especially Chapter 3.

3 Rudolph Hoernle (1841–1918), Orientalist, See Ursula Sims-Williams' article in this volume.

4 George Eumorfopoulos (1863–1939), collector. See R. L. Hobson, *The George Eumorfopoulos Collection, 11 vols*, Ernest Benn, London, 1925–32.

5 Sir Clarmont Percival Skrine (1888–1974), British consul in Kashgar, 1922–24. See D.C. Waugh and U. Sims-Williams, 'The Old Curiosity Shop in Khotan', *The Silk Road 8* (2010), pp. 69–96, accessible on http://www.silkroadfoundation.org/newsletter/vol8/ (accessed Jan 2012); and D.C. Waugh, 'The Mysterious and Terrible Karatash Gorges: Notes and Documents on the Explorations of Stein and Skrine', *The Geographical Journal vol. 163 no. 3* (Nov 1999), pp. 306–20.

6 Joseph Needham (1900–1995), renowned for his multi-volume series *Science and Civilization in China*, 1954 onwards.

7 See F. Wood and M. Barnard, T*he Diamond Sutra: the story of the world's earliest dated printed book*, British Library, London, 2010,

8 See the IDP website http://idp.bl.uk/ .

9 This gallery was refurbished and renamed in 1992 to reflect the generous donation of Sir Joseph E. Hotung.

10 *See Guide to an Exhibition of Paintings, Manuscripts, and Other Archaeological Objects, collected by Sir Aurel Stein, K.C.I.E., in Chinese Turkestan*, British Museum, 1914 (57 pp.). The Introduction to this Guide is reproduced in H. *Wang, Sir Aurel Stein in The Times*, Saffron Books, London, 2002, pp. 143–5; along with The Times coverage of this exhibition (2, 5, 7, 8 May 1914), pp. 62–8.

11 See H. Wang, 'Sir Aurel Stein – Bibliography', in H. Wang and J. Perkins (eds), *Handbook to the Collections of Sir Aurel Stein in the UK, op. cit.*, pp. 50–9.

12 Roderick Whitfield was a curator at the British Museum from 1968 to 1984, when he became the Percival David Professor of Chinese and East Asian Art, School of Oriental & African Studies, London. See D.M. Wilson, *The British Museum*. A History, British Museum Press, London, 2002, p. 393.

13 R. Whitfield, *The Art of Central Asia. The Stein Collection in the British Museum*, 3 vols, Kodansha International in co-operation with the Trustees of the British Museum, New York, c.1982–5.

14 Anne Farrer was a curator at the British Museum from 1984–2000; see D.M. Wilson, *The British Museum. A History, op. cit.*, p. 385.

15 Roderick Whitfield and Anne Farrer, *Caves of the Thousand Buddhas: Chinese Art from the Silk Route*, British Museum Press, London, 1990.

16 Wang Tao (School of Oriental and African Studies, University of London) and Frances Wood (British Library) organised a workshop in London in 2004 to do precisely this, with grants received from the Sino-British Fellowship Trust, and the Chiang Ching-Kuo Foundation for International Scholarly Exchanges, and published the results in Wang Tao, Frances Wood and Hu Pingsheng (eds), *Unpublished Chinese Wooden Slips in the British Library*, Shanghai cishu chubanshe, Shanghai, 2007.

17 Lilla is now the Curator for Central Asian Art, at the Museum für Asiatische Kunst, Berlin.

18 The Department was renamed in 2003.

19 Tanya's single minded pursuit of excellence and unfailing loyalty to Merlin has earned her the affectionate nickname as 'the Rottweiler' of data standards at the Museum.

20 She is now Conservator: Stone, Wall Paintings and Mosaics.

21 Mrs Qiu retired from full time work in August 2011. She is known to her Chinese-speaking colleagues, of all ages, as Xiao Qiu ('Young/ Little Qiu')..

22 The method was devised by Stanley Littlejohn (1877–1917), conservator at the British Museum. See Laurence Binyon and Sidney Colvin, 'The Late Stanley William Littlejohn', *Burlington Magazine*, vol.32, 1918, pp.16–19, summarised on National Portrait Gallery website http://www.npg.org.uk/research/programmes/directory-of-british-picture-restorers/british-picture-restorers-1630-1950-l.php. For a history of the collection, see the paper by Wang, Persson and Wood in this volume.

23 After this formal period of employment was over, Cecilia continued to help with entries on the Merlin database.

24 Ms Zhang Wenhui, as subject librarian at the Institute of Archaeology, Chinese Academy of Social Sciences, Beijing, was an intern working on the IDP from March 2003 for one year, funded with a Chinese government grant.

25 Saren Gaowa translated from the Japanese version; Li Defan (edited the Chinese), and Lin Shifan then checked the Chinese text against the English version.

26 He is now the Director, and the Hangzhou Silk Museum is now known as the China National Silk Museum.

27 This building was demolished in 2011 to make room for the British Museum's new World Conservation and Exhibitions Centre (WCEC).

28 As part of the World Collections Programme, the International Dunhuang Project Internship Programme offered a series of internships at the IDP to provide training in digitisation for young professionals in China and India. See http://www.britishmuseum.org/about_us/skills-sharing/world_collections_programme/international_dunhuang_project.aspx (accessed Jan 2012).

29 The two last remaining groups of objects collected by Stein that still await digitisation are the potsherds (in the Department of the Middle East), and the coins (in the Department of Coins and Medals).

30 Sergei Fedorovich Oldenburg (1863–1934) led two expeditions to Central Asia. For details, see the IDP website http://idp.bl.uk/pages/collections_ru.a4d .

31 Zhao Feng et al., Textiles from *Dunhuang in UK Collections*, Donghua University Press, Shanghai, 2007.

32 Zhao Feng et al., *Textiles de Dunhuang dans les collections françaises*, Donghua University Press, Shanghai, 2010.

33 I should like to thank Helen Wang for her invaluable help at every stage of the writing of this paper.

Dunhuang Textiles in London:
A History of the Collection

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We can satisfactorily tackle only finite things in this world, — and a study of Chinese textile art would at present belong to the infinite category if taken up as a whole![1]

Introduction

Sir Aurel Stein (1862–1943) visited Dunhuang in 1907 and 1914. Here, at Qianfodong, the Caves of the Thousand Buddhas, the Chinese monk Wang Yuanlu revealed to him the hidden library in Cave 17, which had been sealed at the beginning of the eleventh century. The contents of that library are well-known: in particular, the paper documents in various languages and scripts, and the exquisite paintings on silks.[2] Less attention has been paid to the textiles, and it was therefore with great pleasure that we welcomed Professor Zhao Feng and his assistants Wang Le and Xu Zheng to work on the collections of Dunhuang textiles in London in the summer of 2006.

Our introduction aims to explain some of the background to the textiles from Dunhuang that are now in London. First, we offer a concise history of the three institutions in which those textiles are now housed: the British Museum, the British Library (which includes the India Office Library) and the Victoria and Albert Museum. Second, we offer an outline history of the Stein Collection. Stein made four Central Asian Expeditions, visiting Dunhuang on the Second and Third Expeditions.[3] Although the Dunhuang textiles in London are from the Second Expedition only, we have prepared a concise history of the finds from the first three expeditions for the sake of clarity. Third, we offer a survey of the work that has been done on the textiles in the three institutions subsequent to their publication by Stein.

The British Museum, the British Library, the India Office and the V&A

The British Museum

The British Museum has its origins in the vast collections of Sir Hans Sloane (1660–1753). When Sloane died, a parliamentary act (the British Museum Act of 1753) was passed to purchase his private collection of 80,000 objects and select a board of trustees who would be responsible for preserving it and making it publicly accessible. Other important collections were added to the Sloane collection, including the library of the family of Sir Robert Bruce Cotton. The Museum was open to the public, and a reading room was provided in which scholars could consult the library. For over 200 years the library of printed books and manuscripts was a major department within the Museum (with a Sub-Department of Oriental Manuscripts). In 1972, the British Library Act was passed by Parliament, bringing the Library into operation from July 1973, and the British Museum's library became part of the newly formed British Library. Non-textual material remained in the British Museum. The Museum's collection of Asian antiquities was first housed in the Department of Antiquities, and as the collection grew a Sub-Department of Oriental Antiquities was established in 1921. There was also a Sub-Department of Oriental Prints and Drawings (created in 1912) within the Department of Prints and Drawings. In 1933 these two sub-departments were brought together to form the Department of Oriental Antiquities. With some

reconfigurations, this was renamed in 2003 as the Department of Asia.

The British Library

The British Library was created in 1972 from several institutions with the most significant being the British Museum's printed books and manuscript departments. In this way, the manuscript material (including the Chinese scrolls, with their silk attachments) collected by Sir Aurel Stein was transferred from the British Museum to the British Library. In 1982, the India Office Library and Records were also deposited with the British Library, bringing the Stein collection of Tibetan and Khotanese documents in to join the Chinese manuscripts from Dunhuang. The new department was first named the Oriental and India Office Collections (OIOC). Thus, the Stein collection that is now in the British Library has been moved several times: from the Stein Collection (British Museum) to the Oriental and India Office Collections (British Library). OIOC has had three addresses since 1982: Store Street, London WC1 (1982–1990), Orbit House, Blackfriars, London SE1 8NG (1991–1998), and St Pancras, Euston Road, London NW1 2DB (1998 – to present day). OIOC was re-named Asia, Pacific and Africa Collections (APAC) but is now known as Asian and African Studies.

The India Office

The India Office was the successor of the East India Company (founded in 1599). In 1858, after the Mutiny, the East India Company was transferred to the Crown (Her Majesty's Government), under the name of The India Office. The India Office functioned like the Foreign and Colonial Office, handling Indian affairs in the UK for the Government of India. After Indian independence in 1947 the India Office was subsumed into the Foreign and Colonial Office. The India Office Library together with its manuscript and archive collections was incorporated into the British Library in 1982.

The Victoria and Albert Museum

The Victoria and Albert Museum has its origins in the Great Exhibition of 1851. Profits from the Exhibition were used to found the Museum of Manufactures, and to purchase some of its exhibits to form the basis of the new Museum's collections. Its founding principles were to make works of art available to all, to educate working people and to inspire British designers and manufacturers. The Museum moved to its present site in 1857 and was renamed the South Kensington Museum. Its collections (including textiles) expanded rapidly, and new buildings were constructed as semi-permanent exhibition halls, as necessary. In 1880, the holdings of the India Museum were also formally transferred to the South Kensington Museum. In 1899 Queen Victoria laid the foundation stone of a new building designed to give the Museum a grand façade and main entrance. To mark the occasion, it was renamed the Victoria and Albert Museum, in memory of the enthusiastic support Prince Albert had given to its foundation.

Outline history of the Stein Collection

Having studied Sanskrit, Old Persian, Indology, and philology at the universities of Vienna, Leipzig, and Tübingen (1879–84), and map-making as part of his military service in Budapest, Aurel Stein had set out for a career in India. His formal positions were as registrar of Punjab University and principal of the Oriental College, Lahore (1888–99), and principal of the Calcutta Madrasah (1899–1900). But his real interest lay in the 'archaeological exploration' of Central Asia, China, India, Iran, Iraq and Jordan.[4]

Stein's Central Asian Expeditions were funded by various institutions for which he promised to collect archaeological and textual artefacts. The intention was that the finds would eventually be allocated proportionately to the funders. Stein's First Expedition (1900–1) was funded by the Government of India and the Governments of Punjab and Bengal,[5] and it was agreed that the finds should be studied in London and allocated to specific museums later. His visits to Dunhuang occurred on his Second (1906–8) and Third Expeditions (1913–16). The Second Expedition was funded 60% by the Government of India and 40% by the British Museum, and the finds were to be allocated accordingly. The Third Expedition was funded entirely by the Government of India. The intention was that the majority of finds from this expedition should go to a new museum in New Delhi, and that representative specimens and 'literary remains' should be presented to the British Museum.[6]

However, before any 'division' of finds took place, every attempt was made to keep them together so that they could be studied, catalogued, photographed and published. This often took many years, involved representatives from different institutions, and some decisions had to be deferred owing to the Second World War.[7]

Stein's aim was to publish fairly quickly his own 'personal narrative' of the latest expedition. These were based on his personal diaries and published as *Sand-buried Ruins of Khotan* (1903) and *Ruins of Desert Cathay* (1912).[8] Then, after extensive study and cataloguing of the finds, he would publish a more scholarly 'scientific report' which also included work by specialists in different disciplines. These are the well-known titles: *Ancient Khotan* (1907), *Serindia* (1921) and *Innermost Asia* (1928). For both types of publication, he needed a base for the collection and for those managing and working on the collection.[9] The British Museum provided such facilities from the time of Stein's First Expedition. His assistant, Fred Andrews, worked on the finds from all three Expeditions, in London and in Kashmir, thereby providing a steady continuity to Stein's work.

It is often assumed that the finds from Stein's three Central Asian Expeditions came to London in their entirety, and that they were worked on at the British Museum, as part of the British Museum collection. As this is not an accurate assumption, we have tried to outline the history of the collection below. It is important to understand that although the Stein Collection occupied part of the British Museum premises in Bloomsbury, it was not part of the British Museum's collection until specific pieces had been formally acquired by the Museum, usually after lengthy negotiation with the India Office. Until the formal division of finds was

made, the Stein Collection was merely based at the British Museum, and Stein allowed pieces to be removed for study purposes to different people in different locations. His assistants at the Stein Collection kept records of which pieces were removed, so that they could collect them back in later.

Finds from the First Expedition
The finds from Stein's First Expedition (1900–1) were sent to London, where Stein worked on them in a room lent by the British Museum's Indian Antiquities section. The Government of India then recommended that Dr Rudolf Hoernle, together with the British Museum, should determine the distribution of the finds.[10]

Finds from the Second Expedition
The finds from Stein's Second Expedition (1906–8) were also sent to London. They were initially stored at the Natural History Museum (then part of the British Museum) in January 1909,[11] until facilities for the 'Stein Collection' on the British Museum site in Bloomsbury were ready. Stein was disappointed with these facilities, and asked if the Collection might remain at the Natural History Museum, or if there might be alternative accommodation available at the Indian Museum (under the aegis of the V&A).[12] Although investigations were made, his request was turned down, chiefly because of the major transformations that the South Kensington museums were undergoing at that time.[13]

On 5 August 1909 the finds from the Second Expedition were eventually delivered to the Stein Collection, British Museum. The 'Stein Collection' was kept separate from the Museum's permanent collections, and had its own lock and key, as well as its own staff, of whom Fred Andrews and Miss F.M.G. Lorimer were the most important. Although they worked more or less independently on the Stein Collection, they consulted with both Museum staff and with specialists outside the Museum.

After the cataloguing work had been completed, in preparation for the publication of *Serindia* (1921), came the negotiations over the division of finds. Those pieces allocated to the British Museum were formally transferred from the Stein Collection to the British Museum collection in 1917 and 1919 (see below). The finds allocated to the Government of India were removed from the British Museum on 12 February 1919, and sent to the India Office (London), prior to shipment to India.

However, it appears that the finds were not shipped to India immediately, and that they remained in the India Store Depot in London. The publication of Fred Andrews' article 'Ancient Chinese figured silks' (1920)[14] and Stein's *Serindia* and *The Thousand Buddhas*[15] (both 1921) must have prompted a re-opening of the discussion over the finds, for in March 1923 they were back on the British Museum premises, and were transferred in summer 1923 to facilities at the V&A, where Fred Andrews was 'absorbed wholly by the examination, division and re-packing of the antiquities forming the Indian Government's share of the finds' from the Second Expedition.[16] The finds were then repacked, and the majority of crates were sent back to the India Store Depot in October 1923. It would seem that the textiles from the Second Expedition were removed from the rest of the finds at this stage. The V&A applied to the Government of India for a loan of the textiles, and this was approved in December 1923. Three cases, said to contain paintings on silk, were temporarily stored in the bomb-proof store at the V&A, and were removed to the British Museum facilities in September 1924, presumably for comparison with finds from the Third Expedition, some of which were sent from Kashmir to London in 1924.[17]

Finds from the Third Expedition
The finds from the Third Expedition (1913–16) were sent to Srinagar, Kashmir. Fred Andrews and Miss Lorimer moved to Srinagar, and worked on the Stein Collection in a specially built annexe at the Andrews' house there (the wall paintings were housed separately at Lahore).[18] In December 1919 the Government of India agreed that the manuscripts should be transferred to London for study purposes. The India Office, London, was the appropriate location, but there were queries over lack of working space there, and they were probably transferred to the British Museum for examination and cataloguing.[19]

In 1924, some other groups of objects, including textiles, were also transferred from Kashmir to London for the preparation of the plates for the volume *Innermost Asia*. Fred Andrews returned to London to do this work, with the assistance of Joan Joshua, who treated, mounted and restored the textiles. Here, in facilities again provided by the British Museum, 'he directed and supervised the proper treatment and illustration of hundreds of specimens of ancient textiles'.[20] In his Introduction to *Innermost Asia*, Stein wrote 'If the many extremely delicate and fragile objects recovered from the desert sands and ruined sites of the most arid parts of Asia survive in future the effect of wholly different climatic conditions, it will be largely due to the special treatment it was possible to secure at the British Museum'.[21]

The textiles were temporarily removed from the British Museum facilities prior to publication, and in May 1925 Stein wrote that the 'ancient textiles which are reproduced in my *Innermost Asia* are still at Banbury [near Oxford] with the blockmakers [Messrs Henry Stone and Son]'.[22]

In June 1932 the V&A received some textiles (from Astana and Loulan) from the Stein Collection (then at the BM facilities), on loan from the Government of India.[23]

It would seem that the rest of the textiles were sent to India, and that in May 1933 a further group of textiles (from Astana, Kharakhoto and Karakhoja) were brought from India to London on formal loan from the Government of India to the V&A.[24]

Who worked on the Dunhuang textiles from the Second Expedition?

Fred Andrews and Miss F.M.G. Lorimer were the key people working at the Stein Collection on the finds from the Second Expedition. Andrews was employed to work on the Stein Collection on a part-time basis, and had to manage this alongside his main employment as Director of the Art Department, Battersea Polytechnic (London) and subsequently as Director of Industrial Art Education (Kashmir). Miss Lorimer was employed on a full-time basis. They were in regular contact with the staff working on the

Museum's permanent collections, and with other specialists outside of the Museum.

For the textiles, in addition to writing out the 'slips' (slips of paper on which they wrote detailed notes in preparation for the catalogue entries in *Serindia*),[25] other tasks included conservation of the textiles, including finding suitable silk fabric as backing, and finding appropriate dyes for the task.[26] For these tasks, Andrews and Lorimer consulted with the Museum's staff: Miss Winter (repairs to textiles), Mr Goodchild (working on silk), Mr Littlejohn (paintings conservator).[27] Specialists from outside the Museum were also consulted: Professor Julius von Wiesner (1838–1916) of Vienna, expert on Persian textiles and Central Asian paper, and his student Dr T.F. Hanausek (1852–1918), who worked on microscopical analysis of characteristic fabric specimens from different sites, the results of which were included in the Descriptive Lists in *Serindia*, and Prof. Summerville.[28] Prof. Josef Strzygowski (1862–1941) advised on the influence of textile products from Iran.[29] Raphael Petrucci (1872–1917) was also consulted over the selection of objects for illustration in *Serindia*.[30] Andrews, Lorimer and Stein sought out publications that might be relevant to the textiles from Dunhuang. These included Eugène Chartraire's comparison of a silk piece in the V&A with a piece in the Cathedral at Sens (Burgundy, France) that had links with textiles from Dunhuang;[31] and Prof. Otto von Falke's study of the influence of designs from Khorasan or the Oxus region on Persian figured silks.[32]

At that time, Fred Andrews' main employment was at the Battersea Polytechnic. When he found it difficult to combine this with his preferred work on the Stein Collection, Stein arranged for him to select materials from the Stein Collection at the British Museum and take them to the Polytechnic to work on them there.[33] Although his chief task was to examine the textiles and write up the 'slips', Stein also encouraged Andrews to make drawings of the fabrics, insisting that he was the ideal person to do this.[34] From the correspondence between Stein and Andrews, it is clear that he enjoyed this work, discovering the intricate details, patterns and techniques of the woven silks:

> With regard to the drawings of textiles, these are progressing as quickly as possible, and the most difficult are being done first. I know from experience how much time is consumed in finding the scheme of patterns on damasks (which are all in one colour) and gauzes.[35]
>
> As an instance of what may turn up, one pattern now nearly worked out measures about 2 feet square. This was quite unsuspected, and is a white silk damask banner top painted rather roughly with the usual seated B [Buddha]. The painting hides so much of the woven pattern that I had overlooked it. Another has an almost invisible woven pattern of a fine decorative peacock about 10" to 12" high. Yesterday only I found another white silk banner top with a large pattern but so confused with the paint on it, that I have not been able to make out the scheme. But of course I shall try. All these large patterns are quite new to me (and I think I have a fairly wide acquaintance with pattern) and I am sure should be carefully done. [36]

But he struggled to find time away from his work at the Polytechnic, and the demands of preparing the plates for *Serindia*, and eventually engaged a number of draughtsmen to help him. We do not know their names, only that there was one woman and one German among them.[37] Whilst there is no doubt that Stein understood the importance of detailed examination of the textiles, Stein urged Andrews to work as quickly as possible:

> As regards the textile patterns kindly concentrate your efforts – & your drawings on the absolutely essential. Else the risk is great of the whole remaining a torso. It is enough for you to have bravely faced a new line of research. Serindia cannot exhaust this enquiry which would need a monograph.38

While Stein carried out his Third Expedition in Central Asia (July 1913–February 1916), Andrews and Lorimer remained at the 'Stein Collection' at the British Museum. Stein continued work on *Serindia* after his return from the Third Expedition.

Who worked on the textile finds from the Third Expedition?

Fred Andrews and Miss Lorimer moved to Kashmir to work on all the finds, including textiles, from the Third Expedition. Andrews later returned to London, where he continued to work on the textiles, with the assistance of Joan Joshua. *Innermost Asia* was published in 1928. There are no specific references to external help on the textiles, except from Lionel Giles, of the British Museum, who worked on the inscriptions on silk textiles from Astana.[39]

Why are the Dunhuang textiles in London in three different institutions?

To some extent, the current location of the Dunhuang textiles is associated with the history of the institutions: in particular, the creation of the British Library and the incorporation into the British Library of collections from the British Museum and the India Office Library.

However, the current locations are also associated with how the finds from Stein's Expeditions were allocated. Although the guiding principle was that the finds should be allocated proportionately to the funder(s) of each Expedition, there were other criteria. For example, Dunhuang paintings from the Second Expedition were to be divided between India and the British Museum, mainly on the basis of style, although the system was complicated by arguments about relative fragility and less than ideal conservation methods or storage.[40] The Government of India generally agreed that the 'literary remains' could stay in London, usually for reasons of study or conservation. These were to be divided on the basis of language and script: the Chinese textual material went to the British Museum (now in the British Library), and non-Chinese languages and scripts to the India Office (subsequently incorporated into the British Library).

The Dunhuang textiles from the Second Expedition now in the V&A are there as a result of the loan agreement between the V&A and the Government of India (represented by the Director-General of Archaeology) signed on 19 December 1923.[41]

Research on the Dunhuang textiles in the three institutions

Dunhuang textiles in the British Museum

The Dunhuang textiles at the British Museum consist of canopies, valances, banners and banner parts (headers and streamers), covers and ties, patchwork, polychrome weaves (Jin silk, Sogdian samite, Liao samite, brocade, and textiles in two-colours), monochrome weaves (damask on plain weave, twill damask, gauze, other), dyed textiles (clamp-resist dyed), painted silk, and embroidery (split stitch, satin stitch, couching). These were first published in *Serindia* (1921). Selected pieces have since been published by curators of the Museum's Department of Oriental Antiquities: Roderick Whitfield (1983),[42] Roderick Whitfield and Anne Farrer (1990)[43] and Shelagh Vainker (2004).[44] The late Alf Crowley, and more recently Mrs Qiu Jinxian, formerly of the Shanghai Museum, have also worked on the conservation of the silk paintings (including hundreds of fragments of silk paintings) from Dunhuang in the British Museum collection.

In line with the Museum's aim to create digital records and images of its collections, several people have worked on the digitisation of the collections of Sir Aurel Stein since 2000. They include Carol Michaelson (co-ordinator), Lilla Russell-Smith (on 2-D objects), Cecilia Braghin (on 3-D objects) [these projects were funded by the Andrew W. Mellon Foundation], and Zhao Feng, Wang Le and Xu Zheng (on textiles) [this work was funded by the British Academy].[45]

Other researchers have also consulted the collection, but on the whole, the notion of 'Dunhuang textiles in London' is more closely associated with the V&A collection (where the Stein collection consists mostly of textiles) than with the British Museum collection (where textiles are seen as part of the Stein and Central Asian collections). We are delighted that the British Museum, V&A and British Library collections of Dunhuang textiles have been brought together in this catalogue.

Dunhuang textiles in the Victoria and Albert Museum

At first the V&A arranged its collections according to material. In this way, all textiles, no matter their country of origin, were housed in the Department of Textiles. Although the India Museum collections were left intact until 1955,[46] the Far Eastern collections were incorporated into the V&A from 1908, and the textiles collected by Stein, on loan from the Government of India, were thus incorporated into the V&A's Department of Textiles. However, this led to a very particular approach to Asian materials; for example the Department of Textiles had a strong interest in the techniques of textile production.[47] It was not until the creation of the Far Eastern Section in 1970, and the consequent transfer of the East Asian textiles together with other pieces collected by Stein, that a more contextual approach to the material began.

At first glance many of the textile fragments appear to be scraps, cut-offs from larger pieces, or rejects, but closer examination reveals that most of them once formed part of votive objects such as banners and sutra wrappers. The Stein collection at the V&A does not include any of the larger banners and beautiful silk paintings such as may be found in the British Museum and the National Museum of India in New Delhi. It was these more famous pieces that attracted the attention of researchers, and at times the material at the V&A was left somewhat in the background. Nevertheless, the V&A loan collection offers a fascinating insight into the scope of fabrics being produced in, as well as imported into, China before the early 11th century. It is also a marvellous resource for the study of weaving. The woven textiles comprising the Dunhuang textiles are almost exclusively silk and demonstrate a range of plain weaves, satins and beautifully subtle damasks, and vibrant polychrome pattern woven silks such as figured gauzes, brocading and samites. Many of these have been further decorated with embroidery, clamp-resist dyeing and painting. The textiles also show an incredible wealth of colour, from canary yellow through the clearest red to deepest indigo.

The collection clearly proves the intensity of the silk trade in northwestern China during the centuries before the cave was sealed. Dunhuang lay on the main route along which Chinese silk was traded into Central Asia and to the West, and textiles from silk producing regions in the West, for example textiles of Sogdian manufacture, were traded in the East.

Canopies, altar valances and a number of complete and fragmented banners are evidence of the importance of this shrine site as one of China's great Buddhist pilgrimage complexes. While some of the smaller fragments were undoubtedly devotional, others may originally have had a more secular use.[48]

Studies of the V&A Stein loan collection

The textiles from Dunhuang have been in and out of the limelight, largely owing to the driving forces of particular members of staff at the V&A. Over the decades, changing attitudes to the interpretation of objects has also affected how the collection is viewed. The Stein textiles have mainly been studied from a technical viewpoint and they were often overlooked as the focus in museums shifted to a more discursive scholarship on the meanings of objects.

Albert Frank Kendrick (1872–1954), Keeper of the Textile Department at the V&A from 1898, who zealously campaigned for a loan of the Stein textiles in the 1920s and 1930s, was also the first to draw attention to the Stein collection in a publication. In his *Catalogue of Early Medieval Woven Fabrics* (1925)[49] he discussed the possible origin of the roundel design with reference to some of Stein's finds from Dunhuang. He also mentioned Stein's textile finds in the book *Chinese Art* (1935).[50]

Some years later, John Lowry, Deputy Keeper of Indian collection until 1982, outlined the changing style and design of textiles of the Han and Tang dynasty in the *CIBA Review* (1963),[51] and selected a few Dunhuang fragments from the V&A to illustrate this transformation. In the late 1960s Peter Collingwood, a specialist on tablet-weaving, discovered the magnificent resource that was the Stein loan collection,[52] and Mme Krishna Riboud of AEDTA [Association pour l'Etude et la Documentation des Textiles d'Asie] also came to study the Stein collection several times.[53] However, both appear to have paid more attention to materials from sites other than Dunhuang.

Another prominent V&A textile specialist, Donald King, Keeper of the Department of Textiles 1972–93, published just one article on the Stein loan collection, in *Bulletin du CIETA* [Le Centre International d'Etude des Textiles Anciens] (1968),[54] in which he focussed on the weaving technique of warp-faced compound weaves. However, he left a file full of notes with technical analyses on many of the textile fragments and may have intended to publish this more extensive research. Unfortunately his notes are written in a very abbreviated style, which is now partly undecipherable.

During the 1990s a number of papers and publications, featuring fragments from the V&A Stein collection, were written by V&A curators and external scholars. Most notable from the V&A were Amanda Ward, then Senior Museum Assistant in the Far Eastern Section, and Verity Wilson, formerly Curator in the Far Eastern Section. Wilson's article in *Textile History* (1995) provides an excellent introduction to the collection with several suggestions for further study.

The eminent Chinese textile scholars Wang Xu and Wang Yarong of the Chinese Academy of Social Sciences visited the V&A several times in the late 1980s to study the Stein loan collection. Anna Muthesius also studied the textiles, but from a more Western point of view, and argues strongly for the cross-cultural exchange evident in the fragments from the Silk Road.[55]

The new T. T. Tsui Gallery (a display focussing on China) opened in 1991; two banners and a canopy from Dunhuang were included in the section of the gallery labelled 'Temple and Worship'. These were also discussed in the catalogue accompanying the new gallery.[56] A selection of the textiles from the Stein loan collection was displayed in Gallery 98 between 1997 and 2011.

The 1990s saw a renewed interest in the textile fragments and new research paths were introduced, largely owing to the enthusiasm of Verity Wilson. This in turn led to the extensive work on the Stein Mellon Textile Project. With funding from The Andrew W. Mellon Foundation, the textile fragments were photographed and catalogued in 2003. The work was done by curators Helen Persson and Sonia Solicari, photographers Colin Maitland and conservator Thordis Baldursdottir. The collection will be accessible on MIDA, a section of ArtStor, as well as on the British Library's International Dunhuang Project website stein-collection and the V&A's own Collections Online website (http://www.vam.ac.uk/page/s/stein-collection). The continued support of The Andrew W. Mellon Foundation has enabled conservation work and improved storage conditions for the textile collection.

The project has already excited a degree of international research interest and has attracted several renowned visitors. These include Chhaya Bhattacharya-Haesner from the Museum für Indische Kunst, Berlin, and Yasuhiko Ogawa, who studied a handful of the silk ties from Dunhuang in 2004, as well as non-sinologist visitors, such as the Embroiderers' Guild. Now that the emphasis has shifted from the technical aspects of the textiles to embrace other disciplines, it is clear that the Stein collection represents a valuable resource for, say, economic, social and ethnographical studies.

Helen Persson has co-ordinated much of the work on the Stein textiles in recent years, and was already preparing to publish her own research on this collection. It was therefore an excellent and timely opportunity to work together with Zhao Feng, Wang Le and Xu Zheng on the Dunhuang textiles in the V&A in the summer of 2006. The results are published in *Textiles from Dunhuang in UK Collections*.

Dunhuang textiles in the British Library

The British Library is not the sort of institution where you would expect to find many Chinese textiles and those that exist in the collections have been largely ignored for nearly a century. Yet from the moment the paper scroll, rolled on a wooden roller, became the standard 'book' format in China, textiles were included in the form of ties, joined to the retaining rod and used to keep the scroll tidily in place when not in use. Amongst the thousands of paper scrolls collected by Sir Aurel Stein from the Qianfodong or Caves of the Thousand Buddhas near Dunhuang, are some 150 textile ties made from hemp or various types and colours of silk.

Most of the objects that he collected from Cave 17 which are now in the British Library, are documents written, or in rare cases, printed, on paper. Until very recently, their significance to scholars has lain solely in their contents and their physical aspects such as format and materials have only now become the focus of study.[57]

One of the first to publish on the physical aspects of the documents was Jean-Pierre Drège who pioneered work on paper types and book formats, although he did not venture into the area of textiles; neither did Li Zhizhong of the Rare Book Section of the National Library who was also interested in the history of book formats.[58] The textile parts of a typical scroll were accepted without investigation until Dr Yasuhiko Ogawa made his first visit to the British Library in 2004 with the specific aim of examining the silk braids and ties surviving on some of the Dunhuang scrolls.[59] He started his survey on the basis of the 35 scrolls with braids or ties still attached that are listed in Lionel Giles' catalogue of Dunhuang manuscripts which was published in 1957.[60]

As Dr Ogawa noted, Giles' list of scrolls with attached textiles was not complete, furthermore, Giles' catalogue only lists some 7000 Chinese items out of a total which is almost double that number. Though we have no record of Giles' working practice when he was assigned the job of cataloguing the Chinese documents from Dunhuang in 1919, it appears both from his catalogue and from the arrangement of the material he left uncatalogued, that he was aware of a far greater number of textile fragments in the entire corpus. Giles catalogued the scrolls that were relatively complete, often with titles or colophons that made identification possible. He must have made a preliminary division between these and the more difficult, fragmentary material that was placed in large blue boxes and put aside for many decades. These crumpled papers were known as 'the Stein debris' until the late 1980s when, with the financial support of the British Council and the Sino-British Fellowship Trust and the expertise of the Chinese conservators, Du Weisheng, Zhou Peiyuan, Dai Liqiang and Shao Zhuangwen, the 'debris' was smoothed and safely re-housed and elevated to the new name of 'Stein fragments'.[61] That Giles had made some attempt to

sub-divide the 'debris' was clear for there are some 112 textile fragments, all grouped together between S.10853 and S.11961. Though there are some tiny pieces of painted silk (S.11428) which must have become detached from a larger painting or banner and a few hempen scroll covers (S.11468), the majority of these pieces are retaining rods which have become detached from the rest of the scroll, but still have a fragment of silken tie or braid neatly looped around them.

Amongst the India Office Stein materials, four previously unlisted hemp banners (Add. Or. 5222–5) were discovered as the India Office Library prepared to move from Blackfriars into the new British Library building in 1998, thus adding to the number of known textile pieces in the British Library.[62]

Professor Zhao Feng and his team have examined the full range of these British Library textile fragments in detail and, though their interest is in the textiles themselves, we hope that their work may help to shed further light on the history of the 'book' format in China.

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Notes

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1 Letter from Stein to F.H. Andrews, 8 Dec 1912, Bodleian Library, Stein MSS 40/173.

2 See, for example, http://idp.bl.uk [the website of the International Dunhuang Project at the British Library] and http://www.thebritishmuseum.net/thesilkroad [featuring specimens from the collections of Sir Aurel Stein at the British Museum].

3 Stein was forced to abort his Fourth Expedition, and all finds were left in China.

4 J. Mirsky, *Sir Aurel Stein. Archaeological Explorer*, University of Chicago Press, 1977; and A. Walker, *Aurel Stein. Pioneer of the Silk Road, John Murray, London*, 1995.

5 M.A. Stein, Ancient Khotan: *Detailed Report of Archaeological Explorations in Chinese Turkestan*, Clarendon Press, Oxford, 1907, p. vi. [reprinted by Hacker Art Books, New York, 1975]

6 M.A. Stein, *Innermost Asia: Detailed Report of Explorations in Central Asia, Kansu and Eastern Iran, Clarendon Press*, Oxford, 1928, p. xvi (reprinted by Cosmo Publications, New Delhi, 1981).

7 See for example, F. Wood, 'Two thousand years at Dunhuang', in S. Whitfield and F. Wood (eds), *Dunhuang and Turfan: Contents and Conservation of Ancient Documents from Central Asia* (British Library Series in Conservation Science 1), London, 1996, pp. 1–6; also F. Wood, 'Aurel Stein, the British Museum and the India Office', in S. Whitfield and U. Sims-Williams (eds), *The Silk Road: Trade, Travel, War, Faith, British Library*, London, 2004, pp. 91–95; and H. Wang, Sir Aurel Stein in The Times, Saffron Books, London, 2002.

8 Stein did not publish a 'personal narrative' of the Third Expedition.

9 For lists of the correspondence, see Diamond and Rogers paper in this volume; J. Falconer et al., *Catalogue of the Collections of Sir Aurel Stein in the Library of the Hungarian Academy of Sciences*, LHAS/British Museum, Budapest, 2002; and H. Wang (ed.), *Sir Aurel Stein in The Times*, Saffron Books, London, 2002.

10 British Museum Central Archives, Stein Papers, CE32/23/5.

11 British Museum Central Archives, Stein Papers, CE32/231. The Natural History Museum was founded in South Kensington in 1881, and became the new location for the British Museum's natural history collections. The Natural History Museum remained under the Board of the British Museum Trustees until the British Museum Act (1963), when the Natural History Museum became fully independent.

12 British Museum Central Archives, Stein Papers, CE32/23/23/2.

13 M. Conforti, 'The idealist enterprise and the applied arts', in M. Baker and B. Richardson (eds), *A Grand Design: the Art of the Victoria and Albert Museum*, V&A Publications, London, 1997, pp. 23–48, esp. p. 45.

14 F.H. Andrews, 'Ancient Chinese figured silks excavated by Sir Aurel Stein at various sites of Central Asia', *Burlington Magazine for Connoisseurs* (in 3 parts), vol. 37, no. 208 (July) 1920), pp. 2–10; vol. 37, no. 209 (Aug 1920), pp. 71–77; and vol. 37, no. 210 (Sept 1920), pp. 147–52.

15 M.A. Stein, *Ancient Buddhist Paintings from the Caves of the Thousand Buddhas on the Westernmost Border of China*, B. Quaritch, London, 1921.

16 V&A Stein Archives, letter from Stein to C.H. Smith, 19 February 1923; also a note from A.F. Kendrick, dated 14 March 1923. Kendrick was Keeper of Textiles at the V&A, 1897–1924.

17 V&A Stein Archives, Memo, 3 October 1923.

18 A. Walker, *op. cit.*, p. 234.

19 *Innermost Asia*, p. xv.

20 *Innermost Asia*, p. xv–xvi,

21 *Innermost Asia*, p. xvi.

22 V&A Stein Archives, letter from Stein to A.J.B. Wace, 18 May 1925. Wace was Deputy Keeper of Textiles, V&A, 1924–34. See also *Innermost Asia*, p. xix.

23 V&A Stein Archives, receipt of loan of textiles from the Government of India, 14 June 1932.

24 V&A Stein Archives, letter from the Office of the High Commissioner for India to the Board of Education, 20 April 1933; also signed loan agreement, 4 May 1933.

25 For examples of slips written by Miss Lorimer and/or an unidentified person on textiles see Bodleian Stein MSS 62/154–160.

26 There are samples of fabrics in the Stein archive at the Bodleian [Stein MSS 39/17 and 39/23], and comments on them; see letter from Stein to Lorimer, 16 March 1910 [Bodleian Stein MSS 38/18].

27 For Miss Winter see letter from Stein to Lorimer 16 March 1910 [Bodleian Stein MSS 38/18]; for Mr Goodchild see letter from Stein to Andrews, 13 April 1910 [Bodleian Stein MSS 39/26]; for Mr Littlejohn see letter from Andrews to Stein, 28 Feb 1913 [Bodleian Stein MSS 41/56].

28 For references to Prof von Wiesner and Hanausek see *Ancient Khotan*, pp. xiii, 135, 307, 571, 426; also M.A. Stein, *Serindia: Detailed Report of Explorations in Central Asia and Westernmost China*, Clarendon Press, Oxford, 1921, pp. xix, 673 (reprinted by Motilal Banarsidass, New Delhi, 1980). For Prof. Summerville see letter from Stein to Andrews 17 March 1911 [Bodleian Stein MSS 39/44].

29 *Serindia*, p. 902, n.2.

30 Letter from Andrews to Stein, 21 June 1912 [Bodleian Stein MSS 40/39].

31 *Serindia*, p. 908; also E. Chartraire, 'Les tissus anciens de la cathedrale de Sens', *Revue de l'Art Chrétien*, vol. 61 (1911).

32 *Serindia*, p. 908; also Otto von Falke, *Kunstgeschichte der Seidenweberei*, Verlag Ernst Wasmuth, Berlin, 1913.

33 Letter from Stein to Andrews, 26 Sept 1909 [Bodleian Stein MSS 37/196].

34 Letter from Stein to Andrews, 9 April 1910 [Bodleian Stein MSS 39]; letter from Stein to Andrews 15 Dec 1911 [Bodleian Stein MSS 39/64]; letter from Stein to Andrews, 18 Nov 1912 [Bodleian Stein MSS 40/148].

35 Letter from Andrews to Stein, 31 Oct 1912 [Bodleian Stein MSS 40/132].

36 Letter from Andrews to Stein, 31 Oct 1912 [Bodleian Stein MSS 40/132]

37 Letter from Stein to Andrews, 25 Nov 1912 [Bodleian Stein MSS 40/165] and from Andrews to Stein, 6 Dec 1912 [Bodleian Stein MSS 40/172].

38 Letter from Stein to Andrews, 17 Feb 1913 [Bodleian Stein MSS 41/24].

39 *Innermost Asia*, p. xvii and Appendix I 'Chinese Inscriptions and Records'.

40 There are references to the fragility of some silks, for example in a letter from Stein to Andrews, 13 October 1910; Andrews to Stein, 6th

June, 1913; and in a letter from Stein to F.C. Drake, Secretary of the Revenue Department in the India Office, 12th July, 1913. These letters are in the Bodleian Library, Oxford.

41 See V&A Archives, MA/1/S3242.

42 R. Whitfield, *The Art of Central Asia. The Stein Collection in the British Museum, vol. 3. Textiles, Sculpture and Other Arts*, Kodansha International, Tokyo, in co-operation with the Trustees of the British Museum, 1983.

43 R. Whitfield and A. Farrer, *Caves of the Thousand Buddhas: Chinese Art from the Silk Route*, British Museum Publications Ltd, London, 1990.

44 S. Vainker, *Chinese Silk: a Cultural History*, British Museum Press, London, 2004.

45 For example, see http://www.thebritishmuseum.net/thesilkroad.

46 See R. Skelton, 'The Indian Collections, 1798–1978', *Burlington Magazine*, vol. 120, no. 902 (May 1978), pp. 297–304.

47 C. Saumarez Smith, 'National consciousness, national heritage and the idea of "Englishness"', in Baker and Richardson (eds), *A Grand Design*, *op. cit.*, , pp. 1997, pp. 275–83, p. 279.

48 V. Wilson, 'Early textiles from Central Asia: approaches to study with reference to the Stein Loan Collection in the Victoria and Albert Museum, London', *Textile History*, vol. 26, no. 1 (1995), pp.23–52, esp. p. 38.

49 A.F. Kendrick, *Catalogue of Early Medieval Woven Fabrics*, V&A Museum, London, 1925.

50 See R.E. Fry et al., *Chinese Art. An Introductory Handbook to Painting, Ceramics, Textiles, Bronzes and Minor Arts*, B.T. Batsford Ltd., London, 1935. Kendrick wrote the chapter on textiles.

51 J. Lowry, 'Early Chinese silks', *CIBA Review* (CIBA Lrd, Basle), 1963/2, pp. 2–30.

52 See P. Collingwood, *The Techniques of Tablet Weaving*, Faber and Faber, London, 1982.

53 For her work on the textiles collected by Paul Pelliot in Dunhuang, see K. Riboud and G. Vial, *Tissus de Touen-houang conservés au Musée Guimet et la Bibliothèque Nationale*, Mission Paul Pelliot 13, Paris, 1970. See also K. Riboud, 'Some remarks on strikingly similar Han figured silks found in recent years in diverse sites', *Archives of Asian Art*, no. 26 (1972–73), pp. 12–25; and 'Further indication of changing techniques in figured silks of the Post-Han period', *Bulletin du CIETA*, vol. 41, no. 2 (1975), pp. 13–40.

54 D. King, 'Some notes on warp-faced compound weaves', *Bulletin du CIETA 28* (1968), pp. 9–19.

55 See A. Muthesius, 'Byzantine influences along the Silk Route: *Central Asian silks transformed', in Contact, Crossover, Continuity*, 1994 Proceedings of the Textile Society of America, published in 1997.

56 See R. Kerr (ed.), *Chinese Art and Design: the T.T. Tsui Gallery of Chinese Art, V&A Publications, London, 1991.*

57 Though the vast majority of the documents were Chinese Buddhist texts, the non-canonical and secular documents have been studied with the greatest interest. See Zhongguo shehui kexueyuan Lishi yanjiusuo, Zhongguo Dunhuang Tulufan xiehui Duhuang gu wenxian bianji weiyuanhui, *Ying cang Dunhuang wenxian* [Documents from Dunhuang in UK Collections], Sichuan renmin chubanshe, Chengdu, 1990–95, for the range of non-canonical materials and for materials in other languages also found in Cave 17, the website of the International Dunhuang Project: http://idp.bl.uk .

58 See, for example, J.-P. Drège, 'Les cahiers des manuscrits de Touen-houang', in M. Soymié (ed.) *Contributions aux etudes sur Touen-houang, Librairie Droz, Geneva and Paris*, 1979, pp. 17–28; and 'Papillons et tourbillons' in J.-P. Drège (ed.), *De Dunhuang au Japon: études chinoises et bouddhiques offertes à Michel Soymié*, Librairie Droz, Geneva, 1996, pp. 163–78.

59 Ogawa Yasuhiko, 'A study of the silk braids on Stein Chinese scrolls', *IDP News 27* (Spring 2006), pp. 6–7, http://idp.bl.uk/pages/archives_newsletter.a4d.

60 L. Giles, *A Descriptive Catalogue of the Chinese Manuscripts from Tunhuang in the British Museum*, British Museum, London, 1957.

61 See P. Lawson and M. Barnard, 'The preservation of pre-10th century graphic material', in S. Whitfield and F. Wood (eds), *Dunhuang and Turfan: Contexts and Conservation of Ancient Documents from Central Asia* (British Library Studies in Conservation Science 1), London, 1996, pp. 7–15.

62 It is probable that these had been selected by Laurence Binyon at some time during the First World War for despatch to India but never sent; see F. Wood, 'Two thousand years at Dunhuang', in Whitfield and Wood (eds), *Dunhuang and Turfan*, *op. cit.*, p. 4; and R. Whitfield, 'Four unpublished paintings from Dunhuang in the Oriental Collections of the British Library', *British Library Journal*, vol. 24, no. 1 (Spring 1998), pp. 90–97.

International Dunhuang Project: Working on Stein's Archaeological Legacy

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With eight full partners and over 30 collaborating institutions, the International Dunhuang Project (IDP) is an exemplar of using digital and web technology to bring dispersed archaeological treasures to all.[1] By the end of 2011 it offered free online access to almost 350,000 images and data on over 130,000 manuscripts, paintings and other artefacts from the remains of ancient Silk Road settlements skirting the Taklamakan, Lop and Gobi deserts in western China.

Over the past few years, IDP UK at the British Library (BL) has been working with the Xinjiang Institute of Archaeology (XJIA) to enhance the online resources specifically relating to the four Central Asian Expeditions of Aurel Stein (1862–1943). This article gives a brief introduction to the work of IDP before discussing this specific project.

IDP: history, partners and activities

History

IDP was established in 1994 following a meeting of curators and conservators from institutions worldwide holding major collections of archaeological materials from the explorations of Stein and his contemporaries. With the aim of sharing expertise, formulating international standards for conservation and making material more accessible through digitization and online access, they founded IDP. They agreed to set up a directorate in the British Library and to hold regular conferences and meetings.

Work started at the BL on creating a database suitable for holding information about the archaeological objects and their images and serving it online, and then on digitization of manuscripts from Stein's expeditions. The website, making several thousand images and data freely available, went online in 1998.

The use of 'Dunhuang' in IDP's name is somewhat misleading: its remit has always been the eastern Silk Road and not restricted to the site of Dunhuang. In fact, the first artefacts to be digitized were manuscripts from Stein's first expedition to sites in the Taklamakan. And, although IDP started with a focus on manuscripts, the whole range of archaeological artefacts is in scope, along with the related archives from the archaeological expeditions, including maps and photographs. For example, paintings, textiles and three-dimensional objects from the British Museum Stein collection started to become available on IDP from 2002.[2]

The Partnership Model

After the first meeting, the founding members of IDP held conferences every two years focused on the conservation of the material, but also discussing the development of the database and digitization at the BL. IDP also produces a regular newsletter and is actively engaged in fundraising to expand its activities. Its staff at the BL and many of its international activities were, and continue to be, largely dependent on external funds.[3]

In 2001 the British Library signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the National Library of China (NLC) to establish IDP China, a full centre with a digitization and cataloguing studio and a Chinese website served through a local server. The website, showing newly digitized images of

manuscripts from the NLC alongside those from the BL went online in November 2002, thanks to the support of the Sino-British Fellowship Trust (SBFT).

Other founder members followed to become full partners over the next decade, digitizing their own collections and hosting local language websites. As of 2012 there were IDP Centres in Beijing, Dunhuang, St Petersburg, Berlin, Paris, Kyoto, Seoul and, most recently, Stockholm. IDP partners are responsible for digitizing their collections and entering related metadata onto the IDP database. The data is synchronised across all servers so that users accessing the website in China, for example, see the same set of data and images as those accessing the data in Russia. But specific information, for example, details of local events, can be entered by partners onto their local website.

Partners might comprise collaborations by more than one institution: for example, IDP France consists of a collaboration between the Bibliothèque nationale de France and the Musée Guimet. In Berlin the Staatsbibliothek, the Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities and the Museum of Asian Art all contribute. In addition, partners act as regional hubs, hosting data and images from other institutions or individuals with smaller collections. So, for example, the National Library of China will be responsible for collecting information and data on Dunhuang and Central Asian collections throughout central China while the Dunhuang Academy will act as host for Dunhuang material in Gansu Province. Currently, the British Library hosts material from the British Museum, the Victoria and Albert Museum in London, the Library of the Hungarian Academy of Sciences in Budapest, the Chester Beatty Library in Dublin and several institutions in the USA.

In 2012 a programme started to update the IDP technology and to implement APIs (Application Programming Interfaces) to allow wider access to IDP material (subject to agreement by the institutional holders) on other interfaces and for the IDP interface to give access to related material on other servers.

Activities

Conservation, Cataloguing and Digitisation

IDP provides a model for an end-to-end workflow, from initial selection and conservation of the material through to cataloguing, digitization and online access, with quality control processes throughout. It aims to adhere to the highest standards where possible and, through onsite training, to enable the same standards to be implemented in all IDP Centres worldwide. Digitisation has the dual purposes of providing wider access while ensuring a digital archive for long-term preservation. The workflow ensures that the images become immediately available online with associated data.

Education

IDP has always hoped to bring the rich resources associated with Stein and others to as wide an audience as possible and, to this end, offers a range of educational resources.[4]

Research

IDP has always had the long-term objective of providing a space where scholars can locate most of the resources they require for their research, whether images of ancient manuscripts, archaeological site plans, journal articles, unpublished expedition papers or scientific datasets. Not only was the interface designed with all this material in mind, but IDP has also actively sought to collect and, where possible, create data to enable it to provide a holistic resource for a wide group of scholars.

IDP also has an active research programme.[5] For example, in 2011 it completed a five-year research project, led by Dr Sam van Schaik and Dr Imre Galambos, Research Project Managers of IDP, on the palaeography of Tibetan and Chinese manuscripts from the Stein Collection at the British Library. Since 2008 it has been actively engaged on research on the archaeological sites of the southern Taklamakan, a result of which is the enhancement of the research resources on Stein's expeditions to this region. This project is described below.

Stein's expeditions to the southern Taklamakan

As part of its remit to set the artefacts in context, in 2008 IDP started an EU-funded project called 'Cultural Routes of Eurasia', with the aims of strengthening links with Chinese scholars and institutions and bringing the legacy of Stein and other contemporary European explorers to a wider European public.[6] One of the major parts of this project was a research programme with XJIA to review Stein's expedition photographs, plans and notes, and make them fully available on IDP with enriched metadata including GIS.

Stein took over 4000 photographs during his four expeditions to this region: these are mainly in the collections of the British Library and the Library of the Hungarian Academy of Sciences. They have all been digitized and are freely available with catalogues on IDP. The project included a field trip to Xinjiang to revisit and document sites unearthed by Stein a century ago. Part of this documentation consisted of taking modern photographs matching those of Stein, thereby adding value to the BL collections and providing a valuable record to scholars of changes in archaeological sites over the past century. In addition, general documentation – photographic and video – was taken of some of the sites originally excavated by Stein in order to provide a more complete record. This visit took place in November 2008. It also included a visit by two young scholars from Xinjiang to the British Library, funded by the Sino-British Fellowship Trust.

Following the success of this project, in 2010 IDP signed a renewed MoU with XJIA for further field trips, for six-month internships at the British Library (funded by the World Collections Programme and involving collaboration with the British Museum), and for other collaborative research activities. The first intern arrived in London in October 2011 and a second field trip, to Niya and Karadong, took place in November 2012. A report of both trips and their results is given below.

2008: Karashahr, Miran, Endere, Rawak, Mazar Tagh and Khotan

The itinerary of the first expedition was restricted by budget and time to Stein sites that were reachable in a day in a four-wheel drive vehicle. A hundred years on from Stein and life for the traveller is easier in many obvious ways, not least among them the 4WD. Stein travelled by pony, with his supplies and finds packed on a camel train (**Fig. 1**). Such roads as existed were tracks often covered by sand. There was no telephone network or even telegraph in this region. A remarkably efficient postal network was, however, maintained by 'dak runners', who carried mail across the mountains to India and thence by ship to Europe.

In 2008 a programme of road improvement in Xinjiang resulted in newly tarmaced dual carriageway roads all around the Taklamakan and, at three points, across it. Three systems of stopping the sand dunes from burying the roads in their relentless movement are being tested and seem to be working. Wireless towers are found at regular intervals. There is a railway along both the northern and southern Taklamakan and numerous small airports, the former a development unwillingly foreseen by Stein, who anticipated 'the day, happily still far off, when Khotan will have its railway, and when all this busy life of the road will be transferred to stations and trains.'[7] However, the Taklamakan itself has not changed and once the main roads are left there is no certainty of being able to reach any given destination by vehicle. The team had to get out and walk to several sites when the vehicles could no longer negotiate the dunes. This resulted in reduced time at the sites — we were on a much less flexible timetable than Stein.

Another major improvement from Stein's time is the existence today of the XJIA and the Xinjiang Cultural Relics Bureau who have overall control of security and investigation of archaeological sites and the finds, as well as taking part in an ongoing programme of new excavations. Some of these are international efforts, such as the Sino-Japanese excavations at Niya (1988–97)[8] and the Sino-French explorations along the Keriya River (1991–4),[9] and have resulted in many new finds. The desert still has secrets to yield. The 2008 team was under the leadership of the XJIA Director, Idris Abdurusul, and it was thanks to the XJIA's excellent planning and knowledge of the region that the team was able to visit so many sites so successfully.



Figure 1 Stein's camel train on his Third Central Asian Expedition in 1913 (The British Library, Photo 392/28(252))

Stein wrote after his first expedition (1900–1) that he hoped the region would one day have its own museum. For many years now there have been major museums in Urumqi, Turfan and Khotan and all have recently moved to new and larger buildings with space for impressive displays. Along the southern Silk Road, the focus of Stein's attention and of this field trip, there are several new museums showcasing recent archaeological finds. A massive building in the rebuilt centre of Qiemo, for example, houses a museum on its ground floor that includes details of recent excavations, such as those of the cemetery at Zaghunluq. But a small museum has also been built over one of the tomb pits at the archaeological site itself a few kilometres outside the town, allowing visitors to see the mummies *in situ*.

Archaeological finds are not now automatically sent to the regional or national capital, some, at least, being kept at the places they were found to encourage local understanding and tourism. This was most noticeable at the site of Tuopukdun Temple outside Domoko. This miniature Buddhist temple was uncovered accidentally from its long burial in the desert sands by farmers in 2000. They contacted local archaeologists and a team carried out a careful excavation in 2002. Another temple was then discovered to its south and this was also carefully excavated. In 2007 a small museum was built on the site itself to house the remains of the temples and their finds.[10] Situated just south of Domoko, it is easily accessible and has captions in Chinese, Uighur and English. Stein would have been heartened to see these examples of the care taken to preserve and display archaeological sites and their artefacts today. He would also have been fascinated by these new discoveries that add to our understanding of life and culture in the ancient kingdom of Khotan.

The 2008 field trip took the combined team of fifteen from the XJIA and BL on a long drive south from Urumqi through the Tianshan ('Heavenly Mountains') to Korla, where we stopped to visit the temple site and caves at Karashahr. We then continued south across the desert road following the Tarim River before it disappears finally into the desert sands, and on to Ruoqiang (Stein's Charklik). From here we spent a day at the ruins of Miran, comprising a large area of Buddhist monasteries and stupas dating from the 2nd–4th centuries and a military fort built and occupied by Tibetan soldiers in the 8th–9th centuries.

At large sites with many structures, such as Miran, we found it helpful when one team member went on ahead to scout the locations, and the members of the XJIA and the local guides provided invaluable assistance in the identification of locations at many sites. But even with original plans of the sites, subsequent sand drifting and erosion often made accurate correlation between early photographs and existing structures difficult.

Unlike many of his contemporaries, Stein did not take a specialist photographer on his expeditions: he valued independence and travelled with Indian surveyors and servants, along with local guides and diggers, but with no other Europeans. He had learned the skills of photography from his colleague, Fred Andrews, during previous expeditions in northern India in the 1890s, and throughout his career he kept in touch with the latest technology in the

field. By the time of his first expedition he had become a competent photographer (and, equally important, a meticulous recorder of his photographic data) and photography was to form an integral component of his recording methods. While cumbersome and time-consuming to operate compared to modern equipment, photographic technology was sufficiently advanced by the early 20th century to enable Stein to work with compact, sturdy and easily transportable folding cameras, producing negatives measuring 5x7 inches and smaller.[11] While cameras became increasingly miniaturised in the early decades of the 20th century, photography on an extended expedition still required a degree of effort and planning that is largely foreign to the modern digital photographer. Sufficient supplies of chemicals and glass plates (and later film) had to be transported for long periods over climatically and geographically demanding terrains, and negatives had to be processed in often difficult circumstances. Given the competing demands on Stein's time – surveying, excavating, recording finds and all the associated logistics of managing major expeditions – it is remarkable that he managed to produce such a comprehensive record of his travels and archaeological discoveries.

Following in Stein's footsteps a century or more later, we had two digital photographic teams, each consisting of a photographer, a scout, a note-taker and someone to record GPS. We also took had a video operator. Apart from Idris Abdurusul, the XJIA team included the Deputy-Director, Li Wenying, and two young scholars, Hu Xingjun (from XJIA) and Yu Jianjun (from Xinjiang Cultural Relics Bureau). Yu and Hu joined the photographic teams to help in identification. They subsequently visited IDP at the British Library in summer 2009.

From Ruoqiang we travelled westwards, along the southern edge of the Taklamakan, to the museums at Qiemo (Cherchen) and then to Endere, a stupa, fort and other ruins in the desert. Stein travelled across much of the Taklamakan, visiting Karadong and Dandan Uiliq, but we did not have sufficient time on this visit to make the long trek required for these sites. The roads only go so far. Even with 4WD and skilful drivers, we inevitably got stuck several times en route to desert sites and had to walk the final few miles. Specialist sand vehicles and camels are essential for longer forays into the Taklamakan.

The greatest problem for our photographic teams in the desert areas was the shifting sands. Additionally, in desert conditions assessment of distances can be extremely problematic. For future work, an electronic rangefinder for measuring distances between structures and landscape features would be of major assistance in relating the present-day environment to historical plans. Another major problem posed with the replication of the Stein photographs was caused by the time of day. Having identified the position from which the original image was photographed we were often required to shoot directly into the sun or into deep shadow due to the sun being at its highest point in the sky. Had more time been available it would have been preferable to plan photography for the most appropriate time of day for the best photographic results.

From Endere we moved on to sites around Khotan, still a thriving jade town. One day was spent visiting Mazar Tagh, a three-hour drive along the new road north into the desert along the course of the Khotan River. This Tibetan fort, contemporaneous with the one at Miran, stands on the remains of what was possibly once a range of hills, but now consists of only a small bluff projecting over the river, thus commanding a strategic position to control the route south into Khotan. Because of the position of the remains on rock rather than sand and the distinctive and largely intact structure, some of the most effective matching photographs were taken here (**Figs. 2a and b**).

We also visited Yotkan, Melikawat, Aksipil and Rawak stupa, the last being another impressive Buddhist ruin among the shifting dunes, and one at which Stein left many statues for a future museum. He carefully re-covered them with sand only to discover on a subsequent expedition that they had been uncovered, possibly by treasure seekers, and largely destroyed. However, like most places we visited, the structure of the stupa has changed little since Stein's day (**Figs. 3a and b**). There has been some erosion, but very little. In some cases, there have also been repairs and rebuilds, but this is fairly rare.

The site at Rawak, as in other places in the area, is under the protection of the Khotan Bureau of Cultural Relics and Archaeology, and it is possible to acquire a permit to visit with a guide. The road leading to the site has a gatekeeper and it is clear that every effort is made to protect the site.

During our visits in Khotan we were joined by Matkasim Tomur of the Khotan Bureau who proved invaluable for his local knowledge of the sites. We had many opportunities to discuss Stein and his work during the trip with other team members and locals, and were surprised at the generally favourable response they gave to our questions. Although often vilified as an imperialist thief, there is also a respect among scholars and archaeologists for the value of his work and the documentation he left on the sites and their artefacts. His expedition reports are now available in Chinese and, at all the sites we visited, his site plans and numbering systems were familiar to the local archaeologists.

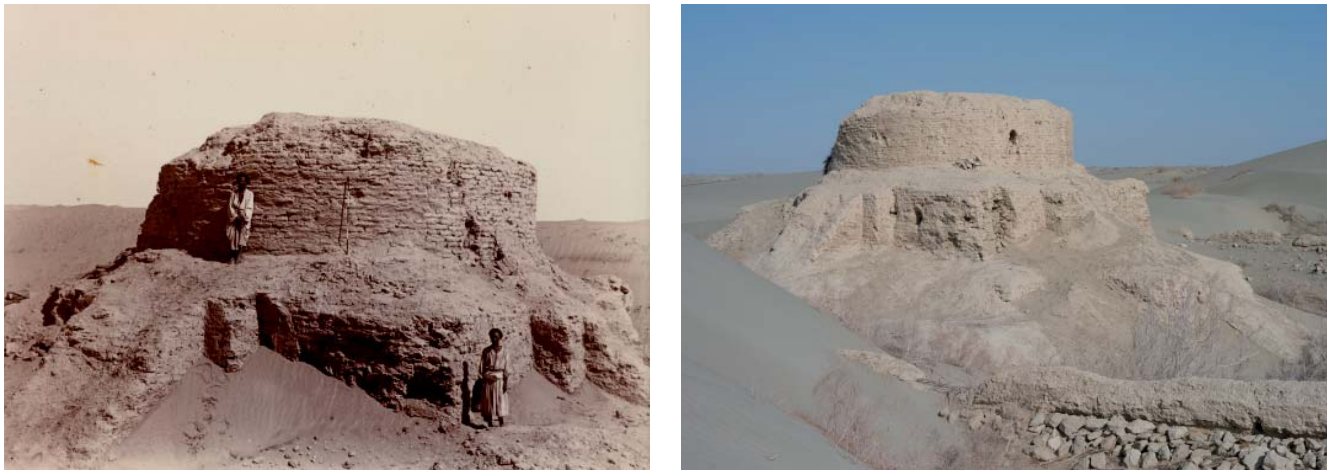
On our return, 410 new site images with metadata were added to the IDP database, thus making them freely available online.[12] They were linked to the original Stein photographs. A copy of the images and metadata was sent to the XJIA for their use. In addition to this, short videos were prepared of each site visited and added to the IDP YouTube channel.[13] Considerable additional work was also carried out on the structure of the IDP database to allow more information to be captured and made available on the sites.

2011: Niya and Karadong

The second field trip in November 2011 comprised a smaller team – five members from the British Library and five from XJIA – and visited Niya and Karadong, sites that are only accessible by sand vehicles or camel, requiring several nights' camping in the desert. The teams were again led by Idris Abdurusul, now retired as Director, and with Matkasim Tomur and Hu Xingjun from the 2008 team. The other members were Anwar Abdulkasim, XJIA Deputy Director, and Nijat Rozi, XJIA researcher. The IDP UK team was led by Susan Whitfield, Director of IDP, with Vic Swift and John



Figures 2a and b Mazar Tagh fort taken by Stein in November 1913 and by Vic Swift of IDP in November 2008 (The British Library, Photo 392/28(277) and Photo 1187/2(283))



FiguresF 3a and b Rawak stupa taken by Stein in September 1906 and by John Falconer of IDP in November 2008 (The British Library, Photo 392/26(154) and Photo 1125/16(387))

Falconer as photographers, Rachel Roberts taking video and photography, and Alastair Morrison as project interpreter and researcher.

Based on the lessons learned from 2008, three teams were formed each comprising two people, a photographer (or video operator) and note-taker. One team concentrated on replicating Stein's photographs, while the other two teams prepared overall photographic and video documentation of the sites. The other members of the group helped scout Stein's photographs and provided general support. Since XJIA had GPS readings of all the sites, there was no need to take these. Existing GPS documentation also formed an important aid in locating specific sites in the desert.

The main point of focus for this visit was the ancient kingdom of Caḍota (Niya), visited by Stein on all four of his Central Asian expeditions. His first knowledge of it came from the account of the 7th-century Chinese pilgrim monk, Xuanzang, his guide throughout the Taklamakan. However, Xuanzang visited when it was the small eastern frontier post for the kingdom of Khotan, whereas Stein soon found the sites he excavated dated mainly from a period several centuries earlier when it had been a larger kingdom in its own right. His first sign of the richness of its history was from two inscribed wooden tablets shown him by one of his camelmen while en route. The man had picked them up near the Imam-Ja'far-Sadik shrine after they had been discarded as worthless by a man called Ibrahim, whom Stein describes as 'an enterprising young villager'. He, in turn, had acquired them after digging in a house in the ancient remains (N.I.).[14] Stein recognized them as containing Kharoṣṭhī script of a type prevalent during the Kushan period in the earlier centuries of our era. On reaching the site he established camp near the stupa (**Fig. 4**) and the next day set off at sunrise 'with the temperature still well below zero Fahr., I hastened to the ruined building where Ibrahim had a year previously picked up his ancient tablets … I picked up at once three tablets inscribed with Kharoṣṭhī lying amidst the debris of massive timber which marked wholly eroded part of the ruined structure.'[15]



Figure 4 The stupa at Niya, where Stein camped on his First Expedition (Stein, *Ancient Khotan*, 1908, Fig. 38)

This was the start of a series of document finds that were to reveal the social and economic life of Caḍota's inhabitants (**Fig. 5**).[16] They are now in the collections of the British Library and the National Museum, New Delhi, and all the former are online on IDP. IDP continues discussion with the National Museum about making its share of these collections more accessible.

Niya is deep in the Taklamakan Desert and extensive, spanning 25km from north to south and 7km across. The terrain is very difficult. Specialist sand vehicle transport was therefore required. There is no shelter, water or, indeed, anything much apart from sand, at either site. Therefore all supplies, including tents, water, fuel, food, fodder and medical supplies, had to be purchased, packed and taken by the team. The initial days in Urumqi and Korla were occupied with planning, buying and loading supplies. This was excellently organised by XJIA.

Even in sand vehicles, travelling in the desert is slow (**Fig. 6**). Considerable detours are required to negotiate dunes, tamarisk cones and areas of soft clay deposits from spring and summer floods. Walking within and between adjacent areas in the sites was challenging because of the dunes.

From Korla the team took sand vehicles across the desert road, stopping one night at the Tarim River before arriving on the second evening at the village of Kapak-Askan (marked on Stein's maps) just south of the Imam-Ja'far-Sadik shrine. Here we stayed a night at the guesthouse of Kaysar Mahmut, guardian of the Niya site, before travelling with him to the centre of the Niya site (west of the stupa) and setting up camp (**Fig. 7**). During our five days at Niya, the first three were spent in the northern area and the final two in the south. Over twenty sites were documented, all but two of them being sites excavated by Stein. Locating and identifying the sites was helped greatly by the knowledge of Kaysar Mahmut and the GPS documentation prepared by the Sino-Japanese team.[17]

The nature of the Niya ruins was different from most of the sites visited in 2008. Apart from the stupa, the buildings had wooden frameworks with rush or tamarisk walls. All that can be seen of most of these are the much-eroded wooden wall posts, with an occasional horizontal roof beam and the remains of woven rush walling. The sand levels were often markedly different from those in Stein's photographs: where Stein had taken a photograph from the top of a dune, for example, there was now a depression. This made the matching of photographs very difficult. However, what was striking was the unchanging nature of the tamarisk cones over a hundred years, whose root systems create an effective binding resistance to the desert winds. In the south where they were most frequent, it was often possible to match views by recognizing the profile of a cone, for example, in the large site with vineyard that Stein numbered N.XLIV (93A24 in XJIA system). Stein had obviously also found them a useful vantage point: in several places his pictures are taken from the top of a cone, most noticeably in the panorama of N.XLI. (93A23) (**Fig. 8**).

It was a custom of Stein's to use people to provide scale in his photographs, and many were locals employed to help the excavations. These images were to prove of great interest to Kaysar Mahmut who recognized at least one person whose

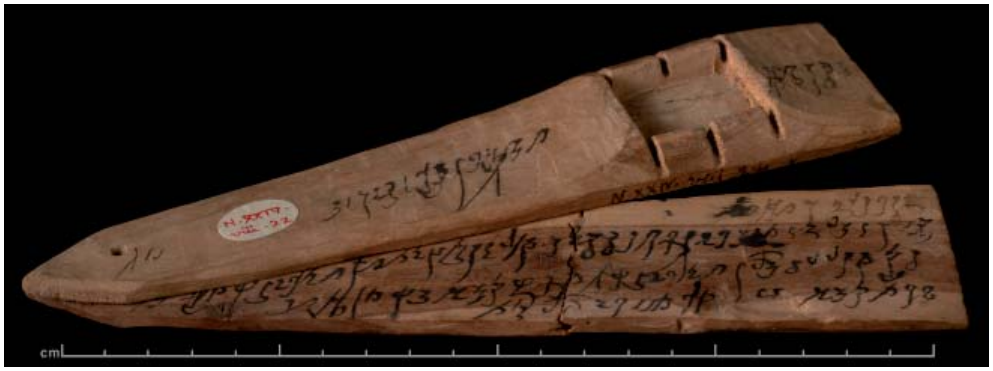


Figure 5 A typical manuscript from Niya excavated by Stein (The British Library, Or.8211/1415)



Figure 6 Sand vehicle negotiating the dunes in the northern part of Niya, taken by John Falconer, November 2011 (The British Library, Photo 1235/1(206))



Figure 7 Camp at Niya, November 2012, taken by John Falconer (The British Library, Photo 1235/1(269))



Figure 8 Panorama of Niya site N.XLI (93A23), taken by Vic Swift of IDP from the vantage point used by Stein (The British Library, Photo 1235/3(161))

descendants continue to live in his village (**Fig. 9a and b**).

On day three we drove through higher dunes to the east and, where they became impassable for the sand vehicles, got out and walked for a couple of kilometres. This took us to a cemetery, mostly hidden by the dunes but with scattered remains in the eroded depressions where robbers had been. This had been discovered by Kaysar Mahmut in 2005. The robbers had left the skulls, bones and pieces of the wooden coffin scattered carelessly on the surface. There were only a few pieces of silk and cotton textiles left of the grave goods for which, presumably, the robbers had come. But despite the circumstances of its uncovering, the continued discovery of new sites in the area is a potent reminder of the archaeological wealth which still remains beneath the sand.

The nature of the site and the terrain make it impossible to prevent such incidents, but the work of the Sino-Japanese team in recording the sites and the continued vigilance of Kaysar Mahmut ensure that they are reduced. Stein discovered over forty ruins, mainly dwellings with associated orchards and animals sheds. The Sino-Japanese team discovered some 250 ruins including temples, cemeteries, dwellings, manufacturies, earthen walls, animal sheds, orchards, reservoirs and lines of trees. These included the cemetery of the royal family. Details of all of these are being entered onto IDP.

Karadong, our next destination, was also visited by Stein on his first expedition, following the accounts by Sven Hedin of his visit in 1896 and those of Stein's guide, Turdi, 'whose "treasure-seeking" expeditions had twice extended to this place.'[18] It lies 150km from Keriya up the Keriya River, and the journey it took Stein six days on long marches, stopping en route to hire labourers. We covered his first five days of the journey in one, by 4WD vehicles for the 200km drive up the course of the Keriya River to the village of Daheyan or Darya Bayi, visible from a distance thanks to its newly erected China Mobile transmission tower. Although the river has reduced considerably at Daheyan it was still not possible to ford it and we crossed by a bridge, making our way to the house of Matsaydi Abla, guardian of the Keriya sites (**Fig. 10**). Stein noted here that he could discern three dry river beds spreading out in different directions 'like the fingers of a hand'[19] but he saw little on his march owing to the wind. The next day we slowed down to Stein's pace: the 15 camels hired for the trek to Karadong were loaded and we set out up the branches of the now dry river bed, passing farmsteads and herds of sheep and goats. At one place we were warned of wolves, but saw only deer and a remarkably fearless hare. Like Stein, we set out west across the dunes for the final few kilometres and set up camp near the ruin Stein called K.I.

The next day we were able to walk to all the sites noted by Stein, although only the quadrangle that he identified as a fortified frontier post or caravanserai, was from his first expedition. It was the most impressive, but also the most greatly changed, of all the sites we visited. Here, Stein had excavated a large wooden gateway with roof and door intact (**Fig. 11**). Only the frame remains today, with signs of a more recent fire showing the problems of preventing damage (**Fig. 12**).

The telecommunication mast signal did not penetrate the dunes so we only started receiving mobile signals on re-approaching the village. Stein received momentous news on his march back: his mail, brought by a mail runner from Keriya, told him of the death of Queen Victoria, filling him with 'deep emotion … with the disappearance from this worldwide scene of the greatest ruler of England.'[20]



Figure 9a Kaysar Mahmut at Niya site N.XXXVI, in November 2011, taken by Rachel Roberts of IDP (The British Library, Photo 1235/2(358))



Figure 9b The same site taken by Stein in 1906 with a villager recognized by Kaysar Maymut (The British Library, Photo 392/26(191))

Ongoing Work

Following the two field trips, it became apparent that the richness of the data would necessitate a redesign of the IDP user interface, for efficient searching, displaying and reusing of the complex and interlinked data. Planning for this started in early 2012, the first step being to raise funds to enable the work. Further activities under the MoU will also take place and full reports are given in *IDP News*.[21]

Conclusion

A century on and it seems as if Stein's hopes that the kingdoms of the Taklamakan deserved international attention and serious scholarship are finally being realised and, just as importantly, his own role in making this possible is also acknowledged.



Figure 10 The house of Matsaydi Abla, guardian of the Keriya sites, in Daheyan village, taken by Rachel Roberts in November 2011 (The British LIbrary, Photo 1235/2)



Figure 11 At Karadong Stein excavated a large gateway with roof and door intact (The Library of the Hungarian Academy of Sciences, Stein Photo 5/2(90))



Figure 12 The gateway at Karadong today, taken by Rachel Roberts in November 2011 (Photo 1235/2(431))

Notes

1 http://idp.bl.uk
2 See Michaelson's paper in this volume.
3 The archive of newsletter is online (http://idp.bl.uk/pages/archives_newsletter.a4d). For details of funders see http://idp.bl.uk/pages/about_funding.a4d
4 http://idp.bl.uk/pages/education.a4d
5 http://idp.bl.uk/pages/education_research.a4d
6 http://idp.bl.uk/idp_crea/index.htm
7 Stein, *Ruins of Desert Cathay*, 2 vols, London, 1912 vol. 1, p. 166.
8 中日日中共同尼雅遺跡学術調査隊 *Chū-Nichi Nitchū Kyōdō Niya Iseki Gakujutsu Chōsatai. 1996–2007*, 中日日中共同尼雅遺跡学術調査報告書 Chū-Nichi Nitchū kyōdō Niya Iseki gakujutsu chōsa hōkokusho, Kyoto.
9 C. Debaine-Francfort and Idriss Abduressul, Keriya, *Mémoires d'un fleuve: archéologie et civilisation des oasis du Taklamakan*, Paris, 2001.
10 See *IDP News* 32 (http://idp.bl.uk/archives/news32/idpnews_32.a4d)
11 On his first expedition, this was the recently introduced Sanderson Hand Camera. By 1906, he had acquired the Sinclair Una, a smaller camera which had come onto the market two years earlier.
12 Put 'Photo 1187' into database search box on idp.bl.uk to show all photographs. Click to see with Stein matches where applicable.
13 http://www.youtube.com/user/IDPUKvideo
14 M.A. Stein, *Ancient Khotan*, London, 1907, p. 312.
15 Stein, *Ancient Khotan*, p. 316.
16 Transcribed and translated originally by T. Burrow, *A Translation of the Kharosthi Documents from Chinese Turkestan* (James G. Forlong Fund, Vol. 20), The Royal Asiatic Society, London, 1940, see http://depts.washington.edu/silkroad/texts/niyadocts.html. For use of the documents to reconstruct the life of Caḍota's inhabitants see Mariner Ezra Padwa, 'An archaic fabric: Culture and landscape in an early Inner Asian Oasis (3rd–4th century C.E. Niya)', Dissertation for a PhD at Harvard University, 2007.
17 See endnote 8 above.
18 M.A. Stein, *Sand-Buried Ruins of Khotan*, London, 1903, p. 426.
19 *Ibid.*, p. 427.
20 *Ibid.*, p. 433.
21 http://idp.bl.uk/pages/archives_newsletter.a4d

Appendix: Conferences and Study Days relating to Sir Aurel Stein

So many Silk Road and Central Asian events have taken place around the world in the last twenty years that it would be impossible to list them all here. Many have focussed on particular themes, such as the Silk Road, Central Asia, Dunhuang, Buddhist art, ancient languages and scripts, religious studies, textiles and conservation. The five conferences and study days listed here have been selected to reflect the work that has taken place on the Stein Collections in London and Budapest, and to acknowledge the people who have done that work.

Sir Aurel Stein and Central Asia Study Day
London, 23 March 2002

This event was organised as one of a series of Central Asian study days at the British Museum. It also marked the launch of two books: the *Catalogue of the Collections in the Library of the Hungarian Academy of Sciences*, and *Sir Aurel Stein in The Times*. Most of the papers from this study day were published in the *Sir Aurel Stein, 23 March 2002* (British Museum Occasional Paper 142, 2004).

Sir Aurel Stein and his Hungarian background
Éva Apor (Library of the Hungarian Academy of Sciences)
Aurel Stein and the Hungarian Academy of Sciences
Ágnes Kelecsényi (Library of the Hungarian Academy of Sciences)
Aurel Stein, the photographer
John Falconer (British Library)
Reports, letters and bestsellers: Stein's writings about his First and Second Expeditions
Lilla Russell-Smith (British Museum)
A biographer's dilemma
Annabel Walker (author of Sir Aurel Stein, Pioneer of the Silk Road)
Stein's Fourth 'American Expedition' – or who was Milton Bramlette?
Shareen Blair Brysac (author of Tournament of Shadows: the Great Game and The Race for Empire in Asia)
Aurel Stein and Bahman Karimi on Old Routes of Western Iran
Vesta Curtis (British Museum)
Sir Aurel Stein in The Times
Helen Wang (British Museum)

Stein Aurél Emlekülés (Aurel Stein Conference)
Budapest, 13 May 2002

This conference was organised at the Hungarian Academy of Sciences in Budapest to celebrate the completion of the UK-Hungarian project to catalogue the Stein archive material in Budapest and the launch of the *Catalogue of the Collections of Sir Aurel Stein in the Library of the Hungarian Academy of Sciences*.

Köszöntő (Greeting words)
Gyula Wojtilla

Stein Aurél expediciói Közép-Ázsiában (Aurel Stein's expeditions in Central Asia)
János Harmatta
A Stein gyűjtemény digitalizálása a British Museumban: új technológia a kutatás es ismeretterjesztés szolgálatában (Digitising the Stein Collection in the British Museum: a new technology serving research and the dissemination of information)
Lilla Russell-Smith (British Museum)
Sir Aurel Stein in The Times
Helen Wang (British Museum)
Aurel Stein, the photographer
John Falconer (British Library)
Szanszkrit kéziratok nyomán Kasmirban (Tracing Sanskrit manuscripts in Kashmir)
Gyula Wojtilla
Stein Aurél és a magyar tudományos élet (Aurel Stein and Hungarian academic life)
Ágnes Kelecsényi
Stein, az iranisztika es a magyar-brit közös projekt (Stein, Iranian studies and the Hungarian-British joint project)
Éva Apor

Zárszó (Concluding words)

Inauguration of the Aurel Stein Exhibition (Vasarely Hall, LHAS)
Attila Meskó (Hungarian Academy of Sciences)

Wreath-laying ceremony at Aurel Stein's birthplace
1051 Budapest, Tüköry u. 2

The South Asian Legacy of Sir Aurel Stein – Conference
Leicester, 6–7 March 2004

This conference was organised by PRASADA (South Asian Arts) of De Montfort University, Leicester, in collaboration with the Circle of Inner Asian Art, University of London, with support from the British Academy, Circle of Inner Asian Art and the Society for South Asian Studies (British Academy). Its aim was to draw attention to Stein's contribution to the study of South Asia, most of which in his lifetime was part of British India. Born as a Hungarian, Stein became a British subject and lived for most of his life in British India. His work in the field of textual scholarship, archaeology or topography of the North-Western peripheries of the subcontinent, that is Kashmir, the North-Western Frontiers, Sistan and Baluchistan, played a direct role in our understanding of ancient South Asia, while most of his explorations were undertaken to investigate India's contact with neighbouring regions and the spread of her material and spiritual wealth in the surrounding areas. His achievements in the field of South Asian textual and material studies opened up new ways of research that are as important today as in his own time. The papers of this conference presented aspects of present-day research linked to South and Central Asia on material collected by Stein as well as his personal contact with South Asia and with his native country, Hungary, where he was first inspired to study

the ancient culture of India. It was planned to publish a volume of the conference proceedings, however this has not been possible.

Saturday 6 March
Introductory Remarks
Helen Wang (British Museum)

Stein Collections and South Asia
The Stein Collection from Central Asia at the Lahore Museum
Anjum Rehmani (Lahore Museum)
The Stein Collection at the Ashmolean Museum, Oxford
Madhuvanti Ghose (Ashmolean Museum and CIAA)
Precious stone and glass artifacts from the Stein Collection in the British Museum
Cecilia Braghin (British Museum)
Coins from Kashmir: Sir Aurel Stein's Collection in the Heberden Coin Room, Ashmolean Museum, Oxford
Shailendra Bhandare (Ashmolean Museum)

Stein and South Asian Texts
Interpreting Gandhari Prakrit texts (paper read in absentia)
János Harmatta (Eotvos Lorand University)
Kashmir-Kanyakubja Stuggle: the Rajatarangini and beyond. A tribute to Aurel Stein
Ashvini Agrawal
Religion and politics in Kashmir at the turn of the tenth century
Csaba Dezsö
The Kashmirian Sarada manuscripts of the Abhijnanasakuntala in the Stein Collection
Somdev Vasudeva (Wolfson College, University of Oxford)

Stein and South Asian Art
Indian connections in the art of Dunhuang: the silk painting of famous images in the Stein Collection, London and New Delhi
Roderick Whitfield (SOAS)
Indo-Tibetan influences in banners from Dunhuang, Central Asia. A tribute to Stein
Chhaya Bhattacharya-Haesner (Independent scholar)

Sunday, 7 March
Stein and South Asian Archaeology
Sir Aurel Stein's survey of the Thar Desert in 1940–42 and its impact on Indus archaeology
Mohammad Rafique Mughal (Boston University)
Stein's discovery of Kanishkapur unveiled in the centennial excavations in 1998–99 in Kashmir
B.R. Mani (Institute of Archaeology, New Delhi)
Alexander's route and Stein: from Messaga to Ora
Abdur Rehman (Punjab University)
Alexander's crossing of the River Jhelum with reference to Stein
M. Salim (Quaid-e Azam University)

Stein, Hungary and South Asia
Aurel Stein and Hungarian scholarship
Ágnes Kelecsényi (Library of the Hungarian Academy of Sciences)
Sir Aurel Stein's photographs in the collection of the Hungarian Academy of Sciences
Lilla Russell-Smith (Circle of Inner Asian Art)
Aurel Stein's correspondence with the Hungarian Indologist Ervin Baktay
Géza Bethlenfalvy (Hungarian Academy of Sciences; Eotvos Lorand University)
Remembering Sir Aurel Stein: from unmapped accounts of his Kashmir labours
Surinder Nath Pandita (Independent researcher)

Concluding Remarks
Roderick Whitfield (SOAS)

A Hundred Years of Dunhuang, 1907-2007
London, 17–19 May 2007

This conference, organised by the British Academy, the British Library and the British Museum, took place in London, 17–19 May 2007. The aim of the conference was 'to mark the centenary of Sir Aurel Stein's discovery of a hidden library in Cave 17 at the Buddhist Caves, Dunhuang, and to reflect on the discovery, to review its impact on "oriental studies" including the writing and re-writing of history and to discuss directions for the future.' Speakers from different disciplines were invited to give short papers on their research lasting no longer than 15 minutes. We had originally hoped to publish the conference proceedings, but the range of subjects proved too vast (and thus too demanding) to do this in a useful way. However, many of the papers have since been published elsewhere, and many delegates have confirmed that friendly conversations at the conference brought people from different disciplines together and sowed the seeds for new projects. The programme of the conference is published here as a record of the occasion.

Thursday 17 May 2007
The Discovery of Cave 17
Chairs: Helen Wang (British Museum) and Frances Wood (British Library)
Sir Aurel Stein, archaeological-explorer
Susan Whitfield (International Dunhuang Project, British Library)
Rudolf Hoernle and Aurel Stein
Ursula Sims-Williams (British Library)
Lajos Lóczy, who encouraged Stein to go to Dunhuang
Lilla Russell-Smith (Circle of Inner Asian Art)
Aurel Stein's dealings with Wang Yuanlu and Chinese officials of Dunhuang in 1907
Wang Jiqing (Lanzhou University)
Spreading the word: Aurel Stein and Count Otani
Imre Galambos (International Dunhuang Project, British Library)
Pictures of Dunhuang – a photographic record in London and Hungary
John Falconer (British Library)
The Dunhuang Collections in London, 1907-2007
Helen Wang and Frances Wood

Exploring Dunhuang: The Contents of Cave 17
Chair: Valerie Hansen (Yale University)
On some silk painting fragments in the British Museum
Roderick Whitfield (Emeritus Professor, SOAS)
Dunhuang and the history of the Chinese book
Jean-Pierre Drège (Ecole Pratique des Hautes Etudes, Paris)
Textiles from Dunhuang in the V&A
Helen Persson (V&A)
New studies on the textiles from Dunhuang

Zhao Feng (China National Silk Museum, Hangzhou)
The Dunhuang collections in Paris
Nathalie Monnet (Bibliothèque Nationale, Paris)
The Dunhuang collections in St Petersburg
Irina Popova (Institute of Oriental Studies, St. Petersburg)
Private Dunhuang-related collections in Japan
Akao Eikei (Kyoto National Museum)
The banners from Dunhuang, in the Stein Collection of the National Museum, New Delhi
Chhaya Bhattacharya-Haesner

Friday 18 May 2007
New Research on Chinese and Khotanese Texts
Chair: Wang Tao (SOAS/University College London)
A survey of the newly discovered documents in Turfan (1997-2006)
Rong Xinjiang (Peking University)
New research on the Chinese texts
Fang Guangchang (Shanghai Normal University)
New research on the Chinese Texts
Hao Chunwen (Shanghai Normal University)
The Kozanji Temple Buddhist Scripture Project
Harumichi Ishizuka
New research on the Khotanese texts
Oktor Skjaervo (Harvard University)
New research on the Khotanese texts
Hiroshi Kumamoto (University of Tokyo)

New Research on Texts
Chair: Graham Shaw (British Library)
Buddhist Sogdian texts and their Chinese originals
Barbara Meisterernst (Turfanforschung, Berlin), Desmond Durkin-Meisterernst (Turfanforschung, Berlin)
The earliest Sogdian texts: Stein's 'Ancient Letters' and the newly discovered inscriptions from Southern Kazakhstan
Nicholas Sims-Williams (SOAS)
New research on the Sogdian texts
Yutaka Yoshida (Kyoto University)
Recent research on Tocharian texts
Georges-Jean Pinault (Ecole Pratique des Hautes Etudes, Paris)
New research on texts
Peter Zieme (Berlin-Brandenburgische Akademie der Wissenschaften)
A magic text from Dunhuang and recent studies in Kharosthi manuscripts
Ingo Strauch (Freie Universität Berlin)
The Impact of the finds at Dunhuang on Tibetan Studies
Tsuguhito Takeuchi (Kobe City University of Foreign Studies)
Scientific analysis of paper specimens of the ancient Uighur documents and manuscripts in the the Otani collection
Enami Kazuyuki (Ryukoku University)
The Altun Yaruk Sudur - reconstructed
Simone-Christiane Raschmann (Turfanforschung, Berlin)

Saturday 19 May 2007
Dunhuang in the Future
Chair: Oktor Skjaervo (Harvard University)
Updates on Dunhuang projects
The International Dunhuang Project
Susan Whitfield (IDP, BL)
Stein Collections and Stein Projects in the Library of the Hungarian Academy of Sciences
Éva Apor (LHAS)
Critical Edition of the British Collection of Dunhuang Documents
Hao Chunwen (Shanghai Normal University)
Recent and future activities of the International Liaison Committee for Dunhuang Studies
Tokio Takata - Kyoto University
The politics of preservation and museum building in Western China in the early twentieth century
Sanchita Balachandran
Locating Dunhuang in the broader history of the Silk Road
Valerie Hansen (Yale University)

Dunhuang and its place in world history and culture
Chairs: Roderick Whitfield (SOAS) and Victor Mair (University of Pennsylvania)

Closing remarks
Frances Wood (British Library)

Dunhuang: Past, Present, Future — Sir Aurel Stein and Dunhuang (conference) 14–15 December 2007

This conference, organised by the East Asian Department of the Lóránd Eötvös University of Humanities (ELTE), Budapest and the Circle of Inner Asian Art (CIAA), School of Oriental and African Studies (SOAS), University of London took place in Stein's hometown, Budapest, to commemorate the hundredth anniversary of his expedition to Dunhuang. One aim of the conference was to take an up-to-date view of the links of Stein to Hungarian scholarship throughout his life. Stein always acknowledged the important role of Lajos Lóczy, who drew his attention to the importance of Dunhuang. Lóczy himself went there as early as 1879 with an Austro-Hungarian expedition organised by Count Béla Széchenyi. Other papers looked at the changing assessment of Stein's role in China, and recent work on Stein's collections in various countries around the world. Many of the papers have since been published, several of them in the *Journal of Inner Asian Art and Archaeology*, the journal founded by the CIAA. The conference was made possible by support from the Chiang Ching-kuo Foundation and the Chinese World Cultural Heritage Foundation.

Stein's Changing Image in China and Other Explorers
Chair: Michael Friedrich (University of Hamburg)
The negotiations for Cave 17: a case-study in archaeological method
Valerie Hansen and Valeria Lopez-Fadul (Yale University)
Confronting Indiana Jones: The Chinese conquest of Sir Aurel Stein and the raiders of Dunhuang, 1900–44
Justin Jacobs (University of California, San Diego)
Otani Kozui and European explorers of Central Asia
Imre Galambos (International Dunhuang Project, British Library)

Stein and Hungary
Chair: Gyula Wojtilla (University of Szeged)
Sir Aurel Stein's books in Hungarian
Szabolcs Felföldi (University of Szeged)

The photographic and manuscript collections of Sir Aurel Stein at the Hungarian Academy of Sciences
Éva Apor (Library of the Hungarian Academy of Sciences)
Sir Aurel Stein's photographs as unique visual documents in the research of Dunhuang art
Lilla Russell-Smith (Asian Art Museum, National Museums in Berlin and CIAA)
Visit to the Oriental Collection of the Library of the Hungarian Academy of Sciences
Kinga Dévényi (Library of the Hungarian Academy of Sciences)
Visit to the exhibition 'The Silk Road's Secret Treasures: Sir Aurel Stein and the Caves of the Thousand Buddhas' (exhibition curated by Ágnes Kelecsényi, in the Vasarely Room, Library of the Hungarian Academy of Sciences. This exhibition was specially mounted to coincide with the conference: 22 Nov – 17 Dec 2007).
Lajos Lóczy, Sir Aurel Stein and Dunhuang
Ágnes Kelecsényi (Library of the Hungarian Academy of Sciences)

Recent Research on Manuscripts and Paintings found in Dunhuang
Chair: Valerie Hansen (Yale University)
Huayan texts from Dunhuang
Imre Hamar (ELTE)
The Manichaean Turkish texts of the Stein Collections
Peter Zieme (Berlin-Brandenburgische Akademie der Wissenschaften)
Mañjuśrī at Dunhuang: iconography and iconology
Robert M. Gimello (University of Notre Dame, Indiana)
Pseudo-Buddhist expressions in the Chinese Manichaia from Dunhuang
Gábor Kósa (Dharma-Gate Buddhist College, Budapest)
Putting together the pieces: fragments of silk paintings from the Library Cave
Roderick Whitfield (SOAS)

The Origins of Printing in Dunhuang
Origins of Zen printing in Dunhuang
Tim Barrett (SOAS)
Early devotional prints in China: technique, format and function
Anne Farrer (Sotheby's Insitute of Arts, London)

The Collections of Stein Material, Recent Projects and On-going Work
Recent results in the research of Dunhuang at the British Museum
Jane Portal (British Museum)
Caring for the Stein Collection: learning from the past
Frances Wood (British Library)